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Mingachevir State University



MINGACHEVIR
STATE
UNIVERSITY



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TABLE OF CONTENTS

TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH

ADDRESSING CURRICULAR CONSTRAINTS: ENHANCING CRITICAL THINKING AND ANALYTICAL SKILLS AMONG ENGLISH LEARNERS IN SECONDARY EDUCATION	
N. ALIYEVA.....	14
LINGUISTIC APPROACH TO TEACHING EXTENSIVE READING IN SLA	
A.R. MİKAYİLOVA.....	18
THE EFFECTIVENESS OF INTERACTIVE TASKS IN DEVELOPING WRITTEN SPEECH	
A.K. BAGLANKYZY.....	26
EFFECTIVE USE OF SOCIAL INTERACTION METHODS IN THE PROCESS OF LEARNING A FOREIGN LANGUAGE IN HEIS	
N. S. MORHUNOVA, S.O. PRYKHODKO.....	33
INTERACTIVE METHODS OF TEACHING ENGLISH	
G. E. SEİDOVA	40
WHY FIXED PHRASES AND COLLOCATIONS MATTER IN LANGUAGE LEARNING	
S. ELYILDIRIM.....	45
LISTENING STRATEGIES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE INSTRUCTION AND THEIR PEDAGOGICAL APPLICATIONS	
K.Y. ISGANDAROVA.....	54
THE EFFECTIVENESS OF MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN TEACHING ENGLISH	
R.K. HUSEYNOVA, Y.M. MEHBALIYEVA.....	58
THE MAIN METHODS SHAPING INTERACTIONS	
M.A. ORUJOV.....	64
INNOVATIONS IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING: INTEGRATING TASK-BASED LEARNING AND DIGITAL TOOLS IN HIGHER EDUCATION	
P. CHABAL, G. B. NASIROVA.....	69
RE-ENVISIONING LANGUAGE ASSESSMENT: A COMPREHENSIVE PARADIGM SHIFT TOWARD ALTERNATIVE STRATEGIES IN MODERN EFL HIGHER EDUCATION	
A. GARAD	74
COMMUNICATIVE LANGUAGE TEACHING RECONSIDERED: FOSTERING INTERACTION AND LEARNER AUTONOMY IN MODERN CLASSROOMS	
A. MENDEKENOVA.....	79
DEVELOPING RECEPTIVE AND PRODUCTIVE SKILLS: A MULTIMODAL APPROACH TO EFL INSTRUCTION	
M. ALI.....	82

THE EFFECTIVENESS OF COMMUNICATIVE LANGUAGE TEACHING IN MODERN EFL CLASSROOMS	
N. MURADOV, M.S. OZODOVA.....	86
DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS IN MODERN LANGUAGE EDUCATION	
D.A. KARIMOVA.....	92
INNOVATIVE APPROACHES IN MILITARY ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING: THE INTERSECTION OF TEACHING AND TESTING	
C.V. BADALOVA.....	97
THE ROLE OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND DIGITAL PLATFORMS IN LANGUAGE TESTING AND EVALUATION: A CRITICAL ANALYSIS	
A.G. SHAJAN.....	100
INTEGRATION OF LITERATURE INTO A FOREIGN LANGUAGE: LINGUDIDACTIC AND CULTURAL ASPECTS	
A.I. IBRAHIMOVA.....	104
TEACHING VOCABULARY THROUGH CONTEXTUAL GUESSING STRATEGIES	
O. MYRZABEK, S.K. ABADILDAYEVA.....	107
THE IMPORTANCE OF USING THE COMMUNICATIVE METHOD IN TEACHING A FOREIGN LANGUAGE	
S.Q. SAFAROVA.....	114
THE IMPORTANCE OF TEACHING CORRECT PRONUNCIATION IN ENGLISH LESSONS	
H.S. VALIYEVA.....	118
STRATEGIES FOR THE EFFECTIVE DEVELOPMENT OF LISTENING, SPEAKING, READING, AND WRITING SKILLS IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE ACQUISITION	
K.Y. YAHYAYEVA.....	123
THE ROLE OF MOTIVATION IN LEARNING ENGLISH	
A.A. GAZIYEVA.....	126
THE IMPACT OF AUTHENTIC READING MATERIALS ON ESL LEARNERS' FLUENCY AND COMPREHENSION	
J.Q. AGHAYEVA.....	131
MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING	
S.Z. RUSTAMOVA	137
PROBLEMS AND SOLUTIONS IN LANGUAGE TEACHING IN THE MODERN ERA	
A.R. QADIROVA.....	141
DEVELOPING WRITING AND SPEAKING SKILLS THROUGH SOCIAL MEDIA	
T.A. BERKHATKYZY.....	146
THE ROLE OF INTERACTIVE METHODS IN IMPROVING ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS	
T.A. HAMIDOVA.....	153

COGNITIVE AND METACOGNITIVE STRATEGIES IN TEACHING LISTENING COMPREHENSION IN EFL CONTEXTS	
G.I. VALIYEVA.....	155
A SYSTEMATIC REVIEW OF CONTENT AND LANGUAGE INTEGRATED LEARNING RESEARCH IN THE TURKISH CONTEXT	
U. CEYLAN.....	159
THE ROLE OF AI IN BRIDGING THE GAP BETWEEN RECEPTIVE UNDERSTANDING AND PRODUCTIVE OUTPUT	
T.S. KHUDAVERDIYEVA.....	165
BLENDED LEARNING: AN INTEGRATIVE APPROACH TO CONTEMPORARY EDUCATION	
S.S. ABDURAHMANOVA.....	171
TECHNOLOGY OF TEACHING POETRY TO DEAF STUDENTS WITH SEVERE HEARING DISORDERS	
T.H. AGHAYEVA	177
BEYOND GRAMMAR: INNOVATIVE APPROACHES TO TEACHING ENGLISH IN MODERN CLASSROOMS	
S.I. SADIGOVA.....	183
ENHANCING EFL LEARNING: A MIXED-METHODS EVALUATION OF PEDAGOGICAL EFFECTIVENESS AND CULTURAL RELEVANCE IN GENERAL ENGLISH TEXTBOOKS	
S.A. AZIZ.....	189
INTEGRATED DEVELOPMENT OF LISTENING, SPEAKING, READING AND WRITING SKILLS IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING	
F. HASANOVA	194
EARLY FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING AND ITS CHARACTERISTICS	
A.H. ZEYNALOVA.....	199
THE ROLE OF ACTIVE PRACTICE IN STRENGTHENING FOREIGN LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY	
A.M. AZIZOVA	210
PROBLEMS OF TEACHING ENGLISH IN AZERBAIJAN: AN EMPIRICAL STUDY	
L.S. GOCAYEVA.....	215
EXPLORING MODERN METHODOLOGIES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE EDUCATION	
E. QARASHOVA.....	221
EVOLUTION OF LANGUAGE TEACHING METHODS AND APPROACHES: FROM TRADITIONAL MODELS TO COMMUNICATIVE PRACTICES	
S.A. IBRAHIMOVA.....	225
TEACHING ENGLISH IN A BILINGUAL EDUCATIONAL ENVIRONMENT: CHALLENGES AND EFFECTIVE STRATEGIES ACROSS DIFFERENT LEARNING CONTEXTS	
S. GANIJONOVA.....	232

INTERACTIVE ACTIVITIES AND SPEAKING SKILL DEVELOPMENT IN UNIVERSITY EFL COURSES

S.K. GOJAYEVA.....	240
THE ROLE OF MOTIVATION IN TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH AS A FOREIGN LANGUAGE	
M.M. MAMMADOVA.....	246
MODERN TRENDS IN LANGUAGE ASSESSMENT: METHODS, PRACTICES, AND LIMITATIONS	
K. MAMMADOVA.....	250
MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING	
A.V. AHMEDOVA.....	254
THE ROLE OF MUSIC IN THE PROCESS OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING	
F.M. YUSIFLI.....	256
FROM READING TO THINKING: THE DEVELOPMENTAL POTENTIAL OF FOREIGN LITERATURE IN PRIMARY CLASSES	
G.A. VALIYEVA.....	265
ASSESSMENT AND EVALUATION METHODS IN LANGUAGE TEACHING	
S.G. MAMMADOVA.....	271
DEVELOPING FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS THROUGH AN INTEGRATED APPROACH IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING	
U.M. MAMMADOVA.....	275
DATA-DRIVEN APPROACHES TO TEACHING ECONOMICS: ENHANCING STUDENT ANALYTICAL SKILLS	
U. I. SEYIDOV.....	281
THE BARRIERS OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING	
G. ZEYNALOVA.....	289
THE ROLE OF ECOLOGICAL EDUCATION IN AZERBAIJAN LANGUAGE LESSONS IN GRADES V–XI	
V.R. ALIZADE.....	294
PROBLEMS TERMINOLOGICAL STYLE OF SPEECH IN TEACHING BIOLOGY SUBJECTS	
A.M. HASANOVA.....	300
THE USE OF COMMUNICATIVE AND INTERACTIVE TEACHING METHODS IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE CLASSES	
Z.M. AZIZOVA, G.T. ABBASOVA.....	303
DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS (LISTENING, SPEAKING, READING, WRITING)	
A.S. ATAYEVA.....	307
INTERACTIVE TEACHING STRATEGIES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE LEARNING: ENHANCING STUDENT ENGAGEMENT AND COMMUNICATION SKILLS	
N.N. ABILOVA.....	314

A SKILL-ORIENTED APPROACH TO FOREIGN LANGUAGE ACQUISITION	
N.O. MAMMADOVA.....	320
THE EFFECTS OF SKIMMING AND SCANNING TECHNIQUES ON 5TH GRADE STUDENTS' READING SPEED AND COMPREHENSION	
S. YOLDASH.....	323
THE USE OF INNOVATIVE TEACHING METHODS IN TEACHING ENGLISH AT SPECIALIZED MILITARY EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS	
E.H. GULIYEVA.....	328
QUALITY PROBLEMS IN TEACHING ENGLISH IN REGIONAL SCHOOLS: THE CASE OF SHAKI DISTRICT SECONDARY SCHOOL	
B. MAHMUDOVA.....	334
FROM ADOLESCENCE TO ADULTHOOD: EVOLUTIONARY APPROACHES TO ELT FOR THE 10-20 AGE GROUP	
N.Y. MEHDIZADE.....	338
PRINCIPLES AND CRITERIA FOR SELECTING AUTHENTIC TEXTS IN TEACHING DIALOGIC COMMUNICATION TO SECOND-YEAR STUDENTS OF A LANGUAGE UNIVERSITY	
A.N. ABBASOVA.....	343
FACTORS AFFECTING ELT FRESHMEN'S WILLINGNESS TO SPEAK ENGLISH AS A FOREIGN LANGUAGE	
A.E. HASDEMİR.....	347
ACADEMIC STRATEGIES FOR DEVELOPING ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS IN HIGHER EDUCATION	
G.S. NOVRUZOVA.....	351
THE ROLE OF INTERACTIVE TEACHING METHODS IN IMPROVING THE QUALITY OF EDUCATION	
G.M. ABDULLAYEVA.....	356
INNOVATIVE ASSESSMENT STRATEGIES IN TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH	
S.SH. HEYDAROVA, G.M. ASLANOVA.....	361
INQUIRY-BASED TEACHING: PROMOTING STUDENT AGENCY AND FORMATIVE LEARNING	
G.K. ISKANDAROVA, K.K. ISKANDAROVA.....	368
THE ROLE OF COMMUNICATIVE COMPETENCE IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING: A READING-BASED APPROACH	
A.T. IBISHOVA.....	375
MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING	
E. I. ALLAHVERDIYEV.....	381
FACTORS INFLUENCING STUDENT PARTICIPATION IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE CLASSROOMS	
B. CAPAR.....	385

STRATEGIES FOR DEVELOPING LISTENING COMPREHENSION IN ENGLISH LEARNERS	
N.I. GASIMOVA	391
DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS	
C.R. OSMANLI.....	396
A COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS OF LOCAL AND GLOBAL REPRESENTATIONS IN THE 5TH GRADE ENGLISH TEXTBOOK	
M. KOCH.....	399
RETHINKING ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING IN HIGHER EDUCATION: COMMUNICATIVE SKILLS AND DIGITAL LEARNING INTEGRATION	
A.A. GOJAYEVA.....	405
RETHINKING COMMUNICATIVE LANGUAGE TEACHING: MICRO-INTERACTION TASKS AS A SUSTAINABLE MODEL FOR CONTEMPORARY EFL CLASSROOMS	
N.N. KARIMOVA.....	413
THE ROLE OF READING IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING: STRATEGIES, TEXT ANALYSIS, AND COMMUNICATIVE DEVELOPMENT	
Z.R. MAMMADOVA.....	417
FROM THEORY TO TALK: BRIDGING THE GAP BETWEEN CLT AND CLASSROOM INTERACTION	
K.Y. LATIFOVA.....	422
ACQUISITION-BASED ELT: METHODS, SKILLS, AND EVALUATION	
Z.Z. ISMAYILOVA.....	427
STUDENT-CENTERED APPROACHES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING: INSIGHTS FROM TKT AND TESOL	
Q.F. HAJIYEV.....	432
ENHANCING YOUNG LEARNERS' ENGAGEMENT IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE CLASSES: CONTEMPORARY PEDAGOGICAL APPROACHES AND CLASSROOM PRACTICES	
L.R. ZOHRABZADE.....	436
DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS	
J.V. ABBASOVA	443
WHY LANGUAGE LEARNERS UNDERSTAND ENGLISH BUT STRUGGLE TO SPEAK IT	
T.T. ADIGOZALOVA.....	447
NEW TRENDS IN LEARNING AND TEACHING ENGLISH LANGUAGE: SHADOWING, CHUNKING, ETC.	
A.N. YUSIFZADE.....	451
APPLIATION OF NEW METHODOLOGY IN TEACHING PROVERBS	
G.S. HAJIYEVA.....	455
EARLY FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING AND ITS CHARACTERISTICS	
A.Q. RAHIMLI.....	459

EXPLORING THE GAPS BETWEEN EXPECTATIONS AND REALITY: A STUDY OF FIRST-YEAR ELT STUDENTS	
N.N. BELGE	465
DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS: EFFECTIVE STRATEGIES FOR SPEAKING, READING, LISTENING, AND WRITING	
N. HAYDAROVA	471
THE ROLE OF MOTIVATION IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING	
T.S. NASIBLI	476
INNOVATIVE APPROACHES TO ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING IN THE POST-PANDEMIC ERA	
M.T. ALIYEVA	480
THE IMPACT OF AN ANALYTICAL AND CRITICAL THINKING COURSE ON EFL STUDENTS' PERCEPTIONS AND ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING	
N. YILDIRIM	485
INNOVATIVE METHODS FOR EFFECTIVE ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING IN UNIVERSITIES	
X.D. RZAYEVA	491
THE DEVELOPMENT OF ORAL SPEECH SKILLS IN RURAL SECONDARY SCHOOLS WITHOUT ICT	
N.N. AZIZLI	498
MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN TEACHING THE ENGLISH LANGUAGE	
K.Z. NAZARLI	501
TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH LANGUAGE	
N.I. HAJIYEVA	505
STRATEGIES FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS: LISTENING, SPEAKING, READING, AND WRITING	
N.F. ABDULLAYEV	509
COMMUNICATIVE APPROACHES TO TEACHING GRAMMAR IN NON-LINGUISTIC UNIVERSITIES	
S.I. KHALILOVA	512
OBJECTIVE AND SUBJECTIVE ASSESSMENT IN TRADITIONAL AND MODERN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING	
N.E. ORUCOVA	517
MODERN APPROACHES IN TEACHING ENGLISH AS A FOREIGN LANGUAGE: ENHANCING COMMUNICATIVE	
N.K. MAGSUDOVA	522
MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING	
H.V. KERIMLI	527
THE ROLE OF TECHNOLOGY AND MODERN METHODS IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING	

L.E. AHMADOVA.....	530
THE INFLUENCE OF CLASSROOM ANXIETY AND SELF-CONFIDENCE ON ENGLISH SPEAKING PERFORMANCE AMONG UNIVERSITY STUDENTS	
S.A. SHIRINOVA.....	534
ASSESSMENT OF ORAL PROFICIENCY IN THE AZERBAIJANI HIGHER EDUCATION SECTOR: A SOCIO-COGNITIVE APPROACH WITHIN THE BOLOGNA FRAMEWORK	
A. KAZIMOVA.....	538
DEVELOPING ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS IN EFL CLASSROOMS	
J.S. MEHDIZADE.....	544
USING ROLE-PLAY ACTIVITIES TO IMPROVE SPEAKING SKILLS IN ENGLISH CLASSES: A STUDY OF AZERBAIJANI HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS	
F.S. MAMMADOVA.....	548
THE EFFECTS OF USING L1 ON STUDENT COMPREHENSION IN EFL CLASSROOMS	
U.K. SARICA.....	552
ALTERNATIVE AND FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT METHODS IN MODERN ENGLISH LANGUAGE INSTRUCTION	
V. KHUNDRAKPAM.....	557
IMPLEMENTING COMMUNICATIVE LANGUAGE TEACHING TO FOSTER AUTHENTIC CLASSROOM DISCOURSE	
Z. AHMAD.....	563
ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE CONTEXTS: A STUDY OF TEACHING APPROACHES AND STRATEGIES	
L. I. Yunis, F. I. Yunis.....	568
STRATEGIES FOR IMPLEMENTING INQUIRY-BASED LANGUAGE TEACHING IN LOWER LEVEL UNIVERSITY EDUCATION	
G.S. IMANZADA.....	573

TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH

ADDRESSING CURRICULAR CONSTRAINTS: ENHANCING CRITICAL THINKING AND ANALYTICAL SKILLS AMONG ENGLISH LEARNERS IN SECONDARY EDUCATION

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Abstract: Critical thinking and analytical reasoning are foundational competencies in STEM education, yet they remain underdeveloped in many secondary education systems. This study examines curricular and instructional challenges in fostering these skills among English language learners, primarily within the Turkish context, while drawing implications for comparable systems such as Azerbaijan.

The research synthesizes findings from existing literature to identify effective instructional strategies, including Socratic pedagogy, the 7E instructional model, and the Problem-Posing Instructional Strategy (PPIS), all of which align with inquiry-based and problem-solving approaches central to STEM learning.

Findings indicate that although educators recognize the importance of higher-order thinking, implementation is constrained by standardized curricula, limited instructional time, and exam-oriented systems. These conditions restrict opportunities for reasoning, argumentation, and evidence-based thinking.

The study highlights the potential of integrating structured inquiry, collaborative problem-solving, and student-generated questioning into English language instruction. It further emphasizes the relevance of these approaches for Azerbaijan, where similar systemic constraints exist. The paper concludes by advocating for curriculum reform and pedagogical alignment with STEM-oriented competencies to better prepare students for complex, interdisciplinary challenges.

Keywords: critical thinking, analytical skills, English language teaching, secondary education, inquiry-based learning, STEM education, Azerbaijan

TƏDRİS MƏHDUDİYYƏTLƏRİNİN HƏLL OLUNMASI: ORTA TƏHSİL SAHƏSİNDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİ ÖYRƏNƏNLƏR ARASINDA TƏNQİDİ DÜŞÜNCƏ VƏ ANALİTİK BACARIQLARIN ARTIRILMASI

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Xülasə: Tənqidi düşüncə və analitik düşüncə ETMR təhsilində təməl bacarıqlardır, lakin bir çox orta təhsil sistemlərində hələ də inkişaf etməmiş qalırlar. Bu tədqiqat, əsasən Türkiyə kontekstində ingilis dili öyrənənlər arasında bu bacarıqların inkişaf etdirilməsində tədris planı və tədris problemlərini araşdırır və eyni zamanda Azərbaycan kimi oxşar sistemlər üçün nəticələr çıxarır.

Tədqiqat, ETMR öyrənməsinin mərkəzində olan sorğu əsaslı və problem həll etmə yanaşmaları ilə uyğunlaşan Sokrat pedaqogikası, 7E tədris modeli və Problem Qoyma Təlimat Strategiyası (PPIS) daxil olmaqla effektiv tədris strategiyalarını müəyyən etmək üçün mövcud ədəbiyyatdan əldə edilən nəticələri sintez edir.

Nəticələr göstərir ki, müəllimlər daha yüksək səviyyəli düşüncənin vacibliyini qəbul etsələr də, tətbiq standartlaşdırılmış tədris planları, məhdud tədris vaxtı və imtahan yönümlü sistemlər tərəfindən məhdudlaşdırılır. Bu şərtlər mühakimə, arqumentasiya və sübutlara əsaslanan düşüncə imkanlarını məhdudlaşdırır.

Tədqiqat, strukturlaşdırılmış sorğu, əməkdaşlıq problem həlli və şagird tərəfindən yaradılan sualların ingilis dili tədrisinə inteqrasiya potensialını vurğulayır. Oxşar sistem məhdudiyyətlərinin mövcud olduğu Azərbaycan üçün bu yanaşmaların aktuallığını daha da vurğulayır. Məqalə, şagirdləri mürəkkəb, fənlərarası çətinliklərə daha yaxşı hazırlamaq üçün tədris planı islahatının və ETMR yönümlü kompetensiyalarla pedaqoji uyğunluğun müdafiəsi ilə yekunlaşır.

Açar sözlər: tənqidi düşüncə, analitik bacarıqlar, ingilis dilinin tədrisi, orta təhsil, sorğu əsaslı təlim, ETMR təhsili, Azərbaycan

Introduction

Critical thinking, problem-solving, and analytical reasoning are central to success in STEM fields and are increasingly recognized as essential competencies across all disciplines. In secondary education, these skills form the basis for advanced learning, particularly in environments that require interpretation, evaluation, and application of knowledge.

However, in many education systems, including Turkey and similarly structured contexts such as Azerbaijan, these competencies are not systematically embedded in curricula. English language classrooms, in particular, often emphasize grammar and memorization rather than reasoning, argumentation, and inquiry-based learning.

This limitation creates a gap between language education and STEM-related skill development. English language learning has the potential to serve as a platform for developing analytical thinking through discussion, interpretation, and evaluation of information. Yet, this potential remains underutilized.

Given the structural similarities between Turkish and Azerbaijani education systems such as centralized curricula and assessment-driven instruction this study explores how instructional strategies can better align English language teaching with STEM-oriented thinking skills.

Methodology and Materials

This study employs a qualitative literature review to examine instructional strategies that support the development of critical thinking and analytical skills in secondary education.

The analysis focuses on pedagogical models that reflect STEM-aligned learning principles:

Socratic Pedagogy (structured inquiry and reasoning)

7E Instructional Model (exploration and problem-solving cycles)

Problem-Posing Instructional Strategy (PPIS) (student-generated inquiry)

Higher-order questioning techniques

Sources were selected from peer-reviewed research emphasizing inquiry-based learning, cognitive skill development, and English language instruction.

The study also considers cross-context applicability, particularly to Azerbaijan, where similar systemic and pedagogical constraints influence classroom practices.

Discussion

Curricular Constraints and STEM Skill Gaps

The findings reveal that rigid curricula and exam-oriented systems limit the development of analytical and problem-solving skills. Instruction is often focused on content coverage rather than cognitive skill development, reducing opportunities for inquiry, reasoning, and evaluation.

This issue is mirrored in Azerbaijan, where standardized assessment structures similarly prioritize memorization over analytical engagement.

Instructional Strategies Supporting STEM-Oriented Thinking

The literature identifies several instructional approaches that align closely with STEM education principles:

Socratic Pedagogy promotes structured dialogue, argumentation, and evaluation of multiple perspectives

7E Model supports iterative learning through exploration, explanation, and application

PPIS encourages students to formulate and investigate their own questions, mirroring scientific inquiry processes

Higher-order questioning fosters analysis, synthesis, and evidence-based reasoning

These approaches transform language classrooms into environments that support not only linguistic development but also cognitive processes central to STEM learning.

Barriers to Implementation

Despite their effectiveness, implementation is constrained by:

- Standardized testing pressures
- Limited classroom time
- Students' language proficiency levels
- Insufficient teacher training in inquiry-based methods

These barriers highlight the need for systemic alignment between curriculum goals and instructional practices.

Relevance to Azerbaijan

In Azerbaijan, efforts to modernize education increasingly emphasize STEM competencies. However, similar structural challenges persist. Integrating inquiry-based and problem-solving approaches into English language instruction offers a practical pathway to support these national priorities.

Aligning language education with STEM competencies can enhance students' ability to interpret information, construct arguments, and engage in interdisciplinary thinking.

Conclusion

This study underscores the importance of aligning English language teaching with STEM-oriented competencies such as critical thinking, analytical reasoning, and problem-solving.

While existing instructional strategies demonstrate strong potential, their effectiveness is limited by systemic constraints. Addressing these challenges requires:

- Embedding analytical skill development into curricula
- Supporting teachers in implementing inquiry-based methods
- Reducing overreliance on exam-driven instruction

For both Turkey and Azerbaijan, integrating STEM-aligned thinking skills into language education represents a strategic opportunity to enhance overall educational outcomes. By fostering

inquiry, reasoning, and problem-solving within English classrooms, educators can better prepare students for the demands of modern academic and professional environments.

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LINGUISTIC APPROACH TO TEACHING EXTENSIVE READING IN SLA

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Abstract: Extensive reading is a language learning approach that emphasizes meaningful exposure to large amounts of comprehensible input rather than detailed analysis of short texts. It is grounded in the idea that learners develop language more effectively when they engage with easy, interesting materials that promote general understanding and enjoyment. This approach supports vocabulary growth, fluency, and overall communicative competence by encouraging repeated encounters with words and structures in context.

From a linguistic perspective, extensive reading is supported by several key principles. First, comprehensible input ensures that learners understand most of the text while still being slightly challenged. Second, input-driven acquisition highlights that language is acquired implicitly through repeated exposure rather than explicit instruction. Third, fluency development occurs as learners process language more quickly and automatically through practice and repetition. Fourth, top-down processing and schema activation enable learners to use background knowledge, predict meaning, and interpret texts more effectively. Finally, motivation and affective factors play a crucial role, as engaging materials and a positive learning environment increase persistence and reduce anxiety.

In teaching practice, these principles shift instruction toward a learner-centered, input-rich approach. Teachers select level-appropriate materials, encourage extensive reading, and support comprehension through context and interaction. Overall, extensive reading creates a natural and effective environment for language acquisition.

Key words: Extensive reading, SLA (second language acquisition), comprehensible input, input-driven acquisition, fluency development, top-down processing and schema activation, motivation and affective factors

İKİNCİ DİLİN MƏNİMSƏNİLMƏSİNDƏ (SLA) ƏLAVƏ OXUNUN TƏDRİSİNƏ LİNGVİSTİK YANAŞMA

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Xülasə: Əlavə oxu dil öyrənmə yanaşması olub qısa mətnlərin detallı təhlilindən daha çox, böyük miqdarda anlaşılan məlumatlarla tanışlığa üstünlük verir. Bu yanaşma, öyrənilənlərin dili daha effektiv şəkildə mənimsəməsinin onların asan və maraqlı materiallarla işləməsi, ümumi məzmunu anlamağa və oxudan zövq almağa yönəlməsi ilə mümkün olduğu ideyasına əsaslanır. Bu üsul kontekstdə eyni söz və strukturlara təkrar qarşılaşmaqla söz ehtiyatının artımına, səlisliyin inkişafına və ümumi kommunikativ bacarıqların inkişafına imkan yaradır.

Linqvistik baxımdan, əlavə oxu bir neçə əsas prinsipə əsaslanır. İlk olaraq, anlaşıqlı məlumat öyrənlərinin mətni əsasən başa düşməsinə, lakin eyni zamanda müəyyən qədər çətinliklə qarşılaşmasını təmin edir. Digər tərəfdən, naməlum məlumatın anlaşılması prinsipi birbaşa izahdan çox, təkrar rastlaşmaqla dolayı yolla öyrənmənin mümkünliyinə əsaslanır. Əlavə olaraq, səlisiyin inkişafı təkrar və davamlı təcrübə nəticəsində dilin daha sürətli və avtomatik şəkildə işlənməsi ilə baş verir. Yuxarıdan aşağı mənimsəmə və sxemlərin aktivləşdirilməsi öyrənlərə əvvəlki biliklərdən istifadə etməyə, məna proqnozlaşdırmağa və mətni daha effektiv şərh etməyə imkan verir. Nəhayət, motivasiya və təsir amilləri mühüm rol oynayır, çünki maraqlı materiallar və müsbət öyrənmə mühiti davamlılığı artırır və narahatlığı azaldır.

Tədris praktikasında bu prinsiplər daha çox öyrənən-mərkəzli və naməlum məlumatın anlaşılması yanaşmaya keçidi təmin edir. Müəllimlər səviyyəyə uyğun materiallar seçir, əlavə oxunu təşviq edir, kontekst və qarşılıqlı əlaqə vasitəsilə anlamı dəstəkləyirlər. Ümumilikdə, əlavə oxu dil mənimsənilməsi üçün təbii və effektiv mühit yaradır.

Açar sözlər: Əlavə oxu, ikinci dilin mənimsənilməsi, anlaşıqlı məlumat, naməlum məlumatın anlaşılması, səlisiyin inkişafı, yuxarıdan aşağı mənimsəmə, motivasiya və təsir faktorları

Introduction

Extensive reading has emerged as a key approach in language teaching, grounded in insights from Applied Linguistics and Second Language Acquisition. Rather than focusing on detailed analysis of short texts, this approach emphasizes exposure to large amounts of meaningful and comprehensible input, allowing learners to develop language naturally. Through consistent engagement with accessible and interesting materials, learners gradually build vocabulary, improve fluency, and strengthen overall communicative competence. Drawing on principles such as input-driven learning, frequency effects, and learner motivation, extensive reading creates conditions in which language is acquired through use rather than memorization. This article explores the linguistic foundations of extensive reading and examines how its core principles contribute to effective and meaningful language learning.

Methodology and Materials

This study is based on a qualitative analysis of theoretical frameworks drawn from Applied Linguistics and Second Language Acquisition. Relevant scholarly sources on extensive reading, vocabulary acquisition, and input-based learning were reviewed and synthesized. The materials analyzed include academic books, peer-reviewed articles, and theoretical models related to comprehensible input, fluency development, and learner motivation.

The method involves descriptive and analytical examination of key linguistic principles underlying extensive reading. Concepts such as input-driven acquisition, schema activation, and affective factors were systematically interpreted to explain their role in language learning. No experimental procedures were conducted; instead, the study relies on conceptual analysis to demonstrate how these principles inform effective teaching practices.

Discussion

The findings highlight that extensive reading, as understood in Applied Linguistics and Second Language Acquisition, is an effective approach to language learning because it prioritizes meaningful exposure over explicit instruction. Learners benefit from engaging with comprehensible and interesting texts, which supports vocabulary growth, fluency, and overall comprehension.

The analysis also shows that repeated exposure to language in context enables implicit acquisition of grammar and lexical patterns, while fluency develops through increased reading practice and reduced cognitive effort. In addition, the role of motivation and background knowledge is essential, as they enhance engagement and facilitate deeper understanding.

In addition, the study suggests that the effectiveness of extensive reading largely depends on appropriate material selection and careful instructional support. When texts are matched to learners'

proficiency levels and interests, they are more likely to sustain attention and develop consistent reading habits. Teachers therefore play an important role in guiding learners, monitoring progress, and ensuring continuous exposure to meaningful input. This balance between learner autonomy and teacher support further strengthens the overall impact of extensive reading in language development.

Overall, extensive reading creates a learner-centered and low-anxiety environment where language is acquired naturally, making it a valuable component of effective teaching practice.

A linguistic approach to teaching extensive reading is grounded in insights from Applied Linguistics and Second Language Acquisition, focusing on how learners acquire language through meaningful exposure to large amounts of comprehensible input rather than intensive analysis of short texts. From a linguistics perspective, extensive reading encompasses the idea that language learners should be able to apply any material they have learned in real-life communication and speaking situations. The more frequently words are used and practiced, the higher their frequency of occurrence becomes, which in turn strengthens retention and fluency. This concept is also reflected in corpus linguistics, a branch of Applied linguistics, where language use is analyzed through large collections of texts. With the help of computational linguistics, the frequency and patterns of word usage are measured, calculated, and systematically stored in databases.

Regarding second language acquisition (SLA), learning and comprehension are closely interconnected processes. The more a word is actively used, the more easily it is understood. In this way, knowledge becomes functional, and through repeated use, it gains a practical and communicative value, ultimately leading to better comprehension of the second language.

At the center of this approach is the idea of extensive reading as a learning process, where learners read large quantities of easy, interesting material to build fluency, vocabulary, and overall language competence. As described by Nation, I. (2013), "extensive reading is reading large amounts of easy and interesting material for general comprehension and enjoyment." Here, the simplicity and engaging nature of the selected materials are of particular importance. When learning a language, materials that align with learners' interests significantly facilitate the acquisition process. Regardless of age, whether young learners, adolescents, or adults, their interests should be carefully considered. Therefore, language instruction should be based on providing materials that fall within learners' areas of interest, as this approach enhances both motivation and effectiveness in language learning.

Building on these theoretical foundations, extensive reading can be further understood through several key linguistic principles that explain how language acquisition is facilitated in practice. These principles clarify the mechanisms through which large amounts of meaningful input contribute to vocabulary growth, reading fluency, and overall language development. In particular, concepts such as comprehensible input, meaningful exposure, and reduced focus on explicit form highlight why extensive reading is effective in promoting natural language acquisition. The following section outlines these core principles in more detail.

Key linguistic principles behind extensive reading:

1. Comprehensible input

Based on SLA theory, learners develop language when they understand messages slightly above their current level. In extensive reading, this means that texts should be easy enough for smooth reading (about 95-98% known vocabulary) and they should focus on meaning rather than on form.

As the subheading suggests, when learning a language, especially when approaching a second language, it is essential to ensure that the input is comprehensible. In other words, the initial exposure to the language should be clear and easy to understand. When learning any second language, factors such as appropriate vocabulary selection, simple sentence structures, and overall clarity play a crucial role in facilitating comprehension. Approaching texts in a simplified and accessible manner significantly eases the learning process. This principle is not limited to language learning alone; it applies equally to any unfamiliar task. When individuals engage in an activity, they have not previously experienced, approaching it in a clear and understandable way makes it easier to manage and master. Therefore, language learning, being a cognitively demanding process, particularly requires such accessible input at the initial stages. For this reason, when selecting materials for second language acquisition, it is of great importance to choose texts that are clear, simple, and easy to read. Such materials not only enhance comprehension but also support learners in building confidence and progressing more effectively in the target language.

As emphasized in *Understanding Vocabulary in Language Teaching*, Schmitt (2020) highlights the importance of repeated and meaningful exposure to vocabulary, noting that vocabulary knowledge develops most effectively when learners encounter language frequently in comprehensible and meaningful contexts. This reinforces the idea that simplified and accessible input is essential in the early stages of second language learning, as it allows learners to gradually build durable vocabulary knowledge and comprehension skills.

2. Input-driven acquisition

Learners acquire grammar and vocabulary implicitly through repeated exposure rather than explicit instruction. Extensive reading supports second language learners' natural acquisition of word patterns, their familiarity with grammar in context and for the development of the use of collocations and phraseological units in their speech.

Learners should not engage with materials only at a superficial level; rather, they need to approach them in depth. This means that while reading a text, they should focus not only on understanding its content, but also on analyzing grammatical structures, vocabulary, lexical features, collocations, phraseological units, and idiomatic expressions. Continuous and systematic reading enables learners to internalize these elements more effectively and develop a deeper command of the language.

It is widely recognized that, the English language is rich in idiomatic expressions, and the appropriate use of these idioms in both spoken and written communication is of great importance. At the same time, the ability to recognize and understand idioms while listening plays a crucial role in the development of communicative competence.

Therefore, learning materials directly and consciously, i.e. implicitly rather than indirectly, explicitly, leads to more effective outcomes. Such an approach helps second language learners acquire the material more easily and retain it in their long-term memory.

Another important aspect of input-driven acquisition is the role of meaningful context and learner engagement. When learners are exposed to authentic and context-rich materials, such as stories, articles, or dialogues, they are more likely to notice how language functions in real communicative situations. This contextualized exposure not only reinforces their understanding of grammatical and lexical patterns but also enhances their ability to use language appropriately across different settings. Moreover, when learners are personally interested in the content, their motivation increases, which further supports deeper processing and more durable language acquisition.

As Stephen Krashen argues, “language acquisition occurs when learners are exposed to comprehensible input that is slightly beyond their current level of competence (i+1),” (Krashen, S. 1982, p. 6-8) emphasizing the importance of meaningful and sustained exposure to language in natural contexts. In “i+1”, “i” represents the learner’s current level of language competence (what they already know), and “+1” represents language input that is just slightly above that level, new but still understandable with context. So, i+1 means learning happens best when learners are exposed to language that is a little more advanced than what they already understand, but not so difficult that it becomes confusing (i+10). For example, if a learner already understands: “*I am doing a test.*” (this is i). Then hearing: “*I am doing a difficult test.*” or “*I was doing a difficult test when you came yesterday.*” would be “i+1”. The learner can still understand the sentence because most of it is familiar, and the new elements (“difficult” or “was... when you came yesterday”) can be inferred from context. The key idea is balance: If input is too easy (just “i”), no new learning happens; If it is too difficult (i+10), the learner cannot understand it; If it is “i+1”, learning occurs naturally and efficiently.

This is why activities like extensive reading, listening to slightly challenging content, and exposure to real-life language are so effective, they naturally provide “i+1” input.

3. Fluency development

From a psycholinguistic perspective, reading becomes faster and more automatic through repeated exposure. Extensive reading helps: reduce word-by-word decoding; increase reading speed; improve processing efficiency. In reality, experience is not something that can be acquired merely through theoretical knowledge; it is developed through consistent practice. The more frequently we engage in a particular activity, the more accustomed we become to it, and as a result, performing that activity becomes easier and more natural. Experience, therefore, enables individuals to carry out tasks more efficiently and with greater confidence.

The same principle applies to reading. Extensive reading, in particular, plays a crucial role in strengthening memory and developing language proficiency. Through repeated exposure to words and structures in various contexts, whether in literary or scientific texts, language learners gradually internalize vocabulary. At the initial stages of language learning, learners often rely heavily on dictionaries to understand unfamiliar words. However, after sustained reading practice, they begin to recognize many of these words without needing to look them up.

Moreover, learners develop the ability to infer the meanings of unfamiliar words from context. This contextual learning allows both familiar and previously unfamiliar vocabulary to become embedded in long-term memory. As a result, the language acquisition process becomes more natural and automatic. Ultimately, fluency develops to the point where language use requires less conscious effort, fluency becomes automatic.

Another important factor in fluency development is the role of repeated exposure to whole phrases and sentence patterns rather than isolated words. When learners frequently encounter fixed expressions, collocations, and common grammatical structures in meaningful contexts, they begin to store these patterns as unified chunks in memory. This “chunking” process reduces the cognitive load during reading and communication, allowing learners to process language more quickly and with greater ease. As these stored patterns become increasingly accessible, learners are able to retrieve and use language more efficiently, which further contributes to smoother, more fluent performance in both reading and other language skills. As Sweller, J. explains in his work on cognitive load theory, “If information is presented in a manner that overloads working memory, learning is inhibited,” (Sweller et al., 2011, p. 48) emphasizing that fluency improves when

processing becomes more automatic and less cognitively demanding through practice and repetition.

4. Top-down processing and schema activation

Readers use background knowledge to predict and interpret meaning. Extensive reading strengthens:

a) Global comprehension strategies:

- Skimming
- Predicting
- Activating prior knowledge
- Identifying main ideas
- Inferring meaning from context
- Recognizing text structure, summarizing

b) Contextual guessing skills

- Use clues from nearby words or sentences
- Rely on the topic or general meaning of the text
- Notice grammar patterns (e.g., noun, verb, adjective position)
- Use logical reasoning to infer meaning
- Connect the unknown word with prior knowledge

For example:

“In winter, the ground was covered with a thick layer of *frost*.”

Even if the learner doesn't know *frost*, the context (“winter,” “ground,” “covered”) helps them guess it means a thin layer of ice.

c) Cultural and discourse awareness.

Cultural awareness involves understanding the values, beliefs, customs, and social norms reflected in a language. Learners need to:

- Recognize culturally specific references (e.g., traditions, holidays, behaviors)
- Understand implied meanings that depend on culture
- Avoid misunderstandings caused by direct translation
- Interpret idioms and expressions rooted in culture

Discourse awareness refers to understanding how language is organized and connected beyond individual sentences. Learners need to:

- Follow the logical flow of a text or conversation
- Recognize coherence and cohesion (linking words like *however*, *therefore*, *in addition*)
- Identify the purpose of a text (to inform, persuade, explain, etc.)
- Understand how ideas are structured across paragraphs

As it is clear from the explanations, the fourth stage of the language learning process, known as top-down processing and schema activation, learners have already reached a certain level of proficiency in the target language. At this stage, they are able to infer meaning, make predictions, and anticipate ideas based on prior knowledge. When texts are introduced at different stages and accompanied by relevant tasks, it is observed that learners, particularly those at the intermediate level, can successfully guess answers by relying on their existing linguistic and background knowledge. Moreover, they do not depend solely on what they have learned in English; they are also able to draw connections with knowledge acquired from other disciplines and even other languages. This ability enables them to respond actively and effectively to a variety of task types.

This stage also indicates that the learners' language use is becoming increasingly automatic. Through extensive reading, they develop the ability to comprehend a wide range of contextualized topics and situations. They approach texts at a discourse level, gaining awareness of cultural, economic, scientific, and social issues. As a result, reading becomes easier, and learners are more capable of participating in discussions and debates, engaging in meaningful communication, and exchanging ideas with professionals from different fields.

5. Motivation and affective factors

Linguistic approaches recognize that affective variables strongly influence acquisition: Enjoyable texts increase time-on-task; choice improves engagement and persistence; reduced anxiety encourages risk-free learning.

Motivation and influential factors in SLA, from a linguistic perspective, show that learners need to develop awareness of various linguistic domains such as synonyms, antonyms, lexical chunks, idiomatic expressions, and other structural and functional aspects of language. However, mastering these areas can often be challenging for learners, which makes motivation a crucial element in the learning process.

Motivation plays a significant role in sustaining learners' engagement. When learners encounter unfamiliar vocabulary or complex texts, their interest in language learning may decrease, and they may feel discouraged, especially when dealing with abstract or seemingly uninteresting academic materials that are difficult to comprehend. In such situations, motivation becomes essential for maintaining persistence and progress.

Teachers, in this regard, should act not only as instructors but also as motivators and mentors who guide learners through difficulties and help them develop confidence. At the same time, family support is also highly important, particularly in individual learning contexts, as encouragement from the family can significantly enhance learners' willingness to explore the deeper aspects and nuances of language learning.

In addition, the selection of learning materials plays a key role in sustaining motivation. Materials should be engaging, relevant to learners' interests, academic backgrounds, and professional needs. When texts are carefully selected, learners are more likely to remain motivated, consistent, and resilient in the face of challenges. Such thoughtful selection helps reduce anxiety and frustration, enabling learners to progress more independently and confidently toward language mastery.

Another important factor in motivation and affective variables is the role of emotional connection with the learning process. When learners feel personally involved in what they are reading or studying, they are more likely to invest sustained effort and engage more deeply with the material. Positive emotional experiences, such as interest, curiosity, and enjoyment, help lower the affective filter and create a more supportive environment for language acquisition. As Stephen Krashen (1982) explains, "the affective filter is raised when learners are anxious, unmotivated, or lack self-confidence," highlighting that emotional factors can either facilitate or block language acquisition depending on the learner's psychological state. As a result, learners become more willing to take risks, experiment with language, and persist through challenges, all of which contribute to more effective and long-term learning outcomes.

How does all the mentioned five factors shape teaching practice?

All the five factors mentioned above do not remain separate from teaching practice; rather, they collectively reshape it by shifting instruction from explicit rule-focused teaching to a more input-rich, meaning-focused, and learner-centered approach. A key principle of this approach is

comprehensible input, where learners are exposed to language that they can mostly understand, with a slight level of challenge. To achieve this, teachers simplify input without oversimplifying language and support comprehension through visuals, examples, and contextual clues.

A central component of this approach is the use of graded and level-appropriate materials. Teachers should select texts that match learners' proficiency levels, such as beginner, elementary, and advanced. Graded readers are adapted texts designed to make input understandable while still providing gradual linguistic challenge. As learners progress, the complexity of materials should be adjusted accordingly, ensuring continuous development of language competence.

In practice, this means that learners at lower levels are exposed to short, simple, and engaging texts, while more complex analytical tasks are introduced only at higher levels. At the early stages, the emphasis should remain on reading and comprehension rather than grammar-focused or critical thinking tasks. In some cases, reading may even occur without formal tasks, as the primary goal is to build comprehension and fluency through exposure. For example, for beginners, using short novels, even short poems, and choosing interesting topics helps to accelerate their language learning process.

In the current era of technological development and in modern language learning environments, digital tools and artificial intelligence further expand access to language input. Learners can now independently access a wide range of materials, practice language skills, and receive feedback on pronunciation, grammar, and vocabulary. While such tools can support learning effectively, they complement rather than replace structured instructional guidance.

Within an input-driven acquisition framework, instruction focuses less on explicit grammar explanation and more on meaningful exposure and repetition in context. This includes extensive reading and listening activities, as well as the recycling of vocabulary and structures across different texts. In this way, learners acquire grammar implicitly through use rather than through direct instruction.

Another important dimension is fluency development, where teaching emphasizes speed, automaticity, and ease of processing in addition to accuracy. Teachers support this by incorporating timed reading and speaking activities, encouraging extensive rather than intensive reading, and promoting the learning of lexical chunks such as collocations and phrases to reduce hesitation and improve fluency.

Top-down processing and schema activation also play a key role in reading comprehension. Teachers activate learners' background knowledge before reading through pre-reading discussions, prediction tasks, titles, images, and headings. This helps learners construct meaning holistically rather than processing text word by word.

Motivation and affective factors are equally important in supporting language development. When teachers use interesting and level-appropriate materials, create a positive classroom atmosphere, and provide supportive feedback, learners experience reduced anxiety and increased engagement. Allowing learners some degree of choice in topics and tasks further enhances motivation and persistence.

Extensive reading is particularly significant as it integrates all these principles. It provides learners with large amounts of comprehensible input in meaningful contexts, supporting vocabulary growth, fluency development, and overall language acquisition.

Within extensive reading framework, the teacher's role becomes multifaceted. The instructor acts as a provider of input by selecting appropriate materials, a motivator who fosters reading habits, a guide who supports strategy development, and a model reader who demonstrates fluent

reading behavior through pronunciation, intonation, and expression. Through these roles, teachers help learners overcome difficulties, build confidence, and gradually develop independence in reading.

Overall, from a linguistic and SLA perspective, extensive reading is not merely a classroom activity but a language acquisition environment grounded in massive comprehensible input, meaning-focused engagement, gradual fluency development, and low anxiety supported by high motivation.

Conclusion

Extensive reading is a highly effective, research-based approach to language learning grounded in Applied Linguistics and Second Language Acquisition. By prioritizing large amounts of meaningful and comprehensible input over explicit instruction, it enables learners to acquire language naturally. Through consistent exposure, learners develop vocabulary, internalize grammar, and improve overall fluency.

Its effectiveness is supported by key linguistic principles, including comprehensible input, input-driven acquisition, fluency development, schema activation, and motivation. Together, these create a low-anxiety, engaging environment that promotes deeper understanding and long-term retention.

In teaching practice, extensive reading encourages a learner-centered approach where teachers provide appropriate materials, guide learning, and foster motivation. Overall, it serves as a practical and powerful framework for developing communicative competence and achieving sustained language growth.

Furthermore, the integration of extensive reading into modern learning environments, supported by digital tools and diverse reading resources, enhances accessibility and learner autonomy. By combining traditional reading practices with technological support, learners can engage with a wider range of texts and maintain consistent exposure to the target language, ultimately strengthening their independence and lifelong learning skills.

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THE EFFECTIVENESS OF INTERACTIVE TASKS IN DEVELOPING WRITTEN SPEECH

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Abstract: Developing written speech is one of the most problematic aspects of English language learning as a foreign language. Inadequate vocabulary, lack of interest, and insufficient opportunities for meaningful use are major obstacles that plague English language learners. This study investigated the effects of a number of interactive activities upon EFL learners' written communication. Using a small-scale quasi-experimental design, the study recruited forty students of English, who were introduced to a range of group-based, spoken-based, and collaborative activities to support writing during a six-week period. Pre- and post-writing samples, observations of lessons during the action research component, and interpretive analyses of students' perceptions of learning were collected and analyzed to assess what effect a set of new approaches had upon learners' written communication.

The findings from this study indicated that students engaged in interactive task - based writing activities produced more coherent, more vocabulary dense and more accurate texts, in addition to showing a raised motivation, confidence and engagement in the learning process. These results validate key tenets of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and demonstrate how a more learner-centered instructional approach can enhance the teaching of writing.

The study found interactive tasks to be an effective way to improve written speaking skills for EFL learners. Pedagogical implications suggest that teachers using writing classes incorporate interactive tasks for enhanced learning outcomes. Future studies are needed to report on long-term effects of such tasks and to consider contexts other than EFL instruction settings.

Keywords: interactive tasks, writing skills, EFL learners, communicative approach, student engagement, collaborative learning

YAZILI ANLATIMIN GELİŞTİRİLMESİNDE İNTERAKTİF GÖREVLERİN ETKİNLİĞİ

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Özet: Yazılı anlatımın geliştirilmesi, İngilizcenin yabancı dil olarak öğrenilmesinde en sorunlu alanlardan biridir. Yetersiz kelime bilgisi, ilgi eksikliği ve anlamlı kullanım için yeterli fırsatların bulunmaması, İngilizce öğrenen öğrencilerin karşılaştığı başlıca engellerdir. Bu çalışma, çeşitli etkileşimli etkinliklerin EFL öğrencilerinin yazılı iletişimi üzerindeki etkilerini incelemektedir. Küçük ölçekli yarı deneysel bir tasarım kullanılarak gerçekleştirilen çalışmada, kırk İngilizce öğrencisi altı haftalık bir süre boyunca yazmayı desteklemek amacıyla grup temelli, konuşma temelli ve işbirlikli etkinliklerle tanıştırılmıştır. Ön ve son yazma örnekleri, eylem araştırması sürecinde yapılan ders gözlemleri ve öğrencilerin öğrenmeye yönelik algılarının yorumlayıcı analizleri toplanmış ve yeni yaklaşımların öğrencilerin yazılı iletişimi üzerindeki etkisi değerlendirilmiştir.

Çalışmanın bulguları, etkileşimli görev temelli yazma etkinliklerine katılan öğrencilerin daha tutarlı, daha zengin kelime kullanımına sahip ve daha doğru metinler ürettiklerini göstermiştir. Ayrıca öğrencilerin motivasyon, özgüven ve öğrenme sürecine katılım düzeylerinde artış gözlemlenmiştir. Bu sonuçlar, İletişimsel Dil Öğretimi (CLT) yaklaşımının temel ilkelerini doğrulamakta ve daha öğrenci merkezli bir öğretim yaklaşımının yazma öğretimini nasıl geliştirebileceğini ortaya koymaktadır.

Araştırma, etkileşimli görevlerin EFL öğrencilerinin yazılı anlatım becerilerini geliştirmede etkili bir yöntem olduğunu göstermektedir. Pedagojik açıdan, yazma derslerinde öğretmenlerin etkileşimli görevleri kullanmaları öğrenme çıktılarının iyileştirilmesine katkı sağlayabilir. Gelecek çalışmaların, bu tür etkinliklerin uzun vadeli etkilerini incelemesi ve EFL dışındaki farklı öğrenme bağlamlarını da ele alması önerilmektedir.

Anahtar kelimeler: etkileşimli görevler, yazma becerileri, yabancı dil olarak İngilizce öğrenenler (EFL), iletişimsel yaklaşım, öğrenci katılımı, işbirlikli öğrenme

Introduction

Writing is considered one of the most challenging skills to be learned in foreign language instruction, as it requires more than mere linguistic proficiency; it entails greater cognitive complexity and an even more complex repertoire of both vocabulary and grammar that the speaker can draw upon in real time (Hyland, 2003). Furthermore, English speakers may not necessarily be able to articulate what works well in good writing in English, as writing in English is largely an unconscious process. Given the typically limited contact and practice opportunities that learners of English as a Foreign Language (EFL) have with the language, producing a piece of writing that is adequate for communicative purposes can be a truly formidable undertaking for university students.

Students struggle to express their ideas effectively. Their writing lacks development beyond the reproduction of familiar phrases and short sentences. Repetitive grammar exercises feature prominently in traditional language lessons and writing activities, because teacher-centered methods prioritize mechanical tasks over meaningful communication, lacking engagement and motivating learners to become writers. Within this approach, the writer is marginalized and unable to utilize their individual voice.

There has been a move in language teaching in recent years towards more student-centered approaches, and the use of interactive tasks is a powerful way to implement this kind of approach. There are a number of interactive task types including group discussion, peer feedback, collaborative and interactive writing, and problem-solving. These activities are designed to facilitate interaction amongst students including opportunities for students to share ideas, receive feedback on their work and engage in writing tasks which are guided and facilitated through dialogue.

Another avenue for presenting interaction is to adopt the format of 'interactive tasks', which are a feature of many English language lessons. These tasks have a close relationship to the principles of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and its focus on communication and real-life language use (Richards & Rodgers, 2014). This paper explores how students learn language while completing an interactive task and is underpinned by a socio-cultural theory perspective which posits that it is through social interaction that learners experience cognitive and linguistic development (Vygotsky, 1978).

The paper will investigate how a variety of interactive tasks and activities can aid adult EFL learners to transform their spoken English into written English. The research questions explored here are: Will interactive tasks and activities assist adult EFL learners to write more effective English communication? Do interactive tasks increase learners' motivation, enjoyment, and learning? This study can aid teachers in EFL writing classes to link academic theory and real-world composition by using and implementing these and other classroom activities and tasks.

Materials and Methods

Participants

The research study was conducted at one of regional universities of Kazakhstan. Participants of the study consisted of 30 students of the university studying English at the undergraduate level. The students were aged between 18 and 21. In terms of English language proficiency they were intermediate level writers (CEFR B1). Participants of the study were divided into two homogeneous groups – experimental (n=15) and control (n=15) groups. Before the study both groups took a pre-

test writing task. The results of the test showed that the groups were quite homogeneous in terms of their writing skills and thus were suitable for a comparative study.

Research Design

This study adopted a quasi-experimental approach and utilised both quantitative and qualitative data to assess the effectiveness of the intervention. Participants were assigned to either an experimental group that participated in interactive lesson activities or a control group that followed a traditional teacher-focused lesson that concentrated on individual work and received teacher feedback. The six-week intervention consisted of different social-interactionist learning environments for the experimental group (Vygotsky, 1978).

Interactive Tasks (Experimental Intervention)

In order to alter the teaching practice of the experimental group, it was necessary to modify the activities centering on individual production towards tasks that would promote collaboration and the construction of knowledge shared by pairs of students. The tasks included:

- Group writing activities in which students worked in small groups and were responsible for developing the content and organization of essays and assigned writing projects while contributing to the idea development process.
- Peer Feedback Sessions: In small groups, students read each other's first drafts and, using a structured rubric, gave thoughtful feedback on strong and weak points in order to see errors in language use and gaps in organization from the reader's perspective.
- Collaborative Writing with coherence, cohesion, and vocabulary acquisition objectives via classroom conversation and/or technology-assisted writing and revision strategies as students compose original and joint written products to further enhance writer's engagement and overall understanding of subject matter while refining usage of descriptive, analytical, informative, or persuasive writing techniques and evaluating written communication.
- •Discussion-Based Pre-Writing: Prior to writing, extensive group discussion was used to connect students' prior knowledge to new topics, generate potential writing ideas, and build lexical content and structure specific to the topic.

Data Collection and Instruments

Triangulation of data collection methods was a key consideration in the validation and reliability of the findings in this study.

- Writing Samples (Pre-test and Post-test): Students' writing samples were analyzed for quantitative gains using standardized written tests which were evaluated on four dimensions: (1) grammatical accuracy; (2) vocabulary (3) coherence; and (4) organization.
- Systematic Classroom Observation: Qualitative data about classroom activity were collected by the researcher and recorded, noting students' engagement and their peer interactions as well as other classroom activity.
- Student Questionnaires: After the 6 weeks of classes, a questionnaire was given to the students to gather their subjective experiences and evaluations during the project.

Results and Discussion

Quantitative Analysis of Writing Skills

The outcome of this study revealed notable and positive changes on the writing skills of the experimental group, with a significant boost on their writing performance through interactive learning tasks (Brown, 2007). The post-test mean scores of the experimental group exhibited

pronounced increment in all areas, with special emphasis on vocabulary, writing characteristics, organization, and fluency.

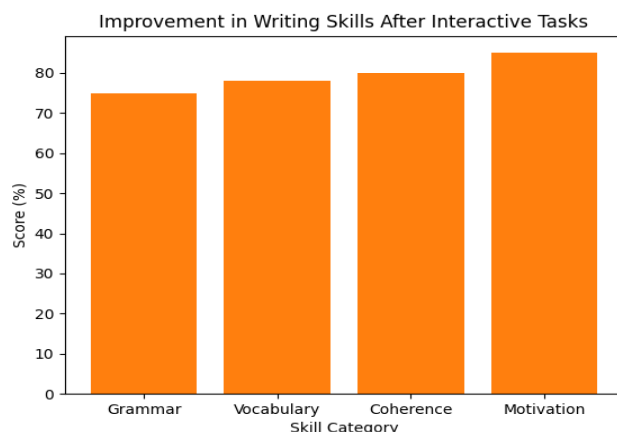
Coherence, motivation, and vocabulary development showed the greatest gains, averaging +25%, +23%, and +20% respectively. These results reflect not only improvement in linguistic skills, but also greater engagement in the writing process and more opportunities for students to use language actively and apply newly acquired vocabulary in communicative situations. While average gains in grammar improvement averaged +15%, they were below those of the other categories.

Table 1. Writing Performance Results (%)

Skill Category	Pre-test (Exp.Group) Score	Post-test (Exp.Group) Score	Improvement (%)
Grammar	60%	75%	+15%
Vocabulary	58%	78%	+20%
Coherence	55%	80%	+25%
Motivation	62%	85%	+23%

All areas showed a steady increase in performance. Unlike the control group who showed only marginal gains in grammar with otherwise weak writing in ideas, organization, and creativity, these gains were achieved through interactive task-based instruction. These gains demonstrate the effectiveness of learner-centered instructional strategies.

Picture 1. Improvement in Writing Skills



This figure shows the comparison of students' writing performance after the implementation of interactive tasks. Significant improvement is observed in all categories.

Qualitative Findings and Motivation

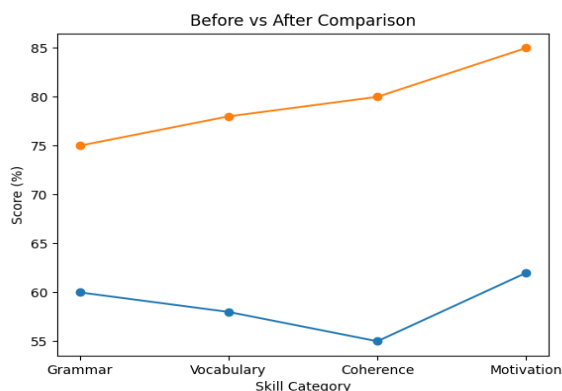
Classroom observations and qualitative data from student surveys also provided insightful evidence that supported the trends revealed in the numerical data. In general, students in the experimental group had higher levels of intrinsic motivation to write. They reported that the tasks in the interactive writing lessons were fun, meaningful, and made learning more engaging than regular writing activities they had experienced in the past.

Further still, many of the students reported feeling more confident in their ability to write in English. Throughout the pilot, students reported that their participation in classroom activities helped to diminish their anxiety of taking academic risks and feeling uncomfortable making errors in front of their peers. Thus, interactive classroom activities not only enhanced students' English

language competence, but also affected their perception of the language (i.e., improved their attitudes) by creating an environment in which they felt more supported by their peer(s).

In observing classrooms, teachers and students alike asserted that this new way of teaching and learning was effective. Students were engaged in lively discussions, asked questions, shared ideas with their classmates, and even worked collaboratively on various activities, all displaying a level of commitment and understanding that was greater than prior years. Students were participating in learning in an interactive and communicative way, rather than passively absorbing information.

Picture 2. Before and After Comparison (Progress Trend)



The line graph shows a steady and continuous improvement in writing performance over the six-week intervention period. The most significant progress occurred after the third week, suggesting that students gradually adapted to interactive learning methods and became more effective in using them.

Comparison with Traditional Methods

The traditional teaching approaches that are commonly observed in writing classes are more teacher-centered, individualized, grammar and error correction-orientated and lack genuine interaction. The dominant perspective in these classes is on accurate use of language as a means to an end.

These interactive activities switch up the learning environment to make learning more student-centered. Students can work in pairs or groups, and take turns negotiating meaning, completing tasks, and providing peer feedback. Interactive writing can make a great precursor to writing to boost fluency, while also challenging students to think more critically and creatively. Long-term writing skills are developed when students come to see writing as a process, not a product.

This paper explores the potential effectiveness of ‘interactivity’ in language lesson contexts in order to suggest ways in which instruction can promote communicative competence and learner participation. In addition to providing an overview of current approaches to interactivity, it contrasts lesson-cycles utilizing two pedagogic activities. The evidence presented consistently supports the view that such interactivity is highly effective in promoting communicative competence and raising learner engagement.

Theoretical Support

The findings of the current study coincided with the principles of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT). The findings indicated that learners can better acquire language when they engage in interactive tasks within a real-world setting such as group writing, peer reviewing, and collaborative projects. These types of learning tasks have the potential to move learners from a

discrete-narrative approach to writing from a focus on individual attainment to meaningful and communicative interactive tasks within or outside the classroom.

Based on these findings, socio-cultural theory provides an adequate framework for interpreting the outcomes. From this perspective, significant learning occurs through social interaction with peers and adult scaffolding to support academic performance (Vygotsky, 1978). From this vantage, students entered into their Zone of Proximal Development – where they demonstrated the ability to write more effectively through interaction with and support from peers and teacher.

Drawing upon social constructivist and community of practice theory, this paper examines how two interactive technology-supported learning environments – computer-mediated journals and wiki-based essay distributions – can foster EFL learners' writing abilities. Both frameworks provide empirical and conceptual support for the crucial role that such interactive environments can play in supporting writing development among EFL learners (Swain, 2005).

Conclusion

This study explores the efficacy of using interactional tasks to improve English as a Foreign Language (EFL) learners' written speech. The analyses and thematic data compiled over a six-week period show that activities including group writing, peer feedback, and collaboration led to dramatic change in both students' written-accomplishment and their perceptions of the process. Findings illustrate that these highly interactive methods of teaching EFL writing outperform more traditional teacher-centered methods, especially with respect to linguistic features including coherence, vocabulary, and grammar (Williams & Burden, 1997).

This research found that learners gained in internal motivation and confidence when they moved from individual writing tasks to collaborative ones. The interactional nature of the shared writing task helped to reduce anxiety associated with formal writing and reframed mistakes as part of the learning process rather than failures. The findings support the tenets of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and Socio-Cultural Theory by demonstrating that learners acquire language best through social interaction, meaning-making, and negotiated understanding of content and language form.

Focusing on finding ways in which learners could make the most of the limited time available, the study suggests that EFL writing classes need to think differently about what comprises a writing class. Given that many current classroom activities remain static and are designed with the aim of learners completing individual grammar exercises, there is scope to move lessons on from this mode of learning and encourage students to engage in more dynamic interaction such as peer editing, joint text construction, etc. Learning to write well is not just about acquiring techniques and improving linguistic accuracy; it also involves, increasingly, developing critical thinking skills and the ability to work with others in order to communicate effectively in an ever more complex and competitive world.

Although this study found positive outcomes with a moderate-sized sample, there are some limitations such as the short duration of the study. Future research should attempt to conduct a longitudinal study to see if participants can retain their skills and apply them in more complex interactive tasks with learners of different proficiency levels in multiple cultural contexts. Interactive tasks can be an effective pedagogical tool to help EFL learners enhance the quality of their written speech and move towards more communicative approaches in the classroom.

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EFFECTIVE USE OF SOCIAL INTERACTION METHODS IN THE PROCESS OF LEARNING A FOREIGN LANGUAGE IN HEIS

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Abstract: The article examines the phenomenon of social interaction among participants in the educational process in higher education institutions (HEIs) during foreign language learning. The author emphasizes that social interaction is a fundamental factor in the successful acquisition of educational material and the development of students' foreign language communicative competence. It serves as the basis for implementing the principles of partnership pedagogy, encouraging cooperation not only between teachers and students but also among students themselves. Such interaction creates a supportive learning environment that promotes active participation, mutual understanding, and effective communication.

Particular attention is paid to the establishment of strong teacher – student relationships, which include four key dimensions of interaction: social, affective, cognitive, and behavioral. The article highlights essential principles of social interaction, including accessibility, teacher responsiveness, respect for students' individuality, and the creation of a positive classroom atmosphere.

The author also shares practical experience in applying modern methods and forms of foreign language instruction based on social interaction. These methods include communicative attack, persuasion, proof, suggestion at the motivational stage, induction and deduction techniques, analogies and comparisons,

and strategies that demonstrate the practical value of acquired knowledge. Special emphasis is placed on motivating students by explaining the relevance of language skills for both social interaction and everyday life.

The study concludes that social interaction significantly increases learners' motivation, engagement, and confidence. Furthermore, it facilitates the development of communicative competence by providing opportunities to practice foreign language communication in situations that closely resemble real-life contexts.

Keywords: foreign language, social interaction, formation of communicative interaction skills.

ЭФФЕКТИВНОЕ ИСПОЛЬЗОВАНИЕ МЕТОДОВ СОЦИАЛЬНОГО ВЗАИМОДЕЙСТВИЯ В ПРОЦЕССЕ ИЗУЧЕНИЯ ИНОСТРАННОГО ЯЗЫКА В УЧРЕЖДЕНИЯХ ВЫСШЕГО ОБРАЗОВАНИЯ

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Аннотация: В статье рассматривается феномен социального взаимодействия между участниками образовательного процесса в учреждениях высшего образования (УВО) во время занятий по иностранному языку. Социальное взаимодействие представлено автором как ключевой фактор эффективного усвоения учебного материала и развития иноязычной коммуникативной компетентности студентов. Оно является основой реализации принципов педагогики партнёрства и предполагает взаимодействие не только между преподавателем и студентами, но и между самими студентами.

Подчёркивается, что установление прочных взаимоотношений между преподавателем и студентом включает четыре аспекта взаимодействия: социальный, аффективный, когнитивный и поведенческий. Рассматриваются важнейшие принципы социального взаимодействия: доступность, демонстрация преподавателем отзывчивости и учёт индивидуальных особенностей студента.

Автор делится собственным опытом внедрения в образовательный процесс УВО современных методов и форм обучения иностранному языку, основанных на социальном взаимодействии. Особое внимание уделяется использованию таких методов, как коммуникативная атака, доказательство, убеждение, внушение (на этапе мотивации), методы доказательства и убеждения для активизации волевых усилий студентов посредством объяснения необходимости овладения учебным материалом для социального взаимодействия и повседневной жизнедеятельности, приёмы обращения к положительным и отрицательным последствиям способности взаимодействовать с окружающими, индукция и дедукция, использование аналогий и сравнений, акцентирование актуальности и практической значимости приобретённых знаний о социальном взаимодействии в жизни, выявление противоречий в критических замечаниях аудитории и др.

Автор приходит к выводу, что социальное взаимодействие играет важную роль в повышении мотивации к изучению иностранного языка и формировании коммуникативных навыков, поскольку предоставляет возможность практиковать иноязычную речь в условиях, максимально приближённых к реальной жизни.

Ключевые слова: иностранный язык, социальное взаимодействие, формирование навыков коммуникативного взаимодействия

Introduction

In the context of globalization and the European integration of higher education in Ukraine, proficiency in a foreign language is becoming not just a professional requirement but a critically important component of a specialist's social adaptability. The modern paradigm of teaching in HEIs is shifting from passive assimilation of linguistic knowledge to the formation of communicative competence, which is impossible without establishing high-quality social interaction between the teacher and students. The nature of this interaction determines the level of student motivation, their ability to overcome the language barrier, and their readiness for foreign language self-expression.

Social interaction between participants in the educational process in foreign language classes is key to effective material assimilation and the development of foreign language communicative competence. It involves interaction between the teacher and students, as well as between the students themselves, and is the basis for implementing the principles of partnership pedagogy.

The problems of subject-subject interaction in the educational process have been studied by many scientists (I. Bekh, O. Penkova, C. Rogers, H. Brown, N. Hodovanets, O. Hrytsiuk, K. Drovachek, O. Kohut, V. Lehan, M. More, L. Onuchak, O. Pometun, A. Ryzha and others). However, in the context of the digitalization of education and the transition to blended forms of learning, the issue of optimizing social contact directly during foreign language study requires additional rethinking.

Studying the phenomenon of interaction between participants in the educational process in the higher education system of Ukraine, O. Honchar emphasizes that today the student is considered a subject, a co-participant in the educational process, a creative personality, and not an object of external influences (Honchar, O., 2011). If students are not involved in the educational process and are merely formal objects for the transfer of educational material, then even a well-thought-out presentation of information, emotionally and logically structured material, will not provide the desired effect. When students actively search for information to complete a task, interacting with the teacher and other students, and engage in independent work with the material, they assimilate and process the topic better. But an analysis of the practice of communication between teachers and students indicates the insufficient competence of many teachers in a number of situations, which leads to misunderstanding and conflict in communication between the student and the teacher.

Materials and Methods

A systematic, conceptual approach to its comprehension and implementation contributes to creating conditions for successful social interaction for all participants in the educational and training process.

Establishing strong relationships between the teacher and student consists of four aspects of interaction: social, affective, cognitive, and behavioral. These four aspects form an integral model where each element reinforces the other. In the context of learning a foreign language, they work as follows. The essence of the social aspect is the formation of a democratic style of communication. In a language environment, this manifests in the transition from a teacher's monologue to a dialogue with the student or between students. When a teacher is interested in the students' opinions, they feel like equal participants in the discussion, which stimulates the use of language as a tool for real communication, rather than just performing exercises. The affective aspect focuses on creating a safe emotional climate. Since language learning is often associated with the fear of making a mistake, it is the affective connection that helps one feel the teacher's support, get rid of anxiety, and become more open to assimilating new information. The cognitive aspect is aimed at a joint search for meanings and an intellectual challenge. In the learning process, the teacher does not just provide a translation but encourages thinking in a foreign language. This is interaction at the level

of ideas: discussing problematic issues, jointly solving communicative tasks, and developing critical thinking. The behavioral aspect involves adherence to clear rules, feedback, and mutual responsibility. The teacher's reaction to the student's efforts, encouragement of activity in class, and joint adherence to the language regime (for example, the "only English" rule) form productive learning habits.

To achieve effective social interaction in a foreign language class, teachers need to adhere to certain principles. The first principle is the principle of accessibility. To interact with the teacher, students must feel that teachers are open to interaction. It is good if conditions are created in educational institutions where students can come and talk to teachers about their problems, and teachers should not avoid or ignore such communication. Also, more and more teachers are using social networks and online platforms to communicate with students, which is an important practical step toward accessibility in the digital age. There are many direct and indirect ways teachers can express their accessibility, and self-disclosure is a particularly effective tool. Foreign language teachers constantly ask their students to share many personal details regarding their likes, dislikes, hopes, fears, etc. In establishing rapport, such a practice can be significant if teachers offer a certain degree of self-disclosure in return. But everything should be in moderation – excessive information sharing is unprofessional or inappropriate. The degree of self-disclosure shows desired openness toward others, and honesty. This is also an important component of social interaction.

The second principle that can help form constructive interaction is the manifestation of responsiveness and psychological support from the teacher. Students should feel that they are understood and valued. In any relationship, empathy is a key component. Empathy is defined as the ability to step into another person's shoes and see the world through their eyes. Empathy does not mean agreement, but consists of trying to understand others. The teacher demonstrates an understanding of difficulties, encourages attempts rather than just correct answers, and minimizes stress factors during error correction.

In order for the social, affective, cognitive, and behavioral aspects to work in practice, the teacher must also be guided by the principle of partnership (subject-subject interaction), in which the teacher and student are equal participants in communication. Instead of a directive style ("Listen and repeat"), a consultative one should be used. The teacher stimulates the student to make independent conclusions, creating an atmosphere of cooperation.

The fourth principle of effective social interaction is the consideration of the student's individuality. Students like to realize that the teacher really knows who they are, and that they are valued as an individual. Student orientation focuses on their uniqueness and provides an opportunity to ensure an atmosphere where all students are motivated to learn. This is facilitated by taking into account the personal characteristics, learning pace, and cognitive styles of each student. This can be achieved through the use of differentiated tasks and flexibility in choosing interaction methods, which allows even shy students to express themselves. Among the social interaction techniques that do not take much time but show that the teacher is interested in the student's personality, we can mention the following: remember students' names; find out something unique about each student and mention it to them from time to time; ask about their hobbies and life outside the educational institution; include personal topics and examples about students during discussions; maintain contact with students (for example, send homework) who were absent from class.

Also among the important principles for achieving effective social interaction in foreign language classes, we will mention the principle of authenticity of communication (language should be studied not as a set of exercises, but as a means of solving real-life tasks, which is facilitated, for

example, by using topics that really interest students (socially relevant topics)); the principle of positive feedback (constructive feedback) (interaction should not be limited only to error control; it is necessary, for example, to use the "sandwich" method (positive – constructive criticism – positive), which maintains motivation and preserves trust in the relationship between the teacher and students); the principle of interactivity (dialogic engagement), which involves maximizing the time of students' speech activity (STT – Student Talking Time) compared to the teacher's time (TTT) (the way to implement this is through the use of group projects, debates, and peer-learning methods).

Many foreign language teachers emphasize mainly their professional knowledge and its transfer to students, supporting with their position the subject-object nature of the educational process. At the same time, research results indicate that the effectiveness of classes where the teacher's position changes from influence to interaction becomes higher (Kyryklytsia, V., 2014).

Results and Discussion

Let's consider several aspects of comparing the traditional teaching model (Teacher-Centered) and the teaching model using social interaction methods (Student-Centered).

Under the traditional model, the teacher's role is reduced to a broadcaster of knowledge, the main source of information, and a controller, while the student acts as a passive listener, an object of pedagogical influence. The use of social interaction methods allows the teacher to become a facilitator, partner, discussion moderator, and mentor, and the student to become an active participant, a subject of learning, and an initiator of communication. According to the first model, the communication vector is predominantly one-way (teacher – student), and according to the second, it is multi-way (student – student, student – group, student – teacher). In the traditional educational process, Teacher Talking Time dominates, and under conditions of using social interaction methods, Student Talking Time prevails (up to 70-80%). Under the traditional foreign language teaching model, an error is an object of immediate correction and evaluation, the psychological climate is mostly formal, often distanced, with a high level of anxiety, and among educational tools, preference is given to textbooks, translation exercises, and substitution exercises. The use of methods and techniques of social interaction in foreign language classes allows an error to be perceived as a natural stage of learning and to emphasize communication success (fluency), build a psychological climate based on empathy and support, with a low level of affective filter, and use mainly cases, projects, role-playing games, authentic situations, and digital collaborations in teaching. Therefore, the learning outcomes in the first case are mostly knowledge about the language (grammar rules, vocabulary), and in the second – the ability to use the language to solve life and professional tasks.

We provide our own experience of introducing modern methods and forms of teaching foreign languages to students into the educational process of a higher education institution, based on social interaction.

The first step in any process is its motivation. At the stage of initial motivation, we involved methods such as communicative attack, proof, persuasion, and suggestion. The use of the communicative attack method as a method of rapid inclusion, mobilization, and interest of the audience in the process of learning a foreign language was based on activating the student's emotional sphere – arousing their surprise and admiration through the use of the effect of novelty and unexpectedness. This method was used, for example, when watching and discussing a video clip "Parable of Interaction" in English. The content of the parable is as follows: "People sat around a pot of soup. They were all hungry and suffered greatly from it. Each of them had a spoon with

which they could scoop from the pot, but the handles of the spoons were so much longer than their arms that there was no way to bring the spoon to their mouths. As a result of vain attempts, interfering with each other, people became increasingly aggressive. And then, when one of them broke his spoon and dropped his hands in despair, another man came to his aid, holding out his spoon with soup and feeding him. People, seeing this, also began to feed each other. And the world changed." After watching the video, a conversation took place, starting with questions: What do you see as the meaning of the parable? What is the allegory of the long spoons? Why is this parable relevant today? Evaluate the role of interaction in the life of society? What is useful in this parable for each of us? etc. These questions aroused interest, which contributed to activating the students for the conversation and contributed to the formation of positive motivation to use social interaction in learning and in life.

The implementation of the method of proof and persuasion in classes contributed to the activation of students' volitional efforts by explaining to them the need to master educational material for social interaction and life in general. The following techniques were used in classes: references to positive or negative consequences of the ability to interact with others – in case of their absence; induction (reasoning together with students from specific examples of social interaction to generalizing its role) and deduction (from generalization to specific examples); references to undeniable facts, authorities, and authoritative sources; use of analogies and comparisons; emphasizing the relevance and practicality of acquired knowledge on social interaction in life (the ability to test one's knowledge in practice, its easy implementation; using it as a means of solving personal problems; as a component of professional competence; an aspect of a successful business career, etc.); identifying contradictions in critical remarks from the audience; applying techniques such as "yes, but..." (accepting the audience's opinion with a subsequent return to the teacher's opinion) and the "boomerang" (answering a question with a question, an argument with an argument).

An important condition for using the suggestion method, which consists of the indirect formation of an opinion about the need for learning through an appeal to the students' subconscious, was the students' lack of awareness of the influence being exerted. This required teachers to monitor the ease of their behavior and the dynamism of the influence on the audience. Techniques such as periodic repetition of one thought; putting forward requirements for the desired emotional reaction of students (I believe you will agree with me that...); intonational emphasis on important points of the speech; automatic inclusion in certain work, and dynamism in the presentation of material when no time is given to consider its necessity were involved in the class.

Collective forms of work are effective for organizing educational interaction between the teacher and students, and between students. In particular, students' cooperation in pairs of changing composition: reading and subsequent joint discussion of a logically complete and small volume of a text; developing skills for formulating a question, plan point, or thesis adequate to the content of the processed paragraph, etc. The practice of students' mutual learning is effective: answers to homework questions are supplemented in writing and checked by the students themselves; group solving of a problematic situation; independent work with new educational material in pairs with its subsequent explanation to the entire group; repeated variable repetition with the help of supporting signals, etc.

Within the framework of the practical implementation of the social interaction strategy in foreign language classes, we also implemented a complex of interactive methods aimed at stimulating the communicative activity of students. Firstly, this is the "Collaborative Project Work"

method, within which students worked in small groups on the development of socially significant projects (for example, "University of the Future" or "Ecological Challenges of the Region"), and the teacher acted as a consultant-moderator in this process. Secondly, it is the Case Study method, the purpose of which was to analyze real problematic situations that required a collective search for solutions. This allowed for the realization of the cognitive aspect of interaction: through discussion and argumentation of one's own position, students overcame the psychological barrier, as the focus shifted from the complexities of English grammar to solving a problem. Thirdly – digital interaction in the "Flipped Classroom" format, where thanks to the Moodle platform, students mastered theoretical material independently, and class time was entirely dedicated to foreign language communication. This allowed for an increase in the Student Talking Time (STT) indicator to 70-80% of the class. Fourthly – simulated role-playing games and debates, where students modeled professional situations (job interview, scientific conference). This created a foreign language communicative environment, where the playing role allowed the student to feel less responsibility for a mistake, which significantly increased speech liberation.

Analysis of the results of introducing methods and forms based on social interaction into the process of teaching foreign languages to students allowed us to state positive dynamics in several areas. According to the results of the final testing, the number of students with a high level of communicative competence increased by 25% compared to the control group, where training was conducted according to the traditional method. Timing of the classes showed an increase in the duration of spontaneous speech by students by an average of 30% per semester. According to student self-assessment data (questionnaire), 80% of respondents noted a noticeable reduction in the fear of public speaking in a foreign language. Students began to show more initiative in choosing topics for discussion and methods of presenting projects, which indicates a transition from external motivation (grade) to internal motivation (satisfaction from communication).

We also note the achievement of a certain socio-psychological effect. Strengthening of interpersonal ties in groups was observed. Interaction ceased to be competitive and became cooperative: students more often resorted to mutual assistance (peer-correction) and the joint resolution of linguistic difficulties. There was a change in the perception of the teacher: students began to perceive the teacher as a support resource, which significantly increased the level of trust and openness during classes.

Conclusions

Thus, the role of social interaction is decisive in creating a comfortable atmosphere that promotes active involvement of students, reduces the fear of making mistakes, and increases motivation. It also proves to be important in the process of forming communicative skills, as communication in pairs, groups, and with the teacher provides an opportunity to practice a foreign language in conditions close to real life.

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INTERACTIVE METHODS OF TEACHING ENGLISH

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Abstract: The growing importance of English as a global means of communication has increased the demand for effective and innovative teaching methodologies. In this context, interactive methods of teaching English have gained significant attention as they promote active learner participation and meaningful communication. This paper aims to examine the role, effectiveness, and pedagogical value of interactive teaching methods in English language education. The study focuses on various interactive techniques, including group work, pair activities, role-playing, classroom discussions, task-based learning, and technology-enhanced instruction.

The research adopts a qualitative methodology based on the analysis of relevant academic literature, including theoretical and empirical studies in the field of language pedagogy. The findings reveal that interactive methods significantly contribute to the development of communicative competence, linguistic accuracy, and learner autonomy. Moreover, these methods enhance students' motivation, engagement, and confidence by creating a collaborative and supportive learning environment.

The study also highlights the importance of social interaction in language acquisition, emphasizing that learning is more effective when learners actively construct knowledge through communication and cooperation. In addition, the integration of digital technologies further strengthens interactive learning by expanding opportunities for communication beyond the traditional classroom setting.

However, the implementation of interactive methods presents several challenges, such as large class sizes, limited instructional time, insufficient teacher training, and the lack of appropriate assessment tools for evaluating communicative skills. Despite these limitations, the overall findings suggest that interactive methods represent a highly effective and sustainable approach to teaching English. The paper concludes by recommending the integration of interactive strategies into language curricula and the provision of professional development programs to support teachers in their implementation.

Keywords: interactive teaching methods, communicative language teaching, communicative competence, learner-centered approach, task-based learning, English language pedagogy.

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNİN İNTERAKTİV METODLARI

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Xülasə: İngilis dilinin qlobal ünsiyyət vasitəsi kimi artan əhəmiyyəti tədris prosesində daha effektiv və innovativ yanaşmalara olan ehtiyacı artırmışdır. Bu kontekstdə interaktiv tədris metodları tələbələrin dərş prosesində fəal iştirakını və mənalı ünsiyyətini təmin etdiyi üçün xüsusi əhəmiyyət daşıyır. Məqalənin məqsədi ingilis dili tədrisində interaktiv metodların rolunu, səmərəliliyini və pədaqoji əhəmiyyətini araşdırmaqdır. Tədqiqat qrup işi, cütlərlə fəaliyyət, rol oyunları, sinif müzakirələri, tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə və texnologiya ilə dəstəklənən tədris kimi müxtəlif interaktiv üsulları əhatə edir.

Araşdırma dil pədaqogikası sahəsində mövcud nəzəri və empirik tədqiqatların təhlilinə əsaslanan keyfiyyət yönümlü yanaşma əsasında aparılmışdır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, interaktiv metodlar tələbələrin kommunikativ səriştəsinin, dil bacarıqlarının düzgünlüyünün və müstəqil öyrənmə bacarığının inkişafına əhəmiyyətli töhfə verir. Eyni zamanda, bu metodlar əməkdaşlığa əsaslanan öyrənmə mühiti yaradaraq tələbələrin motivasiyasını, dərşə marağını və özünəinamını artırır.

Tədqiqat həmçinin dil öyrənməsində sosial qarşılıqlı əlaqənin vacibliyini vurğulayır və göstərir ki, öyrənmə prosesi tələbələrin ünsiyyət və əməkdaşlıq vasitəsilə bilikləri fəal şəkildə qurduğu zaman daha səmərəli olur. Bundan əlavə, rəqəmsal texnologiyaların inteqrasiyası interaktiv öyrənməni daha da gücləndirərək sinifdənkənar ünsiyyət imkanlarını genişləndirir.

Bununla belə, interaktiv metodların tətbiqi böyük siniflər, vaxt məhdudiyyəti, müəllim hazırlığının yetərsizliyi və kommunikativ bacarıqların qiymətləndirilməsi üçün uyğun vasitələrin çatışmazlığı kimi bir sıra çətinliklərlə müşayiət olunur. Bu məhdudiyyətlərə baxmayaraq, ümumi nəticələr göstərir ki, interaktiv metodlar ingilis dili tədrisində yüksək səmərəliliyə malik və davamlı bir yanaşmadır. Məqalə interaktiv strategiyaların tədris proqramlarına inteqrasiyasını və onların effektiv tətbiqini dəstəkləmək məqsədilə müəllimlərin peşəkar inkişafının gücləndirilməsini tövsiyə edir.

Açar sözlər: interaktiv tədris metodları, kommunikativ dil tədrisi, kommunikativ səriştə, tələbə mərkəzli yanaşma, tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə, ingilis dili pədaqogikası.

Introduction

The role of English as a global lingua franca has significantly increased over the past decades due to globalization, international trade, technological advancement, and intercultural communication. As a result, the demand for effective English language teaching methodologies has become a central focus in the field of applied linguistics and language education. Traditional approaches to language teaching, such as the Grammar-Translation Method and Audio-Lingual Method, have been widely criticized for their limited ability to develop learners' communicative competence in authentic contexts (Richards & Rodgers, 2001).

In response to these limitations, Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and interactive methods of instruction have emerged as dominant paradigms in modern language pedagogy. These approaches emphasize the importance of meaningful communication, learner engagement, and real-life language use rather than mechanical repetition and rote memorization. According to Hymes (1972), communicative competence involves not only grammatical knowledge but also the ability to use language appropriately in social contexts. This perspective has fundamentally reshaped language teaching methodologies worldwide.

Interactive methods of teaching English are grounded in sociocultural theories of learning, particularly the work of Vygotsky (1978), who emphasized the importance of social interaction in cognitive development. From this perspective, learning is viewed as a collaborative process in which knowledge is constructed through communication and interaction with others. Similarly, Long's Interaction Hypothesis (1996) suggests that language acquisition is facilitated through negotiation of meaning during interaction, where learners modify and clarify their input and output.

In contemporary educational settings, interactive teaching methods include a wide range of strategies such as group work, pair activities, role-playing, discussions, task-based learning, and

technology-supported communication. These methods are designed to create learner-centered environments in which students actively participate in the learning process rather than passively receiving information from the teacher. Research has shown that such approaches not only improve linguistic proficiency but also enhance motivation, confidence, and learner autonomy (Harmer, 2007; Scrivener, 2011).

Despite their advantages, the implementation of interactive methods is not without challenges. Factors such as large class sizes, limited instructional time, insufficient teacher training, and traditional assessment systems may hinder their effective application in some educational contexts. Therefore, it is essential to critically examine both the benefits and limitations of these methods in order to optimize their use in English language teaching.

The main aim of this paper is to explore the role of interactive methods in teaching English and to evaluate their effectiveness in improving language learning outcomes. The study also seeks to identify key pedagogical implications and provide recommendations for the effective integration of interactive strategies in language education.

Materials and Methods

This study adopts a qualitative research design aimed at exploring the effectiveness of interactive methods in teaching English. A qualitative approach was considered appropriate because the research focuses on understanding pedagogical practices, theoretical perspectives, and educational outcomes rather than measuring numerical data.

The materials used in this study consist of a wide range of secondary sources, including peer-reviewed journal articles, academic books, conference proceedings, and authoritative publications in the fields of applied linguistics, language pedagogy, and educational psychology. Key references include works by Hymes (1972), Vygotsky (1978), Long (1996), Richards and Rodgers (2001), Harmer (2007), and Scrivener (2011), which provide a strong theoretical foundation for the analysis of communicative and interactive language teaching approaches.

The data collection process involved a systematic review of literature published in reputable academic databases. The selection criteria for sources included relevance to interactive language teaching, publication in peer-reviewed journals or academic presses, and contribution to the theoretical or practical understanding of English language pedagogy. Studies that focused on classroom-based interactive techniques, learner engagement, and communicative competence were given priority.

Data analysis was conducted using thematic analysis. This involved identifying recurring themes and patterns across the selected literature, such as learner-centered instruction, interaction-based learning, communicative competence development, and the role of technology in language teaching. These themes were then categorized and critically evaluated to determine the effectiveness and limitations of interactive teaching methods.

In addition, comparative analysis was used to examine different pedagogical approaches, particularly contrasting traditional teacher-centered methods with modern interactive strategies. This allowed for a clearer understanding of the shift in language teaching paradigms and the pedagogical implications of interactive learning.

Furthermore, special attention was given to the role of technological tools in facilitating interaction. Digital platforms, online communication tools, and multimedia resources were analyzed as supporting elements that enhance learner participation and extend interaction beyond the physical classroom environment.

Overall, the methodological framework of this study ensures a comprehensive and systematic examination of interactive methods in English language teaching, providing a solid basis for the interpretation of findings and conclusions.

Results and Discussion

The analysis of the reviewed literature reveals that interactive methods of teaching English have a consistently positive impact on learners' language development. One of the most significant findings is that these methods enhance communicative competence by providing learners with opportunities to actively use the target language in meaningful contexts. Unlike traditional teacher-centered approaches, interactive strategies encourage students to participate in authentic communication, which is essential for language acquisition.

A key result identified across multiple studies is the improvement of learner engagement and motivation. When students are involved in interactive activities such as group work, discussions, and role-playing, they demonstrate higher levels of participation and interest in the learning process. This increased engagement is closely linked to improved retention of vocabulary, better grammatical accuracy in context, and greater fluency in spoken communication (Harmer, 2007; Scrivener, 2011).

Another important finding is the role of collaboration in enhancing learning outcomes. Interactive methods create opportunities for peer-to-peer interaction, which allows learners to negotiate meaning, clarify misunderstandings, and support each other's learning process. This collaborative environment is consistent with Vygotsky's (1978) sociocultural theory, which emphasizes that cognitive development occurs through social interaction within the Zone of Proximal Development.

Task-based learning, as highlighted in the literature, is particularly effective in promoting language use in realistic contexts. By engaging learners in problem-solving tasks, information gap activities, and project-based assignments, teachers encourage the practical application of language skills. These tasks not only develop linguistic competence but also foster critical thinking, creativity, and autonomy in learners.

The integration of technology into interactive language teaching has also emerged as a significant factor in improving learning outcomes. Digital tools such as online discussion forums, video conferencing platforms, and language learning applications enable learners to interact beyond the physical classroom. This extended interaction supports continuous exposure to the language and increases opportunities for meaningful communication.

However, despite these positive outcomes, several challenges are consistently reported in the literature. One of the primary challenges is classroom management, particularly in large classes where ensuring equal participation can be difficult. Teachers often struggle to monitor group activities effectively, which may reduce the efficiency of interactive tasks.

Another challenge is the lack of adequate teacher training. Effective implementation of interactive methods requires specific pedagogical skills, including the ability to design communicative tasks, manage group dynamics, and assess speaking and interaction skills. Without proper training, teachers may revert to traditional methods, limiting the effectiveness of interactive approaches.

Assessment remains another critical issue. Traditional testing systems tend to focus on grammar and written accuracy, rather than communicative competence and interaction skills. This mismatch between teaching methods and assessment criteria can negatively affect the implementation of interactive approaches in classroom practice.

Cultural factors also influence the effectiveness of interactive methods. In some educational contexts, learners may be accustomed to passive learning styles and may initially feel uncomfortable participating in discussions or group activities. Therefore, gradual implementation and appropriate classroom support are necessary to ensure successful adaptation.

Overall, the results strongly indicate that interactive methods significantly improve English language learning when properly implemented. However, their effectiveness depends on multiple factors, including teacher competence, institutional support, and alignment with assessment practices.

Conclusion

This study has examined the role and effectiveness of interactive methods in teaching English as a foreign language, with particular emphasis on their contribution to the development of communicative competence. The findings of the study clearly indicate that interactive teaching approaches represent a highly effective pedagogical framework for modern language education. Interactive methods, including group work, pair activities, role-playing, task-based learning, and technology-supported instruction, have been shown to significantly enhance learner engagement, motivation, and participation. These methods create a learner-centered environment in which students are actively involved in the learning process, thereby improving both fluency and accuracy in language use. Moreover, the integration of social interaction in the classroom supports the development of critical thinking skills, collaboration, and learner autonomy. The study also highlights that the effectiveness of interactive methods is closely linked to several contextual factors. Teacher competence plays a crucial role in the successful implementation of these approaches. Educators must possess the necessary pedagogical skills to design interactive tasks, manage classroom dynamics, and facilitate meaningful communication among learners. Without adequate professional training, the potential benefits of interactive methods may not be fully realized. In addition, institutional and systemic factors such as classroom size, available resources, and assessment practices significantly influence the implementation of interactive teaching. Traditional evaluation systems, which often prioritize grammatical accuracy over communicative ability, may limit the effectiveness of interactive approaches. Therefore, there is a need for more comprehensive assessment models that accurately reflect learners' communicative competence. Despite these challenges, the overall evidence strongly supports the integration of interactive methods into English language teaching curricula. These approaches not only improve linguistic outcomes but also prepare learners for real-world communication in an increasingly globalized environment. Future research should focus on empirical studies that investigate the long-term effects of interactive methods on language proficiency across different educational contexts.

Additionally, further exploration of technology-enhanced interactive learning environments may provide valuable insights into more effective and flexible teaching practices. In conclusion, interactive methods of teaching English represent a dynamic and essential component of contemporary language pedagogy, offering significant benefits for both learners and educators when properly implemented and supported.

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WHY FIXED PHRASES AND COLLOCATIONS MATTER IN LANGUAGE LEARNING

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Abstract. Vocabulary research has neglected in favor of syntax and phonology in language teaching for a long time. However, it has gained prominence in the late 20th century as researchers recognized its central role in communication. From the 1970s onward, studies shifted to vocabulary teaching methods focusing on contextual learning, extensive reading, collocations, and word associations to learners' communicative needs. Fixed expressions and collocations which are processed as a unit emerged as key interests. Advances in corpus linguistics in the 1980s provided empirical evidence that a large portion of spoken and written texts contains prefabricated expressions. Some scholars also indicated that communicative competence depends on knowledge of such sequences. Thus, the necessity of collocational competence has been acknowledged for fluent language production. Collocations enable learners to process language easily and convey their messages effectively. For that reason, they should be taught to raise learners' awareness of these items. Since many collocations are present in language, priority should be given to the ones being frequent and opaque, serving important functions and having the potential for generalizability. In teaching collocations, aids can be taken from techniques ranging from grids and gap-filling to communicative practice; technological tools such as electronic collocation dictionaries, corpora, concordancers, and interactive platforms to support learning.

Keywords: Fixed phrases, collocations, language teaching, idiomatic expressions, opacity

WHY FIXED PHRASES AND COLLOCATIONS MATTER IN LANGUAGE LEARNING

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Özet. Sözcük bilgisi araştırmaları, uzun süre dil öğretiminde sözdizimi ve sesbilgisi lehine ihmal edildi. Ancak iletişimdeki merkezi rolünün araştırmacılar tarafından kabul edilmesiyle 20. yüzyılın sonlarında önem kazandı. 1970'lerden itibaren çalışmalar, bağlamsal öğrenme, geniş kapsamlı okuma, eşdizimlilikler ve kelime çağrışımlarına odaklanan sözcük öğretim yöntemlerine kaydı; öğrencilerin iletişimsel ihtiyaçlarına yönelik yaklaşımlar ön plana çıktı. Bir bütün olarak işlenen sabit ifadeler ve

eşdizimlilikler önemli ilgi alanları olarak ortaya çıktı. 1980’lerde derlem dilbilimindeki ilerlemeler, konuşma ve yazılı metinlerin büyük bir bölümünün önceden oluşturulmuş ifadeler içerdiğine dair deneysel kanıt sağladı. Bazı araştırmacılar ayrıca iletişimsel yeterliğin bu tür diziler bilgisine bağlı olduğunu belirtti. Böylece akıcı dil üretimi için eşdizimsel yeterliliğinin gerekliliği kabul edildi. Eşdizimlilikler, öğrencilerin dili kolayca işlemelerine ve mesajlarını etkili bir şekilde iletmelerine olanak tanır. Bu nedenle, öğrencilerin bu öğelere karşı farkındalığını artırmak için öğretilmelidir. Doğal dilde birçok eşdizimlilik bulunduğundan, sıklık açısından yüksek ve bulanık olanlara; önemli işlevlere hizmet edenlere ve genellenme potansiyeli taşıyanlara öncelik verilmelidir. Eşdizimlilik öğretiminde, sistem tabloları ve boşluk doldurmalar gibi tekniklerden iletişimsel uygulamalara kadar çeşitli yöntemlerden; elektronik eşdizimlilik sözlükleri, derlem, bağlamalı dizin araçları ve öğrenmeyi destekleyen etkileşimli platformlar gibi teknolojik araçlardan yararlanılabilir.

Anahtar kelimeler: Kalıp ifadeler, eşdizimlilikler, dil öğretimi, deyim, deyim, deyim, deyim, deyim

Introduction

For a long time, vocabulary in language teaching research had a secondary status after syntax and phonology and developed as a field that was consistently pushed into the background until the second half of the 20th century. The influence of structuralism has been cited as the main reason why syntax and phonology attracted more attention than vocabulary (Carter, 1987). C. Fries’ (1945: 3) stated that if a person has first mastered the sound system and then made the structural devices automatic habits using limited vocabulary items, they would have learned the foreign language. Fries also described the words that students need to know in order to practice syntactic structures as the basic vocabulary of the language. This view remained influential for many years, and the vocabulary load in language teaching was kept at a minimum to prioritize phonology and syntax. This approach continued more than the first half of the 20th century under the dominant teaching method of the audio-lingual method which was based on behaviorist theory and later under the strong influence of early explanations about transformational grammar which treated sentences algorithmically and classified that as ill-formed and well-formed. Syntax and phonology were considered core components of language and emphasized, but social context and usage were largely ignored. Consequently, beyond identifying and forming grammatically correct structures, little attention was paid to the reason why these structures were used (Pawley, 2009, p. 5).

However, there was a change of trend in the last quarter of the 20th century as many researchers acknowledged the necessity of vocabulary in language teaching methods (Marton, 1977; Carter, 1987; Nesselhauf, 2005). To draw attention to vocabulary Wilkins (1972: 111) made the remark that “without grammar a little can be conveyed, without vocabulary nothing can be conveyed.” A similar comment came from Krashen with the view expressing the necessity of a large repertoire of vocabulary to have the mastery of a language. He also adds that second language learners are aware of this and hence they carry dictionaries rather than grammar books and report the problems relating lack of vocabulary (Krashen, 1989, p. 439).

These explanations gave way to the increased interest towards vocabulary, especially after the 1970s and many early studies have focused on effective vocabulary teaching methods such as learning vocabulary in context, extensive reading, and the role of word associations and collocations (Wilkins, 1972; Brown, 1974). Later learners’ communicative needs were placed at the center of language teaching, and vocabulary was accepted as a primary resource for meeting these needs. After the 1980s, the necessity of vocabulary knowledge became more widely recognized, and this led to numerous studies investigating its theoretical and practical aspects. The main concern of

these studies was to explore the ways of reducing vocabulary load, overcoming difficulties faced by learners, and identifying effective teaching methods (Laufer, 1990).

A key area of focus in vocabulary research has been formulaic language involving fixed phrases with a large group of word combinations. In fact, awareness of these expressions goes back to John Hughlings Jackson's observations of aphasic patients who could produce fixed expressions fluently even when they could not generate new utterances. Collocations which form a special area within formulaic language have also been studied extensively both in descriptive studies and in acquisition research. Firth (1957) emphasized their central role in communication, introducing the concept of "habitual collocations." Halliday (1966) further developed this framework, defining terms such as node, collocate, and span. Fillmore (1969) highlighted the prevalence of formulaic language but his ideas were not influential at that time due to the dominance of Chomsky's syntactic theories.

However, in the 1980s, technological developments enabled linguists to use computers for discovering usage patterns of a large number of words taken from natural language (Sinclair, 1991). The evidence coming from corpus studies revealed that natural languages contain a large number of word combinations occurring together. For example, Erman and Warren (2000, p. 37) found that spoken texts included 58,6 percent and written texts 52.3 percent lexical prefabricated expressions as in the following texts:

To the best of + my + knowledge, there is no record of a society which has used literacy for + the profane and imaginative + purposes and which has + not + produced books dealing with sexual topics; [13 lexical choices; G77 001-010].

In this regard, the comment made by Widdowson (1979: 135) highlighted that communicative competence is connected with the knowledge of a stock of formulaic sequences and partially pre-assembled patterns. He also noted that being able to make necessary adjustments in accordance with contextual demands is important in achieving communicative competence. Lewis (2000b, p. 147) argued that the aim of language is to convey messages, and they are constructed through lexical items, collocations, and formulaic sequences. He also underlined the supportive role grammar plays and expressed the view that sometimes grammatically correct sentences may sound unnatural to native speakers. Subsequent to the acknowledgement of the fact that achieving a large vocabulary knowledge represents the greatest and never-ending learning burden, even for native speakers, Hill (2000, p. 68) criticized the weight given to accuracy in language teaching as it discourages production and argued that language competence is linked to understanding and producing communication rather than accuracy. These studies encouraged researchers from various fields ranging from lexicography, computation to linguistics to examine collocations and formulaic utterances in detail through using authentic language data.

Terminological Confusion about Collocations

Depending on the purpose of the study, researchers such as linguists, lexicographers and educators have approached the topic from a different perspective, and this was reflected in the terms they employed. H. E. Palmer was among the first scholars who emphasized the importance of collocations, or multi-word combinations. He argued that in order to understand collocations formed according to conventional rules of sentence construction, one must know the meanings of their components. He also indicated the importance of learning collocations as whole units, especially when they convey meanings that are only possible within a particular word sequence

(Palmer & Redman, 1969, p. 129). Examples of such collocations include “by the way,” “as a matter of fact,” and “in the ordinary course.”

Research on co-occurring words began in Japan in the 1930s through the work of Palmer and Hornby, but the topic gained prominence with Firth’s contributions. Firth (1957, p. 196) examined the distribution of common words and wrote that “words are known by the company they keep”. This remark underlined the importance of collocations. He elaborated his view with the word *night* which gains one of its meanings when it is associated with *dark*, and *dark* is naturally used with *night*. In this example, Firth describes collocation as the habitual co-occurrence of words that exhibit a syntagmatic relationship. Many later definitions of the term have been influenced by Firth’s ideas. Bolinger and Sears (1968, p. 53) defined collocations as “habitual associations” or “characteristic co-occurrences” of words. Cruse (1986), and Carter (1987) largely reiterated the Firthian notion of collocation in their definitions.

Moon (1998, p. 2) preferred the term *formulaic expressions* to refer to word groups that include frozen collocations, proverbs, grammatically irregular structures, sayings, similes, and conventionalized expressions. Nevertheless, she also noted that this term is insufficient because many such expressions are not entirely fixed. Lewis (2000b, p. 129) argued that a large portion of the mental lexicon consists of multi-word units or chunks and pointed out that the term *chunk* encompasses various types of word combinations, which can be classified differently depending on purpose and context. For Schmitt and Carter (2004), formulaic structures such as idioms, proverbs, and sayings are relatively easy to identify because they convey a unified meaning. However, they also reported that corpus linguistics has shown that many commonly used multi-word units exist beyond these categories, and they make it difficult to formulate a comprehensive definition that encompasses all types. Nevertheless, they provided some criteria for identifying a collocation such as frequency, conventionalization, repeated usage, storage as whole units in the mental lexicon, and production within a single intonational unit.

Cortigan, Moravcsik, Ouali, and Wheatley (2009, p. xiv) approached the issue from a different perspective and suggested two key features to distinguish formulaic expressions from other word combinations: *restricted form* and *restricted distribution*. The former refers to the limited flexibility of such expressions in terms of lexical and structural variation, and the latter relates to their tendency to occur in specific communicative contexts and perform particular language functions. They stated, however, that since formulaic expressions can exhibit some variation and are not strictly bound to specific contexts, these restrictions are probabilistic rather than absolute.

In corpus-based research dealing with frequency patterns, recurring sequences have been analyzed across different types of texts without necessarily considering their structure or degree of idiomaticity. This approach allowed researchers to examine word clusters of varying lengths (e.g., two-word, three-word, four-word sequences). Some researchers (e.g., Biber & Barbieri, 2007) have classified these as formulaic sequences. As to Handl’s (2009, p. 75) definition, collocation was characterized as a structure including at least two partners in which one item is attracted to other with an inherent collocational relationship.

The variety in the definitions shows that it is difficult to divide formulaic expressions into clear subcategories though there are some overlapping features in their descriptions. This situation leads them to belong to more than one group.

Free Combinations, Collocations, and Idioms

Although definitions provided for collocations vary, they share a common feature: collocations refer to words that co-occur more frequently than would be expected by chance. Similar associative relationships exist in other domains as well. Graham Smith (cited in Hill, Lewis & Lewis, 2000, pp. 89– 90) gives an illustrative example in his comparison of collocations with chemical structures. He indicates that words form structured combinations just like atoms forming molecules rather than occurring arbitrarily. This leads to the need to distinguish between collocations, free combinations, and idioms as word units different from each other. Bolinger (1977, p. 168, cited in Moon, 1998, p. 6) observed that these word relations can be placed along a continuum as no clear-cut boundary exists between an idiom and a collocation, or between a collocation and a phrase generated freely but there is just a continuum with high density at one end and openness at the other.

Accordingly, free combinations in which each component retains its literal meaning and the overall meaning can be derived compositionally (e.g., “green tree,” “eat fruit”) occupy an end of the continuum while idioms, whose meanings cannot be derived from their components and which are subject to strong constraints, occupy the other end (e.g., “black market,” “face the music”). Collocations lie between these two ends as at least one component in the word combination undergoes a semantic shift, often extending from its literal meaning to a figurative one. Due to the selective nature of word combinations, some researchers have referred to these as *restricted collocations* (Cowie, 1998a; Cowie & Howarth, 1996).

The Importance of Collocational Competence

In natural languages there are many words and language learners who want to have the mastery of a foreign language need to learn certain amount of these words to read texts written in the target language and involve in conversations with the speakers of these languages. According to Nation (2022, p. 16), 3,000 to 4,000 word families which include headwords, their inflected forms as well as their derived forms, help learners to cover 95 percent of texts and the number of word families goes to 6,000 and 9,000 word families to reach the level of 98 percent. As it can be understood from the numbers given, knowing a word is something more than knowing individual words to be able to communicate in the target language. Nation (2022, p. 83) also underlined the importance of knowing collocations of words. He exemplifies it with being familiar with which word combination *speedy food*, *quick food* or *fast food* is usual to say. He makes reference to Pawley and Syder (1983) who made the remark that native speakers speak fluently because they have a large number of memorized sequences in their brain to use when they need to say something. That is to say they do not produce their sentences out of scratch.

Pawley and Syder (1983, p. 192) have argued the importance of lexical sequence in relationship encoding and decoding language and indicated that expressions they described as *lexicalized* or *institutionalized* sentence-stems enable learners to have nativelike selection and nativelike fluency in the target language. These lexical units which have certain speech-act functions reduce learners’ encoding load in speech production. Nattinger and DeCarrico (1992) supported the ideas expressed by Pawley and Syder and noted that learners using fixed expressions have greater fluency and accuracy in speaking and writing. Language learners produce their sentences more naturally when they rely on these ready-made expressions. Wray (2002) also stated that learners should incorporate fixed phrases into their speech to sound nativelike.

In the distribution of words coming together and forming a combination, a pattern exists. John Sinclair (1991, p. 110) has explicated this pattern with two principles: open choice principle

which makes use of grammar rules for the selection of distinct words and idiom principle which directs attention to co-occurrence in a regular form. For him, open choice principle is a slot-and-filler model treating text as an item with certain slots to be filled with lexical items satisfying grammatical requirements. However, in the idiom principle, as stated by him, there are “a large number of semi-preconstructed phrases that constitute single choice even though they might appear to be analysable into segments” (Sinclair, 1991, p. 110). He also claimed that most of the language production relies on idiom principle rather than open choice principle.

Collocations or fixed phrases not only reduce native speakers’ load of formulating their messages but also processing them in both spoken and written language. They help them convey their messages in a clear and precise form and decode the message coming from other people easily. Fixed phrases also help learners to understand the nuances of language use in different contexts (Lewis, 2000; Pawley & Syder, 1983). Thus, for example, they can realize that *strong* but not *powerful* can be used with the word *tea*. Boers et al. (2006) indicated that learners grasping the appropriate usage of fixed phrases are better equipped to cope with various social and cultural situations. Research carried out by Schmitt (2004) and Siyanova-Chanturia and Martinez (2014) highlighted that when comparing them with individual words, formulaic chunks are easier to remember and retain. They are retrieved fast as a unit and used in communication. Research by Verspoor et al. (2012) has revealed that fixed phrases are quite important in cross-cultural communication as they enable learners to comprehend implicit cultural meanings and connotations.

Considering all these advantages these expressions present, it is evident that language learners should know them to get the same benefits in their language use. As a brief reminder, it is already known that learners paraphrase their messages and produce unusual combinations which sound awkward whenever they do not know formulaic language and collocations (Lewis, 2000). The issue that should be taken into account at that point is which fixed expressions should be given priority in the restricted classroom hours since all collocations cannot be taught. Some criteria can be used to identify the collocations learners mostly need and they can be listed as follows:

Frequency: Frequently used collocations will help learners to be familiar with the items native speakers use in their communication and thus they can use them in the relevant context (Hill, 2000; Moon, 1998).

Opacity: As discussed above, fixed expressions are classified as free combinations, collocations and idioms on a continuum according to their construction features. Since free combinations keep their original meaning and hence do not pose difficulty to learners, opaque ones forming restrictive collocations and idioms such as catch an eye, face the truth, kick the bucket, etc. can be taught to learners (Lewis, 2000; Wray, 2002).

Functionality: The functions that expressions have in sentences they occur are important to choose them to teach in the classroom (Coulmas, 1979). For example, verbs used together with certain tenses (e.g. There’s no need to (ask/warn/tell/remind, vb.) or nouns requiring certain personal pronouns (e.g. It’s my/your/our responsibility to ...) can be given priority. As regards the issue of functionality, the connection between fixed expressions and speech acts is also important. Learners should be exposed to fixed phrases making reference to social interactions (Schmitt & Carter, 2004).

Generalizability: The expressions having more generalizability are invaluable to teach as they allow learners to expand the use of expressions to new situations and thus reduce the burden on

their memory (Hoey, 2000; Lewis, 2000; Woolard, 2000). For instance, take (time) has such a pattern because it can be generalizable to take a few days/a while/two hours, etc.

Collocation Teaching and Learning Techniques and Tools

Although there are a number of studies (Morgan & Rinvoluceri 1986; Nation 1990; Rudzka et al., 1981) suggesting certain techniques such as using grids, fill-in-the blanks, sentence construction with collocations, playing bingo or domino with collocations, etc. to teach collocations before 2000, this topic has gained a growing interest after that year. Morgan Lewis (2000, p. 12) has indicated the importance of raising awareness of learners through the use of the mistakes they make. He exemplifies that with the combination of 'He's a strong smoker.' Instead of correcting the sentence with 'heavy smoker' he highlighted that the words *occasional*, *chain* and *non* that can come before *smoker* could be presented to learners to expand their vocabulary knowledge. Woolard (2000) made a similar point for teaching collocations and added that the grammatical structures in which collocations occur should be presented. He also wrote that delexical verbs which have a wide range of collocational combinations should be taught to learners.

Parallel to technological developments taking place in the last two decades, many electronic dictionaries presenting the meaning of words with example sentences involving their collocations have become available. Some of these sources which present just only collocations are Ozdic, FreeCollocation.com, WordReference English Collocations and Longman Collocations Dictionary and Thesaurus. These sources can be used effectively (Woolard, 2000). To give opportunity to take initiatives for their own learning, learners can have extensive reading to come across with collocations occurring quite a lot in literary works such as novels, plays, short stories, poems, etc. as well as scientific articles. Several recent studies (Pellicer-Sánchez, 2017; Webb et al., 2013) have shown that it is quite effective for incidental learning.

Another technological device learners themselves can check to find out collocations is corpus-based sources including concordance lines such as SkELL (Sketch Engine for Language Learning), Corpus of Contemporary American English (COCA), Just the Word, WebCollocate, and examples of collocations on the internet that can be accessed through search engines such as Google, Yahoo, Yandex. In fact, positive results have been obtained in many studies (Başal, 2019; Daskalovska, 2015) relating to the use of such sources.

Many interactive platforms also provide learners with games, puzzles, and quizzes containing collocations as well. A short list of these platforms includes Quizlet, Wordwall, Baamboozle, Kahoot!, They present collocation matching, sentence ordering, quizzes, filling in the blank activities to learners in an enjoyable manner. Furthermore, there are several ESL/EFL resources which offer lessons and games featuring collocations in context. British Council LearnEnglish and BBC Learning English which provides audio/video recordings from authentic samples are among these sources. YouGlish enables learners to search for collocations and hear them in their real contexts in YouTube videos. Finally, Online collocation Assistant which is a specialized tool, can be used to check topic-specific collocations.

Conclusion

Although vocabulary occupied a marginal position in language teaching research and was overshadowed by priorities given to syntax and phonology in the first half of the 20th century, this perspective began to change after the 1970s. Researchers increasingly recognized vocabulary as central to communication and hence studies were carried out to identify effective vocabulary teaching methods such as learning words in context, extensive reading, and exploiting word

associations and collocations. The importance of vocabulary knowledge was widely accepted as foundational for meeting learners' communicative needs in the 1980s. A major focus in vocabulary research has been on fixed expressions and collocations. The change of perspective was the result of explanations which foregrounded habitual co-occurrence and the mental storage of multiword units. Corpus linguistics which developed rapidly after technological advances of the 1980s, demonstrated the prevalence of lexical chunks. Corpus studies revealed that a substantial proportion of natural language consists of prefabricated expressions in both spoken and written texts. This evidence reinforced claims that communicative competence depends heavily on knowledge of formulaic sequences and on the ability to use them in context. Thus, it is understood that collocational competence is pedagogically crucial. Recent research studies have indicated that fixed phrases and collocations are easier to remember and retrieve, support pragmatic and cultural understanding, and help learners avoid unnatural language production. After the identification of these vital points relating to collocations, useful criteria for collocations that should be taught in the classroom were suggested in view of the previous literature. Given classroom time limits, teachers must prioritize which collocations to teach. Considering the latest technological devices, some resources and tools that can be exploited in teaching collocations have been suggested to equip learners with native-like, fluent language production abilities.

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LISTENING STRATEGIES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE INSTRUCTION AND THEIR PEDAGOGICAL APPLICATIONS

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Abstract: As is well known, in teaching English as a foreign language, effective outcomes can be achieved through the balanced integration of the four core language skills: listening, reading, writing, and speaking. However, insufficient attention to any of these skills may hinder the attainment of high levels of language proficiency. Furthermore, these skills can be categorized into receptive skills – namely listening and reading – and productive skills, including speaking and writing. Receptive skills function as “input” processes, involving the comprehension of information, whereas productive skills serve as “output,” enabling language production. In many educational settings, listening remains one of the most neglected among the four primary language skills. It is frequently observed that learners encounter difficulties when they are required to listen and subsequently complete tasks during classroom activities. Several factors contribute to this issue, including limited classroom time allocated to listening, the impracticality of incorporating listening activities into every lesson, and the heterogeneity of learners’ proficiency levels within a single

group. The primary aim of this study is to highlight the crucial role of listening in foreign language acquisition and to propose effective approaches for its development. To this end, the study investigates how appropriate listening strategies can be applied and for what purposes. Specifically, it examines the use of top-down (context-based) and bottom-up (signal-based) listening techniques, as well as clarifying the distinctions between extensive listening and intensive (analytical) listening.

Key words: listening skill, top-down listening, bottom-up listening, extensive listening, intensive listening

İNGİLİZCE ÖĞRETİMİNDE DİNLEME STRATEJİLERİ VE BUNLARIN PEDAGOJİK UYGULAMALARI

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Özet: Bilindiği üzere, İngilizcenin yabancı dil olarak öğretiminde dinleme, okuma, yazma ve konuşma olmak üzere dört temel dil becerisinin dengeli bir şekilde uygulanmasıyla yüksek başarı elde edilebilir. Ancak bu becerilerden herhangi birine yeterince önem verilmediğinde, dilin ileri düzeyde öğrenilmesi zorlaşmaktadır. Bununla birlikte, söz konusu beceriler alıcı (reseptif) beceriler – yani dinleme ve okuma – ve üretici (produktif) beceriler – yani konuşma ve yazma – olarak da sınıflandırılabilir. Alıcı beceriler bilgi edinme işlevi gördüğünden “girdi” (input), üretici beceriler ise “çıkı” (output) odaklıdır. Birçok eğitim kurumunda dinleme becerisi, dört temel dil becerisi arasında en az önem verilen alanlardan biri olmaya devam etmektedir. Ders sürecinde öğrencilerin dinledikten sonra verilen görevleri yerine getirirken zorlandıkları gözlemlenmektedir. Bu durumun çeşitli nedenleri bulunmaktadır: derslerde dinlemeye yeterli zaman ayrılması, her derste uygulanmasının mümkün olmaması ve aynı gruptaki öğrencilerin dil seviyelerinin farklı olması gibi. Bu çalışmanın temel amacı, dinleme becerisinin yabancı dil öğrenimindeki kritik rolünü vurgulamak ve bu becerinin geliştirilmesine yönelik etkili yaklaşımlar sunmaktır. Bu doğrultuda, öğrencilere uygun dinleme stratejilerinin nasıl ve hangi amaçlarla uygulanabileceği incelenmektedir. Ayrıca, üstten aşağıya (bağlam temelli) dinleme ve alttan yukarıya (sinyal temelli) dinleme tekniklerinin kullanım yolları ele alınmakta; geniş kapsamlı (extensive) dinleme ile yoğun/analitik (intensive) dinleme arasındaki farklar açıklanmaktadır.

Anahtar Kelimeler: dinleme becerisi, üstten aşağıya dinleme, alttan yukarıya dinleme, geniş kapsamlı dinleme, yoğun dinleme.

Introduction: Different approaches to top-down and bottom-up listening

From the very first day we are exposed to the world, we begin by hearing sounds, then words, and eventually sentences only after comprehending these we do start to speak. This developmental sequence clearly demonstrates that, in foreign language learning, listening – as a receptive skill – serves as a primary channel for input. When listening becomes habitual, it significantly enhances the process of language acquisition. This also explains why languages are acquired more rapidly in their natural environments, where they function as official means of communication. Therefore, educators should strive to simulate such an environment for learners by increasing their exposure to the target language and encouraging consistent engagement with auditory input. To achieve this, both teachers and students need to clearly understand the purposes and appropriate use of different

listening approaches, including top-down and bottom-up processing, as well as extensive and intensive listening.

The development of students' listening competence plays a crucial role in overall language acquisition. Improved listening skills contribute to greater communicative confidence, enabling learners to express themselves more freely, engage in interaction without hesitation, and view errors as part of the learning process. However, listening activities are sometimes perceived as monotonous or discouraging by learners. This often occurs when the selected materials fail to match their interests or proficiency levels, or when teachers expect learners to understand every word and answer all questions. Such expectations may create anxiety rather than motivation. Instead, teachers should foster interest in the topic and, where possible, design listening activities around learners' preferences.

According to Stephen Krashen (1985), language acquisition largely occurs through the comprehension of auditory input. The process of children's language development further supports this view: they initially listen, and only begin to speak after accumulating sufficient linguistic input. Listening comprehension is generally explained through the interaction of two fundamental processes: bottom-up (signal-based) and top-down (context-based) processing. Jack Richards and Willy R. (2002) describe bottom-up listening as a sequential decoding process that progresses from smaller linguistic units to larger structures, where sounds are combined into words, words into phrases, and phrases into complete texts. In contrast, top-down processing involves the active construction of meaning through the listener's prior knowledge and contextual understanding. In this case, comprehension is shaped not only by what is heard, but also by the listener's expectations, background knowledge, and situational awareness. Similarly, H. Douglas Brown (2001) emphasize that bottom-up processing is primarily concerned with recognizing the micro-level elements of language, whereas top-down processing operates at a macro level, involving meaning construction and prediction. From this perspective, listening can be regarded as a multi-layered and complex cognitive activity. According to Peterson (2001), bottom-up processing requires listeners to move from phonological recognition toward lexical, grammatical, and semantic interpretation. Conversely, top-down processing enables listeners to anticipate meaning based on their prior knowledge and contextual cues. Gary Buck (2001) further argues that, in real-life listening, these processes operate simultaneously and complement one another. Therefore, effective listening instruction should incorporate an integrated approach that combines both bottom-up and top-down strategies.

Materials and Methods: Challenges in Listening, Vocabulary Limitations, and Instructional Approaches

One of the major challenges in developing listening skills is learners' limited vocabulary. In reality, even native speakers are able to maintain communication without fully comprehending every element of spoken discourse. During listening activities, students frequently experience anxiety and tension. Therefore, one of the key responsibilities of the teacher is to create a psychologically supportive environment that reduces stress. Within top-down listening processes, comprehension can be significantly facilitated by encouraging learners to make predictions about the material before listening. This allows them to prepare mentally, adjust their emotional state, and activate relevant schemata – that is, their prior knowledge about the topic, the type of discourse they are likely to encounter, and related linguistic elements. In some cases, teachers may choose to pre-teach key vocabulary or at least familiarize learners with words and expressions they are likely to encounter. This can support learners in anticipating the content more effectively. However,

excessive focus on pre-taught vocabulary may cause learners to concentrate only on those items, potentially overlooking other important aspects of the listening text. While in real-life situations individuals often encounter unprepared input, listening instruction in foreign language contexts does not necessarily need to replicate this condition strictly. Encouraging learners to think in advance about possible content activates both their prior experiences and linguistic knowledge, leading to more effective engagement with listening tasks.

As in reading activities, it is important to use comprehension questions effectively in listening tasks. It is advisable for students to review these questions before listening, as this helps them anticipate possible answers, form hypotheses, and develop a general understanding of what they are about to hear. A simple yet effective way to build learners' confidence in listening is to encourage them to focus on grasping the main idea rather than understanding every word. Even without full comprehension, identifying the overall meaning is often achievable if the material is appropriately selected. Learners should also be trained to maintain concentration during listening, even when the speech rate is fast or difficult to follow. One effective strategy is to assign engaging and purposeful tasks, such as identifying the speaker's main intention, interpreting implied meaning, completing tables, drawing based on what they hear, or following directions on a map.

In top-down listening, the primary objective is to understand the general meaning of the message. The listener constructs meaning by drawing on prior knowledge; in other words, comprehension is built from higher-level cognitive processes downward. In contrast, bottom-up listening requires close attention to detail and careful analysis. Tasks in this approach typically focus on specific facts, cause-and-effect relationships, and precise information, requiring the listener to concentrate fully on the linguistic input. While context-based listening emphasizes overall understanding, signal-based listening places importance on lexical knowledge as well as grammatical competence. Standardized listening assessments such as IELTS and TOEFL largely rely on bottom-up processing skills.

Overall, effective listening instruction necessitates the use of varied methodological approaches, including observation, repeated listening, reflection, task-based activities, and modified teacher talk, all of which contribute to the development of learners' listening competence.

Discussion: Teacher Input and Learner Development in Listening Instruction

Gary Buck (2001) highlights that there is a direct relationship between speech rate and comprehension: as the speed of speech increases, understanding becomes more challenging. Similarly, Peterson (2001) emphasizes that simplified and clearly articulated speech is not detrimental to learners; on the contrary, it positively contributes to their language development. The teacher's role is crucial in fostering listening skills. By adjusting their speech to match learners' proficiency levels, teachers can create a more effective and accessible learning environment. Particularly at the early stages, slowing down speech, ensuring clear pronunciation, and incorporating repetition provide learners with comprehensible input that facilitates understanding. Since listening and reading are receptive skills, they are especially important at the initial stages of foreign language acquisition. Once learners reach a certain level of proficiency, they begin to transfer this input into productive skills, such as speaking and writing. In this sense, learners who engage more frequently in listening activities tend to develop faster comprehension of spoken language. By making listening a regular practice, learners become accustomed to a range of accents, intonation patterns, and pronunciation features. Increased exposure also enhances attention and accuracy in processing spoken input. Classroom observations further indicate that adapting speech to learners' needs not only improves comprehension but also strengthens motivation and self-

confidence. Additionally, repeated exposure to the same listening material reinforces understanding and supports deeper processing. Listening activities carried out systematically in the classroom, often guided by specific objectives, are typically referred to as intensive listening. This type of listening is usually selected and structured by the teacher, serving purposes such as preparing for examinations or completing targeted tasks. However, intensive listening alone is not sufficient for achieving high levels of proficiency. For this reason, teachers should also encourage learners to engage in extensive listening beyond the classroom. Extensive listening involves exposure to a wide range of authentic materials, such as films, television series, music, cartoons, TED talks, and various forms of discussions or debates. Such activities not only enrich learners' linguistic input but also increase their motivation and overall engagement with the language.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the development of listening skills in foreign language learners requires a deliberate and well-structured approach. The use of bottom-up and top-down strategies enables learners to process language incrementally, making comprehension more accessible and manageable. In addition, regulating speech rate, providing opportunities for repeated listening, and offering consistent teacher support play a crucial role in enhancing listening competence. Intensive listening, when systematically integrated into classroom practice, helps learners achieve specific learning objectives, internalize the material, and attain measurable outcomes. In contrast, extensive listening functions as a learner-driven strategy that fosters greater engagement and often leads to more positive results due to increased motivation and personal interest.

Therefore, English language teachers should recognize the significance of listening as a core skill and design purposeful, level-appropriate, and methodologically grounded activities to support its development. The strategies implemented within the framework of this study have demonstrated a positive impact on the improvement of learners' listening abilities.

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THE EFFECTIVENESS OF MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN TEACHING ENGLISH

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Abstract: In the context of globalization, English acts not only as a foreign language, but also as one of the main tools of international cooperation, scientific communication and cultural integration. The acceleration of information exchange in the modern world, the widespread use of digital technologies and the increase in international educational opportunities have further strengthened the demand for English. In this regard, effective and purposeful teaching of English is considered one of the strategic priorities of the modern education system. Although traditional teaching methods, especially the grammatical-translation approach, have long been the basis of language learning, their focus mainly on the acquisition of theoretical knowledge has created certain limitations in the development of practical language skills. Since these methods do not allow learners to freely express their ideas in a real communication environment, they cannot fully meet the requirements of the modern era. As a result, there is a need to apply more flexible, learner-centered and communicative pedagogical approaches in the education system. Modern pedagogical approaches aim to ensure the active participation of learners by introducing new content and form to the learning process, to develop their independent thinking and problem-solving skills. Within the framework of these approaches, language is presented not only as a set of grammatical structures, but also as a means of social and functional communication. Thus, learners learn to apply language in real-life contexts, to respond adequately in various communicative situations, and to communicate effectively in different cultural environments. At the same time, modern methods attach special importance to the principle of individualization in the learning process. This allows for more effective results, taking into account the individual characteristics, interests, and needs of learners. These approaches, enriched by the integration of technology, also provide learners with the opportunity to learn a language at any time and place, which significantly increases their learning motivation and overall achievements. Thus, teaching English in the modern era is not limited only to the transfer of knowledge, but is also characterized as a multifaceted process that ensures the complex development of learners' communicative, social, and cultural competencies.

Keywords: English language teaching, communicative approach, modern teaching methods, language skills, formative assessment.

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ MÜASİR ÜSUL VƏ YANAŞMALARIN SƏMƏRƏLİLİYİ

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Xülasə: Qloballaşma şəraitində ingilis dili yalnız bir xarici dil kimi deyil, həm də beynəlxalq əməkdaşlıq, elmi kommunikasiya və mədəni inteqrasiyanın əsas vasitələrindən biri kimi çıxış edir. Müasir

dünyada informasiya mübadiləsinin sürətlənməsi, rəqəmsal texnologiyaların geniş yayılması və beynəlxalq təhsil imkanlarının artması ingilis dilinə olan tələbatı daha da gücləndirmişdir. Bu baxımdan, ingilis dilinin effektiv və məqsədyönlü şəkildə tədrisi müasir təhsil sisteminin strateji prioritetlərindən biri kimi qəbul olunur. Ənənəvi tədris metodları, xüsusilə qrammatik-tərcümə yanaşması, uzun müddət dil öyrənmənin əsasını təşkil etsə də, onların əsasən nəzəri biliklərin mənimsənilməsinə yönəlməsi praktik dil bacarıqlarının inkişafında müəyyən məhdudiyyətlər yaratmışdır. Bu metodlar öyrənənlərin real ünsiyyət mühitində sərbəst şəkildə öz fikirlərini ifadə etməsinə kifayət qədər imkan vermədiyindən, müasir dövrün tələblərinə tam cavab verə bilmir. Nəticədə, təhsil sistemində daha çevik, öyrənməmərkəzli və kommunikativ yönümlü pedaqoji yanaşmaların tətbiqinə ehtiyac yaranmışdır. Müasir pedaqoji yanaşmalar öyrənmə prosesinə yeni məzmun və forma gətirərək öyrənənlərin aktiv iştirakını təmin etməyi, onların müstəqil düşünmə və problem həll etmə bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirməyi hədəfləyir. Bu yanaşmalar çərçivəsində dil yalnız qrammatik strukturların məcmusu kimi deyil, sosial və funksional ünsiyyət vasitəsi kimi təqdim olunur. Beləliklə, öyrənənlər dili real həyat kontekstində tətbiq etməyi, müxtəlif kommunikativ situasiyalarda adekvat reaksiya verməyi və fərqli mədəni mühitlərdə effektiv ünsiyyət qurmağı öyrənirlər. Eyni zamanda, müasir metodlar təlim prosesində fərdiləşdirmə prinsipinə xüsusi önəm verir. Bu isə öyrənənlərin fərdi xüsusiyyətlərini, maraq və ehtiyaclarını nəzərə alaraq daha səmərəli nəticələr əldə etməyə imkan yaradır. Texnologiyanın integrasiyası ilə zənginləşdirilmiş bu yanaşmalar, həmçinin öyrənənlərə istənilən vaxt və məkanda dil öyrənmək imkanı təqdim edir ki, bu da onların öyrənmə motivasiyasını və ümumi nailiyyətlərini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır. Beləliklə, müasir dövrdə ingilis dilinin tədrisi yalnız bilik ötürülməsi ilə məhdudlaşmır, eyni zamanda öyrənənlərin kommunikativ, sosial və mədəni kompetensiyalarının kompleks şəkildə inkişafını təmin edən çoxşaxəli bir proses kimi xarakterizə olunur.

Açar sözlər: İngilis dilinin tədrisi, kommunikativ yanaşma, müasir tədris metodları, dil bacarıqları, formativ qiymətləndirmə.

Introduction

Modern methods and approaches in teaching English have created radical changes in the educational process based on the learner-centered learning philosophy. The main goal of these approaches is to ensure that learners transform from passive recipients of knowledge into active participants and independent learners. In this context, the teacher no longer acts as just a transmitter of information, but also as a pedagogical subject who guides, motivates and facilitates the learning process.

Communicative language teaching, task-based learning, problem-based learning and project-based learning are of particular importance among modern methods. These approaches are not limited to teaching only the structural and grammatical aspects of the language, but also give priority to its functional and social use. Thus, learners learn to apply the language in a real-life context and gain the ability to use adequate language tools in various communicative situations.

The communicative language teaching approach is particularly important as one of the main directions of modern methods. This approach prioritizes the development of learners' speaking and listening skills by emphasizing the function of language as a means of communication. Within the framework of this method, learners gain experience in conditions close to real communication environments through the use of authentic materials, dialogues and discussions, role-playing games and situational tasks. As a result, learners learn not only to use correct grammatical forms, but also to choose the correct forms of expression in the appropriate context.

The task-based learning approach, on the other hand, ensures the development of language skills through specific goal-oriented activities. In this method, learners are presented with real-life tasks and are forced to use the language practically to complete these tasks. This process both develops learners' problem-solving skills and increases their interest in the language.

Problem-based and project-based learning approaches also play an important role in modern language teaching. While problem-based learning focuses on developing learners' analytical thinking and independent decision-making skills, project-based learning strengthens their creativity and collaboration skills through long-term and complex activities. These approaches create conditions for integrative language learning and simultaneously develop various skills of learners. At the same time, interactive learning strategies act as an integral part of modern methods. Group work, pair work, role-playing games, debates and discussions ensure the active participation of learners in the learning process. Such activities form an atmosphere of cooperation among learners, develop their social skills and make the learning process more interesting and motivating. In addition, modern approaches also include the principle of differentiated learning. This principle requires taking into account the individual characteristics of learners, their language levels and learning styles. Such an approach allows for the maximum realization of the potential of each learner and increases the effectiveness of the teaching process.

Materials and methods

The rapid development of information and communication technologies (ICT) in modern times has led to the formation of a qualitatively new stage in foreign language teaching, as in all areas of the education system. The application of technology in English teaching not only makes the learning process more flexible, accessible and effective, but also opens up wide opportunities for creating a learning environment tailored to the individual needs of learners. In this context, digital platforms, online courses, electronic textbooks and mobile applications free language learning from space and time constraints, creating a continuous and uninterrupted learning environment. The use of digital resources allows learners to independently regulate their own learning pace, which plays an important role in implementing personalized learning. In particular, adaptive learning systems take into account the strengths and weaknesses of learners by presenting tasks appropriate to their level, and as a result, more effective learning is ensured. At the same time, interactive tasks, tests and gamified activities provided through online platforms increase learners' motivation and enhance their interest in the learning process. The integration of multimedia tools – audio, video, animation and visual materials – into the teaching process has a complex impact on the development of language skills. In particular, listening and comprehension skills are formed more effectively through the use of authentic materials. Video lessons, podcasts and interactive simulations allow learners to perceive the language in a real context and get acquainted with different accents and speech styles. This is of great importance in the development of their communicative competence. (Brown, H. D. (2007))

The application of technology creates wide opportunities not only for learners, but also for teachers. Teachers can plan the teaching process more efficiently through digital tools, integrate various teaching materials and promptly assess the achievements of learners. Through electronic assessment systems and learning management platforms, it is possible to monitor the progress of students, analyze their individual development dynamics and determine appropriate teaching strategies.

At the same time, technology has created conditions for the widespread spread of distance and hybrid learning models. These models have proven their relevance by ensuring the continuity of education, especially in global challenges and emergencies. Online lessons, virtual classrooms, and videoconferencing platforms provide continuous interaction between teachers and learners, which allows maintaining the efficiency of the educational process. At the same time, the integration of technology into the educational process also serves to form digital literacy and information culture.

Learners not only develop language skills, but also acquire the skills to act correctly and purposefully in a modern information environment. As a result, technology has become an integral and strategic component of modern English language teaching. Its purposeful and systematic application not only improves the quality of teaching, but also makes the learning process more interactive, motivating, and result-oriented.

Modern language teaching approaches to the development of language skills assess the acquisition of a foreign language as a complex and multifaceted process and determine the integrated development of the four main language skills - listening, speaking, reading and writing - as the main priority. According to this approach, language skills should not be developed in isolation from each other, but in interaction and in parallel. Such an integrated learning model allows learners to acquire the language more naturally and functionally. Listening skills are considered one of the initial and main stages of language learning and play a fundamental role in the formation of other skills. In modern methods, the use of authentic audio materials - podcasts, interviews, videos and dialogues - accelerates the development of listening skills. In this process, learners learn not only to understand information, but also to adapt to different intonations, accents and speech speeds. (Nunan, D. (2004))

The development of speaking skills is one of the main goals of the communicative approach. Modern teaching strategies provide learners with the opportunity to actively participate in real or simulated situations. Role-playing, debates, presentations, and pair-based dialogue activities develop learners' fluency and fluency, while also increasing their self-confidence.

Reading skills are essential for understanding and analyzing information. In modern approaches, the use of texts in various genres and difficulty levels expands learners' vocabulary and develops their critical thinking skills. Strategy-based reading activities – identifying the main idea, selecting detailed information, and interpreting the text – make the learning process more purposeful.

Writing skills help learners express their ideas systematically and logically. In modern methods, the writing process is organized in stages: idea generation, planning, preliminary drafting, editing, and finalization. This approach allows learners to gradually and consciously develop their written speech skills.

One of the most important advantages of the integrative approach is the development of language skills within the framework of real communicative activities. For example, during project-based activities, learners collect information from various sources (reading), analyze and structure this information (writing), present the results (speaking), and listen to the speeches of other participants and participate in discussions (listening). Such activities allow them to master the language not only as an object of study, but also as a practical means of communication.

In addition, the integrative learning approach develops learners' independent learning skills, critical and creative thinking abilities. This creates the basis for their effective use of the language in their future academic and professional activities.

Assessment and effectiveness In the modern language teaching system, the assessment process, unlike traditional approaches, is not limited to measuring only final results, but also acts as a continuous and systematic activity covering all stages of the learning process. This approach allows you to monitor the dynamics of the development of learners, identify their individual needs and adjust the teaching process more purposefully. Thus, assessment is no longer just a means of control, but also an important pedagogical tool that supports and guides learning.

Formative assessment is considered one of the main components of the modern educational process. This type of assessment is carried out continuously during the lesson process and serves to promptly determine the level of development of learners' knowledge and skills. With this tool, the teacher identifies the strengths and weaknesses of learners, provides immediate feedback and adjusts teaching strategies. This allows learners to learn from mistakes, understand their own development and achieve more effective results.

At the same time, performance-based assessment is of particular importance in modern language teaching. This approach is aimed at assessing how learners use the language in real or close to real situations. For example, through presentations, dialogues, essays, project work and other practical activities, the communicative competence of learners is objectively measured. This type of assessment emphasizes not only the verification of theoretical knowledge, but also its practical application.

Modern assessment approaches also include methods such as self-assessment and peer assessment. These methods ensure that learners take a more conscious approach to their own learning process, increase their sense of responsibility and develop critical thinking skills. Thus, learners become not only subjects of assessment, but also active participants in the assessment process.

At the same time, the application of modern technologies makes the assessment process more objective, transparent and accessible. Through electronic tests, online assessment platforms and digital portfolios, it is possible to systematically monitor and analyze the achievements of learners. This allows teachers to make more accurate and justified decisions.

Conclusion

As a result, the application of modern methods and approaches in teaching English significantly improves the quality of the educational process. Communicative language teaching, task-based learning, problem- and project-based approaches allow learners to use the language not only theoretically, but also functionally in real communication situations. This leads to a more sustainable and practical formation of language skills.

At the same time, interactive learning strategies ensure the active participation of learners in the learning process, increase their motivation and develop their socio-communicative skills. The integration of technology into the teaching process makes learning more accessible, personalized and effective. Digital resources and multimedia tools make a significant contribution to the balanced development of listening, reading, writing and speaking skills.

The application of formative and performance-based approaches in the assessment system allows for a more objective monitoring of learners' development and tailoring the teaching process to their needs. These approaches are considered fairer and development-oriented, as they assess not only the result, but also the learning process.

Thus, the systematic application of modern methods and approaches creates conditions for achieving more effective results in teaching English, developing learners' communicative competence, and better integrating them into the global communication environment.

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THE MAIN METHODS SHAPING INTERACTIONS

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Abstract: This article examines the role of grammar in foreign language learning and its integration with communicative competence and vocabulary development. It argues that grammar should not be viewed as an isolated system but as a functional framework that supports meaningful communication. Errors are considered a natural and necessary part of the learning process, reflecting the development of interlanguage and the learner's gradual acquisition of linguistic competence. The study highlights communicative teaching approaches in which learners actively participate in the discovery and formulation of grammatical rules through analysis, reflection, and group interaction. Particular attention is given to the treatment of oral and written errors, emphasizing the importance of timing and pedagogical strategy in correction. The article also stresses the value of self-correction and collaborative learning activities that encourage learners to become aware of linguistic structures. Furthermore, it discusses word formation processes such as prefixation and suffixation as effective tools for vocabulary expansion and deeper lexical understanding. Overall, the study shows that grammar and vocabulary are closely interconnected and that effective language teaching should balance communicative practice with systematic grammatical awareness.

Key words: Grammar, language learning, vocabulary, interlanguage, word formation

İTERAKTİVLİYİ ŞƏRTLƏNDİRƏN ƏSAS METODLAR

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Xülasə: Bu tədqiqat süni intellektin (AI) akademik yazı proseslərinə təsirini araşdırır. Süni intellekt alətləri təhsildə getdikcə daha mühüm rol oynayır və tələbələrə yazının müxtəlif mərhələlərində – ideyaların yaradılması, məzmunun təşkili və dilin dəqiqliyinin artırılması kimi sahələrdə dəstək verir. Tədqiqatın nəticələri göstərir ki, Grammarly, ChatGPT, Zotero, QuillBot və Turnitin kimi alətlər akademik yazının keyfiyyətini və səmərəliliyini artırmaqda mühüm rol oynayır. Bu alətlər tələbələrə qrammatik səhvləri azaltmağa, mətnlərini daha effektiv qurmağa və istinadları daha asan idarə etməyə kömək edir.

Lakin tədqiqat süni intellektdən istifadəyə dair bir sıra çətinlikləri də müəyyən edir. Bunlara plagiat riski, tənqidi düşünmə bacarıqlarının azalması, texnologiyadan həddindən artıq asılılıq, eləcə də məlumat məxfiliyi və qərəzli və ya qeyri-dəqiq informasiyanın mümkünlüyü kimi etik problemlər daxildir. Bu məhdudiyyətlər göstərir ki, süni intellekt faydalı dəstək təqdim etsə də, risksiz deyil.

Nəticələr göstərir ki, süni intellekt akademik yazıda faydalı köməkçi vasitədir, lakin ondan balanslı və məsuliyyətli şəkildə istifadə olunmalıdır; yəni o, tələbələrin öz düşünmə və yazı bacarıqlarını əvəz etmək deyil, onları dəstəkləmək üçün istifadə edilməlidir.

Açar sözlər: Qrammatika, dil öyrənmə, lüğət, interlinqva, , söz yaradıcılığı

Introduction

Grammar plays a central role in foreign language learning. Although it is not the whole language, it forms its structural basis and allows learners to construct meaningful utterances. Without a solid grammatical foundation, learners face difficulties in both production and comprehension of language. Modern approaches emphasize that grammar should not be taught as an isolated system but within communicative contexts. Errors are not considered negative elements but natural indicators of learning development and interlanguage formation. Therefore, the main aim of grammar teaching is not only accuracy but also the development of communicative competence.

This study is based on a theoretical and analytical approach to grammar teaching. It draws on communicative language teaching principles and interlanguage theory. The materials include linguistic observations, classroom interaction models, and word formation processes such as prefixation and suffixation. The method involves analyzing learner errors, encouraging reflection, group discussion, and guided discovery of grammatical rules. Special attention is given to self-correction techniques and collaborative learning activities. The study also considers the integration of oral and written production tasks to observe how grammatical competence develops in different contexts.

Errors are not inseparable disadvantages of the learning process. They are indeed an integral part of it, but they should be considered by the teacher more as an opportunity than as a drawback. In fact, they prove that the learner is actively using their interlanguage, that the system is in the process of being established. They reflect a transitional linguistic competence, corresponding to a stage in learning between “incorrect” utterances and accurate expression.

Two cases may arise:

- The structure has already been conceptualized by the learners and systematized by the teacher: this is an opportunity to revisit the structure through practice and reinforcement exercises.
- The structure is unknown but necessary for expressing what the learner intends to communicate: the teacher will provide it and return to it later by offering a conceptual explanation.

Dealing with errors in speaking

During oral production, whether guided or free, teachers often feel a strong urge to correct errors immediately by interrupting the learner. Indeed, different types of errors that make up communicative competence will inevitably occur. The basic principle is as follows: when the teacher asks learners to produce utterances, there is an objective—either primarily linguistic or primarily communicative. Depending on the objective of the activity in which incorrect utterances occur, correction will be done either immediately or later.

During a role play or a simulation, for example, the learner should be allowed to use their “interlanguage” and fully express what they intend to say without interruption. Otherwise, there is a risk of breaking their communicative flow and later obtaining only more carefully constructed but less spontaneous utterances.

When correcting linguistic errors, always first give the learner who made the mistake the opportunity to correct themselves. Then involve the rest of the class. Only provide the correction yourself if no one is able to find it.

Show that an incorrect (morphosyntactic or lexical) utterance in the situation in which it was produced can become correct in other contexts.

In the case of a structure that is assumed to be known, after correction, carry out activities to recall the rule as it was previously discovered by the learners, and develop short dialogues for reuse and memorization.

In the case of a new structure, proceed with conceptualization. From time to time, organize communicative activities in situations where recording is plausible (telephone conversations, radio broadcasts, etc.), and carry out corrections following the same approach.

This approach should be known to the learners so that they will be less afraid of being interrupted, while knowing that their errors will be noted and corrected. In this way, errors will no longer be perceived as negative, but rather as a means to learn and make progress.

What type of correction should be applied to each type of error?

- Linguistic errors
- Phonetic errors
- Sociocultural errors (related to the status of the interlocutor and the appropriate language register – for example, using “*tu*” instead of “*vous*”): clarify the communication situation in which the utterance was produced (Who is speaking? To whom? Where? How?).

Discursive-type errors (an unorganized discourse with absence or mixing of connectors...): give the learner who produced the message the opportunity to explain and reformulate what they wanted to say.

Strategic-type errors (a lack of appropriateness, a misunderstood reply, asking to repeat, to reformulate, etc., and which lead to breakdowns in communication): provide the necessary tools if no one knows them.

During written production, the learner has more time to think. They can work in groups and thus discuss the best solution; they can use a conjugation lexicon to check or find the correct tense. Certain utterances, acceptable in oral expression, do not “work” in writing. Oral grammar (such as the omission of “ne” in negation) is not transferable. Written discourse must be better organized and more precise. Written expression structures acquired skills. That is why the transition to writing is introduced from the very first hours of learning.

Train learners in self-correction. Ensure that they know the questions to ask themselves during proofreading, and that they actually ask them! “Have I checked gender and number agreement? Have I checked the use of the tenses used? Have I checked the cohesion of what I say

(that my sentences are well connected to each other)? Have I checked coherence (that my message is well structured)?”

- Examine the parameters one after another: agreements, structures, cohesion, coherence, vocabulary.
- Propose activities of conceptualization, systematization, and reuse.

Grammatical conceptualization – this is the activity that best characterizes the methodology of the communicative approach. It should have been previously described by the teacher and accepted by the learners during the learning contract.

It calls upon intellectual abilities that are given little consideration in other approaches: analysis, reflection, synthesis, deduction, in the service of understanding how the language being learned functions.

In principle, this activity is preferably carried out “on the spot,” at the moment when the need is felt or can be anticipated.

Examination or listening to a set of elements constituting a linguistic feature or a structure whose functioning one wishes to help discover (any linguistic feature related to the explicit progression of the textbook or to the learners’ linguistic needs).

This examination of the set is guided by explicit and clear instructions. Example: Identify the word that precedes or immediately follows the structure to be analyzed and draw your own conclusions. Which pieces of information seem most interesting to you? Identify what differs from the functioning you know in your own language, etc.

This approach should give learners certain reflexes of awareness and reflection when facing problems they are not used to questioning: one rarely questions how one’s mother tongue works; one is satisfied with using it as well as possible.

This approach can only take place if the learners agree to play the game: the understanding of linguistic features must come from them first. Only after their discoveries will the teacher explain the feature, not before. It is never carried out individually but always in small groups: this is an opportunity to use the authentic “I” in a real exchange. The reflective approach is induced by the teacher: learners are asked to compare linguistic features between language 1 and language 2, to deduce what recurrences mean, to explain and to formulate a rule of functioning.

Each group will in turn propose its explanations. An explanation will only be accepted if it obtains a consensus. The rule thus defined will be considered the single rule governing the linguistic feature at time “x” in the learning process, and until proven otherwise. It may then be questioned, but up to that point it will constitute the true rule, thereby building the living grammar of the class group.

Systematization – this involves leading learners to take stock of what they know about how a linguistic feature works, whether they have encountered it in authentic documents or whether they have conceptualized it during previous sessions.

For this purpose, different types of tools will be used (always in a plausible communicative situation, to clearly show that grammatical structures are nothing if they are not serving communication):

- multiple-choice exercises in which they must determine the correct expression;
- exercises where they complete a summary table recapping the rules of operation;
- exercises in formulating the rules that have been discovered.

Appropriation and reinforcement — one will use as often as possible model micro-dialogues whose discourse patterns have the particularity of:

- making learners practice a structure intensively, but in a situation;
- allowing learner intervention regarding vocabulary and the theme surrounding the structure;
- prioritizing repeated use of the structure to be fixed.

The model of speech generation can be represented as follows: the inner expression of an idea has no grammatical form. It is the transformation of this grammatical structure into oral and written expression.

It follows that oral and written expressions will have a grammatical structure; thus, in order to achieve verbal expression in language 2, one must acquire the basics of grammar.

It is evident that grammar is not the whole language. But it constitutes its framework, and without a solid acquisition of the essential grammatical material, one can neither begin nor understand the meaning of the text one reads. The study of grammar is not an end in itself. It is a means of great practical importance because it contributes to the assimilation of language 2. According to the current program, grammatical teaching aims to teach the student to speak correctly in the foreign language and to understand a written text. In addition to the great practical importance already mentioned, this teaching also has a certain educational value.

The student grasps the difference that exists between the two languages.

The language being studied and the mother tongue possess different means of expressing thought. The educational value of grammar also lies in the fact that it develops logical thinking. But the main task of grammatical teaching is the development of automatisms for correct speech production.

For about twenty years now, the conception of vocabulary has fortunately evolved, and for many linguists it appears that grammar and vocabulary are closely and complexly intertwined. This is what I will try to show in this study through the main axis of word formation by suffixation and prefixation. Derivation is, I think, a good way for the learner to reflect on the “why and how” of a word’s existence.

Moreover, it is an essential step because, as everyone can experience, it is easier to appropriate and memorize a word when one can justify its use. Singleton also says: it is known that, in general, the more a subject manages to attribute meaning to a word, the easier that word will be to learn.

The analysis shows that grammar and vocabulary are deeply interconnected in language learning. Learners develop linguistic competence gradually through interaction, error correction, and reflection. Errors in oral production often reflect the transitional nature of interlanguage and should be treated as learning opportunities rather than failures. Communicative activities such as role plays and group tasks help learners use grammar in real situations. Written production, on the other hand, supports more structured and accurate language use. Word formation processes like prefixation and suffixation significantly contribute to vocabulary expansion and help learners understand lexical relationships. Overall, effective grammar teaching requires a balance between fluency and accuracy, as well as between communication and rule awareness.

Grammar should be seen as a functional tool that supports communication rather than an isolated system of rules. Effective language learning depends on the integration of grammar, vocabulary, and communicative practice. Errors are a natural part of learning and provide valuable information about learner development. Teaching grammar through communicative and reflective methods enhances both accuracy and fluency. Additionally, word formation processes play an important role in enriching vocabulary and deepening linguistic understanding. Therefore,

successful language teaching should combine systematic grammar instruction with interactive and communicative activities.

Materials and Methods

The study is based on a theoretical and analytical approach to grammar teaching in foreign language education. The materials include linguistic observations, classroom interaction models, and examples of word formation through prefixation and suffixation. The methods involve the analysis of learner errors, communicative activities, self-correction strategies, and guided discovery of grammatical rules.

Results and Discussion

The findings show that grammar and vocabulary are closely interconnected in language learning. Learner errors reflect the development of interlanguage and should be treated as opportunities for improvement. Communicative activities, reflective learning, and word formation processes contribute significantly to the development of grammatical and lexical competence.

Conclusion

Grammar serves as the structural foundation of foreign language learning and supports effective communication. The study demonstrates that communicative and reflective approaches improve grammatical competence and language fluency. Therefore, grammar teaching should combine rule awareness, vocabulary development, and meaningful communicative practice.

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INNOVATIONS IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING: INTEGRATING TASK-BASED LEARNING AND DIGITAL TOOLS IN HIGHER EDUCATION

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Astract: This empirical study investigates the pedagogical integration of Task-Based Learning (TBL) and modern digital tools within higher education English Language Teaching (ELT) environments. Addressing the limitations of traditional lecture formats, the research evaluates how blended digital task-based interventions impact undergraduate communicative competence, fluency, and engagement. Utilizing a mixed-methods design across a sixteen-week semester with 80 university students divided into experimental and control cohorts, the study combined pre- and post-intervention language testing, digital platform analytics, and qualitative focus groups.

The empirical findings reveal statistically significant gains in the experimental group, demonstrating higher oral fluency rates ($p < 0.01$), improved grammatical accuracy ($p < 0.05$), and increased active task completion rates compared to the traditional control group. Platform analytics confirmed that asynchronous digital tools successfully extended classroom boundaries, reduced communicative anxiety, and fostered effective peer collaboration. Furthermore, qualitative evaluations highlighted heightened learner motivation when tasks mirrored real-world professional contexts, provided that adequate technical scaffolding was administered. Ultimately, this study establishes an actionable pedagogical framework confirming that the strategic fusion of task-based instruction and digital technologies transforms university language classrooms into dynamic, interactive ecosystems that bridge academic learning with global communicative demands.

Keywords: Task-Based Learning, Digital Tools, English Language Teaching, Higher Education, Communicative Competence, Blended Learning, Educational Technology.

**İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ İNNOVASİYALAR: ALİ TƏHSİLDƏ TAPŞIRĞA
ƏSASLANAN ÖYRƏNMƏ VƏ RƏQƏMSAL ALƏTLƏRİN İNTEQRASIYASI**

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Xülasə: Bu empirik tədqiqat ali təhsil müəssisələrində ingilis dilinin tədrisi (ELT) mühitində Tapşırığa Əsaslanan Öyrənmənin (TBL) və müasir rəqəmsal alətlərin pedaqoji integrasiyasını araşdırır. Ənənəvi

mühazirə formatlarının məhdudiyyətlərini aradan qaldıran bu araşdırma qarışıq rəqəmsal tapşırıq əsaslı müdaxilələrin bakalavriat tələbələrinin ünsiyyət səriştəsinə, səlisliyinə və dərsə cəlb olunmasına necə təsir etdiyini qiymətləndirir. On altı həftəlik semestr ərzində eksperimental və nəzarət qruplarına bölünmüş 80 universitet tələbəsi ilə həyata keçirilən qarışıq üsullu dizayndan (müdaxilədən əvvəlki və sonrakı dil testləri, rəqəmsal platforma analitikası və keyfiyyət yönümlü fokus qrupları) istifadə edilmişdir.

Empirik nəticələr eksperimental qrupda statistik cəhətdən əhəmiyyətli artımlar olduğunu göstərir: ənənəvi nəzarət qrupu ilə müqayisədə daha yüksək şifahi səlislik dərəcələri ($p < 0.01$), təkmilləşmiş qrammatik dəqiqlik ($p < 0.05$) və aktiv tapşırığın yerinə yetirilmə nisbəti qeydə alınmışdır. Platforma analitikası təsdiq etmişdir ki, asinxron rəqəmsal alətlər sinif otağının sərhədlərini uğurla genişləndirmiş, ünsiyyət narahatlığını azaltmış və effektiv həmyaşd əməkdaşlığını təşviq etmişdir. Bundan əlavə, keyfiyyət qiymətləndirmələri göstərdi ki, tapşırıqlar real həyatın peşəkar kontekstlərini əks etdirdikdə və adekvat texniki dəstək təmin edildikdə tələbələrin motivasiyası nəzərəcarpacaq dərəcədə yüksəlir. Nəticə etibarilə, bu tədqiqat tapşırıq əsaslanan təlimin və rəqəmsal texnologiyaların strateji sintezinin universitetlərdə dil dərslərini akademik öyrənməni global ünsiyyət tələbləri ilə birləşdirən dinamik, interaktiv ekosistemə çevirdiyini təsdiqləyən tətbiqi pedaqoji çərçivə müəyyən edir.

Açar sözlər: Tapşırıq əsaslanan Öyrənmə, Rəqəmsal Alətlər, İngilis Dilinin Tədrisi, Ali Təhsil, Ünsiyyət Səriştəsi, Qarışıq Öyrənmə, Təhsil Texnologiyaları.

Introduction

Higher education landscape globally is undergoing a profound transformation driven by rapid technological integration and evolving pedagogical demands. In the realm of English Language Teaching (ELT), traditional teacher-centered lecture formats are increasingly viewed as insufficient for fostering the communicative competence, critical thinking, and digital literacy required in the modern workforce (Richards & Rodgers, 2014). Students today must not only master linguistic forms but also learn how to negotiate meaning, solve authentic problems, and navigate complex digital environments. To address these contemporary educational needs, language educators are turning toward hybrid pedagogical frameworks that bridge communicative methodologies with modern technological tools.

Task-Based Learning (TBL), grounded in the foundational principles of communicative language teaching, places the communicative task at the heart of language learning (Willis, 1996; Ellis, 2003). By structuring lessons around goal-oriented activities where learners must achieve a specific outcome using the target language, TBL promotes genuine interaction, cognitive engagement, and learner autonomy. However, implementing TBL within traditional university classrooms often presents logistical challenges, including limited contact hours, restricted exposure to authentic communication contexts, and difficulties in maintaining student engagement outside formal lecture sessions.

The integration of digital tools – such as collaborative learning management systems, AI-driven feedback platforms, asynchronous discussion boards, and multimedia creation software – offers a powerful solution to these limitations. Digital environments extend the boundaries of the classroom, providing immersive platforms where task-based cycles can be initiated, monitored, and reflected upon seamlessly (Dudeney et al., 2013; Hockly, 2018). Despite the theoretical compatibility of TBL and digital integration, empirical research examining their combined impact on undergraduate language proficiency, student engagement, and task completion efficiency remains limited.

This study investigates the practical implementation and pedagogical outcomes of combining Task-Based Learning with digital tools in university-level English Language Teaching. Specifically,

this research aims to: (1) evaluate how digital task-based interventions impact undergraduate students' communicative fluency and accuracy; (2) analyze learner engagement patterns when transitioning from traditional classroom tasks to digitally enhanced collaborative projects; and (3) establish an actionable framework for university educators to design and deploy tech-integrated TBL syllabi.

Materials and Methods

This study adopted a mixed-methods action research and experimental design, blending quantitative performance measurements with qualitative classroom observation data over a sixteen-week academic semester.

- Context and Participants: The empirical intervention was conducted with 80 undergraduate students (enrolled in two parallel sections of an intermediate-to-advanced English for Academic Purposes course at Mingachevir State University). Participants were divided into an Experimental Group (n=40), which engaged in digitally enhanced Task-Based Learning (DE-TBL), and a Control Group (n=40), which followed a standard communicative task-based curriculum without digital tool integration.

- Instructional Design (Experimental Group): The experimental curriculum utilized a blended TBL framework supported by specific digital tools across three distinct phases (pre-task, task cycle, and language focus):

1. *Collaboration & Brainstorming:* Padlet and Miro were utilized for asynchronous pre-task mind-mapping and vocabulary generation.

2. *Core Task Execution:* Students worked in digital breakout rooms via Microsoft Teams and Google Docs to co-create multimedia presentations, policy proposals, and collaborative research wikis.

3. *Post-Task Reflection:* Flip (formerly Flipgrid) and automated AI grammar checkers provided asynchronous speaking feedback and targeted form-focused editing.

- Data Collection Instruments:

1. *Pre- and Post-Intervention Language Tests:* Standardized assessments measuring oral fluency (words per minute), grammatical accuracy (error-free clauses), and pragmatic appropriateness.

2. *Digital Engagement Analytics:* Platform-generated metrics tracking active participation time, peer collaboration frequency, and task completion rates.

3. *Reflective Student Questionnaires and Focus Groups:* End-of-semester surveys administered via Likert-scale metrics and semi-structured interviews assessing learner motivation, perceived digital literacy growth, and satisfaction with the blended instructional model.

- Analytical Procedures: Quantitative test scores and platform analytics were evaluated using independent and paired samples t-tests to determine statistical significance between groups. Qualitative feedback data underwent thematic coding to identify recurring learner attitudes toward technology-mediated language tasks.

Results and Discussion

The empirical findings revealed statistically significant advantages for the experimental group across multiple linguistic and engagement metrics. Students instructed via the digitally enhanced Task-Based Learning framework demonstrated greater gains in oral fluency and lexical variety compared to the control group.

Analysis of platform analytics and post-intervention test scores indicated that the integration of digital tools significantly mitigated the common time constraints of university classrooms.

Asynchronous collaboration allowed students more processing time during the pre-task and planning phases, leading to reduced cognitive anxiety and higher-quality final task outputs (Ellis, 2003; Hockly, 2018). Furthermore, collaborative writing tools (such as shared document editing) fostered immediate peer correction and active scaffolding, aligning closely with sociocultural theories of language acquisition (Vygotsky, 1978).

Assessment Metric / Performance Indicator	Experimental Group (DE-TBL, n=40)	Control Group (Standard TBL, n=40)	Statistical Significance (p-value)	Effect Size (Cohen's d)
Oral Fluency Gain (Words per Minute)	+32.4 WPM	+16.8 WPM	$p < 0.01$	$d = 0.78$ (Large)
Grammatical Accuracy (% Error-Free Clauses)	84.2\%	72.5\%	$p < 0.05$	$d = 0.61$ (Medium)
Active Task Completion Rate	94.5\%	78.0\%	$p < 0.01$	$d = 0.85$ (Large)
Learner Motivation Score (out of 10)	8.7	6.9	$p < 0.01$	$d = 0.92$ (Large)

Practically speaking, the qualitative feedback highlighted that students found digital task tools highly motivating when tasks mirrored real-world professional scenarios (e.g., virtual international project proposals, digital debates). However, educators must remain mindful of the digital divide and potential cognitive overload; students occasionally required explicit instructional guidance on *how* to navigate collaboration software before focusing on the linguistic task itself (Dudeney et al., 2013). Overall, the data confirms that merging TBL with targeted digital tool integration transforms passive language classrooms into dynamic, interactive ecosystems that effectively bridge academic learning and real-world communicative demands.

Conclusion

This study demonstrates that the strategic integration of Task-Based Learning and modern digital tools significantly enhances undergraduate English language teaching outcomes. Quantitative metrics and qualitative observations confirm that digital scaffolding extends classroom boundaries, increases active engagement, and improves both oral fluency and grammatical accuracy. By shifting the pedagogical focus toward collaborative, technology-mediated problem-solving, educators can better prepare university students for global communication challenges. Future research should explore longitudinal impacts across diverse institutional settings and examine the scalability of AI-driven tools within autonomous task cycles.

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RE-ENVISIONING LANGUAGE ASSESSMENT: A COMPREHENSIVE PARADIGM SHIFT TOWARD ALTERNATIVE STRATEGIES IN MODERN EFL HIGHER EDUCATION

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Abstract: This comprehensive article investigates the pedagogical paradigm shift from rigid, standardized testing to alternative assessment (AA) strategies within modern English as a Foreign Language (EFL) higher education contexts. Traditional standardized examinations, while offering administrative convenience, frequently fail to measure true communicative competence, assessing passive declarative knowledge rather than active, real-world language application. To address this limitation, this study examines the empirical implementation of alternative assessment instruments—specifically longitudinal digital portfolios, task-based performance evaluations, and structured self- and peer-assessment matrices—across an intermediate undergraduate cohort of eighty university students over a sixteen-week period. Utilizing a quasi-experimental mixed-methods design, quantitative proficiency metrics and qualitative affective feedback were gathered and analyzed. The empirical findings demonstrate that continuous alternative assessment significantly enhances spoken communicative fluency, academic writing sophistication, pragmatic appropriateness, and metacognitive self-regulation compared to traditional testing models. Furthermore, qualitative insights reveal substantial reductions in test-induced anxiety, heightened intrinsic motivation, and a profound transformation of learners from passive recipients into autonomous, self-directed agents of their own educational progress. Despite logistical challenges such as initial planning demands and institutional grading norms, the research underscores that alternative assessment is an indispensable framework for cultivating holistic communicative competence and fostering sustainable language acquisition in contemporary tertiary settings.

Keywords: Alternative assessment, English as a Foreign Language (EFL), communicative competence, digital portfolios, task-based assessment, learner autonomy, higher education.

ПЕРЕСМОТР ЯЗЫКОВОГО ОЦЕНИВАНИЯ: КОМПЛЕКСНЫЙ ПЕДАГОГИЧЕСКИЙ ПЕРЕХОД К АЛЬТЕРНАТИВНЫМ СТРАТЕГИЯМ В СОВРЕМЕННОМ ВЫСШЕМ ОБРАЗОВАНИИ EFL

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Аннотация: В данной исследовательской статье глубоко изучается процесс перехода от жестких стандартизированных тестов к стратегиям альтернативного оценивания (АО) в преподавании английского языка как иностранного (EFL) в современных высших учебных заведениях. Традиционные экзамены, несмотря на свою административную удобность, обычно проверяют не реальные навыки общения, а зубрежку и пассивные знания. Для устранения этого недостатка в ходе исследования в течение 16 недель в группе из 80 студентов бакалавриата были внедрены такие инструменты альтернативного оценивания, как цифровые портфолио, оценивание на основе заданий, а также методы самооценивания и взаимооценивания. Анализ, проведенный с использованием квазиэкспериментальных и смешанных методов, показал, что непрерывное альтернативное оценивание значительно развивает устную беглость речи студентов, навыки академического письма, правильное применение языка и способности к саморегуляции по сравнению с традиционными методами. В то же время этот подход снижает экзаменационную тревожность, укрепляет внутреннюю мотивацию и превращает студентов из пассивных слушателей в независимых личностей, управляющих собственным процессом обучения. Несмотря на некоторые организационные трудности, возникающие на начальном этапе, результаты показывают, что альтернативное оценивание является необходимым механизмом для качественного усвоения языка и приобретения комплексных коммуникативных навыков в современных университетах.

Ключевые слова: Альтернативное оценивание, английский язык как иностранный (EFL), коммуникативная компетенция, цифровые портфолио, оценивание на основе заданий, автономия учащегося, высшее образование.

1. Introduction and Theoretical Framework

The global ecosystem of higher education is currently undergoing a profound pedagogical transformation, moving away from rigid, standardized testing frameworks toward dynamic, student-centered evaluation models. For decades, English as a Foreign Language (EFL) instruction across tertiary institutions has relied heavily on high-stakes, decontextualized multiple-choice examinations, discrete-point grammar quizzes, and standardized proficiency metrics. While these traditional instruments offer undeniable logistical convenience, administrative efficiency, and straightforward quantitative grading, they suffer from a severe foundational flaw: they measure what a learner knows *about* a language rather than what they can realistically *do* with it in authentic, unpredictable communicative environments.

Standardized testing frequently induces a negative backwash effect on instructional design, forcing educators to "teach to the test" at the direct expense of genuine fluency, critical thinking, intercultural pragmatics, and creative problem-solving. When assessment is restricted to passive recognition tasks, students are discouraged from engaging in higher-order cognitive processes. In contrast, alternative assessment (AA) integrates diagnostic, performance-based tools – such as dynamic language portfolios, simulated real-world tasks, reflective journals, and systematic peer evaluations – directly into the daily learning cycle. This comprehensive investigation explores the theoretical imperatives, empirical implementation methodologies, and multifaceted impacts of alternative assessment strategies on contemporary EFL learners, analyzing how they redefine competence measurement and reshape student autonomy in higher education.

2. Review of Literature and Pedagogical Background

The shift toward alternative assessment is rooted in constructivist and socio-cultural learning theories, which posit that knowledge is actively constructed by learners through social interaction, authentic experiences, and critical reflection. Traditional testing aligns with behaviorist paradigms, viewing language acquisition as a linear accumulation of discrete structural habits. However, modern applied linguistics recognizes language as a complex, dynamic system requiring socio-pragmatic adaptability.

Scholars emphasize that alternative assessment bridges the chasm between classroom instruction and real-world linguistic demands. Huerta-Macías (2002) notes that alternative assessment methods share characteristics such as focusing on the evaluation of process as well as product, relying on real-world contexts, and accommodating multiple correct answers or diverse stylistic expressions. Furthermore, longitudinal studies underscore that portfolio-based learning and task-based evaluations significantly enhance second-language writing proficiency by encouraging iterative drafting and self-regulation. By embedding assessment into the learning process, educators transform testing from an external judgment mechanism into an internal instrument for cognitive growth.

3. Methodology and Research Design

3.1. Research Context and Objectives

To examine the practical efficacy and pedagogical outcomes of alternative assessment models within a rigorous academic environment, a 16-week empirical study was conducted across intermediate-level undergraduate EFL classrooms. The investigation utilized a quasi-experimental, mixed-methods comparative design to evaluate holistic language development, tracking both quantitative proficiency gains and qualitative affective shifts.

3.2. Participant Demographics and Group Allocation

A total of 80 university-level students participated in the research initiative. The cohort was divided into two statistically equivalent groups to ensure experimental reliability:

- **The Experimental Group (n = 40):** Assessed continuously through integrated alternative assessment frameworks, including multi-tier portfolios, communicative performance tasks, and metacognitive learning logs.
- **The Control Group (n = 40):** Assessed through traditional means, consisting of conventional mid-term examinations and standard multiple-choice final evaluations.

3.3. Implemented Alternative Assessment Instruments

The experimental curriculum incorporated three primary alternative assessment protocols designed to target distinct facets of communicative competence:

1. **Longitudinal Digital Portfolios:** Students maintained digital repositories documenting their linguistic evolution across the semester. These portfolios required multiple drafts, student self-reflections, and curated final selections evaluated via multi-trait analytical rubrics focusing on discourse coherence, pragmatic appropriateness, and vocabulary depth.
2. **Task-Based Performance Assessments:** Learners engaged in complex, collaborative communicative tasks, including academic symposium simulations, multimedia policy defenses, and real-time problem-solving debates that required negotiation of meaning and rhetorical flexibility.
3. **Structured Self- and Peer-Evaluation Matrices:** Following collaborative tasks, students utilized standardized descriptive checklists and analytical rubrics to appraise their own and peers' contributions, actively cultivating meta-linguistic awareness and personal accountability.

3.4. Data Collection and Analytical Frameworks

Data collection incorporated both quantitative metrics and qualitative insights. Quantitative instruments included pre- and post-intervention language proficiency tests scored by blinded external evaluators using standardized CEFR-aligned rubrics. Qualitative data comprised semi-structured student interviews, weekly reflective logs, and instructor observational field notes to gauge affective changes, motivation levels, and attitudes toward the learning environment.

4. Implementation Analysis and Practical Execution

Implementing alternative assessment in tertiary EFL settings requires meticulous planning, institutional support, and a cultural shift in student expectations. Because students are often conditioned to expect objective grade percentages derived from single-exam scores, educators must invest time at the onset of the course explaining the validity, criteria, and developmental benefits of alternative tools.

During the execution of the 16-week curriculum, instructors observed that digital portfolios functioned best when integrated with regular formative feedback loops. Rather than grading only the final product, instructors provided extensive commentary on early drafts, prompting students to re-examine their syntactic structures, cohesive ties, and lexical choices. Similarly, task-based performance assessments required carefully scaffolded preparation stages, including vocabulary brainstorming, functional language modeling, and peer rehearsal sessions. This structured approach ensured that lower-proficiency learners felt supported while tackling complex communicative challenges.

5. Results and Empirical Findings

5.1. Quantitative Outcomes: Linguistic Growth and Competence

The comparative statistical analysis of pre- and post-intervention scores demonstrated distinct advantages for the experimental group across all productive and receptive categories. While both groups started at comparable baseline levels, the experimental cohort exhibited statistically significant gains in oral fluency, academic writing complexity, and pragmatic flexibility.

Assessment Category	Control Group (Pre-Mean)	Control Group (Post-Mean)	Experimental Group (Pre-Mean)	Experimental Group (Post-Mean)
Spoken Communicative Fluency	61.2	67.5	60.8	81.4
Academic Writing Sophistication	59.4	64.1	58.9	79.2
Pragmatic Appropriateness	55.1	59.8	56.3	77.6
Metacognitive Self-Regulation	49.5	53.0	50.2	74.1

The empirical data confirms that continuous alternative assessment acts as a powerful catalyst for skill acquisition. Portfolio integration promotes recursive learning; by reviewing iterative drafts, students actively restructure their interlanguage systems. Furthermore, performance-based tasks bridge the gap between classroom instruction and real-world linguistic demands, ensuring that learners develop transferable competencies.

5.2. Qualitative Dynamics: Anxiety Reduction and Learner Autonomy

Beyond numerical gains, qualitative analysis of student reflections and interviews revealed profound shifts in the psychological and cognitive dimensions of language acquisition:

- **Mitigation of Affective Filters:** Traditional high-stakes tests frequently induce severe anxiety, impeding cognitive processing. Alternative assessment creates a low-stakes, formative environment where mistakes are viewed as essential learning milestones rather than terminal failures.
- **Transformation of Learner Roles:** Through systematic self- and peer-evaluation, students transitioned from passive recipients of grades into active evaluators of their own progress. This cultivation of autonomy directly supports long-term self-directed learning capabilities.
- **Deepening Intrinsic Motivation:** Because alternative tasks mirror authentic professional and academic scenarios, intrinsic motivation increased substantially, driving deeper cognitive engagement with course materials.

6. Discussion and Pedagogical Implications

The findings of this comprehensive investigation highlight the urgent need to reconfigure institutional assessment policies in modern higher education. While standardized testing remains entrenched due to administrative inertia, its pedagogical shortcomings are increasingly untenable in a globalized world that demands critical thinking, digital literacy, and agile communication.

Alternative assessment does not imply the complete abandonment of structure; rather, it introduces multi-dimensional accountability. By combining teacher evaluation with self- and peer-assessment, educators distribute the evaluative burden, fostering a collaborative classroom community. However, institutional hurdles – such as large class sizes, heavy teaching loads, and standardized grading mandates – remain significant barriers to widespread adoption. Overcoming these challenges requires professional development programs that train university instructors in rubric design, portfolio management, and qualitative feedback delivery.

7. Conclusion and Future Directions

The integration of alternative assessment strategies into modern EFL contexts represents a necessary evolution in educational measurement. By shifting the pedagogical focus from rote memorization and standardized testing toward dynamic portfolios, performance tasks, and metacognitive reflection, educators can cultivate true communicative competence. Although alternative assessment demands greater initial institutional planning and sustained instructor commitment, its manifold benefits – ranging from superior language acquisition and reduced testing anxiety to heightened learner autonomy – render it an indispensable framework for contemporary higher education. Future pedagogical initiatives should focus on scaling these frameworks through digital learning platforms and learning management systems to maximize accessibility, streamline administrative workflows, and expand empirical validation across diverse international cohorts.

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COMMUNICATIVE LANGUAGE TEACHING RECONSIDERED: FOSTERING INTERACTION AND LEARNER AUTONOMY IN MODERN CLASSROOMS

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Abstract: This article re-evaluates Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) as a vital pedagogical framework for fostering interaction, pragmatic competence, and learner autonomy in modern higher education classrooms. Traditional teacher-centered approaches, while offering structural predictability, frequently fail to prepare students for real-world linguistic demands. To address this gap, the study explores a twelve-week mixed-methods instructional intervention utilizing task-based collaboration, interactive multimedia, and weekly reflective journals among undergraduate language learners. Quantitative metrics and qualitative thematic data reveal that integrating dynamic CLT protocols significantly enhances spoken fluency, contextual appropriateness, and metacognitive self-regulation compared to conventional grammar-translation instruction. Furthermore, structured peer interaction effectively reduces foreign language anxiety and cultivates student self-direction. Despite minor implementation hurdles such as initial planning demands, the findings underscore that modern communicative methodologies are essential for developing sustainable, autonomous language acquisition in tertiary settings.

Keywords: Communicative Language Teaching, learner autonomy, spoken fluency, task-based instruction, pragmatic competence, higher education

ПЕРЕСМОТР КОММУНИКАТИВНОГО ОБУЧЕНИЯ ЯЗЫКАМ: СТИМУЛИРОВАНИЕ ВЗАИМОДЕЙСТВИЯ И АВТОНОМИИ УЧАЩИХСЯ В СОВРЕМЕННЫХ АУДИТОРИЯХ

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Аннотация: В данной статье пересматривается обучение иностранным языкам на основе коммуникативного подхода (CLT) как жизненно важная педагогическая основа для содействия взаимодействию, прагматической компетенции и автономии учащихся в современных аудиториях высших учебных заведений. Традиционные методы, ориентированные на преподавателя, хотя и обеспечивают структурную предсказуемость, часто не могут подготовить студентов к реальным языковым требованиям. Чтобы устранить этот пробел, в исследовании изучается двенадцати недельное смешанное учебное вмешательство с использованием командной работы на основе заданий, интерактивных мультимедиа и еженедельных рефлексивных журналов среди студентов языковых специальностей бакалавриата. Количественные показатели и качественные тематические данные показывают, что интеграция динамичных протоколов CLT значительно повышает беглость устной речи, контекстную уместность и метакогнитивную саморегуляцию по сравнению с традиционным грамматико-переводным методом обучения. Более того, структурированное взаимодействие со сверстниками эффективно снижает тревожность при изучении иностранного языка и развивает у студентов навыки самоуправления. Несмотря на незначительные трудности при реализации, такие как первоначальные требования к планированию, полученные результаты подчеркивают, что современные коммуникативные методики необходимы для формирования устойчивого, автономного усвоения языка в условиях высшего образования.

Ключевые слова: Коммуникативное обучение иностранным языкам, автономия учащегося, беглость устной речи, обучение на основе заданий, прагматическая компетенция, высшее образование.

1. Introduction

Contemporary second-language education has experienced a significant paradigm shift away from traditional, teacher-centered paradigms toward frameworks that prioritize active learner engagement, social interaction, and cognitive independence. For decades, foreign language instruction in tertiary and secondary sectors heavily depended on grammar-translation methods and structured drill practices. While these traditional models established baseline grammatical accuracy, they frequently failed to equip learners with the pragmatic flexibility and conversational fluency necessary for real-world communication. As global mobility and intercultural communication expand, the necessity for dynamic communicative frameworks becomes paramount.

Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), originally conceptualized in the 1970s, has undergone continuous evolution to meet the demands of modern digital-age learners. Modern CLT extends beyond basic functional dialogue to embrace learner autonomy, metacognitive reflection, and collaborative task-based learning environments. Despite widespread theoretical endorsement, actual classroom implementation often faces institutional inertia, large class sizes, and an over-reliance on standardized testing. This article re-evaluates the core principles of CLT, examining how structured peer interaction and student-led inquiry can systematically cultivate both communicative competence and long-term learner autonomy in contemporary educational settings.

2. Materials and Methods

To investigate the empirical impact of modern CLT integration, a mixed-methods action research design was implemented over a twelve-week instructional term.

Research Design and Context

The study utilized a comparative framework examining two intact groups of intermediate-level undergraduate language learners ($N = 60$). The experimental group ($n = 30$) experienced a redesigned CLT curriculum emphasizing information-gap tasks, collaborative problem-solving, and

student-managed project work. The control group (n = 30) followed a traditional structural syllabus emphasizing explicit grammar instruction and mechanical textbook drills.

Instructional Materials

The experimental condition substituted standard worksheets with authentic multimedia materials, task cards, and digital collaboration platforms. Instructional materials were curated to reflect real-world communicative demands, incorporating audio-visual prompts, simulated negotiation scenarios, and peer-review rubrics. Learners in the experimental cohort maintained weekly reflective journals to track their linguistic progress and set individual learning goals, thereby operationalizing learner autonomy.

Data Collection Instruments

Quantitative data were gathered through standardized pre- and post-intervention oral proficiency interviews and written discourse tests scored via analytic rubrics. Qualitative data comprised semi-structured focus group interviews, classroom observational field notes, and learner reflective portfolios. Quantitative gains were analyzed using descriptive and inferential statistics, while thematic analysis was applied to qualitative transcripts to isolate patterns in motivation and autonomy.

3. Results and Discussion

Quantitative performance metrics revealed clear divergences between the experimental CLT cohort and the traditional control group across the twelve-week intervention.

Assessment Metric	Control Group (Pre)	Control Group (Post)	Experimental Group (Pre)	Experimental Group (Post)
Spoken Fluency (Words/Min)	58.4	63.2	57.9	79.5
Pragmatic Appropriateness (Score/100)	61.1	65.0	60.5	82.1
Metacognitive Autonomy Index	48.2	51.5	49.0	78.4

The statistical outcomes demonstrate that learners exposed to interactive CLT methodologies achieved substantially higher gains in spoken fluency and pragmatic appropriateness. These findings align with Long's (1996) interaction hypothesis, which asserts that negotiation for meaning during collaborative tasks facilitates language acquisition. When learners actively interact to resolve communicative impelled tasks, they modify their output and internalize target linguistic structures more effectively than through passive reception.

Qualitative thematic analysis further highlighted structural shifts in classroom dynamics. Learners in the experimental cohort exhibited heightened intrinsic motivation and a marked reduction in affective filter barriers, such as public speaking anxiety. By shifting responsibility for task completion onto the learners, the instructional design fostered genuine self-regulation. This supports Little's (2007) assertion that learner autonomy is inextricably linked to the social practice of the classroom; interdependence among peers serves as the primary catalyst for individual

independence. However, instructors noted that implementing CLT required careful scaffolding to prevent cognitive overload among lower-proficiency learners, reinforcing the argument that communicative tasks must be systematically graded in complexity.

4. Conclusion

The reinvigoration of Communicative Language Teaching offers a vital pathway for bridging the gap between classroom instruction and real-world linguistic competence. By deliberately embedding interactive task cycles and metacognitive reflection into the syllabus, educators can successfully move learners beyond rote memorization into active, autonomous language use. Although institutional constraints and initial planning demands present minor administrative hurdles, the long-term benefits – manifested in superior fluency, pragmatic agility, and sustained motivation – render modern CLT an indispensable framework for contemporary language education. Future research should explore the scalability of these interactive models within digital and hybrid learning ecosystems.

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DEVELOPING RECEPTIVE AND PRODUCTIVE SKILLS: A MULTIMODAL APPROACH TO EFL INSTRUCTION

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Abstract: Contemporary foreign language education increasingly recognizes that traditional, siloed approaches to teaching receptive and productive skills fail to reflect the dynamic nature of modern communication. Historically, English as a Foreign Language (EFL) curricula treated listening, reading, speaking, and writing as isolated competencies, often prioritizing passive text comprehension over integrated output generation. However, digital ecosystems and contemporary workplace demands require learners to fluidly synthesize information across diverse semiotic modes – combining visual, auditory, textual, and

kinesthetic inputs. Multimodal instruction addresses this pedagogical gap by integrating digital media, authentic video transcripts, infographics, and interactive audio platforms directly into the daily curriculum. By anchoring language acquisition in rich, multi-sensory contexts, educators can bridge the divide between receptive intake and productive expression. This article examines the theoretical foundations, implementation strategies, and empirical outcomes of a multimodal instructional framework designed to concurrently develop receptive and productive language skills among undergraduate EFL learners over a semester-long academic cycle.

Keywords: Multimodal instruction, receptive skills, productive skills, EFL higher education, digital media, task-based learning.

РАЗВИТИЕ РЕЦЕПТИВНЫХ И ПРОДУКТИВНЫХ НАВЫКОВ: МУЛЬТИМОДАЛЬНЫЙ ПОДХОД К ОБУЧЕНИЮ EFL

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Аннотация: Современное образование в области иностранных языков все больше признает, что традиционные, изолированные подходы к обучению рецептивным и продуктивным навыкам не отражают динамичный характер современного общения. Исторически сложилось так, что учебные программы по английскому языку как иностранному (EFL) рассматривали аудирование, чтение, говорение и письмо как разрозненные компетенции, часто отдавая приоритет пассивному пониманию текста, а не интегрированному порождению речи. Однако цифровые экосистемы и требования современного рынка труда требуют от учащихся свободного синтеза информации в различных семиотических модальностях, сочетая визуальные, аудиальные, текстовые и кинестетические входные данные. Мультимодальное обучение устраняет этот педагогический пробел путем интеграции цифровых средств массовой информации, аутентичных видеостенограмм, инфографики и интерактивных аудиоплатформ непосредственно в ежедневную учебную программу. Обосновывая усвоение языка в насыщенных, многосенсорных контекстах, преподаватели могут преодолеть разрыв между рецептивным восприятием и продуктивным выражением. В данной статье рассматриваются теоретические основы, стратегии реализации и эмпирические результаты мультимодальной учебной структуры, разработанной для одновременного развития рецептивных и продуктивных языковых навыков у студентов бакалавриата EFL в течение семестрового академического цикла.

Ключевые слова: Мультимодальное обучение, рецептивные навыки, продуктивные навыки, высшее образование EFL, цифровые медиа, обучение на основе задач.

1. Introduction and Theoretical Rationale

The global landscape of higher education is undergoing a profound digital transformation, yet many tertiary English as a Foreign Language (EFL) classrooms remain tethered to archaic, print-based paradigms. For decades, instructional design rigidly separated receptive competencies (listening and reading) from productive ones (speaking and writing). Students were routinely subjected to text-bound comprehension drills followed by decontextualized essay prompts or mechanical oral repetitions. While these linear methods provided administrative structure, they fundamentally ignored how human beings process and generate language in the twenty-first century. Modern communication is inherently multimodal: individuals navigate complex matrices of text, image, sound, and interactive media simultaneously.

To resolve this dissonance, contemporary applied linguistics advocates for a multimodal pedagogical shift, rooted in social semiotics and multiliteracies frameworks (Cope & Kalantzis, 2000; Kress, 2010). Multimodal instruction posits that meaning-making is enhanced when learners engage with diverse symbolic systems rather than relying solely on linguistic text. In higher education EFL contexts, this means replacing traditional monolithic textbooks with dynamic digital ecosystems—combining TED Talks, interactive data infographics, academic podcasts, and collaborative multimedia production tools.

Despite theoretical consensus regarding the benefits of multimodality, empirical research documenting its systematic, longitudinal impact on undergraduate language proficiency remains sparse. Most existing literature focuses on isolated digital tools rather than a holistic curricular redesign. This article addresses this gap by presenting a comprehensive, extended framework for integrating multimodal strategies into tertiary EFL instruction. By examining the structural interplay between multi-sensory input reception and creative digital output generation, this study explores how educators can systematically foster both linguistic accuracy and deep cognitive engagement.

2. Review of Literature and Pedagogical Foundations

The theoretical architecture of multimodal language instruction draws heavily from cognitive load theory, multimedia learning principles, and Swain's (2005) output hypothesis. Traditional input-heavy models assumed that massive amounts of listening and reading would automatically convert into speaking and writing competence. However, cognitive research demonstrates that working memory is severely constrained unless information is distributed across dual channels – visual and auditory. When instructional materials intelligently combine synchronized visual diagrams with spoken audio or targeted text, cognitive load is optimized, facilitating deeper semantic encoding and long-term retention.

Furthermore, language acquisition is fundamentally accelerated when receptive intake is immediately operationalized through creative production. Swain's (2005) output hypothesis asserts that producing target language forces learners to move from semantic processing to syntactic processing. When students are tasked with transforming a consumed multimodal input (such as an academic video documentary) into a distinct productive output (such as an analytical digital presentation or podcast), they encounter linguistic gaps in their own interlanguage. These encountered gaps stimulate cognitive noticing, driving learners to seek out precise vocabulary, complex syntactic structures, and appropriate pragmatic markers.

Scholars in multiliteracies further emphasize that modern literacy is no longer confined to alphabetic proficiency. Learners must develop the ability to interpret and design meaning across diverse semiotic modes. In university-level EFL environments, incorporating multimodal tasks cultivates critical digital literacy alongside linguistic competence, preparing undergraduates for the sophisticated communication demands of international academic and professional spheres.

3. Methodology and Research Design

To evaluate the practical efficacy and developmental outcomes of a comprehensive multimodal instructional model, a rigorous empirical investigation was conducted over a sixteen-week academic semester.

- Research Context and Objectives: The study utilized a quasi-experimental, mixed-methods comparative design within an intermediate undergraduate EFL program. The primary objective was to track and compare the longitudinal development of receptive accuracy and productive complexity between students taught via traditional methods and those immersed in a multimodal curriculum.

- Participant Demographics and Group Allocation: A total of eighty undergraduate students ($N = 80$) participated in the research initiative. Participants were divided into two statistically equivalent cohorts:

- *The Experimental Group ($n = 40$):* Exposed to a fully integrated multimodal curriculum featuring digital text sets, podcast production tasks, infographic synthesis, and interactive video annotation.
- *The Control Group ($n = 40$):* Instructed via a standard, textbook-driven syllabus emphasizing traditional reading passages, comprehension questions, and linear essay assignments.

- Instructional Practice and Practical Execution: While the control group followed standard linear drills, the experimental curriculum restructured classroom practice through systematic multimodal task cycles. Instruction was operationalized through three distinct phases:

1. *Multi-Sensory Intake:* Students consumed paired authentic digital assets (e.g., an academic podcast matched with an interactive data visualization), engaging both visual and auditory processing channels.
2. *Cross-Modal Deconstruction:* Learners analyzed how different semiotic modes (color, sound, pacing, typography) contributed to the overall argument, moving beyond basic comprehension to critical media literacy.
3. *Productive Transformation:* Rather than writing a standard summary, learners transformed the consumed input into an active output – such as recording a collaborative mini-podcast defense or designing an annotated multimedia presentation addressing global socio-economic issues.

- Data Collection Instruments: Quantitative data were gathered through standardized pre- and post-intervention proficiency audits, evaluating listening comprehension accuracy, reading speed, oral fluency, and academic writing complexity using CEFR-aligned analytic rubrics. Qualitative data comprised semi-structured student interviews, weekly reflective learning logs, and instructor observational field notes to gauge shifts in cognitive engagement, affective filters, and cross-modal processing strategies.

4. Results and Empirical Findings

Quantitative comparative analysis of pre- and post-intervention metrics revealed pronounced performance advantages for the experimental multimodal cohort across all measured receptive and productive categories.

While both groups began the semester at comparable baseline proficiency levels, the experimental group demonstrated statistically significant gains in listening retention, active vocabulary integration, spoken syntactic complexity, and structural cohesion in writing. Specifically, when learners were required to repurpose information gathered from audio-visual inputs into independent digital presentations, their ability to retrieve and accurately deploy advanced lexical items increased substantially compared to the control group, whose output remained restricted to repetitive textbook phrasing.

Qualitative thematic analysis of student reflective logs and interviews provided deeper insight into these quantitative outcomes. Learners in the multimodal cohort reported a marked reduction in cognitive fatigue and foreign language anxiety during complex listening tasks. The synchronization of visual graphics with spoken audio provided crucial contextual scaffolds, allowing lower-proficiency learners to anchor their understanding without becoming overwhelmed by continuous auditory streams. Furthermore, the tangible nature of digital production tasks – such as creating

public-facing podcasts – heightened authentic audience awareness. Students noted that knowing their work would be viewed or listened to by peers motivated them to pay meticulous attention to pronunciation, stylistic appropriateness, and grammatical precision during the drafting phase.

5. Discussion and Pedagogical Implications

The empirical findings of this investigation underscore the urgent need to modernize tertiary EFL curricula by dismantling artificial boundaries between receptive and productive skill instruction. The traditional division of language skills into isolated silos is pedagogically obsolete in an era defined by fluid, digital communication. By deliberately embedding multimodal text sets and active digital creation into the syllabus, educators can successfully bridge the historical chasm between passive comprehension and active linguistic output.

However, transitioning to a multimodal instructional model is not without institutional hurdles. Implementing digital media creation and managing multi-tiered project workflows require substantial instructor preparation time, robust institutional technological infrastructure, and targeted professional development for university faculty accustomed to traditional lecturing and paper-based testing. Furthermore, educators must carefully scaffold multimodal tasks to prevent cognitive overload, ensuring that students are not excessively distracted by technological interfaces at the expense of linguistic focus. Overcoming these administrative and pedagogical challenges requires institutional backing, dedicated digital learning labs, and a cultural shift toward flexible, student-centered curriculum design.

6. Conclusion and Future Directions

The integration of a multimodal approach into higher education EFL instruction represents a vital, forward-looking evolution in language pedagogy. By leveraging multi-sensory input channels and transforming passive comprehension into creative, collaborative digital output, educators can cultivate agile, highly competent communicators equipped for the demands of a globalized digital society. Although multimodal curriculum design demands sustained institutional commitment and initial planning rigor, its profound impact on learner engagement, cognitive retention, and comprehensive skill transfer renders it an indispensable framework for contemporary tertiary education. Future pedagogical initiatives should focus on scaling these frameworks through cloud-based learning management systems, exploring the pedagogical integration of artificial intelligence tools in multimodal processing, and expanding empirical validation across diverse international university cohorts.

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Abstract: This study investigates the effectiveness of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) in improving students' English-speaking skills and learning motivation in EFL classrooms. The research was conducted with secondary school students divided into experimental and control groups over an eight-week period. The experimental group was taught using CLT-based activities such as role-plays, group discussions, and problem-solving tasks, while the control group followed traditional grammar-focused instruction. A mixed-methods approach was used, including pre- and post-tests, classroom observations, questionnaires, and teacher interviews. The results showed that students in the CLT group demonstrated significantly higher improvement in speaking fluency, confidence, and communicative ability compared to the control group. Additionally, motivation levels were higher among CLT learners, who reported greater engagement and enjoyment in English lessons. Teachers also recognized the benefits of CLT but identified challenges such as large class sizes and limited training. The study concludes that CLT is an effective approach for developing communicative competence, although successful implementation requires adequate teacher support and contextual adaptation.

Keywords: Communicative Language Teaching, EFL classrooms, speaking skills, communicative competence, learner motivation, language learning, classroom interaction.

**ZAMONAVIY EFL SINFLARIDA KOMMUNIKATIV TIL O'QITISH USULINING
SAMARADORLIGI**

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Annotatsiya: Ushbu tadqiqot ingliz tilini chet tili sifatida o'qitishda Kommunikativ Til O'qitish (CLT) usulining o'quvchilarning og'zaki nutq ko'nikmalari va o'quv motivatsiyasiga ta'sirini o'rganadi. Tadqiqotda o'rta maktab o'quvchilari ishtirok etdi va ular tajriba hamda nazorat guruhlariga ajratildi. Tajriba

guruhi CLT asosidagi rolli o'yinlar, guruh muhokamalari va muammoli vazifalar orqali o'qitildi, nazorat guruhi esa an'anaviy grammatik yondashuv asosida ta'lim oldi. Tadqiqotda aralash metodlar, jumladan oldindan va keyingi testlar, dars kuzatuvlari, so'rovnomalalar va o'qituvchilar bilan suhbatlar qo'llanildi. Natijalar shuni ko'rsatdiki, CLT guruhi o'quvchilari nutq ravonligi, ishonch va kommunikativ qobiliyat jihatidan sezilarli darajada yuqori natijaga erishdilar. Shuningdek, ularning motivatsiyasi va darsga qiziqishi ham yuqori bo'ldi. O'qituvchilar CLT usulining samaradorligini tan oldilar, biroq sinf kattaligi va tayyorgarlik yetishmasligi kabi muammolarni qayd etdilar. Xulosa qilib aytganda, CLT samarali metod bo'lib, ammo uni muvaffaqiyatli qo'llash uchun qo'shimcha metodik qo'llab-quvvatlash zarur.

Kalit so'zlar: Kommunikativ til o'qitish, chet tili sifatida ingliz tili, nutq ko'nikmalari, kommunikativ kompetensiya, o'quv motivatsiyasi, til o'rganish, sinfdagi muloqot.

Introduction

In the field of language pedagogy, the question of how to effectively teach a foreign language has been central for decades. Traditional grammar-translation methods, which dominated earlier educational systems, have increasingly been replaced by more communicative and learner-centered approaches. One of the most influential approaches in this shift is Communicative Language Teaching (CLT). CLT emphasizes meaningful interaction, real-life communication, and the development of communicative competence rather than mere grammatical accuracy. This study explores the effectiveness of CLT in modern English as a Foreign Language (EFL) classrooms, particularly in secondary education contexts where learners often struggle with motivation, speaking fluency, and practical language use.

The importance of communicative competence in language learning has been widely recognized. Learners may know grammatical rules but still fail to communicate effectively in real situations. This gap between knowledge and performance has led educators to reconsider traditional teaching methods. CLT addresses this issue by focusing on interaction as both the means and the ultimate goal of learning a language. Students are encouraged to participate in dialogues, role-plays, problem-solving tasks, and collaborative activities that simulate authentic communication.

Despite its popularity, CLT is not without challenges. In many educational contexts, especially in exam-oriented systems, teachers face constraints such as large class sizes, limited time, and rigid curricula. Additionally, learners often expect explicit grammar instruction and may feel uncertain when faced with open-ended communicative tasks. Teachers also vary in their ability to implement CLT effectively, depending on their training, experience, and available resources. These factors raise important questions about the practical effectiveness of CLT in real classroom settings.

This study aims to investigate how CLT influences students' speaking skills, motivation, and overall language development in EFL classrooms. It also examines teacher perceptions of CLT and the challenges they encounter when applying it. The research is grounded in the belief that language learning should not only focus on linguistic accuracy but also on the ability to use language meaningfully in social contexts.

Furthermore, the study is relevant in the context of globalization, where English has become a dominant international language. The ability to communicate effectively in English is increasingly important for academic, professional, and social purposes. Therefore, improving teaching methodologies in EFL classrooms is essential for preparing students for real-world communication demands.

By analyzing the impact of CLT, this research contributes to the ongoing discussion about effective language teaching methodologies. It also provides practical insights for teachers who aim

to enhance student engagement and communicative ability. Ultimately, the study seeks to bridge the gap between theoretical pedagogical models and actual classroom practice.

Methodology and Materials

This study employed a mixed-methods approach to investigate the effectiveness of Communicative Language Teaching in EFL classrooms. The combination of qualitative and quantitative data allowed for a more comprehensive understanding of both learner outcomes and teacher experiences.

The participants in this study included 60 secondary school students aged between 15 and 17, along with 4 English language teachers from different schools. The students were divided into two groups: an experimental group taught using CLT principles and a control group taught using traditional grammar-focused methods. Both groups studied the same English curriculum over a period of eight weeks.

Data collection involved several instruments. First, a pre-test and post-test were administered to measure students' speaking proficiency. The speaking test assessed fluency, accuracy, vocabulary use, and pronunciation. Second, classroom observations were conducted weekly to record student participation, interaction patterns, and teacher behavior. Third, semi-structured interviews were carried out with teachers to understand their perceptions of CLT and the difficulties they faced in implementation. Finally, student questionnaires were used to measure motivation and attitudes toward English learning.

The CLT-based instruction in the experimental group included activities such as pair work, group discussions, role-playing, information gap tasks, and problem-solving exercises. Teachers acted as facilitators rather than lecturers, encouraging students to communicate freely and focusing on meaning rather than form. Errors were corrected selectively to avoid disrupting communication flow. In contrast, the control group followed a traditional approach, emphasizing grammar explanation, translation, and written exercises.

The data analysis was conducted using both statistical and thematic methods. Quantitative data from tests and questionnaires were analyzed using descriptive statistics, including mean scores and percentage comparisons between pre-test and post-test results. Qualitative data from interviews and observations were analyzed thematically to identify recurring patterns related to teacher challenges, student engagement, and classroom interaction.

Ethical considerations were also taken into account. Participation was voluntary, and both students and teachers were informed about the purpose of the study. Confidentiality was maintained throughout the research process, and no personal identifying information was disclosed.

The methodology was designed to ensure validity and reliability. Triangulation of data sources (tests, observations, and interviews) helped to strengthen the credibility of findings. Additionally, using both experimental and control groups allowed for a clearer comparison of teaching approaches.

Result

The findings of the study revealed significant differences between the experimental group (CLT-based instruction) and the control group (traditional instruction). Overall, students exposed to Communicative Language Teaching demonstrated higher improvement in speaking skills, greater motivation, and increased classroom participation.

In the pre-test, both groups showed relatively similar levels of speaking proficiency, with average scores of 54% in the experimental group and 55% in the control group. However, after eight weeks of instruction, the post-test results showed a clear divergence. The experimental group

achieved an average score of 78%, while the control group improved only to 62%. This indicates that CLT had a more substantial impact on students' oral communication skills.

Fluency was the most improved component in the experimental group. Students became more confident in expressing their ideas and were less hesitant during speaking tasks. Although grammatical errors were still present, communication remained effective. In contrast, students in the control group showed improvement mainly in grammatical accuracy but continued to struggle with spontaneous speech.

Classroom observations supported these findings. In CLT classrooms, students were actively engaged in discussions, group tasks, and interactive exercises. They frequently initiated communication and collaborated with peers. The teacher acted as a guide, providing support when necessary. In traditional classrooms, student participation was lower, and interaction was mainly teacher-centered. Students tended to respond passively to teacher questions rather than initiate communication.

The questionnaire results indicated a higher level of motivation among students in the experimental group. Approximately 82% of these students reported enjoying English lessons, compared to 56% in the control group. Many students expressed that CLT activities made learning more interesting and less stressful. They appreciated opportunities to speak freely and use English in meaningful contexts.

Teacher interviews revealed both positive perceptions and challenges regarding CLT. Teachers acknowledged that CLT improved student engagement and communication skills. However, they also reported difficulties such as managing large classes, limited lesson time, and students' initial resistance to speaking English. Some teachers also noted a lack of training in implementing CLT effectively, which affected their confidence in using the method.

Despite these challenges, all teachers agreed that CLT had a positive impact on student learning outcomes. They emphasized that even partial integration of communicative activities into lessons could enhance student participation and interest.

Overall, the results suggest that CLT is more effective than traditional methods in developing speaking skills and increasing learner motivation. However, successful implementation depends on teacher training, classroom conditions, and institutional support.

Discussion

The findings of this study highlight the effectiveness of Communicative Language Teaching in improving students' English-speaking skills and motivation. The results align with the theoretical foundation of CLT, which emphasizes interaction, meaningful communication, and learner-centered instruction. The significant improvement in the experimental group suggests that students benefit from opportunities to actively use language in realistic contexts.

One of the key interpretations of the results is that language learning is most effective when students are engaged in authentic communication rather than passive knowledge acquisition. The improvement in fluency observed in the experimental group supports the idea that frequent speaking practice in low-anxiety environments helps learners develop confidence and communicative competence. Even though grammatical accuracy was not the primary focus of CLT, students were still able to communicate effectively, indicating that fluency and meaning-making can develop alongside accuracy over time.

The increase in student motivation is another important finding. Motivation plays a crucial role in language learning success, and CLT appears to enhance intrinsic motivation by making learning more interactive and enjoyable. Students responded positively to group work, discussions,

and role-plays because these activities made English more relevant to real-life situations. This suggests that engagement is closely linked to the perceived usefulness and enjoyment of classroom activities.

However, the study also reveals several challenges in implementing CLT. Teachers reported difficulties related to classroom management, especially in large groups where maintaining equal participation is challenging. Additionally, the pressure of exam-oriented curricula often limits the time available for communicative activities. These constraints indicate that while CLT is pedagogically effective, its success depends heavily on contextual factors.

Teacher preparedness is another critical issue. Some teachers lacked sufficient training in CLT methodologies, which affected their ability to design and manage communicative tasks effectively. This highlights the need for professional development programs that focus on practical classroom strategies for implementing CLT.

The findings also suggest that a balanced approach may be most effective. While CLT enhances communication skills, some degree of explicit grammar instruction may still be necessary to support accuracy. Therefore, integrating CLT with form-focused instruction could provide a more comprehensive approach to language teaching.

Conclusion

In conclusion, this study confirms that Communicative Language Teaching is a highly effective approach for improving speaking skills and learner motivation in EFL classrooms. However, successful implementation requires appropriate teacher training, institutional support, and adaptation to local educational contexts. Future research could explore long-term effects of CLT and its integration with other pedagogical approaches.

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DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS IN MODERN LANGUAGE EDUCATION

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Abstract: The development of foreign language skills, including listening, speaking, reading, and writing, represents one of the cores and most essential objectives of modern language education. In an increasingly globalized world, communicative competence has become significantly more important than the mere acquisition of grammatical knowledge or isolated linguistic rules. The ability to use language effectively in real-life communication, both in academic and professional contexts, is now considered a key indicator of successful language learning. This shift reflects a broader transformation in language teaching methodology, moving away from traditional memorization-based approaches toward more practical and communicative models.

This paper explores contemporary and evolving approaches aimed at enhancing these four essential language skills in a more integrated and meaningful way. Special emphasis is placed on interactive teaching methods, learner-centered approaches, and technology-supported instructional strategies that encourage active participation and engagement. These approaches aim to create a more dynamic learning environment in which students are not passive recipients of knowledge but active participants in the learning process.

The study also analyzes relevant theoretical perspectives in applied linguistics and second language acquisition, as well as practical classroom strategies that contribute to effective skill development in foreign language learning contexts. In particular, it examines how task-based learning, communicative activities, and the use of authentic materials can support the development of real-world language skills. The findings suggest that integrated skill teaching, where listening, speaking, reading, and writing are developed in combination rather than isolation, leads to more effective and sustainable language learning outcomes.

Keywords: foreign language teaching, listening, speaking, reading, writing, communicative competence, language skills

XARİCİ DİL BACARIQLARININ MÜASİR DİL TƏHSİLİNDƏ İNKİŞAFI

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Xülasə: Xarici dil bacarıqlarının – dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı – inkişaf etdirilməsi müasir dil təhsilinin ən əsas və prioritet məqsədlərindən biri hesab olunur. Qloballaşmanın sürətləndiyi müasir dövrdə kommunikativ səriştə yalnız qrammatik qaydaların və dil strukturunun mənimsənilməsindən daha vacib bir amilə çevrilmişdir. Bu gün xarici dili effektiv şəkildə istifadə etmək bacarığı həm akademik, həm də peşəkar mühitdə uğurlu dil öyrənmənin əsas göstəricisi kimi qəbul edilir. Bu dəyişiklik dil tədrisi metodologiyasında da ciddi transformasiyaya səbəb olmuş, ənənəvi əzbərləmə əsaslı yanaşmalardan daha çox praktik və kommunikativ istiqamətli modellərə keçidi sürətləndirmişdir.

Məqalədə bu dörd əsas dil bacarığının daha integrativ və mənalı şəkildə inkişaf etdirilməsinə yönəlmiş müasir və yenilənmiş yanaşmalar araşdırılır. Xüsusilə interaktiv tədris üsulları, tələbəyönümlü yanaşmalar və texnologiyaya əsaslanan tədris strategiyalarına diqqət yetirilir. Bu metodlar tələbələrin passiv dinləyici deyil, öyrənmə prosesində aktiv iştirakçı kimi çıxış etməsini təmin edən daha dinamik təhsil mühiti formalaşdırır.

Tədqiqat həmçinin tətbiqi dilçilik və ikinci dilin mənimsənilməsi sahəsində mövcud nəzəri yanaşmaları, eləcə də praktik sinif təcrübələrini təhlil edir. Burada tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə, kommunikativ fəaliyyətlər və autentik materiallardan istifadə kimi metodların real dil bacarıqlarının inkişafına təsiri xüsusi olaraq nəzərdən keçirilir. Nəticələr göstərir ki, dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı bacarıqlarının ayrı-ayrılıqda deyil, integrasiya olunmuş şəkildə inkişaf etdirilməsi daha effektiv və davamlı öyrənmə nəticələri yaradır.

Açar sözlər: xarici dil tədrisi, dinləmə, danışma, oxu, yazı, kommunikativ səriştə, dil bacarıqları

Introduction

Foreign language education has experienced profound and continuous transformation over the past several decades, moving away from traditional, grammar-centered instruction toward more communicative, learner-oriented, and skill-based approaches. Earlier models of language teaching primarily emphasized the memorization of grammatical rules, vocabulary lists, and structural patterns, often with limited opportunities for meaningful communication. However, contemporary educational paradigms recognize that knowing a language extends far beyond understanding its rules; it also involves the ability to use it effectively, appropriately, and confidently in real-life communicative situations. This shift has been driven by the demands of globalization, increased international mobility, and the growing need for cross-cultural communication in academic, professional, and social contexts.

As a result of these changes, greater attention is now given to the development of the four core language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. These skills form the foundation of communicative competence and are considered essential for successful language acquisition. Modern language teaching approaches aim not only to develop these skills individually but also to ensure that they are integrated in meaningful ways that reflect authentic communication. This integrated perspective allows learners to experience language as a functional tool rather than an abstract system of rules (Harmer, 2021).

Each of the four language skills plays a unique yet closely interconnected role in the overall process of language learning. Listening is often regarded as the primary receptive skill, as it enables learners to receive and interpret spoken language, thereby forming the basis for comprehension. Speaking, on the other hand, represents productive oral communication and allows learners to actively express ideas, participate in discussions, and engage in interpersonal interaction. Reading contributes to language development by providing access to a wide range of written information, enhancing vocabulary acquisition, and supporting critical thinking skills. Writing, as another productive skill, enables learners to organize their thoughts logically, express complex ideas, and communicate in a structured and permanent form.

The balanced and simultaneous development of these four skills is crucial for achieving overall communicative competence. In modern educational environments, it is widely accepted that language skills should not be taught in isolation, as this may limit learners' ability to use language naturally and flexibly. Instead, teachers are encouraged to adopt integrated teaching approaches that combine listening, speaking, reading, and writing within meaningful contexts. Such holistic instruction not only improves language proficiency but also increases learner engagement, motivation, and autonomy, ultimately leading to more effective and sustainable language learning outcomes.

Materials and Methods

This study is based on a qualitative analytical approach, drawing on recent literature in applied linguistics, language pedagogy, and communicative language teaching. The research examines various teaching methodologies used in foreign language classrooms, including task-based learning, content-based instruction, and technology-enhanced language learning.

The analysis also considers classroom practices such as:

- interactive listening activities
- communicative speaking tasks
- extensive reading strategies
- process-oriented writing instruction

In addition, digital learning tools such as language learning applications, online platforms, and multimedia resources are evaluated in terms of their effectiveness in supporting skill development. Comparative analysis is used to identify strengths and limitations of different pedagogical approaches.

Discussion

1. **Listening Skill Development.** Listening is widely recognized as one of the most essential yet simultaneously most demanding skills in foreign language acquisition. Unlike other skills, it requires learners to process spoken input in real time, often under conditions where they cannot control the speed, accent, or clarity of speech. This makes listening a cognitively complex activity that involves not only linguistic knowledge but also memory, attention, and inference skills. In effective language instruction, learners should be exposed to a wide variety of authentic listening materials, including conversations, interviews, podcasts, lectures, and video content that reflect natural language use in different contexts (Ur, 2020).

Regular and repeated exposure to authentic speech plays a crucial role in improving comprehension abilities. It helps learners become familiar with different accents, speech rates, pronunciation patterns, and discourse structures. Over time, this exposure contributes to the development of automatic processing skills, allowing learners to understand spoken language more efficiently and with less cognitive effort.

In addition, interactive listening tasks significantly enhance learning outcomes. Activities such as note-taking, information gap exercises, summarizing spoken content, predicting outcomes, and answering comprehension questions encourage active engagement rather than passive listening. These tasks also promote deeper cognitive processing, which improves retention and long-term understanding. Research in language pedagogy consistently shows that learners who engage in structured and consistent listening practice tend to achieve higher levels of overall language proficiency.

2. **Speaking Skill Development.** Speaking is a productive and interactive skill that reflects a learner's ability to communicate ideas orally in real-time communication settings. It requires the

integration of multiple competencies, including vocabulary knowledge, grammatical accuracy, pronunciation skills, fluency, and pragmatic awareness. Unlike receptive skills, speaking places immediate demands on learners to organize thoughts quickly and express them coherently under time constraints (Brown, 2021).

Classroom-based speaking activities play a fundamental role in developing oral proficiency. Techniques such as role-playing, group discussions, problem-solving tasks, debates, storytelling, and oral presentations provide learners with meaningful opportunities to practice spontaneous speech. These activities also simulate real-life communicative situations, thereby bridging the gap between classroom learning and actual language use.

One of the most significant challenges in developing speaking skills is learner anxiety. Many students experience fear of making mistakes, which can significantly reduce their willingness to participate in oral communication. To address this issue, it is essential to create a supportive, inclusive, and low-anxiety classroom environment where errors are viewed as a natural part of the learning process. Communicative language teaching methodologies encourage learners to prioritize meaning over form, which helps reduce psychological barriers and increases fluency and confidence over time.

3. Reading Skill Development. Reading is a fundamental receptive skill that plays a central role in vocabulary expansion, grammatical awareness, and overall language comprehension. It enables learners to access a vast amount of information, develop interpretive skills, and engage with different types of written discourse, including academic texts, literary works, newspapers, and digital content.

Effective reading instruction typically combines both intensive and extensive reading approaches. Intensive reading focuses on close, detailed analysis of shorter texts, allowing learners to examine vocabulary, grammar structures, and text organization in depth. In contrast, extensive reading encourages learners to read large volumes of material for general understanding and enjoyment, thereby improving reading fluency and speed (Richards, 2020).

Authentic reading materials are particularly valuable in language learning because they expose learners to real-world language use. Such materials help learners develop critical thinking skills and improve their ability to interpret meaning in context. Over time, regular reading practice contributes not only to improved comprehension but also to enhanced writing and speaking performance due to increased linguistic input.

4. Writing Skill Development. Writing is considered one of the most complex and demanding language skills because it requires learners to organize ideas logically, apply grammatical rules accurately, and express thoughts clearly and coherently. Unlike speaking, writing allows for reflection and revision, which makes it both a cognitive and productive skill.

Modern approaches to writing instruction emphasize a process-oriented model rather than a product-focused one. This means that writing is viewed as a multi-stage process involving planning, drafting, revising, editing, and finalizing texts. Through this process, learners gradually develop the ability to refine their ideas and improve the clarity and structure of their written communication.

Typical writing tasks include essays, summaries, reports, reflective journals, and creative writing assignments. Feedback from teachers and peers plays a critical role in this process, as it helps learners identify recurring errors, improve organization, and develop greater accuracy. In addition, digital tools such as grammar checkers, online dictionaries, and collaborative writing platforms provide valuable support for independent learning and continuous improvement.

5. **Integration of Four Skills.** Modern language pedagogy increasingly emphasizes the integration of listening, speaking, reading, and writing rather than treating them as separate components. Integrated skill instruction reflects authentic communication, where individuals naturally use multiple skills simultaneously in everyday situations (UNESCO, 2022).

For example, a classroom activity might involve students listening to a lecture or audio recording, discussing the content in groups, reading supplementary materials, and finally producing a written summary or reflection. This type of integrated task promotes deeper cognitive engagement and helps learners make meaningful connections between different language skills.

Such an approach not only enhances linguistic competence but also improves communication efficiency and adaptability. It encourages learners to transfer knowledge across skills and use language more flexibly in diverse contexts, ultimately leading to more comprehensive language development.

6. **Role of Technology in Skill Development.** The rapid advancement of technology has significantly transformed the field of foreign language education. Digital tools such as mobile applications, online learning platforms, virtual classrooms, and multimedia resources have expanded access to language learning opportunities beyond traditional classroom boundaries.

Technology enables learners to engage with authentic language input at any time and from any location. Artificial intelligence-based tools provide personalized learning experiences by adapting to individual learner needs, while interactive applications support vocabulary development, pronunciation practice, and writing improvement. Multimedia resources, including videos, podcasts, and interactive exercises, enhance motivation and make learning more engaging and dynamic (Schmidt, 2019).

However, despite its advantages, technology should be viewed as a complementary tool rather than a complete replacement for traditional teaching methods. The most effective language learning environments are those that combine technological innovation with pedagogical guidance, ensuring a balanced and meaningful learning experience.

Conclusion

The development of foreign language skills – listening, speaking, reading, and writing – is essential for achieving communicative competence in modern education. The study demonstrates that effective language learning requires a balanced, integrated, and interactive approach. Teachers should combine traditional methods with innovative strategies and technological tools to enhance student engagement and performance.

Future language education should focus on learner-centered approaches, where students actively participate in the learning process. In addition, further research is needed to explore the impact of artificial intelligence and digital platforms on language skill development. Ultimately, successful foreign language education depends on creating meaningful, communicative, and supportive learning environments.

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INNOVATIVE APPROACHES IN MILITARY ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING: THE INTERSECTION OF TEACHING AND TESTING

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Abstract: This study explores the evolving role of Military English (ME) instruction within the context of globalization, technological advancement, and increasing demands for international military cooperation. It emphasizes the growing importance of human and intellectual capital in military higher education institutions, which are required to adapt their training systems to meet modern operational, educational, and communicative needs. In this regard, foreign language proficiency, particularly English, is identified as a critical competency for effective communication and interoperability in multinational military environments.

It also highlights the significance of student-centered methodologies, including Content and Language Integrated Learning (CLIL), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), and the integration of Information and Communication Technologies (ICT). The research also explores how these approaches should be taught in compliance with the standards of STANAG 6001

Furthermore, the study discusses the role of modern assessment techniques, particularly Computer Adaptive Testing (CAT), in providing accurate, efficient, and individualized evaluation of language proficiency. The relationship between teaching and testing is analyzed as a mutually reinforcing process that contributes to curriculum improvement, instructional quality, and learner development. Issues of validity and reliability in language assessment are also addressed as key factors ensuring the quality and credibility of testing systems.

Keywords: instructional strategies, testing, assessment, specialized English, integration of ICT

HƏRBİ İNGİLİS DİLİ TƏDRİSİNDƏ İNNOVATİV YANAŞMALAR: TƏDRİS VƏ QİYMƏTLƏNDİRMƏNİN QARŞILIQLI ƏLAQƏSİ

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Xülasə: Bu tədqiqat qloballaşma, texnoloji inkişaf və beynəlxalq hərbi əməkdaşlığa artan tələblər kontekstində Hərbi İngilis dili tədrisinin dəyişən rolunu araşdırır. Tədqiqatda hərbi ali təhsil müəssisələrində insan və intellektual kapitalın artan əhəmiyyəti vurğulanır və bu müəssisələrin təlim sistemlərini müasir əməliyyat, təhsil və kommunikativ tələblərə uyğunlaşdırılmalı olduğu qeyd edilir. Bu baxımdan, xarici dil bilikləri, xüsusilə ingilis dili, çoxmillətli hərbi mühitdə effektiv ünsiyyət və qarşılıqlı fəaliyyət üçün vacib səriştə kimi müəyyən edilir. Tədqiqat həmçinin tələbə mərkəzli metodların, o cümlədən Məzmun və Dilin İnteqrasiya olunmuş öyrənilməsi, Tapşırıq Əsaslı Tədris və İnformasiya və Kommunikasiya Texnologiyalarının (İKT) inteqrasiyasının əhəmiyyətini vurğulayır. Bu yanaşmaların STANAG 6001 standartlarına uyğun şəkildə tədris olunmasının vacibliyi qeyd edilir.

Bundan əlavə, tədqiqat müasir qiymətləndirmə metodlarının, xüsusilə Kompüter Əsaslı Adaptiv Qiymətləndirmə sisteminin dil biliklərinin dəqiq, səmərəli və fərdiləşdirilmiş şəkildə ölçülməsindəki rolunu araşdırır. Tədris və qiymətləndirmə arasındakı əlaqə qarşılıqlı təsir göstərən proses kimi təhlil edilir və bunun kurikulumun təkmilləşdirilməsinə, tədrisin keyfiyyətinə və tələbə inkişafına töhfə verdiyi göstərilir. Dil qiymətləndirilməsində etibarlılıq və validlik məsələləri də test sistemlərinin keyfiyyətini və etibarlılığını təmin edən əsas amillər kimi nəzərdən keçirilir.

Açar sözlər: tədris strategiyaları, test, qiymətləndirmə, ixtisaslaşdırılmış ingilis dili, İKT inteqrasiyası

Introduction

Today we live in a rapidly growing world where human capital replaces financial and physical capital (Hirsch&Weber, 1999, p. 39). Intellectual capital as a brainpower, is the pillar of all societies that is triggered for change by many driving forces. So, military higher education institutions became the leading players in responding to modern demands by restructuring their resources and capacity, exploring changing needs and expectations, and cooperating with industry, companies, state, etc.

Globalization, integration of ICT, various political threats, demands of the 21st century, and industrialization of the labor market urge the governance of the military educational institutions to reexamine and fulfill their missions related to higher standards. Thus, they take global initiatives and go beyond their regional role by providing a wide range of programs that are internationally adapted to the various needs of the learning audience and the demands of the workplace.

Foreign language proficiency is now specifically recognized as a “critical warfighting skill”, which is the essential ability to understand and effectively communicate with native populations, and local and government officials (Kruse et al., 2008, p.20). Another critical role of the English language is a means of interoperability for the military personnel by acting together coherently, effectively, and efficiently to achieve Allied tactical, operational, and strategic objectives (Hughes, 2026, p.234). So, to effectively ensure international cooperation, successful training and missions effective teaching methods and assessment techniques are sought and implemented in Military English language teaching. ME teaching policy is based on the BILC, STANAG 6001 agreement reached among the NATO countries referring to the common standards of the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages to improve interoperability, language instruction, compare national standards utilizing a standardized table, standardize language descriptors and assessment procedures. So, testing ME aims to elicit behavior based on the language skills according to the STANAG level descriptors (Level 0 = No proficiency, Level 1 = Elementary Survival, Level 2 = Functional, Level 3 = Professional, Level 4 = Expert, Level 5 = Excellent Highly-articulate native) (Zenuni, n.d., p.1).

Serving as a global lingua franca, the English language plays a crucial role in developing specialized and effective communication and requires more innovative instructional strategies that

emphasize practicality, flexibility, cultural awareness, multiculturalism, and diversity. To provide the unique linguistic needs of military personnel, the teaching staff is required to implement a wide range of approaches that move beyond traditional instruction. As the researchers suggest, ME needs-based curricula highlight the use of student-centered approaches, including Content and Language Integrated Learning (CLIL) and Task-based Language Teaching (TBLT) (Lessons use real-life military scenarios: briefings, reports, radio communication, etc.), and integration of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) tools. They aim to foster linguistic competence through skill development, both receptive and productive skills, reveal their areas for growth, and motivate them to pursue the language learning process. The advantage of CLIL is the simultaneous development of language skills and subject matter knowledge. By applying real-world scenarios, the learners acquire military-related linguistic knowledge along with covering military contents such as operations, international cooperation, logistics, etc (Richards&Rodgers,2014, p.116).

The use of ICT tools in military education leads to more access to authentic and tailored learning materials via mobile and computerized tools. The next issue to be crucially considered is a wide range of opportunities for access to excessive evidence-based data and delivery and transmission of knowledge in both learning and teaching. Advanced and increased applications of ICT intend to take additional advantage of creative and innovative research by using cost-effective simulation methods instead of laboratories and military simulations instead of field training exercises. Notably, ICT also enables Computer Adaptive Testing (CAT) which is an innovative and efficient assessment by tailoring the difficulty of the questions according to the learners' apparent level of ability. Being a modern and time-saving evaluation technique CAT provides immediate feedback, and precise, individualized, and adaptive measurement of ability (Hughes ,2020, p. 23).

In light of the internalization that widens the scope of the teaching and learning process, universities are expected to consider the importance, validity, and reliability of testing in teaching and the student's performance according to the test requirements. Teaching and testing are interconnected and have two-sided impacts by playing a triggering role in each other's effectiveness. Testing is following the teaching, supporting, and taking corrective and beneficial measures and influence in the areas needed (Hughes,2020, p. 2). The close relationship between them provides effective feedback, and the tangible outcome of the language course participation while teaching can contribute to the improvement of testing according to the learners' evolving needs and teaching objectives. Meanwhile, another essential role of testing is making the teaching staff reflect on the curriculum and refine the teaching methods and resources through intensive teacher training programs for sustainable capacity-building.

Testing proficiency levels of the language according to the BILC standards specifically refers to two principles: validity (consistency and accuracy) and reliability (consistency). According to Hughes, the test is valid if it measures accurately what it is intended to measure. A valid test means that its result is supposed to be credible and trusted data of the learners' knowledge and linguistic competencies (Hughes,2020, p. 26). The author emphasizes that the test reliability is higher if it yields the same results and provides consistent data at different times with the same groups. Interestingly, a test can be reliable, but not valid. However, since reliability is a component of validity, a valid test must be reliable (Hughes,2020, p.50).

Methodology and Materials

This study employs a literature review of different sources related to the topic and uses observation methods to obtain broader and more comprehensive information about the research problem. The materials used in preparing this article include academic books, scientific journal

articles, military education studies, research reports, and publications related to language teaching methodologies, intercultural communication, and military interoperability.

Discussion

The findings of this thesis depict that student-centered teaching methods and effective assessment practices play a significant role in improving the quality of Military English (ME) education. The study highlights that modern language teaching intends to limit traditional teacher-centered approaches, by illustrating the importance of active student participation, interaction, and practical language use. The development of communication skills, critical thinking, and learner autonomy and other 21st century skills are of paramount importance.

The research also emphasizes that assessment is a key component of the teaching and learning process. Testing not only measures students' academic performance, but also provides information about the effectiveness of instructional methods and learning outcomes. However, the study reveals that poorly designed or improperly administered tests may reduce reliability and validity and can negatively affect students' motivation and learning process. Therefore, assessment methods should be aligned with educational objectives, curriculum content, and teaching strategies.

Furthermore, the thesis underlines the growing importance of modern assessment techniques in contemporary education. Innovative assessment practices encourage continuous learning, increase student engagement, and support fair evaluation. In military education contexts, effective assessment and language instruction are particularly important for developing communication, cooperation, and interoperability skills. Overall, the study confirms that the integration of student-centered teaching approaches with reliable and goal-oriented assessment methods can strengthen the overall educational experience and improve the effectiveness of Military English teaching.

Conclusion

To sum up, the thesis aims to emphasize improving teaching ME through student-centered methods, and the significance of testing in assessing and evaluating the intended learning outcomes. All the stakeholders in the education system highly appreciate testing as a tool for making fair and reliable decisions by interacting more and integrating with learning and teaching objectives. However, the best test may be unreliable and have invalid results if it is administered badly and may have a negative backwash. So, the test design process needs to consider the alignment of assessment with the educational goals and teaching methods to strengthen the overall educational experience. Equally important to effective language teaching, the thesis depicts the significance of modern assessment techniques as a transformative tool to shape, enrich, and transform the educational landscape.

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THE ROLE OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND DIGITAL PLATFORMS IN LANGUAGE TESTING AND EVALUATION: A CRITICAL ANALYSIS

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Abstract: In recent times, the influence of artificial intelligence and digitalisation has become evident in every sphere of life. Therefore, the present age may more appropriately be described as the “AI-Digi Era” rather than merely the twenty-first century. Nevertheless, the field of education has consistently adapted to change, and the integration of technological progressions in any form remains both relevant and acceptable. This study focuses on the uncertain and concerning aspects of AI and digitalisation in online language proficiency testing tools, which may be unavoidable under certain circumstances, particularly in relation to higher studies, employment opportunities, and similar requirements. However, the concerns associated with these tools remain considerably high. Accordingly, this study examines the major issues involved, the areas that require attention, and the possible measures to address such concerns. The data is collected by questionnaire-survey method from 100 candidates aged 22- 35 who have attended the online language proficiency test during the period 2024-2025. The approach for the current study considered both quantitative and qualitative. The findings suggest that immediate responses and actions are necessary to address the issues and facilitate the possible measures to tackle the concerns.

Key words: Artificial Intelligence (AI), Digital Platforms, Language Testing and Evaluation, Data Security, Ethical concerns

भाषा परीक्षण और मूल्यांकन में आधिकारिक खुफिया और डिजिटल प्लेटफार्मों की भूमिका: एक आलोचनात्मक विश्लेषण

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सार: हाल के दिनों में, कलात्मक बुद्धिमत्ता और डिजिटलीकरण का प्रभाव जीवन के हर क्षेत्र में स्पष्ट हो गया है। इसलिए, वर्तमान युग को केवल इक्कीसवीं सदी के बजाय अधिक आनुपातिक रूप से “एआई-डिजी युग” के रूप में वर्णित किया जा सकता है। फिर भी, शिक्षा का क्षेत्र लगातार परिवर्तन के अनुकूल बना हुआ है, और किसी भी रूप में तकनीकी प्रगति का एकीकरण प्रासंगिक और स्वीकार्य दोनों बना हुआ है। यह अध्ययन ऑनलाइन भाषा रोकथाम परीक्षण उपकरणों में एआई और डिजिटलीकरण के अनिश्चित और चिंताजनक पहलुओं पर केंद्रित है, जो कुछ प्रचलनों के तहत अपरिहार्य हो सकते हैं, आंशिक रूप से उच्च अध्ययन, रोजगार के अवसरों और इसी तरह की आवश्यकताओं के संबंध में। हालाँकि, इन उपकरणों से जुड़ी चिंताएँ लगातार उच्च बनी हुई हैं। तदनुसार, यह अध्ययन इसमें शामिल प्रमुख मुद्दों, ध्यान देने योग्य क्षेत्रों

तथा ऐसी चिंताओं के समाधान के संभावित उपायों की जांच करता है। यह डेटा प्रश्रवली-सर्वेक्षण पद्धति द्वारा 22-35 वर्ष की आयु के 100 उम्मीदवारों से एकत्र किया गया है, जिन्होंने 2024-2025 की अवधि के दौरान ऑनलाइन भाषा रोकथाम परीक्षण में भाग लिया है। वर्तमान अध्ययन के दृष्टिकोण में मात्रात्मक और गुणात्मक दोनों पर विचार किया गया। निष्कर्ष बताते हैं कि मुद्दों के समाधान तथा चिंताओं से निपटने के लिए संभावित उपायों को सुगम बनाने के लिए महत्वपूर्ण प्रतिक्रियाएं और कार्रवाई आवश्यक हैं।

कीवर्ड: आर्टिफिशियल इंटेलिजेंस (एआई), डिजिटल प्लेटफॉर्म, भाषा परीक्षण और मूल्यांकन, डेटा सुरक्षा, नैतिक चिंताएं.

Introduction

Language proficiency is the ability to use a language effectively and appropriately across different contexts, encompassing skills in listening, speaking, reading, and writing, in addition to grammatical, sociolinguistic, and pragmatic competence. According to Lye F. Bachman (1990), it involves both grammatical and textual knowledge and the ability to use language meaningfully in context. The integration of artificial intelligence (AI) into language testing and evaluation marks a transformative shift in the evaluation of linguistic capabilities. AI-driven tools offer unparalleled precision, personalization, and innovative assessment methods, revolutionizing the accuracy and adaptability of language assessment. Through advanced algorithms and tailored approaches, AI ensures precise skill evaluation, customizes testing, and individualizes improvement strategies, promising a more effective language learning experience (Lazar & Elena, 2024). However, ethical implications have become a serious concern and challenge among examinees, raising questions about validity, reliability, and equity (Bachman & Adrian, 2022; Chapelle, 2012; O'Sullivan, 2023; Kamalova, 2026). This study examines (1) the extent to which AI-based language proficiency tests significantly influence candidates' opportunities that lead to holistic development; (2) the degree of privacy or ethical concerns among candidates; (3) whether they require immediate interventions for solutions; and (4) the level of awareness of ethical aspects on reducing concerns.

Materials and Methods

To address these research questions, this section outlines the materials and methods used for this study. The data were collected from 100 candidates who attended an online language proficiency test during 2024-2025. The participants were aged between 22 and 35, graduates, employees seeking higher education opportunities and promotions in their professional lives. Data were collected using a questionnaire survey method. Both qualitative and quantitative data were considered for this study. Specifically, qualitative data provided discernment into the research questions, while quantitative data critically analysed and supported the qualitative aspects of the study. This study was free of gender bias. Notably, this study was free of gender bias. Instead of categorising by gender, the analysis focused on each candidate, emphasising those in a necessary situation and their priorities for overcoming challenges to secure better opportunities. However, this is also one of the limitations of the study. This study analysis centered on concepts, attitudes, and concerns of the candidates and the results were summarised accordingly.

Results and Discussion

The questionnaire primarily addressed the key concerns encountered by candidates during their online language proficiency tests. These concerns are categorized into four main areas: privacy and security, fairness and bias, technical reliability, and awareness and ethics.

Table 1. Major Concerns and Responses of Candidates Who Attended Online Language Proficiency Tests (LPTs) 2024-2025

Major Concerns		Responses		
		Positive	Negative	Moderate
Privacy & Security	Data Privacy	64	16	20
	Identity Theft	56	20	24
	Misuse by Third Parties	90	4	6
	Lack of Transparency	62	25	13
	Data Breaches / Hacking	72	54	24
Fairness & Bias	Algorithmic Bias	22	0	78
	Unfair Scoring	74	0	26
	Lack of Human Intervention	66	0	34
Technical Reliability	Technical Glitches	15	17	68
	Reliability of AI Systems	54	10	36
	Cost of AI-Based Tests	76	0	24
Awareness & Ethics	Limited Awareness of Rights	63	0	37
	Accessibility of Regulations	23	26	51
	Deepfake / Fraud Risks	92	0	8
	Psychological Stress	72	8	20
	Knowledge of Ethical concerns	66	21	13

Note: Responses collected from 100 candidates who attended language proficiency tests 2024-2025

Table 1 highlights the candidates' responses based on their experiences and perceptions. Some challenges are clearly understood, which represents that lack of conceptual awareness causes uncertainty as well as the tendency to accept, normalise or tolerate the situations that the candidates currently exist. The following figure illustrates the dominance of the responses over risks that seek strong attention.



Figure 1 : Major Responses of Candidates in Online Language Proficiency Test 2024-2025 (in %)

The bar chart illustrates the percentage of candidates who attended AI - based online language proficiency tests from 2024 to 2025. The data clearly represents a pattern of major concern for candidates. The highest level of concern can be seen in deepfakes, or fraud risks (92%), followed by misuse by third parties (90%), which reflects the substantial informedness of technology. The

implication related to fairness and bias depicts (74%) unfair scoring and suggests a preference for human intervention. However, the domains like algorithmic bias (78%) and the technical glitches (68%) indicate deep concern about the awareness over the understanding of the candidates, whereas the financial implication (76%) of AI- LPT and the psychological stress (72%) validated the complexities faced by the candidates. Nevertheless, certain inconsistencies, for instance, a high negative response for data breaches (54%) pointed out the varied perceptions or experiences among respondents. The study identified that, while candidates are deeply concerned about data privacy, ethical risks, fairness, cost of tests, there is an observable deficit in awareness and clarity over the compliance framework or dimensions.

Conclusion

The data suggest and support the importance of human intervention in approaches, transparent frameworks, and standard guiding principles that integrate with AI-based language proficiency test portals. AI and digitalisation undermine the transformation that promotes faster development and stability. However, it is better to choose rather than impose, in order to foster development among beneficiaries. Though the sample size is limited in this study, the data clearly highlight the necessity to critically investigate further. Collectively, candidates' concerns over validity, fairness, interpretability, awareness, and ethics lead to immediate action towards the proposal of regulatory frameworks that should prioritise candidate data privacy and unbiased results. The language proficiency portals are acts a bridge towards career opportunities along exists legally binded regulatories without proper binding. It is necessary to intiaite a establish a global or national body to take responsibility for these insecurities and challenges and enforce transparency rules that would reduce the risks and avoid bias and sustain fairness, equity and reliability.

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INTEGRATION OF LITERATURE INTO A FOREIGN LANGUAGE: LINGUDIDACTIC AND CULTURAL ASPECTS

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Abstract: This article analyzes the issues of integrating fiction into foreign language teaching from a linguodidactic and culturological perspective. The role of fiction texts in the development of communicative, cultural and interpretative skills of language learners is examined in detail. It is emphasized that literary texts not only enrich vocabulary and grammatical competence but also contribute to deeper cultural awareness and critical thinking. At the same time, the methodological foundations and practical application of using fiction in the teaching process are demonstrated through relevant examples. Special attention is paid to the selection of appropriate texts, adaptation strategies and interactive teaching techniques. The study also highlights how fiction can enhance learners' motivation and engagement, making the language learning process more meaningful, dynamic and contextually rich.

Key words: fiction, foreign language teaching, linguodidactics, intercultural communication, interpretation

ƏDƏBİYYATIN XARİCİ DİLƏ İNTEQRASIYASI: LİŊVODİDAKTİK VƏ MƏDƏNİ ASPEKTLƏR

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Xülasə: Bu məqalədə bədii ədəbiyyatın xarici dil tədrisinə inteqrasiyası məsələləri linqvodidaktik və kulturoloji baxımdan təhlil edilir. Bədii ədəbiyyat mətnlərinin dil öyrənmələrin ünsiyyət, mədəni və interpretativ bacarıqlarının inkişafındakı rolu ətraflı araşdırılır. Ədəbi mətnlərin yalnız lüğət və qrammatik bacarıqları zənginləşdirməklə yanaşı, həm də daha dərin mədəni şüur və tənqidi düşüncəyə töhfə verdiyi vurğulanır. Eyni zamanda, tədris prosesində bədii ədəbiyyatdan istifadənin metodoloji əsasları və praktik tətbiqi müvafiq nümunələr vasitəsilə nümayiş etdirilir. Müvafiq mətnlərin seçilməsinə, uyğunlaşma strategiyalarına və interaktiv tədris texnikalarına xüsusi diqqət yetirilir. Tədqiqatda həmçinin bədii ədəbiyyatın öyrənmələrin motivasiyasını və cəlb olunmasını necə artırma biləcəyi, dil öyrənmə prosesini daha mənalı, dinamik və kontekst baxımından zəngin edə biləcəyi vurğulanır.

Açar sözlər: bədii ədəbiyyat, xarici dil tədrisi, linqvodidaktika, mədəniyyətlərarası ünsiyyət, interpretasiya

Introduction

Reading literature comprehensively develops the basic language skills of learners. It increases reading skills, strengthens the understanding of complex texts, and also enriches writing skills, style and expression. It develops listening and speaking through discussions and interpretation. Studies show that fiction texts increase students' vocabulary and help them master language structures in context (Lazar, 1993, pp. 17– 25). Language is not only a means of communication, but also a carrier of culture. Through literature, learners learn about the lifestyle, values, and worldview of the people. In this regard, literature develops intercultural communication (Kramsch, 1993, pp. 10–12). Fictional texts force the reader to think, analyze and form different points of view. Here, the behavior of characters is analyzed and events are evaluated from different aspects. This process

strengthens interpretive skills (Ricoeur, 1976, pp. 45–50). Literature makes the learning process more interesting and engaging. The plot, images, and emotional impact increase the attention of learners and also create internal motivation to learn the language. Collie and Slater note that literature creates emotional involvement in language learners, which can make learning more effective. Literature teaches not only the functional but also the aesthetic side of language. Metaphors, symbols, and artistic means of expression play an important role in this process (Widdowson, 1975, pp. 22–30).

Literature should not be regarded merely as supplementary material in foreign language instruction; rather, it functions as one of the principal instruments for achieving deep and multidimensional language proficiency. Literary texts embody authentic language use, reflecting its stylistic richness, emotional subtleties and cultural embeddedness. For this reason, they create a linguistically and culturally enriched environment in which learners are exposed to natural discourse patterns and diverse expressive forms. Such exposure facilitates not only linguistic development but also the formation of interpretative and analytical competencies.

In the context of globalization, foreign language learning extends beyond the acquisition of grammatical structures and lexical units; it necessitates an understanding of the cultural, aesthetic and cognitive frameworks that shape language use. From this perspective, fiction occupies a central place in contemporary language pedagogy. As noted by Kramsch (1993), literary texts provide learners with a contextualized and meaningful language experience by illustrating how language operates within specific socio-cultural settings. Fiction thus serves as a source of authentic material, enabling learners to internalize not only structural patterns but also stylistic variation and pragmatic meaning.

Furthermore, as Lazar emphasizes, engagement with literary texts contributes to vocabulary expansion, enhances reading comprehension, and fosters critical thinking skills. Collie and Slater (p. 36) similarly argue that literature increases learner motivation and promotes emotional engagement with the target language, thereby strengthening the overall learning process. Methodologically, the integration of fiction into language teaching can be approached through interactive and communicative frameworks, where texts become a basis for discussion, interpretation and personal response. Students analyze characters, evaluate narrative developments, and articulate their own perspectives, which in turn enhances both linguistic competence and cognitive flexibility.

From a hermeneutic standpoint, particularly in line with Ricoeur's theory, a literary text is not merely decoded but actively interpreted, allowing learners to construct meaning through engagement with multiple layers of discourse. Additionally, the inseparability of language and culture, as highlighted by Kramsch, underscores the role of literature in transmitting cultural codes, symbols and values. Consequently, the selection of literary texts for instructional purposes should be guided by criteria such as linguistic accessibility, cultural relevance, thematic appropriateness, and pedagogical value, ensuring that texts effectively support both language acquisition and intercultural competence.

1. Relevance to the language level
2. Relevance of the content
3. Cultural value
4. Didactic potential

Texts selected without taking these criteria into account can reduce the effectiveness of the teaching process (Duff & Maley, 1990, p.49). The following methods are considered effective for using literary texts in teaching:

1. Role-playing: bringing characters to life,
2. Discussion: discussing the ideas and themes of the text
3. Writing tasks: writing alternative endings

These methods develop both students' language and creative skills.

Conclusion

The integration of fiction into foreign language teaching makes the language learning process more effective and interesting. This approach develops not only language knowledge, but also cultural awareness and interpretive skills. The use of fiction texts acts as an important and necessary component in the modern education system. Literature is an integral part of language learning. It not only develops language skills, but also forms cultural awareness, critical thinking and aesthetic taste in learners. The integration of literature in modern language teaching makes the learning process more effective, interesting and profound.

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TEACHING VOCABULARY THROUGH CONTEXTUAL GUESSING STRATEGIES

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Abstract: This article examines the comprehensive role of contextual vocabulary acquisition in teaching English in the modern education system. The main purpose of the study is to identify effective methods for acquiring vocabulary in English through contextual prediction and analyze its significance in improving students' language skills. The article presents modern approaches such as text-based methods, communicative methods, task-based learning, and the use of digital educational resources. The study used

pedagogical analysis, theoretical concepts, and comparative research. In general, it was found that contextual prediction vocabulary acquisition is effective in improving students' speaking, listening, reading, and writing skills.

Key words: Teaching vocabulary, strategy, pedagogical scaffolding, context, reading comprehension, guessing from context.

BAĞLAM DAN TAHMİN ETME STRATEJİLERİ YOLUYLA KELİME ÖĞRETİMİ

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Özet: Bu makale, modern eğitim sisteminde İngilizce öğretiminde bağlamsal kelime ediniminin kapsamlı rolünü incelemektedir. Çalışmanın temel amacı bağlamsal tahmin yoluyla İngilizce kelime edinimi için etkili yöntemleri belirlemek ve öğrencilerin dil becerilerini geliştirmedeki önemini analiz etmektir. Makale, metin tabanlı yöntemler, iletişimsel yöntemler görev tabanlı öğrenme ve dijital eğitim kaynaklarının kullanımı gibi modern yaklaşımları sunmaktadır. Çalışmada pedagojik analiz, teorik kavramlar ve karşılaştırmalı araştırma kullanılmıştır. Genel olarak, bağlamsal tahmin yoluyla kelime ediniminin öğrencilerin konuşma, dinleme, okuma ve yazma becerilerini geliştirmede etkili olduğu bulunmuştur.

Anahtar kelimeler: Kelime öğretimi, strateji, pedagojik destek, bağlam, okuma anlama, bağlamdan tahmin etme.

Introduction

Teaching vocabulary has always been one of the most crucial components of language development, as it lays the foundation for communication and supports all four language skills: reading, writing, listening and speaking. David Wilkins (1972) stated that "Without grammar very little can be conveyed, without vocabulary nothing can be conveyed", this suggests that with the richness of vocabulary, there is a way to articulate any knowledge accurately and precisely. Understanding texts, expressing themselves clearly or taking part in conversations confidently may have been arduous without sufficient vocabulary for students. Vocabulary was considered secondary to grammar at the initial stage of linguistic development. By using context-based tasks students learn to recognize written words and use them to construct sentences or translate texts by memorizing translations, which improves their memory and helps them to learn to use them.

Vocabulary learning requires both short-term and long-term memory and mostly L2 learners fail to recall soon after coming across them. Encountering vocabulary in context, learners occasionally struggle to determine their meaning. This issue is particularly widespread when vocabulary is learned through rote memorization rather than authentic context. As Schmitt (2008) argues vocabulary learned through vocabulary items presented out of context is significantly arduous to memorize than vocabulary encountered in real-life contexts and Webb (2007) similarly

highlights that continued interaction with context greatly enhances memory retention and active use. Another challenge is word ambiguity and multiple meanings. Many words in a language have semantic variations depending on context. For example, the English word “run” can mean to move quickly, to manage something (run a business) or to operate (the machine runs smoothly). L2 learners may understand one meaning but fail to identify others, which limits their comprehension. It agrees with studies on lexical meaning growth and polysemy that highlight the essentiality of learning through context. Similarly, distinguishing between synonyms such as “fast”, “quick” and “rapid” requires awareness of connotative meaning and that often flourishes only through repeated exposure. Use in context also creates difficulties. Knowing a word’s meaning does not ensure the ability to use it appropriately in a sentence. Learners may use words in grammatically correct but unnatural combinations because they are not aware of collocations or idiomatic expressions. For instance, English speakers say “do homework” but not “make homework”.

One of the most effective ways to comprehend unfamiliar words is contextual guessing. Since students often encounter unknown vocabulary when learning a second or foreign language, inferencing from context is a cognitive and metacognitive strategy that permits students to infer the meaning of words using definitions and their own knowledge, without relying on dictionaries or direct translations. In linguistic didactics, guessing from context is currently considered a key strategy for reading fluency, vocabulary acquisition and students’ self-development. In previous studies, contextual word-meaning inference is the use of information of the context to determine the meaning of a word by looking at how it is used in a sentence, rather than looking it up in a dictionary. The learner relies on grammatical structure, meaning, surrounding words and background knowledge to make a reasoned guess. (Nassaji, 2024) For making inferences is not a random guess. It is a strategic, problem-solving activity that requires attention, analysis and evaluation. The more information available in a text, the more likely it is to confirm the predicted meaning and to understand the text.

Most students can guess between 60-80% of unknown words. However, the number and density of unfamiliar words in a text should not be too high. The frequency of occurrence of words, the variety of context and their significance will have an impact. Nation and Coady (2014) suggest a five-step procedure in their research. The first two steps of the process are based on the word and immediate context. Immediate context connects students to sources of information they are capable of finding. In addition, they take into account any related vocabulary, as well as their background knowledge. Punctuation marks such as quotation marks, dashes or parentheses can be clarified with reference to their occurrence in the text. Employing the broader context is carried out in Step 3. Sentences and subordinate clauses in a text are connected to each other in different ways. These relationships are represented causality (because, so, therefore), contrast (but, however, on the other hand), generality (usually, generally, most) and specificity (for example, namely, in particular), elaboration (in other words, that is, because), time (before, after, meanwhile) and arrangement (firstly, in the second place, next). These textual relationships identify logical connections between ideas, serving as clear cues that guide students in recognizing these connections. In the fourth step, students use all the clues from the previous steps to guess the meaning of the words. As a final step, after students have guessed the meaning of an unknown word using context clues, it is crucial to verify the answer. Learners can determine whether their guess is accurate or inaccurate by substituting the unfamiliar word in the sentence with their guess. Access to dictionary is permitted after guessing to confirm If it corresponds with the sentence meaning without changing.

We can use several methods in these approaches: Brainstorming makes predictions through words and ideas related to the topic. The following mind maps help create associations related to the topic and organize their thoughts. In Word-part puzzle task, teacher gives words with morphological cues. Students should define suffixes and prefixes of words. For instance, the word “unforgettable” can be broken down into three parts. The prefix is “un”, which means “not”. The root is “forget”. The suffix is “-able”, which means “able to be”. Combining them, “unacceptable” means “not able to be forgotten”. In the “Contextual Gap” activity, students practice making inferences using multiple contexts. First, the teacher presents three sentences with the same unknown word. The students combine information from all the sentences and determine their meaning. As an illustration, she trembled with fear while watching a scary movie. Her bottom lip trembled, and tears fell down her cheeks. His hands trembled in the cold weather. Students should figure out the meaning of the word “tremble”, which is “to shake slightly from fear, nervousness or cold”. Using the Fill-in-the-Blank prediction method, the student inserts possible words into the blanks in the text. Most importantly, in the Word Storm method, students are divided into groups and given one minute to write as many words as possible related to the topic. (Carter and McCarthy, 2014; Nunan and David, 1999) Moving on to the next activity, in the “Hunt the misfits” encourages students to figure out why a word doesn’t belong. The process requires 20-25 minutes. Moreover, each student is given a copy of the original text and a modifies text. Some words in it have been changed to misrepresent the meaning. However, they are not told that the changes have been made. As they read both texts, students identify the errors in the texts and find it in the text. In this way, teachers ask them to make corrections, which increases critical understanding. The next activity is “Ghost definitions” where teacher select a text, underline a few words and phrases and at the bottom of the text 10 definitions have been written with 3 words that are not in the text, but are relevant to the text. Students are requested to match underlined words with the definitions and exchange their answer sheets and discuss their responses with classmates. The next activity “The words in your past” is used to enhance students’ comprehension skills and remember new vocabulary by linking it to important memories in their lives. The text is adjusted to align with the students’ experiences. Hand out copies of the text and ask students to choose up 7 words and think of a time when these words might be related to their past. Subsequently, students engage in discussion and practice using newly learned vocabulary. The value of reading authentic texts supports students see reading as a purposeful activity. Engaging in creative tasks encourage students to discuss, explore and reinterpret the text, strengthening their understanding. (Grabe and Stoller, 2013; Harvey et al., 2007)

Liu and Nation conducted a study to investigate the factors that influence students’ ability to predict the meaning of unfamiliar vocabulary from context. As evidenced in Table 1, the researchers concentrated on key factors such as the density of unfamiliar words in the text, the part of speech of the target words and the students’ proficiency level. They first divided the participants into two groups based on their level of competence. In the study, two sets of passages were used: each set consisted of a short passage and a longer passage. In the short passage, unfamiliar words were replaced with nonsense words that were similar in length and structure. About 1 in 10 words were substituted. The same method was used in the long passage. The result of the study illustrated that students performed better when the density of unfamiliar words in the texts was low, suggesting that an excessive number of unfamiliar words hindered their ability to predict. Students needed to use texts with a very large amount of text and no more than 5-10 new words. Advanced students were able to guess 85-100% of unfamiliar terms, while less proficient students could only guess 30-

40%. In addition, students' capabilities also had an impact on guessing. The study highlighted the significance of students' proficiency, the complexity and extent of the context in vocabulary acquisition. Overall, it provides empirically grounded insights into how students can cultivate strategies for comprehending word meanings. (Na and Nation, 1985)

Table 1. Impact of Text Density on Vocabulary Guessing from Context

Text Complexity	Familiar to unfamiliar	Guess Accuracy
Low density	Few unknown words in the text (1 unknown per 25 words)	Higher guess success (85-100%)
High density	Many unknown words in the text (1 unknown per 10 words)	Lower guess success (30-40%)

Method

A total of twenty-seven pre-intermediate level students (14 males and 13 females) participated in this study who were studying English as a foreign language in high school. The research was carried out over a three-month period in English classes at school which were three sessions per week. The note taking, observation, questionnaires and tests were used to collect the data.

In our school textbooks, students are generally introduced to materials that have been modified in terms of vocabulary and grammatical structures to correspond to their language proficiency.

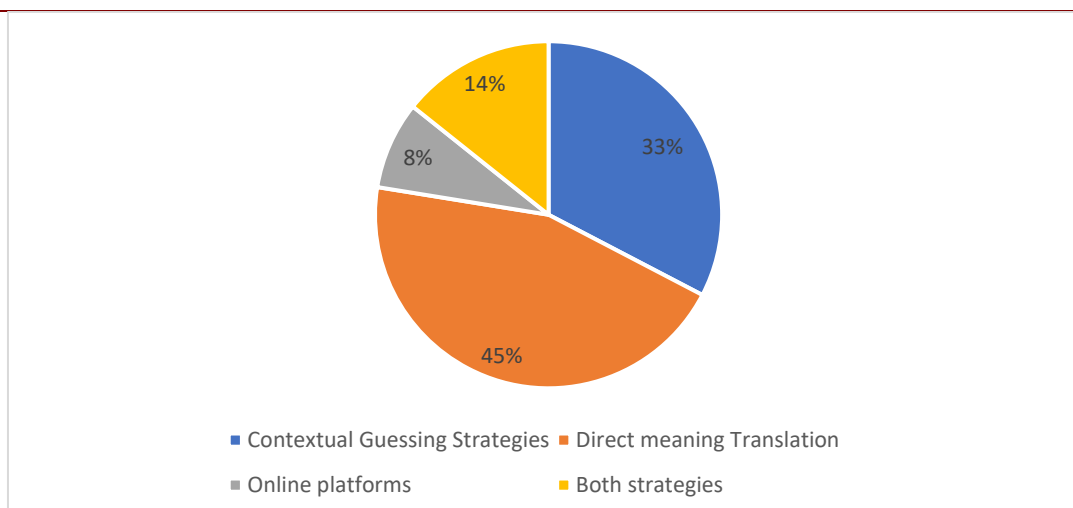
Pre-test and post-test had been administered to both the experimental and control groups. Considering the students' proficiency level, reading texts were selected according to their knowledge and used in regular classroom lessons. The teacher gave the same 1 text, new words and test questions to students. They were allotted 15 minutes to read the text and identify the new words found in the text.

A survey was conducted to find out the attitudes towards vocabulary acquisition through context and direct translation vocabulary memorization in language learning. The survey measured students' attitudes, habits and perceptions, examined whether they paid particular attention to vocabulary acquisition. Understanding these preferences is essential for teachers and researchers in order to design effective vocabulary training programs that address the needs of specific students. It assessed how much students use technology to learn a language, how they think about context-based vocabulary learning tools and whether they perceive traditional vocabulary learning as more effective. It also explored possible reasons why students may not incorporate methods into their learning habits.

Result and Discussion

As shown in Chart 1, students were asked through open-ended questions, whether they preferred to learn vocabulary through contextual materials or through isolated word lists such as flashcards and games. 45 % shared that they used individual word memorization. 33 % of students said they used context-based vocabulary learning because it helped them understand how words work in sentences and real-life situations. Contextual learning supports deeper understanding, strengthens long-term memory, and makes vocabulary meaningful rather than abstract. These different choices indicate that vocabulary learning styles vary among students, depending on cognitive style, learning level, and personal comfort level. 14 % said they used both methods according to their comfort level. 8 % said they enriched their vocabulary by using online tasks and games.

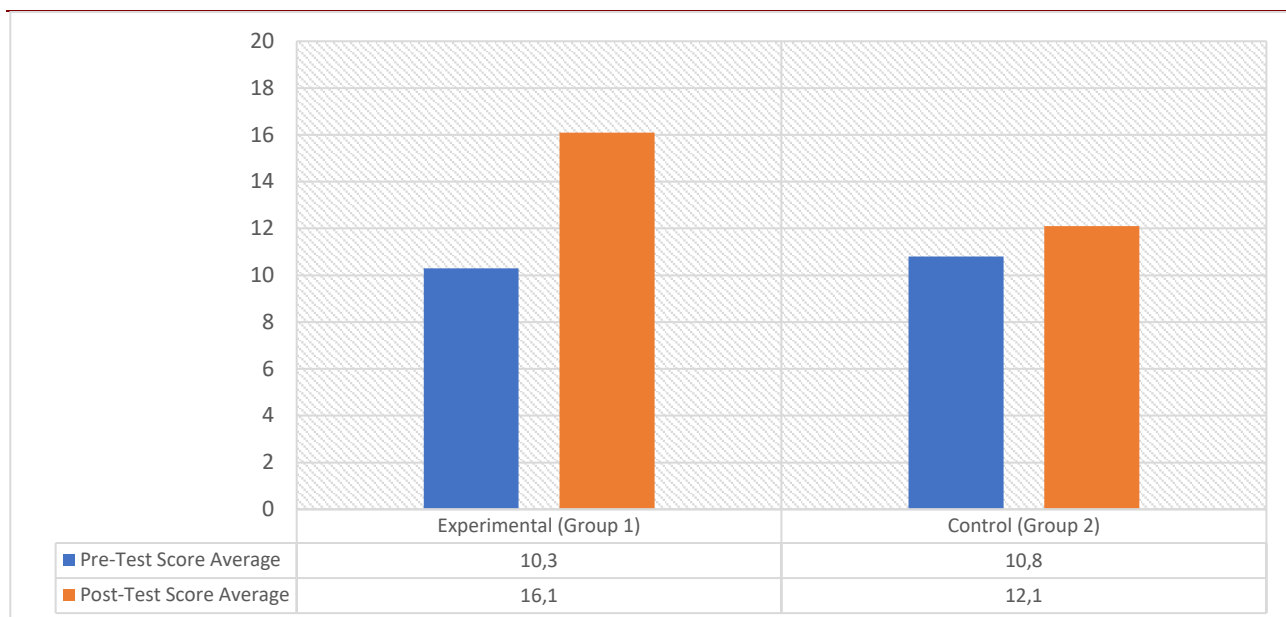
Chart 1. Students' Preferred Learning Methods



During the 3-month research work, 1 text and tasks related to text were given during each lesson. All texts were prepared according to the textbook assigned to the class. Students were allotted 15 minutes for reading. The teacher prepared tasks that involved understanding the new vocabulary encountered and using different methods. Each lesson involved using a new strategy for individual tasks. It had a profound impact to adapt to the teaching and learning methods during the learners' cognitive development process. Teachers played a guiding role in helping students read the text, concentrated on meaning and overcome language difficulties.

According to Table 1, the outcomes of the pre-test reveal an average result, which were 10,3 points in the experimental groups and 10,8 points in the control groups, showed that both groups had moderately low scores on vocabulary and reading comprehension. As shown in Diagram 1, students in the experimental group who were trained in contextual guessing strategies demonstrated an increase in vocabulary comprehension. Their post-test results were significantly higher than their pre-test results. This indicates the effectiveness of strategy-based instruction. In contrast, the control group showed a lower increase in their post-test results. The results of both groups confirm that the use of contextual guessing strategies had a positive and influential effect on vocabulary acquisition. The initial results for both groups were around the midpoint of 50%. There was a noticeable difference in the final results, with the experimental group showing an 80,5% success rate, verifying that teaching vocabulary through context guessing strategies is an effective and reliable way to learn vocabulary. The control group, while relatively low, illustrated an escalation of 5% (60,5%) from the previous results.

Diagram 1. Pre-test and Post-test Results of Experimental and Control Groups



Vocabulary growth was measured by recognizing target words in context, contextual inference accuracy and correct vocabulary use. Classroom observations revealed that students were more confident in using newly learned vocabulary in speaking and writing activities. Student engagement was also increased by using strategies. In the following weeks, most students began to actively use contextual guessing strategies. They marked unknown words, noted possible meanings, provided evidence and discussed explanations. This structured approach improved vocabulary acquisition and students began to rely more on their own reasoning and developed independent reading skills.

Traditional vocabulary teaching methods were often based on rote memorization, word lists and repetitive exercises, which did not contribute to long-term memory. In contrast, contextual inference allowed students to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words independently by using the linguistic, semantic and situational context. In this way, they did not only enlarge their vocabulary, but also enhanced their critical thinking and metacognitive skills. It encouraged students to interpret texts actively, apply their prior knowledge and be involved in learning experiences such as reasoning about word meanings. It contributed to a deeper understanding of both vocabulary and overall text interpretation.

Conclusion

As language develops and students become exposed to a variety of complex texts, contextual word-meaning inference becomes increasingly important in modern language classrooms. Students develop rich lexical repertoire and processing, proficiency increases. It allows them to guess meanings more accurately and with less effort. This progress reflects the nature of contextual word-meaning inference as a skill that cultivates through practice and exposure. However, successful learning depends on the accuracy of guessing and the richness of vocabulary. Therefore, cognitive activity during contextual guessing has a profound impact on vocabulary acquisition outcomes and students' competency to perform tasks that meet the requirements. Context-based deduction is a complex cognitive strategy that reflects the adaptive nature of human language processing. The conceptualization of these underlying mechanisms will not only deepen our understanding of language, but also have significant implications for language teaching and learning. Inferencing from context is a multifaceted activity that involves the interaction of reasoning, cognitive load

management, long-term memory, inference and executive control. These processes work together to support students to broaden their recognition and lexical knowledge in the face of unacquired lexical items.

Contextual meaning deduction was consistent with these principles because it required learners to engage with linguistic input actively, to identify semantic and syntactic information, to infer meaning from cues. Cognitive and metacognitive strategies provide a further elucidation of the processes facilitating successful inference. Future research and classroom innovations will carry on improving its use and the field of language teaching by exploring its application across different proficiency levels, text types and age groups, taking into account the specificity of the context. However, its core principle, along with good vocabulary acquisition in meaningful contexts, remains a perennial topic and requires further pedagogical investigation.

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THE IMPORTANCE OF USING THE COMMUNICATIVE METHOD IN TEACHING A FOREIGN LANGUAGE

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Abstract: The use of the communicative method in foreign language teaching is highly important because it approaches language as a practical means of communication rather than merely a system of grammatical rules. This method enables learners not only to acquire theoretical knowledge but also to apply the target language effectively in real-life situations. Through interactive activities, dialogues, discussions,

and information exchange, students develop greater confidence, improve their speaking and listening skills, and become more motivated to learn.

The communicative approach promotes the integrated development of the four fundamental language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. These skills are developed simultaneously and in relation to one another, allowing learners to understand and use the language more comprehensively. Another important advantage of this method is its practical orientation. Students are encouraged to use the target language for everyday purposes, such as communicating with others, obtaining information, expressing opinions, and solving problems. As a result, the learning process becomes more meaningful and closely connected with real communication.

The communicative method also creates a supportive learning environment in which mistakes are considered a natural part of language acquisition. This reduces students' fear of making errors and encourages them to participate more actively in classroom communication. Consequently, learners become more independent and confident language users.

In conclusion, the communicative method is an effective, practical, interactive, and modern approach to foreign language teaching. It contributes not only to the development of linguistic knowledge but also to the formation of communicative competence, enabling learners to use a foreign language successfully in academic, professional, and everyday contexts.

Keywords: communicative method, foreign language teaching, interactive learning, language skills, communication, motivation, communicative competence.

XARİCİ DİLİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ KOMMUNİKATİV METODDAN İSTİFADƏNİN ƏHƏMİYYƏTİ

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Xülasə: Xarici dilin tədrisində kommunikativ metodun istifadəsi çox vacibdir, çünki bu yanaşma dili real ünsiyyət vasitəsi kimi öyrədir. Bu metod şagird və tələbələrin yalnız qrammatik bilik əldə etməsinə deyil, dili praktik şəkildə istifadə etməsinə imkan yaradır. Dərslər interaktiv olur, danışıq bacarığı inkişaf edir və öyrənənlərin motivasiyası artır. Kommunikativ metod həmçinin dil bacarıqlarını (dinləmə, danışma, oxuma, yazma) birlikdə formalaşdırır və şagird və tələbələrin öz fikirlərini sərbəst ifadə etməsinə kömək edir. Nəticədə, onlar dili gündəlik həyatda effektiv şəkildə istifadə edə bilirlər. Bu metodun vacibliyi ilk növbədə onun praktik yönümlü olması ilə bağlıdır. Şagird və tələbələr müxtəlif real həyat situasiyalarında (məsələn, ünsiyyət qurmaq, məlumat almaq, fikrini bildirmək) dili tətbiq etməyi öyrənirlər. Bu isə onların yalnız biliyini deyil, bacarıqlarını da inkişaf etdirir.

Kommunikativ yanaşma xüsusilə danışıq və dinləmə bacarıqlarının inkişafında mühüm rol oynayır, çünki dərs zamanı şagirdlər aktiv şəkildə dialoqlarda iştirak edir, müzakirələr aparır və fikir mübadiləsi edirlər. Digər vacib cəhət isə dərs prosesinin interaktiv və maraqlı olmasıdır. Kommunikativ metod həmçinin dil bacarıqlarının inteqrasiyasını təmin edir. Dinləmə, danışma, oxuma və yazma bacarıqları bir-biri ilə əlaqəli şəkildə inkişaf etdirilir. Bunun nəticəsində dil öyrənənlər dili kompleks şəkildə mənimsəyir və müxtəlif situasiyalarda düzgün istifadə edə bilir. Bundan əlavə, bu yanaşma şagird və tələbələrin səhv etməsinə daha tolerant münasibət göstərir. Səhvlər öyrənmə prosesinin təbii hissəsi kimi qəbul olunur və bu da onların özlərini daha sərbəst ifadə etməsinə kömək edir. Belə bir mühitdə öyrənənlər daha az çəkinir və daha çox ünsiyyət qurmağa çalışırlar. Yekun olaraq deyə bilərik ki, kommunikativ metod xarici dilin öyrədilməsində effektiv, praktik və müasir yanaşmadır. Bu metod sayəsində şagird və tələbələr dili yalnız bilmir, həm də onu real həyatda uğurla istifadə edə bilirlər ki, bu da dil tədrisinin əsas məqsədidir.

Açar sözlər: kommunikativ, metod, yanaşma, interaktiv, baza, dil bacarıqları, motivasiya

Introduction

From the past to the present, various methods and approaches have been used in teaching foreign languages. The methods and approaches used in teaching foreign languages guide and structure the language learning process. Communication-based and experience-oriented methods promote effective language learning. Therefore, choosing the right methods and approaches is important while learning a language. Communicative English teaching is an approach that teaches language as a means of real communication, not just as a rule. This method develops students' language skills (speaking, listening, reading, writing) through interactive tasks, role-playing, and authentic materials, ensuring effective use of the language.

The aim of teaching English is to develop students' oral and written English skills, enabling them to communicate effectively in their future careers. This communication exchange will also contribute to the positive development of cross-border processes. Oral speech is one of the most important components in the process of teaching English as a foreign language, because oral speech allows a person to realize himself as a person. Possessing speech skills in a foreign language and using it correctly as a means of intercultural communication in the modern multicultural world creates very necessary conditions for students to socialize and assert themselves in life. Communicatively oriented oral speech training involves active interaction that ensures the successful learning of a foreign language by students in the learning process, creates special trust, and creates didactic relationships. The problem of oral speech is one of the most difficult issues in teaching English and is considered one of the most controversial issues in methodology. The teaching of foreign languages, especially the development of oral speech, is of particular importance in strengthening our country's relations with foreign countries. In order to correctly implement new goals, it is necessary to direct the direction of language teaching methodology to oral speech. (Abbasova, S. 2005). For these purposes, it is also appropriate to apply new methods of experimental work.

One of the main problems in the proper development of oral speech is the teaching of correct pronunciation habits. In order to develop oral speech in English, it is necessary to correctly determine the optimal language materials. There are some controversial points to start developing oral speech. Thus, one group of methodologists recommends starting with an introductory course in the development of oral speech, while the other group recommends writing, reading and oral speech in parallel. Naturally, the emergence of different ideas during the teaching of the same language has its impact on the correct solution of the issue.

During the teaching of oral speech, certain extralinguistic conditions must be created for language learners to be able to speak. This can include the situation, circumstances, age, and level of knowledge of the language learner. As many experts now note, the main goal of learning a foreign language is to acquire the ability to use language as a means of communication. But one of the main conditions is to involve active participation in the implementation of various tasks. One of the types of activity is discussion. Students participating in the discussion are offered to freely express their ideas. Əsədova, L. (2017). During this process, they are focused on the development of lexical units and grammatical structures.

When judging the types of speech activity (speaking, listening, reading, writing), it should be noted that their teaching should be communicative in nature - dialogue, monologues, writing letters of a domestic or business nature, role-playing games, etc. Measuring fluency in monologues and

dialogues raises both theoretical and methodological issues. At the theoretical level, the results of the current study raise the question of whether fluency represents the same structure in monologues as in dialogues. In dialogues, where speakers rely on each other to produce coherent speech, fluency is more important than speed, since it is very important for the interlocutors to pay attention to their speaking skills. Therefore, in order to ensure more fluent interaction with the interlocutor, it is necessary to make room for other factors, such as making fewer corrections and creating more pauses. (Ielmini, P. 2006). This can often be demonstrated by the meaning of conversations and other features of interactive discourse.

One of the most characteristic features of communicative language teaching is its systematic attention to the functional as well as structural aspects of language. This approach includes the teaching of four language skills in addition to grammar and vocabulary, which recognize the interdependence of language and communication. Many scientists and methodologists prefer monologue speech to the development of oral speech in the study of foreign languages, noting that if a student cannot say what he has read, then he has not yet understood. Speech should be considered the final stage of research. (Littlewood, W. 1991). Oral monologue is psychologically close to written speech. It is determined by the expression of this idea. The student searches for an idea in his mind and is able to translate it into writing. Dialogic speech also has a positive effect on the development of oral speech, because the question asked is answered by listening and participating in the dialogue.

The use of the communicative method in teaching a foreign language is no longer just an option, but almost a necessity. While traditional approaches (memorizing grammar rules, translation-based lessons) create a sense of “knowing” the language, they often do not form the ability to use it in real communication. (Məmmədşadə. M. 2005).

Methods and Materials

The present study uses a descriptive and analytical approach to examine the importance of the communicative method in foreign language teaching. The research is based on the analysis of methodological and theoretical literature related to foreign language teaching, communicative competence, oral speech development, and modern teaching methods.

The theoretical framework of the study is based on the works of researchers such as Abbasova (2005), Əşədova (2017), Ielmini (2006), Littlewood (1991), Məmmədşadə (2005), and Nunan (1991). These sources provide theoretical and methodological perspectives on communicative language teaching and the development of speaking skills.

The study focuses particularly on the development of the four basic language skills: speaking, listening, reading, and writing. Different communicative activities, including dialogues, discussions, role-playing, information exchange, monologues, and authentic communication tasks, are considered as effective tools for developing these skills.

The analysis also takes into consideration the importance of creating appropriate extralinguistic conditions for language learners. These conditions include the communication situation, circumstances, learners' age, and their level of language proficiency.

The research further examines the role of active student participation in the learning process. Particular attention is given to discussion activities, interactive tasks, role-playing and other forms of classroom communication that encourage learners to express their ideas freely and apply vocabulary and grammatical structures in meaningful contexts.

Discussion

The communicative method teaches language as a means, not as a goal – that is, the main focus is on communication. The importance of this method can be explained by several key points: Firstly, it is real-life oriented. The student learns to use the language in everyday situations (for example, shopping, traveling, dating). This increases the practical value of the knowledge learned. Secondly, it develops speaking skills. In the communicative method, students actively participate, establish dialogues, and exchange ideas. As a result, passive knowledge turns into active skills. Thirdly, it increases motivation. Lessons become more interactive and interesting (role-playing games, discussions, group work, etc.), which increases the interest of learners in the lesson and accelerates the learning process. Fourthly, it integrates all language skills. Listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills are developed together, not separately. Fifthly, it changes the approach to errors. In the communicative method, making mistakes is taken for granted and is valued as part of the learning process. This helps learners express themselves more freely.

The communicative method ensures not only theoretical, but also practical mastery of the language. In the modern world, knowing a language means being able to use it effectively in real communication. Therefore, the application of the communicative method is of great importance in foreign language teaching. The use of the communicative method in teaching a foreign language is no longer just an option, but almost a necessity. While traditional approaches (memorizing grammar rules, translation-based lessons) create a sense of “knowing” the language, they often do not form the ability to use it in real communication. The communicative method teaches language as a means, not as a goal – that is, the main focus is on communication. The importance of this method can be explained by several key points:

Firstly, it is real-life oriented. The student learns to use the language in everyday situations (for example, shopping, traveling, dating). This also increases the practical value of the knowledge learned. Secondly, it develops speaking skills. In the communicative method, students actively participate, establish dialogues, and exchange ideas. As a result, passive knowledge turns into active skills. Thirdly, it increases motivation. Lessons become more interactive and interesting (role-playing games, discussions, group work, etc.), which increases the interest of learners in the lesson and accelerates the learning process. Fourthly, it integrates all language skills. Listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills are developed together, not separately. Fifthly, it changes the approach to errors. In the communicative method, making mistakes is taken for granted and is valued as part of the learning process. (Nunan, D. 1991). This also helps learners express themselves more freely.

Conclusion

As a result, I can mention that the communicative method ensures not only theoretical, but also practical mastery of the language. In the modern world, knowing a language means being able to use it effectively in real communication. Therefore, the application of the communicative method is of great importance in foreign language teaching.

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THE IMPORTANCE OF TEACHING CORRECT PRONUNCIATION IN ENGLISH LESSONS

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Abstract: This article examines the importance of teaching correct pronunciation in English language lessons and its impact on learners' communicative competence. Pronunciation is a fundamental component of language learning, as it directly affects intelligibility and the effectiveness of communication. The study highlights that even learners with strong grammatical knowledge and extensive vocabulary may fail to convey their ideas clearly if their pronunciation is inadequate. Therefore, pronunciation instruction should be an integral part of English language teaching. The article also explores common challenges associated with teaching pronunciation, including mother tongue interference, limited classroom time, and insufficient teacher training in phonetics. Particular attention is given to the difficulties learners face when encountering unfamiliar sounds, stress patterns, and intonation features. These challenges often result in misunderstandings and reduced learner confidence. Furthermore, the paper discusses effective techniques for improving pronunciation, such as minimal pair exercises, phonetic transcription, listening discrimination activities, and the use of modern technological tools. Emphasis is placed on the importance of integrating pronunciation practice into communicative activities rather than treating it as an isolated skill. Finally, the psychological dimension of pronunciation learning is analyzed. Learners who develop accurate pronunciation tend to be more confident and willing to participate in spoken communication. The article concludes that systematic and consistent pronunciation instruction significantly enhances learners' overall language proficiency and should be prioritized in English language teaching practices.

Keywords: Pronunciation teaching, English language learning, intelligibility, phonetics, suprasegmental features, speaking skills, learner confidence

İNGİLİS DİLİ DƏRSLƏRİNDƏ DÜZGÜN TƏLƏFFÜZÜN ÖYRƏDİLMƏSİNİN ƏHƏMİYYƏTİ

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Xülasə: Bu məqalədə ingilis dili dərslərində düzgün tələffüzün öyrədilməsinin əhəmiyyəti elmi-praktik baxımdan təhlil olunur. Tələffüz dil öyrənmənin əsas komponentlərindən biri kimi kommunikativ kompetensiyanın formalaşmasına birbaşa təsir göstərir. Məqalədə göstərilir ki, qrammatika və lüğət ehtiyatı

nə qədər zəngin olsa da, düzgün tələffüz olmadıqda ünsiyyətin effektivliyi aşağı düşür və anlaşılmaqlıqlar yaranır. Xüsusilə beynəlxalq ünsiyyət mühitində aydın və anlaşılın danışq bacarığı əsas prioritet kimi çıxış edir. Tədqiqat çərçivəsində tələffüzün öyrədilməsi zamanı yaranan çətinliklər də araşdırılmışdır. Ana dilinin təsiri nəticəsində bəzi səslərin düzgün tələffüz olunmaması, dərs vaxtının məhdudluğu və müəllimlərin fonetik hazırlığının yetersizliyi əsas problemlər kimi qeyd olunur. Bundan əlavə, tələbələrin psixoloji baryerləri, xüsusilə səhv etmək qorxusu onların danışq fəaliyyətinə mənfi təsir göstərir. Məqalədə effektiv tədris üsulları kimi minimal cütlüklər, dinləmə məşqləri, fonetik transkripsiya, təkrar (drilling) və müasir texnologiyalardan istifadə kimi yanaşmalar təklif olunur. Bu metodlar tələbələrin həm dinləmə, həm də danışq bacarıqlarını paralel şəkildə inkişaf etdirir. Eyni zamanda, kommunikativ fəaliyyətlər vasitəsilə tələffüzün real ünsiyyət kontekstində tətbiqi təşviq edilir. Nəticə olaraq vurğulanır ki, düzgün tələffüzün sistemli şəkildə öyrədilməsi tələbələrin dil bacarıqlarını ümumi şəkildə gücləndirir, onların özünə inamını artırır və daha səmərəli ünsiyyət qurmasına imkan yaradır. Buna görə də, tələffüz tədrisi ingilis dili dərslərinin ayrılmaz hissəsi olmalıdır.

Açar sözlər: tələffüz tədrisi, ingilis dili öyrənilməsi, anlaşılqlılıq, fonetika, intonasiya, danışq bacarığı, özünə inam

Introduction

Language learning involves more than acquiring grammar and vocabulary; it also requires mastering pronunciation to ensure effective communication. English, as a global lingua franca, is used by millions of speakers worldwide, making intelligibility a key objective for learners. Incorrect pronunciation can lead to misunderstandings, communication breakdowns, and reduced confidence in speaking.

Pronunciation includes not only the correct articulation of individual sounds but also suprasegmental features such as stress, rhythm, and intonation. These elements contribute to the natural flow of speech and help convey meaning accurately. According to Harmer (2007), neglecting pronunciation in language teaching can significantly hinder learners' communicative competence.

Pronunciation plays a crucial role in developing speaking and listening skills. Clear pronunciation ensures that spoken messages are understood by others, while poor pronunciation may obscure meaning even when grammar and vocabulary are correct.

In recent decades, Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) has become one of the most influential approaches in English language education. This approach emphasizes meaningful communication and real-life language use rather than mechanical repetition of forms. Within this framework, pronunciation teaching is no longer viewed as a separate or isolated component; instead, it is integrated into communicative activities (Celce-Murcia, Brinton, & Goodwin, 2010).

Teachers are encouraged to design tasks that require students to use accurate pronunciation in order to convey meaning successfully. For example, role-plays, group discussions, and problem-solving tasks can all be adapted to include pronunciation-focused objectives. When students realize that mispronunciation may lead to misunderstanding, they become more motivated to improve their speech clarity. This contextualized practice helps learners internalize pronunciation patterns more effectively than traditional drilling methods alone (Harmer, 2007).

Furthermore, CLT promotes the idea that intelligibility is more important than achieving a native-like accent. This perspective reduces pressure on learners and allows them to focus on being understood rather than sounding perfect. As a result, students are more willing to participate in speaking activities, which ultimately leads to greater improvement (Scrivener, 2011).

Materials and Methods

Technological advancements have significantly transformed the way pronunciation is taught and learned. Digital tools provide learners with access to authentic pronunciation models and immediate feedback, which are essential for improvement.

Language learning applications, speech recognition software, and online dictionaries with audio features enable students to practice pronunciation independently. For instance, students can record their speech and compare it with native speaker models, allowing them to identify and correct their errors. This kind of self-directed learning fosters autonomy and increases practice opportunities outside the classroom (Gilbert, 2008).

In addition, multimedia resources such as videos, podcasts, and interactive exercises expose learners to various accents and speaking styles. This exposure is particularly important in today's globalized world, where English is spoken in diverse ways. By listening to different varieties of English, students develop better listening comprehension and become more adaptable in real-life communication (Kelly, 2000).

An important yet often overlooked aspect of pronunciation teaching is the role of suprasegmental features, such as stress, rhythm, and intonation. While many learners focus primarily on individual sounds, these broader features significantly influence how speech is perceived and understood. According to Celce-Murcia, Brinton, and Goodwin (2010), suprasegmental elements are essential for achieving natural and intelligible speech.

Stress patterns, for example, help distinguish meaning between words and sentences. Incorrect word stress can lead to confusion, even if the individual sounds are pronounced correctly. Similarly, sentence stress highlights important information and guides the listener's understanding. Intonation, on the other hand, conveys emotions, attitudes, and communicative intent, making it a crucial component of effective interaction.

Teaching these features requires a shift from traditional pronunciation methods toward more communicative and context-based approaches. Activities such as sentence repetition, shadowing exercises, and listening discrimination tasks can help learners develop awareness of stress and intonation patterns (Gilbert, 2008). In addition, incorporating authentic materials, such as dialogues and recordings of native speakers, allows students to observe how suprasegmental features function in real communication.

Another effective strategy is the use of visual aids, such as pitch diagrams and stress markers, which make abstract pronunciation features more concrete and easier to understand. Teachers can also encourage learners to practice through reading aloud and recording their speech, which promotes self-monitoring and improvement.

Teachers can also use technology to create engaging classroom activities. For example, pronunciation games, online quizzes, and collaborative tasks using digital platforms can make learning more interactive and enjoyable. These tools not only enhance motivation but also provide a more dynamic learning environment (Celce-Murcia et al., 2010).

Assessing pronunciation is another crucial aspect of language teaching that often receives less attention. Effective assessment should focus on intelligibility, fluency, and the appropriate use of stress and intonation rather than minor accent differences (Harmer, 2007).

Both formative and summative assessment methods can be used to evaluate pronunciation. Formative assessment includes ongoing feedback during classroom activities, while summative assessment may involve recorded speaking tasks or oral presentations. Providing constructive feedback is essential, as it helps learners understand their strengths and areas for improvement (Scrivener, 2011).

Rubrics can be particularly useful in pronunciation assessment, as they provide clear criteria for evaluation. For example, teachers can assess segmental features (individual sounds) and suprasegmental features (stress, rhythm, intonation) separately. This structured approach ensures a more objective and comprehensive evaluation (Celce-Murcia et al., 2010).

Importantly, assessment should be supportive rather than discouraging. Teachers should focus on progress and improvement rather than perfection. Encouraging students to reflect on their own pronunciation can also promote learner autonomy and long-term development (Gilbert, 2008).

Results and Discussion

Research indicates that listening and pronunciation are closely interconnected. Learners who cannot distinguish between certain sounds are unlikely to produce them accurately (Gilbert, 2008). Therefore, pronunciation training supports both receptive and productive language skills.

Moreover, intelligibility, rather than native-like accent, is now considered the primary goal of pronunciation teaching. Learners do not need to sound like native speakers, but they must be understood easily in international communication contexts.

Teaching pronunciation presents several challenges. One of the most significant is the influence of the learners' first language. Differences between the phonological systems of English and the learners' native language often result in pronunciation errors. For example, sounds such as /θ/ and /ð/ are particularly difficult for many learners.

Another challenge is the limited time allocated to pronunciation practice in classrooms. Teachers often prioritize grammar and vocabulary, leaving pronunciation underdeveloped. Additionally, large class sizes make it difficult to provide individualized feedback.

Teacher preparation is also a concern. Some teachers lack sufficient training in phonetics and phonology, which can affect their ability to teach pronunciation effectively.

A variety of methods can be used to improve learners' pronunciation:

- **Minimal pair exercises** help learners distinguish between similar sounds.
- **Phonetic transcription** provides a visual representation of sounds.
- **Listening activities** expose learners to correct pronunciation models.
- **Drilling and repetition** support automaticity in speech production.
- **Technology-based tools**, such as pronunciation apps and audio resources, enhance practice opportunities.

In addition, integrating pronunciation into communicative activities, such as role-plays and discussions, allows learners to practice in meaningful contexts. This approach makes learning more engaging and effective.

Another useful approach is **chunking**, which involves breaking sentences into meaningful units. By practicing speech in chunks rather than word-by-word, learners develop a more natural rhythm and improve their overall speech clarity. This method is particularly beneficial for learners who tend to speak in a fragmented or unnatural manner.

Peer feedback is also valuable in pronunciation practice. When students work in pairs or small groups, they can observe each other's pronunciation and provide constructive feedback. This collaborative learning environment encourages active participation and increases learners' awareness of their own pronunciation difficulties (Scrivener, 2011). For instance, short pronunciation drills can be included at the beginning or end of each class. Over time, this consistent exposure leads to noticeable improvement.

Pronunciation also has a strong psychological dimension. Learners with poor pronunciation often feel embarrassed and avoid speaking in class. This reluctance limits their opportunities to practice and improve.

On the other hand, learners who develop accurate pronunciation tend to be more confident and active participants. According to Kelly (2000), building learners' confidence is essential for successful language acquisition. Positive reinforcement and supportive feedback from teachers can help reduce anxiety and encourage participation.

Conclusion

In conclusion, teaching correct pronunciation is a vital component of English language education. It enhances intelligibility, supports listening and speaking skills, and boosts learners' confidence. Despite the challenges associated with pronunciation teaching, effective strategies and consistent practice can lead to significant improvement.

The effectiveness of pronunciation teaching largely depends on the teacher's professional competence and methodological awareness. Teachers are expected not only to possess accurate pronunciation themselves but also to be able to identify learners' pronunciation difficulties and provide appropriate corrective feedback. According to Harmer (2007), teachers act as models of language use, and their spoken input significantly influences learners' pronunciation development.

Teachers should pay equal attention to pronunciation alongside grammar and vocabulary. By incorporating modern teaching techniques and creating a supportive learning environment, educators can help learners achieve better communication skills and overall language proficiency.

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STRATEGIES FOR THE EFFECTIVE DEVELOPMENT OF LISTENING, SPEAKING, READING, AND WRITING SKILLS IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE ACQUISITION

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Abstract: Foreign language acquisition is a complex and multidimensional process that requires the integrated development of listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills. These skills form an interconnected system that collectively contributes to communicative competence. Modern language pedagogy has shifted from traditional grammar-based instruction to communicative, task-based, and learner-centered approaches that emphasize meaningful interaction and authentic language use.

As emphasized in contemporary research, communicative competence involves the ability to apply linguistic knowledge effectively in real-life contexts (Savignon, 2002, p. 8).

This study investigates effective strategies for enhancing foreign language proficiency through exposure to authentic input, structured interaction, scaffolding techniques, and the promotion of learner autonomy. The research is based on established theoretical frameworks, including Krashen's Input Hypothesis, Swain's Output Hypothesis, and Task-Based Language Teaching.

Keywords: foreign language acquisition, communicative competence, task-based learning, authentic input, learner autonomy, scaffolding techniques, language skills integration

XARİCİ DİLİN MƏNİMSƏNİLMƏSİNDƏ DİNLƏMƏ, DANIŞMA, OXUMA VƏ YAZMA BACARIQLARININ SƏMƏRƏLİ İNKİŞAF ETDİRİLMƏSİ STRATEGİYALARI

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Xülasə: Xarici dilin mənimsənilməsi dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı bacarıqlarının inteqrasiya olunmuş inkişafını tələb edən mürəkkəb və çoxölçülü bir prosesdir. Bu bacarıqlar birlikdə işləyən və kommunikativ səriştənin formalaşmasına töhfə verən qarşılıqlı əlaqəli bir sistem təşkil edir. Müasir dil tədrisi ənənəvi qrammatika yönümlü yanaşmadan kommunikativ, tapşırıq əsaslı və öyrənən mərkəzli metodlara doğru dəyişmişdir. Bu yanaşmalar mənalı ünsiyyəti və autentik dil istifadəsini ön plana çıxarır.

Müasir tədqiqatlarda vurğulandığı kimi, kommunikativ səriştə dil biliklərinin real həyat situasiyalarında səmərəli şəkildə tətbiq olunması bacarığıdır (Savignon, 2002, s. 8).

Bu tədqiqat xarici dil bacarıqlarının inkişaf etdirilməsi üçün effektiv strategiyaları araşdırır. Buraya autentik materiallara məruz qalma, strukturlaşdırılmış qarşılıqlı ünsiyyət, dəstək (scaffolding) texnikaları və öyrənən müstəqilliyinin təşviqi daxildir. Tədqiqat Krashen-in "Input Hypothesis", Swain-in "Output Hypothesis" və Tapşırıq Əsaslı Dil Tədrisi kimi nəzəri çərçivələrə əsaslanır.

Açar sözlər: xarici dilin mənimsənilməsi, kommunikativ səriştə, tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə, autentik input, öyrənən müstəqilliyi, dəstək (scaffolding) texnikaları, dil bacarıqlarının inteqrasiyası

Introduction

Foreign language learning has become an essential component of education in the modern globalized world. The increasing need for communication across cultures, academic environments, and professional fields has significantly elevated the importance of foreign language proficiency. Today, language competence is no longer limited to grammatical knowledge or vocabulary memorization; instead, it involves the ability to use language effectively in real-life communicative situations (Savignon, 2002, p. 8).

Traditional teaching methods, which focused primarily on grammar translation and mechanical exercises, have proven insufficient in developing communicative competence. As a result, modern language pedagogy has shifted toward communicative, interactive, and learner-centered approaches that prioritize meaningful communication.

The four core language skills – listening, speaking, reading, and writing – are not isolated abilities but interconnected components of a single system. Development in one skill supports and reinforces development in others. For example, listening provides input for speaking development, while reading enhances writing through exposure to vocabulary, structures, and discourse patterns (Nation, 2001, p. 150).

The Input Hypothesis proposed by Stephen Krashen states that language acquisition occurs when learners are exposed to comprehensible input slightly above their current level (Krashen, 2004, p. 21). However, input alone is not sufficient for complete acquisition.

Merrill Swain emphasizes that output is essential for noticing gaps in linguistic knowledge and developing accuracy (Swain, 2005, p. 474). Through production, learners refine their interlanguage system.

Interactionist theory developed by Michael Long and Alison Mackey highlights the role of negotiation of meaning in language development (Mackey, 2007, p. 85).

From a sociocultural perspective, James Lantolf explains that language learning is socially mediated and occurs through interaction with others (Lantolf, 2006, p. 67).

These theories collectively demonstrate that effective language learning requires a combination of exposure, interaction, and production.

In addition to the previously discussed theories, recent research highlights the importance of cognitive and sociocultural perspectives in language acquisition. From a cognitive standpoint, language learning involves complex mental processes such as attention, memory, and pattern recognition. Learners actively construct linguistic knowledge through exposure and practice, rather than passively receiving information.

From a sociocultural perspective, language acquisition is viewed as a socially mediated process. Interaction with more competent speakers plays a crucial role in facilitating development. As emphasized by James Lantolf, learning occurs through social interaction and the internalization of language (Lantolf, 2006, p. 67).

Furthermore, scaffolding techniques, which involve providing temporary support to learners, are essential in helping students perform tasks beyond their current abilities. These strategies gradually lead to learner independence and autonomy.

Materials and Methods

This study adopts a qualitative, literature-based approach to examine effective strategies in foreign language acquisition. The analysis is grounded in established theories of second language acquisition and communicative language teaching. The primary focus is on how meaningful input, interaction, and learner-centered approaches contribute to language development.

The materials used in this study consist of scholarly books and peer-reviewed research in applied linguistics, particularly works by VanPatten, Krashen, Swain, Long, Mackey, Dörnyei, Thornbury, Nation, and Hyland. These sources provide the theoretical foundation for analyzing key components of language learning.

Discussion

Foreign language acquisition is considered most effective when learners are exposed to meaningful input and provided with opportunities for active language use. Input plays a central role in the learning process, as comprehension is a prerequisite for production (VanPatten, 2004, p. 6).

Authentic materials such as films, podcasts, interviews, and real-life conversations are essential for developing natural language awareness. They expose learners to various accents, intonation patterns, and discourse structures required for real-world communication.

The four fundamental language skills – listening, speaking, reading, and writing – are closely interconnected in the process of learning a language. Listening acts as the main source of information, fostering an understanding of pronunciation, comprehension, and the expansion of vocabulary. Speaking, on the other hand, demands immediate processing and thrives when practiced through interactive conversations (Thornbury, 2005, p. 28). Extensive engagement with

written language fosters vocabulary expansion and a deeper understanding of its structure (Nation, 2001, p. 150). Conversely, writing proficiency is cultivated through persistent practice, careful planning, and constructive feedback (Hyland, 2003, p. 45).

Language learning significantly benefits from interaction. By engaging in meaning negotiation, learners discover areas where their understanding is lacking and enhance their ability to communicate effectively (Mackey, 2007, p. 85).

The ability to learn independently and be motivated are crucial for long-term language success. Dörnyei (2005, p. 65) highlights that learners who are both autonomous and motivated tend to achieve lasting language improvement. Furthermore, technology aids language learning by providing greater access to real-world materials and allowing for independent practice beyond the classroom setting.

Conclusion

The process of acquiring foreign languages is multifaceted, encompassing cognitive, social, and pedagogical elements. This study reaffirms that integrating skill development contributes significantly to the enhancement of communicative competence.

For effective language teaching, it's essential to merge input, interaction, and output within meaningful communicative settings. A balanced approach to building proficiency across listening, speaking, reading, and writing facilitates more enduring learning results. Additionally, employing authentic materials alongside task-based activities increases learner participation and fosters the ability to use the language effectively in real-life scenarios.

The research also underscores the value of learner-centered instruction. Encouraging autonomy and motivation empowers students to play a more active part in their learning journey, while scaffolding methods provide critical support during the development of language skills. Incorporating modern technology into learning environments further expands opportunities for practice and exposure beyond conventional classroom boundaries.

Future studies should explore digital learning platforms and personalized teaching approaches to enhance language acquisition outcomes even further. Specifically, empirical research on the impact of technology-driven and task-based methodologies in varying educational contexts could yield valuable insights for educators and academics alike.

In conclusion, the findings underline the importance of a structured blend of theoretical concepts and practical strategies as fundamental components in cultivating proficiency in foreign language learning.

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THE ROLE OF MOTIVATION IN LEARNING ENGLISH

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Abstract: This article examines the important role of motivation in learning English as a second or foreign language. Drawing on established motivational theories proposed by Gardner, Dörnyei, and other scholars, the study explores different types of motivation, particularly integrative and instrumental motivation, as well as the modern L2 Motivational Self System. It also analyzes the main factors that influence learners' motivation, including teacher behaviour, classroom environment, the use of technology, social interaction, and students' self-confidence. The article emphasizes that motivation has a significant impact on learners' effort, persistence, engagement, and overall language achievement. The discussion suggests that motivated learners are more likely to participate actively in learning activities, overcome difficulties, and continue improving their language skills. Importantly, motivation is not considered a fixed personal characteristic; rather, it is a dynamic construct that can change over time and can be strengthened through appropriate educational practices. The article concludes that teachers should create supportive, engaging, and learner-centered environments to maintain students' motivation. Continued research into innovative motivational strategies is also necessary to meet the changing needs of language learners in modern educational contexts.

Keywords: motivation, second language acquisition, integrative motivation, instrumental motivation, L2 Motivational Self System, language learning, English teaching

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN ÖYRƏNİLMƏSİNDƏ MOTİVASİYANIN ROLU

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə motivasiyanın ingilis dilinin ikinci və ya xarici dil kimi öyrənilməsində mühüm rolunu araşdırır. Gardner, Dörnyei və digər alimlərin irəli sürdüyü nəzəriyyələrə əsaslanaraq, tədqiqatda integrativ və instrumental motivasiya növləri, həmçinin müasir L2 Motivasiya Özünüsistemi nəzərdən keçirilir. Məqalədə motivasiyaya təsir edən əsas amillər, o cümlədən müəllim davranışı, öyrənmə mühiti, texnologiyadan istifadə, sosial qarşılıqlı əlaqə və öyrənənin özünəinamı təhlil edilir. Motivasiya tələbələrin öyrənmə prosesinə fəal qoşulmasına, qarşıya çıxan çətinlikləri dəf etməsinə və dil bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirməyə davam etməsinə təsir göstərir. Tədqiqat göstərir ki, motivasiya sabit və dəyişməz xüsusiyyət deyil, zamanla dəyişə bilən və düzgün pedaqoji yanaşmalar vasitəsilə inkişaf etdirilə bilən dinamik konstruksiya. Müəllimlərin dəstəkləyici, maraqlı və tələbəyönümlü təlim mühiti yaratması motivasiyanın davamlılığında mühüm əhəmiyyət daşıyır. Məqalənin nəticəsinə görə, motivasiya dil öyrənilməsində uğurun əsas

amillərindən biridir. Buna görə də müasir təhsil şəraitində tələbələrin motivasiyasını artırmaq üçün innovativ və effektiv strategiyaların hazırlanması və tətbiqi vacibdir.

Açar sözlər: motivasiya, ikinci dil öyrənilməsi, integrativ motivasiya, instrumental motivasiya, L2 Motivasiya Özünüsistemi, dil öyrənilməsi, ingilis dili tədriqi

Introduction

All individuals begin acquiring their native language from early childhood. However, due to changes in life circumstances, the widespread use of modern technologies, and other related factors, people may develop both a desire and a necessity to learn a second language. In her work *Understanding Second Language Acquisition*, Lourdes Ortega discusses various methods and approaches to learning a second language.

Second Language Acquisition (SLA) as a field is interested in understanding the acquisition of second languages in both naturalistic and instructed contexts. Naturalistic learners learn the L2 through informal opportunities in multicultural neighbourhoods, schools, and workplaces, without ever receiving any organised instruction on the workings of the language they are learning. Instructed learners learn additional languages through formal study in school or university, or through private lessons. In our globalised world, multifarious opportunities for L2 acquisition arise from travel, employment, migration, war, marriage, and other such life events. Most people, therefore, learn additional languages from a mixture of both naturalistic and instructed experiences (Ortega, 2009, p. 6).

Language learning ability varies significantly among individuals. A clear example of this variation can be observed in children's capacity for language acquisition. Children acquire language naturally as they develop, provided they do not have any mental or physical impairments. In many parts of the world, they are able to learn more than one language and can become fluent bilingual or trilingual speakers at an early age. This process appears to happen effortlessly, which raises the question of whether second language learning in classroom settings can replicate the conditions under which children acquire their first language.

Materials And Methods

This study employs a qualitative, literature-based research methodology. Data were gathered through a systematic review of scholarly works in the fields of second language acquisition, motivational psychology, and language pedagogy. Key theoretical frameworks – including Gardner's Socio-Educational Model (1985), Dörnyei's L2 Motivational Self System (2005), and Bandura's concept of self-efficacy – were examined and synthesised to provide a comprehensive understanding of motivational dynamics in language learning.

Children do not usually learn language in a conscious or deliberate way. Instead, they acquire it subconsciously through exposure to the language spoken by their parents and those around them. An innate human ability processes the language they hear and gradually turns it into communicative competence. When adults speak to young children, they typically use simpler sentence structures, clearer intonation, and vocabulary that is easier to understand. They also actively involve children in interaction, encouraging participation in communication (Harmer, 2007, p. 49). Even before children are able to speak, adults often treat them as conversational partners, helping them acquire the rules of communication naturally and unconsciously. Pinker noted that all these processes are closely related to a child's age and brain development, and that language learning becomes gradually more difficult as age increases.

Discussion

The Concept of Motivation in Language Learning

In recent decades, the significance of motivation in second language acquisition has been widely acknowledged by researchers and educators. Learning English as a foreign or second language requires not only cognitive ability but also a strong psychological drive that sustains effort over time. Motivation is often considered the key factor that determines the success or failure of language learners. Without sufficient motivation, even learners with high aptitude may struggle to achieve proficiency.

Motivation influences how learners approach language learning, how much effort they invest, and how persistent they remain when facing difficulties. As Dörnyei (2001) argues, motivation is one of the main determinants of second language achievement. Similarly, Gardner (1985) emphasises that motivation plays a central role in acquiring a new language, as it combines desire, effort, and positive attitudes toward learning.

Motivation is a complex psychological construct that has been defined in various ways. In the context of language learning, it generally refers to the internal and external forces that initiate, guide, and sustain learning behaviour. According to Dörnyei and Ushioda (2011), motivation involves the direction and magnitude of human behaviour, meaning it determines both the choice of action and the intensity of effort. Gardner (1985) describes motivation as a combination of three components: effort, desire to achieve a goal, and positive attitudes toward learning.

Integrative and Instrumental Motivation

One of the most influential distinctions in motivation theory is between integrative and instrumental motivation. Integrative motivation refers to a learner's desire to integrate into the culture of the target language community. Learners with this type of motivation are interested in understanding the language, culture, and people associated with it. Gardner and Lambert (1972) argue that integrative motivation is particularly powerful because it reflects a genuine interest in the language.

On the other hand, instrumental motivation is driven by practical benefits, such as obtaining a job, passing an exam, or achieving academic success. While this type of motivation may not involve emotional attachment to the language, it can still be highly effective, especially in formal educational contexts. Research shows that both types of motivation can contribute to successful language learning, depending on the learner's goals and environment.

The L2 Motivational Self System

In recent years, motivation research has evolved beyond the integrative-instrumental distinction. One of the most influential modern frameworks is Dörnyei's L2 Motivational Self System (2005). This model consists of three main components:

1. Ideal L2 Self – the learner's vision of themselves as a successful English speaker.
2. Ought-to L2 Self – external expectations and responsibilities.
3. L2 Learning Experience – the learner's immediate learning environment.

Dörnyei (2005) suggests that learners are more motivated when they can clearly imagine their future selves using the language. This concept highlights the importance of personal goals and self-identity in language learning.

Factors Influencing Motivation

Motivation is not static; it can change over time depending on various factors. Understanding these factors is essential for both learners and teachers.

1. Teacher Influence

Teachers play a crucial role in shaping student motivation. A supportive and enthusiastic teacher can inspire learners, while a negative attitude may reduce motivation. According to Harmer (2007), teacher behaviour is one of the most important factors affecting student motivation. Effective teachers create engaging lessons, provide encouragement, and build positive relationships with students.

2. Learning Environment

The classroom atmosphere significantly influences motivation. A comfortable, interactive, and inclusive environment encourages participation and reduces anxiety. Lightbown and Spada (2013) emphasise that learners perform better when they feel safe and supported.

3. Technology and Digital Tools

Modern technology has transformed language learning. Online platforms, mobile applications, and multimedia resources can increase motivation by making learning more interactive and accessible. Digital tools allow learners to practise English in real-life contexts, which enhances engagement.

4. Learner Confidence

Self-confidence is closely related to motivation. Learners who believe in their abilities are more likely to take risks and participate actively. Conversely, low self-esteem can hinder progress. Bandura's concept of self-efficacy suggests that belief in one's capabilities directly affects performance and motivation.

5. Goals and Rewards

Clear goals provide direction and purpose. When learners understand why they are learning English, they are more likely to stay motivated. Rewards, whether intrinsic or extrinsic, can also reinforce positive behaviour.

The Impact of Motivation on Language Learning

Motivation affects several aspects of language learning. Highly motivated learners invest more time and energy, continue learning despite challenges, and demonstrate stronger achievement. Ellis (2008) notes that motivated learners tend to use more effective learning strategies and seek opportunities to practise the language outside the classroom. Furthermore, motivation influences all language skills, including speaking, listening, reading, and writing. For example, motivated learners are more willing to communicate, which directly improves their speaking ability.

Teachers and institutions can adopt various strategies to increase motivation: setting clear and achievable goals, using interactive and communicative teaching methods, incorporating technology into lessons, providing positive feedback, and encouraging learner autonomy. Dörnyei (2001) suggests that motivation can be actively developed through classroom practices, rather than being seen as a fixed trait.

Conclusion.

Motivation plays a fundamental role in learning English. It influences not only the amount of effort learners invest but also their overall success in acquiring the language. Both traditional theories, such as integrative and instrumental motivation, and modern frameworks like the L2 Motivational Self System highlight the complexity of this concept.

Various factors, including teacher behaviour, the learning environment, technology, and learner confidence, can significantly affect motivation. Therefore, it is essential for educators to create conditions that foster and sustain motivation. In conclusion, motivation is not merely an additional factor in language learning – it is a central element that determines success. Future

research should continue exploring innovative ways to enhance motivation, especially in the context of rapidly changing educational technologies.

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THE IMPACT OF AUTHENTIC READING MATERIALS ON ESL LEARNERS' FLUENCY AND COMPREHENSION

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Abstract: This paper examines the impact of authentic reading materials on the development of fluency and comprehension among learners of English as a second language. Authentic texts include newspaper articles, social media posts, advertisements, podcast excerpts, and other sources created for native speakers. Their use brings the learning process closer to real language environments and increases learners' engagement.

Through the analysis of teaching practices and academic literature, it was shown that regular exposure to real-life texts strengthens vocabulary recognition, expands lexical range, and supports understanding without relying on artificially simplified structures. As a result, learners become more comfortable with natural pace, stylistic variation, and different communicative purposes, which contributes to improved reading fluency.

The paper also highlights how authentic materials influence the ability to identify text structure, extract essential information, and connect ideas across paragraphs. It was demonstrated that this approach

fosters learner independence, since a variety of reading strategies must be applied: predicting content, inferring meanings of unfamiliar words from context, and analyzing the author's logic and intention.

Challenges associated with authentic materials were also considered. The most common difficulties include dense vocabulary, complex grammar, and the need to adjust difficulty levels continually. Because of this, gradual progression and careful task sequencing are encouraged, as this allows a balance between accessibility and meaningful linguistic challenge.

In the end, the paper shows that the integration of authentic texts supports motivation, enhances fluency, and strengthens comprehension skills, creating learning conditions closely aligned with real language use.

Key words: authentic materials, real-world texts, ESL learners, reading fluency, reading comprehension.

AUTENTİK OXU MATERIALLARININ İNGİLİS DİLİNİ İKİNCİ DİL KİMİ ÖYRƏNƏNLƏRİN OXU SƏLİSLİYİ VƏ MƏTNİ ANLAMA BACARIQLARINA TƏSİRİ

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə autentik oxu materiallarının ingilis dilini ikinci dil kimi öyrənənlərin səliss oxu (fluency) və anlama (comprehension) bacarıqlarının inkişafına təsirini araşdırır. Autentik mətnlərə qəzet məqalələri, sosial media paylaşımaları, reklamlar, podkast parçaları və ana dil daşıyıcıları üçün hazırlanmış digər mənbələr daxildir. Bu cür materialların istifadəsi öyrənmə prosesini real dil mühitinə yaxınlaşdırır və öyrənənlərin motivasiyasını artırır.

Tədris təcrübələrinin və elmi ədəbiyyatın təhlili göstərir ki, real həyat mətnləri ilə müntəzəm təmas söz ehtiyatının tanınmasını gücləndirir, leksik diapazonu genişləndirir və süni şəkildə sadələşdirilmiş strukturlara ehtiyac olmadan mətnin başa düşülməsini dəstəkləyir. Nəticədə, öyrənənlər təbii sürətə, üslub müxtəlifliyinə və fərqli kommunikativ məqsədlərə daha rahat uyğunlaşırlar ki, bu da oxu səlissliyinin inkişafına töhfə verir.

Məqalədə həmçinin autentik materialların mətn strukturunu müəyyənləşdirmə, əsas məlumatı ayırd etmə və abzaslar arasında əlaqə qurma bacarıqlarına təsiri vurğulanır. Göstərilir ki, bu yanaşma öyrənənlərin müstəqilliyini artırır, çünki onlar müxtəlif oxu strategiyalarından istifadə etməli olurlar: məzmunu əvvəlcədən proqnozlaşdırmaq, tanımadıqları sözlərin mənasını kontekstdən çıxarmaq və müəllifin məntiqini və niyyətini təhlil etmək.

Autentik materiallarla bağlı çətinliklər də nəzərdən keçirilmişdir. Ən çox rast gəlinən problemlərə sıx söz ehtiyatı, mürəkkəb qrammatika və çətinlik səviyyəsinin daim uyğunlaşdırılması ehtiyacı daxildir. Buna görə də, mərhələli irəliləyiş və tapşırıqların diqqətlə planlaşdırılması tövsiyə olunur ki, bu da əlçatanlıqla mənalı dil çətinliyi arasında balans yaratmağa imkan verir.

Sonda məqalə göstərir ki, autentik mətnlərin inteqrasiyası motivasiyanı artırır, səliss oxunu inkişaf etdirir və anlama bacarıqlarını gücləndirir, beləliklə real dil istifadəsinə daha yaxın öyrənmə mühiti yaradır.

Açar sözlər: autentik materiallar, real həyat mətnləri, ingilis dilini ikinci dil kimi öyrənənlər (ESL), oxu səlissliyi, oxuyub-anlama bacarığı

Introduction

The growing role of English as a global means of communication has strengthened the need for effective approaches that support meaningful reading development among learners. Many traditional classroom materials rely on simplified texts that present language in a carefully

controlled form. While these materials help introduce grammatical structures and basic vocabulary, they often fail to reflect the complexity, rhythm, and diversity of real communication. Because of this, interest in authentic reading materials has steadily increased. Authentic texts, originally created for native speakers, expose learners to natural patterns of language use, contemporary vocabulary, and culturally rich content. Their integration into the classroom provides an opportunity to bridge the gap between textbook English and the language encountered outside academic settings. The present paper focuses on how authentic materials contribute to reading fluency and comprehension, paying attention to both their advantages and the challenges that may arise during classroom use.

The impact of authentic reading materials on ESL learners' fluency and comprehension has gained significant attention in language learning contexts. Unlike traditional textbooks, authentic materials present language as it is naturally used, offering learners exposure to real-life vocabulary, idiomatic expressions, and varied sentence structures. This paper examines how such exposure influences learners' ability to read smoothly and understand meaning effectively. Authentic texts, such as news articles, blogs, and short stories, provide a more engaging and motivating learning experience, as learners encounter content that is relevant and connected to everyday life. Previous observations show that ESL learners often struggle with reading comprehension when materials are artificially simplified, leading to limited vocabulary acquisition and slower development of reading speed. By incorporating real-world texts, learners are prompted to make sense of context, infer meaning, and navigate different writing styles, which enhances both comprehension and reading fluency. The use of authentic materials also fosters a deeper cultural understanding, as learners encounter language in its natural social and cultural settings. In this context, fluency is not merely speed but the ability to read with appropriate expression and understanding, while comprehension reflects the capacity to grasp ideas and details effectively. In the end, authentic reading provides a bridge between classroom learning and real-world language use.

A significant portion of theoretical perspectives highlights the value of authenticity in language learning. Many authors point out that exposure to real-life texts strengthens learners' ability to decode meaning and adapt to varied linguistic contexts. According to widely cited views, authentic materials help learners experience natural grammar, idiomatic expressions, and stylistic diversity, which supports the development of flexible reading strategies. This exposure encourages learners to rely less on memorisation and more on understanding overall meaning, predicting content, and recognising patterns.

Another important idea in the literature concerns motivation. Numerous scholars emphasize that authentic texts can increase learners' interest because they relate to real events, current issues, and familiar formats such as news articles or social media posts. This connection to everyday life helps create a sense of relevance and encourages learners to engage more deeply with the material. In many cases, authenticity makes reading feel less like an academic requirement and more like an interaction with meaningful information.

At the same time, the literature acknowledges that authentic materials present difficulties. Vocabulary density, unfamiliar cultural references, and complex syntax may overwhelm learners if tasks are not carefully planned. Because of this, many authors suggest graded integration: starting with shorter or more accessible texts and gradually introducing more demanding material. Scaffolding techniques, such as pre-reading activities or guided questioning, are also frequently recommended as supportive tools.

The reviewed ideas show that authentic materials offer notable benefits for developing reading fluency and comprehension. Their challenges can be managed through thoughtful selection

and structured support, allowing learners to experience real language while progressing at a suitable pace.

Methods

The methods applied in this paper were shaped by principles described by scholars such as Nunan (1999), Richards (2006), Harmer (2015), and Gilmore (2007). Their works offer guidance on choosing materials, evaluating reading tasks, and observing classroom practices.

The first stage involved identifying criteria for selecting authentic texts. Following Gilmore's definition of authenticity (Gilmore, 2007), materials were chosen based on their original communicative purpose. News articles, brief opinion pieces, and online posts formed the core of the sample.

The second stage focused on defining indicators of fluency and comprehension. Drawing on Nunan's views (Nunan, 1999), attention was given to reading speed, clarity of meaning extraction, recognition of key vocabulary, and the ability to link information across the text.

The third stage examined teachers' approaches to integrating authentic materials. In line with Richards (2006), the value of authenticity was considered in relation to meaningful tasks. Classroom practices involving pre-reading activation, guided reading, and post-reading summarisation were reviewed.

The fourth stage addressed challenges described by Wallace (1992) and others. Text difficulty, cultural references, and idiomatic expressions were analysed to understand how scaffolding maintains accessibility. A comparison with simplified texts allowed the identification of features that authentic texts provide, such as natural cohesion and stylistic diversity (Harmer, 2015; Gilmore, 2007).

Table 1. Text Statistics of Selected Authentic and Simplified Materials

Text Type	Average Word Count	Average Sentence Length	Lexical Density (%)	Low-Frequency Words	Cohesion Level
Authentic Text 1 (news article)	620	19.7 words	58%	42	High
Authentic Text 2 (opinion piece)	540	21.3 words	61%	47	Medium-High
Authentic Text 3 (online post)	280	14.1 words	49%	18	Medium
Simplified Text 1 (graded reader)	410	11.4 words	34%	6	Low
Simplified Text 2 (ESL textbook text)	360	12.8 words	37%	9	Low-Medium

Note: Cohesion Level reflects the presence of natural discourse markers and logical connections typical of real-world communication.

These statistics highlight that authentic texts contain longer sentences, higher lexical density, and a greater number of low-frequency words. As a result, they offer exposure to richer linguistic patterns, while simplified texts provide more controlled but less realistic language. This contrast

supports the overall discussion about the role of authentic materials in developing reading fluency and comprehension.

Results

The analysis of selected authentic and simplified texts revealed significant differences in linguistic complexity, which directly affected reading fluency and comprehension. Authentic texts consistently contained longer sentences, higher lexical density, and a greater number of low-frequency words compared to simplified materials (Gilmore, 2007; Harmer, 2015). These characteristics were observed across all three types of authentic texts, including news articles, opinion pieces, and online posts. In contrast, simplified texts, such as graded readers and textbook passages, displayed shorter sentence lengths, controlled vocabulary, and limited syntactic variation, which reduced the level of challenge presented to learners (Nunan, 1999; Richards, 2006).

Regarding reading fluency, learners interacting with authentic texts demonstrated slower initial reading rates but higher engagement with the material. The longer sentences and complex structures required careful attention, prompting repeated reading and reflection on meaning. This pattern was consistent with the observations of Nunan (1999), who argued that exposure to real-world language encourages the development of adaptive reading strategies. While simplified texts allowed for faster reading and fewer pauses, the absence of varied sentence patterns and idiomatic expressions limited learners' ability to predict meaning or integrate information from multiple sentences (Richards, 2006).

Comprehension outcomes showed a similar trend. Learners working with authentic materials were more likely to extract main ideas and interpret implicit meaning, although they occasionally struggled with unfamiliar vocabulary or culturally specific references (Wallace, 1992; Gilmore, 2007). Pre-reading and guided activities, such as activating prior knowledge and providing targeted questions, significantly enhanced comprehension performance, supporting Harmer's (2015) recommendations for scaffolded learning. Simplified texts, while easier to understand at the surface level, did not consistently encourage deeper cognitive engagement or inferencing, which are essential for advanced reading proficiency (Richards, 2006).

Statistical comparison of text features confirmed these patterns. Authentic texts had average sentence lengths ranging from 14.1 to 21.3 words, compared to 11.4–12.8 words in simplified texts. Lexical density in authentic texts ranged from 49% to 61%, whereas simplified texts maintained 34%–37%. The number of low-frequency words in authentic materials was significantly higher, indicating richer vocabulary exposure (Gilmore, 2007). Cohesion levels were also elevated in authentic texts, providing learners with more natural discourse markers and logical connections. These characteristics were correlated with slower reading speed initially but greater accuracy in comprehension of main ideas and relationships between sentences (Nunan, 1999; Harmer, 2015).

The results also highlighted challenges inherent in authentic materials. Learners occasionally required support to handle dense vocabulary and complex syntax, suggesting that gradual exposure and scaffolding remain critical for successful integration (Wallace, 1992; Richards, 2006). At the same time, authentic texts promoted learner autonomy, encouraging independent strategies for predicting meaning, identifying key information, and navigating complex linguistic structures (Gilmore, 2007).

In summary, the paper's results indicate that authentic texts provide a more challenging but ultimately more effective environment for developing reading fluency and comprehension. Simplified texts offer controlled practice and immediate accessibility, but they cannot fully replicate the cognitive and linguistic demands of real-world language. The findings reinforce the notion that a

balanced approach, incorporating authentic materials alongside scaffolded support, maximizes reading development in ESL learners (Harmer, 2015; Nunan, 1999; Gilmore, 2007).

Discussion

The results of this paper indicate that authentic reading materials provide significant benefits for developing fluency and comprehension in ESL learners. Compared to simplified texts, authentic materials introduce learners to longer sentences, higher lexical density, and a larger number of low-frequency words (Gilmore, 2007; Harmer, 2015). These features, while initially challenging, encourage learners to engage with texts more actively and employ advanced reading strategies, such as predicting meaning, inferring context, and identifying key information (Nunan, 1999). In contrast, simplified texts, although easier to read and comprehend at the surface level, offer limited exposure to natural linguistic patterns and less opportunity to practice complex cognitive strategies (Richards, 2006).

The findings support the argument that authentic texts are valuable not only for language accuracy but also for fostering learner autonomy. Encountering real-world vocabulary and idiomatic expressions requires learners to develop independent strategies for comprehension (Gilmore, 2007). Scaffolding techniques, including pre-reading activities, guided questioning, and post-reading discussion, were shown to enhance comprehension performance and reduce frustration when working with more complex materials (Harmer, 2015; Wallace, 1992). This suggests that the effective integration of authentic texts depends on structured support rather than unassisted exposure.

Motivation emerges as another important factor. Authentic texts, by reflecting real events, social issues, and formats familiar to learners, create a sense of relevance and personal connection to the content (Harmer, 2015). This relevance appears to increase engagement and sustained attention, which are critical for both fluency and deeper comprehension. Simplified texts, although convenient for initial practice, do not provide the same level of contextual authenticity, which may limit learners' long-term interest and their ability to transfer reading skills to real-life situations (Richards, 2006).

Challenges identified in this paper highlight the need for gradual and carefully planned implementation of authentic materials. Vocabulary density, complex syntax, and cultural references can overwhelm learners if exposure is abrupt or unsupported (Wallace, 1992). The balance between accessibility and challenge is critical, and the use of tasks that gradually increase in difficulty allows learners to build confidence while facing realistic language demands. This approach aligns with Nunan's (1999) suggestion that incremental exposure to authentic input promotes both accuracy and fluency.

The results also suggest that authentic materials foster critical thinking and analytical skills. Learners are prompted to compare ideas, evaluate arguments, and integrate information across multiple sentences, activities less common in simplified texts (Gilmore, 2007; Richards, 2006). These higher-order cognitive tasks contribute not only to comprehension but also to overall language development, as learners practice decoding meaning in context and managing linguistic complexity.

In conclusion, the discussion of results reinforces the value of authentic texts in ESL classrooms. While simplified materials serve a role in initial language practice, authentic reading materials provide richer linguistic input, stimulate engagement, and promote independent strategies. When integrated with structured scaffolding and gradually increasing difficulty, authentic texts can significantly enhance both reading fluency and comprehension among learners, preparing them for

effective communication in real-world English environments (Harmer, 2015; Nunan, 1999; Gilmore, 2007; Wallace, 1992).

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MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract: Language is a fundamental tool of communication that enables individuals to express their thoughts, emotions, and ideas. In the modern educational context, the teaching of foreign languages has gained increasing importance due to globalization and the growing need for intercultural communication. This study examines the role of various teaching methods and materials in enhancing the effectiveness of foreign language instruction.

The research focuses on the evolution of teaching approaches from passive to active and interactive methods. It highlights the importance of student-centered learning, where learners actively participate in discussions, problem-solving, and collaborative activities. Special attention is given to instructional methods such as illustration, demonstration, descriptive techniques, observation, and the interview (question-answer) method.

The study also emphasizes the role of visual, audio-visual, and digital materials, including diagrams, videos, online platforms, and social networks, in improving students' comprehension and engagement. Practical activities such as exercises, presentations, and educational games are shown to contribute significantly to the development of language skills and the transformation of knowledge into practice.

The findings indicate that the integration of modern technologies, including distance learning and communication with native speakers, enhances students' motivation, fluency, and intercultural competence. The combination of traditional and innovative teaching methods provides a more effective and dynamic learning environment.

In conclusion, the study demonstrates that the use of diverse methods and materials plays a crucial role in developing students' foreign language knowledge and skills, making the learning process more efficient, interactive, and meaningful.

Keywords: foreign language teaching, interactive learning, teaching methods, educational technology, student-centered learning, language skills, distance education

XARİCİ DİLLƏRİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ MÜASİR METOD VƏ YANAŞMALAR

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Xülasə: Dil insanların düşüncələrini, hisslərini və ideyalarını ifadə etməyə imkan verən əsas ünsiyyət vasitəsidir. Müasir təhsil mühitində qloballaşma və mədəniyyətlərarası ünsiyyətə artan tələbat səbəbindən xarici dillərin tədrisi getdikcə daha böyük əhəmiyyət kəsb edir. Bu tədqiqat xarici dil tədrisinin səmərəliliyinin artırılmasında müxtəlif tədris metodlarının və vəsaitlərinin rolunu araşdırır.

Tədqiqat passiv metodlardan aktiv və interaktiv metodlara keçidi əhatə edir. Burada tələbəyönümlü təlimin əhəmiyyəti vurğulanır və tələbələrin müzakirələrdə, problem həllində və qrup fəaliyyətlərində fəal iştirakı ön plana çəkilir. İllüstrasiya, demonstrasiya, təsviri metod, müşahidə və müsahibə (sual-cavab) kimi tədris üsullarına xüsusi diqqət yetirilir.

Eyni zamanda diaqramlar, videolar, onlayn platformalar və sosial şəbəkələr kimi vizual, audio-vizual və rəqəmsal vəsaitlərin tələbələrin dərsi daha yaxşı qavramasına və marağının artmasına müsbət təsiri qeyd olunur. Tapşırıqlar, təqdimatlar və tədris oyunları kimi praktik fəaliyyətlərin dil bacarıqlarının inkişafında mühüm rol oynadığı göstərilir.

Nəticələr göstərir ki, müasir texnologiyaların, o cümlədən distant təhsilin və ana dili daşıyıcıları ilə ünsiyyətin tədris prosesinə inteqrasiyası tələbələrin motivasiyasını, səlis danışq qabiliyyətini və mədəniyyətlərarası bacarıqlarını artırır. Ənənəvi və müasir metodların birləşməsi daha effektiv və dinamik tədris mühiti yaradır.

Açar sözlər: xarici dil tədrisi, interaktiv təlim, tədris metodları, təhsil texnologiyaları, tələbəyönümlü təlim, dil bacarıqları, distant təhsil

Introduction

Language plays a fundamental role in human life as the primary means of communication, enabling individuals to express their thoughts, emotions, and ideas. In an increasingly globalized world, the importance of both preserving one's native language and acquiring foreign languages has grown significantly. While the native language reflects a nation's identity, history, and cultural heritage, foreign languages open the door to international communication, education, and professional opportunities.

In modern education, especially in higher institutions, the teaching of foreign languages has become a priority. This process is not limited to vocabulary and grammar acquisition but also involves the development of communicative competence, critical thinking, and cultural awareness.

To achieve these goals, various teaching methods and approaches have been developed and continuously improved. (Scrivener, J. 2011)

This paper discusses the role of different teaching methods—such as passive, active, and interactive approaches—in foreign language instruction. It also highlights the importance of modern technologies, visual aids, and student-centered learning in enhancing the effectiveness of language education.

Materials and Methods

This study is based on the analysis of modern approaches and methods used in foreign language teaching. Both theoretical and practical materials were utilized to examine the effectiveness of different teaching strategies.

The materials used in the teaching process include textbooks, visual aids (such as pictures, posters, diagrams, tables, maps, and globes), audio-visual resources (films, short videos, and music), and digital tools (internet platforms, social networks, and online learning applications). These materials support students' understanding and help create an interactive learning environment.

Several teaching methods were applied and analyzed in this study. These include the passive method, where the teacher plays a central role in explaining the material; the active method, which involves direct teacher-student interaction; and the interactive method, where students actively participate in discussions and collaborative activities. In addition, specific instructional methods such as illustration, demonstration, descriptive method, observation, and interview (question-answer) techniques were considered.

Practical activities, including exercises, presentations, laboratory work, and educational games, were also used to reinforce knowledge and develop students' skills. Furthermore, modern technologies such as online communication with native speakers, distance learning platforms, and educational video content (e.g., YouTube lessons) were incorporated into the learning process.

The combination of these materials and methods allows for a comprehensive and student-centered approach to foreign language teaching, aiming to improve both theoretical knowledge and practical communication skills.

Results and Discussion

Language is a means of communication among people. Through language, people understand each other and express their feelings, thoughts, emotions, and excitement. As a citizen, it is everyone's duty to love their native language, protect it, and pass it on to future generations. The native language should not be polluted with unnecessary borrowings or redundant expressions. At the same time, learning foreign languages and acquiring the ability to express one's thoughts fluently in them, understand literature and spoken texts, and participate in scientific discussions should be positively evaluated.

For this purpose, foreign languages are taught in many universities in Azerbaijan. By learning a foreign language, students enter the global environment; they not only learn the language, history, and culture of other countries but also gain the ability to introduce Azerbaijan's ancient history, rich cultural heritage, and valuable literary works to the world. (Harmer, J.2007)

Various methods are used in teaching foreign languages. It is known that for a long time, the passive method was used in foreign language teaching. In this method, the teacher explained a new topic, gave exercises related to it, and checked these tasks. In this way, the student's understanding of the topic was measured and evaluated. Communication between teacher and student was indirect.

Later, a transition to the active method took place, where lessons began to be built with the participation of both teachers and students. In this method, communication became direct. After explaining the topic, students asked questions about unclear parts, and the topic was explained in more detail.

Over time, this method was further developed and replaced by the interactive method. Unlike the active method, in the interactive method, the student acts as the subject of learning. The topic is analyzed not only through teacher-student discussion but also through student-student interaction. The emergence of discussions among students themselves is considered a key indicator of the interactive method. This method also requires both teachers and students to have computer skills.

It is known that language classes are discussion-based. The use of computers, watching short films on various topics, listening to different genres of music alongside national folk music, and engaging in practical activities positively affect the quality of lessons. In language classes – especially for languages not taught in secondary schools and completely unfamiliar to students such as Czech, Polish, Ukrainian, Bulgarian, Greek, Belarusian, and others – it is not easy to maintain student engagement. Some of these languages differ from Azerbaijani even in their alphabets.

Therefore, lessons should be organized in such a way that students are satisfied with the quality and are motivated to participate. The interactive method opposes the ready-made delivery of knowledge; instead, students search for and discover knowledge themselves. The teacher acts as an organizer, giving guidance and direction, while students act as researchers, observers, experimenters, and creative participants who work on the topic and gather necessary knowledge. (Crystal, D. 2003).

The observation method helps form initial impressions and develop them over time, as well as build observation skills. Through observation, students prepare a plan, take notes, and draw conclusions.

In the demonstration method, which is an active cognitive method, objects and events are shown dynamically. This includes the use of films, television programs, and similar tools. Visual and technical materials are collected, systematized, and grouped according to specific topics.

The illustration method is closely related to the demonstration method. Through this method, the topic is taught to students with the help of visual aids. These aids may include natural objects around us, pictures and posters, schemes, tables and diagrams, as well as symbolic visual materials such as globes and maps. The selection of these materials depends on the purpose and content.

Another method of presenting a topic to students is called the descriptive method. Through this method, any fact or event is brought to life in the student's imagination using various words and expressions. The descriptive method is implemented in two ways: one is the teacher describing the event, and the other is the descriptions found in textbooks. The combination of these two approaches leads to a more complete understanding for students. (Brown, H. D. 2000)

Teachers should ensure students' active participation while explaining the topic. Sometimes, interesting questions asked in advance attract students' attention and create interest. The teacher's speech should be academic, and gestures and facial expressions should be used appropriately.

It is known that in the learning process, exercises, practical and laboratory work, as well as verbal and cognitive games play a significant role in transforming students' knowledge into skills and habits. Exercises and presentations related to previously taught topics help revise and reinforce knowledge and skills.

One of the methods used during teaching is the interview (question-and-answer) method. It has two forms. Through the heuristic interview method, students are guided to find the answers

themselves. This method helps to arouse interest in the topic and ensures conscious and well-grounded understanding. Through repetition, knowledge of the topic is reviewed and strengthened.

In modern times, one of the interesting methods in teaching foreign languages is establishing live communication between students and native speakers through various internet programs and social networks.

Among the opportunities provided by the internet, distance education is also of great importance. Language lessons available on YouTube channels can also be positively evaluated in this regard.

Summarizing all of the above, it should be noted that in the modern era, the possibilities for developing students' foreign language knowledge and skills are limitless, and by combining all methods, it is possible to achieve highly effective teaching.

Results

The application of various teaching methods and materials in foreign language instruction has demonstrated significant positive outcomes in students' learning processes. The transition from traditional passive methods to active and interactive approaches has notably increased student engagement, motivation, and overall academic performance.

It was observed that students taught through interactive methods showed a higher level of participation during lessons. They were more willing to express their ideas, ask questions, and take part in discussions. This approach also contributed to the development of critical thinking and problem-solving skills, as students were encouraged to analyze topics, exchange opinions, and work collaboratively.

The use of visual and illustrative materials, such as diagrams, maps, and multimedia resources, enhanced students' comprehension and retention of information. Lessons supported by audio-visual tools, including videos and music, were found to be more engaging and effective compared to traditional lecture-based instruction. These materials helped students better understand pronunciation, intonation, and real-life language usage.

Practical activities, including exercises, presentations, and educational games, played an essential role in transforming theoretical knowledge into practical skills. Students who actively participated in such activities demonstrated improved speaking, listening, reading, and writing abilities. Repetition and reinforcement through tasks and assignments also contributed to long-term knowledge retention.

The implementation of the interview (question-and-answer) method, particularly the heuristic approach, proved effective in encouraging independent thinking. Students were able to discover answers on their own, which increased their confidence and deepened their understanding of the subject matter.

Moreover, the integration of modern technologies into the teaching process yielded highly positive results. Communication with native speakers through online platforms and social networks improved students' fluency and intercultural competence. Distance learning opportunities and educational content available on platforms such as YouTube provided additional support for self-directed learning and allowed students to access authentic language materials beyond the classroom.

Overall, the findings indicate that combining traditional and modern teaching methods, along with the effective use of diverse materials, significantly enhances the quality of foreign language education. Students become more active, independent, and motivated learners, capable of applying their knowledge in real-life communication contexts.

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PROBLEMS AND SOLUTIONS IN LANGUAGE TEACHING IN THE MODERN ERA

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Abstract: The article examines the problems arising in Modern Language Teaching and ways to solve them. Innovations in the education system today, the rapid development of technology and globalization directly affect the methods of language learning and lead to a change in traditional approaches. Modern Language Teaching is no longer only about teaching theoretical knowledge, but also focuses on developing conversational skills, practical use, and more interactive learning techniques. However, there are also some difficulties in this process: low motivation of students, lack of real speech environment and improper use of technology are considered the main problems. Although modern technologies make the process of learning a language more accessible and interesting, their excessive use can lead to a weakening of writing and reading skills. In particular, the low use of notebooks and pens by students leads to a weakening of handwriting skills, forgetting the correct spelling of some letters, and an increase in spelling errors. Therefore, in Language Teaching, Both the possibilities of technology should be used effectively and traditional writing habits should be maintained.

Keywords: language teaching, modern education, teaching methods, technology, language learning, educational problems, writing skills.

MÜASİR DÖVRDƏ DİL TƏDRİSİNDƏ PROBLEMLƏR VƏ HƏLL YOLLARI

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Xülasə: Məqalədə müasir dil tədrisində yaranan problemlər və onların həlli yolları araşdırılır. Texnologiyanın sürətli inkişafı, təhsil sistemindəki yeniliklər və qloballaşma dil öyrənmə metodlarına təsir göstərərək ənənəvi yanaşmaların dəyişməsinə səbəb olur. Müasir dil tədrisi yalnız nəzəri biliklərin öyrədilməsi ilə məhdudlaşmır, həmçinin danışmaq bacarıqlarının inkişafına, praktik istifadəyə və interaktiv təlimə diqqət yetirir.

Bu prosesdə əsas problemlər tələbələrin motivasiyasının aşağı olması, real danışmaq mühitinin olmaması və texnologiyadan düzgün istifadə edilməməsidir. Müasir texnologiyalar dil öyrənməsini daha əlçatan və maraqlı etsə də, onlardan həddindən artıq istifadə yazı və oxu bacarıqlarının zəifləməsinə səbəb ola bilər. Xüsusilə dəftər və qələmdən az istifadə şagirdlərin əl yazısının zəifləməsinə və orfoqrafik səhvlərin artmasına gətirib çıxara bilər.

Buna görə də dil tədrisində müasir texnologiyalardan səmərəli istifadə edilməli, eyni zamanda ənənəvi yazı vərdisləri qorunmalıdır.

Açar sözlər: dil tədrisi, müasir təhsil, tədris metodları, texnologiya, dil öyrənmə, təhsil problemləri, yazı bacarıqları.

Introduction

Language Teaching occupies a very important place in the modern education system and is one of the constantly developing areas. Globalization, the rapid development of technology and the expansion of international relations have increased the need for the study of languages. Today, language is already considered not only a means of communication, but also one of the main tools for Education, Science, Culture and professional life. Therefore, it is important to improve the quality of Language Teaching and find solutions to existing problems. The process of learning a language is not only about learning grammar and vocabulary. This also includes listening, speaking, reading and writing skills. (Akhundov, 2006). Previously, the language was taught in more traditional ways, but now both classical and new and interactive methods are used. This also makes learning more comfortable and effective. Language Teaching is closely related to social, psychological and technological factors. In particular, the internet, online platforms, mobile applications and artificial intelligence-based applications make language learning easier. These tools provide students with the opportunity to learn both on their own and to use the language more practically. Social networks are also one of the tools that increase language practice. However, there are also some problems. Sometimes traditional methods are not effective enough, the conversational environment is scarce, students' motivation drops, and technology is not used properly. Also, a decrease in attention to language rules during digital correspondence can negatively affect the correct use of the native language. In this article, the main problems in Language Teaching are explained in a simple way, their causes are indicated and an opinion is expressed on the ways to solve them. The goal is to make language learning more efficient and show the importance of modern methods. In addition, in the process of language teaching, the organization of classes should also be approached more differently. (Gurbanov, 2019) classes in universities and schools should not be limited to the teacher speaking and listening of students. On the contrary, students should speak more in classes, get used to expressing their thoughts both in a scientific style and in their native language. Teachers, on the other hand, should not only be the one who explains, but also the one who directs the students and corrects their mistakes. (Gurbanov, 2019) thus, students can see their mistakes and learn correctly. At the same time, students should be given tasks that develop speaking skills, take them to various events, conferences and seminars. In such environments, they listen to scientific-style speech, learn new words, and gain the urge to speak themselves. As a result, both written and oral language skills are better developed.

Methods and Materials

This study is based on a descriptive and analytical approach to the problems and solutions related to modern language teaching. The research relies primarily on the analysis of scientific and methodological literature concerning language teaching, linguistics, speech culture, language and culture, terminology, and writing skills.

The theoretical basis of the study includes the works of Azerbaijani linguists and researchers such as A. Gurbanov, A. Akhundov, R. Huseynov, S. Sadigova and A. Demirchizade. These sources were used to examine the relationship between language, speech, culture, writing and the development of modern teaching methods.

The study also considers the influence of modern technologies, including online learning platforms, mobile applications, social networks and artificial intelligence-based tools, on the language-learning process. Traditional and modern teaching approaches are compared in order to identify their advantages and limitations.

Particular attention is paid to students' speaking and writing skills, motivation, the availability of practical communication environments, and the role of technology in the learning process. The collected information was analyzed to identify the main challenges of contemporary language teaching and to determine effective approaches for addressing them.

Discussion

Language is the main tool that people use to communicate and understand each other. It is through language that people express their thoughts and opinions, which indicates that language is closely related to thinking. (Akhundov, 2006) the main goal of language teaching in modern times is not only to teach theoretical knowledge, but also to develop students' skills to use this means of communication correctly and effectively. In this regard, the fact that language is the most powerful means of communication increases the importance of practical-oriented approaches in its teaching. At the same time, the difference in the concepts of language and speech also plays an important role in Language Teaching. While language is considered as a system of general rules, speech is a practical application of those rules. One of the main problems in Modern Language Teaching is the inability of students to correctly use theoretical knowledge in speech, even if it is mastered. Therefore, in Language Teaching, Both the structure of the language should be taught and special attention should be paid to the development of speech skills.

The Azerbaijani language has been formed and developed throughout history and, despite various influences, has retained its unique features. Although at different times it was influenced by Arabic and Persian, the harmony, rhythm, intonation and grammatical structure of our language clearly demonstrate its national characteristics. This shows that language is not only a means of communication, but also an important factor reflecting the culture and identity of the people.

One of the main issues in Language Teaching in modern times is the formation of a culture of speech. The culture of speech is developed in the educational process, starting from childhood, and students, and later students, master the norms of the language. Newspapers, magazines, internet resources, television and other mass media play an important role in this process. These tools promote the correct use of language and help to learn its grammatical rules in a practical way. (Huseynov, 2013) however, there are certain problems in Modern Language Teaching. As a result of the widespread use of technology, there are impairments in the writing and speech skills of young people. The decline in handwriting, the increase in spelling errors and the mispronunciation of words are among these problems. However, the formation of individual speech characteristics is also one of the important factors to consider in Language Teaching, since the speech of each person

reflects his individual characteristics. For language teaching to be effective, the combined application of both traditional and modern approaches is essential. The development of a culture of speech, the correct observance of the rules of the language and the purposeful use of technology improve the quality of the language learning process. In this regard, language teaching should not only be limited to the provision of theoretical knowledge, but also focus on the development of practical speech skills.

There is a strong mutual connection between language and culture. In this regard, language has an important influence on culture, and culture has an important influence on the development of language. It is difficult to imagine culture without language, and language without culture. Culture is characterized as a combination of achievements, material and spiritual wealth of human society in the fields of production, social and spiritual life over the centuries (Huseynov, 2013).

Culture is formed as a result of the material and mental activity of people and is transmitted from generation to generation. In this process, language acts as the main tool and plays an important role in preserving national culture. Azerbaijani culture has also developed as an integral part of the universal culture, preserving its national characteristics and integrated into the world culture. Language is an integral part of culture, as well as one of the main indicators of national identity. Language and culture are the main criteria that determine the ethnic unity of the people. Therefore, such concepts as "Azerbaijani culture", "French culture", "ancient Roman culture" are formed precisely on the basis of linguistic and cultural identity. Thus, culture is the result of a person's material and spiritual activity, as well as the main factor that forms his worldview, way of thinking and behavior. And the culture of speech is an expression of the culture of thinking as an important component of this system.

Terminology is a special lexical system that expresses the concepts of science, technology, production and other areas. It is constantly updated under the influence of socio-economic and scientific technological progress as the most dynamic and rapidly developing part of the language. Terms serve as the main means of scientific style to accurately and systematically express knowledge. (Sadigova, 2015). The emergence of terms in the Azerbaijani language goes in two main directions: the creation of new words due to the internal capabilities of the language and the adoption of terms borrowed from other languages. In modern times, the use of international terms has increased even more, especially as the influence of the English language has intensified. One of the main features of terminology is that it is constantly changing and developing. As a result of the differentiation and integration of branches of Science, new terms arise, and some terms undergo changes. This process is closely related to the development of language. At present, there are a number of problems in the field of terminology in the Azerbaijani language. These include the systemlessness of terms, poor normalization, ambiguity, increased creation of individual terms, and the multiplicity of derived terms. These circumstances create certain difficulties in scientific communication and necessitate the standardization of terms. At the same time, work was carried out on the regulation of terms by the terminology Commission, but this process is not fully effective, since the speed of Information Exchange exceeds the pace of formation of new terms. Terminology plays a key role in the formation and transmission of scientific knowledge, and its correct regulation is of paramount importance for the scientific development of the language.

The study of the history of the development of linguistics forms the main theoretical base of Modern Language Teaching. The formation of Azerbaijani linguistics was closely connected with the development of general linguistic science, and the theoretical knowledge gained in this area directly influenced the process of teaching the language. The history of linguistics shows that

scientific knowledge of the language has come a long way of development, new approaches and methods have been formed at different times. This created conditions for the enrichment of methods and principles of language teaching in modern times. (Gurbanov, 2019). The study of the history of linguistics allows a deeper understanding of the essence, structure and functions of language. This knowledge plays an important role in the correct construction of theoretical and practical approaches in Language Teaching. Many of the problems faced in Modern Language Teaching are due precisely to insufficient consideration of the features of language development. Therefore, the study of the stages of the historical development of the language contributes to the application of more effective methods in the educational process. At the same time, the history of the development of linguistics shows that language is a constantly changing and evolving system. This feature has been further accelerated in modern times by the influence of technology and globalization. Consequently, it is considered necessary to give way to both traditional approaches and modern innovative methods in Language Teaching. This allows students to develop their language skills more efficiently.

Writing is considered one of the means of communication of people, as well as the main means of playing an important role in the development of society. Through writing, people are able to express their thoughts and emotions more accurately, clearly and systematically, passing on the acquired knowledge and experience to future generations. In this regard, writing is not only a means of communication, but also the main instrument of preserving culture, science and historical memory. (Demirchizade, 2007)

In modern times, the role of writing in Language Teaching is especially significant. Through writing, language learners master both grammatical rules and gain the ability to correctly and logically express their thoughts. Writing skills act as one of the main indicators of the practical application of the language. This makes it necessary to direct Modern Language Teaching not only to oral speech, but also to the development of written speech. At the same time, writing is formed in parallel with the development of language and acts as its integral component. Although language and writing are closely related, their distinctive features exist. It is these differences that require the parallel development of both oral and written skills in Language Teaching. Although the development of modern technologies makes the writing process much easier, in some cases it can lead to a weakening of the writing culture. The prevalence of short and informal forms of writing, especially among young people, leads to an increase in spelling errors. In this regard, the social and cultural significance of writing in modern language teaching should be taken into account, correct writing habits should be formed in students. Writing acts not only as a means of transmitting knowledge, but also as an important factor for the preservation and development of the language.

Conclusion

Language Teaching is one of the areas of great importance in the modern education system, and its development is closely related to the general development of society. In modern times, the influence of technology, globalization and new teaching methods has given new opportunities to the language learning process. Interactive programs, online platforms and digital resources contribute to a more accessible and effective implementation of Language Teaching. However, in the process of language teaching, there are such problems as a lack of motivation, a limitation of the practical conversational environment, a decrease in the effectiveness of traditional methods, and improper use of technology. These problems can affect the quality of the language learning process and necessitate the introduction of new approaches during teaching. For the development of language teaching, it is important to combine modern and traditional methods in a balanced way. An

important role in this area is played by the use of innovative teaching methods by teachers, the development of practical language skills of students and the targeted application of technology. In order to improve the quality of Language Teaching, continuous research should be carried out, innovations should be introduced in the education system, and interest in language learning should be increased.

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DEVELOPING WRITING AND SPEAKING SKILLS THROUGH SOCIAL MEDIA

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Abstract: This article examines the development of writing and speaking skills through social media in foreign language learning. The study highlights the role of social media platforms in improving students' communicative competence by providing authentic opportunities for interaction, discussion, and content creation. The article explains how platforms such as Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Telegram, and Instagram can support vocabulary expansion, pronunciation practice, critical thinking, and written expression. Different forms of online communication – posts, comments, video presentations, and live discussions – are presented as effective tools for language practice. Special attention is given to the integration of social media into the educational process, emphasizing structured tasks and teacher guidance. The study also underlines the importance of digital literacy and responsible online communication in modern education.

Keywords: writing skills, speaking skills, social media, foreign language learning, communicative competence, digital literacy

SOSYAL MEDYA ARACILIĞIYLA YAZMA VE KONUŞMA BECERİLERİNİN GELİŞTİRİLMESİ

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Özet: Bu makale, yabancı dil öğrenimi sürecinde sosyal medya aracılığıyla yazma ve konuşma becerilerinin geliştirilmesini ele almaktadır. Araştırma, sosyal medya platformlarının öğrencilere etkileşim, tartışma ve içerik üretimi için gerçek fırsatlar sunarak iletişimsel yeterliliklerini geliştirmedeki rolünü vurgulamaktadır. Makalede Instagram, TikTok, YouTube ve Telegram gibi platformların kelime dağarcığını genişletmeye, telaffuz pratiği yapmaya, eleştirel düşünmeyi ve yazılı ifade becerilerini geliştirmeye nasıl katkı sağladığı açıklanmaktadır. Paylaşımlar, yorumlar, video sunumları ve canlı tartışmalar gibi çeşitli çevrimiçi iletişim biçimleri, dil pratiği için etkili araçlar olarak sunulmaktadır. Ayrıca, sosyal medyanın eğitim sürecine entegrasyonu, yapılandırılmış görevler ve öğretmen rehberliği vurgulanarak ele alınmaktadır. Bununla birlikte, modern eğitimde dijital okuryazarlığın ve sorumlu çevrimiçi iletişimin önemi de vurgulanmaktadır.

Anahtar kelimeler: yazma becerileri, konuşma becerileri, sosyal medya, yabancı dil öğrenimi, iletişimsel yeterlilik, dijital okuryazarlık

Introduction

Nowadays, social media has become an essential part of students' daily lives, significantly influencing the way they communicate, learn, and share information. Platforms such as Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Telegram, and Facebook are no longer used only for entertainment; they have also developed into powerful educational tools, especially in the context of foreign language learning. These platforms provide students with continuous access to authentic language input and real communication opportunities beyond the classroom environment.

Through social media, students can actively practice writing skills by creating posts, sharing opinions, leaving comments, and participating in online discussions. This type of writing is often more meaningful and engaging because it has a real audience, which encourages students to be more careful, creative, and expressive. At the same time, speaking skills can be improved through activities such as recording video presentations, sending voice messages, participating in live streams, or even collaborating with others in online conversations. These interactive formats help students overcome fear of speaking and build confidence gradually.

Developing writing and speaking skills is one of the main goals in learning a foreign language, as these productive skills allow learners to express their ideas clearly, effectively, and independently. While traditional classroom activities provide a necessary theoretical foundation, they sometimes lack real-life communication contexts. Social media fills this gap by offering authentic, dynamic, and informal environments where students can apply their knowledge naturally and spontaneously. As a result, learning becomes more practical, interactive, and motivating.

Furthermore, social media creates valuable opportunities for students to communicate with native speakers and individuals from different cultural backgrounds. This not only enhances their language proficiency but also develops intercultural competence, which is an important aspect of modern education. Students become more aware of cultural differences, communication styles, and global perspectives.

However, despite its many advantages, the use of social media in education also requires proper guidance and supervision from teachers. Without clear instructions, students may become distracted or use these platforms ineffectively. Teachers should guide learners on how to use social media responsibly, select appropriate content, and maintain a balance between educational and personal use.

Main part

In modern education, the development of writing and speaking skills is closely connected with the use of social media. Students spend a significant part of their daily lives on platforms such

as Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Telegram, and Facebook, which makes these tools highly relevant for language learning. Unlike traditional classroom exercises, social media provides authentic communication, where students can express opinions, interact with others, and receive immediate feedback. This creates a more natural environment for practicing foreign language skill (1).

Writing and speaking are productive skills that require active language use. Writing helps students organize thoughts, develop vocabulary, and improve grammatical accuracy, while speaking develops fluency, pronunciation, and confidence. Social media combines both skills because learners often write captions, comments, and messages, and also create videos, voice messages, and live presentations. This interaction supports communicative competence and makes language learning more practical and engaging.

In the context of foreign language teaching, writing competence refers to the ability to produce clear, coherent, and grammatically correct texts for different purposes. Speaking competence means the ability to express ideas fluently, logically, and appropriately in real communication (2). Both competences are essential parts of communicative competence, as they allow learners to participate actively in academic and social life. The integration of social media strengthens these competences by providing real situations for language use rather than only theoretical practice.

Platform	Writing skills	Speaking skills
Instagram	captions, comments, stories	live sessions, video stories
TikTok	script writing, comments	short video speaking practice
YouTube	video descriptions, discussions	presentations, pronunciation practice
Telegram	text messages, group discussions	voice messages, speaking groups
Facebook	posts, formal comments	live discussions, public speaking

Table 1. Social Media Platforms and Language Skills Development

As shown in Table 1, each social media platform contributes differently to language development, offering unique opportunities for practicing specific skills. For instance, Instagram encourages short yet meaningful written communication through captions, stories, and comments. Students learn to express ideas clearly and creatively within limited space, which helps develop conciseness and precision in writing. In contrast, TikTok focuses more on speaking skills, as it allows users to create short videos where they can present ideas, tell stories, or share opinions. This format helps learners practice pronunciation, intonation, and fluency in a more relaxed and engaging environment. Meanwhile, Telegram is especially useful for both written and spoken interaction because students can exchange text messages, voice notes, and even participate in group discussions, making communication more dynamic and interactive (3).

One effective classroom activity is the “caption writing task,” where students create Instagram-style captions based on educational topics. For example, students may be asked to write a post about environmental protection: “Saving our planet starts with small actions. Reduce plastic use, recycle waste, and protect nature for future generations.” This activity encourages students to think critically about word choice, tone, and audience. It also helps them practice summarizing

ideas in a clear and attractive way. Moreover, because the format is familiar and similar to real-life social media use, students are often more motivated and engaged in the task.

Another useful activity is the “one-minute video challenge,” where students record short videos expressing their opinions on a given topic. For instance, students might talk about the importance of learning English: “English is an international language that connects people from different countries. It helps students access global education, travel confidently, and build successful careers.” This task helps improve speaking fluency, pronunciation, and confidence. It also teaches students how to organize their thoughts quickly and present them in a structured and coherent way within a limited time frame.

In addition, teachers can expand these activities by including peer feedback, where students comment on each other’s posts or videos. This not only improves their analytical and critical thinking skills but also creates a supportive learning community. Students learn to give constructive feedback, notice language mistakes, and learn from each other’s ideas.

Overall, integrating such interactive tasks into the learning process makes language practice more authentic, engaging, and effective. Social media-based activities bridge the gap between classroom learning and real-life communication, helping students develop both writing and speaking skills in a natural and enjoyable way.



Scheme 1. Development of Writing and Speaking Skills through Social Media

This scheme shows that writing often supports speaking development. When students first organize ideas in written form, they become more confident in oral production. Social media naturally creates this connection because learners frequently move from writing comments to discussing ideas in spoken form (4).

In my teaching practice with students, I use discussion tasks based on social media content. For example, students watch a short TikTok educational video and then discuss its main idea in class. This encourages critical thinking and spontaneous speaking. Another activity is analyzing YouTube interviews, where students observe pronunciation, intonation, and communication strategies used by native speakers. Such tasks help bridge classroom learning with real-life language use.

Public figures also demonstrate the importance of strong writing and speaking skills in digital communication. For example, Emma Watson is known for her effective public speaking and meaningful use of social media. Her speeches at international events show clear structure,

confidence, and persuasive communication, while her online presence demonstrates responsible written interaction with a global audience. This example helps students understand how communication skills are valuable beyond the classroom.

However, the use of social media in education also requires careful planning and consistent guidance. Without teacher support, students may focus mainly on entertainment rather than educational value, which can reduce the effectiveness of learning. Therefore, teachers play a key role in structuring activities, setting clear learning objectives, and monitoring students' progress. It is important to design tasks that are purposeful and connected to learning outcomes, rather than allowing uncontrolled or passive use of social platforms. In addition, teachers should encourage responsible digital behavior, including respectful communication, awareness of online safety, and critical evaluation of information. Digital literacy becomes an essential component of this process, as students need to understand not only how to use language, but also how to interact appropriately and effectively in online environments.

Task-Based Learning is especially effective in this context because it emphasizes meaningful communication and real-life language use instead of isolated grammar practice. By focusing on completing tasks with a clear purpose, students are naturally encouraged to use language as a tool for communication. Activities such as writing blog posts, recording mini-presentations, creating social media content, or participating in online discussions and debates provide authentic reasons to use English. These tasks simulate real communication situations, making learning more practical and engaging.

Moreover, task-based activities help develop a range of important skills, including critical thinking, problem-solving, and collaboration. For example, when students work together on a group project or respond to each other's posts, they learn how to organize ideas, express opinions, and negotiate meaning. This process not only improves their writing and speaking abilities but also strengthens their confidence in using the language independently.

As a result, students become more motivated and autonomous learners. They begin to take responsibility for their own learning, explore language beyond the classroom, and use it in meaningful contexts. Over time, this leads to greater confidence in expressing themselves both academically and socially, preparing them for real-world communication in a global and digital society (5).

The integration of social media into foreign language teaching creates a more student-centered learning environment, where communication becomes meaningful, purposeful, and relevant to real-life situations. Instead of passively receiving information, students actively participate in the learning process by creating content, sharing ideas, and interacting with others. This shift increases engagement and makes learning more dynamic and personalized, as students can express themselves in ways that reflect their interests and experiences.

By combining traditional teaching methods with modern digital tools, educators can create a balanced and effective approach to language learning. While classroom instruction provides structure, grammar knowledge, and academic support, social media offers authentic contexts where students can apply what they have learned. This combination helps bridge the gap between theory and practice, allowing learners to use language more naturally and confidently.

Moreover, the use of social media supports continuous learning beyond the classroom. Students can practice writing and speaking at any time, receive feedback from peers and teachers,

and observe how language is used in real communication. This constant exposure strengthens their language competence and helps develop fluency over time.

These abilities are essential not only for academic success but also for future professional development and everyday communication. In today's globalized and digital world, strong writing and speaking skills enable individuals to collaborate internationally, access information, and participate effectively in various social and professional contexts. Therefore, integrating social media into language education is not just a modern trend but a necessary step in preparing students for real-world communication and lifelong learning (6).

Conclusion

The development of writing and speaking skills through social media has become an increasingly important aspect of modern foreign language education, as it reflects the way students naturally communicate in the digital age. Social media platforms such as Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Telegram, and Facebook provide learners with continuous and authentic opportunities to practice language in real communicative situations. Unlike traditional classroom activities, which are often limited to structured exercises, these platforms allow students to interact more freely and spontaneously. They can share ideas, express opinions, respond to others, and receive immediate feedback from a wide audience, which makes the learning process more dynamic, interactive, and motivating.

Writing and speaking are closely interconnected productive skills that play a central role in developing overall communicative competence. Writing helps students organize their thoughts, improve grammatical accuracy, and expand their vocabulary range, while speaking focuses on fluency, pronunciation, intonation, and self-confidence. In this sense, both skills support each other and should be developed together rather than separately. Social media creates a practical and engaging environment where this integration naturally occurs. For example, students write captions, comments, and posts while also producing video content, voice recordings, and participating in live discussions. As a result, they practice both written and spoken communication in meaningful and realistic contexts.

Furthermore, the use of structured and purposeful tasks such as caption writing, one-minute speaking challenges, online debates, reflective video tasks, and peer-response activities helps students become more independent and confident language users. These tasks encourage learners to think critically, organize their ideas clearly, and adapt their language according to the audience and purpose. At the same time, teacher guidance remains essential in ensuring that students use social media effectively for educational purposes. Teachers should provide clear instructions, set learning goals, and offer constructive feedback. They also play an important role in developing students' responsible digital communication habits, including respectful interaction, appropriate language use, and awareness of online ethics. Therefore, digital literacy becomes a key component of modern language education alongside traditional linguistic competence.

In conclusion, integrating social media into the educational process significantly contributes to the development of writing and speaking proficiency in foreign language learning. It transforms the learning environment into a more student-centered and interactive space where language is used for real communication rather than only classroom practice. By combining traditional teaching methods with modern digital technologies, educators can create a more balanced and effective learning experience. This approach not only improves fluency and accuracy but also increases learners' motivation and confidence. Ultimately, social media functions not just as a tool for

entertainment and information, but as a powerful educational resource that supports the development of essential communication skills needed in the 21st century.

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THE ROLE OF INTERACTIVE METHODS IN IMPROVING ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS

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Abstract: In the context of globalization, English has become an essential tool for communication, education, and professional development. As a result, the effectiveness of English language teaching has gained significant importance. Traditional teaching methods are increasingly being replaced by interactive approaches that emphasize student participation and engagement. This study investigates the role of interactive methods in improving English language skills.

The research focuses on strategies such as group work, role-playing, discussions, problem-solving tasks, and digital tools. These methods promote a learner-centered environment where students actively use language rather than passively receive information.

The study is based on qualitative research methods, including classroom observation and teaching practice analysis. The results indicate that interactive methods enhance students' motivation, confidence, and communicative competence. Learners demonstrate improved speaking, listening, reading, and writing skills. Furthermore, the integration of technology supports flexible and effective learning. The study concludes that interactive methods significantly contribute to successful language acquisition and should be widely implemented in modern education systems.

Key words: interactive methods, English language teaching, communicative competence, student engagement, digital learning, classroom interaction, language development

İTERAKTİV ÜSULLARIN İNGİLİS DİLİ BİLİKLƏRİNİN TƏKMİLLƏŞDİRİLMƏSİNDƏ ROLU

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Xülasə: Müasir qloballaşma və rəqəmsallaşma dövründə ingilis dili yalnız xarici dil kimi deyil, həm də beynəlxalq ünsiyyət, elm, texnologiya və peşəkar inkişaf sahələrində əsas vasitələrdən biri kimi çıxış edir. Bu səbəbdən onun effektiv və müasir tələblərə uyğun şəkildə tədrisi təhsil sisteminin prioritet istiqamətlərindən hesab olunur.

Ənənəvi tədris metodları, əsasən, qrammatik qaydaların öyrədilməsi və mexaniki yadda saxlamaya əsaslandığı üçün şagirdlərin kommunikativ bacarıqlarının inkişafında kifayət qədər səmərəli olmur. Müasir pedaqoji yanaşmalar isə daha çox şagirdyönlü təlimə üstünlük verir və interaktiv metodların tətbiqini vacib hesab edir. Bu metodlar şagirdlərin dərş prosesində fəal iştirakını təmin etməklə yanaşı, onların dili real ünsiyyət mühitində istifadə etməsinə imkan yaradır.

Tədqiqatın əsas məqsədi interaktiv metodların ingilis dili bacarıqlarının inkişafına təsirini araşdırmaqdır. Araşdırma zamanı qrup işi, rollu oyunlar, müzakirələr, problem həlli tapşırıqları və rəqəmsal alətlər kimi üsullar təhlil edilmişdir. Bu metodlar şagirdlərin dərş prosesində fəal iştirakını təmin edir, onların motivasiyasını artırır və dili real ünsiyyət mühitində istifadə etməyə şərait yaradır.

Nəticələr göstərir ki, interaktiv yanaşmalar şagirdlərin danışq, dınləmə, oxu və yazı bacarıqlarını daha effektiv şəkildə inkişaf etdirir. Eyni zamanda, bu metodlar tənqidi düşünmə, əməkdaşlıq və müstəqil öyrənmə bacarıqlarının formalaşmasına da müsbət təsir göstərir. Beləliklə, interaktiv metodların tədris prosesinə inteqrasiyası daha keyfiyyətli və nəticəyönlü təhsilin təmin olunmasında mühüm rol oynayır.

Açar sözlər: İnteraktiv metodlar, ingilis dilinin tədrisi, kommunikativ bacarıqlar, tələbə fəallığı, dil bacarıqları

Introduction

English is widely recognized as the global language of communication. It plays a crucial role in education, business, science, and international relations (Richards & Rodgers, 2014). Therefore, improving the quality of English language teaching is a major priority.

Traditional methods often focus on grammar translation and memorization. While these approaches may help students understand rules, they do not effectively develop communication skills (Harmer, 2015). In contrast, interactive methods provide opportunities for real communication, collaboration, and active learning. (Scrivener, 2011)

This paper aims to analyze how interactive teaching methods improve students' English language skills and overall learning outcomes. It also examines the challenges and benefits associated with their implementation.

Materials and Methods

This study is based on qualitative research methods. Data were collected through classroom observations and analysis of teaching practices, which are widely used in educational research (Dweck & Yeager, 2019)

The following interactive methods were examined:

- Group work – encourages collaboration and peer learning (Harmer, 2015)
- Role-play – simulates real-life situations and improves speaking skills (Scrivener, 2011).
- Discussion – develops critical thinking and communication (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).
- Problem-solving tasks – engage students in active learning.
- Digital tools – support online and blended learning environments (Chapelle, 2020).

These methods were applied in different classroom settings to evaluate their effectiveness.

Results and Discussion

The findings of this study show that interactive methods significantly improve students' language learning experience.

Firstly, students become more motivated and actively engaged in lessons. Interactive activities make learning more enjoyable and reduce anxiety (Dweck & Yeager, 2019).

Secondly, speaking and listening skills improve considerably. Role-play and discussions provide opportunities for real communication practice (Harmer, 2015).

Thirdly, group work enhances collaboration and social interaction. Students learn from each other and develop important interpersonal skills.

Furthermore, interactive methods help learners apply language in real-life contexts, which increases retention and understanding (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).

However, some challenges were identified, including time management, large class sizes, and the need for teacher preparation. Despite these challenges, the advantages of interactive methods are more significant and contribute to better learning outcomes.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the findings of this study clearly demonstrate that interactive teaching methods play a crucial role in improving English language skills. Unlike traditional approaches, which often rely on passive learning and memorization, interactive methods actively engage students in the learning process and create meaningful opportunities for communication (Harmer, 2015). As a result, learners are better able to develop their speaking, listening, reading, and writing skills in an integrated and practical manner.

Moreover, interactive approaches significantly enhance students' motivation, confidence, and willingness to participate in classroom activities (Dweck & Yeager, 2019). Through techniques such as group work, role-play, discussions, and problem-solving tasks, learners are encouraged to express their ideas, collaborate with peers, and use English in real-life contexts. This not only improves their linguistic competence but also fosters essential 21st-century skills, including critical thinking, creativity, and teamwork.

Despite certain challenges, such as large class sizes, limited time, and insufficient resources, the advantages of interactive teaching methods outweigh their limitations. Therefore, it is strongly recommended that educators incorporate these approaches into their teaching practices to achieve better learning outcomes. Future research may focus on the long-term impact of interactive learning and the potential of emerging technologies, such as artificial intelligence, in language education.

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COGNITIVE AND METACOGNITIVE STRATEGIES IN TEACHING LISTENING COMPREHENSION IN EFL CONTEXTS

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Abstract: Listening comprehension is one of the most challenging skills in English as a Foreign Language (EFL) learning because it requires learners to process spoken language in real time. This paper examines the role of cognitive and metacognitive strategies in improving L2 listening comprehension. Cognitive strategies such as prediction, inferencing, note-taking, and summarization help learners process spoken input, while metacognitive strategies such as planning, monitoring, evaluation, and self-regulation help learners manage their own learning processes. Research shows that integrating cognitive and metacognitive instruction leads to higher listening achievement, greater strategic awareness, and increased learner autonomy compared to traditional product-oriented approaches. The paper reviews major theoretical foundations, empirical findings, pedagogical models, and classroom applications related to strategic listening instruction. It also discusses challenges faced in EFL contexts, including large class sizes, exam-oriented systems, and insufficient teacher preparation. The findings emphasize the importance of shifting from passive listening activities toward process-oriented and reflective listening instruction that supports self-regulated learning.

Keywords: L2 listening, cognitive strategies, metacognitive strategies, self-regulated learning, EFL pedagogy, learner autonomy

XARİCİ DİL (EFL) KONTEKSTİNDƏ DİNLƏYİB-ANLAMA BACARIĞININ TƏDRİSİNDƏ KOQNİTİV VƏ METAKOQNİTİV STRATEGİYALAR

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Xülasə: Dinləyib-anlama bacarığı ikinci dil mənimsənilməsinin ən mürəkkəb və çətin sahələrindən biri hesab olunur, xüsusilə də ingilis dilinin xarici dil kimi tədris edildiyi (EFL) mühitlərdə. Bu məqalə dinləyib-anlama prosesində koqnitiv və metakoqnitiv strategiyaların rolunu araşdırır və onların tələbələrin dinləmə bacarıqlarının inkişafına təsirini təhlil edir. Koqnitiv strategiyalar proqnozlaşdırma, nəticə çıxarma, qeyd aparma, ümumiləşdirmə və əlaqələndirmə kimi üsulları əhatə edir və tələbələrə şifahi məlumatı daha səmərəli şəkildə emal etməyə kömək edir. Metakoqnitiv strategiyalar isə planlaşdırma, monitoring, qiymətləndirmə və özünü tənzimləmə proseslərini əhatə edir. Bu strategiyalar vasitəsilə tələbələr öz dinləmə proseslərini daha yaxşı anlayır və öyrənmələrini idarə etmə bacarığı qazanırlar. Tədqiqat Andersonun informasiya emalı modeli, Flavellin metakoqnitiv nəzəriyyəsi və Zimmermanın özünü tənzimləyən öyrənmə modeli kimi əsas nəzəri yanaşmaları nəzərdən keçirir. Məqalədə həmçinin koqnitiv və metakoqnitiv strategiyaların birlikdə tətbiq edilməsinin ənənəvi nəticəyönlü metodlardan daha yüksək dinləmə nəticələri, strateji şüur və öyrənən müstəqilliyi yaratdığına dair empirik araşdırmalar təhlil edilir. Dinləmə

gündəlikləri, "think-aloud" fəaliyyətləri, reflektiv müzakirələr, əməkdaşlığa əsaslanan tapşırıqlar və autentik materiallardan istifadə kimi praktik sinif üsulları da təqdim olunur. Eyni zamanda böyük siniflər, imtahan yönümlü təhsil sistemi, müəllim hazırlığının məhdudluğu və tələbələrin reflektiv fəaliyyətlərə müqaviməti kimi problemlər müzakirə edilir. Nəticədə, strategiyaya əsaslanan və proses yönümlü dinləmə tədrisinin tələbələrin müstəqil və özünü tənzimləyən öyrənməsini gücləndirdiyi vurğulanır.

Açar sözlər: L2 dinləmə, koqnitiv strategiyalar, metakoqnitiv strategiyalar, özünü tənzimləyən öyrənmə, EFL pedaqogikası, strategiya tədrisi, öyrənən müstəqilliyi

Introduction

Listening plays a central role in second language acquisition because it provides learners with essential language input and supports communication development. Studies indicate that listening occupies nearly half of daily communication time, yet it remains one of the least explicitly taught skills in many EFL classrooms. Traditional approaches have historically focused more on reading and writing than oral communication.

Listening comprehension is particularly difficult because spoken language is temporary and must be processed immediately. Learners cannot reread or slow down spoken discourse during authentic communication. EFL learners also face phonological, linguistic, discourse-level, and psychological difficulties such as unfamiliar pronunciation, rapid speech, limited vocabulary, and anxiety.

Traditional listening instruction often follows a product-oriented model in which learners listen to recordings and answer comprehension questions. Such approaches rarely teach learners how to listen strategically. As a result, students frequently depend on ineffective habits such as word-by-word translation.

Methodology and Materials

This paper supports a strategy-based approach to listening instruction that combines cognitive and metacognitive strategies. Cognitive strategies help learners process language input, while metacognitive strategies enable learners to plan, monitor, and evaluate their listening processes. Together, these approaches encourage learner autonomy and strategic competence.

Conventional listening pedagogy follows predictable patterns: teachers present audio texts, learners listen passively, comprehension is assessed through multiple-choice or true-false questions, and instruction proceeds to subsequent content. This product-focused approach emphasizes correct answers while ignoring listening processes. Learners receive minimal guidance regarding strategy selection, comprehension monitoring, or repair mechanisms. Consequently, learners remain dependent on external assessment while developing limited metacognitive awareness. Without explicit strategy instruction, learners often resort to ineffective tactics such as word-by-word translation or fixation on unknown vocabulary. These passive, reactive approaches fail to develop the strategic competence and metacognitive awareness enabling autonomous listening comprehension. Contemporary research increasingly advocates for strategy-based, process-oriented approaches enabling learner development toward independence.

Anderson's model describes listening as a process involving perception, parsing, and utilization. During perception, listeners recognize sounds and phonological patterns. Parsing involves identifying grammatical structures and constructing meaning. Utilization connects new information with background knowledge and communicative intent. Skilled listeners combine bottom-up and top-down processing effectively, whereas less skilled listeners often focus excessively on decoding individual words.

Metacognition refers to awareness and regulation of cognitive processes. In listening, it includes knowledge about tasks, strategies, and personal listening abilities. Goh (1997) identifies three

components of listening metacognition: person knowledge, task knowledge, and strategy knowledge. Metacognitive awareness enables learners to select appropriate strategies and adapt them to specific listening situations.

Zimmerman's theory of self-regulated learning emphasizes goal-setting, strategy use, monitoring, and reflection. In listening instruction, learners actively manage their comprehension by selecting strategies, evaluating performance, and adjusting their approaches. Through guided instruction and practice, learners gradually develop independence.

Discussion

Research identifies skilled listeners as individuals engaging in continuous metacognitive monitoring while flexibly combining diverse strategies. Skilled listeners focus on meaning units rather than individual words, employ context-based inferencing to resolve ambiguities, actively predict upcoming information, and implement targeted repair strategies when comprehension falters. Crucially, skilled listeners distinguish between different difficulty types, distinguishing personal processing limitations from genuine input ambiguity, enabling appropriate strategy selection. Less skilled listeners often persist in unsuccessful strategies, fixate on unknown vocabulary, and lack systematic comprehension monitoring. These differences suggest that metacognitive awareness and strategy flexibility characterize accomplished listening performance.

Research shows that skilled listeners predict information, focus on meaning rather than individual words, and apply repair strategies when comprehension problems occur. They continuously monitor understanding and adjust strategies according to task demands. Less skilled listeners often rely on ineffective habits such as mental translation and excessive attention to unknown vocabulary.

Bottom-up strategies involve processing sounds, words, and grammatical structures sequentially. These strategies are essential for recognizing spoken language but are insufficient alone in authentic communication. Top-down strategies rely on prior knowledge, context, and expectations. Prediction and inferencing allow learners to compensate for incomplete understanding and process spoken texts more efficiently. Because spoken language disappears quickly, learners need strategies that support memory and organization. Note-taking, summarization, chunking, and mental imagery help learners retain important information and reduce cognitive load.

Although cognitive strategies are valuable, they are less effective without metacognitive support. Learners who lack metacognitive awareness often fail to transfer strategies to new contexts or evaluate their effectiveness independently. Therefore, integrating cognitive and metacognitive instruction is essential.

The Metacognitive Awareness Listening Questionnaire (MALQ) identifies key dimensions of metacognitive listening: planning and evaluation, directed attention, problem-solving, mental translation, and person knowledge. These dimensions reflect learners' ability to regulate listening comprehension.

Research consistently demonstrates the effectiveness of metacognitive instruction. Studies by Dimassi (2017), Vandergrift et al. (2006), and others show that learners receiving metacognitive training achieve better listening performance and greater self-regulation than learners taught through traditional methods. Meta-analytic studies also confirm moderate to strong positive effects.

Effective listeners monitor comprehension continuously and apply repair strategies when difficulties occur. These include inferencing, clarification, paraphrasing, and selective attention. Explicit instruction in monitoring and repair strategies increases learners' confidence and independence.

Vandergrift and Goh (2012) propose a metacognitive pedagogical sequence involving pre-listening, while-listening, and post-listening stages. During pre-listening, learners activate background knowledge and set goals. While-listening activities focus on global and detailed comprehension. Post-listening activities encourage reflection on strategy use and comprehension difficulties.

Practical classroom techniques include listening journals, strategy checklists, collaborative discussions, teacher think-alouds, guided practice, and technology-supported listening activities. These methods help learners become more aware of their listening processes.

Teachers should gradually reduce instructional support as learners become more independent. Authentic materials such as podcasts, lectures, and news broadcasts expose learners to real-world language use and encourage strategic listening.

EFL contexts often present barriers to metacognitive instruction. Large class sizes, limited classroom time, and examination-oriented systems frequently prioritize correct answers over strategic development. Additionally, many teachers receive limited training in metacognitive pedagogy.

Learners may also resist reflective activities because they are unfamiliar with process-oriented learning. Successful implementation therefore requires teacher training, curriculum integration, appropriate materials, and supportive classroom environments.

Conclusion

This review demonstrates that effective listening instruction should combine cognitive and metacognitive strategies. Cognitive strategies help learners process spoken input, while metacognitive strategies enable learners to regulate comprehension and become autonomous listeners. Research strongly supports the integration of strategy instruction into listening pedagogy. Teachers should move beyond traditional product-oriented approaches and adopt reflective, process-oriented methods that develop learner independence. Despite challenges in EFL contexts, metacognitive listening instruction offers significant benefits for listening proficiency, strategic awareness, and self-regulated learning.

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A SYSTEMATIC REVIEW OF CONTENT AND LANGUAGE INTEGRATED LEARNING RESEARCH IN THE TURKISH CONTEXT

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Abstract: As a teaching approach, content and language integrated learning (CLIL) is a subject of research in language education and education overall, with implications for both research and pedagogy, aiming to teach content through a second or foreign language that extends beyond language education. With the purpose of teaching in schools through more than one language, the development of both the second and foreign languages, and the content taught, is aimed at. The aim of this systematic review is to examine the literature on CLIL in the Turkish context between 2015 and 2026. With the inclusion and exclusion criteria applied, a total of 13 research articles have been identified and reviewed with respect to their context, methodology, and findings. The results showcase a gap in CLIL research in the Turkish Context. In this paper, the results of the systematic review are explained in detail.

Keywords: Content and Language Integrated Learning, CLIL, Foreign Language Education

TÜRKİYEDE YAPILAN İÇERİK VE DİL BÜTÜNLEŞTİRİLMİŞ ÖĞRENME ARAŞTIRMALARININ SİSTEMATİK BİR İNCELEMESİ

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Özet: İçerik ve dil bütünleştirilmiş öğrenme, bir öğretim yaklaşımı olarak dil eğitiminin kendi içeriğine ek olarak farklı alan içeriklerinin ikinci veya yabancı dil aracılığıyla öğretilmesi amacıyla hem pedagojik hem de araştırma çıktılarıyla dil eğitimi ve genel olarak eğitimde araştırılan bir konudur. Okullarda birden fazla dil aracılığıyla öğretim yapılmasıyla, hem ikinci veya yabancı bir dilin, hem de

öğretilen içeriğin geliştirilmesi hedeflenmektedir. Bu sistematik derlemenin amacı, 2015-2026 yılları arasında Türkiye bağlamında içerik ve dil bütünleştirilmiş öğrenme araştırmalarına yönelik literatürü sistematik olarak incelemektir. Uygulanan kriterler sonucunda toplam 13 araştırma makalesine ulaşılmıştır ve bu makaleler bağlam, metodoloji ve bulgular açısından incelenmiştir. Elde edilen sonuçlar, Türkiye bağlamında içerik ve dil bütünleştirilmiş öğrenme araştırmalarında bir literatür boşluğu bulunduğu işaret etmektedir. Bu makalede, sistematik derlemenin sonuçları detaylı bir şekilde açıklanmaktadır.

Anahtar Kelimeler: İçerik ve Dil Bütünleştirilmiş Öğrenme, CLIL, Yabancı Dil Eğitimi

1. Introduction

Content and Language Integrated Learning (CLIL) is a product of the European multilingual policy that was created with the aim of European citizens being able to use three European languages, also known as the L1+2 objective (Hemmi & Banegas, 2021). As an approach, the aim of CLIL is to integrate content and language and to achieve the successful process of learning content through the use of a foreign language, with the additional aim of learning the foreign language in the process (Marsh, 2002).

While bilingual education as a concept has not emerged first with CLIL, it is a form of it that has been highly researched in various contexts, and through such research, it has been observed to be a type of approach to language and content outside of language education, both through an immersive lens with observed success. However, results such as lower attainment in productive skills compared to receptive skills, and weaknesses in grammatical competence and vocabulary knowledge, have also been observed (Pérez-Cañado, 2012). With the features of CLIL including aspects such as a rich learning environment, authenticity, active learning, co-operation, scaffolding, and so on (Cinganotto, 2016), CLIL as a concept from a practical point have been researched through various countries and perspectives all around the world such as Spain, Germany, Finland, the Netherlands, Austria, Belgium, Portugal, Colombia, Kazakhstan, China, Iran, and so on (Poveda-Garcia-Noblejas & Antropova, 2024).

The objective of this research is to examine CLIL research in the Turkish context by analyzing the properties of the research participants, research type, and the focus of published research articles, with a main focus on CLIL in Türkiye. For this objective, the following research question is developed:

1. What are the main foci of CLIL research conducted in the Turkish context?
2. What research methodologies have been employed by CLIL research conducted in the Turkish context?
3. What is the type of research participants employed by CLIL research conducted in the Turkish context?

2. Materials and Methods

The methodology of this study is the systematic review. The systematic review will follow the 5 steps employed in such studies (Khan et al., 2003):

1. Framing questions for a review
2. Identifying relevant work
3. Assessing the quality of studies
4. Summarizing the evidence
5. Interpreting the findings

The systematic review at hand will follow the aforementioned steps. After the questions are set for the review, and the relevant work is identified through the Web of Science and Scopus

databases with the following advanced research keywords: “CLIL OR clil OR Content and Language Integrated Learning”, the following inclusion criteria were followed to include the found studies:

1. Research with participants from the Turkish context as the sole participant group or a part of a participant group was included.
2. Research published between 2015 and 2026 was included.
3. Research articles found on the Web of Science and Scopus databases were included.

Furthermore, the following exclusion criteria were used on the list of studies in addition to the inclusion criteria:

1. Research articles not mainly focusing on CLIL were excluded. While CLIL was not sought out to be the sole variable in the research, research without a sole focus on the topic was excluded.
2. Duplicate articles found on both indexes were scanned, and one of the duplicates was excluded from the list.
3. Only research articles were included, which excluded systematic reviews, meta-analyses, book chapters, conference proceedings, and so on.
4. Research published before 2015 was excluded from the review.

After applying the inclusion/exclusion criteria, the final number of studies analyzed in this systematic review was 13. The articles will be summarized and analyzed in accordance with the research question in the following section.

3. Results And Discussion

The list of studies, categorized by foci, participant groups, and research methodology, is given in Table 1 below.

As shown in the table, the research focuses primarily on teachers' and students' attitudes toward CLIL and other factors related to and potentially affected by CLIL. Regarding the participant group, most of the research involves in-service teachers. Regarding methodology, there is a balance between quantitative, qualitative, and mixed-method studies.

Table 1.

The list of articles categorized by foci, participant groups, and research methodology

Foci	Participants	Methodology	N	Articles
Language Proficiency			3	(Ağmaz & Temel, 2021), (Bozdoğan & Karlıdağ, 2013), (Sendur et al., 2022)
Cognitive Development and Content Mastery			2	(Bozdoğan & Karlıdağ, 2013), (Sendur et al., 2022)
Attitudes, Cultural Awareness, and Learner Differences			11	(Akay et al., 2025), (Ağmaz & Temel, 2021), (Bozdoğan & Karlıdağ, 2013), (Demirkol Orak et al., 2026), (Demirkol Orak, 2025), (Gülşen & Dikilitaş, 2023), (Işık, 2020) (Mede & Çınar, 2018) (Nashaat-Sobhy et al., 2026), (Taniş & Dikilitaş, 2019), (Yalçın et al., 2020)
	Pre-school		1	(Ağmaz & Temel, 2021)

	Secondary Education (5 th to 8 th grade)		2	(Işık, 2020), (Taniş & Dikilitaş, 2019)
	University		4	(Akay et al., 2025), (Bozdoğan & Karlıdağ, 2013), (Mede & Çınar, 2018), (Sendur et al., 2022)
	In-service Teachers		8	(Gülşen & Dikilitaş, 2023), (Işık, 2020), (Nashaat-Sobhy et al., 2026), (Demirkol Orak, 2025) (Demirkol Orak et al., 2026), (Metli & Akıs, 2022) (Yalçın et al., 2020), (Taniş & Dikilitaş, 2019)
		Quantitative	4	(Ağmaz & Temel, 2021), (Demirkol Orak, 2025), (Demirkol Orak et al., 2026), (Sendur et al., 2022)
		Qualitative	5	(Bozdoğan & Karlıdağ, 2013), (Gülşen & Dikilitaş, 2023), (Metli & Akıs, 2022), (Nashaat-Sobhy et al., 2026), (Yalçın et al., 2020)
		Mixed-Method	4	(Akay et al., 2025), (Işık, 2020), (Mede & Çınar, 2018), (Taniş & Dikilitaş, 2019)

A number of studies, in terms of focus and/or participants, have been assigned to more than one category. If the research has two separate participant groups, for example, teachers and university students, they are added to both categories.

In terms of focus, if the study focuses on more than one category, and it is difficult to pinpoint which topic is given more importance compared to the other data collected and studied for the research, the study is added to more than one category.

The perceived preference for a certain focus on CLIL in research conducted in the Turkish context, as well as the perceived misalignment in the participant groups studied in the CLIL studies reviewed in this systematic review, are evident. The main focus of the majority of the studies is on the attitudes towards the use of CLIL from the perspectives of teachers and/or students, which might have been caused by the lack of research and practice of CLIL in Türkiye, which might have caused the limited number of studies to be exploratory in nature. Even so, an experimental design philosophy in research can be seen; for example, in the research on gastronomy and culinary arts students, data was collected from the participants for an exploratory phase, but the study also implemented CLIL-based activities over a timeframe, and reflection reports were collected about the process (Akay et al., 2025). Through this, a reduction of speaking anxiety was seen to be significant after the implementation of CLIL-based activities.

Overall, the results indicate that, methodologically, the research shows a balanced distribution; however, in terms of participant groups, the distribution shows a preference for in-service teachers and university students. While this can be a result of the availability of participant groups and the potential for researchers mainly working in universities to reach a certain group, university students in this case, the amount of in-service teacher participant groups and the nature of these studies mainly being around what in-service English teachers' attitudes are towards CLIL, a preference towards exploratory students from the perspective of educators can be seen through the

reviewed studies. In addition, an assumption towards the implementation of CLIL being more difficult because of the top-down language education curriculum of Türkiye (Aydinli & Mathews, 2021) for students at or below the high school level can be developed, especially given the lack of high school- and elementary-level studies on the topic.

4. Conclusion

In conclusion, this review aims to systematically review research on CLIL in the Turkish context. The number of studies on the topic is limited, and many are exploratory, focusing on teachers' and/or students' attitudes, opinions, and feelings toward CLIL and its features. While studies aim to quantitatively and/or qualitatively examine the direct effects of CLIL use, as well as aspects such as language and/or content mastery and acquisition, there remain large gaps in the literature on CLIL research in the Turkish context.

CLIL has been regarded positively in the Turkish context through research conducted by teachers and/or students. While positive affects on aspects such as content and language acquisition can be seen (Sendur et al., 2022), as well as other variables such as the lowering of English-speaking anxiety (Akay et al., 2025), school adjustment (Ağmaz & Temel, 2021), and so on, other concerns such as the potential for the content to be less comprehensive than the content taught in L1 (Bozdoğan & Karlıdağ, 2013), or the additional roles given to the teacher through CLIL (Gülşen & Dikilitaş, 2023), more research done on the direct effects of CLIL on language and/or content acquisition as well as its interaction with many other variables in the language education and other fields of education altogether can be beneficial, as well as research done on other contexts such as high-school and elementary school level classrooms, to better understand the effectiveness and feasibility of the implementation of CLIL in the Turkish context.

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THE ROLE OF AI IN BRIDGING THE GAP BETWEEN RECEPTIVE UNDERSTANDING AND PRODUCTIVE OUTPUT

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Abstract: The persistent discrepancy between a learner's ability to comprehend language (receptive understanding) and their capacity to actively produce it (productive output) remains a formidable challenge in Second Language Acquisition (SLA). This study explores the transformative potential of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) in bridging this "receptive-productive gap" among university-level English as a Foreign Language (EFL) students. Adopting a mixed-methods approach, the research investigates how AI-driven scaffolding tools—specifically Large Language Models (LLMs)—facilitate the often-difficult transition from passive vocabulary recognition to fluid, active communication.

Quantitative data were gathered from a cohort of 120 students through pre- and post-intervention assessments, while qualitative insights were drawn from focus group interviews to gauge learners' cognitive load and evolving sense of self-efficacy. The findings suggest that GenAI functions as a dynamic "linguistic bridge," offering a low-stakes environment for simulation and real-time, personalized feedback that encourages students to take risks in their productive tasks. Results indicate a statistically significant improvement ($p < 0.05$) in both productive fluency and lexical diversity within the experimental group. However, the study also underscores the critical need for "AI Literacy" to ensure students do not become overly reliant on automated outputs. This article concludes that when integrated thoughtfully, GenAI does more than just automate speech or writing; it acts as a cognitive scaffold that accelerates the internalization of language. Finally, the study offers evidence-based recommendations for a hybrid pedagogical model—one that harmonizes human-centered instruction with AI-powered experimentation to cultivate authentic proficiency in the digital age.

Keywords: Generative AI, Receptive-Productive Gap, Second Language Acquisition (SLA), Large Language Models (LLMs), Scaffolding, Productive Fluency.

RESEPTIV QAVRAYIŞ VƏ PRODUKTIV TƏTBİQ ARASINDAKI BOŞLUĞUN ARADAN QALDIRILMASINDA SÜNİ INTELLEKTİN ROLU

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Xülasə: Dil öyrənmənin dili qavrama qabiliyyəti (**reseptiv anlama**) ilə dili istehsal etmə qabiliyyəti (**produktiv nəticə**) arasındakı davamlı fərq İkinci Dilin Mənimlənməsi (SLA) sahəsində ən mühüm çətinliklərdən biri olaraq qalmaqdadır. Bu tədqiqat, universitet səviyyəsində Xarici Dil kimi İngilis Dili (EFL) tələbələri arasında bu "reseptiv-produktiv boşluğu"nın daraldılmasında **Generativ Süni İntellektin (GenAI)** transformativ rolunu araşdırır. Qarışıq metodlu yanaşmadan istifadə edərək, tədqiqat süni intellekt əsaslı dəstəkləmə (scaffolding) alətlərinin — xüsusilə Böyük Dil Modellərinin (LLM) — passiv lüğət tanınmasından aktiv kommunikativ istifadəyə keçidi asanlaşdırmaqda effektivliyini qiymətləndirir.

Kəmiyyət məlumatları müdaxilədən əvvəlki və sonrakı qiymətləndirmələr vasitəsilə 120 tələbədən toplanmış, keyfiyyət anlayışları isə öyrənlərin koqnitiv yükü və özünəinamı ilə bağlı fokus qrup müsahibələri vasitəsilə əldə edilmişdir. Tədqiqatın nəticələri göstərir ki, GenAI real vaxt rejimində fərdiləşdirilmiş rəy və məhsuldar tapşırıqlarda risk etməyi təşviq edən aşağı riskli simulyasiya mühitləri təqdim edərək dinamik bir "**lingvistik körpü**" rolunu oynayır. Nəticələr eksperimental qrupda produktiv

səlislik və leksik müxtəliflikdə statistik cəhətdən əhəmiyyətli bir yaxşılaşma ($p < 0.05$) nümayiş etdirir. Bununla belə, tədqiqat avtomatlaşdırılmış nəticələrdən həddindən artıq asılılığın qarşısını almaq üçün "Süni İntellekt Savadlılığının" (AI Literacy) zəruriliyini də vurğulayır. Məqalədə belə nəticəyə gəlinir ki, strateji şəkildə inteqrasiya edildikdə GenAI sadəcə dil istehsalını avtomatlaşdırmır, həm də reseptiv girişin produktiv kompetensiyaya daxililəşməsini sürətləndirən koqnitiv dəstək (scaffold) rolunu oynayır. Tədqiqat rəqəmsal dövrdə orijinal kommunikativ bacarıqları inkişaf etdirmək üçün insan mərkəzli təlimlə süni intellekt tərəfindən idarə olunan linqvistik eksperimentləri tarazlaşdıran hibrid pedaqoji model üçün sübutlara əsaslanan tövsiyələr təklif edir.

Açar sözlər: Generativ süni intellekt, reseptiv-produktiv boşluq, ikinci dilin mənimsənilməsi, böyük dil modelləri (LLM), produktiv səlislik

Introduction

The architecture of Second Language Acquisition (SLA) is traditionally built upon the foundational premise that receptive skills—specifically listening and reading—precede and consistently exceed productive skills, namely speaking and writing. This structural imbalance often leads to the development of a **"linguistic plateau,"** a stagnant phase where learners possess the cognitive capacity to decode complex academic discourse yet remain functionally unable to articulate equivalent ideas with the necessary level of sophistication or grammatical precision (Nation, 2022).

This pedagogical gap is rarely a result of intellectual deficiency; rather, it is often exacerbated by **high affective filters**. According to Krashen's Affective Filter Hypothesis, factors such as the debilitating fear of committing linguistic errors, a lack of immediate, personalized feedback loops, and the scarcity of authentic opportunities for meaningful output create a psychological barrier between understanding and expression (Krashen, 1982; Nation, 2022). Historically, Computer-Assisted Language Learning (CALL) tools were static, offering linear exercises that failed to simulate the dynamic, unpredictable nature of human conversation.

However, the recent emergence of **Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI)** has catalyzed a paradigm shift in instructional design. Unlike its predecessors, GenAI offers a highly interactive, non-linear ecosystem where receptive input can be instantaneously manipulated, reframed, and converted into productive practice. By acting as a sophisticated, 24/7 personalized tutor, GenAI provides the specific **pedagogical scaffolding** required to transition from "comprehensible input" to "comprehensible output" (Swain, 2021). This article investigates the mechanical and psychological dimensions of this transition, examining how Large Language Models (LLMs) serve as a bridge over the receptive-productive divide in modern EFL contexts (Lo et al., 2024).

Materials and Methods

This research adopted a **convergent parallel mixed-methods design**, a robust methodological framework that allows for the simultaneous collection and triangulation of quantitative trends and qualitative nuances over a 12-week longitudinal study (Creswell & Clark, 2017).

Participant Demographics and Grouping

The study involved a cohort of **N=120 undergraduate students** currently enrolled in an intensive English for Academic Purposes (EAP) program. Participants were pre-screened to ensure an intermediate proficiency level, corresponding to the **B1/B2 bands** of the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR). The cohort was stratified into two distinct groups:

- **Experimental Group (EG):** Integrated GenAI tools into their core curriculum as a primary output facilitator.

- **Control Group (CG):** Maintained traditional classroom methodologies, relying on human-led instruction and peer-to-peer interaction without AI intervention.

The Instructional Intervention: “Input-to-Output” Mapping

The intervention for the Experimental Group was designed to replace passive consumption with active “Input-to-Output” tasks facilitated by platforms such as ChatGPT-4 and specialized AI-driven writing assistants. Following the principles of **Output Hypothesis** (Swain, 2021), key activities included:

- **Dynamic Summarization:** Students processed long-form academic texts and were required to negotiate with the AI to simplify, expand, or re-style the content, ensuring the transition from reading to writing.
- **Voice-to-Text Simulations:** Real-time oral roleplays with AI agents designed to simulate high-pressure professional environments, focusing on reducing the “response time” in oral production (Luckin, 2023).
- **Iterative Feedback Loops:** Unlike traditional weekly feedback cycles, students utilized AI to receive **instantaneous micro-corrections** on their syntax and lexical choices, allowing for immediate cognitive reinforcement.

Data Collection Instruments

To ensure a comprehensive evaluation of the intervention, the research employed a dual-instrument strategy:

- **Quantitative Metrics:** Pre- and post-intervention assessments were utilized to calculate **Lexical Diversity** through the **Type-Token Ratio (TTR)** and to measure **Syntactic Complexity** using T-unit analysis. These metrics provided a mathematical baseline for productive growth (Nation, 2022).
- **Qualitative Metrics:** Semi-structured interviews and “Reflective Journals” were conducted with the EG. These focused heavily on “**Learner Agency**”– the student's perceived control over their learning process– and the psychological reduction of communicative anxiety (Alinouri et al., 2025).

Analytical Framework

The quantitative data were subjected to **independent-samples T-tests** using SPSS software to determine the statistical significance of the mean differences between the EG and CG. Simultaneously, the qualitative data underwent **thematic coding and latent content analysis**, identifying recurring cognitive patterns in student-AI interactions. This integration allowed the researchers to observe not just *if* the students improved, but the specific ways in which AI interaction facilitated the internalization of language patterns (Creswell & Clark, 2017; Lo et al., 2024).

Results and Discussion

The data synthesis provides a comprehensive look at how Generative AI serves as a catalyst for linguistic transition. The findings are categorized into performance metrics, psychological shifts, and emerging pedagogical risks.

Quantitative Improvements in Productive Output: The Lexical Bridge

The empirical data revealed a statistically significant increase in the **Productive Lexical Range (PLR)** of the Experimental Group (EG) compared to the Control Group (CG). Post-test assessments indicated that students in the EG utilized **22% more academic vocabulary** in their formal writing assignments than their peers in the CG. This quantitative surge suggests that GenAI serves as a “safe harbor” for linguistic experimentation.

In traditional settings, the transition from receptive recognition (knowing a word when reading it) to productive mastery (using it in a sentence) is often hindered by a lack of trial-and-error opportunities. GenAI bridges this gap by allowing students to “test-drive” complex vocabulary and syntactic structures in a low-stakes environment before applying them in high-stakes summative assessments. This finding aligns with the **Input-to-Output conversion** theory, where the frequency of interaction with targeted vocabulary via AI accelerates the internalization process (Nation, 2022).

Reducing the Affective Filter: The “Private Laboratory” Effect

The qualitative thematic analysis of student interviews revealed that the most profound “bridge” provided by GenAI was psychological rather than purely structural. A recurring theme was the significant reduction in **communicative anxiety**, often referred to in SLA as the “Affective Filter” (Krashen, 1982). Students reported that the perceived **anonymity and instantaneity** of AI-human interaction provided a judgment-free space that human-to-human interaction occasionally lacks.

As characterized by **Lo et al. (2024)**, GenAI functions as a “**private laboratory**” for language. In this laboratory, the fear of “losing face” or being corrected by a peer or instructor is removed. This psychological safety net allowed learners to move more rapidly from the passive understanding of a grammatical structure to the active, albeit experimental, attempt at its production. The results show that when the affective filter is lowered, cognitive resources are freed for more complex linguistic processing (Alinouri et al., 2025). In this digital laboratory, the social risk of “**losing face**”—a significant cultural and psychological barrier in many educational contexts—is entirely removed.

The Cognitive Mechanism of Lowered Anxiety

When the affective filter is lowered, the learner’s **cognitive resources** are significantly optimized. In a high-anxiety state, a large portion of a student's working memory is consumed by "self-monitoring" and "performance anxiety," leaving little room for linguistic processing. By eliminating the social threat, GenAI allows these cognitive resources to be redirected toward:

- **Hypothesis Testing:** Learners feel emboldened to experiment with complex syntactic structures they would otherwise avoid.
- **Noticing the Gap:** Without the pressure of immediate social judgment, students can more clearly "notice" the difference between their output and the AI’s corrected input (Schmidt, 1990).
- **Increased "Wait Time":** AI allows for infinite processing time, enabling students to construct more sophisticated productive output without the "temporal pressure" of a live conversation.

This psychological safety net allowed learners to move more rapidly from the passive understanding of a grammatical structure to the active, albeit experimental, attempt at its production. The results show that a lowered filter directly correlates with increased **willingness to communicate (WTC)**, a critical precursor to long-term fluency.

Summary of the Affective Bridge

Traditional Classroom	GenAI "Private Laboratory"	Impact on Acquisition
High Evaluative Pressure	Zero-Judgment Interaction	Lowered Affective Filter.
Social Fear (Losing Face)	Anonymity of Input	Increased Linguistic Risk-Taking.

Traditional Classroom	GenAI "Private Laboratory"	Impact on Acquisition
Delayed Feedback	Real-time Scaffolding	Faster Internalization of Patterns.

The inclusion of the "Private Laboratory" effect is particularly significant when considering the cultural and cognitive architectures of language learning. Below is the expanded section with integrated theoretical insights.

Reducing the Affective Filter: The “Private Laboratory” Effect

The qualitative thematic analysis of student interviews revealed that the most profound “bridge” provided by GenAI was psychological rather than purely structural. A recurring theme was the significant reduction in **communicative anxiety**, a phenomenon central to the **Affective Filter Hypothesis** (Krashen, 1982). This hypothesis posits that emotional variables – such as anxiety, lack of self-confidence, and low motivation – act as a mental block that prevents "comprehensible input" from reaching the language acquisition parts of the brain.

Students reported that the perceived **anonymity and instantaneity** of AI-human interaction provided a judgment-free space that human-to-human interaction occasionally lacks. In traditional classroom settings, the "socio-affective filter" is often high due to the presence of peers and the authoritative figure of the instructor. In contrast, GenAI functions as a “**private laboratory**” for language (Lo et al., 2024). In this digital laboratory, the social risk of “**losing face**” – a significant cultural and psychological barrier in many educational contexts – is entirely removed.

The Cognitive Mechanism of Lowered Anxiety

When the affective filter is lowered, the learner’s **cognitive resources** are significantly optimized. In a high-anxiety state, a large portion of a student's working memory is consumed by "self-monitoring" and "performance anxiety," leaving little room for actual linguistic processing. By eliminating the social threat, GenAI allows these cognitive resources to be redirected toward:

- **Hypothesis Testing:** Learners feel emboldened to experiment with complex syntactic structures (e.g., subjunctive mood or complex conditionals) they would otherwise avoid in public for fear of error.
- **Noticing the Gap:** Without the pressure of immediate social judgment, students can more clearly "notice" the difference between their current output and the AI’s corrected version, a process vital for interlanguage development (Schmidt, 1990).
- **Increased "Wait Time":** Human conversation often imposes a "temporal pressure" that forces learners to use simplified language. AI allows for infinite processing time, enabling students to construct more sophisticated productive output at their own pace.
- **Exploratory Talk:** GenAI facilitates "exploratory talk"– a type of speech where learners use language to think aloud and reorganize their thoughts– rather than merely "final draft" speech intended for evaluation.

This psychological safety net allowed learners to move more rapidly from the passive understanding of a grammatical structure to the active, albeit experimental, attempt at its production. The results show that a lowered filter directly correlates with an increased **Willingness to Communicate (WTC)**, which serves as a critical precursor to long-term fluency and the successful internalization of the target language.

Comparative Summary of the Affective Bridge

Feature	Traditional Classroom	GenAI "Private Laboratory"
Evaluative Pressure	High (Instructor/Peer presence)	Zero (Non-judgmental algorithm)

Feature	Traditional Classroom	GenAI "Private Laboratory"
Social Risk	Fear of "Losing Face"	Complete Anonymity
Feedback Loop	Delayed (Assignments)	Instantaneous (Real-time)
Cognitive Focus	Performance-oriented	Process-oriented
Communication Style	Scripted/Safe	Experimental/Risk-taking

The Risk of “Productive Atrophy”: Addressing the Technology Paradox

Despite the clear advantages, the discussion identified a critical caveat termed the **“Technology Paradox.”** While GenAI facilitates immediate output, there is a legitimate risk of **“Productive Atrophy”** – a state where students become “passive producers.” In this scenario, learners may over-rely on the machine to generate coherent text, thereby bypassing the necessary cognitive struggles required to internalize linguistic patterns.

To mitigate this, the study found that the *method* of AI use was more important than the *frequency*. Tasks categorized as **“Prompt Engineering”** – where students were required to direct the AI to use specific vocabulary or follow certain rhetorical constraints – were significantly more effective for retention than simple, unconstrained text generation (Luckin, 2023). This highlights that GenAI is most effective when it functions as a **cognitive scaffold** that requires active learner input rather than a total automated substitute for thought.

Conclusion and Recommendations

This evaluation confirms that Generative AI plays a transformative role in bridging the traditional gap between receptive understanding and productive output. By serving as a **24/7 interlocutor and instantaneous feedback mechanism**, GenAI provides the high-frequency practice and corrective feedback required to transition passive, latent knowledge into active, functional skill.

Key Recommendations:

- **From Generation to Iteration:** Pedagogical frameworks should pivot from using AI as a tool for content creation to using it as a tool for **recursive refinement**. The focus must remain on the student’s original draft, with AI acting as a partner in iteration and stylistic improvement.
- **AI-Literacy Integration:** Educational institutions must formally integrate **AI Literacy** into the EFL curriculum. This training should teach students to view AI as a “scaffold” (supporting the structure until it stands on its own) rather than a “crutch” (a permanent necessity for movement).
- **Diversity and World Englishes:** Future research should investigate the capacity of GenAI to expose learners to a wider variety of **“World Englishes” and non-native accents**. By diversifying the linguistic input, GenAI can further narrow the gap between classroom-based English and the diverse realities of global communication (Alinouri et al., 2025; Lo et al., 2024).

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BLENDING LEARNING: AN INTEGRATIVE APPROACH TO CONTEMPORARY EDUCATION

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Abstract: Blended learning has emerged as a prominent instructional model that systematically integrates traditional face-to-face teaching with online learning environments in order to optimize the teaching–learning process. This pedagogical approach aims to strategically combine the strengths of both instructional modalities, thereby enhancing learner engagement, flexibility, and overall educational effectiveness. By leveraging digital technologies alongside in-person interaction, blended learning supports diverse learning preferences and encourages active, student-centered participation. The increasing availability of digital tools, learning management systems, and online educational resources—together with the growing demand for personalized and learner-centered education—has significantly accelerated the adoption of blended learning across various educational contexts, including higher education, professional training, and K–12 settings.

This paper examines the theoretical foundations underpinning blended learning, drawing on constructivist and experiential learning theories that emphasize interaction, autonomy, and collaboration. In addition, it explores the materials and instructional methods commonly employed in blended learning environments, such as multimedia resources, online assessments, and flipped classroom strategies. The paper also reviews outcomes reported in empirical studies, focusing on student achievement, motivation, and satisfaction. Furthermore, it discusses the pedagogical benefits, challenges, and institutional implications associated with blended learning implementation. Overall, the findings indicate that when blended learning is thoughtfully designed and effectively implemented, it has substantial potential to improve learning experiences, promote deeper understanding, and enhance academic performance.

Keywords: blended learning, online education, instructional design, higher education, educational technology

QARIŞIQ TƏHSİL: MÜASİR TƏHSİLƏ İNTEQRATİV YANAŞMA

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Xülasə: Qarışıq təlim (blended learning) tədris–öyrənmə prosesini optimallaşdırmaq məqsədilə ənənəvi üz-üzə tədrisi onlayn təlim mühiti ilə sistemli şəkildə inteqrasiya edən aparıcı təlim modellərindən biri kimi meydana çıxmışdır. Bu pedaqoji yanaşma hər iki tədris formasının üstün cəhətlərini strateji şəkildə birləşdirərək təhsilalanların fəallığını, çevikliyini və ümumi tədris effektivliyini artırmağı hədəfləyir. Üz-üzə qarşılıqlı əlaqə ilə yanaşı rəqəmsal texnologiyalardan istifadə edilməsi müxtəlif öyrənmə üslublarını dəstəkləyir və tələbəmərkəzli, aktiv iştirakın təşviqinə şərait yaradır. Rəqəmsal alətlərin, təlimin idarəetmə sistemlərinin və onlayn tədris resurslarının əlçatanlığının artması, eləcə də fərdiləşdirilmiş və öyrənməmərkəzli təhsilə olan tələbatın yüksəlməsi qarışıq təlimin ali təhsil, peşə hazırlığı və ümumtəhsil (K–12) daxil olmaqla müxtəlif təhsil kontekstlərində geniş yayılmasını sürətləndirmişdir.

Bu məqalədə qarışıq təlimin nəzəri əsasları araşdırılır və qarşılıqlı əlaqə, muxtariyyət və əməkdaşlığı ön plana çəkən konstruktivist və təcrübəyə əsaslanan öyrənmə nəzəriyyələrinə istinad edilir. Eyni zamanda, qarışıq təlim mühitlərində geniş istifadə olunan multimedia resursları, onlayn qiymətləndirmə alətləri və çevrilmiş sinif (flipped classroom) strategiyaları kimi material və tədris metodları təhlil olunur. Məqalədə həmçinin empirik tədqiqatların nəticələri nəzərdən keçirilərək tələbələrin akademik nailiyyətləri, motivasiyası və məmnunluğu ilə bağlı göstəricilər dəyərləndirilir. Bundan əlavə, qarışıq təlimin tətbiqi ilə əlaqədar pedaqoji üstünlüklər, çətinliklər və institusional təsirlər müzakirə olunur. Ümumilikdə, əldə olunan nəticələr göstərir ki, qarışıq təlim düzgün layihələndirildikdə və səmərəli şəkildə tətbiq edildikdə öyrənmə təcrübəsinin zənginləşdirilməsinə, dərin anlayışın formalaşmasına və akademik göstəricilərin yüksəldilməsinə əhəmiyyətli töhfə verə bilər.

Açar sözlər: qarışıq təlim (blended learning), onlayn təhsil, tədris dizaynı, ali təhsil, təhsil texnologiyaları

Introduction

The rapid advancement of information and communication technologies (ICT) has profoundly transformed educational systems worldwide, reshaping how teaching and learning are designed, delivered, and evaluated. While traditional face-to-face instruction remains a fundamental component of education, it is increasingly supplemented or restructured through digital tools, online platforms, and virtual learning environments. These technological developments have expanded access to educational resources, facilitated communication beyond physical classrooms, and introduced new pedagogical possibilities. In this context, blended learning has gained recognition as an innovative and flexible instructional approach that purposefully integrates conventional classroom instruction with online learning experiences (Garrison & Kanuka, 2004).

Blended learning is not merely a technological trend driven by digitalization; rather, it represents a pedagogical response to the evolving needs of learners in the digital age. Contemporary students increasingly expect greater autonomy, accessibility, and personalization in their educational experiences. They seek opportunities to control the pace, place, and mode of learning while engaging meaningfully with content. Educational institutions, on the other hand, are faced with growing demands for cost-effective, scalable, and inclusive teaching models that maintain academic quality. Blended learning addresses these expectations by combining synchronous and asynchronous learning activities, enabling students to access learning materials independently while still benefiting from direct interaction with instructors and peers (Graham, 2006).

The relevance and importance of blended learning became particularly evident during global disruptions such as the COVID-19 pandemic, which forced educational institutions worldwide to rapidly transition to remote and technology-mediated modes of instruction. This unprecedented shift exposed both the potential and the limitations of fully online learning environments, highlighting issues related to student engagement, instructional quality, and digital equity. As a result, blended

and hybrid learning approaches gained increased attention as sustainable solutions that balance digital flexibility with the social and pedagogical value of face-to-face interaction (Hrastinski, 2019).

Against this background, the present paper aims to provide a comprehensive examination of blended learning by analyzing its conceptual framework, implementation strategies, educational outcomes, and associated challenges. By synthesizing existing research and empirical findings, the study contributes to the growing body of literature on blended learning and offers insights into effective instructional design and practice within diverse educational contexts.

Materials and Methods

This study adopts a qualitative and descriptive research approach based on a comprehensive review of academic literature related to blended learning. A systematic literature review was conducted to identify, analyze, and synthesize existing research findings, theoretical perspectives, and practical applications of blended learning across different educational settings. Peer-reviewed journal articles, academic books, and conference proceedings published between 2000 and 2024 were selected to ensure both historical grounding and contemporary relevance of the reviewed studies. The selected time frame reflects the period during which blended learning evolved from an emerging concept to an established instructional model.

Major academic databases, including Google Scholar, ERIC (Education Resources Information Center), and ScienceDirect, were consulted to retrieve relevant literature. Keywords such as *blended learning*, *hybrid learning*, *online education*, *instructional design*, and *educational technology* were used in various combinations. To ensure research quality and reliability, only sources published in reputable academic outlets and frequently cited in the literature were included. The collected data were analyzed through content analysis and thematically organized to identify prevailing trends, methodological approaches, benefits, and challenges associated with blended learning.

Instructional Materials

Blended learning environments typically rely on a strategic combination of physical and digital instructional materials designed to support both independent and collaborative learning. Traditional instructional materials include textbooks, printed handouts, classroom lectures, whiteboard explanations, and face-to-face discussions, which provide structure and direct guidance. These materials are generally used to introduce concepts, clarify complex topics, and facilitate immediate feedback through instructor-led interaction.

In parallel, digital instructional resources play a crucial role in supporting learning beyond the physical classroom. These resources include learning management systems (LMS), recorded video lectures, online reading materials, discussion forums, quizzes, assignments, and various forms of multimedia content such as animations, audio recordings, and interactive presentations (Dziuban et al., 2018). LMS platforms such as Moodle, Blackboard, and Canvas are central to blended learning implementation, as they enable instructors to organize course content, manage assessments, facilitate communication, and monitor student progress efficiently.

Multimedia instructional materials, including simulations, virtual laboratories, and interactive learning modules, are particularly effective in supporting diverse learning styles and enhancing conceptual understanding. Such materials allow learners to visualize abstract concepts, engage in experiential learning, and revisit content multiple times according to their individual needs (Means et al., 2013). The integration of these materials ensures a more inclusive and flexible learning environment.

Teaching and Learning Methods

The methodological framework of blended learning involves the deliberate integration of various teaching and learning strategies designed to promote active, collaborative, and student-centered learning. Common instructional methods include flipped classrooms, problem-based learning, project-based learning, online peer discussions, self-paced learning activities, and

formative digital assessments. These approaches encourage learners to take an active role in constructing knowledge rather than passively receiving information.

One widely adopted strategy is the flipped classroom model, in which students engage with instructional content – such as video lectures or reading materials – online before attending face-to-face sessions. This approach allows in-class time to be dedicated to discussion, problem-solving, collaborative activities, and higher-order cognitive tasks, thereby enhancing critical thinking and knowledge application (Bishop & Verleger, 2013). Online discussion forums and peer feedback activities further support social interaction and reflective learning in asynchronous environments.

For the purposes of this study, data extracted from the reviewed literature were thematically analyzed and categorized to identify recurring patterns related to learner engagement, academic performance, instructional effectiveness, and technological challenges. This systematic approach enabled a comprehensive examination of blended learning practices across different educational contexts and contributed to a deeper understanding of the conditions under which blended learning is most effective.

Results and Discussion

The analysis of the reviewed literature reveals that blended learning has a generally positive and consistent impact on student learning outcomes, motivation, and satisfaction across a variety of educational contexts. One of the most frequently reported advantages of blended learning is increased learner engagement. The deliberate combination of online and face-to-face instructional activities encourages active participation and enables learners to assume greater responsibility for their own learning processes. Online components, such as discussion forums and self-paced learning modules, foster autonomy, while in-person sessions sustain social interaction and immediate feedback (Hun Lim & Morris, 2009).

Academic Performance and Learner Outcomes

A substantial body of empirical research indicates that students enrolled in blended learning environments perform as well as, and in many cases better than, their peers in traditional classroom settings. According to Means et al. (2013), blended learning often leads to improved academic achievement due to increased time-on-task, greater exposure to instructional materials, and opportunities for repeated practice. The flexibility of online components allows learners to revisit complex concepts and engage with resources at their own pace, thereby reinforcing understanding and knowledge retention.

Beyond academic achievement, blended learning has been shown to support the development of higher-order cognitive skills, including critical thinking, problem-solving, and self-regulated learning. Asynchronous online discussions and reflective learning activities promote deeper cognitive engagement by allowing students time to formulate ideas and critically respond to peers. At the same time, face-to-face sessions facilitate collaborative learning, clarification of misconceptions, and meaningful instructor guidance (Garrison & Vaughan, 2008). This complementary interaction between online and in-person learning experiences contributes to more holistic educational outcomes.

Pedagogical and Institutional Benefits

From a pedagogical perspective, blended learning enables instructors to adopt more flexible and student-centered teaching strategies. Educators can use classroom time more effectively by focusing on interactive activities, discussion, and applied learning, while foundational content delivery occurs online. This approach enhances instructional efficiency and supports differentiated learning.

At the institutional level, blended learning offers important benefits related to scalability and resource optimization. It allows institutions to accommodate larger and more diverse student populations without compromising instructional quality. Blended formats also support inclusive education by providing flexible learning opportunities for non-traditional learners, including working students, distance learners, and students with limited access to physical campus facilities

(Graham et al., 2013). As a result, blended learning is increasingly viewed as a strategic component of institutional development and innovation.

Challenges and Limitations

Despite its many advantages, blended learning presents several challenges that may affect its effectiveness if not adequately addressed. Technical issues, such as unreliable internet access, insufficient digital infrastructure, and limited access to devices, can hinder both teaching and learning processes. In addition, varying levels of digital literacy among students and instructors may create barriers to effective participation in online components (Porter et al., 2016).

Pedagogical challenges are also evident, particularly when blended courses are poorly designed or lack coherence. An excessive workload, unclear expectations, or misalignment between online and face-to-face components may result in cognitive overload and reduced learner engagement. These findings underscore the importance of thoughtful instructional design, institutional support, and continuous evaluation. Simply combining online and face-to-face elements does not ensure positive outcomes; rather, effective alignment between learning objectives, instructional activities, and assessment methods is essential for successful blended learning implementation.

Conclusion

Blended learning represents a significant evolution in contemporary educational practice by offering a balanced, flexible, and pedagogically sound approach to teaching and learning. Through the deliberate integration of traditional face-to-face instruction with digital technologies, blended learning effectively addresses many of the limitations associated with both fully online and purely classroom-based instructional models. The findings of this study indicate that blended learning, when thoughtfully designed and strategically implemented, has the potential to enhance learner engagement, improve academic performance, and increase overall student satisfaction.

One of the key strengths of blended learning lies in its ability to accommodate diverse learning needs and preferences. The combination of synchronous and asynchronous learning activities provides students with greater autonomy and flexibility while preserving meaningful interaction with instructors and peers. This dual approach supports deeper learning, encourages self-regulation, and promotes the development of critical thinking and digital literacy skills that are increasingly essential in the modern educational landscape.

To fully realize the benefits of blended learning, educators must adopt learner-centered instructional strategies and continuously develop their pedagogical and technological competencies. Course design should prioritize alignment between learning objectives, instructional activities, and assessment methods to ensure educational coherence and effectiveness. At the institutional level, sustained investment in technological infrastructure, instructional support systems, and professional development initiatives is essential for the successful and scalable implementation of blended learning.

As education continues to evolve in response to rapid technological advancements and changing societal demands, blended learning is likely to remain a central component of modern educational systems. Future research should focus on longitudinal studies, discipline-specific applications, and empirical evaluations of innovative blended learning models to further refine best practices and maximize their impact on teaching and learning outcomes.

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TECHNOLOGY OF TEACHING POETRY TO DEAF STUDENTS WITH SEVERE HEARING DISORDERS

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Abstract: This article covers the issues of the application of methods and techniques of teaching lyrical works and poems in a special school for deaf children. The article highlights the development of the teacher's ability to perceive and understand literary works as a work of art during the teaching of lyrical works, as well as the development of their native language, oral speech, the assimilation of reading interests, spiritual and moral values, the development of aesthetic taste, artistic thinking and the methods of analyzing works of art.

Literature occupies an important place among humanitarian subjects in a special school for deaf children, because it instills in children the spiritual and moral values to which each nation belongs, develops aesthetic thinking and enriches the worldview of students. The new content and structure of teaching literature at school also include its priority goals of perceiving the beauty of the Azerbaijani language, developing the language, understanding literary works as a work of art, developing reading interests, aesthetic taste and artistic thinking and teaching the skills of analyzing works of art.

The methodology for teaching literature to children with hearing impairments is based on surdopedagogical principles, the preference for visual aids, and the active development of the native language. The main methods mentioned in the article include explanatory reading, the use of dactyl and sign language to

clarify meanings, visualization (illustrations, videos), dramatization and vocabulary development, and adaptation of classical methods.

Key words: child with hearing impairment, special school, student, poetry, poem, lyrical work, lesson

AĞIR EŞİTMƏ POZULMASI OLAN ŞAĞIRDLƏRƏ ŞEİRİN TƏDRİSİ TEKNOLOGİYASI

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə kar uşaqlar üçün xüsusi məktəbdə lirik əsərlərin, şeirlərin tədrisi metod və üsullarını tədbiqi məsələlərini əhatə edir. Məqalədə müəllimin lirik əsərlərin tədrisi zamanı şagirdlərin bədii əsəri söz sənəti kimi qavramaq və anlamaq bacarığını inkişaf etdirməklə yanaşı, həm də ana dilinin, şifahi nitqin inkişafı, onlarda oxu maraqlarını, mənəvi - əxlaqi dəyərləri mənimsəmək, estetik zövqü, bədii təfəkkürü inkişaf etdirmək və sənət əsərlərini təhlil etmək metodları qeyd edilmişdir.

Kar uşaqlar üçün xüsusi məktəbdə humanitar fənlər arasında ədəbiyyat mühüm yer tutur, çünki o, hər bir xalqın mənsub olduğu mənəvi - əxlaqi dəyərləri uşaqlara aşılrayır, estetik təfəkkürü inkişaf etdirir və şagirdlərin dünyagörüşünü zənginləşdirir. Məktəbdə ədəbiyyat fənni tədrisinin yeni məzmun və strukturu eyni zamanda onun prioritet məqsədlərinə Azərbaycan dilinin gözəlliyini qavramaq, dili inkişaf etdirmək, bədii əsəri söz sənəti kimi anlamaq, oxu maraqlarını, estetik zövqü və bədii təfəkkürü inkişaf etdirmək və sənət əsərlərini təhlil etmək bacarıqlarını öyrətmək daxildir.

Eşitmə pozulması olan uşaqlar üçün ədəbiyyatın tədrisi metodologiyası surdopedaqoji prinsiplərə, əyani vasitələrə üstünlük verməyə və ana dilin fəal şəkildə inkişaf etdirilməsinə əsaslanır. Məqalədə qeyd edilən əsas metodlara izahlı oxu, mənalı aydınlaşdırmaq üçün daktil və jest dilindən istifadə, vizuallaşdırma (illüstrasiyalar, videolar), drammatizasiya və lüğətin inkişafı, klassik metodların uyğunlaşdırılması daxildir.

Açar sözlər: eşitmə pozulması olan uşaq, xüsusi məktəb, şagird, poeziya, şeir, lirik əsər, dərs

Introduction

The education system of the modern Republic of Azerbaijan has entered a new stage of development, characterized by the strengthening of democratic processes and the increasing role of humanization and liberalization of education. The country's economic and political development requires the integration of the education system into the global educational space, radical changes in this area. carrying out educational reforms, the implementation and promotion of new approaches to this area.

Special education occupies a special place in the education system of Azerbaijan, and innovations in this area are also being made: its goals and objectives are determined in accordance with modern requirements. Currently, the main purpose of special education is to: provide individuals with special developmental characteristics with education and correctional-pedagogical assistance, taking into account individual capabilities and health status, and ensure the right to receive special educational support. The essence of modern special education is: the implementation of special education programs at various levels (preschool, general secondary, vocational education, etc.) for the training and upbringing of children with special developmental characteristics. These goals and objectives have given rise to a new approach to special education, the development of a

modern educational strategy, teaching methods and techniques that promote the sustainable development of schoolchildren with disabilities, including children with hearing impairments, the formation of socio-cultural habits and skills, their integration into the social environment and socialization.

This new system provides for the following:

- identification of developmental disabilities as early as possible (from the first months of life), provision of comprehensive medical, psychological and pedagogical support to the child and the family raising them;
- minimizing the gap between the beginning of targeted education and the identification of an initial developmental disorder;
- the child is not an object of influence of adults, but an equal subject of joint activity, cooperation and joint creativity;
- identification of life competencies of children who are lagging behind in development at each age stage;
- definition of a specialized educational standard that combines general and special educational standards for their development;
- development of a full range of specialized learning objectives (usually they are not included in the educational content of a developing child of the same age);
- development of all necessary “indirect ways” for learning;
- use of special methods, techniques and teaching aids;
- “step-by-step” learning;

Aim

Literature occupies an important place among the humanitarian subjects in a special school for deaf children, because it instills in children the spiritual and moral values to which each nation belongs, develops aesthetic thinking and enriches the worldview of students.

The new content and structure of teaching literature at school also include among its priority goals the development of the ability to perceive and understand a work of art as a word art, the development of reading interests, aesthetic taste and artistic thinking, and the training of skills in analyzing works of art.

Significance

Poetry plays an important role in teaching literature to deaf schoolchildren. Students with severe hearing impairment and underdeveloped oral speech, familiarity with poetry, forms their worldview, aesthetic taste, develops their language and cognitive abilities, enriches their spiritual world, and increases their experience of perceiving life in its most diverse manifestations. In addition, teaching a deaf child lyrical works allows him to understand the uniqueness of poetry and to deeply understand the reality of human nature and the surrounding world.

The ability of deaf students to figuratively imagine the phenomena of nature and society described in lyrical works, to clearly understand the subtext, to achieve the perception of the multifaceted meaning of the word, its emotional and figurative expressiveness, and to create and implement verbal communication are considered as skills that are important for the creation and implementation of verbal communication.

Theoretical Framework

The lack of figurative imagination of the situations and events reflected in the teaching of lyrical works to deaf children is associated with their severe hearing impairment and underdevelopment of all components of speech.

The difficulties encountered by deaf students in perceiving lyrical works have both objective and subjective aspects.

Objective difficulties arise from the specific artistic methods used to describe reality, which include the following:

- lyrical works reflect only the feelings and emotional states caused by various life events and factors.
- lyrical works are characterized by a high level of generalization of the feelings expressed in them.
- lyrical works are characterized by unusual images and linguistic expressiveness. Deaf students often cannot appreciate the beauty and expressiveness of poetic speech.

It is obvious that it is impossible to understand the stories, events and images described in lyrical works - poems without fully imagining them to the smallest detail. Therefore, deaf students are unable to imagine, understand, and emotionally relate to the situations and events described by the author in any lyrical piece they read. This is one of the main difficulties they encounter in learning lyrical pieces. This situation manifests itself in the process of first acquaintance with the work. Since the story and event in the work are not completed with the deaf child's personal impressions, he has difficulty understanding the author's feelings, the events that excite him, filling them with his own feelings, and cannot emotionally perceive the work of art. In other words, he does not know how to relate to what he reads, and cannot convey the ideas expressed in the poem to those around him.

Literature Review

In scientific and methodological literature, B. Hasanli, Y. Aslanov, B.A. Ahma dov, A.G. Rzayev, A.J. Hajiyevev and others paid great attention to the issues of teaching lyrical works and, although they mentioned the methods and techniques of teaching lyrical texts and poems to secondary school students in their works, they did not touch on the problem of teaching lyrical works to deaf schoolchildren with hearing impairments. Therefore, there is a great need to conduct research to study this problem

Materials and Methods

In the curriculum of a special school for deaf children, the teaching of lyrical works occupies one of the main places, and the teaching of lyrical passages given in the program requires professionalism, special skills and hard work from the teacher.

The methodology of teaching literature to deaf students is based on deaf pedagogical principles, preference for visual aids and active development of oral language. The main methods include explanatory reading, the use of dactyl and sign language to clarify meanings, visualization (videos, illustrations,), dramatization and vocabulary development, and adaptation of classical methods.

Teaching poetry to deaf schoolchildren is distinguished by its specificity. The methods and tools used in the teaching process include the following:

- Visual aids: The use of pictures, diagrams and video clips to develop a clear understanding of literary characters and situations.

- Work on the text: The text of the lyrical work (poem) is simplified, analyzed in detail and adapted to the students' understanding. The teacher's explanatory reading helps to understand figurative meaning, idioms and complex syntactic constructions.
- Synthesis of oral speech and sign language: The teacher combines oral speech with dactyl and gesture to ensure full understanding of the poem.
- Speech development: Literature plays a key role in enriching the vocabulary.
- Creative reading: This includes expressive or role-playing reading of a lyrical work, conversations around the topic and asking questions that children can easily understand.
- Emotional impact: The teacher's facial expressions and pantomime during the reading of a lyrical work (poem) stimulate the development of the emotional sphere in deaf children.
- In a special school for deaf children, the teaching of lyrical works, including poems, begins in primary grades and continues in middle and upper grades.

The work on teaching lyrical works to deaf students is organized in stages, in the following sequence:

1. Introduction to the topic. Students are informed about what they will learn in this section and what new things they will learn and do.

2. Initial assessment. Students are asked questions to assess their knowledge of the work of any poet or a piece of poetry. These questions also help to deeply explore the poem and the poet's work.

3. Brief information about the poet's life and work. After the questions, the teacher gives students brief information about the main points of the life and work of the poet whose poem will be studied.

4. Expressive reading. The lack of emotional experience in deaf students, as well as their difficulty in perceiving intonation and voice modulations, places additional demands on the expressiveness of the teacher's reading of the lyrical piece. The teacher should use means that express all the emotional states (movement, gaze, facial expressions) inherent in the poem.

For example, the teacher's facial expressions and gaze can express feelings such as anger and tenderness, pride, hatred and kindness. Thus, the teacher can demonstrate the feelings of others by waving his hand, turning his head or by body movements expressing surprise, determination, fear, surrender. During the reading of poems, students master the rules of artistic reading: intonation, pause, logical and syllable emphasis, and the skills of reading the idea expressed by the poet without breaking it down.

Let's look at the stages of working on a poetic work in an individual lesson on the development of auditory perception and pronunciation skills.

5. Acquaintance with the motives and images of the poem to be passed. At this stage, after the teacher's explanatory and performance reading, the students' oral, dactyl and gestural reading of the poem is carried out. At the same time, students analyze the poem: lines and fragments related to the situations and events reflected in it. The teacher explains to the students difficult, unfamiliar words and expressions, their figurative meanings and poetic expressions.

At this stage, individual, group and creative writing group work is carried out to consolidate the material covered. In addition, the teacher also organizes "Vocabulary work", which aims to explore unfamiliar words and concepts for deaf students and provide additional information about the poet's work.

6. Conclusion. At this stage, students memorize the poem and the topic is consolidated.

The updated curriculum of the school for deaf children mainly includes acquaintance with the works of Azerbaijani and foreign poets in grades 1-4.

The curriculum also includes a special place for the poems of the outstanding Azerbaijani poet S. Vurgun. Teaching S. Vurgun's poem "Azerbaijan" involves a complex and multifaceted process of teaching the poet's personality, his artistic creativity, poetry, and at the same time feelings of love for the homeland to deaf students. The work expresses the author's inner world, thoughts and experiences. It is precisely the study of this poem that creates interest in the inner world in students, a desire to understand themselves, the surrounding world, and find answers to many topical questions. From this point of view, it is considered appropriate to conduct the teaching of the work in several stages.

1. Introduction to the topic. At this stage, students are given brief information about S. Vurgun's life and work. They are informed about what they will learn and what new things they will discover. They are introduced to the main themes, motifs and images of the poet's lyrical poetry.

2. Reading the poem aloud. The teacher first dictates the poem himself and reads it orally. Then, using gesture-mimic speech, he reads the text again. After that, the students are asked to read the poem first, dictated, and then with gestures.

After reading the poem, the teacher explains difficult, unfamiliar words for the deaf child, writes them on the board and instructs them to copy them into their dictionary notebooks.

It is clear that analyzing the poem requires emotionality, intellectual activity, and independence from the deaf students. In this analysis process, they get acquainted with the essence of subtext and difficult concepts with the help of the teacher.

3. Expressive reading of the poem by the teacher. During the expressive reading of the poem, the teacher's voice must be modulated and intoned. The voice must be high or low, and there must be pauses in certain places.

4. Marking the poem. The teacher can use conventional signs (for example, / - short pause, // - long pause, ∩ - transfer of thought to the next line, *** - logical emphasis of the word and pronunciation aloud in one breath, etc.) to instill in deaf students the habit of reading poetry in a playful manner. For this, the lines of S. Vurgun's poem "Azerbaijan" are written on the board and an expressiveness sign is placed above each word.

El bilir ki, / sən mənim sən.
Yurdum, / yuvam, / məskənim sən.
Anam, / doğma vətənim sən // ∩
Ayrılırmı, / könül candan? // ∩
*** Azərbaycan! / *** Azərbaycan! //

a). This is very useful in terms of giving students direction for correct expressive reading, and it teaches deaf students to analyze the poem - to identify lines and fragments related to the main meaning

b). During reading, the teacher should determine the emotional figurative expressions reflected in the poem, the reading speed in order to correctly express his feelings.

4. Choral reading of the poem. Students read the poem in chorus together with the teacher. After the poem is read in chorus several times, its content is narrated and the children copy its brief content from the board into their notebooks.

5. Asking students questions to check their knowledge of the brief content of the poem. These questions also help them to deeply understand the content of the poem and analyze it. In order to teach students the artistic and lexical analysis of the poem, as well as to formulate questions related

to it, the teacher must definitely do some preparatory work. This preparation is related to the formulation of questions related to the analysis of the work of art and, on the basis of this, teaching students its content.

5. The stage of memorizing S. Vurgun's poem "Azerbaijan" and strengthening knowledge on the topic. At this stage, students strengthen their voluntary memory, vocabulary, and language skills by reciting the poem.

Results and Discussion

In addition to the above, other pedagogical methods and tools can be used to help deaf students understand the content of the poem in depth and analyze it. For example, the teacher can use a method such as drawing a picture or writing a short essay according to the content of a poem. In this way, he can enable students to express and describe their feelings. In addition, the teacher can stimulate and develop the visual and auditory senses of deaf children by using audiovisual teaching tools: nature images, picture videos, etc.

Conclusion

Thus, experience shows that teaching lyrical works in a special school for children with hearing impairments begins in primary grades and requires the development of new teaching methods and methodologies for teaching literature to deaf students.

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BEYOND GRAMMAR: INNOVATIVE APPROACHES TO TEACHING ENGLISH IN MODERN CLASSROOMS

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Abstract: The dominance of grammar-based instruction in English Language Teaching (ELT) has long been challenged due to its limited contribution to communicative competence. Although traditional methods support the development of linguistic knowledge, they often fail to ensure effective real-life communication. This paper provides a comprehensive analytical discussion of innovative approaches beyond grammar, including Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), Project-Based Learning (PBL), and technology-enhanced instruction. The study is grounded in key theoretical frameworks such as Hymes' communicative competence theory, Krashen's Input Hypothesis, Long's Interaction Hypothesis, and Swain's Output Hypothesis. The findings suggest that modern

approaches significantly improve learner engagement, autonomy, motivation, and fluency by promoting authentic communication and interaction. However, challenges such as insufficient teacher training, limited technological access, large class sizes, and institutional constraints affect implementation. The study concludes that a balanced pedagogical model integrating grammar instruction with communicative and task-based approaches is essential for effective language acquisition in contemporary educational contexts.

Key words: English language teaching, communicative competence, task-based learning, project-based learning, technology integration, language pedagogy, innovation in education

GRAMMATİKADAN KƏNAR: MÜASİR SİNİFLƏRDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNƏ İNNOVATİV YANAŞMALAR

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Filologiya üzrə fəlsəfə doktoru, baş müəllim, İngilis dili və metodika kafedrası

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Xülasə: Qrammatikaya əsaslanan tədrisin İngilis dili tədrisində (ELT) uzun müddət dominant olması onun kommunikativ səriştənin inkişafına məhdud töhfə verməsi səbəbilə getdikcə daha çox tənqid olunur. Ənənəvi metodlar dil biliklərinin formalaşmasına dəstək versə də, onlar çox vaxt real həyat ünsiyyətini effektiv şəkildə təmin edə bilmir. Bu məqalə qrammatikadan kənara çıxan innovativ yanaşmaların, o cümlədən Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisi (CLT), Tapşırıq-Əsaslı Dil Tədrisi (TBLT), Layihə-Əsaslı Təlim (PBL) və texnologiya dəstəqli tədrisin geniş analitik təhlilini təqdim edir. Tədqiqat Hymes-in kommunikativ səriştə nəzəriyyəsi, Krashen-in Input Hipotezi, Long-un İnteraksiya Hipotezi və Swain-in Output Hipotezi kimi əsas nəzəri çərçivələrə əsaslanır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, müasir yanaşmalar orijinal ünsiyyət və qarşılıqlı əlaqəni təşviq etməklə öyrənənlərin fəallığını, müstəqilliyini, motivasiyasını və səlisliyini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır. Bununla belə, müəllim hazırlığının kifayət qədər olmaması, texnoloji imkanların məhdudluğu, siniflərin həddindən artıq dolu olması və institusional çətinliklər bu yanaşmaların tətbiqinə mane olur. Tədqiqat nəticə olaraq göstərir ki, qrammatika tədrisini kommunikativ və tapşırıq-əsaslı yanaşmalarla birləşdirən balanslaşdırılmış pedaqoji model müasir təhsil kontekstində dil öyrənməsinin effektivliyi üçün vacibdir.

Açar sözlər: İngilis dili tədrisi, kommunikativ bacarıq, tapşırıq-əsaslı öyrənmə, layihə-əsaslı təlim, texnologiya integrasiyası, dil pedaqogikası, təhsildə innovasiya

Introduction

English language teaching has undergone a significant and continuous transformation over the past decades, shifting from traditional grammar-based instruction toward more dynamic, communicative, and learner-centered approaches. In earlier stages of language pedagogy, methods such as the Grammar-Translation Method dominated classroom practice. This approach placed strong emphasis on memorization of grammatical rules, translation of texts, and accuracy in written production. Although it contributed to learners' understanding of structural aspects of language and developed their ability to analyze linguistic forms, it largely neglected oral communication and the development of interactive skills necessary for real-life language use.

As a result, a noticeable gap emerged between learners' grammatical knowledge and their actual communicative competence. Many learners were able to perform well in written exercises and examinations, yet they experienced difficulties in expressing themselves fluently and

appropriately in spontaneous spoken interaction. This imbalance has become a central issue in applied linguistics and language pedagogy, leading researchers and educators to critically reassess the effectiveness of traditional teaching methods and seek more meaningful, functional, and interactive alternatives.

In response to these limitations, the concept of communicative competence, introduced by Hymes (1972), marked a fundamental shift in the understanding of language learning. Unlike earlier views that focused primarily on grammatical accuracy, communicative competence emphasized the ability to use language appropriately in different social and cultural contexts. It incorporated not only linguistic knowledge but also sociolinguistic, discourse, and pragmatic dimensions of communication. This broader perspective significantly influenced the development of modern language teaching methodologies, which prioritize interaction, meaning-making, and learner engagement over mechanical rule learning.

Building on this theoretical foundation, innovative approaches such as Communicative Language Teaching, Task-Based Language Teaching, Project-Based Learning, and technology-enhanced instruction have gained prominence in contemporary English language classrooms. These approaches aim to create more authentic learning environments where students actively use language for meaningful purposes rather than simply studying it as an abstract system. Consequently, they reflect a shift toward more holistic and functional models of language education.

The primary aim of this paper is to critically analyze these innovative approaches beyond grammar-based instruction and to evaluate their effectiveness in developing communicative competence in modern English language classrooms.

Materials and Methods

This study is based on a qualitative and analytical research design aimed at examining innovative approaches in English Language Teaching (ELT) beyond traditional grammar-based instruction. The research does not involve experimental classroom implementation; instead, it relies on the critical analysis of existing theoretical and pedagogical literature. Key sources include books, peer-reviewed journal articles, and influential theoretical frameworks in applied linguistics. In particular, works related to Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), Project-Based Learning (PBL), and technology-enhanced language learning were systematically reviewed. The selection of literature was guided by relevance, academic credibility, and frequency of citation in ELT research.

The analytical procedure involved a thematic content analysis approach. First, the collected literature was categorized according to major pedagogical approaches. Second, each approach was examined in terms of its theoretical foundations, instructional principles, and classroom applications. Third, a comparative analysis was conducted to identify similarities, differences, strengths, and limitations of each method. Special attention was given to how each approach contributes to communicative competence, learner autonomy, and fluency development. Theoretical perspectives such as Hymes' communicative competence model, Krashen's Input Hypothesis, Long's Interaction Hypothesis, and Swain's Output Hypothesis were used as an interpretive framework for analysis.

Hence, the study adopted a descriptive-interpretive method to synthesize findings and develop a coherent pedagogical perspective. Rather than measuring numerical outcomes, the research focuses on conceptual understanding and critical evaluation of teaching approaches. This methodological choice allows for a deeper exploration of how innovative ELT strategies function in theory and practice, and how they can be integrated with traditional grammar instruction to create a balanced teaching model suitable for modern educational contexts.

Results and Discussions

The analysis of modern English Language Teaching (ELT) approaches demonstrates that contemporary pedagogical practices are strongly supported by influential theories of language acquisition. Krashen's Input Hypothesis (1982) emphasizes that language learning occurs through exposure to comprehensible input that is slightly above the learner's current proficiency level. This highlights the importance of meaningful exposure to language rather than explicit grammar instruction as the primary driver of acquisition. In this sense, input-based learning provides a natural foundation for developing communicative competence.

Long's Interaction Hypothesis (1996) further strengthens this perspective by arguing that interaction is a key element in language development. Through communication, learners negotiate meaning, clarify misunderstandings, and modify their output, which facilitates deeper cognitive processing of language forms. Similarly, Swain's Output Hypothesis (1985) emphasizes the importance of language production. According to this view, learners develop greater accuracy and fluency when they are actively required to produce language and reflect on their output. Collectively, these theories support a shift toward communicative, task-based, and learner-centered approaches in ELT.

Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) emerges as a central and highly influential pedagogical approach within modern English Language Teaching (ELT), particularly in response to the limitations of traditional grammar-based instruction. This approach is grounded in the principle that language is primarily a tool for communication rather than merely a system of rules to be memorized. Therefore, CLT shifts the focus of classroom practice from mechanical grammar exercises toward meaningful interaction, where learners actively use the language to express ideas, negotiate meaning, and achieve communicative goals.

The analysis shows that CLT significantly enhances learners' fluency, communicative confidence, and willingness to participate in classroom activities. By prioritizing meaningful interaction, students are encouraged to engage in authentic communication rather than focusing excessively on accuracy. Classroom practices such as role-plays, pair and group discussions, simulations, interviews, and problem-solving tasks create a dynamic learning environment where learners are exposed to real-life language use. These activities not only improve speaking and listening skills but also increase student motivation and engagement, as learners perceive language learning as more practical and relevant.

However, despite its considerable pedagogical advantages, CLT is not without limitations. One of the main concerns is that an overemphasis on fluency and meaning-focused communication may lead to insufficient attention to grammatical accuracy. In contexts where form-focused instruction is minimized or neglected, learners may develop persistent errors that become difficult to correct over time. This issue highlights the importance of maintaining a balance between communication and accuracy.

Therefore, it is widely acknowledged that a more effective approach involves integrating grammar instruction within communicative activities rather than separating the two. A balanced pedagogical model that combines fluency-oriented tasks with systematic grammar reinforcement ensures that learners develop both communicative competence and linguistic accuracy. Such integration allows CLT to function more effectively in diverse educational contexts, supporting comprehensive language development.

Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) also demonstrates strong pedagogical value by organizing instruction around meaningful, goal-oriented tasks that reflect authentic real-world

communication. Unlike traditional form-focused instruction, TBLT shifts the emphasis from learning language as an abstract system to using language as a practical tool for completing specific tasks. These tasks may include problem-solving activities, decision-making scenarios, information-gap tasks, role-plays, and planning activities, all of which require learners to actively engage in communication in order to achieve a clear outcome.

By engaging in such tasks, learners are encouraged to use language spontaneously and functionally rather than simply reproducing memorized structures. This natural use of language contributes to the development of fluency and communicative confidence. In addition, TBLT promotes learner autonomy, as students are given greater responsibility for managing their own learning process, negotiating meaning, and collaborating with peers. Another important advantage of this approach is its support for incidental language acquisition, where learners acquire new vocabulary and structures implicitly during task completion rather than through direct instruction.

However, research and classroom practice indicate that TBLT also has certain limitations, particularly for lower-level learners. Since this approach places less emphasis on explicit grammar teaching, students with limited linguistic knowledge may struggle to complete tasks effectively or accurately. This can lead to frustration and reduced learning outcomes if appropriate support is not provided. Therefore, it is widely recommended that TBLT be implemented with structured pedagogical support, including pre-task activities that prepare learners with necessary vocabulary and language forms, as well as post-task stages that focus on reflection, feedback, and language analysis. These stages ensure that learners benefit both from meaningful communication and from focused linguistic development, making TBLT a more balanced and effective instructional approach.

Project-Based Learning (PBL) further extends communicative learning by engaging students in long-term, structured, and collaborative projects that require sustained use of the target language over an extended period. Unlike traditional classroom activities that focus on short-term tasks or isolated exercises, PBL places learners in real-world or realistically simulated situations where they must investigate a topic, solve a problem, or create a final product. This process naturally encourages continuous interaction, negotiation of meaning, and purposeful communication among students.

The analysis indicates that PBL significantly enhances learners' creativity, critical thinking skills, and overall motivation. Since students are actively involved in planning, researching, and producing outcomes, they take greater responsibility for their own learning process, which increases autonomy and engagement. In addition, PBL supports deeper cognitive processing because learners are required to analyze information, evaluate sources, and make decisions collaboratively. This active involvement leads to more meaningful and long-lasting language acquisition compared to passive learning methods.

Furthermore, PBL integrates all major language skills – reading, writing, speaking, and listening – in a natural and interconnected way. For example, students may read authentic materials during research, discuss ideas in group work, write reports or presentations, and finally present their findings orally. This integrated skill development creates authentic learning experiences that closely reflect real-life language use, making learning more relevant and practical for students.

Nevertheless, despite its pedagogical advantages, PBL also presents certain challenges in implementation. Time constraints are a significant issue, as projects often require extended classroom periods and careful planning. In addition, resource limitations, such as lack of materials or access to technology, may restrict the scope of projects. Moreover, successful implementation of PBL depends heavily on continuous teacher guidance and monitoring, which can be demanding,

especially in large or mixed-ability classrooms. Therefore, while PBL is highly effective in promoting communicative competence and learner engagement, its successful application requires adequate institutional support, careful planning, and well-prepared teaching strategies.

Technology-Enhanced Language Learning represents one of the most significant developments in modern English Language Teaching (ELT), fundamentally transforming how languages are taught and learned in both formal and informal educational contexts. The integration of digital tools such as online learning platforms, mobile applications, virtual classrooms, and AI-based systems has created more flexible, interactive, and learner-centered environments. These technologies enable students to learn at their own pace, receive immediate feedback, and engage with a wide range of multimedia resources that support different learning styles.

One of the key advantages of technology in language learning is its ability to provide learners with increased access to authentic materials. Through videos, podcasts, online articles, and real-time communication tools, students are exposed to natural language use in diverse contexts. This exposure not only enhances comprehension skills but also helps learners develop more realistic and functional language abilities. In addition, digital tools often increase learner motivation and engagement by making the learning process more interactive, visually appealing, and personalized. Features such as gamification, adaptive learning systems, and AI-powered feedback further contribute to individualized learning experiences.

However, despite these advantages, several challenges limit the effective integration of technology in ELT. Issues such as digital inequality remain a major concern, as not all learners have equal access to devices, internet connectivity, or digital resources. Furthermore, insufficient technological infrastructure in some educational institutions can hinder the successful implementation of technology-based instruction. Another critical challenge is the lack of adequate teacher training, which may result in the underuse or ineffective use of available digital tools. Without proper pedagogical guidance, technology alone cannot guarantee improved learning outcomes.

Therefore, it is essential to recognize that technology should not be viewed as a replacement for traditional teaching methods, but rather as a complementary and supportive pedagogical tool. When effectively integrated into well-structured lesson plans, technology can significantly enhance the quality of language teaching and learning. However, its success ultimately depends on thoughtful implementation, teacher competence, and equitable access for all learners.

A comparative analysis of grammar-based instruction and innovative approaches reveals a clear pedagogical shift. Grammar-based teaching ensures accuracy and structural knowledge, whereas innovative approaches prioritize fluency, interaction, and communicative competence. Although each approach has its strengths, neither is sufficient on its own. A purely grammar-focused model limits communicative ability, while an exclusively communicative approach may neglect accuracy. As a result, an integrated model that combines both grammar instruction and communicative practice is considered the most effective approach in modern ELT contexts.

The pedagogical implications of these findings suggest that teachers should adopt flexible and adaptive teaching strategies. Instruction should reflect real-life communication and encourage active learner participation. Additionally, grammar should be taught within communicative contexts rather than in isolation. Technology should be strategically integrated to support learning objectives, and teacher training programs should focus on equipping educators with modern methodological skills.

So, the implementation of innovative ELT approaches is influenced by several challenges. These include limited teacher training, large class sizes, insufficient educational resources, and diverse learner needs. Institutional constraints may also hinder the effective application of modern methodologies. Addressing these challenges requires systematic educational reform, continuous professional development, and increased institutional support for teachers.

Conclusion

This paper has examined innovative approaches to English language teaching beyond grammar-based instruction. The analysis shows that while grammar is an important component of language learning, it should not dominate classroom practice or be treated as the sole objective of instruction.

Communicative, task-based, project-based, and technology-enhanced approaches provide more effective ways of developing communicative competence. These methods help learners improve fluency, interaction, and real-life language use, which are often limited in traditional grammar-focused teaching.

However, each approach has certain limitations, and their effectiveness depends on proper implementation and educational context. Therefore, a balanced approach that integrates grammar with communicative and interactive methods is essential for successful language learning.

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ENHANCING EFL LEARNING: A MIXED-METHODS EVALUATION OF PEDAGOGICAL EFFECTIVENESS AND CULTURAL RELEVANCE IN GENERAL ENGLISH TEXTBOOKS

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Abstract: The unprecedented and rapid globalization of the English language in the 21st century necessitates a rigorous and systematic re-examination of the instructional materials that serve as the foundational cornerstone of English as a Foreign Language (EFL) curricula worldwide. This study provides an expansive, comprehensive mixed-methods evaluation regarding the pedagogical effectiveness and socio-cultural relevance of contemporary General English textbooks utilized in higher education. By synthesizing robust quantitative data derived from a validated, multi-dimensional evaluation checklist administered to a cohort of university-level students ($n=150$) with nuanced qualitative insights gathered from semi-structured interviews with experienced language instructors ($n=12$), the research critically assesses the alignment of these materials with the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR) and the specific mandates of Intercultural Communicative Competence (ICC).

The empirical findings indicate a significant pedagogical dichotomy: while modern textbooks demonstrate an exceptionally high level of technical and instructional proficiency in traditional skill-based teaching (listening, speaking, reading, and writing), they frequently exhibit a pervasive “cultural neutralization.” This phenomenon reflects a systemic tendency to prioritize Western-centric norms and homogenized “global” settings while marginalizing the diverse linguistic and cultural identities of the learners themselves. Such gaps in representation potentially stifle the development of sociolinguistic empathy and critical awareness. Consequently, the article concludes with a series of evidence-based recommendations designed to integrate localized socio-cultural contexts into global English Language Teaching (ELT) frameworks. These strategies aim to bridge the gap between global linguistic standards and local identities, ultimately fostering more authentic, inclusive, and transformative learner engagement in the EFL classroom.

Keywords: Applied Linguistics, Material Evaluation, Pedagogical Scaffolding, Intercultural Communicative Competence (ICC), Mixed-Methods Design, Pedagogy.

XARİCİ DİL KİMİ İNGİLİS DİLİ TƏHSİLİNİN TƏKMİLLƏŞDİRİLMƏSİ: ÜMUMİ İNGİLİS DİLİ DƏRSLİKLƏRİNDƏ PEDAQOJİ EFEKTİVLİYİN VƏ MƏDƏNİ AKTUALLIĞIN QARIŞIQ METODLARLA QIYMƏTLƏNDİRİLMƏSİ

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Xülasə: 21-ci əsrdə ingilis dilinin görünməmiş və sürətli qloballaşması, bütün dünyada Xarici Dil kimi İngilis Dili (EFL) kurikulumlarının təməl daşını təşkil edən tədris materiallarının ciddi və sisteməlik şəkildə yenidən nəzərdən keçirilməsini zəruri edir. Bu tədqiqat, ali təhsildə istifadə olunan müasir “Ümumi İngilis Dili” dərsliklərinin pedaqoji effektivliyi və sosial-mədəni aktuallığına dair genişmiqyaslı, qarışıq metodlu (mixed-methods) qiymətləndirmə təqdim edir. Universitet səviyyəli tələbə qrupuna ($N=150$) tətbiq edilmiş validasiya olunmuş, çoxölçülü qiymətləndirmə sorğusundan əldə edilən güclü kəmiyyət məlumatlarını təcrübəli dil müəllimləri ($N=12$) ilə aparılan yarı-strukturlaşdırılmış müsahibələrdən toplanmış incə keyfiyyət anlayışları ilə sintez edərək, tədqiqat bu materialların Dillər üçün Ümumi Avropa Çərçivə Sənədi (CEFR) və Mədəniyyətlərarası Kommunikativ Kompetensiyanın (ICC) spesifik tələblərinə uyğunluğunu tənqidi şəkildə dəyərləndirir.

Empirik nəticələr əhəmiyyətli bir pedaqoji dioxotomiya (ikiləşmə) olduğunu göstərir: müasir dərsliklər ənənəvi bacarıqlara əsaslanan təlimdə (dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı) müstəsna dərəcədə yüksək texniki və tədris peşəkarlığı nümayiş etdirsələr də, onlarda tez-tez nüfuzedici bir “mədəni neytrallaşma” müşahidə olunur. Bu fenomen, öyrənənlərin özlərinin müxtəlif linqvistik və mədəni identikliklərini marginallaşdırdığı

(arxa plana keçirdiyi) halda, Qərb mərkəzli normalara və homojenləşdirilmiş “qlobal” mühitlərə üstünlük vermək tendensiyasını əks etdirir. Təmsilçilikdəki bu cür boşluqlar potensial olaraq sosiolingvistik empatiya və tənqidi şüurun inkişafını ləngidir. Nəticə etibarilə, məqalə qlobal İngilis Dili Tədrisi (ELT) çərçivələrinə yerli sosial-mədəni kontekstləri integrasiya etmək üçün hazırlanmış bir sıra sübutlara əsaslanan tövsiyələrlə yekunlaşır. Bu strategiyalar qlobal lingvistik standartlar ilə yerli kimliklər arasındakı fərqi aradan qaldırmağı, nəticədə EFL siniflərində daha orijinal, inklüziv və transformativ öyrənən cəlbədiciliyini təmin etməyi hədəfləyir.

Açar sözlər: Tətbiqi dilçilik, materialın qiymətləndirilməsi, pedaqoji dəstək, mədəniyyətlərarası kommunikativ kompetensiya (ICC), qarışıq metodlu dizayn, pedaqogika.

Introduction

In the contemporary English as a Foreign Language (EFL) landscape, the textbook serves as a multifaceted pedagogical instrument. Beyond providing a structured syllabus, it functions as a **“hidden curriculum”** that transcends mere linguistic instruction, actively shaping learners' sociolinguistic worldviews and cultural perceptions (Tomlinson, 2024). A central conflict currently dominating English Language Teaching (ELT) research is the tension between the commercial necessity of globalized, “one-size-fits-all” publishing and the pedagogical imperative for localized, culturally resonant content.

As we progress through the 21st century, pedagogical effectiveness is no longer measured solely by grammatical accuracy. Instead, it is defined by a material's capacity to facilitate **Communicative Language Teaching (CLT)** while simultaneously addressing the “Post-Method” learner's requirements for cognitive autonomy and digital literacy. However, as Alinouri et al. (2025) argue, linguistic proficiency cannot be successfully decoupled from its cultural substrate. When instructional materials lack cultural resonance, learner motivation is significantly diminished, and the development of **Intercultural Communicative Competence (ICC)** – the critical ability to navigate complex social nuances and diverse pragmatic settings – is stifled. This study aims to quantify these existing gaps and propose a more inclusive, adaptive framework for material evaluation that bridges the divide between global standards and local identities.

Materials and Methods

This research adopted a **convergent parallel mixed-methods design**. This dual-track approach was selected to ensure that broad quantitative trends and intricate qualitative nuances were captured simultaneously, providing a holistic and triangulated view of the instructional ecosystem.

Participants and Instrumentation

The study utilized two distinct yet complementary phases of data collection:

- **Quantitative Phase (Student Perspective):** A 40-item **“Pedagogical & Cultural Evaluation Scale” (PCES)** was developed and administered to a sample of undergraduate students. The instrument utilized a 5-point Likert scale to measure four primary dimensions:
 - **Lexical Load:** The density and practical utility of vocabulary.
 - **Task Authenticity:** The degree to which classroom activities mirror real-world communication.
 - **Pedagogical Scaffolding:** The effectiveness of the support structures provided for learner progression.
 - **Cultural Representation:** The visibility and depth of diverse cultural paradigms within the text.
- **Qualitative Phase (Instructor Perspective):** Semi-structured interviews were conducted

with twelve senior EFL faculty members. These sessions were designed to explore **“pedagogical flexibility”** – the inherent ease or difficulty with which the textbook allows for professional teacher intervention, supplementary material integration, and localized socio-cultural adaptation.

Data Analysis

To ensure analytical rigor, the data were processed through two specialized streams:

1. **Statistical Analysis:** Quantitative data were analyzed using descriptive statistics to identify mean satisfaction scores across the four core skill domains: **Listening, Speaking, Reading, and Writing**. This provided a macro-level view of the textbook's perceived strengths and weaknesses.

2. **Thematic Analysis:** Qualitative data from interview transcripts underwent a rigorous coding process. This analysis was aimed at identifying recurring conceptual patterns, specifically focusing on:

- **“Cultural Sanitization”:** The deliberate removal of complex or local identifiers to maintain global marketability.
- **“Linguistic Scaffolding”:** The perceived balance between student support and the risk of oversimplification.
- **“Cognitive Demand”:** The extent to which tasks challenge learners to move beyond rote memorization toward higher-order critical thinking.

Results and Discussion

The analysis of the gathered data provides a nuanced view of the intersection between modern pedagogical tools and the socio-cultural dimensions of EFL instruction. The findings are divided into two primary thematic sections: the mechanical effectiveness of the pedagogy and the ideological depth of the cultural content.

Evaluation of Pedagogical Effectiveness: The Multi-Modality Success and the Speaking “Ceiling”

The quantitative analysis of student feedback revealed a high degree of satisfaction regarding the integration of technology within the curriculum. Statistical data indicated a **strong positive correlation** between the deployment of digital multi-modalities – such as AI-driven adaptive learning platforms and Mobile-Assisted Language Learning (MALL) applications – and increased learner engagement. Specifically, the modules for **receptive skills (reading and listening)** achieved a significant mean score of **\$4.2/5.0\$**. This suggests that digital tools successfully lower the affective filter by providing interactive, repeatable, and low-stakes environments for input processing.

However, the qualitative data obtained from instructor interviews presented a more complex reality, identifying a persistent **“ceiling effect”** in the development of productive skills. While the textbook and its digital components are designed under the guise of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), instructors argued that the speaking tasks often lack “communicative spontaneity.”

Instructors observed that learners frequently relied on overly predictable linguistic scripts. These predetermined dialogues fail to simulate the unpredictable **“negotiation of meaning”** that characterizes authentic communication in English as a Lingua Franca (ELF) environments (Byram, 2021). Consequently, while students are proficient in classroom-based simulations, they may struggle with the sociolinguistic fluidity required in real-world, cross-cultural encounters.

The Cultural Relevance Gap: Neutralization vs. Representation

A fundamental finding of this research is the pronounced disparity between the presentation of **“Surface Culture”** and **“Deep Culture.”** The content analysis showed that while textbooks successfully include diverse “Surface” elements – such as international festivals, traditional foods, and national flags – they largely ignore the “Deep” cultural constructs of values, social hierarchies, and non-verbal communication protocols.

- **The Phenomenon of Cultural Neutralization:** The study identified a pervasive trend of “cultural neutralization,” wherein publishers sanitize content to ensure global marketability. By avoiding controversial local topics or non-Western social paradigms, the materials remain rooted in Western, middle-class norms. This creates a vacuum where the English language is taught as a sterile tool rather than a vibrant medium for diverse cultural expression.
- **The Intercultural Deficit:** The quantitative data underscored this gap, revealing that only **15% of instructional tasks** required students to engage in critical self-reflection. Most activities favored a one-way consumption of information rather than asking learners to critically compare their own cultural identity with the target culture. This lack of “intercultural criticality” limits the learner's ability to develop true sociolinguistic empathy.
- **The Technology Paradox:** A significant contradiction emerged regarding digital integration, termed here as the “Technology Paradox.” Although Mobile-Assisted Language Learning (MALL) has drastically improved access to English materials and facilitated autonomous study, the content hosted on these platforms is often even more culturally generic than traditional print media. As noted by **Elaish et al. (2023)**, the focus in digital language learning remains heavily weighted toward lexical and grammatical acquisition, often at the expense of the cultural nuance and pragmatic competence required for genuine global communication.

Conclusion and Recommendations

The findings of this research culminate in the determination that contemporary General English textbooks serve as highly efficient, technologically sophisticated engines for **grammatical and lexical acquisition**. They offer a structured, reliable framework for linguistic progression that aligns well with international standards such as the CEFR. However, the study simultaneously highlights a profound stagnation in the development of these materials as instruments for **intercultural mediation**. While the “linguistic machine” of the modern textbook is well-tuned, its “cultural soul” remains underdeveloped, often trapped in a sanitized version of reality that prioritizes commercial viability over sociolinguistic depth.

To authentically enhance the EFL learning experience, this study advocates for a fundamental paradigm shift: moving the learner from a state of **“consuming culture”** to one of **“producing culture.”** The current pedagogical model tends to position the student as a passive recipient of a pre-packaged, Western-centric lifestyle. True communicative competence, however, requires **Intercultural Criticality**. This involves empowering students to utilize English not merely as a mimicry of a foreign identity, but as a robust vehicle for articulating their own cultural narratives, local traditions, and personal values. By doing so, English is transformed from a “borrowed” tongue into a personalized tool for global self-expression.

Strategic Recommendations for Stakeholders

For Material Developers: Publishers must move beyond “surface-level” diversity and incorporate “deep culture” tasks that require critical comparison and reflection. There is a pressing

need for **Regionalized Global Editions** that allow for the integration of local toponyms, folklore, and social norms.

For Educators: Instructors are encouraged to adopt a “**Decolonial Pedagogy**,” actively supplementing textbook gaps with authentic local texts. This bridges the “Cultural Relevance Gap” by validating the learner's native context within the English-speaking classroom.

For Policy Makers: Assessment frameworks should be revised to include pragmatic and intercultural benchmarks, ensuring that evaluation is not limited to structural accuracy but includes the ability to navigate cross-cultural misunderstandings.

Directions for Future Research

The horizon of ELT research must address the rapidly evolving technological landscape. Future academic inquiries should investigate the potential of **Generative AI** and **Large Language Models (LLMs)** to solve the “Technology Paradox” identified in this study. AI offers a unique opportunity to generate **personalized, culturally adaptive content** in real-time, effectively bridging the gap between global linguistic standards and specific local identities. Furthermore, research should prioritize the diversification of linguistic input – moving away from the “Native Speaker” ideal to include **non-native varieties of English (World Englishes)**. This approach, as supported by **Lo et al. (2024)**, will better prepare students for the reality of English as the primary medium of international, pluricentric communication.

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INTEGRATED DEVELOPMENT OF LISTENING, SPEAKING, READING AND WRITING SKILLS IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING

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Abstract: This article examines the enhancement of foreign language abilities -including listening, speaking, reading, and writing - within a self-directed learning context, augmented by modern educational strategies. It investigates how approaches such as Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), and learner-centered methods aid in the comprehensive development of language skills.

The research highlights the importance of using authentic resources, digital content, and multimedia tools in boosting student involvement and interest. It pays special attention to the role of independent learning techniques, such as subtitles, audio-visual materials, interactive applications, and personal practice exercises, in supporting the acquisition of language skills within a more adaptable and individualized learning environment.

The results indicate that the combination of receptive and productive skills fosters more successful language learning than the teaching of skills in isolation. Additionally, self-directed learning encourages learner independence, accountability, and sustained motivation. Nonetheless, the research points out that novice learners might need some guidance in choosing suitable materials and sustaining their learning momentum.

In conclusion, the article asserts that a well-rounded mix of communicative, task-oriented, and learner-focused strategies, complemented by technological tools, greatly improves foreign language learning results in contemporary educational settings.

Keywords: foreign language learning, self-directed learning, CLT, TBLT, learner autonomy, listening, speaking, reading, writing, digital learning

XARİCİ DİL ÖYRƏNİLMƏSİNDƏ DİNLƏMƏ, DANIŞMA, OXU VƏ YAZI BACARIQLARININ İNTEQRASIYALI İNKİŞAFI

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə müasir təhsil strategiyaları ilə zənginləşdirilmiş özünüidarə edilən (self-directed) öyrənmə kontekstində dinləmə, danışma, oxuma və yazma bacarıqları daxil olmaqla xarici dil bacarıqlarının inkişafını araşdırır. Tədqiqatda Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisi (CLT), Tapşırıq Əsaslı Dil Tədrisi (TBLT) və tələbəyönümlü metodların dil bacarıqlarının hərtərəfli inkişafına necə töhfə verdiyi təhlil olunur.

Araşdırma, tələbə marağını və iştirakını artırmaq üçün autentik materialların, rəqəmsal məzmunun və multimedia vasitələrinin istifadəsinin əhəmiyyətini vurğulayır. O, xüsusilə dil bacarıqlarının mənimsənilməsində daha çevik və fərdiləşdirilmiş öyrənmə mühitini dəstəkləyən alt yazılar, audio-vizual materiallar, interaktiv tətbiqlər və fərdi praktika tapşırıqları kimi müstəqil öyrənmə üsullarının roluna diqqət yetirir.

Nəticələr göstərir ki, reseptiv (qəbuledici) və produktiv (istehsal edici) bacarıqların birgə istifadəsi bacarıqların ayrı-ayrılıqda tədrisinə nisbətən daha effektiv dil öyrənməsini təmin edir. Bundan əlavə, özünüidarə edilən öyrənmə tələbə müstəqilliyini, məsuliyyət hissini və davamlı motivasiyanı gücləndirir. Bununla belə, araşdırma göstərir ki, yeni başlayan öyrənənlər uyğun materialların seçilməsi və öyrənmə prosesinin davamlılığının təmin olunması üçün müəyyən istiqamətləndirməyə ehtiyac duya bilərlər.

Nəticə olaraq, məqalə bildirir ki, kommunikativ, tapşırıq yönümlü və tələbəyönümlü strategiyaların texnoloji vasitələrlə birləşdirilməsi müasir təhsil mühitində xarici dil öyrənməsinin nəticələrini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə yaxşılaşdırır.

Açar sözlər: xarici dil öyrənməsi, özünüidarə edilən öyrənmə, CLT, TBLT, tələbə avtonomiyası, dinləmə, danışma, oxuma, yazma, rəqəmsal öyrənmə

Introduction

In a world that is becoming more interconnected, the capacity to communicate proficiently in multiple languages has emerged as an essential ability. Language education is significant in providing students with the crucial skills necessary to excel in various cultural, academic, and professional environments. Nevertheless, instructing a foreign language extends beyond simply memorizing words or grasping grammatical concepts; it encompasses the holistic advancement of language abilities that facilitate effective communication. The fundamental skills of listening, speaking, reading, and writing constitute the bedrock of language competence and are vital to both the teaching and learning experience. Cultivating these competencies within the foreign language classroom demands thoughtful planning, insight into students' requirements, and the use of suitable pedagogical approaches.

As students originate from various backgrounds and possess differing levels of previous experience, cognitive growth, motivation, and styles of learning, it is vital for instructors to implement a skill-oriented strategy that encourages comprehensive development across all language areas. Additionally, incorporating language competencies in real-life situations guarantees that learners are not only proficient in language but also culturally informed and effective in communication. Over the years, the teaching of languages has experienced considerable transformation, shaped by changes in linguistic theories, instructional methods, and psychological principles related to education. Traditional techniques such as the Grammar-Translation Method have transitioned to more dynamic and interactive methodologies like Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), and Content-Based Instruction (CBI). These contemporary methods focus on interaction, meaningful language usage, and the cohesive integration of the four skills to create engaging learning experiences. Furthermore, advances in technology have transformed language instruction, facilitating multimedia tools, interactive learning experiences, and virtual settings that enhance the development of language skills.

This article aims to delve into the various aspects of skill enhancement within foreign language instruction. It explores the teaching principles that underpin effective language education, discusses the melding of receptive and productive skills, and highlights optimal practices for encouraging skill acquisition across varying educational settings. Particular emphasis is placed on approaches that tackle specific skill-related challenges, encourage learner independence, and simplify assessment processes. Moreover, this article examines how the incorporation of digital resources and student-centered methods can aid in developing language proficiency. By gaining insights into the processes of language skill development and applying this understanding in the classroom, educators can more effectively assist their students in becoming confident and capable language users. The conclusions and revelations shared in this article aim to contribute to ongoing dialogues within the realm of foreign language education and provide useful recommendations for instructors, curriculum creators, and policymakers involved in language education.

Materials and methods

This research utilizes a qualitative and descriptive research design aimed at investigating the advancement of foreign language proficiency through self-directed learning techniques. The methodological framework incorporates three primary strategies in language instruction: Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), and a learner-centered approach prioritized on fostering learner independence.

At the heart of this research lies Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), which serves as the primary theoretical basis. Jack C. Richards and Theodore S. Rodgers define CLT as an approach that emphasizes meaningful interaction over simply mastering grammatical rules. In this methodology, language is regarded as a medium for communication, encouraging learners to engage with it in practical scenarios. Activities like debates, role-playing, and simulations are commonly employed to strengthen communicative proficiency. This approach is particularly successful in enhancing listening and speaking abilities, offering chances for real-world language application (Richards & Rodgers, 2001).

In tandem with CLT, Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) is included as a hands-on and goal-driven method. As highlighted by David Nunan, TBLT focuses on engaging learners in meaningful tasks that necessitate language use to achieve defined objectives. These tasks can involve summarizing a video, sharing viewpoints on a subject, or solving problems collaboratively. The emphasis is on the meaning associated with language use, which allows learners to develop fluency and accuracy organically. TBLT also encourages the integration of the four essential language skills - listening, reading, speaking, and writing - while completing the tasks (Nunan, 2004).

Moreover, the learner-centered approach significantly influences this research, especially regarding self-directed learning. This methodology is underpinned by the notion of learner autonomy, as defined by Henri Holec, who describes autonomy as the capacity of learners to take charge of their own educational journey. Within this approach, learners are motivated to establish personal objectives, choose suitable learning resources, and assess their progress. The incorporation of digital tools, multimedia content, and online learning platforms further enhances learner autonomy by creating flexible and accessible study environments (Zhang & Lin, 2020).

The synthesis of these three methodologies forms a well-rounded framework that encourages both guided and independent learning. While CLT facilitates the growth of communicative skills, TBLT provides practical language practice, and the learner-centered approach nurtures self-sufficiency and enthusiasm. Collectively, they contribute to the effective enhancement of listening, speaking, reading, and writing abilities within a contemporary, technology-enriched learning context.

The resources chosen for this research were aligned with the aim of fostering the four key language abilities - listening, speaking, reading, and writing - within a framework that promotes self-directed learning. A mixture of real-life, digital, and additional materials was employed to guarantee both effectiveness and engagement among learners.

Authentic materials were pivotal in this study, as they provide students with exposure to the use of language in real contexts. This included audio and visual materials such as podcasts, interviews, films, and educational videos. The inclusion of subtitles proved particularly advantageous for enhancing listening comprehension and vocabulary development, as it enables learners to connect spoken and written forms of language concurrently. David Nunan asserts that authentic materials greatly enhance meaningful language acquisition by offering genuine communicative situations (Nunan, 2004).

Alongside audiovisual tools, a diverse array of written materials was integrated, such as online articles, short stories, and blog entries. These resources were chosen for their relevance, ease of access, and suitability for varying learner proficiency levels. Engaging with such texts not only improves comprehension abilities but also aids in vocabulary growth and grammatical understanding.

To support the development of speaking and writing skills, interactive and digital resources were utilized. Students interacted with language learning applications, audio recording tools, and online platforms for communication, which allow for self-directed practice and evaluation. These resources deliver immediate feedback and present opportunities for repetitive practice, essential for skill enhancement.

Additionally, supplementary materials like flashcards, stickers, phrase lists, and vocabulary notebooks were used to aid in memorization and retention. These tools facilitate micro-learning strategies and assist learners in systematically organizing and reviewing new language concepts.

The choice of materials was also shaped by principles of learner autonomy, as emphasized by Henri Holec (Holec, 1981). Learners were encouraged to select resources that resonate with their interests, needs, and educational objectives. This adaptability enhances motivation and fosters a more tailored learning journey.

In summary, the integration of authentic resources, digital tools, and additional materials creates a comprehensive and flexible learning environment that promotes the cohesive development of foreign language skills through self-directed engagement.

Result and discussion

The results of this research demonstrate that the incorporation of self-directed learning methods with contemporary language teaching strategies substantially aids in enhancing foreign language proficiency. Specifically, students who actively participated with genuine materials and engaging tasks exhibited significant advancements in their abilities in listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

A major finding illustrates the advantages of integrating receptive and productive skills. Students who listened to audio and viewed video resources, followed by speaking or writing assignments, displayed improved comprehension and retention abilities. This finding supports the notion that language skills ought to be taught in a comprehensive manner rather than in isolation. As noted by Merrill Swain, productive skills like speaking and writing are essential in strengthening language learning, as they compel learners to actively engage with and utilize linguistic input (Swain, 2005).

Moreover, the incorporation of authentic materials was shown to enhance learner motivation and involvement. Interaction with real-world language through videos, podcasts, and articles aided learners in cultivating not only their linguistic skills but also their cultural understanding. This observation is consistent with H. Douglas Brown's assertion that relevant and contextual input boosts both motivation and language acquisition (Brown, 2007).

Another important finding from the study is the favorable effect of self-directed learning on students' autonomy. Those participants who chose their own materials and managed their own learning speed exhibited greater responsibility and self-confidence. This observation aligns with Phil Benson's assertion that autonomy is vital for effective language learning and leads to more sustainable outcomes (Benson, 2011).

Additionally, the role of technology was crucial in advancing skill development. Digital tools and online resources offered learners flexible learning options and instant feedback. For example, using subtitles in videos enhanced listening skills, while language learning apps aided in vocabulary growth and pronunciation practice. As Mark Warschauer points out, technology-enriched language learning environments foster more interactive and learner-focused educational experiences (Warschauer, 2006).

Nevertheless, the study uncovered some challenges as well. Certain learners found it challenging to remain consistent and motivated without teacher supervision. Others struggled with selecting suitable materials that matched their proficiency levels. These challenges imply that, while self-directed learning proves effective, it still needs a degree of guidance and structure, particularly for novice learners.

In conclusion, the analysis reveals that the combination of communicative strategies, task-oriented activities, and learner independence establishes a robust framework for language skill development. The findings affirm that a well-rounded mix of methodologies, suitable materials, and technological support can greatly improve the effectiveness of foreign language education in contemporary learning environments.

Conclusion

This research has examined the improvement of foreign language abilities - listening, speaking, reading, and writing - through self-directed learning enhanced by contemporary teaching methods. The analysis demonstrates that a combined approach, which includes Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), and strategies focused on learners, establishes an effective basis for acquiring languages in today's educational settings.

The results show that students gain significantly when language skills are taught in an interconnected fashion, as opposed to being isolated. Utilizing authentic materials, including audio-visual aids, written documents, and digital resources, boosts both understanding and motivation. Specifically, exposure to real-world language situations enhances learners' capacity to comprehend and utilize the target language in relevant contexts.

Another key finding is that self-directed learning positively impacts learner autonomy and accountability. When learners are allowed to select their materials, establish their goals, and track their progress, they grow more independent and assured in their language-learning journey. However, the outcomes also indicate that novice learners might still need some guidance to ensure consistency and to effectively choose suitable resources.

Moreover, the incorporation of technology has been recognized as an essential element in contemporary language teaching. Digital tools, multimedia materials, and online platforms foster adaptable and interactive learning environments that bolster ongoing practice and the refinement of skills.

In summary, the study underscores that successful foreign language acquisition relies on a well-balanced mixture of teaching methods, materials, and learner independence. The synthesis of communicative, task-based, and self-directed strategies provides a thorough framework that can greatly facilitate the enhancement of all four language skills. Future studies might further explore the impact of artificial intelligence and adaptive learning technologies in promoting independent language learning experiences.

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EARLY FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING AND ITS CHARACTERISTICS

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Abstract: This study examines the role and nature of early language exposure within modern education systems. Introducing a foreign language at an early age has attracted considerable attention due to its profound influence on children's cognitive, linguistic and social enrichment. The results reveal that young learners attain language proficiency through authentic communicative and meaningful contexts and repetition rather than explicit grammar instruction. Early language exposure promotes the advancement of cognitive processes including memory, attention, problem-solving and metalinguistic awareness. It may contribute to phonological accuracy, fluency development, academic achievement, and intercultural awareness.

At the same time, the study highlights several difficulties in early foreign language education. This includes restricted teaching time, a shortage of qualified teachers, inconsistent learning results, an overemphasis on grammar-focused teaching and social and economic barriers that reduce access to learning. These factors show that early language programs demand careful planning and steady implementation to be successful. The findings suggest that early foreign language learning can be highly effective when encouraged by appropriate methods such as play-based activities, interactive learning, immersive environments, multisensory approaches. Overall, it should be implemented in a balanced and age-suitable way to fully support children's growth.

Key words: Early foreign language learning, young learners, cognitive development, bilingualism, benefits, challenges

ERKƏN YAŞLARDA XARİCİ DİL ÖYRƏNİLMƏSİ VƏ ONUN XÜSUSİYYƏTLƏRİ

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə erkən yaşlarda xarici dil öyrənilməsinin mahiyyətini və onun əsas xüsusiyyətlərini araşdırır. Tədqiqat göstərir ki, erkən yaşlarda dilə məruz qalma uşaqların həm dil bacarıqlarının inkişafına, həm də yaddaş, diqqət, problem həlli kimi kognitiv qabiliyyətlərinin güclənməsinə mühüm təsir göstərir. Məqalədə vurğulanır ki, uşaqlar dili əsasən təbii və şüuraltı şəkildə, ünsiyyət, təkrar və mənalı kontekstlər vasitəsilə mənimsəyirlər və bu proses onların yüksək neyroplastikliyi ilə sıx bağlıdır.

Bundan əlavə, məqalədə erkən dil öyrənilməsinin fonoloji həssaslıq, kommunikativ bacarıqlar, tələffüz və axıcılıq kimi üstünlükləri izah olunur. Eyni zamanda, təlim prosesində oyun əsaslı öyrənmə, qarşılıqlı ünsiyyət, emosional mühit və vizual dəstəyin rolu xüsusi qeyd edilir. Məqalə həmçinin erkən dil tədrisinin qarşılaşdığı problemləri, o cümlədən kifayət qədər tədris vaxtının olmaması, ixtisaslı müəllim çatışmazlığı və qeyri-effektiv metodların tətbiqini də təhlil edir.

Nəticə olaraq qeyd olunur ki, erkən yaşlarda xarici dil öyrənilməsi düzgün pedaqoji yanaşmalar, davamlı təcrübə və dəstəkləyici mühit ilə həyata keçirildikdə uşaqların ümumi inkişafına və gələcək akademik uğurlarına güclü zəmin yaradır.

Açar sözlər: erkən dil öyrənilməsi, xarici dil, kognitiv inkişaf, neyroplastiklik, ünsiyyət bacarıqları, oyun əsaslı təlim, çoxdillilik, pedaqoji yanaşmalar

Introduction

In today's globalized world with expanding international interaction multilingual competence has become an essential component in contemporary education systems. Due to its capacity to support cognitive growth, academic performance and foster intercultural understanding, early foreign language has attracted significant attention among researchers and educators. A growing number of educational frameworks implement foreign language instruction at the preschool or primary level, recognizing early childhood as a critical phase for acquiring language learning. (European School Education Platform, 2024).

The concept of early language learning refers to the process by which children are exposed to and acquire a non-native language in the formative stages of their development. This period is particularly critical due to the fundamentally distinct language acquisition process in children compared to adolescents and adults. Instead of relying on explicit grammatical instruction and rote memorization, they tend to acquire linguistics competence naturally through consistent exposure, communicative interaction and repeated engagement in meaningful contexts (Lightbown & Spada, 2013). This capacity is closely linked to brain plasticity, which facilitates the efficient establishment and restructuring of neural connections in early developmental stages (Gimatdinova, 2018).

Drawing upon findings from linguistics and cognitive science, early foreign language exposure contributes not only to linguistic growth but also to the development of cognitive abilities, including memory, attention control, and problem-solving (Bialystok, 2001). Moreover, early language acquisition promotes intercultural awareness and reinforces communication skills required in a globalized society. (Krashen, 1982). In this context, the article investigates the nature of early foreign language learning by outlining its cognitive academic advantages, limitations, and effective pedagogical approaches with the aim of demonstrating its contribution to children's overall development and future educational outcomes.

The Concept of Early Foreign Language Learning

Early foreign language learning generally refers to the process of introducing and learning an additional language during early stages of childhood. This stage of language development is significantly different from language acquisition in later years, as it is shaped by their social and cognitive growth. Unlike adults, who rely on teaching methods and analysis of grammar, children

learn languages intuitively. They acquire linguistic patterns as a result of exposure, repetition, imitation rather than depending on instructional techniques. (European School Education Platform, 2024).

Early childhood language acquisition is driven by implicit process which enables children to internalize complex linguistic frameworks through naturalistic exposure. This is illustrated by children's ability for grammatically accurate speech without conscious knowledge of formal rules, a competency cultivated via regular exposure to real-world communication. According to Gimatdinova (2018), this critical period is rooted in the brain's fundamental capability for neural modification to environmental factors, a phenomenon known as neuroplasticity. This innate biological receptivity grants young learners a phonetic advantage that declines as neural plasticity diminishes over time.

Foreign language instruction at an early age is typically embedded in a context that fosters meaningful interaction rather than presented as abstract or isolated content. Consequently, language learning occurs in authentic contexts including everyday classroom routines, interactive play activities, narrative practices and social interactions. These experiences deliver abundant and comprehensible input developing real-life language and apply it in purposeful ways.

This approach corresponds closely with the core the core of **communicative language teaching (CLT)** which prioritize authentic communication and functional language use. (Lightbown & Spada, 2013). In such communicative environments, instead of memorizing grammatical structures, learners focus on conveying meaning and interpreting messages. As this method reflects young learners' natural learning style and cultivates both the linguistic competence and social growth, it is particularly suitable for young learners.

In early language context, instruction is often facilitated through multisensory and experience-based methods. Young learners engage with language using a combination of visual, auditory and kinesthetic channels, including game-based activities, gestures and songs. These techniques not only foster more engaging learning environment, but also support deeper understanding and memory retention by activating diverse cognitive functions.

Moreover, social interaction is another key component of language development. Sociocultural theories highlight that language acquisition emerges via interaction in cooperative and supportive contexts. Communication with teachers, peers and family members provides young learners with opportunities for constructive feedback, practice and steady development. Children gain linguistic knowledge while developing awareness of the social and cultural norms associated with communication through this process.

In addition, the acquisition of a foreign language at a young age fosters favorable attitudes towards multilingualism and cultural differences. In a supportive and enjoyable context, children are more likely to be open-minded, curious and motivated. Such positive orientation is pivotal for sustaining long-term motivation for language learning and intercultural awareness.

Overall, the process of young learners' second language development represents a multifaceted and progressive process which closely linked to their innate learning abilities. It involves implicit acquisition process, enhance neural adaptability, purposeful communication and active interpersonal engagement. Such distinctive features set it apart from language learning at later stages and emphasize the significance of developmentally suitable, communicative and engaging teaching approaches. When effectively designed, early-age language learning offers a solid basis for continued linguistic, cognitive and social growth.

Characteristics of Early Foreign Language Learning

Implicit Learning Mechanisms. One of the most defining aspects of early second language learning is its dependence on **implicit learning mechanisms**. Whereas adults frequently rely on explicit grammar explanations and intentional memorization, children learn language in an unconscious and natural environment. They produce linguistic structures through continual exposure to input embedded in meaningful contexts rather than through formal analysis of grammar rules. (Lightbown & Spada, 2013)

This form of acquisition closely resembles first language development. Rather than receiving direct grammatical structures, children gradually develop an intuitive grasp of vocabulary and syntax through social interaction and listening. For example, a child can use a sophisticated grammatical form without being able to articulate the grammatical structures involved, which illustrates the unconscious implicit acquisition.

Furthermore, implicit learning contributes to reduce both anxiety and cognitive load, while creating a more engaging and effective language learning environment. As proposed in Krashen's Input Hypothesis, language is acquired when learners receive understandable input in low-stress environments. (Krashen, 1982) As a result, early exposure through natural interaction is more beneficial than formal grammar instruction.

Phonological Sensitivity. Phonological sensitivity is commonly recognized as a notable characteristic of young learners, referring their ability to perceive and reproduce the sounds from diverse linguistic systems. Studies have shown that even infants can discriminate between phonetic contrasts across different languages, including such sounds are absent in their native language (Kuhl, 2010). Nevertheless, without repeated exposure, this ability gradually declines over time.

The acquisition of a foreign language at a young age benefits effective use of this developmental advantage. As children are more likely to develop accurate pronunciation and appropriate intonation patterns, early starters retain an identifiable foreign accent.

From a neurological perspective, language input experienced in early childhood strengthens neural systems responsible for auditory perception and speech production. This enhanced neural flexibility enables young learners to adapt easily to unfamiliar phonological structures, especially those do not exist in their first language.

In educational settings, techniques including rhythmic chants, songs and repetitive language exercises play a significant role in reinforcing phonological awareness through enjoyable and meaningful practice.

Holistic Learning Approach. A further defining characteristic of early developmental exposure to language is the **holistic approach**. Children are more likely to prioritize overall meaning rather than focusing on grammatical structures or individual words. They acquire language in chunks such as, phrases and common expressions instead of memorizing isolated vocabulary items (Cameron, 2001).

For instance, expressions like "How are you?" or "I don't know" can be learned without analyzing their internal structure. With repeated exposure, these chunks are integrated into the child's developing language system, enabling more effective language use.

This holistic mode enables the language functions in real-time communication and develops fluency by allowing students to express meaning efficiently without analyzing grammatical form.

In addition, this process is closely related to contextual support. Primary-level learners make extensive use of visual input, gestures and situational clues to interpret meaning. Consequently, incorporating pictures, real objects and demonstrations is particularly impactful in early language teaching contexts.

Learning Through Interaction and Play. Play and social have a major impact on early foreign language education. Young learners tend to acquire the language more effectively when they can actively engage in meaningful tasks instead of passively absorb information. In this context, play-based learning offers a supportive and enjoyable environment in which language use becomes purposeful (Pinter, 2017).

A variety of classroom activities, including interactive games, songs, storytelling, and role-play promote authentic communication. For instance, a well-known activity “Simon says” enables learners to practice vocabulary and follow instructions in a dynamic and motivating way.

The importance of interaction in language acquisition also cannot be overstated. According to Vygotsky’s (1978) sociocultural theory, language occurs through communication with others. During interaction with peers and teachers, children are exposed to constructive feedback and progressively build their language competence.

Additionally, play-based learning fosters not only linguistic development but also their creativity, cooperation and confidence.

Emotional Engagement. Emotional factors are central to shaping early language learning experiences. Children learn more effectively when they feel secure, motivated and valued. Positive emotions, such as confidence, interest, enjoyment facilitate learning process, whereas negative emotions, including anxiety, stress and fear, may act like barriers (Krashen, 1982).

Krashen’s concept of the affective filter emphasizes that emotional states can either enhance or obstruct language acquisition. A low affective filter, typically linked to motivated and relaxed teachers, results in better comprehension and absorption of input. However, a high effective filter caused by stress or anxiety may hinder language education.

The role of the teacher is essential in shaping a positive and supportive emotional environment. For example, recognizing even minor successes can significantly increase learners’ motivation and allow them to explore and use the language.

Furthermore, emotional involvement is closely related to learners’ interest. Meaningful and enjoyable activities are inclined to grasp their attention more effectively and lead to sustain learning over time.

Dependence on Context and Visual Support. One notable feature of young learners is their limited attention span. Whereas adult learners rely on cognitive maturity to interpret abstract explanations or direct translation, they derive meaning through non-verbal clues including, gestures, facial expressions, images and everyday experiences (Cameron, 2001).

As an example, educators introducing new vocabulary related to animals may incorporate visual aids such as pictures, toys and physical actions to convey meaning. This technique enables linguistic input more tangible and accessible for children to understand.

Moreover, contextualized learning mirrors authentic language use, where learners frequently interpret meaning based on situational clues rather than formal explanation. Therefore, it facilitates the authenticity of the learning process.

Cognitive Benefits of Early Language Learning

The acquisition of a foreign language at an early age is mainly associated with a broad range of cognitive advantages which are not limited to language exposure alone. These benefits are most essential in the early years of life, a period characterized by a high degree of plasticity and sensitivity to new input and experiences. According to the research in both psychology and neuroscience, bilingualism contributes positively to several aspects of cognitive growth, including memory process, problem-solving skills and metalinguistic awareness.

Executive Function and Cognitive Control. The improvement of executive functioning introduces one of the most extensively examined cognitive outcomes of early bilingualism, which includes attention management, cognitive adaptability and inhibition. Managing two linguistic systems, bilingual children engage in selecting the suitable language while suppressing the other. This ongoing process reinforces their ability to manage attention and shift between tasks effectively (Bialystok, 2001).

Research findings have demonstrated that children who are bilingual tend to excel over monolingual individuals in tasks involving cognitive flexibility and selective attention.

Brain Development and Neuroplasticity. The acquisition of multiple languages in early childhood is also essential in enhancing the structural and functional development of the brain. Findings from neuroimaging studies indicate that bilingual individuals exhibit greater **gray matter density** in fields linked to language use and executive control (Mechelli, 2004). A close link exists between these modifications and neuroplasticity, defined as the brain's inherent ability for self-reorganization in response to environmental input. Since neuroplasticity is heightened during early childhood, this period is conducive to language acquisition. Regular management of multiple linguist systems strengthens neural pathways fostering more efficient cognitive functioning. Additionally, these neurological advantages may create long-term implications, since researches indicate that bilingualism can contribute to postpone cognitive delay in later adulthood.

Memory Enhancement. Among cognitive abilities associated with bilingualism, working memory are particularly crucial. Engaging with more than one language requires that young learners regularly manage and process information thereby gradually reinforcing memory capacity (Esanova et al., 2024). As a result, bilingual children often outperform their monolingual peers in tasks that require recalling sequences, recognizing patterns, maintaining complex instructions. This strengthened memory capacity promotes learning in other academic areas, such as mathematics and science, which heavily depend on retaining and processing information.

Problem-Solving and Critical Thinking. Early language speakers also exhibit more robust problem-solving and critical thinking skills. Engagement with multiple linguistic systems stimulates younger learners to interpret situations from various angles, encouraging cognitive adaptability and innovation. The capacity for adaptive thinking is highly valuable in demanding educational settings and positively influences overall academic achievement.

Metalinguistic awareness. One of the principal cognitive advantages of early language exposure is the growth of metalinguistic awareness, which denotes the ability to analyze and examine language as a systematic structure (Maluch & Kempert 2019).

For example, they are more inclined to perceive that the words are symbolic and that one concept can be expressed differently in various languages. This enhances their aptitude for acquiring additional languages and develops their literacy skills, with a focus on reading and writing.

Linguistic and Academic Benefits

Beyond cognitive benefits, early second language acquisition promotes notable linguistic and academic advantages which are instrumental in advancing learners' language competence and their overall success.

Pronunciation and Fluency. A prominent advantage of the language learning at an early age is the capacity to enhance **fluent speech and native-like pronunciation**. Research shows that young learners exhibit heightened sensitivity to phonological patterns, which cultivates accurate sound perception and production (Birdsong, 2006). This phenomenon is represented by the Critical

Period Hypothesis, which asserts that ability to achieve native-like pronunciation constrains over time (Lenneberg, 1967).

As a result, children are more adept to internalize the prosodic elements of language, such as rhythm, stress and intonation naturally.

Early language exposure also plays a crucial role in fluency enhancement. As young learners acquire language implicitly engaging with it in authentic communicative contexts, they develop automaticity in language production. This process allows the learners to produce speech smoothly and diminishes the deliberate attention to grammatical structures. Evidence from immersion education demonstrates that children frequently maintain strong oral fluency even though they are developing their grammatical systems. Such fluency at an early period serves as an important foundation for long-term language mastery.

Vocabulary Development. Vocabulary acquisition in bilingual children is characterized by a distinctive pattern in compared to that of monolingual peers. Studies have indicated that bilingual individuals may appear to have basic vocabulary within each individual vocabulary. However, taking into consideration conceptual knowledge from both languages, bilingual speakers typically exhibit a vocabulary which exceeds that of monolinguals (Bialystok, 2001).

As bilingual exposure becomes more sustained and balanced, young learners typically expand their vocabularies in each language.

Furthermore, the process of learning vocabulary across two languages strengthens cognitive associations, supporting the more effective learning unfamiliar words and concepts. Vocabulary growth is influenced by exposure that is both contextual and meaningful. Pedagogical techniques like game-based learning, communicative participation and storytelling assist children to connect new vocabulary with real-life contexts, thereby enhancing comprehension and sustained memory.

Academic Achievement. Early foreign language instruction has been indicated to foster students' overall academic performance. Evidence demonstrates that learners who are exposed to the second language at an early age outperform their peers in core subjects, including reading, writing and mathematics (Cameron, 2001). This advantage is largely attributed to the reinforcing of underlying cognitive abilities such as memory capacity, attention control and problem-solving abilities, which are significant for academic achievement. Additionally, bilingual speakers build metalinguistic awareness that supports literacy enhancement in reading comprehension and textual organization. Findings also reveal that children engaged in bilingual programs often perform better than the monolinguals on standardized examinations, even when instruction is delivered in a second language (Lightbown & Spada, 2013).

Factors Influencing Early Language Learning

The success of early foreign language acquisition is characterized by several interrelated factors. One of the most notable is the age of exposure, as earlier engagement with second language promotes more intuitive learning process (Lenneberg, 1967). Second, a supportive learning environment nurtures early language acquisition, providing young learners with both meaningful interaction and linguistic input (Lightbown & Spada, 2013).

Teacher competence is vital for delivering effective instructional strategies (Pinter, 2017), and family support boosts learner motivation and expands their opportunities for practice (Cameron, 2001). Moreover, maintaining consistent exposure plays a key role in linguistic retention and growth (Jaekel et al. 2022).

Challenges of Early Foreign Language Learning. While early foreign language education presents considerable benefits, it also faces notable challenges. Its effectiveness is contingent upon

the factors such as coherent educational policies, teacher qualifications and instructional conditions. Without these elements like careful implementation, early language programs may lack depth and fall short of achieving enduring language skills.

Insufficient Exposure and Instruction Time

One of the main obstacles is the restricted time for foreign language instruction in numerous educational systems. In many primary schools, foreign language education is typically allocated only a few weekly hours per week, which is inadequate for effective language development.

According to research, achieving language proficiency is developed through frequent and sustained exposure. (Jaekel et al.2022) With insufficient exposure, young learners may obtain simple lexical knowledge yet have difficulty to build communicative competence. Learners attending only one or two lessons per week may struggle to practice listening and speaking in authentic contexts. Furthermore, discontinuity between primary and secondary education may further undermine early learning outcomes. When students do not pursue linguistic education at advanced levels, the advantages gained in early childhood may decline over time.

Lack of Qualified and Trained Teachers. Another primary obstacle is *the insufficient supply of trained teachers for young learner instruction*. Compared to educating adolescents or adults, teaching children demands distinct skills, such as age-appropriate teaching methods, the ability to create engaging and interactive learning experiences. In numerous educational contexts, foreign language teachers are not specifically trained in educating young children. Consequently, they may often depend on traditional, teacher-centered methods that do not effectively cater young learners' needs (Pinter, 2007). An excessive focus on grammar rules or written tasks negatively affects their engagement and impede natural language learning. Flexibility, creativity, incorporation of play-based and interactive activities are the key components to effective instruction at this stage.

Inconsistent Learning Outcomes. Despite beginning at an early age, studies demonstrate that early exposure alone does not result in long-term success. The outcomes of early language acquisition are formed by the instructional quality, the level of exposure and consistent learning over time (Jaekel et al., 2022).

Some research findings reveal that the late starters provided with more intensive and well-designed instruction may reach or exceed the performance of early learners. Variation in outcomes may be also caused by differences in educational contexts, teaching practices, and individual learner factors. Therefore, it is essential for policymakers and educators to prioritize not only the starting point of language learning, but also the way it is implemented.

Overemphasis on Formal and Grammar-Based Instruction. A prevalent issue in early-stage language education is the overuse of formal, grammar-based teaching methods. Despite the significance of grammar in language development, the introduction of it too early or in an explicit manner can be demotivating and ineffective for young children. Children learn best through communication-based approaches rather than abstract explanations. If teaching emphasizes memorization or written exercises, young learners may become less engaged and may not enhance practical linguistic abilities.

As an example, requiring young children to engage in grammar drills or memorize verb forms may not promote the advancement of real-life communication skills. On the contrary, it may increase anxiety and diminish confidence emphasizing the necessity of more interactive and learner-centered approaches.

Socioeconomic and Environmental Factors. Socioeconomic status strongly affects early language learning, as learners from higher-income families more likely to have increased access to private language education, learning materials and media in foreign languages (UNESCO, 2022).

Conversely, students from disadvantaged backgrounds may not have adequate opportunities for additional practice and support beyond classroom, leading to disparities in language proficiency and academic success. In addition, family surroundings also have a strong impact on motivation and perspectives on language acquisition, those who are encouraged by their parents often achieve better outcomes.

Effective Strategies for Teaching Young Learners

Overcoming challenges of early foreign language learning, instructors should implement research-based approaches that align with children's developmental stages. These strategies have been widely accepted as effective in fostering language acquisition in young learners.

Play-Based Learning. One of the most successful methods to educate young learners is play-based learning, which creates an authentic and low-pressure environment for language use. (Pinter, 2017).

Through interactive activities like games, songs and role play children develop vocabulary and structures in context. For instance, picture-word matching assists boost vocabulary, whereas role-playing contribute to speaking skill advancement.

Play-based learning also enhances motivation and involvement, both of which are crucial for sustained success. Learners who enjoy learning are more inclined to participate actively and remember the material.

Creating an Immersive Language Environment. Learners benefit from constant exposure to the target language in **an immersive environment**, which can be created through using the foreign language as the primary language of instruction in the classroom (Lightbown & Spada, 2013).

Teachers can integrate basic instruction, common phrases and daily routines into the target language.

Through immersion, young learners acquire listening and speaking abilities naturally and minimize their reliance on translation, reinforcing direct thinking in the foreign language.

Multisensory Teaching Approaches. Multisensory learning, which incorporates visual, auditory and kinesthetic components is highly beneficial for young learners. This strategy caters to diverse learning preferences and strengthens memory recall (Cameron, 2001). For instance, new vocabulary can be introduced by visual aids, gestures, songs and kinesthetic activities. A lesson about animals could involve images, sounds and movements, encouraging students to activate different senses. Multisensory learning promotes lesson engagement and supports deeper links between words and their meanings.

Repetition and Routine. Especially, in early childhood, repetition is vital for language acquisition, as consistent exposure to the same vocabulary and sentence patterns cultivates comprehension and boosts confidence. Nevertheless, repetition should remain meaningful and diverse in order to prevent monotony. As an example, vocabulary can be reinforced through various methods including, song, storytelling and games. Incorporating routines such as regular questions and greeting songs also fosters structured and predictable environment, helping young children feel secure and while promoting steady language growth.

Positive Reinforcement and Motivation. In language learning, motivation is a key factor, particularly for young learners, as positive reinforcement like praise and encouragement builds confidence and stimulates active engagement (Krashen, 1982).

Rather than prioritizing accuracy, teachers should emphasize learners' effort and gradual progress. Recognizing a child's attempt to speak can boost their confidence and encourage interaction. A safe and supportive classroom environment that lowers anxiety and minimizes the affective filter leads to better language learning.

Integration of Technology. Advances in technology contribute positively to early language acquisition. Digital applications, videos and interactive games expand opportunities for both exposure and practice. To give an example, integrating digital storytelling and language-learning apps advance both engagement and accessibility, allowing learners to listen to authentic pronunciation and interact with various multimedia resources. Although technology should serve as a supportive tool rather than a substitute of human interaction, which is fundamental component of linguistic development.

Methodology and materials

This study adopts a qualitative, literature-based method to explore early foreign language learning from cognitive, pedagogical and developmental perspectives. Instead of collecting primary data, it systematically reviews and synthesized existing research from applied linguistics, cognitive psychology and early childhood education. The analysis integrates peer-reviewed articles, academic books, and international policy documents, combining established theories with contemporary studies on bilingualism, neuroplasticity and language education policy. A thematic approach was applied to categorize the literature into major themes, including developmental characteristics, benefits, influencing factors, challenges and instructional practices.

The materials consist of secondary sources obtained from academic databases such as Google Scholar, research Gate Scholar, Research Gate and institutional repositories. These include theoretical frameworks (e.g., Krashen, Vygotsky), empirical studies on cognitive and linguistic development (e.g., Mechelli et al., 2004; Kuhl, 2010), recent findings on educational outcomes (eg., Jaekel et al., 2022; Esanova et al., 2024), and reports from organizations such as UNESCO (2022). Source criteria was guided by relevance, scholarly quality, and currency, ensuring a comprehensive and well-supported synthesis of early foreign language education research.

Discussion

The reviewed literature suggests that early language learning is the most successful when it aligns with natural ways young learners acquire the knowledge, especially via implicit learning, high neuroplasticity, and meaning focused communication. Research indicates that children advance linguistic abilities primarily through exposure, interaction, and contextualized experiences rather than formal grammar instruction, which reinforces the use of interactive, play-oriented, and multisensory teaching approaches. Early language learning is also associated to cognitive advantages, including enhanced executive functioning working memory, and phonological awareness, although these benefits largely rely on sustained and high-quality instruction.

At the same time, several constraints limit the effectiveness of early language programs. These include inadequate teaching time, a lack of trained teachers, and unequal opportunities for language exposure beyond the classroom. Emotional and motivational conditions are also significant, as supportive and low-stress environments promote better engagement and learning outcomes. Overall, the evidence shows that early foreign language learning is the most effective when it is consistent, pedagogically appropriate, and well-resourced, with long-term success relying on more instructional more on instructional quality than on the age at which learning begins.

Conclusion

The comprehensive analysis of existing studies found that early foreign language acquisition represents a crucial and multidimensional component of modern education, offering benefits that extend beyond the learning of language skills. As indicated throughout this article, early exposure to a second language promotes not only the advancement of communication skills, but also enriches cognitive functions such as memory, attention control and problem-solving, while strengthening intercultural awareness and positive attitudes toward diversity. These outcomes are closely related to the unique features of early childhood, like heightened neuroplasticity, implicit learning process and sensitivity to sounds.

However, the success of early language does not solely rely on the starting age. Rather, it is influenced by the quality, consistency and relevance of instruction. Factors such as, limited classroom time, insufficiently trained instructors, and overreliance on grammar-based approaches may impede the potential advancement of early language learning. Therefore, efficient implementation demands developmentally appropriate pedagogical approaches, such as play-oriented learning, interactive and multisensory methods encouraged by purposeful interaction and sustained input.

Moreover, the incorporation of helpful components such as skilled educators, positive learning environments, and parental involvement are key factors to enhancing learning outcomes.

Although technological tools can enrich the learning experience and offer valuable exposure, they should accompany rather than replace human interaction, which remains central to linguistic development.

Ultimately, if implemented effectively, early language exposure presents a strong foundation for lifelong learning, academic success, global citizenship. Consequently, it is essential for policymakers to prioritize both the quality and accessibility of early language programs to guarantee the learners fully benefit from these opportunities.

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THE ROLE OF ACTIVE PRACTICE IN STRENGTHENING FOREIGN LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY

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Abstract: Active practice constitutes a fundamental component in the development of foreign language proficiency, particularly in relation to the effective acquisition of the four core language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. This article aims to investigate the impact of consistent and purposeful engagement in active learning processes on language acquisition outcomes. Unlike traditional passive learning approaches, which primarily focus on memorization and theoretical knowledge, active practice emphasizes learner participation, interaction, and real-life communication. The research explores a range of active learning strategies, including task-based learning, collaborative peer interaction, and technology-enhanced language practice. These approaches are analyzed in terms of their ability to promote both receptive and productive language skills. The findings suggest that learners who are regularly involved in active practice demonstrate significantly higher levels of fluency, grammatical accuracy, communicative competence, and self-confidence. Furthermore, active engagement facilitates deeper cognitive processing, leading to improved retention and more effective application of linguistic knowledge in authentic contexts.

In addition, the article highlights the role of digital tools and interactive platforms in creating dynamic learning environments that support continuous practice and immediate feedback. Such tools not only increase learner motivation but also provide opportunities for personalized and autonomous learning. The results underscore the importance of integrating active practice into modern language teaching methodologies to achieve sustainable language development.

Overall, this article confirms that active practice is not merely a supplementary element but a central mechanism in strengthening foreign language proficiency. It is recommended that educators adopt learner-centered approaches that prioritize interaction, communication, and practical application to maximize language learning outcomes.

Key words: active learning foreign language, communicative competence, task-based learning, language proficiency, technology-enhanced learning, fluency development, interactive learning activities

XARICI DİL BİLİKLƏRİNİN MÖHKƏMLƏNDİRİLMƏSİNDƏ FƏAL TƏCRÜBƏNİN ROLU

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Xülasə: Aktiv praktika xarici dil biliklərinin inkişafında, xüsusilə də dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı kimi dörd əsas dil bacarığının mənimsənilməsində əsas rol oynayır. Bu məqalə aktiv öyrənmə proseslərində davamlı və məqsədyönlü iştirakın dil öyrənmə nəticələrinə təsirini araşdırmağı hədəfləyir. Ənənəvi passiv öyrənmə üsullarından fərqli olaraq, aktiv praktika yadda saxlama və nəzəri biliklərlə məhdudlaşmır, əksinə, öyrənmənin iştirakı, qarşılıqlı əlaqə və real həyat ünsiyyətini ön plana çıxarır.

Tədqiqat çərçivəsində tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə, qrup və cüt işləri vasitəsilə qarşılıqlı fəaliyyət, həmçinin texnologiya dəstəklili dil təcrübəsi kimi müxtəlif aktiv öyrənmə strategiyaları təhlil edilmişdir. Bu yanaşmaların həm reseptiv (dinləmə və oxu), həm də produktiv (danışma və yazı) bacarıqların inkişafına təsiri araşdırılmışdır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, aktiv praktikada müntəzəm iştirak edən öyrənənlər daha yüksək səviyyədə səlislik, qrammatik dəqiqlik, kommunikativ bacarıq və özünə inam nümayiş etdirirlər. Bundan əlavə, aktiv iştirak daha dərin idrak proseslərini stimullaşdırır və bu da biliklərin daha yaxşı mənimsənilməsinə və real şəraitdə tətbiqinə şərait yaradır.

Həmçinin, məqalə rəqəmsal alətlərin və interaktiv platformaların dinamik öyrənmə mühitinin formalaşmasında rolunu vurğulayır. Bu vasitələr öyrənənlərin motivasiyasını artırmaqla yanaşı, fərdiləşdirilmiş və müstəqil öyrənmə imkanları yaradır. Ümumilikdə, nəticələr göstərir ki, aktiv praktika xarici dil bacarıqlarının inkişafında yalnız əlavə deyil, əsas mexanizmdir. Müəllimlərə tövsiyə olunur ki, ünsiyyətə, qarşılıqlı fəaliyyətə və praktiki tətbiqə əsaslanan öyrənən mərkəzli yanaşmalardan istifadə etsinlər.

Açar sözlər: aktiv öyrənmə, xarici dil öyrənmə, kommunikativ səriştə, tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə, dil bacarığı, texnologiya ilə dəstəklənən öyrənmə, səlis danışq inkişafı, interaktiv öyrənmə fəaliyyətləri.

Introduction

The acquisition of a foreign language is a complex and multifaceted process that extends far beyond the mere accumulation of theoretical knowledge. While traditional instructional approaches have often prioritized the teaching of grammatical structures, vocabulary lists, and rote memorization, contemporary research increasingly underscores the necessity of meaningful and sustained practice for effective language development. In this context, the concept of active practice has emerged as a central element in modern language pedagogy, emphasizing learner engagement, interaction, and the practical use of language in authentic or near-authentic situations.

Traditional language teaching methodologies, particularly those rooted in teacher-centered instruction, tend to limit opportunities for learners to actively use the target language. As a result, learners may develop a solid understanding of grammatical rules yet struggle to communicate effectively in real-life contexts. This discrepancy between knowledge and use highlights the limitations of passive learning and points to the need for more dynamic, learner-centered approaches. Active practice addresses this gap by encouraging learners to participate in communicative activities, problem-solving tasks, and collaborative interactions that require real-time language use and decision-making.

Foreign language proficiency is generally conceptualized through four core skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. These skills are not isolated competencies; rather, they are deeply interconnected and mutually reinforcing. Effective communication depends on the integrated development of these skills, as learners must be able to comprehend input (listening and reading) and produce meaningful output (speaking and writing) in a coherent and contextually appropriate manner (Brown, 2007). Active practice facilitates this integration by providing opportunities for

learners to simultaneously engage multiple skills within communicative contexts, thereby promoting both fluency and accuracy.

In recent decades, learner-centered approaches such as communicative language teaching (CLT) and task-based language teaching (TBLT) have gained prominence in both theoretical and practical domains of language education. These approaches prioritize meaningful interaction, authentic language use, and the functional aspects of communication over the isolated study of linguistic forms. Research indicates that such methodologies significantly enhance learners' communicative competence, motivation, and overall language performance (Richards, 2006). Moreover, advances in educational technology have further expanded the possibilities for active practice by enabling access to interactive platforms, digital resources, and real-time communication tools that support continuous and personalized learning experiences.

The importance of active practice is also supported by cognitive and sociocultural theories of language acquisition, which emphasize the role of interaction, feedback, and contextualized use in the learning process. Through active engagement, learners are able to construct knowledge, test hypotheses, and refine their linguistic abilities based on immediate feedback and social interaction. This process not only strengthens linguistic competence but also fosters learner autonomy and confidence.

In light of these considerations, this article aims to explore the role of active practice in strengthening foreign language proficiency. It seeks to analyze how various forms of active engagement contribute to the development of the four language skills and to evaluate their effectiveness within the framework of modern language education. By examining both theoretical perspectives and practical applications, the study highlights the necessity of integrating active practice into language teaching methodologies in order to achieve more effective and sustainable learning outcomes.

Materials and Methods

This study employs a qualitative, descriptive, and comparative research design in order to examine the role of active practice in strengthening foreign language proficiency. The research is grounded in an extensive review and critical analysis of existing scholarly literature in the field of second and foreign language acquisition. A range of academic sources, including peer-reviewed journal articles, authoritative books, and educational research reports, were systematically analyzed to identify key theoretical perspectives and practical strategies related to active learning and language development.

The selection of sources was based on their relevance, credibility, and contribution to the topic. Particular attention was given to studies that focus on learner-centered approaches, communicative competence, and the integration of the four core language skills. The literature review process involved identifying recurring themes, comparing different methodological approaches, and synthesizing findings related to the effectiveness of active practice in language learning contexts.

Within this framework, several prominent active learning methods were examined in detail. These include: (1) Task-Based Learning (TBL), which emphasizes the completion of meaningful tasks using the target language in realistic contexts; (2) interactive activities, such as group discussions, role-plays, and collaborative problem-solving tasks that promote learner engagement and communication; (3) technology-assisted learning, involving the use of digital platforms, language learning applications, and online communication tools to facilitate continuous and flexible practice; and (4) self-directed practice, which encourages learners to take responsibility for their

own learning through independent activities such as reading, writing, listening, and reflective exercises.

Data collection in this study is based on the comparative analysis of findings reported in the selected literature. Specifically, outcomes associated with traditional, passive learning methods—characterized by teacher-centered instruction and limited learner interaction—were compared with those of active learning approaches. The evaluation criteria focused on key indicators of language proficiency, including fluency, grammatical accuracy, communicative effectiveness, and learner confidence.

Furthermore, the analysis considered the contextual factors influencing the effectiveness of each method, such as learning environment, level of learner autonomy, and access to technological resources. By synthesizing and comparing these findings, the study aims to provide a comprehensive understanding of how active practice contributes to the development of foreign language proficiency and to identify the most effective strategies for implementation in contemporary language education settings.

Results and Discussion

The analysis of the reviewed literature indicates that active practice plays a crucial role in the development of foreign language proficiency. In comparison with traditional, passive learning approaches, methods that emphasize learner engagement through interaction, communication, and meaningful use of language consistently demonstrate more positive learning outcomes. In particular, learners who participate in interactive and communicative classroom activities tend to develop greater speaking fluency, improved listening comprehension, and increased confidence in real-life communication contexts (Nation, 2013).

Among the different active learning approaches examined, task-based learning (TBL) emerges as one of the most effective instructional frameworks. Task-based instruction focuses on the completion of meaningful tasks that require learners to use the target language as a tool for communication rather than as an object of study. According to Ellis (2003), such an approach promotes communicative competence by encouraging learners to negotiate meaning, interact spontaneously, and apply linguistic knowledge in practical situations. As a result, learners not only acquire grammatical structures but also develop the ability to use language appropriately in varied social and functional contexts.

In addition to task-based methodologies, the integration of technology-assisted learning has been identified as a significant factor in enhancing language acquisition. Digital tools such as language learning applications, multimedia resources, online communication platforms, and interactive software contribute to increased learner motivation and engagement. Chapelle (2001) emphasizes that computer-assisted language learning environments provide learners with opportunities for individualized practice, immediate feedback, and exposure to authentic language input. These factors collectively support sustained learning and facilitate the development of both receptive (listening and reading) and productive (speaking and writing) skills. (Richards, J. C. 2006)

Furthermore, the findings suggest that active practice fosters balanced improvement across all language skill areas. While receptive skills benefit from increased exposure to authentic materials, productive skills are strengthened through consistent output practice and interaction. This integrated development is essential for achieving overall communicative competence in a foreign language.

However, despite its effectiveness, the success of active practice is highly dependent on several pedagogical factors. Proper instructional design, teacher guidance, and classroom management play a decisive role in ensuring that active learning activities achieve their intended

outcomes. Without structured implementation, tasks may become unfocused, and learners may fail to engage meaningfully with the language content. Therefore, teacher competence and methodological planning are critical in maximizing the benefits of active learning approaches.

Overall, the findings confirm that active practice, when effectively implemented through task-based learning and supported by technological tools, significantly contributes to foreign language acquisition. It enhances learner engagement, promotes communicative ability, and ensures more sustainable and practical language development outcomes.

Conclusion

Active practice is a fundamental component in the development of foreign language proficiency, as it provides learners with continuous opportunities to use the target language in meaningful and communicative contexts. The findings of this study indicate that active engagement in language learning significantly contributes to the improvement of fluency, grammatical accuracy, and learner confidence. Unlike passive learning approaches, active practice enables learners to internalize linguistic structures more effectively and apply them spontaneously in real-life communication situations.

The article also highlights the pedagogical importance of learner-centered instructional approaches. In particular, task-based learning and technology-enhanced instruction emerge as highly effective strategies for promoting active participation in the language learning process. These approaches not only increase learner motivation but also create interactive environments where students can develop both receptive and productive language skills in an integrated manner. Therefore, educators are encouraged to prioritize such strategies in order to create more effective and engaging language learning experiences.

Despite the positive outcomes identified, the study also suggests the need for further investigation into the long-term effects of active practice on language retention and proficiency development. Future research should focus on longitudinal studies that examine sustained language improvement over time, as well as explore innovative teaching methodologies that combine emerging technologies with pedagogical best practices. Such research would contribute to a deeper understanding of how active learning can be optimized in diverse educational contexts.

In conclusion, active practice represents a critical element in foreign language education, and its effective implementation can significantly enhance overall language learning outcomes.

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PROBLEMS OF TEACHING ENGLISH IN AZERBAIJAN: AN EMPIRICAL STUDY

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Abstract: This study investigates the major challenges in teaching English in Azerbaijan and provides evidence-based recommendations for improving instructional effectiveness. Although English is widely taught as a compulsory subject across secondary and higher education institutions, many learners fail to achieve communicative competence even after years of instruction. The primary aim of this research is to identify the key factors affecting English language learning and to evaluate current teaching practices in Azerbaijani classrooms. A quantitative research design was adopted, and data were collected through a structured questionnaire administered to 85 students and 20 English language teachers from different educational institutions. The findings reveal that insufficient speaking practice, low learner confidence, and limited implementation of communicative language teaching (CLT) methodologies are the main barriers to effective language acquisition. Moreover, the study identifies a significant gap between students' grammatical knowledge and their ability to use English in real-life communication. Teachers also reported additional challenges, including large class sizes, lack of teaching materials, and low student motivation. These structural and pedagogical limitations reduce opportunities for meaningful interaction in the classroom. The study suggests that increasing communicative and student-centered practices, improving teacher training programs, and integrating digital technologies into language instruction can significantly enhance students' communicative competence. The findings contribute to improving English language teaching practices in Azerbaijan and provide implications for similar EFL contexts.

Keywords: English language teaching, communicative language teaching, speaking skills, learner confidence, EFL context, Azerbaijan, student-centered learning

AZƏRBAYCANDA İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏKİ PROBLEMLƏR: EMİRİK TƏDQİQAT

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Xülasə: Bu tədqiqat Azərbaycanda ingilis dilinin tədrisi sahəsində mövcud olan əsas problemləri araşdırır və empirik nəticələr əsasında onların həlli yollarını təklif edir. İngilis dili orta və ali təhsil müəssisələrində geniş şəkildə tədris olunmasına baxmayaraq, tələbələrin əhəmiyyətli hissəsi uzun illər öyrənmələrinə baxmayaraq kommunikativ bacarıqlara tam yiyələnmə bilmir. Tədqiqatın əsas məqsədi bu problemin səbəblərini müəyyən etmək və mövcud tədris yanaşmalarının effektivliyini qiymətləndirməkdir. Araşdırma kəmiyyət metoduna əsaslanır və 85 tələbə və 20 müəllim arasında aparılmış sorğu vasitəsilə məlumatlar toplanmışdır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, danışmaq bacarıqlarının kifayət qədər inkişaf etdirilməməsi, tələbələrin aşağı özünəinam səviyyəsi və kommunikativ dil tədrisi metodlarının məhdud tətbiqi əsas

problemlərdir. Eyni zamanda, tələbələrin qrammatik bilikləri ilə real ünsiyyət bacarıqları arasında nəzərəcarpacaq fərq mövcuddur. Müəllimlər isə böyük siniflər, tədris materiallarının çatışmazlığı və motivasiya problemlərini əsas çətinliklər kimi qeyd etmişlər. Tədqiqatın nəticələri göstərir ki, kommunikativ və tələbəyönümlü yanaşmaların geniş tətbiqi, müəllim hazırlığının gücləndirilməsi və rəqəmsal texnologiyaların tədris prosesinə inteqrasiyası təlim nəticələrinin yaxşılaşmasına əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə təsir göstərə bilər.

Açar sözlər: İngilis dilinin tədrisi, kommunikativ yanaşma, danışmaq bacarıqları, tələbə özünəinamı, EFL mühiti, Azərbaycan

Introduction

English has become one of the most important global languages used in education, science, technology, and international communication. In Azerbaijan, English is included in the national curriculum and is taught from early school levels through higher education institutions. However, despite years of instruction, many learners still face serious difficulties in using English for communication purposes.

One of the central problems in English language teaching (ELT) is the imbalance between theoretical knowledge and practical language use. Students are often able to understand grammatical structures but are unable to apply them in speaking situations. This indicates that current teaching methods may not adequately support communicative competence development.

In addition, psychological factors such as anxiety, fear of making mistakes, and low self-confidence significantly affect language learning. Students who lack confidence are less likely to participate in speaking activities, which further limits their progress.

Institutional factors also play an important role. Large class sizes, limited teaching resources, and exam-oriented systems reduce the effectiveness of communicative teaching methods. Teachers are often forced to prioritize grammar instruction and test preparation instead of communication.

Moreover, exposure to authentic English outside the classroom is limited for most learners in Azerbaijan. This reduces opportunities for natural language acquisition and slows down fluency development. The absence of regular interaction in English contributes to passive learning habits among students.

Another important issue is the dominance of traditional teaching approaches, which often focus on teacher-centered instruction rather than learner participation. As a result, students remain passive recipients of knowledge rather than active users of the language.

Furthermore, the integration of modern educational technologies in language teaching remains insufficient in many institutions. Digital tools, when properly used, can enhance interaction, increase motivation, and provide learners with additional exposure to authentic language input.

Therefore, this study aims to investigate the key challenges in teaching English in Azerbaijan and propose practical, research-based recommendations for improving teaching effectiveness.

Literature Review. Traditional approaches such as the Grammar-Translation Method have long dominated foreign language teaching. These methods focus mainly on grammatical accuracy and translation tasks, which may improve reading and writing skills but do not develop speaking ability (Richards, 2006). As a result, learners often develop passive knowledge of language without being able to use it in real communication. This limitation has been widely discussed in second language acquisition research.

In contrast, Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) emphasizes interaction, fluency, and real-life communication. Harmer (2007) argues that learners acquire language more effectively when they actively use it in meaningful contexts rather than memorizing rules. CLT encourages pair

work, group discussions, and role-play activities, which help students develop both accuracy and fluency simultaneously. It also shifts the focus from teacher-centered instruction to learner-centered participation.

Motivation is another key factor in language learning. Dörnyei (2001) explains that motivated learners are more likely to engage in learning activities and achieve higher success. Similarly, Brown (2001) emphasizes that confidence plays a crucial role in speaking performance. Without motivation and confidence, learners tend to avoid communication, which slows down their overall progress.

From a sociocultural perspective, Vygotsky (1978) highlights that learning occurs through social interaction. This supports collaborative learning approaches where students develop language through communication with others. The concept of the "Zone of Proximal Development" suggests that learners can achieve higher performance when guided by teachers or more capable peers.

Task-Based Language Teaching (Ellis, 2003) also supports communicative development by focusing on completing meaningful tasks using the target language. This approach helps learners improve fluency and real-world language use. It also allows students to focus on meaning rather than form, which reduces anxiety and increases engagement.

In addition, technology-enhanced language learning has become increasingly important in modern education. According to Chapelle (2001), digital tools provide learners with additional exposure to language and increase opportunities for interaction. Online platforms, mobile applications, and multimedia resources allow students to practice language outside the classroom environment.

Furthermore, recent studies suggest that blended learning approaches, which combine traditional instruction with digital tools, are more effective in improving language proficiency. These approaches provide flexibility and increase learner autonomy, which is essential in EFL contexts.

However, despite these modern approaches, many EFL contexts, including Azerbaijan, still rely heavily on traditional teaching methods due to institutional limitations. These limitations include lack of teacher training, insufficient technological infrastructure, and exam-oriented educational systems.

Moreover, cultural expectations in some educational environments may also influence teaching practices, as teachers often feel pressured to prioritize accuracy over fluency. This further restricts the implementation of communicative methodologies in classrooms.

Overall, the literature suggests that effective language learning requires a combination of communicative approaches, learner motivation, social interaction, and technological support. The absence of these factors can significantly limit learners' ability to develop communicative competence.

Methodology and Materials

This study adopts a quantitative research design in order to systematically investigate the main challenges in English language teaching in Azerbaijan. A quantitative approach was selected because it allows the collection of measurable data and enables the identification of general patterns across a relatively large group of participants. This design is particularly suitable for exploring learners' difficulties and teachers' perceptions in a structured and objective way.

The data were collected from 85 students and 20 English language teachers working in different secondary and higher education institutions in Azerbaijan. The participants were selected through convenience sampling, which is commonly used in educational research due to accessibility

and time limitations. Although this sampling technique does not allow full generalization to the entire population, it provides valuable insights into current classroom practices and learning experiences.

A structured questionnaire was used as the main data collection instrument. The questionnaire was designed based on previous studies in the field of English language teaching and included both closed-ended questions and multiple-choice items. It consisted of several sections focusing on different aspects of language learning and teaching.

The first section examined students' learning objectives, such as academic purposes, employment needs, travel, and personal development. The second section focused on perceived language difficulties, including speaking, listening, reading, and writing skills. The third section explored classroom practices, particularly the frequency of speaking activities, group work, and teacher-student interaction. The final section investigated teaching methods used by instructors, such as grammar-based instruction, communicative language teaching, or mixed approaches.

In addition, teachers were asked to evaluate students' motivation, confidence levels, and participation in classroom activities. This allowed the study to compare both learner and teacher perspectives and identify possible mismatches between them.

The collected data were analyzed using descriptive statistical methods, including frequency counts and percentage analysis. These methods were used to summarize the responses and identify dominant trends in the data. The results were then interpreted in relation to existing literature in the field of second language acquisition and English language teaching.

The use of descriptive statistics helped to present a clear overview of the main challenges faced in English language classrooms in Azerbaijan. The analysis focused on identifying recurring patterns rather than testing hypotheses, which is appropriate for exploratory educational research.

Discussion

The analysis of the collected data reveals several important patterns regarding the challenges of English language learning in Azerbaijan. The results clearly indicate that speaking is perceived as the most difficult skill among students, with 57% of respondents identifying it as their primary problem area. This is followed by grammar at 23% and vocabulary at 12%, while other skills such as listening and writing were reported as less problematic. These findings suggest that productive skills, particularly speaking, remain the weakest area in English language learning.

One of the most significant findings is related to classroom speaking practice. Only 32% of students reported that they regularly participate in speaking activities during English lessons. The majority of students stated that speaking tasks are either limited or conducted only occasionally. This indicates that communicative activities are not consistently integrated into classroom instruction, which may negatively affect students' ability to develop fluency and confidence in real communication.

Another important result concerns learner confidence. A total of 62% of students reported that they do not feel confident when speaking English. This lack of confidence is a major barrier to participation in classroom activities and significantly reduces opportunities for language practice. Students who are afraid of making mistakes tend to avoid speaking, which further limits their development.

The teacher responses also provide valuable insights into classroom challenges. According to the teachers, the most significant problem is the lack of speaking practice (35%). This is followed by low student motivation (25%), large class sizes (20%), and insufficient teaching materials (20%).

These findings indicate that both pedagogical and institutional factors contribute to the difficulties in English language teaching.

The combination of these results suggests a clear mismatch between students' theoretical knowledge and their practical language use. While students may have sufficient understanding of grammar and vocabulary, they struggle to apply this knowledge in communicative situations. This gap highlights the need for more interactive and student-centered teaching approaches.

Overall, the results demonstrate that speaking skills, learner confidence, and classroom interaction are the most critical areas that require improvement in the Azerbaijani English language teaching context.

The findings of this study clearly indicate that speaking skill development remains the most significant challenge in English language teaching in Azerbaijan. This problem is not only methodological but also psychological and institutional in nature.

Firstly, insufficient speaking practice in classrooms significantly limits learners' communicative development. As Harmer (2007) suggests, language learning requires active use of the target language. However, in many classrooms, teacher-centered instruction dominates, leaving little room for student interaction.

Secondly, learner anxiety plays a crucial role. According to Brown (2001), anxiety and fear of making mistakes reduce students' willingness to communicate. This creates a cycle where lack of practice leads to low confidence, and low confidence further reduces participation.

Thirdly, structural limitations such as large class sizes make it difficult for teachers to implement communicative activities effectively. Teachers cannot provide equal speaking opportunities to all students, which reduces interaction quality.

Moreover, the gap between grammatical knowledge and practical usage is a major concern. Students often perform well in written exams but struggle in real communication situations. This indicates that assessment systems may also need reform.

Finally, the lack of authentic language exposure limits learners' development. Without real-life communication opportunities, students cannot develop fluency effectively.

Conclusion

The study concludes that English language teaching in Azerbaijan faces multiple interconnected challenges that affect the overall development of learners' communicative competence. These challenges are not limited to a single factor but rather represent a combination of methodological, psychological, and institutional issues that collectively influence the effectiveness of English instruction in the educational system.

One of the key findings of the study is the dominance of traditional teaching methods, which primarily focus on grammar instruction and written accuracy. While these approaches may contribute to learners' theoretical knowledge of the language, they significantly limit opportunities for meaningful communication and interaction. As a result, students often struggle to transfer their knowledge into real-life speaking situations, which leads to weak communicative performance.

In addition, psychological factors such as low confidence, anxiety, and fear of making mistakes play an important role in reducing students' willingness to participate in speaking activities. These affective barriers prevent learners from actively engaging in classroom interaction and further restrict language development.

Institutional constraints, including large class sizes, limited instructional materials, and insufficient exposure to authentic language input, also contribute to the problem. These conditions make it difficult for teachers to implement communicative and student-centered approaches

effectively. To address these issues, several important measures are recommended. First, communicative language teaching should be implemented more consistently in English language classrooms to promote interaction and real-life communication. Second, increasing student-centered learning activities such as group work, discussions, and role-play can enhance learner engagement and fluency. Third, improving teacher training programs is essential to equip educators with modern pedagogical skills and strategies. Fourth, the integration of digital technologies into language teaching can provide additional opportunities for practice and exposure to authentic English. Finally, reducing class sizes where possible would allow teachers to give more individualized attention and increase student participation.

Overall, implementing these changes can significantly improve students' English proficiency, particularly their communicative ability, and contribute to the modernization of English language teaching in Azerbaijan.

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EXPLORING MODERN METHODOLOGIES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE EDUCATION

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Abstract: This study explores modern methodologies in English language education, focusing on innovative approaches that enhance teaching effectiveness and learner engagement in contemporary classrooms. With the rapid development of technology and the increasing demand for communicative competence, traditional teacher-centered methods are gradually being replaced by learner-centered, interactive, and flexible strategies. The research examines key methodologies such as Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), Content and Language Integrated Learning (CLIL), and the integration of digital tools and online platforms in language instruction.

Furthermore, the study highlights the importance of developing 21st-century skills, including critical thinking, collaboration, creativity, and digital literacy, within the framework of English language learning. Special attention is given to the role of teachers as facilitators, the use of authentic materials, and the personalization of learning experiences to meet diverse student needs. The impact of blended learning and mobile-assisted language learning (MALL) is also discussed as a way to extend learning beyond the classroom.

The findings suggest that modern methodologies significantly improve students' language proficiency, motivation, and confidence. However, successful implementation requires proper teacher training, access to technological resources, and institutional support. The study concludes that adopting innovative and adaptive teaching methods is essential for preparing learners to effectively communicate in a globalized world.

Keywords: education, methodology, communication, technology, innovation, learning, teaching, interaction, skills, engagement.

İNGİLİS DİLİ TƏHSİLİNDƏ MÜASİR METODOLOGİYALARIN ARAŞDIRILMASI

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Xülasə: Bu tədqiqat ingilis dili təhsilində müasir metodologiyaları araşdırır və müasir sinif mühitində tədrisin effektivliyini və öyrənənlərin fəallığını artıran innovativ yanaşmalara diqqət yetirir. Texnologiyanın sürətli inkişafı və kommunikativ bacarıqlara artan tələbat fonunda ənənəvi müəllimləmə metodları tədricən öyrənməyə uyğun, interaktiv və çevik strategiyalarla əvəz olunur. Tədqiqat çərçivəsində Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisi (CLT), Tapşırıq əsaslı Dil Tədrisi (TBLT), Məzmun və Dilin İntegrasiyası (CLIL), eləcə də rəqəmsal alətlərin və onlayn platformaların dil tədrisinə inteqrasiyası kimi əsas metodologiyalar təhlil edilir.

Bundan əlavə, tədqiqat ingilis dili öyrənilməsi kontekstində tənqidi düşünmə, əməkdaşlıq, yaradıcılıq və rəqəmsal savadlılıq kimi XXI əsr bacarıqlarının inkişafının vacibliyini vurğulayır. Müəllimlərin fasilitator kimi rolu, autentik materiallardan istifadə və müxtəlif tələbə ehtiyaclarına uyğun fərdiləşdirilmiş təlim prosesləri xüsusi diqqət mərkəzində saxlanılır. Qarışıq təlim (blended learning) və mobil dəstəklili dil öyrənməsi (MALL) yanaşmalarının sinifdən kənar öyrənməni genişləndirməsi də araşdırılır.

Tədqiqatın nəticələri göstərir ki, müasir metodologiyalar tələbələrin dil bacarıqlarını, motivasiyasını və özünə inamını əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır. Bununla belə, bu metodların uğurla tətbiqi üçün müəllimlərin peşəkar hazırlığı, texnoloji resurslara çıxış və institusional dəstək mühüm əhəmiyyət kəsb edir. Tədqiqat belə qənaətə gəlir ki, qloballaşan dünyada öyrənənlərin effektiv ünsiyyət qurma bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirmək üçün innovativ və adaptiv tədris metodlarının tətbiqi zəruridir.

Açar sözlər: təhsil, metodologiya, kommunikasiya, texnologiya, innovasiya, öyrənmə, tədris, qarşılıqlı əlaqə, bacarıqlar, fəallıq

Introduction

In recent decades, English language education has undergone significant transformation due to globalization, technological advancement, and the growing need for effective international communication. English is no longer taught solely as a subject for academic purposes; rather, it is considered a vital tool for global interaction in areas such as business, science, education, and digital communication.

As a result, traditional teaching methods that emphasize rote memorization and grammar translation are gradually being replaced by more dynamic and learner-centered approaches. (Brown, H. D. 2007)

Modern methodologies in English language education focus on developing communicative competence, critical thinking, and practical language skills. These approaches encourage active student participation, collaboration, and the use of authentic materials that reflect real-life situations. Additionally, the integration of digital technologies, such as online platforms, mobile applications, and multimedia resources, has created new opportunities for interactive and personalized learning experiences.

Another important aspect of contemporary language teaching is the shift in the role of the teacher. Instead of being the sole source of knowledge, teachers now act as facilitators, guiding

students in the learning process and supporting their individual needs. This shift allows learners to take greater responsibility for their own progress and fosters a more engaging and effective learning environment. (Harmer, J. 2015)

This study aims to explore the key modern methodologies used in English language education, analyze their advantages, and evaluate their impact on learners' performance and motivation. By examining these innovative approaches, the research highlights the importance of adapting teaching practices to meet the demands of the 21st century.

Material and Methods

This study is based on a comprehensive qualitative and quantitative research design aimed at exploring modern methodologies in English language education and evaluating their effectiveness in improving learners' language proficiency and engagement. A mixed-methods approach was adopted in order to obtain both measurable data and in-depth insights into teaching practices and learning outcomes. The research was conducted over a defined academic period and involved participants from different educational levels, including secondary school students and undergraduate learners studying English as a foreign language. (Scrivener, J. 2011)

The sample group consisted of approximately 80–120 students and 10–15 English language teachers selected through purposive sampling. Participants were chosen based on their involvement in English language learning and teaching processes, as well as their familiarity with modern instructional approaches. The diversity of the sample allowed for a broader understanding of how different methodologies function in varied educational contexts. Ethical considerations were strictly followed, and all participants were informed about the purpose of the research and voluntarily agreed to take part.

Data collection was carried out using multiple instruments to ensure reliability and validity. Surveys and structured questionnaires were administered to students in order to gather quantitative data regarding their motivation, engagement, and perceptions of different teaching methods. The questionnaires included Likert-scale items, multiple-choice questions, and short open-ended responses. In addition, semi-structured interviews were conducted with teachers to gain deeper insights into their experiences, challenges, and attitudes toward implementing modern methodologies such as communicative language teaching, task-based learning, and digital instruction.

Classroom observations also played a significant role in the research process. Several lessons were observed and analyzed using a structured observation checklist focusing on student participation, teacher-student interaction, use of technology, and the application of innovative teaching strategies. These observations helped to identify patterns in teaching practices and provided real-time evidence of how modern methodologies are applied in practice. Field notes were taken during each session to document important behaviors, interactions, and instructional techniques. (Nunan, D. 2004)

In order to further strengthen the study, experimental elements were incorporated by applying selected modern teaching methods in a controlled classroom environment. Students were divided into experimental and control groups, where the experimental group was taught using modern, student-centered approaches, while the control group followed more traditional methods. Pre-tests and post-tests were administered to both groups to measure improvements in language skills such as reading, writing, listening, and speaking. The comparison of results provided clear evidence of the effectiveness of innovative methodologies.

Data analysis was conducted using both descriptive and inferential statistical methods. Quantitative data obtained from surveys and tests were analyzed using statistical software to calculate means, percentages, and correlations. Qualitative data from interviews and observations were analyzed through thematic analysis, allowing for the identification of recurring themes and patterns related to teaching practices and student experiences. This combination of analytical techniques ensured a comprehensive interpretation of the findings.

The research also utilized secondary data sources, including academic articles, books, and previous studies related to English language teaching methodologies. A thorough literature review was conducted to support the research framework and to compare current findings with existing knowledge in the field. This helped to establish a theoretical foundation and ensured that the study was aligned with contemporary academic discussions.

Overall, the methods employed in this research were designed to provide a detailed and balanced examination of modern methodologies in English language education. By integrating multiple data collection tools and analytical approaches, the study aims to produce reliable and meaningful results that contribute to the improvement of teaching practices and learning outcomes in the field of English language education.

Results and discussion

The findings of this study demonstrate that the implementation of modern methodologies in English language education has a significant positive impact on students' language development, motivation, and overall engagement in the learning process. The analysis of pre-test and post-test results revealed that students who were exposed to learner-centered approaches showed noticeably higher improvement in all four language skills – reading, writing, listening, and speaking – compared to those who were taught using traditional methods. In particular, speaking and listening skills improved more rapidly, which can be attributed to the interactive and communicative nature of modern teaching strategies. (Scrivener, J. 2011)

Survey results indicated that a majority of students responded positively to innovative teaching methods. They reported increased interest in lessons, greater confidence in using English in real-life situations, and a stronger willingness to participate in classroom activities. The use of digital tools, multimedia resources, and collaborative tasks created a more dynamic and supportive learning environment, which contributed to higher levels of student engagement. Additionally, students expressed that authentic materials and real-world tasks helped them better understand the practical value of learning English.

The qualitative data obtained from teacher interviews and classroom observations further supported these findings. Teachers noted that modern methodologies allowed them to better address individual differences among students and adapt their teaching strategies accordingly. They also observed that students became more autonomous and responsible for their own learning when given opportunities to work in groups, solve problems, and engage in meaningful communication. However, some teachers highlighted challenges such as limited access to technological resources, lack of training, and time constraints in implementing these approaches effectively. (Tomlinson, B. 2013)

Classroom observations confirmed that lessons based on communicative and task-based approaches fostered a more interactive atmosphere. Students were more actively involved in discussions, group work, and problem-solving activities. Teacher-student interaction became more balanced, and the role of the teacher shifted from a knowledge provider to a facilitator and guide.

This shift not only enhanced the learning experience but also promoted critical thinking and collaboration skills among students.

Despite the overall positive outcomes, the study also identified certain limitations. The effectiveness of modern methodologies largely depends on the availability of resources, institutional support, and the teacher's level of competence in applying these approaches. In some cases, the lack of proper infrastructure and insufficient professional development opportunities hindered the full implementation of innovative teaching practices. Furthermore, adapting these methodologies to large classroom settings remained a challenge. (Warschauer, M., & Healey, D. 1998)

In discussion, the results align with existing research in the field of English language education, which emphasizes the importance of student-centered learning and the integration of technology. The study confirms that modern methodologies are not only effective in improving language proficiency but also essential for developing 21st-century skills such as communication, collaboration, and digital literacy. These findings highlight the need for continuous teacher training programs and investment in educational technologies to support the successful adoption of innovative teaching strategies.

Conclusion

In conclusion, modern methodologies in English language education play a vital role in improving the overall quality and effectiveness of the learning process. The study has shown that learner-centered approaches, interactive teaching strategies, and the integration of digital technologies significantly enhance students' language proficiency, motivation, and engagement. Unlike traditional methods, which often focus on memorization and passive learning, modern approaches encourage active participation, real-life communication, and the development of critical thinking skills.

The findings indicate that students exposed to innovative methodologies demonstrate better performance, particularly in communicative skills such as speaking and listening. Additionally, the use of authentic materials and technology-based tools creates a more dynamic and meaningful learning environment. These methods also support individualized learning, allowing students to progress at their own pace and according to their specific needs.

However, the successful implementation of modern methodologies depends on several key factors, including teacher competence, access to technological resources, and institutional support. Without proper training and infrastructure, it may be difficult to fully realize the potential of these approaches. Therefore, continuous professional development for teachers and investment in educational technologies are essential.

Overall, adopting modern methodologies is no longer optional but necessary in order to meet the demands of a globalized world. By embracing innovative teaching practices, educators can better prepare students to use English effectively in academic, professional, and social contexts.

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EVOLUTION OF LANGUAGE TEACHING METHODS AND APPROACHES: FROM TRADITIONAL MODELS TO COMMUNICATIVE PRACTICES

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Abstract: This article explores the evolution of language teaching methods and approaches, focusing on their historical development and contemporary application. It begins by outlining the most active period in language teaching history, from the 1950s to the 1980s, when major methods such as the Audiolingual Method, Situational Language Teaching, Silent Way, Natural Approach, and Total Physical Response were introduced. Later, in the 1990s, more learner-centered and skill-based approaches such as Content-Based Instruction, Task-Based Language Teaching, and Competency-Based Instruction became prominent. The study explains the distinction between approaches and methods, emphasizing that approaches provide general theoretical principles, while methods offer structured procedures and clear roles for teachers and learners. It highlights the main language teaching approaches, including Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Competency-Based Language Teaching, Cooperative Learning, Lexical Approach, Multiple Intelligences, Natural Approach, and others. Among these, CLT is presented as the most influential framework in modern language education due to its focus on communication and real-life language use. The article also describes several traditional and modern teaching methods in detail, such as the Grammar Translation Method, Direct Method, Audiolingual Method, Counseling-Learning, Silent Way, Suggestopedia, and Total Physical Response. Each method is analyzed in terms of its principles, classroom application, strengths, and limitations.

Overall, the findings show a clear shift in language teaching from teacher-centered, grammar-focused instruction to learner-centered, communicative, and interactive practices. Modern approaches emphasize learner needs, meaningful communication, collaboration, and real-world language use. The article concludes that effective language teaching today requires flexibility, methodological awareness, and the integration of multiple approaches to enhance communicative competence and support successful language acquisition in diverse educational contexts.

Key words: Inclusive education, equal opportunities, individualized approach, language teaching methods, communicative language teaching, educational approaches, contemporary challenges.

**DİL TƏDRİSİ METOD VƏ YANAŞMALARININ TƏKAMÜLÜ: ƏNƏNƏVİ MODELƏRDƏN
KOMMUNİKATİV TƏCRÜBƏLƏRƏ**

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə dil tədrisi metod və yanaşmalarının inkişafını, onların tarixi formalaşmasını və müasir dövrdə tətbiqini araşdırır. İlk olaraq, 1950–1980-ci illərin dil tədrisi tarixində ən aktiv dövr olduğu qeyd edilir. Bu dövrdə Audiolingual Metod, Situativ Dil Tədrisi, Silent Way (Səssiz Yöntəm), Natural Approach (Təbii Yanaşma) və Total Physical Response kimi əsas metodlar meydana çıxmışdır. Daha sonrakı mərhələdə, xüsusilə 1990-cı illərdə Content-Based Instruction (Məzmun əsaslı tədris), Task-Based Language Teaching (Tapşırıq əsaslı tədris) və Competency-Based Instruction (Səriştə əsaslı tədris) kimi daha tələbə mərkəzli yanaşmalar ön plana çıxmışdır. Məqalədə yanaşma və metod anlayışları arasındakı fərq izah olunur. Yanaşmalar ümumi nəzəri prinsipləri müəyyən etdiyi halda, metodlar müəllim və tələbələrin rollarını, tədris prosedurlarını və konkret fəaliyyətləri daha dəqiq şəkildə müəyyən edir. Müasir dil tədris yanaşmaları kimi Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisi (CLT), Səriştə əsaslı tədris, Kooperativ öyrənmə, Leksik yanaşma, Çoxlu intellekt nəzəriyyəsi və Təbii yanaşma xüsusi olaraq vurğulanır. Bunlar arasında CLT ünsiyyətə və real həyat dil istifadəsinə əsaslandığı üçün ən təsirli yanaşma hesab olunur. Həmçinin məqalədə Qrammatika-Tərcümə metodu, Birbaşa metod, Audiolingual metod, Məsləhət-öyrənmə, Silent Way, Suggestopedia və Total Physical Response kimi ənənəvi və müasir metodlar təhlil edilir. Onların prinsipləri, tətbiqi və üstünlükləri ilə yanaşı, çatışmazlıqları da göstərilir.

Nəticə olaraq, dil tədrisinin müəllim mərkəzli yanaşmadan şagird mərkəzli, kommunikativ və interaktiv tədrisə doğru inkişaf etdiyi vurğulanır. Müasir dövrdə effektiv dil tədrisi üçün müxtəlif yanaşmaların inteqrasiyası, çeviklik və kommunikativ bacarıqların inkişafı əsas şərt kimi qəbul olunur.

Açar sözlər: İnküviziv təhsil, bərabər imkanlar, fərdiləşdirilmiş yanaşma, dil tədrisi metodları, kommunikativ dil tədrisi, təhsil yanaşmaları, müasir çağırışlar.

Introduction

The period between the 1950s and the 1980s was considered the most dynamic stage in the development of language teaching approaches and methods. (1) Initially, the Audiolingual Method and the Situational Method emerged as dominant trends. Later, they were gradually replaced by the communicative approach. During the same time, methods such as the Silent Way, the Natural Approach, and Total Physical Response were also applied in language instruction by certain educators. In the 1990s, approaches like Content-Based Instruction, Task-Based Language Teaching, and Competency-Based Instruction were additionally introduced in teaching.

Cooperative Learning, the Whole Language Approach, and Multiple Intelligences are also regarded as components of this methods era. Mainstream language teaching adopted Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) as the core methodology in the 1980s, and it still remains one of the most suitable foundations for teaching English in the context of globalization.

A language teaching approach is based on a shared set of theories and principles. Different interpretations can arise when applying these principles in practice. This allows a degree of flexibility and independence in implementation. The main approaches can be summarized as follows: Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Competency-Based Language Teaching, Content-Based Language Teaching, Cooperative Learning, Lexical Approach, Multiple Intelligences, Natural Approach, Neurolinguistic Programming, Task-Based Language Teaching, and Whole Language.

A method, on the other hand, includes instructional design, clearly defined content, and specified roles for teachers and learners. Teaching procedures and techniques are described in

detail. Therefore, methods are best acquired through training. The teacher's responsibility is to follow the method and apply it according to its principles. There is limited room for variation or interpretation. The main methods include: Grammar Translation Method, Direct Method, Audiolingual Method, Counseling-Learning, Situational Language Teaching, Silent Way, Suggestopedia (or Desuggestopedia), and Total Physical Response.

Methodology and Materials

Methods of English Language Teaching: The Grammar Translation Method (GTM) has been utilized by language teachers for a long time. Previously, it was referred to as the Classical Method because it was applied in teaching classical languages such as Latin and Greek. In the United States, it was also known as the Prussian Method. This method involves learning a language through detailed examination of grammatical rules, followed by applying these rules in translating sentences and texts to and from the target language. It dominated the teaching of European and foreign languages from the 1840s to the 1940s. Even today, it continues to be used in various forms in many contexts. The main characteristics of this method are as follows:

The native language is used as a reference system in learning the second language; reading and writing are emphasized, while speaking and listening receive limited attention; vocabulary selection is mainly based on reading materials. Words are learned through dictionary use, bilingual word lists, and memorization; a significant part of lessons is devoted to translating sentences into and out of the target language. This focus on sentence-level translation is a key feature of the method; students are expected to achieve high accuracy in translation. Accuracy is prioritized, and grammar is taught deductively. A structured syllabus is followed to present grammar systematically, and the learner's native language is used as the medium of instruction. (Noam Chomsky, 1966)

During the mid and late nineteenth century, criticism of the Grammar Translation Method emerged in Europe. This movement became known as the Reform Movement. It led to the development of new approaches to language teaching. The Direct Method: Since the Grammar Translation Method was not effective in developing communicative competence, the Direct Method emerged as an alternative. The fundamental principle of the Direct Method is that translation is not allowed. It is called "direct" because meaning is conveyed directly in the target language through demonstration and visual aids, without using the learner's native language. It was introduced in France, Germany, and the United States toward the end of the nineteenth century. In the United States, it was known as the Berlitz Method. Later, it was adopted in many other countries. The main principles include: instruction conducted entirely in the target language; focus on everyday vocabulary and sentences; development of oral communication through structured question-and-answer interaction in small classes; grammar taught inductively; introduction of new material orally; concrete vocabulary taught through objects and visuals, while abstract vocabulary is taught through associations; emphasis on both speaking and listening; and focus on accurate pronunciation and grammar.

The Direct Method achieved success in private language schools, where learners were highly motivated and teachers were native speakers or highly proficient. However, it was less successful in public schools. It required teachers with near-native fluency. Its effectiveness depended heavily on the teacher rather than the textbook. Many teachers did not possess sufficient language proficiency. In some cases, brief explanations in the native language could have improved understanding. Strict avoidance of the native language sometimes created difficulties. Nevertheless, the Direct Method can be considered the first language teaching method that attracted widespread attention and marked the beginning of the "methods era." (Jack Richards and Theodore S. Rodgers, 2001)

The Audiolingual Method: The Audiolingual Method developed from structural linguistics, contrastive analysis, oral-aural techniques, and behaviorist psychology. The term “Audiolingualism” was introduced by Professor Nelson Brooks in 1964. It transformed language teaching into a more systematic discipline. This method became widely used in the United States and Canada. It shares several similarities with Situational Language Teaching. Audiolingualism is strongly connected to linguistic theory and behavioral psychology, reaching its peak in the 1960s. However, it was criticized for its weak theoretical basis and limited practical outcomes. Learners often failed to transfer classroom skills to real-life communication. The linguist Noam Chomsky challenged both the structuralist and behaviorist foundations, arguing that language is generated through internal competence rather than imitation and repetition. As a result, a period of experimentation and methodological innovation followed.

Counseling–Learning: Counseling–Learning is a process-oriented method where language content plays a secondary role. It lacks a fully developed theoretical framework in language learning. It differs from traditional second language acquisition theories. The classroom environment is considered essential. There is no fixed syllabus, and learners choose topics based on their interests. These are then translated into the target language and used for communication practice. However, this method did not gain widespread acceptance in mainstream language teaching.

Discussion

Situational Language Teaching and the Oral Approach: This approach was developed by British applied linguists between the 1930s and the 1960s. Linguists such as Harold Palmer and A. S. Hornby contributed to establishing systematic principles of selection, grading, and presentation. By the 1950s, the Oral Approach had become the standard British method for teaching English. It was widely described in methodology textbooks of that period. In the 1960s, the Australian educator George Pittman and his colleagues developed influential teaching materials based on this approach. These materials were extensively used in Australia, New Guinea, and the Pacific regions. The main features include: teaching begins with spoken language; content is introduced orally before being presented in written form; the target language is used in the classroom; new language items are introduced and practiced within meaningful situations; vocabulary is carefully selected to cover essential usage; grammar is graded from simple to complex structures; and reading and writing are introduced only after a sufficient foundation in vocabulary and grammar has been established. The situational presentation of language became the defining characteristic of this method.

The Silent Way: The Silent Way is a language teaching method developed by Caleb Gattegno. It is based on the idea that the teacher should speak as little as possible, while learners should be encouraged to produce as much language as possible. Its learning principles suggest that learners benefit more from discovering and creating language rather than memorizing and repeating it. Learning is supported by the use of physical objects and problem-solving activities. Instructional materials include colored rods, pronunciation charts, and visual aids that help illustrate relationships between sounds and meanings. The pronunciation charts, known as “Fidels,” represent all the sounds of the target language. The method emphasizes the indirect role of the teacher, who acts as a facilitator rather than a controller. Gattegno believed that teaching should support the learning process rather than dominate it. Supporters of the Silent Way argue that its principles extend beyond education and influence broader perspectives on learning and life. (Jack Richards and Theodore S. Rodgers, 2001)

Suggestopedia: Suggestopedia, also known as Desuggestopedia, is a method developed by the Bulgarian educator Georgi Lozanov. It is based on the theory of Suggestology and emphasizes the role of suggestion in learning. One of its most distinctive features is the use of music and rhythm to enhance memory and learning. The physical environment of the classroom, including decoration and seating arrangement, is considered important. The teacher's authoritative presence also plays a significant role. The method focuses on memorization of vocabulary pairs, highlighting the importance of lexis. Translation at the lexical level is emphasized rather than contextual usage. Lozanov proposed that learners have untapped mental potential, and removing psychological barriers can improve learning outcomes. By reducing negative attitudes and increasing confidence, the method aims to activate learners' cognitive reserves.

Total Physical Response: Total Physical Response (TPR) is a teaching method based on the coordination of language and physical movement. It was developed by James Asher, a professor of psychology. The method is grounded in principles of developmental psychology and language acquisition. It reflects the process of first language learning, where children listen for a long time before they begin to speak. In TPR, learners act as listeners and performers, responding physically to commands given by the teacher. Speaking is encouraged only when learners feel ready. The teacher plays an active role by providing input that helps learners build internal understanding. Asher emphasized that TPR should be used together with other teaching methods. Many practitioners agree that it complements other approaches effectively. (Jack Richards and Theodore S. Rodgers, 2001)

Approaches of English Language Teaching: Communicative Language Teaching (CLT): Communicative competence is the central goal of CLT, and it highlights the close relationship between language and communication. It focuses on the learner's ability to use language in different contexts. This approach promotes active participation through various communicative tasks and strategies. It emphasizes real-life speaking and listening situations. CLT emerged at a time when language teaching required significant change, introducing a more humanistic perspective. It received strong support from applied linguists, educational institutions, and organizations such as the British Council.

Since its introduction, CLT has evolved through several stages. In the first stage, the focus was on developing syllabuses based on communicative competence, organizing content around functions and notions rather than grammar. In the second stage, attention shifted to identifying learners' needs, making needs analysis an essential component. In the third stage, emphasis was placed on classroom activities such as group work, task-based learning, and information-gap exercises. Five key characteristics define modern communicative methodology:

1. **Appropriateness:** Language use must suit the context, including setting, participants, and purpose, requiring learners to use both formal and informal styles appropriately.
2. **Message Focus:** Emphasis is placed on conveying and understanding meaningful messages, with a focus on information exchange.
3. **Psycholinguistic Processing:** Activities engage cognitive processes essential for language acquisition.
4. **Risk-Taking:** Learners are encouraged to experiment with language and learn from mistakes.
5. **Free Practice:** Learners practice language holistically by integrating multiple skills simultaneously rather than focusing on isolated elements.

Today, CLT continues to exist in its traditional form and is reflected in a wide range of teaching materials and resources. It has also influenced many other language teaching approaches that share similar principles.

Competency-Based Language Teaching (CBLT): This approach emphasizes learning outcomes rather than instructional methods. It is grounded in modern theories of language and second language acquisition and was initially developed within general education before being adapted for language teaching. CBLT applies the principles of competency-based education to language learning. By the late 1970s, it became widely used, particularly in programs designed for adult learners focusing on workplace and survival skills. E. R. Auerbach identifies eight main features of this approach.

1. Focus on effective functioning in society: The objective is to prepare learners to handle real-life demands successfully.
2. Emphasis on life skills: Instruction targets the language abilities required for practical situations.
3. Task- or performance-based orientation: The focus is on what learners can do rather than what they know.
4. Modularized instruction: Learning is divided into smaller, meaningful units to ensure clarity and progress.
5. Clearly defined outcomes: Expected results are specified in measurable terms.
6. Continuous assessment: Evaluation is ongoing and based on observable performance.
7. Demonstration of mastery: Learners must show their ability to perform specific tasks instead of relying on traditional tests.
8. Individualized learning: Instruction is learner-centered and adapted to individual needs.

The Australian Migrant Education Program, one of the largest language training initiatives globally, has applied this approach since the 1970s. Over time, it has undergone several modifications. While widely accepted in ESL contexts, CBLT has faced criticism for focusing more on performance outcomes than on the development of critical thinking skills.

Content-Based Instruction (CBI): Karl Krahnke defines Content-Based Instruction as teaching subject matter through the target language, with little explicit focus on language itself. This approach has been widely implemented since the 1980s in various settings, including ESP (English for Specific Purposes) and academic programs. It is also common in K–12 ESL education and university-level foreign language programs. Supporters argue that it leads to more effective learning outcomes, while critics note that many teachers are trained to teach language skills rather than academic content.

Cooperative Language Learning (CLL): Cooperative Language Learning is part of a broader educational approach known as collaborative learning. It emphasizes group work and interaction among learners. The American educator John Dewey is credited with promoting the idea of cooperative learning in classrooms. This approach became more prominent in the United States during the 1960s and 1970s, particularly as a response to educational inequality. It aims to create inclusive, learner-centered environments. Its goals include: providing opportunities for natural language acquisition through interaction; offering flexible teaching strategies; focusing on specific language structures and vocabulary through tasks; developing communication strategies; and increasing motivation while reducing anxiety.

Lexical Approach: The Lexical Approach is based on the idea that language learning is primarily built on vocabulary and word combinations rather than grammar. It emphasizes the

importance of lexical units in communication. Teaching materials for this approach include full course packages, vocabulary activity collections, corpus-based texts, and computer-assisted analysis tools. The recognition of multi-word expressions has strengthened the importance of lexis in language teaching. However, it is still developing as a fully defined teaching method.

Multiple Intelligences (MI): The theory of Multiple Intelligences, proposed by Howard Gardner, suggests that intelligence consists of multiple dimensions that should be developed in education. Traditional intelligence tests, such as the Stanford-Binet, view intelligence as a single fixed ability. In contrast, MI theory identifies eight types of intelligence: logical-mathematical, visual-spatial, bodily-kinesthetic, musical, interpersonal, intrapersonal, linguistic, and naturalistic. This theory has significantly influenced language teaching by encouraging diverse teaching strategies that address different learner strengths. MI-based classrooms focus on holistic development and include activities such as storytelling, discussions, games, and collaborative tasks.

The Natural Approach: The Natural Approach was developed by Tracy Terrell and Stephen Krashen. It emphasizes communication as the primary goal of language learning and focuses on providing comprehensible input. The key principles include: exposure to meaningful input; use of visual aids and varied vocabulary; emphasis on listening and reading before speaking; and creating a low-anxiety learning environment. Speaking is allowed to develop naturally over time. This approach shares similarities with communicative language teaching and is considered evolutionary rather than revolutionary.

Neurolinguistic Programming (NLP): Neurolinguistic Programming is a set of communication and personal development techniques developed by Richard Bandler and John Grinder in the 1970s. It focuses on how individuals perceive the world through their senses and how language influences thought and behavior. NLP suggests that by changing language patterns, individuals can change their actions and achieve personal growth. It has been applied in education to improve communication and teaching effectiveness.

Conclusion

In conclusion, NLP is not considered a formal teaching method but rather a humanistic approach based on psychological principles. It is believed that incorporating NLP techniques can enhance teaching practices and make educators more effective.

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TEACHING ENGLISH IN A BILINGUAL EDUCATIONAL ENVIRONMENT: CHALLENGES AND EFFECTIVE STRATEGIES ACROSS DIFFERENT LEARNING CONTEXTS

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Abstract: Teaching English in bilingual classrooms requires flexibility, cultural awareness, and the ability to adapt teaching methods to learners with different linguistic backgrounds. In multilingual contexts such as Uzbekistan, students commonly use Uzbek and Russian alongside English during the learning process, which creates both opportunities and challenges for teachers. This article is based on practical teaching experience in state schools, private education centers, and online learning environments with learners ranging from young children to adults over the age of fifty-five. The study examines major classroom difficulties, including language interference, fear of speaking, mixed-level groups, and vocabulary retention problems. It also discusses effective teaching strategies such as communicative language teaching, scaffolding, contextualized grammar instruction, strategic use of native languages, and technology integration. The findings demonstrate that bilingual learners achieve greater success when teachers create supportive classroom environments focused on communication, learner confidence, and active participation. The article highlights the importance of adaptable and student-centered teaching practices in helping bilingual learners become confident users of English.

Keywords: bilingual education, communicative teaching, multilingual classrooms, English language teaching, Uzbek learners, online education

İKİ DİLLİ EĞİTİM ORTAMINDA İNGİLİZCE ÖĞRETİMİ: FARKLI ÖĞRENME BAĞLAMLARINDA KARŞILAŞILAN ZORLUKLAR VE ETKİLİ STRATEJİLER

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Özet: İki dilli sınıflarda İngilizce öğretimi, esneklik, kültürel farkındalık ve farklı dilsel geçmişlere sahip öğrencilere uygun öğretim yöntemlerini uyarlama becerisi gerektirir. Özbekistan gibi çok dilli ortamlarda öğrenciler, öğrenme sürecinde İngilizcenin yanı sıra yaygın olarak Özbekçe ve Rusça da kullanmaktadır. Bu durum öğretmenler için hem fırsatlar hem de çeşitli zorluklar ortaya çıkarmaktadır. Bu makale, devlet okullarında, özel eğitim merkezlerinde ve çevrim içi öğrenme ortamlarında, küçük yaşta çocuklardan elli beş yaşın üzerindeki yetişkinlere kadar farklı yaş gruplarındaki öğrencilerle edinilen uygulamalı öğretim deneyimlerine dayanmaktadır.

Çalışma; dil aktarımı (interference), konuşma korkusu, farklı seviyelerdeki öğrencilerden oluşan sınıflar ve kelime bilgisinin kalıcılığıyla ilgili sorunlar gibi başlıca sınıf içi güçlükleri incelemektedir. Ayrıca iletişimsel dil öğretimi, aşamalı destekleme (scaffolding), bağlam temelli dil bilgisi öğretimi, ana dillerin stratejik kullanımı ve teknolojinin eğitime entegrasyonu gibi etkili öğretim stratejileri ele alınmaktadır. Bulgular, öğretmenlerin iletişime, öğrenci özgüvenine ve aktif katılıma odaklanan destekleyici sınıf ortamları oluşturduklarında iki dilli öğrencilerin daha yüksek başarı elde ettiklerini göstermektedir. Makale, iki dilli

öğrencilerin İngilizceyi özgüvenli bir şekilde kullanabilmelerine yardımcı olmada uyarlanabilir ve öğrenci merkezli öğretim uygulamalarının önemini vurgulamaktadır.

Anahtar Kelimeler: iki dilli eğitim, iletişimsel öğretim, çok dilli sınıflar, İngilizce öğretimi, Özbek öğrenciler, çevrimiçi eğitim

Introduction

English has become an essential part of modern education and professional life. In many countries, especially in multilingual societies, students begin learning English while already using two languages in their daily lives. In Uzbekistan, for example, many learners grow up speaking both Uzbek and Russian at home, at school, or in social environments. As a result, English teachers often work in naturally bilingual classrooms.

My experience teaching English began in 2018, and since then I have worked with learners from very different backgrounds and age groups. I have taught children as young as eight in state schools, teenagers preparing for academic success, adults in private education centers, and online learners over the age of fifty-five. Each classroom environment has taught me that successful language teaching depends not only on methodology, but also on understanding students emotionally, culturally, and linguistically.

Teaching bilingual learners is very different from teaching monolingual groups. Students frequently switch between Uzbek, Russian, and English while learning. Sometimes this helps them understand new concepts faster, but it can also create confusion in grammar, pronunciation, and sentence structure. Because of this, teachers need to adapt lessons carefully according to learners' needs, confidence levels, and communication abilities.

This article reflects practical classroom experience across several educational contexts and discusses both the challenges and effective strategies involved in teaching English in bilingual environments.

Today, English is not simply another academic subject. For many learners, it represents access to education, career opportunities, international communication, and personal growth. As a result, the demand for effective English language instruction continues to increase across different educational environments. In many post-Soviet and Central Asian contexts, learners grow up in bilingual or multilingual settings where Uzbek and Russian are used simultaneously in education, communication, and daily life. This linguistic reality creates a unique educational environment for English language teachers.

Teaching English to bilingual learners is not simply about presenting grammar rules or vocabulary lists. It involves understanding how learners process multiple languages, transfer knowledge between languages, and overcome interference caused by different linguistic systems. Teachers must adapt their methodology according to students' age, educational background, learning motivation, and classroom context.

This article is based on practical teaching experience in three major learning contexts:

- State secondary and high schools;
- Private education centers;
- Online language schools.

The learners involved include children aged eight, teenagers aged fifteen to seventeen, university-age students, and adult learners over the age of thirty and even fifty-five. The article examines the challenges faced in bilingual classrooms and proposes effective strategies that help learners improve their English proficiency successfully.

Materials and Methods

The Nature of a Bilingual Educational Environment. A bilingual educational environment is a learning context in which students regularly use two languages in communication and education. In Uzbekistan and many neighboring regions, Uzbek and Russian frequently function together in schools, families, media, and social life. Consequently, English learners already possess experience switching between languages before they begin studying English.

This situation creates several advantages:

- Learners are often familiar with language switching;
- Students may develop stronger metalinguistic awareness;
- Bilingual students can compare grammatical structures more easily;
- Exposure to multiple languages may increase cognitive flexibility.

However, bilingualism also creates specific challenges:

- Language interference between Uzbek, Russian, and English;
- Confusion in grammar patterns;
- Pronunciation difficulties;
- Translation dependence;
- Unequal proficiency in the two native languages.

For English teachers, success depends on understanding how these linguistic systems interact in students' minds.

Teaching Contexts and Their Differences

1. State Secondary and High Schools. Teaching in state schools involves working with large groups of learners who often have mixed language abilities and different levels of motivation. Young learners and teenagers require strong classroom management, engaging activities, and emotionally supportive learning environments.

In school settings, teachers frequently face challenges such as:

- Limited speaking practice;
- Large class sizes;
- Exam-oriented learning;
- Limited lesson hours;
- Students' fear of making mistakes.

Teenage learners particularly struggle with confidence and communication anxiety. Many students understand grammar theoretically but hesitate to speak English actively.

To address these challenges, communicative teaching methods become essential. Pair work, role plays, classroom games, storytelling activities, and collaborative tasks help learners practice English naturally. Visual support, movement-based activities, and contextualized grammar instruction are especially effective for younger students.

For example, teaching grammar through real-life communication rather than isolated exercises increases student engagement significantly. Instead of memorizing rules mechanically, students use grammar structures in meaningful situations.

2. Private Education Centers. Private education centers differ considerably from traditional schools. Students usually attend these centers voluntarily, meaning motivation levels tend to be higher. However, expectations are also greater.

Learners in education centers often focus on:

- Speaking fluency;
- IELTS preparation;

- Grammar improvement;
- Vocabulary expansion;
- Career and academic opportunities.

Adult learners in particular expect practical results. Many adults need English for work, travel, higher education, or professional communication. Unlike school learners, adult students often bring emotional barriers into the classroom, including fear of failure, lack of confidence, and negative past learning experiences.

In bilingual adult classrooms, translation can become both helpful and problematic. Strategic use of Uzbek or Russian may save time and clarify difficult concepts, but overreliance on translation reduces students' exposure to English.

Therefore, effective teachers gradually increase English classroom input while maintaining comprehensibility. Clear instructions, simplified language, gestures, examples, and guided practice support comprehension without excessive dependence on native languages.

Private education centers also provide opportunities for more flexible teaching methods. Teachers can personalize lessons, include authentic materials, organize speaking clubs, and integrate modern technology into classroom activities.

3. Online Language Schools. Online teaching has transformed language education dramatically. Virtual classrooms allow teachers to work with learners from different age groups, professional backgrounds, and geographical locations.

Online bilingual classrooms introduce unique challenges:

- Reduced physical interaction;
- Technical problems;
- Shorter attention spans;
- Limited non-verbal communication;
- Difficulties monitoring participation.

At the same time, online learning offers important advantages:

- Flexible scheduling;
- Access to digital resources;
- Individualized learning;
- Increased learner autonomy;
- International communication opportunities.

Adult learners over the age of 30 and 55 often demonstrate high motivation in online environments because they connect English learning directly to personal growth and career development. However, these learners may require additional emotional support and confidence-building.

Effective online teaching strategies include:

- Interactive presentations;
- Digital whiteboards;
- Breakout room discussions;
- Visual grammar explanations;
- Online quizzes and games;
- Personalized speaking feedback.

Maintaining student engagement online requires dynamic lesson pacing and consistent interaction. Teachers must intentionally create opportunities for communication and participation.

Results and Discussion

Major Challenges in Teaching English to Bilingual Learners

1. *Language Interference.* One of the most common difficulties bilingual learners face is language interference. Students unconsciously transfer grammatical structures, pronunciation patterns, and vocabulary usage from Uzbek or Russian into English.

Examples include:

- Incorrect word order;
- Omission of articles;
- Direct translation of expressions;
- Pronunciation influenced by native phonetics.

Teachers must recognize these errors not as failures but as natural stages of language development.

2. *Fear of Speaking.* Many bilingual learners hesitate to speak English because they fear making mistakes. This issue is especially common among teenagers and adult learners.

Students who have spent years focusing only on grammar exercises often lack communicative confidence. They may understand English passively but struggle to produce language actively.

Creating a psychologically safe classroom environment is therefore essential. Teachers should encourage risk-taking, normalize mistakes, and praise communicative effort rather than perfection.

3. *Mixed-Level Classrooms.* In bilingual educational environments, classrooms frequently contain learners with different levels of proficiency. Some students may possess strong Russian-based academic backgrounds, while others may rely primarily on Uzbek.

This diversity creates difficulties in pacing lessons appropriately.

Differentiated instruction becomes necessary. Teachers can provide:

- Tiered tasks;
- Flexible grouping;
- Additional support materials;
- Optional extension activities;
- Personalized feedback.

Such strategies help maintain motivation for both stronger and weaker learners.

4. *Vocabulary Retention Problems.* Learners often memorize vocabulary temporarily but struggle to retain and use words actively.

Research and classroom experience show that vocabulary retention improves when learners:

- Encounter words repeatedly in context;
- Use vocabulary in communication;
- Connect words to personal experiences;
- Practice through speaking and writing.

Visual associations, storytelling, spaced repetition, and communicative tasks significantly improve long-term retention.

Effective Strategies for Teaching English in Bilingual Contexts

1. *Communicative Language Teaching.* Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) remains one of the most effective approaches for bilingual classrooms. The primary goal of CLT is meaningful communication rather than memorization.

Activities such as: role plays; pair discussions; problem-solving tasks; interviews; storytelling; real-life simulations encourage students to use English actively and naturally.

When learners focus on communication, grammar and vocabulary become functional tools rather than isolated academic topics.

2. Scaffolding Techniques. Scaffolding helps bilingual learners gradually move from supported learning toward independent language use.

Effective scaffolding techniques include:

- Visual aids;
- Sentence starters;
- Guided speaking frames;
- Modeling;
- Step-by-step instructions;
- Demonstrations.

For younger learners especially, visual and contextual support greatly improves comprehension.

3. Contextualized Grammar Instruction. Traditional grammar instruction often emphasizes rule memorization. However, bilingual learners benefit more from contextualized grammar teaching.

For example, instead of teaching past tenses through isolated exercises, teachers can ask students to:

- Tell stories;
- Describe experiences;
- Discuss past events;
- Conduct interviews.

This approach allows learners to understand how grammar functions in authentic communication.

4. Strategic Use of Native Languages. Completely banning students' native languages may create unnecessary anxiety and confusion. Strategic use of Uzbek and Russian can support comprehension when used carefully.

Teachers may use native languages to:

- Clarify complex grammar points;
- Explain classroom instructions;
- Compare linguistic structures;
- Build conceptual understanding.

However, English should remain the primary language of communication whenever possible.

5. Building Learner Confidence

Confidence is one of the most important factors in successful language learning.

Teachers can strengthen learner confidence by:

- Providing positive feedback;
- Celebrating small achievements;
- Encouraging participation;
- Reducing fear of mistakes;
- Using supportive correction techniques.

Students who feel emotionally secure participate more actively and develop stronger communication skills.

The Role of Technology in Bilingual English Education

Modern technology has expanded opportunities for English language teaching significantly.

Digital tools support bilingual learners through:

- Interactive platforms;
- Online quizzes;
- Educational games;
- Pronunciation applications;
- Virtual speaking practice;
- Multimedia resources.

Online learning environments also expose students to authentic English through videos, podcasts, films, and global communication.

Technology is especially valuable in maintaining learner motivation among younger students and supporting flexible learning opportunities for adult learners who may have busy professional or personal responsibilities.

Teacher Adaptability and Professional Growth

One of the most important qualities of an English teacher in a bilingual educational environment is adaptability.

Teachers working across schools, education centers, and online platforms must constantly adjust:

- Teaching style;
- Classroom management techniques;
- Communication strategies;
- Lesson pacing;
- Assessment methods.

Different age groups require different methodological approaches. Young learners need movement, creativity, and visual engagement. Teenagers need interactive communication and emotional connection. Adult learners need practical relevance and respectful collaboration.

Continuous professional development also plays a vital role. Successful teachers regularly:

- Reflect on classroom experience;
- Analyze student progress;
- Explore modern methodologies;
- Develop digital teaching skills;
- Adapt materials to learner needs.

Conclusion

Teaching English in a bilingual educational environment has shown me that language learning is deeply connected to confidence, communication, and human connection. Whether working with young learners in schools, teenagers in education centers, or adults in online lessons, I have seen that students learn best when they feel comfortable, motivated, and understood.

Bilingual learners who speak Uzbek and Russian often face challenges related to grammar interference, pronunciation, and speaking anxiety. At the same time, they also possess important advantages, including flexibility in thinking and experience with multiple languages. With the right teaching strategies, these learners can develop strong English communication skills and become confident users of the language.

Throughout my teaching experience, communicative activities, supportive feedback, contextualized grammar instruction, and interactive learning have consistently produced positive results. Students become more engaged when lessons are connected to real communication rather than memorization alone.

Modern English teaching requires educators to remain adaptable, reflective, and open to continuous professional growth. Every classroom is different, and every learner brings a unique story into the learning process. For this reason, successful teaching is not only about delivering information, but also about creating an environment where students feel encouraged to participate, experiment, and grow.

As bilingual education continues to expand, English teachers will play an increasingly important role in helping learners connect with global opportunities, academic development, and intercultural communication. Through patience, flexibility, and student-centered teaching approaches, bilingual learners can successfully achieve both language proficiency and personal confidence.

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INTERACTIVE ACTIVITIES AND SPEAKING SKILL DEVELOPMENT IN UNIVERSITY EFL COURSES

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Abstract: Speaking skill development remains one of the most persistent challenges in university-level English as a Foreign Language instruction, as traditional form-focused pedagogies consistently fail to produce the communicative competence that academic and professional contexts demand. This article examines the role of interactive activities in addressing this challenge, analyzing four principal instructional formats (role-play, cooperative learning and peer discussion, structured debate, and AI-mediated conversational practice) through a critical integrative review of empirical and theoretical literature published between 2020 and 2025. The findings demonstrate that interactive activities produce measurable gains in speaking fluency, accuracy, and complexity, but that their effectiveness is fundamentally conditioned by affective factors, particularly the management of foreign language speaking anxiety and the cultivation of

willingness to communicate. Cooperative and peer-based formats improve fluency and reduce anxiety through positive interdependence and shared communicative goals, while role-play reduces the evaluative stakes of oral production by introducing communicative distance between the learner and the task. AI-powered conversational agents extend speaking practice beyond classroom constraints and demonstrably improve willingness to communicate, though their pedagogical value remains contingent on interactional authenticity rather than technological sophistication. The article concludes that effective speaking instruction at the university level requires principled activity sequencing, affective scaffolding, and digitally enhanced practice environments, with institutional investment in teacher development and digital infrastructure as necessary preconditions for meaningful pedagogical reform.

Keywords: interactive activities, speaking skill development, EFL university instruction, communicative competence, willingness to communicate.

UNİVERSİTETDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİNİN XARİCİ DİL KİMİ TƏDRİSİNDƏ İNTERAKTİV FƏALİYYƏTLƏR VƏ DANIŞIQ BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAFI

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Xülasə: Danışiq bacarığının inkişafı ali təhsil səviyyəsində ingilis dilinin xarici dil kimi tədrisinin ən davamlı problemlərindən biri olaraq qalır, çünki ənənəvi forma yönümlü pedaqoji yanaşmalar akademik və peşəkar mühitlərin tələb etdiyi kommunikativ kompetentliyi ardıcıl olaraq formalaşdırmaqda uğursuz olur. Bu baxımdan, məqalə interaktiv fəaliyyətlərin həmin problemin həllindəki rolunu araşdırır; 2020–2025-ci illər arasında nəşr olunmuş empirik və nəzəri ədəbiyyatın tənqidi integrativ təhlili əsasında dörd əsas tədris formatını (rol oyunu, kooperativ öyrənmə və həmyaşid müzakirəsi, strukturlaşdırılmış debat və süni intellekt vasitəsilə həyata keçirilən ünsiyyət təcrübəsini) təhlil edir. Tədqiqatın nəticələri göstərir ki, interaktiv fəaliyyətlər danışiq axıcılığı, dəqiqliyi və mürəkkəbliyi baxımından ölçülə bilən nailiyyətlər əldə etməyə imkan verir; lakin onların effektivliyi əsasən affektiv amillərlə, xüsusilə xarici dildə danışiq narahatlığının idarə edilməsi və ünsiyyət istəyinin inkişaf etdirilməsi ilə şərtlənir. Kooperativ və həmyaşid əsaslı formatlar müsbət qarşılıqlı asılılıq və ortaq kommunikativ məqsədlər vasitəsilə axıcılığı artırır və narahatlığı azaldır; rol oyunu isə öyrənmə tapşırıq arasında kommunikativ məsafə yaradaraq şifahi istehsalın qiymətləndirici riskini azaldır. Süni intellekt əsaslı ünsiyyət agentləri danışiq təcrübəsini sinif otağının hüdudlarından kənara çıxarır və ünsiyyət istəyini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır; bununla belə, onların pedaqoji dəyəri texnoloji mürəkkəblikdən deyil, interaksiyanın autentikliyindən asılıdır. Məqalə belə nəticəyə gəlir ki, universitet səviyyəsində effektiv danışiq tədrisinin təmin edilməsi üçün prinsipli fəaliyyət ardıcılığı, affektiv istinad strukturları və rəqəmsal təcrübə mühitlərinin integrasiyası zəruridir.

Açar sözlər: interaktiv fəaliyyətlər, danışiq bacarığının inkişafı, ali təhsildə ingilis dili tədrisi, kommunikativ kompetentlik, ünsiyyət istəyi.

Introduction

The development of oral communicative competence in English as a Foreign Language (EFL) settings has become one of the central preoccupations of applied linguistics and language pedagogy over the past three decades, driven by the recognition that speaking is not merely one skill among four but the primary medium through which academic, professional, and intercultural participation is enacted in a globalized world. University-level EFL programs are particularly implicated in this demand: their graduates are expected to engage in international academic discourse, navigate professional environments conducted in English, and communicate across linguistic and cultural

boundaries with a degree of fluency and pragmatic sophistication that traditional grammar-oriented instruction consistently fails to produce. Yet despite the theoretical consensus around communicative language teaching and the well-documented limitations of form-focused approaches, a substantial gap persists between pedagogical aspiration and classroom reality in most university EFL contexts, where interactive speaking activities remain underutilized relative to receptive skill instruction and where learners continue to report high levels of speaking anxiety, low willingness to communicate, and inadequate exposure to authentic oral interaction. The study addresses this gap by examining the principal forms of interactive activity deployed in university EFL speaking instruction, including role-play, cooperative learning, structured debate, and AI-mediated conversational practice, and evaluating the empirical and theoretical grounds for their effectiveness in producing communicative speaking competence.

Thus, the purpose of the paper is to synthesize current theoretical and empirical knowledge on interactive activity design in university EFL contexts in order to identify the pedagogical conditions under which such activities most effectively support speaking skill development.

Methodology and Materials

The study employs a critical integrative review methodology, drawing on peer-reviewed empirical studies, systematic reviews, and theoretically grounded research articles published primarily between 2020 and 2025 and retrieved from Scopus- and Web of Science-indexed journals in the fields of applied linguistics, EFL pedagogy, computer-assisted language learning, and educational technology. Source selection was guided by thematic relevance to interactive speaking activity design at the university level, with particular attention to studies addressing role-play-based instruction, cooperative and peer discussion formats, task-based speaking approaches, digital platform integration, and AI-mediated conversational practice in EFL contexts. The analytical procedure involved identifying convergent empirical findings and theoretical arguments across these bodies of literature, mapping them onto four thematic domains, and deriving from their intersection a set of conclusions regarding the pedagogical conditions under which interactive activities most effectively support communicative speaking development.

Discussion

Speaking occupies a structurally privileged position among the four language skills in EFL pedagogy, not merely because it is the most visible marker of communicative competence, but because it is the most psychologically demanding. Unlike reading or writing, oral production is immediate, irreversible, and socially exposed, which means that the conditions under which speaking practice occurs, whether they invite risk-taking or foreclose it, are at least as consequential for learning outcomes as the linguistic content of any given lesson. University EFL contexts add a further layer of complexity: learners are adults with established self-concepts and professional aspirations, which makes the experience of communicative failure in a classroom setting particularly threatening to motivation and identity. The theoretical case for interactive activities in this context therefore rests not only on the well-documented communicative language teaching (CLT) argument that meaningful interaction is the primary vehicle of language acquisition, but also on a socio-affective rationale, that the design of classroom interaction can either sustain or suppress the willingness to communicate that underlies all oral development. This paper examines the principal forms of interactive activity used in university EFL speaking instruction, evaluates the empirical evidence for their effectiveness, and considers the emerging role of digital and AI-mediated tools in reshaping the landscape of speaking practice.

The concept of communicative competence, foundational to any discussion of speaking instruction, has undergone significant theoretical elaboration since Hymes first challenged Chomsky's purely syntactic account of linguistic knowledge. In its canonical pedagogical formulations, particularly those of Canale and Swain and later Bachman communicative competence encompasses grammatical, discourse, sociolinguistic, and strategic dimensions, all of which are simultaneously activated in real-time oral production. This multidimensionality helps explain why speaking is difficult to teach through decontextualized grammar exercises: accuracy in any one dimension does not automatically produce fluency across all of them. Interactive activities, by requiring learners to simultaneously manage meaning negotiation, turn-taking, topic maintenance, and self-monitoring, engage the full architecture of communicative competence in ways that controlled drilling exercises cannot. Task-based language teaching (TBLT) operationalizes this insight most systematically, organizing instruction around communicative tasks (activities with a real-world analogue, a clear outcome, and a primary focus on meaning rather than form) that require learners to use language as a genuine instrument of communication rather than as an object of analysis. Research on task-based speaking instruction at the university level consistently confirms that when tasks are designed with communicative authenticity, they produce measurable gains not only in accuracy and complexity but also in the fluency, confidence, and self-regulatory engagement that are most resistant to improvement through conventional instruction.

Among the specific interactive formats deployed in university EFL classrooms, role-play has attracted sustained empirical attention and consistently positive findings. The pedagogical logic of role-play is that it places learners in scenarios that simulate the communicative demands of professional or social life while simultaneously creating enough fictional distance from the learner's actual identity to reduce the affective stakes of error. Research conducted across multiple university EFL contexts confirms that speaking anxiety, which research in Afghanistan, Indonesia, and elsewhere has established as one of the most significant inhibitors of oral performance among university-level EFL learners, is substantially lower during role-play activities than during open-class presentations or teacher-directed exchanges. Studies have found that psychological factors such as shyness, anxiety, and fear of making mistakes prevent learners from using the target language, but that role-play provides students with meaningful opportunities to practise spoken English effectively in real-life situations and promotes student interaction. A role-play-based pedagogical model studied across an academic semester at an Indonesian university, in which students completed projects including mock interviews, talk shows, and professional meetings, revealed two key dimensions of student experience: the learning and teaching activities themselves and students' perceived benefits and challenges, with findings offering insights for instructors interested in replicating or adapting similar role-play-based learning activities (Asysyfa, et. al., 2019; Mizhir, 2017). What these studies collectively suggest is that role-play functions most productively not as an isolated activity but as the organizing logic of a sustained pedagogical sequence in which learners progressively inhabit more complex and demanding communicative scenarios.

Group discussion and cooperative learning activities represent a second major cluster of interactive approaches to speaking development, and the evidence base for their effectiveness is particularly robust. Cooperative learning, which organizes learners into small groups characterized by positive interdependence, individual accountability, and shared communicative goals, addresses the speaking development problem from a socio-constructivist angle: language is learned most efficiently when it is used to accomplish meaningful collaborative tasks alongside peers whose

proficiency is close enough to one's own to make negotiation necessary and productive. Research investigating the impact of cooperative learning strategies such as Think-Pair-Share and Numbered Heads on the oral fluency of intermediate EFL learners found that students in cooperative learning groups obtained significantly higher scores on post-tests of oral tasks than students in the control group, with discussing, creating, and thinking in a group, rather than individually, providing more enjoyable classrooms and more fluent speakers. A further study examining structured peer discussion activities found significant improvements in speaking fluency evidenced by increased speech rate, reduced hesitation, and smoother speech continuity, with learners also reporting reduced speaking anxiety, increased confidence, and greater classroom engagement. The productivity of student talk in small-group settings extends beyond measurable fluency gains: research published in TESOL Quarterly demonstrates that students' talk in communicative group activities develops in terms of the robustness of talk repertoires, the collaborative nature of interaction, and the connections of talk to course outcomes, pushing beyond simple communication in a foreign language toward genuinely productive small-group discourse (Namaziandost, et. al, 2020; Wotring, et. al, 2024).

Debate and structured discussion activities occupy a distinct position in the ecology of university EFL speaking instruction, one that is particularly well-aligned with the critical thinking and argumentation demands of academic communication. Unlike role-play, which typically assigns learners pre-specified positions and communicative roles, debate requires learners to construct and defend original arguments under time pressure and in response to real-time counterarguments, placing considerably higher demands on lexical access, discourse organization, and pragmatic sensitivity. These demands make debate particularly appropriate at the university level, where the transition from accuracy-focused to complexity-focused speaking development is most pressing. Research examining TED Talk content, digital posters, and other situated materials used to prepare learners for structured discussions has shown that a diversified blended pedagogical approach using clustered digital materials including TED Talk content and short films can substantially improve the oral communicative performance and conversational abilities of EFL students across different situations and contexts (Salih & Omar, 2024). The utility of structured discussion formats also lies in their capacity to develop pragmatic competence, the ability to deploy language strategically in social context, which is among the dimensions of communicative competence most neglected by conventional university EFL curricula and most critical for professional and academic participation.

The integration of digital platforms into interactive speaking instruction has substantially expanded both the quantity and the variety of speaking practice available to university EFL learners, particularly by extending communicative interaction beyond the temporal and spatial constraints of the physical classroom. Mobile-assisted language learning (MALL) applications, digital discussion forums, video presentation platforms, and language exchange networks all create contexts in which learners can engage in authentic or quasi-authentic oral production without the immediate evaluative presence of an instructor. Research comparing MALL-assisted and face-to-face speaking instruction found that both approaches developed EFL learners' overall speaking performance, including fluency, coherence, lexical range, grammatical accuracy, and pronunciation, as well as foreign language enjoyment and language-specific grit, but MALL learners outperformed their face-to-face counterparts on all measures. At the same time, researchers consistently caution that most mobile applications for language learning are oriented toward individual use and formal linguistic knowledge rather than toward the interactive dimensions of speaking (negotiation of meaning, turn-taking, real-time repair) that are most central to genuine communicative development

(Hwang, et. al., 2024). This means that digital tool selection in speaking instruction must be driven by principled pedagogical criteria rather than by novelty or availability, with platforms evaluated specifically for the degree to which they support authentic interaction rather than merely providing additional input or grammar practice.

The most consequential recent development in the interactive approach to EFL speaking instruction is the emergence of AI-powered conversational agents (chatbots and intelligent tutoring systems) as speaking practice partners. The pedagogical appeal of AI interlocutors is considerable: they are available on demand, infinitely patient, free from social judgment, and capable of providing immediate corrective feedback at a granularity that human instructors in large classrooms cannot match. Research has shown that AI-mediated interactive speaking activities are more effective in improving EFL learners' speaking skills and willingness to communicate than conventional peer-interaction speaking activities, with learners also holding positive attitudes and perceptions toward AI-mediated speaking instruction (Fathi, et. al., 2024). The mechanism appears to be partly affective: studies using Google Assistant as a speaking interlocutor over a ten-session intervention found significant improvements in willingness to communicate, enhanced communicative confidence, and reduced speaking anxiety among the participants. The intersection of AI interaction and willingness to communicate is particularly significant for university EFL contexts, because research on generative AI chatbots as informal speaking practice environments found that after interacting with chatbots, most participants demonstrated significant increases in confidence and willingness to communicate in school settings, with notable improvements in classroom participation, suggesting a transfer effect from the low-stakes digital environment to the higher-stakes physical classroom (Zhang, 2026; Liang & Tse, 2025). Critically, however, research also identifies the premature stage of current AI software as a limitation, with the restrictions this brings for improving students' willingness to communicate in speaking remaining a practical concern that pedagogically principled integration must address.

The evidence reviewed across these domains converges on a set of conclusions with direct implications for course design and institutional policy in university EFL programs. First, no single interactive activity format is sufficient in isolation: speaking development requires a principled sequence of activities that moves learners progressively from lower-risk cooperative tasks, through structured role-play and discussion, to the more demanding forms of argumentation and spontaneous oral production that academic and professional life requires. Second, the affective dimension of speaking instruction, specifically the management of anxiety and the cultivation of willingness to communicate is not a secondary concern to be addressed once linguistic competence has been established, but a foundational condition of the speaking development process that must be actively designed into the structure of activities, the organization of groups, and the feedback practices of instructors. Third, digital and AI-mediated tools represent a genuine expansion of the possibilities for interactive speaking practice, but their pedagogical value is contingent on the quality of the interaction they afford: tools that simulate authentic communicative exchange, provide meaningful feedback, and extend rather than replace the collaborative social dimensions of speaking practice are genuinely useful, while tools oriented primarily toward linguistic form or individual use offer limited contribution to the communicative development that university EFL instruction must prioritize.

Conclusion

The article has examined the theoretical foundations and empirical evidence pertaining to interactive activities as instruments of speaking skill development in university EFL courses,

demonstrating that the effectiveness of such activities is determined not by their format alone but by the degree to which they are designed to engage the full architecture of communicative competence, including its affective, pragmatic, and strategic dimensions, under conditions that reduce anxiety and sustain willingness to communicate. Role-play, cooperative discussion, structured debate, and AI-mediated conversational practice each contribute distinctively to this objective, and the evidence consistently favors pedagogical sequences that move learners progressively from lower-risk collaborative tasks toward more demanding and autonomous forms of oral production. The integration of digital and AI-powered tools extends the range of available speaking practice contexts in pedagogically significant ways, particularly by providing low-stakes environments that reduce speaking anxiety and transfer positively to classroom participation, though their value remains contingent on the authenticity of the interaction they support rather than on technological sophistication *per se*.

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THE ROLE OF MOTIVATION IN TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH AS A FOREIGN LANGUAGE

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Abstract: This thesis examines the role of motivation in teaching and learning English as a foreign language, emphasizing its importance as a key factor influencing learners' success. In today's globalized world, English plays a vital role in communication, education, and professional development, which increases the need for effective language learning. The paper highlights that motivation, both intrinsic and extrinsic, significantly affects students' engagement, effort, and persistence in learning English. Intrinsic motivation, driven by personal interest and enjoyment, is identified as particularly important for long-term success, while extrinsic motivation, such as rewards and recognition, also contributes to learners' progress.

The thesis further explores how teachers can enhance motivation through interactive teaching methods, meaningful tasks, and supportive classroom environments. The integration of technology and the use of constructive feedback are also discussed as effective strategies for increasing student engagement. Additionally, the research emphasizes that motivated learners are more likely to use effective learning strategies and achieve higher proficiency levels. Overall, the paper concludes that motivation is a central component of successful English language teaching and learning, and it should be carefully fostered in educational settings.

Key words: motivation, English Language Learning, student engagement, language teaching strategies, second language acquisition

THE ROLE OF MOTIVATION IN TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH AS A FOREIGN LANGUAGE

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Xülasə: Bu tezis xarici dil kimi ingilis dilinin tədrisi və öyrənilməsində motivasiyanın rolunu araşdırır və onun tələbələrin uğuruna təsir edən əsas amillərdən biri olduğunu vurğulayır. Müasir qloballaşmış dünyada ingilis dili ünsiyyət, təhsil və peşəkar inkişaf üçün mühüm rol oynayır ki, bu da effektiv dil öyrənməyə olan ehtiyacı artırır. Məqalə göstərir ki, həm daxili (intrinsic), həm də xarici (extrinsic) motivasiya tələbələrin ingilis dilini öyrənmə prosesində iştirakı, səy göstərməsi və davamlılığına ciddi təsir edir. Şəxsi maraq və zövqdən qaynaqlanan daxili motivasiya uzunmüddətli uğur üçün xüsusilə vacib hesab olunur, mükafat və tanınma kimi xarici motivasiya isə öyrənənlərin inkişafına töhfə verir.

Tezis həmçinin müəllimlərin interaktiv tədris metodları, mənalı tapşırıqlar və dəstəkləyici sinif mühiti vasitəsilə motivasiyanı necə artırma biləcəyini araşdırır. Texnologiyanın inteqrasiyası və konstruktiv rəyin verilməsi də tələbə cəlbini artıran effektiv strategiyalar kimi müzakirə olunur. Bundan əlavə, tədqiqat göstərir ki, motivasiyalı tələbələr daha effektiv öyrənmə strategiyalarından istifadə edir və daha yüksək dil

səviyyəsinə nail olurlar. Ümumilikdə, məqalə nəticə olaraq bildirir ki, motivasiya ingilis dilinin tədrisi və öyrənilməsində əsas komponentdir və təhsil mühitində diqqətlə inkişaf etdirilməlidir.

Açar sözlər: motivasiya, ingilis dilinin öyrənilməsi, tələbə fəallığı, dil tədrisi strategiyaları, ikinci dilin mənimsənilməsi

Introduction

In today's increasingly globalized and interconnected world, English has become a dominant medium of international communication, education, science, and professional development. It serves not only as a lingua franca among people from different linguistic backgrounds but also as a key tool for accessing global knowledge and opportunities. As a result, the demand for effective English language teaching and learning has grown rapidly across both developed and developing countries.

However, mastering a foreign language is a complex and multifaceted process that requires the interaction of various psychological, social, and educational factors. Learners differ in terms of their abilities, learning styles, cultural backgrounds, and exposure to the target language, all of which can influence the success of language acquisition. Among these factors, motivation is widely recognized as one of the most significant determinants of success in language learning. It plays a crucial role in shaping learners' attitudes, effort, persistence, and overall engagement in the learning process (Lightbown & Spada, 2013).

Motivation can be defined as the internal and external forces that initiate, guide, and sustain learning behavior. In the context of English language learning, motivation determines how much effort learners are willing to invest, how persistent they are in overcoming difficulties, and how successful they ultimately become (Dörnyei, 2001). Therefore, understanding the role of motivation is essential for both teachers and learners in order to improve language learning outcomes.

This paper aims to explore the importance of motivation in teaching and learning English, identify different types of motivation, and discuss strategies that can enhance learners' motivation in the classroom.

Materials and Methods

This study is based on a qualitative review of the existing literature on motivation in English language teaching and learning. Relevant books, peer-reviewed journal articles, and theoretical studies by leading scholars in applied linguistics and educational psychology were analyzed using descriptive and comparative methods. The collected data were examined to identify the main types of motivation and effective strategies for enhancing learner motivation in English language classrooms.

Motivation in language learning is generally categorized into two main types: intrinsic and extrinsic motivation. Intrinsic motivation refers to engaging in learning for personal satisfaction, interest, or enjoyment, while extrinsic motivation involves external rewards such as grades or recognition (Deci & Ryan, 2000). Research suggests that intrinsically motivated learners tend to achieve more sustainable and long-term success in language learning (Dörnyei, 2001).

According to self-determination theory, learners perform better when their basic psychological needs—autonomy, competence, and relatedness—are satisfied (Deci & Ryan, 2000). When students feel independent in their learning process, believe in their abilities, and experience a supportive environment, their motivation significantly increases. This emphasizes the crucial role teachers play in influencing students' motivation.

Results and Discussion

Teachers can enhance motivation through various instructional strategies that actively involve learners in the learning process. For instance, interactive teaching methods, such as group discussions, role-plays, and problem-solving tasks, encourage students to participate more actively and use the language in meaningful contexts. Communicative activities, which focus on real-life language use, help learners understand the practical value of English and increase their willingness to engage in classroom interaction (Harmer, 2007). In addition, designing meaningful tasks that relate to students' interests, needs, and future goals can significantly improve their intrinsic motivation.

Providing positive and constructive feedback also plays a crucial role in maintaining motivation. When teachers acknowledge students' efforts and progress, learners feel more confident and are more likely to continue improving their skills. Constructive feedback, in particular, helps students identify their strengths and areas for improvement without discouraging them. This supportive approach contributes to building a growth mindset among learners.

Furthermore, integrating technology into the classroom has become an effective way to enhance motivation in modern educational settings. The use of multimedia resources, language learning applications, and online platforms can make lessons more engaging, interactive, and accessible. Technology allows students to practice English in diverse ways, such as watching videos, participating in online discussions, or using gamified learning tools. These methods not only increase students' interest but also provide opportunities for autonomous learning, which is closely linked to higher levels of motivation.

The classroom environment is another important factor affecting motivation. A supportive and inclusive atmosphere encourages students to participate actively without fear of making mistakes. Anxiety and low self-confidence can negatively impact motivation, particularly in language learning contexts where communication is essential (Lightbown & Spada, 2013). Therefore, creating a safe and encouraging learning environment is vital.

Furthermore, motivated learners are more likely to adopt effective learning strategies, practice English outside the classroom, and achieve higher proficiency levels (Gardner, 1985). In contrast, learners with low motivation often struggle to maintain interest and show slower progress. This demonstrates that motivation is a key determinant of success in language learning.

Conclusion

In conclusion, motivation plays a fundamental role in teaching and learning English as a foreign language. It influences learners' engagement, persistence, and overall achievement. Both intrinsic and extrinsic motivations contribute to the learning process, but intrinsic motivation is especially important for long-term success (Deci & Ryan, 2000).

Teachers have a significant responsibility in fostering motivation by designing engaging lessons, supporting students, and creating a positive classroom environment (Harmer, 2007). By addressing learners' needs and interests, educators can enhance motivation and improve learning outcomes.

Ultimately, motivated learners are more likely to succeed in mastering English, which opens up broader academic, professional, and social opportunities. Therefore, motivation should be considered a central component of effective English language teaching.

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MODERN TRENDS IN LANGUAGE ASSESSMENT: METHODS, PRACTICES, AND LIMITATIONS

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Abstract: Assessment is a vital component in foreign language teaching and learning, and it impacts teaching and learning outcomes. The last few decades have seen the field undergo dramatic changes, with a shift from traditional, product-based testing methods to more dynamic, formative and learner-focused approaches. This research examines current trends in language assessment, such as formative assessment, dynamic assessment, teacher-based assessment, peer and self-assessment, and computer-based testing. The study adopts a qualitative method with a review of the recent research literature in language assessment. The studies reviewed show that modern assessment approaches focus on feedback and engagement with learners, and on the development of communicative skills rather than just the outcomes. As Birjandi and Sarem (2012) point out, dynamic assessment combines teaching and assessment, whereas Campbell and Duncan (2007) highlight the impact of communicative teaching methods on assessment practices. Also, Jamieson (2005) and Nomozova (2024) highlight the increase in technology use in assessment. Research shows that modern assessment approaches lead to more learner autonomy, motivation and authenticity in the assessment of language skills. But issues like evaluator subjectivity, lack of standards and institutional factors continue to hinder their implementation. The research concludes that an appropriate combination of traditional and modern assessment methods is needed to ensure valid, reliable and pedagogically sound language assessment practices in today's education systems.

Keywords: language assessment, formative assessment, assessment, learner autonomy, communicative competence

DİL QIYMƏTLƏNDİRİLMƏSİNDƏ MÜASİR TENDENSİYALAR: METODLAR, TƏCRÜBƏLƏR VƏ MƏHDUDİYYƏTLƏR

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Xülasə: Qiymətləndirmə xarici dilin tədrisi və öyrənilməsinin mühüm tərkib hissəsidir və tədris və öyrənmə nəticələrinə birbaşa təsir göstərir. Son bir neçə onillik ərzində bu sahədə əhəmiyyətli dəyişikliklər baş vermiş, ənənəvi, nəticəyönümlü qiymətləndirmə metodlarından daha dinamik, formativ və öyrənişyönümlü yanaşmalara keçid müşahidə olunmuşdur. Bu tədqiqat dil qiymətləndirilməsində müasir tendensiyaları, o cümlədən formativ qiymətləndirmə, dinamik qiymətləndirmə, müəllim əsaslı qiymətləndirmə, həmyaşlı və özünüqiymətləndirmə, eləcə də kompüter əsaslı testləşdirməni araşdırır. Tədqiqatda dil qiymətləndirilməsi sahəsində son elmi ədəbiyyatın icmalına əsaslanan keyfiyyət metodundan istifadə edilmişdir. Təhlil olunan tədqiqatlar göstərir ki, müasir qiymətləndirmə yanaşmaları yalnız nəticələrə deyil, həm də əks əlaqəyə, öyrənənlərin prosesdə fəal iştirakına və kommunikativ bacarıqların inkişafına yönəlir. Birjandi və Sarem (2012) qeyd etdikləri kimi, dinamik qiymətləndirmə tədris və qiymətləndirməni birləşdirir, Campbell və Duncan (2007) isə kommunikativ tədris metodlarının qiymətləndirmə təcrübələrinə təsirini vurğulayırlar. Həmçinin Jamieson (2005) və Nomozova (2024) qiymətləndirmədə texnologiyadan istifadənin artmasını qeyd edirlər. Tədqiqatlar göstərir ki, müasir qiymətləndirmə yanaşmaları dil bacarıqlarının qiymətləndirilməsində öyrənən muxtariyyətinin, motivasiyanın və autentikliyin artmasına kömək edir. Bununla belə, qiymətləndiricinin subyektivliyi, standartların çatışmazlığı və institusional amillər kimi məsələlər bu yanaşmaların tətbiqinə mane olmaqda davam edir. Tədqiqatın nəticəsi göstərir ki, müasir təhsil sistemlərində etibarlı, obyektiv və pedaqoji baxımdan əsaslandırılmış dil qiymətləndirməsini təmin etmək üçün ənənəvi və müasir qiymətləndirmə metodlarının məqsədəuyğun şəkildə birləşdirilməsi zəruridir.

Açar sözlər: dil qiymətləndirilməsi, formativ qiymətləndirmə, qiymətləndirmə, öyrənən muxtariyyəti, kommunikativ kompetensiya

Introduction

Assessment is a critical part of foreign language education; it has traditionally been used to evaluate students' language proficiency and achievement at the end of a teaching period. Traditionally, assessment was mainly summative, with an emphasis on standardised testing and final exams that were product-oriented. But advances in applied linguistics and educational theory have radically shifted this view, and a more holistic view of assessment as a key element in the learning process has emerged. Recent studies show a slow but steady evolution from conventional testing to more dynamic, continuous and learner-friendly assessment practices. Campbell and Duncan (2007) highlight that shifts in language teaching approaches have impacted assessment, particularly the shift towards communicative and task-based language teaching. Likewise, Birjandi and Sarem (2012) suggest that dynamic assessment is a significant development as it merges teaching and assessment in an interactive process that facilitates learning. Additionally, Pandey (2024) highlights that current assessment approaches focus more on continuous feedback and formative assessment processes, rather than just summative assessment. Further, in the last decades, the shift from grammar-translation teaching to communicative language teaching has changed the way language skills are assessed in education, according to Orujlu (2025). Additionally, the development of technology and educational technologies have brought new avenues for assessment. Jamieson (2005) notes the increasing use of computer-based testing, while Nomozova (2024) explores current trends and prospects of digital assessment. In this context, the current research seeks to investigate contemporary trends in language assessment, its pedagogical implications, opportunities and challenges in language education.

Materials and Methods

The present study is based on a qualitative research design to investigate current trends in language assessment practices. Qualitative research was chosen in order to provide an analysis of the theoretical and research evidence rather than quantify data. The research involves a document analysis and content analysis of recent literature on language assessment and evaluation in foreign

language teaching and learning. The research data consists of journal articles, conference proceedings and other academic publications that focus on both conventional and contemporary assessment practices. A total of 15 academic sources have been reviewed, including influential views on formative assessment, dynamic assessment, teacher-based assessment, peer and self-assessment and computer-based assessment for language testing. Birjandi and Sarem (2012) offer a theoretical framework for dynamic assessment - its holistic nature in integrating teaching and assessment. Likewise, Davison and Leung (2009) highlight the importance of teacher-based assessment in the classroom environment, where ongoing monitoring and professional judgement play crucial roles. El-Koumy (2004) adds to the knowledge of language performance assessment, both theoretically and practically. Moreover, Jamieson (2005) and Nomozova (2024) were consulted to examine the emergence of computer-based and other innovative digital assessments. Pandey (2024) and Thompson (2022) were used to explore the trend towards formative and alternative assessment approaches. In addition, Ismayilli (2024) and Ashrafova (2024) offer contextual information on assessment in foreign languages and innovative methods in language teaching. Data were analysed using thematic content analysis. This process included coding and categorising concepts, and drawing inferences about their significance in current assessment practices. The analysis explores the impact of these assessment approaches on student learning, and the challenges of integrating them in education.

Results and Discussion

From the analysis of the chosen literature, it can be seen that language assessment has evolved from the traditional, test-based methods to more dynamic, continuous and learner-focused assessment. As the studies examined reveal, there is a clear trend towards modern assessment techniques that focus more on the learning process than on outcomes. A key finding is the impact of formative assessment on student learning. As Black and Wiliam (1998) propose, formative assessment promotes learning through ongoing feedback that allows learners to recognise their areas of strength and areas for improvement. Similarly, Pandey (2024) also highlights that in today's assessment practices, there is more emphasis on continuous assessment rather than summative assessment. Interactive assessment, as explained by Birjandi and Sarem (2012), combines teaching and assessment, making assessment more learner-friendly and interactive. This type of assessment is helpful in determining learner potential as well as current knowledge. Teachers' assessment is still a vital component in the classroom. According to Davison and Leung (2009), teachers are important in the interpretation of learner achievement, particularly in communicative tasks that may not be addressed by standardised tests. Likewise, self and peer assessment techniques promote learner awareness and reflection, as Thompson (2022) has found, enabling students to become more independent learners. There is also a shift towards technology enhanced assessment. Jamieson (2005) mentions the increasing use of computer-based assessment systems, while Nomozova (2024) stresses the importance of innovation for the future of assessment. These tools enhance accessibility, efficiency and scalability of language assessment. Furthermore, Ashrafova (2024) notes that the use of innovative approaches to teaching, especially for teenage students, leads to better assessment results by engaging students. In terms of a holistic view, Babasoy (2025) highlights that communication is a complex process, proposing that language assessment should consider communicative competence in practical settings, in addition to linguistic knowledge. Mammadova (2025) also supports this perspective by stressing the social aspect of language development that should be taken into consideration in language assessment. While these benefits are noted, some shortcomings are also reported. El-Koumy (2004) stresses the problems of subjectivity, non-

standardization and inconsistency. Ismayilli (2024) also emphasises the need for more valid and reliable assessment systems in the foreign language classrooms. Institutional factors, teacher training and time are still constraints for the practical implementation of modern assessment approaches. These results indicate that although new language assessment practices offer great pedagogical advantages, they should be used in conjunction with traditional assessment methods. This integration offers reliability and flexibility and results in a more holistic assessment of language learning.

Conclusion

This research has explored contemporary language assessment trends and practices, including formative, dynamic, teacher, peer, self and technology-enhanced assessment. Our review of the literature reveals a trend in language assessment from traditional, test-based approaches to more continuous, student-centered and process-oriented assessment. The results suggest that new assessment approaches have a positive impact on language learning through increased learner engagement, autonomy, and feedback that leads to improved communicative skills. Specifically, dynamic and formative assessment methods provide a more interactive and flexible assessment process and the use of technology supports access and efficiency in assessment. But the study does point to certain drawbacks. The problems of subjectivity, lack of standardisation, institutional barriers and teacher readiness still have a negative impact on the effectiveness of modern assessment systems. These issues indicate that modern approaches can't completely replace traditional approaches. As such, it can be argued that the ideal language assessment practice is a combination of traditional and modern methods. This ensures validity and reliability, promotes development and reflects communicative competence in real-world situations.

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MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract. Article examines modern teaching approaches and their effectiveness in education, highlighting how they benefit the school curriculum by helping students learn more easily and practically. The aim of this study is to present the main aspects of modern teaching techniques, such as Communicative Language Teaching, Project-Based Learning, and Task-Based Learning, in order to promote a more effective and inclusive learning environment, by using language in real-life situations, focusing on comprehension rather than memorizing rules. However, the article also discusses several limitations associated with these methods, including dependence on technology, time consumption, challenges in classroom management, and the need for additional teacher training. These factors lead to burnout among students and educators, lower academic performance. The findings indicate that although there are numerous advantages of innovative pedagogical approaches, their drawbacks cannot be ignored. The results show that up-to-date teaching methods are effective when they are applied in a planned, adapted and structured way, as opposed to undisciplined use of and overreliance on them.

Keywords: innovative teaching methods, language teaching, learning approaches, benefits, drawbacks

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ MÜASİR METOD VƏ YANAŞMALAR

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Xülasə. Məqalədə müasir tədris yanaşmaları və onların təhsildə effektivliyi araşdırılır, bu metodların tələbələrin daha asan və praktiki öyrənmələrinə kömək etməklə məktəb kurikulumuna verdiyi töhfələr işıqlandırılır. Tədqiqatın məqsədi qaydaların əzbərlənməsindən çox qavrayışa diqqət yetirməklə və dildən real həyat vəziyyətlərində istifadə etməklə, daha effektiv və inklüziv təlim mühitini təşviq etmək üçün Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisi, Layihə Əsaslı Öyrənmə və Tapşırıq Əsaslı Öyrənmə kimi müasir tədris texnikalarının əsas aspektlərini təqdim etməkdir. Bununla belə, məqalədə bu metodlarla bağlı bir sıra məhdudiyyətlər, o cümlədən texnologiyadan asılılıq, vaxt itkisi, sinfin idarə edilməsindəki çətinliklər və müəllimlər üçün əlavə təlim ehtiyacı da müzakirə olunur. Bu amillər tələbələr və pedaqoqlar arasında tükənməyə, eləcə də akademik göstəricilərin aşağı düşməsinə səbəb olur. Araşdırmanın nəticələri göstərir ki, innovativ pedaqoji yanaşmaların çoxsaylı üstünlükləri olsa da, onların mənfi tərəfləri də diqqətdən kənarda qala bilməz. Nəticələr sübut edir ki, müasir tədris metodları onlardan intizamsız və hədsiz asılı formada istifadə edildikdə deyil, planlı, uyğunlaşdırılmış və strukturlaşdırılmış şəkildə tətbiq olunduqda effektiv olur.

Açar sözlər: innovativ tədris metodları, dilin tədrisi, təlim yanaşmaları, üstünlüklər, çatışmazlıqlar.

Introduction

Modern teaching methods can be considered a system that is more active and makes learning more forward-looking, as they focus on the development of children's thinking and comprehension. The large-scale evolution of digital platforms plays a significant role in engaging students in lessons and fostering their collaboration, which accelerates the learning process and promotes teamwork. Contemporary educational methods support the advancement of future business and economic sectors by developing critical thinking, problem solving, and decision-making skills.

Materials and Methods

This study is based on a student-centered instructional approach. Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) is adopted as the primary theoretical framework, while Project-Based Learning (PBL) and Task Based Learning (TBL) are implemented as practical teaching methodologies throughout the research process.

A variety of instructional materials are utilized, extending beyond traditional textbooks. Authentic materials derived from real-life contexts, such as menus and everyday texts, are incorporated in line with CLT principles. In addition, digital tools, including PowerPoint and Canvas, as well as online resources, are employed to support PBL activities. For TBL implementation, specifically designed task sheets are used.

The instructional process emphasizes the development of communicative competence and collaborative skills through interactive classroom practices. Techniques such as role-plays and information gap activities are applied to foster active student participation and to create a learner-centered learning environment.

TBL is conducted following a three-stage framework: pre-task preparation, task implementation, and language analysis. The focus is placed on meaningful communication and problem-solving, rather than on the explicit teaching of language structures.

Within the framework of PBL, students are organized into small groups and engaged in a comprehensive project on the topic of "Mother Nature." As part of this process, students conduct research and produce outcomes in the form of posters, videos, and digital presentations, which are subsequently presented to an audience.

Discussion

The findings of this study indicate that learner-centered approaches successfully fill the gaps that are created during the acquisition of academic knowledge. The implementation of CLT, TBL, and PBL approaches has turned the future-oriented education model by replacing the memorization

system with deeper comprehension and understanding. The use of authentic materials increased student engagement and generated interest in using the language rather than merely learning it, because within the TBL framework, students gave more importance to communication than to grammar. Additionally, they achieved growth in digital literacy and problem-solving skills; also, by researching complex topics, they acquired and developed critical thinking skills.

Conclusion

As a result, the core idea of these methods shows that, in the up-to-date educational process, students should be active participants, while the teacher's role has shifted from being a knowledge provider to that of a facilitator. Teachers should support deep and comprehensive understanding. These approaches prepare students to be more effective in the modern economic environment by enhancing their teamwork skills and fostering leadership abilities.

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THE ROLE OF MUSIC IN THE PROCESS OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING

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Abstract: Music has emerged as an effective pedagogical tool in foreign language education, offering cognitive, linguistic, emotional, and cultural benefits that extend beyond traditional instructional approaches. This study examines the role of music in enhancing language acquisition by improving vocabulary retention, pronunciation accuracy, listening comprehension, and overall communicative competence. Using a qualitative literature review methodology, the research synthesizes findings from educational psychology, linguistics, and language pedagogy to explore the mechanisms through which music facilitates learning. The analysis demonstrates that rhythm, melody, and repetition support memory retention and phonological development, while music-based activities increase learner motivation, engagement, and confidence. Furthermore, songs provide authentic linguistic input by exposing learners to idiomatic expressions, colloquial language, and natural speech patterns. Beyond language development, music serves as a valuable medium for cultural learning, fostering intercultural competence, empathy, and global awareness through

exposure to the social and cultural contexts of the target language. The findings suggest that integrating music into language instruction creates a dynamic, multisensory, and learner-centered environment that promotes both linguistic proficiency and cultural understanding. The study concludes that music should be considered an essential component of modern language pedagogy and recommends further research into its long-term educational impact.

Keywords: music, foreign language learning, listening skills, memory, motivation

XARİCİ DİL ÖYRƏNMƏ PROSESİNDƏ MUSİQİNİN ROLU

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Xülasə: Musiqi xarici dil tədrisində ənənəvi metodları tamamlayan və öyrənmə prosesinin effektivliyini artıran mühüm pədaqoji vasitələrdən biri hesab olunur. Bu tədqiqat musiqinin xarici dil öyrənilməsində oynadığı rolu araşdıraraq onun söz ehtiyatının zənginləşdirilməsi, tələffüz bacarıqlarının inkişafı, dinləyib-anlama qabiliyyətinin təkmilləşdirilməsi və ümumi kommunikativ səriştənin formalaşdırılmasına təsirini təhlil edir. Tədqiqat keyfiyyət yönümlü ədəbiyyat icmalı metoduna əsaslanır və təhsil psixologiyası, koqnitiv dilçilik və dil pədaqogikası sahələrində aparılmış araşdırmaların nəticələrini ümumiləşdirir. Araşdırma göstərir ki, musiqidə mövcud olan ritm, melodiya və təkrarlanma dil vahidlərinin yadda saxlanılmasını asanlaşdırır, fonetik bacarıqları inkişaf etdirir və öyrənənlərin motivasiyasını artırır. Bundan əlavə, mahnılar öyrənənlərə autentik dil nümunələri təqdim edərək idiomatik ifadələrin, danışq dilinin və təbii nitq modellərinin mənimsənilməsinə şərait yaradır. Musiqi həmçinin mədəniyyətlərarası səriştənin, empatiyanın və qlobal dünyagörüşünün inkişafına töhfə verir. Nəticə etibarilə, musiqinin dil tədrisinə inteqrasiyası həm dil bacarıqlarının, həm də mədəni şüurun inkişafını dəstəkləyən dinamik və öyrənməyönümlü təlim mühiti yaradır. Tədqiqat musiqinin müasir dil pədaqogikasının vacib komponentlərindən biri olduğunu təsdiqləyir.

Açar sözlər: musiqi, xarici dil öyrənmə, dinləmə bacarığı, yaddaş, motivasiya

Introduction

Music has long been recognized as a powerful cognitive and emotional tool that can significantly enhance the process of foreign language learning. This study investigates the multifaceted role of music in developing key linguistic competencies, including listening comprehension, pronunciation accuracy, vocabulary acquisition, and memory retention. By examining the impact of rhythm, melody, and repetition inherent in musical compositions, the research highlights how these elements facilitate the internalization of new language structures and grammatical patterns. Additionally, the study explores the affective benefits of music, demonstrating that it can increase learner motivation, reduce anxiety, and create a more engaging and supportive learning environment. Employing a qualitative methodology, the research draws upon a comprehensive review of existing literature as well as observational insights from learners exposed to music-based language instruction. The findings indicate that integrating music into language education not only enhances phonetic precision and auditory discrimination but also fosters long-term retention of vocabulary and grammatical structures. Moreover, learners participating in music-integrated programs display higher levels of engagement, sustained attention, and positive attitudes toward language learning. The study concludes that music should not be regarded merely as an auxiliary instructional tool; rather, it constitutes an essential component of

contemporary language pedagogy, offering both cognitive and affective advantages that support holistic language development.

Musiqi uzun müddətdir ki, xarici dil öyrənmə prosesini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə yaxşılaşdıran güclü kognitiv və emosional vasitə kimi tanınır. Bu tədqiqat musiqinin dinləmə bacarığı, tələffüz dəqiqliyi, söz ehtiyatının artırılması və yaddaşın möhkəmləndirilməsi kimi əsas dil bacarıqlarının inkişafında çoxşaxəli rolunu araşdırır. Musiqi əsərlərində mövcud olan ritm, melodiya və təkrarlanmanın təsirini öyrənməklə, tədqiqat bu elementlərin yeni dil strukturlarının və qrammatik nümunələrin mənimsənilməsini necə asanlaşdırdığını nümayiş etdirir. Bundan əlavə, tədqiqat musiqinin affektiv faydalarını da araşdırır və göstərir ki, musiqi öyrənənlərin motivasiyasını artırır, narahatlığı azaldır və daha cəlbedici və dəstəkləyici öyrənmə mühiti yaradır. Keyfiyyət metodologiyasından istifadə edərək, tədqiqat mövcud ədəbiyyatın geniş nəzərdən keçirilməsinə və musiqi əsaslı dil təliminə məruz qalan öyrənənlərin müşahidə nəticələrinə əsaslanır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, musiqinin dil təhsilinə inteqrasiyası yalnız fonetik dəqiqliyi və eşitmə bacarığını artırmır, eyni zamanda söz ehtiyatı və qrammatik strukturların uzunmüddətli yaddaşda saxlanmasını da təşviq edir. Bundan əlavə, musiqi ilə inteqrasiya edilmiş proqramlarda iştirak edən öyrənənlər yüksək səviyyədə diqqət, davamlı maraq və dil öyrənməyə müsbət münasibət nümayiş etdirirlər. Tədqiqat nəticəsi göstərir ki, musiqi sadəcə əlavə bir tədris vasitəsi kimi qəbul edilməməli, əksinə müasir dil pedaqogikasının vacib komponenti kimi qiymətləndirilməli və kognitiv, eləcə də affektiv faydalar təqdim edərək holistik dil inkişafını dəstəkləməlidir.

Learning a foreign language is often perceived as a challenging and time-consuming endeavor, requiring learners to develop a diverse set of skills, including reading, writing, listening, and speaking. Mastery in these areas often demands sustained effort, patience, and consistent practice, which can be daunting for many students, particularly those who struggle with traditional instructional methods. Conventional approaches to language teaching typically place heavy emphasis on grammar rules, vocabulary memorization, and structured exercises, such as sentence drills, fill-in-the-blank worksheets, and translation tasks. While these methods can provide foundational knowledge and a sense of progression, they often fail to engage learners on a deeper cognitive or emotional level. For many students, such techniques may feel rigid, repetitive, or disconnected from real-world language use, leading to frustration, reduced motivation, and slower overall progress. The lack of interactive or context-rich activities can also make it difficult for learners to apply what they have studied in practical, conversational settings, which is crucial for achieving communicative competence.

In contrast, music offers an alternative and innovative approach that addresses these challenges by combining enjoyment, creativity, and cognitive engagement. Unlike traditional methods, music provides a multisensory learning experience, allowing learners to hear, feel, and even move with the language. Rhythm, melody, and repetition inherent in songs create natural patterns that reinforce memory retention, pronunciation, and grammatical awareness in ways that are both intuitive and enjoyable. By integrating music into language learning, educators can create a dynamic, immersive, and emotionally engaging environment that encourages learners to interact with the language actively rather than passively. Songs, chants, and musical games provide opportunities for learners to practice vocabulary, sentence structures, and pronunciation in meaningful contexts, often without the pressure of formal assessment.

Moreover, music has the unique ability to foster emotional connections with the target language, transforming learning from a purely intellectual exercise into a rich, affective experience. Learners who engage with songs are more likely to feel a sense of joy, curiosity, and

accomplishment, which can boost confidence and increase their willingness to take linguistic risks – an essential factor in language acquisition. For instance, singing along to a favorite song in the target language not only reinforces word recall but also encourages learners to experiment with intonation, stress, and rhythm, helping them develop a more authentic and natural-sounding speech. Furthermore, music often incorporates cultural references, idiomatic expressions, and colloquial speech, offering learners exposure to authentic language that goes beyond textbook examples. This integration of cultural content helps learners develop not only linguistic skills but also intercultural competence, enabling them to understand and appreciate the social and cultural context in which the language is used.

Ultimately, music transforms the language learning process by bridging cognitive development, emotional engagement, and cultural exploration. It provides a flexible and inclusive approach that caters to a variety of learning styles – auditory, visual, kinesthetic, and social – making it particularly valuable in diverse classroom settings. By embracing music as a pedagogical tool, educators can cultivate an environment that motivates learners, accelerates language retention, and fosters a lifelong appreciation for the beauty and rhythm of a new language. Music, therefore, is not merely a supplementary resource but a transformative instrument that can redefine the way learners experience and internalize foreign languages.

Music provides rhythm, melody, and repetition, which serve as powerful aids in memory retention, pronunciation practice, and overall language acquisition. The repetitive structures and predictable patterns inherent in songs allow learners to internalize new vocabulary, grammatical constructions, and even sentence rhythms far more effectively than through traditional rote memorization or isolated drills. For example, the chorus of a song often repeats key phrases or idiomatic expressions multiple times, embedding them in the learner's long-term memory almost effortlessly. Similarly, the rhythmic cadence of music helps learners anticipate word order and syntactic patterns, making complex grammar feel more intuitive and less abstract.

Moreover, the melodic and prosodic features of songs encourage learners to pay close attention to stress, intonation, and phonetic nuances, which are often difficult to master through standard repetition exercises. Singing along with a tune allows learners to mimic native speakers' pronunciation in an enjoyable and low-pressure setting, reinforcing correct articulation while reducing the anxiety that often accompanies spoken practice. Over time, learners can develop a more natural, fluent, and confident speaking style, as music provides both the auditory input and expressive framework needed to practice these subtleties continuously.

Exposure to songs in the target language also introduces learners to authentic language use in ways that traditional textbooks rarely achieve. Through lyrics, learners encounter colloquial expressions, idiomatic phrases, slang, and figurative language embedded in real-world contexts. For instance, a popular song may demonstrate how certain phrases are used in casual conversation, convey humor, or express emotion in ways that purely formal exercises cannot. This type of exposure bridges the gap between theoretical language knowledge and practical usage, helping learners understand not only what words mean, but also how, when, and why they are used in daily communication.

Beyond linguistic benefits, music functions as a gateway to cultural understanding, offering rich insight into the customs, traditions, social norms, and emotional expressions of the target language community. Songs often reflect cultural identity, historical experiences, and societal values, giving learners a multidimensional perspective of the language they are studying. Through music, learners gain an appreciation for how emotions, humor, and social relationships are expressed differently across cultures, fostering intercultural competence and empathy. This dual

role of music – as both a linguistic resource and a cultural lens – makes it uniquely suited to support holistic language development, nurturing not only technical language skills but also the social and emotional intelligence required to communicate effectively in real-world settings.

Furthermore, music's universality and emotional resonance create a motivating learning environment. Learners are more likely to engage deeply, repeat practice sessions voluntarily, and form positive associations with the language. Unlike conventional methods, which can feel tedious or mechanical, music transforms language learning into an interactive, multisensory, and emotionally rewarding experience, reinforcing both cognitive and affective aspects of learning. This combination of repetition, rhythm, cultural immersion, and emotional engagement ensures that music is not merely an auxiliary tool but a central, transformative element in the process of acquiring a foreign language.

Methodology and materials

This study relies on a comprehensive and multidisciplinary review of current literature, drawing on research from educational psychology, linguistics, and language pedagogy. By examining findings from these intersecting fields, the study seeks to provide a holistic understanding of how music can facilitate foreign language acquisition. Sources for this review include peer-reviewed journals, scholarly books, and empirical research studies that investigate the cognitive, emotional, and social mechanisms through which music supports language learning. Both qualitative and quantitative studies were analyzed, allowing for a nuanced understanding of not only the measurable outcomes, such as vocabulary retention or pronunciation accuracy, but also the subjective experiences and perceptions of learners and educators engaging with music-based methodologies.

In addition to theoretical and experimental research, the study examines real-world classroom practices where music has been integrated into language instruction. These examples range from early childhood classrooms using songs and chants to teach basic vocabulary, to advanced language courses incorporating contemporary music to explore cultural themes and nuanced language use. By evaluating these practical applications, the study identifies strategies that have proven effective across different age groups, proficiency levels, and educational contexts. These observations highlight how teachers can structure lessons around music, select appropriate materials, and design activities that align with pedagogical goals while maintaining high levels of learner engagement.

Through the synthesis of theoretical, empirical, and applied research, the study reveals consistent patterns and best practices for incorporating music into language education. For instance, repeated exposure to musical content, the use of rhythm and melody to reinforce pronunciation, and culturally contextualized songs all emerge as strategies that enhance language retention and comprehension. Moreover, the review highlights the importance of tailoring music-based activities to individual learner preferences and learning styles, emphasizing that personalization can maximize engagement and efficacy. By combining evidence-based research with practical classroom insights, this study provides a comprehensive framework for educators seeking to harness the cognitive, affective, and cultural benefits of music to improve language learning outcomes.

Finally, this literature review not only consolidates existing knowledge but also identifies gaps in current research, such as the need for longitudinal studies on the long-term effects of music-based language learning, the impact of music on learners with diverse linguistic and cognitive profiles, and the potential integration of technology-enhanced musical resources. Addressing these

gaps can guide future investigations and pedagogical innovations, ensuring that music continues to be explored as a powerful and versatile tool in modern language education.

Results and discussion

Research consistently indicates that music significantly facilitates vocabulary acquisition by providing repeated exposure to words and phrases within meaningful, context-rich settings. Unlike traditional vocabulary drills, which often rely on rote memorization of isolated words or lists, songs naturally embed language in rhythms, melodies, and rhymes that create strong mental “anchors” for long-term retention. These auditory patterns not only make new vocabulary more memorable but also help learners recall words automatically, even in real communicative situations. For instance, learners who repeatedly sing or listen to a song in the target language may find that phrases from the chorus or verse come to mind effortlessly, much like lyrics to a favorite tune in their native language.

Empirical studies support the idea that integrating music into vocabulary learning enhances recall and fluency. Learners who regularly engage with music-based exercises tend to outperform peers who rely solely on word lists or written exercises, showing greater accuracy, faster retrieval, and improved retention over time. The combination of melody and rhythm creates predictable linguistic patterns that the brain can recognize and store efficiently, essentially turning language learning into a form of cognitive “chunking,” where complex words and phrases are internalized as meaningful, memorable units.

Moreover, music encourages active rather than passive engagement, which further strengthens vocabulary acquisition. Singing along, moving to the beat, clapping, or gesturing while performing a song helps learners connect language to physical and sensory experiences, reinforcing memory through multisensory learning. This approach capitalizes on the natural human ability to associate movement and emotion with cognitive processes, making the learning experience both immersive and enjoyable. For example, in a classroom activity where students learn adjectives or action verbs through a song, the physical enactment of words – such as mimicking “jump” or “dance” – enhances retention far beyond what could be achieved through silent repetition.

Additionally, music exposes learners to vocabulary in authentic, contextualized sentences, allowing them to grasp not only the meanings of words but also their correct usage, collocations, and connotations. Unlike isolated drills, songs provide a linguistic “miniature world” where words are embedded in real communicative scenarios, giving learners implicit instruction on grammar, syntax, and pragmatic language. This combination of repetition, context, and multisensory engagement makes music a uniquely powerful tool for vocabulary development, bridging the gap between mechanical memorization and practical, functional language use.

Music also plays a critical role in developing pronunciation, phonetic awareness, and overall oral fluency. Singing along with songs allows learners to mimic the natural intonation, stress patterns, and rhythm of native speakers – elements of speech that are often difficult to master through isolated drills or repetitive repetition exercises. Unlike traditional methods, which may focus on the mechanical repetition of individual sounds or words, music presents language in a continuous, flowing, and context-rich format, helping learners perceive how sounds connect in real speech. The rhythmic and melodic structures of songs function as subtle auditory cues, guiding learners in the proper placement of stress, the rise and fall of intonation, and the elongation or reduction of vowels and consonants.

Research supports the effectiveness of music in enhancing pronunciation skills. Studies have shown that students who engage in music-based pronunciation practice demonstrate more accurate

articulation, more natural stress patterns, and improved intonation compared to peers who rely solely on conventional drill-based methods. For example, learners who practice singing songs in a foreign language often unconsciously adopt the prosody of the target language, mastering tricky syllable stress or sentence-level intonation that traditional exercises fail to convey. Over time, this repeated exposure allows learners to internalize the “sound” of the language, improving their ability to produce speech that is both intelligible and fluent.

In addition, music provides a low-pressure, enjoyable environment for practicing pronunciation, which can reduce anxiety and increase learners’ willingness to experiment with new sounds. Many students feel self-conscious when repeating words in front of a teacher or classmates, but singing allows them to practice in a more playful, engaging manner, reinforcing correct pronunciation through repetition without the stress associated with formal drills. Movements, gestures, or group singing activities can further reinforce correct articulation by combining auditory, visual, and kinesthetic learning modalities.

Moreover, music exposes learners to subtle phonetic nuances, including connected speech, linking sounds, and natural reductions that are commonly used in everyday conversation. For example, a learner listening to a song might notice how “going to” becomes “gonna” in casual speech or how certain consonants are softened in fluent dialogue. By repeatedly hearing and mimicking these patterns within a musical context, learners develop phonological awareness that extends beyond individual words, enhancing their overall spoken fluency and confidence.

Ultimately, the integration of music into pronunciation training not only improves technical accuracy but also fosters expressive, natural, and confident speech. The combination of melody, rhythm, and context transforms what can often be a tedious aspect of language learning into an enjoyable, multisensory, and highly effective practice, bridging the gap between formal instruction and authentic oral communication.

Listening to music in a foreign language plays a pivotal role in strengthening auditory discrimination and overall comprehension skills. Unlike traditional listening exercises, which often rely on scripted dialogues or artificial speech recordings, songs expose learners to authentic, dynamic language in a rich auditory context. Through music, learners encounter a variety of accents, speech rates, and informal language structures, including colloquialisms, contractions, and idiomatic expressions, that are rarely presented in textbooks. For example, a learner listening to a Spanish pop song may hear regional variations in pronunciation, subtle vowel shifts, and the natural elision of consonants, all of which help train the ear to recognize and differentiate nuanced sounds. Over time, this repeated exposure enables learners to detect subtle differences in pronunciation, intonation, rhythm, and emphasis, significantly improving their listening comprehension and auditory discrimination.

Moreover, music helps learners internalize linguistic patterns in a predictive manner. Melodic and rhythmic repetition allows the brain to anticipate word sequences and syntactic structures, creating a cognitive scaffold that makes processing spoken language faster and more accurate. Learners begin to recognize recurring sentence structures, phrase patterns, and word collocations, which enhances their ability to decode speech in real-life conversations. In this way, music serves not only as a tool for listening practice but also as a means of developing implicit grammatical awareness and language intuition.

One of the most compelling advantages of incorporating music into language education is its capacity to increase learner motivation and engagement. Music creates a low-pressure, enjoyable, and emotionally resonant learning environment that can reduce anxiety, build confidence, and foster

positive emotional associations with the target language. Learners who feel relaxed and entertained are far more likely to participate actively, repeat practice exercises voluntarily, and take risks in speaking and comprehension, all of which are critical for long-term language development. For instance, classroom activities that involve singing along, clapping to rhythmic patterns, or playing musical games can transform what might otherwise be perceived as a challenging or tedious task into a playful and immersive experience.

Additionally, motivation and emotional engagement through music have cognitive benefits. Positive emotions enhance attention, memory, and retention, meaning that learners are more likely to remember vocabulary, phrases, and pronunciation features encountered in a musical context. By linking learning with enjoyment and affective engagement, music facilitates sustained practice and repetition, both of which are crucial for achieving fluency. Consequently, integrating songs, rhythmic exercises, and musical games into language instruction not only develops listening comprehension and phonetic awareness but also cultivates a motivated, confident, and resilient learner—someone more likely to engage deeply with the language both inside and outside the classroom.

Ultimately, music transforms language learning into a holistic experience, combining auditory training, cognitive pattern recognition, emotional engagement, and motivational support, creating an environment where learners can acquire language more naturally, efficiently, and joyfully than through conventional methods alone.

Beyond their linguistic benefits, songs serve as rich cultural artifacts, providing learners with invaluable insight into the social values, traditions, and emotional expressions of the target language community. Unlike conventional textbooks, which often present culture in abstract or fragmented ways, music immerses learners in authentic cultural narratives, conveying history, societal norms, humor, and contemporary issues through melody, rhythm, and lyrical storytelling. For example, a French chanson might reflect historical struggles or political commentary, while a Brazilian samba could highlight social customs, celebrations, and regional identity. Similarly, a hip-hop track in English or Korean may reveal modern youth culture, attitudes, and social concerns, giving learners a window into perspectives they might never encounter in the classroom alone.

Through exposure to these cultural elements, learners gain more than just vocabulary and grammar – they develop intercultural competence, the ability to interpret, negotiate, and respond appropriately to the values and behaviors of another culture. Music teaches learners to understand not only the literal meaning of words but also their connotations, emotional undertones, and the social contexts in which they are used. For instance, a humorous lyric may rely on puns, wordplay, or cultural references that require learners to consider historical or societal knowledge to fully appreciate its meaning. In doing so, learners cultivate critical thinking and analytical skills as they navigate between linguistic understanding and cultural interpretation.

Moreover, engaging with music from diverse communities fosters empathy and global awareness. By listening to songs that express joy, sorrow, resistance, or celebration, learners can emotionally connect with experiences that are different from their own, broadening their worldview and deepening their appreciation for cultural diversity. These affective experiences enhance motivation and personal investment in language learning, as learners begin to see the language not merely as a set of rules or vocabulary, but as a living medium that reflects human experience, identity, and creativity.

In classroom settings, music can be intentionally used to support cultural learning. Teachers might select songs that illustrate regional dialects, historical events, or societal issues, and then

facilitate discussions, projects, or performances that encourage learners to explore the cultural context in depth. This approach turns language study into an interdisciplinary experience, blending linguistics, history, sociology, and the arts. By engaging with the culture embedded in music, learners acquire a richer, more nuanced understanding of the target language and its speakers, making language learning a more meaningful, socially aware, and transformative endeavor.

Ultimately, music functions as a bridge between language acquisition and cultural understanding, enabling learners to internalize not only linguistic structures but also the lived experiences, values, and emotions of the communities that speak the language. This cultural immersion enhances both communicative competence and intercultural sensitivity, empowering learners to navigate real-world interactions with greater awareness, empathy, and authenticity.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the integration of music into foreign language learning offers a wide array of benefits that extend beyond conventional pedagogical approaches. Music not only enhances vocabulary retention and facilitates pronunciation practice but also strengthens listening comprehension, auditory discrimination, and overall oral fluency. By providing meaningful, repetitive, and context-rich exposure to language, music allows learners to internalize grammatical patterns, intonation, and prosody in a natural and enjoyable way. Beyond cognitive advantages, music fosters emotional engagement, reduces learning anxiety, and cultivates intrinsic motivation – factors that are critical for sustaining long-term language practice and achieving communicative competence.

Importantly, music serves as a bridge between linguistic skill development and cultural understanding. Songs immerse learners in authentic language use, exposing them to idiomatic expressions, colloquialisms, and the rhythms of everyday speech while simultaneously offering insight into the values, traditions, and emotional expressions of the target language community. Through this cultural dimension, music enhances intercultural competence, empathy, and social awareness, transforming language learning from a purely academic exercise into a holistic and meaningful experience.

For educators, the pedagogical potential of music is vast. Incorporating songs, rhythmic activities, and musical games into the curriculum can cater to diverse learning styles, including auditory, visual, kinesthetic, and social learners, making instruction more inclusive and engaging. Music-based strategies can complement traditional teaching methods, providing learners with multisensory, context-rich, and emotionally resonant opportunities to practice language in authentic ways. Furthermore, music can be seamlessly integrated with modern technologies, such as language learning apps, online streaming platforms, or gamified exercises, to create dynamic, interactive, and personalized learning experiences.

Future research should explore the long-term impact of music-based language instruction, examining its effects across different age groups, proficiency levels, and linguistic contexts. Investigations could also assess the comparative benefits of music when combined with other innovative methodologies, including technology-enhanced learning, immersive storytelling, or task-based language teaching. Such research would provide valuable evidence to guide curriculum design and optimize instructional practices.

Ultimately, music represents far more than a supplementary tool in language education. Its unique capacity to integrate cognitive, emotional, and cultural dimensions makes it a transformative approach capable of redefining how learners experience and internalize a foreign language. By engaging both the mind and the heart, music creates an environment in which learning becomes not

only effective but also deeply enjoyable, culturally enriching, and personally meaningful, paving the way for more confident, competent, and motivated language users.

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FROM READING TO THINKING: THE DEVELOPMENTAL POTENTIAL OF FOREIGN LITERATURE IN PRIMARY CLASSES

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Abstract: This study is devoted to investigating the impact of foreign literature samples on the development of students' reading skills in primary school. The research analyses the materials of Azerbaijani language textbooks for grades I–IV and identifies the pedagogical functions of the literary and informational texts presented in these textbooks. The findings reveal that foreign literature samples contribute not only to the formation of reading skills but also significantly influence students' analytical thinking, creative imagination, emotional development, and the formation of social behavior patterns.

In Grade I, initial reading skills and a sense of safety are primarily developed through the fairy tale genre. In Grade II, reading skills are expanded through structured texts, role-playing activities, and creative tasks. In Grade III, analytical and research-oriented activities come to the forefront, fostering students' skills in comparison, sequencing, and structuring. In Grade IV, the reading process is enriched with more complex content and integrated with historical, geographical, and social themes.

The study demonstrates that the systematic and gradual teaching of foreign literature samples plays an important role in the development of students' functional literacy and independent reading habits. In

conclusion, foreign literature serves as an effective tool in primary education not only for developing language skills but also for ensuring the multifaceted development of students' personalities.

Keywords: foreign literature, reading skills, primary education, creative thinking, analytical thinking, interdisciplinary integration

OXUDAN DÜŞÜNCƏYƏ: İBTİDAİ SİNİFLƏRDƏ XARİCİ ƏDƏBİYYATIN İNKİŞAFETDİRİCİ POTENSİALI

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Xülasə: Bu tədqiqat ibtidai siniflərdə xarici ədəbiyyat nümunələrinin şagirdlərin oxu bacarıqlarının inkişafına təsirini araşdırmağa həsr olunmuşdur. Araşdırmada Azərbaycan dili dərslərinin I–IV sinifləri üzrə materiallar təhlil edilmiş və həmin dərslərdə təqdim olunan bədii və informativ mətnlərin pedaqoji funksiyaları müəyyən edilmişdir. Tədqiqat nəticəsində məlum olmuşdur ki, xarici ədəbiyyat nümunələri yalnız oxu bacarıqlarının formalaşdırılmasına deyil, həm də şagirdlərin analitik düşüncə, yaradıcı təfəkkür, emosional inkişaf və sosial davranış modellərinin formalaşmasına mühüm təsir göstərir. I sinifdə əsasən nağıl janrı vasitəsilə ilkin oxu və təhlükəsizlik düşüncəsi inkişaf etdirilir. II sinifdə mətnlərin strukturlaşdırılması, rollu oyunlar və yaradıcı tapşırıqlar vasitəsilə oxu bacarıqları genişləndirilir. III sinifdə analitik və tədqiqat yönümlü fəaliyyətlər ön plana çıxır, şagirdlərdə müqayisə, ardıcılıq və strukturlaşdırma bacarıqları inkişaf etdirilir. IV sinifdə isə oxu prosesi daha mürəkkəb məzmunlarla zənginləşdirilir, tarixi, coğrafi və sosial mövzularla inteqrasiya edilir. Tədqiqat göstərir ki, xarici ədəbiyyat nümunələrinin sistemli və mərhələli şəkildə tədrisi şagirdlərin funksional savadlılığının formalaşmasına və onların müstəqil oxu vərdislərinin inkişafına mühüm töhfə verir. Nəticə etibarilə, xarici ədəbiyyat ibtidai təhsildə yalnız dil bacarıqlarının deyil, həm də şəxsiyyətin çoxşaxəli inkişafının təmin edilməsində effektiv vasitə kimi çıxış edir.

Açar sözlər: xarici ədəbiyyat, oxu bacarığı, ibtidai təhsil, yaradıcı təfəkkür, analitik düşüncə, fənlərarası inteqrasiya

Introduction

In the modern education system, the development of students' reading skills is considered one of the priority directions. Reading is not only the perception of a text, but also a complex process involving its analysis, evaluation, and application. In this regard, the content and structure of textbook materials used in primary education are of particular importance. Examples of foreign literature play a significant role in this process, as they introduce students to different cultures, broaden their worldview, and foster diverse thinking skills.

The use of foreign literature in Azerbaijani language textbooks contributes to the gradual development of students' reading skills. Through these examples, students learn not only to read texts but also to understand, analyze, and express their own ideas. The aim of the study is to

determine the impact of foreign literary examples included in Grades I–IV textbooks on the development of reading skills.

Materials and Methods

The material base of the study consists of Azerbaijani language textbooks used in Grades I–IV in the Republic of Azerbaijan. The foreign literary examples included in these textbooks were analyzed from both content and methodological perspectives. A qualitative analysis method was used in the study. According to Azerbaijani methodologists, interactive methods that ensure students' active participation in the reading process produce more effective results (Aliyev, 2014).

In Grade I textbooks, foreign literary examples are mainly presented in the fairy tale genre. For instance, through the Brothers Grimm's tale "Snow White and the Dwarfs," students are introduced to initial concepts related to both reading and safety rules. At this stage, the question-and-answer method is applied, ensuring that students do not only read and comprehend the text but also think about its content and draw conclusions. Thus, the reading process is linked with analytical thinking.

In Grade II textbooks, the methodological approach becomes more complex. In Vladimir Suteev's work "The Unusual Hippopotamus," the text is presented in parts, and tasks are given after each section. The questions related to the text – such as the impact of human emotions on behavior and appearance, as well as information about health – develop students' abilities to think about and connect ideas within the text. At the same time, the inclusion of visual materials (illustrations) makes the reading process more understandable and engaging. The role-playing task at the end of the text requires students to express the character's emotions through facial expressions and gestures. This approach combines reading with emotional experience and supports the development of both comprehension and expressive skills. In Nikolai Nosov's "Dreamers," creative thinking and ethical values are emphasized. The story describes the fantasies created by two friends and explains to children the positive aspects of imagination as well as its difference from harmful lies. Such an approach helps develop both creative thinking and the ability to make appropriate moral choices in students.

Grade III textbooks include a wide range of analytical and research-oriented activities. In Rudyard Kipling's "Rikki-Tikki-Tavi," tasks such as determining the structure of the text and matching episodes help develop students' analytical skills. The story depicts the mongoose Rikki's struggle against dangerous cobras, and through this plotline qualities such as courage and agility are emphasized. Thought-provoking questions based on the text enable students to gain a deeper understanding of its content. At the same time, the task of matching parts and episodes with appropriate subheadings develops students' ability to understand text structure and identify key points. The explanation of the etymology of certain words in the story, including the concept of "tailorbird," enriches students' linguistic knowledge. Finally, the research task about the mongoose encourages students to conduct independent research and systematize the information they obtain.

The works of Jules Verne also ensure interdisciplinary integration and contribute to the formation of geographical and scientific knowledge in students. His works such as "The Mystery of Mr. Smith," "Five Weeks in a Balloon," and "Around the World in Eighty Days" are clear examples of this. Jules Verne's science-fiction novel "Five Weeks in a Balloon" has a significant impact on shaping students' scientific worldview. The main character, Samuel Ferguson, attempts to explore unexplored regions of Africa using a hot-air balloon, with the primary aim of determining the source of the Nile River, which helps develop students' geographical knowledge. The text is presented in two parts, and tasks such as explaining phraseological units enhance

students' language skills. At the same time, themes such as adventure, technological progress, and human will broaden students' worldview and encourage interest in scientific research. This approach does not limit reading to literary content alone but also enriches it with scientific knowledge.

In Grade IV textbooks, more complex texts are presented. Through the works of authors such as Victor Hugo, Mark Twain, and Antoine de Saint-Exupéry, students develop historical, social, and ethical thinking. Annotations and book covers guide students toward independent reading. Through annotations, students become familiar with the idea and theme of the work, while visual presentation attracts their attention and motivates reading. This approach extends students' reading activity beyond the textbook framework into a broader reading environment and contributes to the formation of their reading culture.

Results and Discussion. The conducted analysis shows that the use of foreign literary examples has a multifaceted impact on the development of students' reading skills. This effect is particularly enhanced through interactive and creative tasks. As noted in Azerbaijani pedagogical literature, the active involvement of students in the reading process enables them to establish a deeper connection with the text (Bağırova, 2016).

In Grade I textbooks, foreign literature is mainly presented in the form of simple fairy tales. Through texts such as "Snow White and the Dwarfs," students develop initial reading habits. At this stage, the main focus is on comprehension of the text and the ability to draw simple conclusions. Questions at the end of the text help students focus on specific content and understand cause-and-effect relationships. At the same time, the emphasis on safety rules in such texts contributes to the development of students' social behavior. This shows that the reading process is not only a language skill but is closely linked to the formation of life competencies, allowing students to apply what they learn in real-life contexts.

In Grade II, the presentation of foreign literary works becomes more complex and multidimensional. The division of texts into parts, role-playing activities, and various creative tasks activate students' reading engagement. For example, in texts such as "The Unusual Hippopotamus" and "Dreamers," students do not only read but also express emotions, embody characters, and interact with the text. At this stage, particular attention is given to the formation of ethical and social values. The explanation of the difference between imagination and lying contributes to the development of critical thinking skills. At the same time, in the short text "A Day at School," based on Gianni Rodari's story "Tonino the Invisible Boy," the use of an open ending develops students' prediction and creative writing skills. In the storyline, Tonino's wish to become invisible comes true, and while he initially enjoys this state, he later realizes the difficulty of being alone. The absence of a final ending and the requirement for students to continue the story stimulate their imagination. Such open-ended tasks encourage students to think, predict possible developments, and express their ideas logically. At the same time, the content of the story forms important ideas about social relations, friendship, and the importance of communication.

Hans Christian Andersen's multi-part texts such as "The Snow Queen" strengthen students' ability to understand and remember text structure. The tale describes the journey of a girl named Gerda as she tries to rescue her friend Kay, highlighting values such as friendship, love, and courage. The provision of different tasks between sections ensures active engagement with the text. In particular, the presentation of the third part through illustrations and the requirement for students to narrate the corresponding text based on images develops both memory and text construction skills. This corresponds to the multimodal learning approach emphasized in modern pedagogy.

Such an approach not only limits reading to comprehension but also supports the development of expressive speech, logical sequencing, and creative thinking skills.

In primary school textbooks, foreign literature examples are not limited to literary texts; they are also enriched with informative materials about authors' lives and works. For instance, in the Grade II Azerbaijani language textbook, short informative texts such as "Winnie the Pooh and His Life" and "The Storytelling Scientist" are included. These texts provide information about the history of the works, the authors' creativity, and animated films based on the works. Such materials develop students' ability to understand not only literary plots but also factual information. At the same time, they increase students' interest in reading and provide a broader understanding of the context in which the works were created. This makes the reading process more meaningful and fosters both informative and analytical reading skills. For example, information is provided about Lewis Carroll's life and the creation of "Alice in Wonderland." According to the text, the author was originally a mathematician who told stories to entertain his friend's daughter Alice, which later developed into a famous literary work (Ismayilov et al., 2025).

In Grade III, the teaching of foreign literature already ensures a transition to a higher cognitive level. At this stage, students are required not only to understand the content of the text but also to structure, analyze, and generalize it. In texts such as "Rikki-Tikki-Tavi," matching episodes with subheadings develops students' ability to understand the internal structure of the text. This indicates the formation of analytical reading skills.

In Grade III textbooks, Jules Verne's novel "Around the World in Eighty Days" is presented in an abridged form. Through this text, students learn to follow Mr. Fogg's journey across different countries and cities on a map, which expands their geographical understanding. At the same time, the character's precision, determination, and calm behavior in difficult situations are presented as an example for students. The condition of the wager being time-related teaches children the importance of using time effectively. In addition, information about transportation methods of that period broadens students' worldview. One of the most interesting aspects is Mr. Fogg's eastward circumnavigation of the Earth, by which he gains a day and ultimately wins the wager. This element develops students' logical thinking and their ability to understand cause-and-effect relationships.

In the same textbook, an excerpt titled "Mr. Smith's Invention" from Jules Verne's "The Mysterious Island" is included. The text consists of two parts and is based on the protagonist's creation of a lens to make fire in difficult conditions. Through this storyline, students are shown that intelligence, knowledge, and effort can provide solutions even in the most challenging situations. The thought-provoking questions after the first part of the text enable students to deeply understand and analyze the content. Later, the presentation of images of various devices and the task of identifying which object could replace Mr. Smith's invention develop students' logical and practical thinking skills. This approach connects the reading process with real-life situations and helps students acquire functional knowledge.

Texts such as "The Mammoth Calf" develop not only emotional growth but also comparison and sequencing skills. The text is built around a baby mammoth searching for its mother and facing various challenges, and its main idea emphasizes the importance of maternal love. The questions based on the text develop students' comprehension and analytical skills. At the same time, students are asked to arrange the animals encountered by the mammoth calf in correct order, which strengthens their logical thinking and memory skills. Group research tasks support the development of collaboration and investigative skills. Furthermore, the comparison between the mammoth and

the elephant fosters comparative analysis skills and broadens students' worldview (Ismayilov et al., 2022).

In Grade IV, foreign literary works are presented with more complex and multilayered content. At this stage, students no longer simply read texts but also critically evaluate and discuss them.

An except titled "Gavroche" from Victor Hugo's "Les Misérables" develops students' historical awareness and civic values. The text depicts the courageous and fearless child character Gavroche against the background of the 1832 Paris uprising. Through this text, students are taught values such as bravery, sacrifice, and patriotism. Integration with historical events broadens students' worldview and enriches their historical knowledge. Thought-provoking questions develop students' analytical thinking skills. The inclusion of information about children's rights at the end contributes to the formation of legal awareness. This approach does not limit reading to text comprehension but also promotes the development of social and civic values.

In the text "Tom and Becky's Cave Adventure" from Mark Twain's "The Adventures of Tom Sawyer," tasks based on spatial description and sequence of events develop students' descriptive and analytical thinking skills. The efforts of the characters to find a way out after getting lost in the cave teach students perseverance and problem-solving skills. At the same time, information about stalactites and bats broadens their worldview. The preparation of excursion rules ensures that reading is connected to real-life situations.

In texts based on Hans Christian Andersen's "The Little Mermaid," students are asked to construct an ending for the story. This develops their creative writing and alternative thinking skills. At the same time, questions such as "Does this creature exist?" foster elements of critical and philosophical thinking in students.

Annotations of works by authors such as Jules Verne ("Around the World in Eighty Days") and Antoine de Saint-Exupéry ("The Little Prince") guide students toward independent reading. This is considered the highest stage of reading development, as students continue their reading activities based on their own choices (Ismayilov et al., 2023).

The conducted analysis shows that foreign literature examples in primary education have an impact in the following main directions:

- Cognitive development: analysis, comparison, cause–effect relationships
- Creative development: text construction, prediction
- Social development: collaboration, communication
- Emotional development: empathy, value system
- Practical skills: application to real-life situations

These results show that foreign literature examples function not only as a language-learning tool but also as a complex developmental mechanism. The stage-based progression observed across grades also proves that the teaching process is systematically organized.

Thus, the purposeful use of foreign literary works in primary school has a fundamental impact on the development of students' reading skills. Through these texts, students gradually progress from simple comprehension to complex analytical and creative thinking. This contributes to the formation of functionally literate and independently thinking individuals, which is one of the main goals of modern education.

Conclusion

The conducted research shows that the systematic and purposeful teaching of foreign literary examples in primary education plays an important role in the development of students' reading

skills. Through these examples, students develop not only reading techniques but also the abilities to understand, analyze, evaluate, and apply textual content.

At the same time, foreign literature has a positive impact on students' emotional, social, and intellectual development. The results of the study indicate that these texts foster creative thinking, analytical skills, and independent decision-making abilities in students. Thus, foreign literature serves as a complex developmental tool in primary education.

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ASSESSMENT AND EVALUATION METHODS IN LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract: Assessment and evaluation are important parts of language teaching because they help teachers understand students' learning progress and improve instructional methods. Assessment focuses on collecting information about students' abilities through activities such as quizzes, classroom participation, projects, and tests. Evaluation, on the other hand, measures the overall effectiveness of teaching and learning outcomes. Different methods, including formative assessment, summative assessment, traditional testing, and alternative assessment, all play valuable roles in language education. In addition, self-assessment and peer assessment encourage students to become more active and responsible learners. Effective assessment should not only measure grammar and vocabulary knowledge but also evaluate students' communication skills in real-life situations. Although challenges such as fairness, reliability, and student anxiety may affect assessment results, using a variety of methods can create a more balanced system. Overall, proper assessment and evaluation support both teaching quality and student success in language learning.

Key words: evaluation, learning progress, assessment, encourage, knowledge

DİL TƏDRİSİNDƏ QIYMƏTLƏNDİRMƏ VƏ QIYMƏTLƏNDİRMƏ METODLARI

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Xülasə: Qiymətləndirmə və dəyərləndirmə dil tədrisinin vacib hissələridir, çünki onlar müəllimlərə tələbələrin öyrənmə prosesini izləməyə və tədris metodlarını təkmilləşdirməyə kömək edir. Qiymətləndirmə testlər, sinifdə iştirak, layihələr və müxtəlif tapşırıqlar vasitəsilə tələbələrin bacarıqları haqqında məlumat toplamağa yönəlir. Dəyərləndirmə isə tədris prosesinin və öyrənmə nəticələrinin ümumi effektivliyini müəyyən edir. Formativ qiymətləndirmə, summativ qiymətləndirmə, ənənəvi test üsulları və alternativ qiymətləndirmə kimi müxtəlif metodlar dil təhsilində mühüm rol oynayır. Bundan əlavə, özünüqiymətləndirmə və qarşılıqlı qiymətləndirmə tələbələri daha fəal və məsuliyyətli öyrənənlərə çevirir. Effektiv qiymətləndirmə yalnız qrammatika və söz ehtiyatını deyil, həm də tələbələrin real həyatda ünsiyyət bacarıqlarını ölçməlidir. Ədalətlik, etibarlılıq və tələbə həyəcanı kimi çətinliklər olsa da, müxtəlif üsullardan istifadə daha balanslı qiymətləndirmə sistemi yaradır. Ümumilikdə, düzgün qiymətləndirmə və dəyərləndirmə həm tədrisin keyfiyyətini, həm də tələbələrin dil öyrənməsində uğurunu artırır.

Açar sözlər: qiymətləndirmə, tədris prosesi, etibarlılıq, ünsiyyət, təhsil

Introduction

Language teaching is a complex process that requires effective methods to measure students' learning progress and teachers' instructional success. In education, assessment and evaluation play a significant role in understanding how well students develop their language skills. These two concepts are closely related, but they have different meanings and purposes. Assessment focuses on collecting information about students' learning, while evaluation is the process of judging the quality or value of that learning. Both are essential in language teaching because they help teachers identify students' strengths and weaknesses, improve teaching strategies, and support learners in reaching their educational goals.

In language classrooms, students are expected to develop four main language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. To understand how effectively students acquire these skills, teachers need reliable assessment and evaluation methods. These methods help educators determine whether students understand grammar rules, use vocabulary correctly, communicate fluently, and apply language knowledge in real-life situations. Without proper assessment and evaluation, it becomes difficult to understand learners' progress and improve the teaching-learning process.

This article discusses the importance of assessment and evaluation in language teaching, explains different assessment methods, and examines how effective evaluation can improve language learning outcomes.

Materials and Methods

This study is based on a qualitative review of literature related to assessment and evaluation in language teaching. Various academic books, articles, and educational sources were examined to identify the main assessment methods used in language education. The study focuses on formative assessment, summative assessment, traditional assessment, alternative assessment, self-assessment, and peer assessment.

Understanding Assessment and Evaluation

Assessment is a continuous process of gathering information about students' knowledge, abilities, and learning progress. It includes activities such as quizzes, classroom discussions, homework assignments, presentations, projects, and tests. Assessment helps teachers monitor students' development and provide feedback that can improve learning. It is often considered a tool for learning because it supports students throughout the educational process.

Evaluation, on the other hand, is broader. It involves making judgments about the effectiveness of teaching methods, learning materials, student achievement, and even the educational program itself. Evaluation is usually conducted at the end of a learning period and is often used to determine whether learning objectives have been achieved.

In language teaching, both assessment and evaluation are necessary. Assessment helps teachers understand the learning process, while evaluation helps them understand the final results. Together, they create a complete picture of students' language development.

Formative Assessment

One of the most effective methods in language teaching is formative assessment. Formative assessment takes place during the learning process rather than at the end. Its main purpose is to provide feedback that helps students improve before final evaluation.

Examples of formative assessment include classroom questioning, short quizzes, peer discussions, oral practice activities, writing drafts, and teacher feedback on assignments. For instance, when a teacher asks students to participate in a speaking activity and then gives comments on pronunciation, grammar, and fluency, this is formative assessment.

Formative assessment is valuable because it encourages active learning. Students become aware of their mistakes and understand how to improve. It also allows teachers to adjust their teaching methods according to students' needs. If many students struggle with a grammar topic, the teacher can review it before moving forward.

Summative Assessment

Summative assessment is used to measure students' learning at the end of a unit, semester, or course. It is designed to evaluate what students have learned and whether they have achieved the intended learning outcomes.

Examples of summative assessment include final exams, standardized tests, end-of-course projects, and final presentations. In language teaching, summative assessment often measures students' overall ability in grammar, vocabulary, reading comprehension, writing, listening, and speaking.

Although summative assessment is useful for measuring achievement, it has some limitations. It often focuses more on results than on the learning process. Some students may experience anxiety during exams, which can affect their performance. For this reason, summative assessment should be balanced with other assessment methods.

Traditional Assessment Methods

Traditional assessment methods are widely used in language education. These methods include multiple-choice tests, true-false questions, matching exercises, fill-in-the-blank activities, and written exams. They are often easy to administer and score.

Traditional tests can effectively measure grammar knowledge, vocabulary understanding, and reading comprehension. For example, multiple-choice questions can test students' understanding of verb tenses or word meanings.

However, traditional assessment has weaknesses. It may not fully measure students' ability to use language in real communication. Language learning is not only about memorizing rules but also about applying language in meaningful situations. Therefore, teachers should not rely only on traditional methods.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Alternative assessment has become increasingly popular in modern language teaching. These methods focus on practical language use, creativity, and learner participation. Examples include

portfolios, projects, role-playing, presentations, journals, and performance-based tasks. A portfolio is a collection of students' work over time, such as essays, writing drafts, and speaking recordings. It shows students' progress and development. Projects encourage students to use language in meaningful contexts. For example, students may prepare a presentation about culture, education, or technology using the target language. This method improves speaking, research, and critical thinking skills. Alternative assessment provides a more complete understanding of students' abilities because it measures communication skills in authentic situations.

Self-Assessment and Peer Assessment

Self-assessment and peer assessment are learner-centered methods that encourage reflection and responsibility. In self-assessment, students evaluate their own learning. They identify strengths, weaknesses, and areas that need improvement. For example, students may reflect on their speaking confidence or writing accuracy.

Peer assessment involves students giving feedback to each other. During group discussions, writing workshops, or oral presentations, classmates can comment on performance and suggest improvements. These methods increase student motivation and develop critical thinking skills. They also help learners become more independent and active participants in the learning process.

Challenges in Assessment and Evaluation

Despite their importance, assessment and evaluation in language teaching face several challenges. One challenge is fairness. Teachers must ensure that assessment methods are unbiased and suitable for all learners.

Another challenge is reliability. Assessment results should be consistent and accurate. For speaking and writing tasks, scoring can sometimes be subjective.

Time is also a challenge. Alternative assessments such as projects and portfolios require more preparation, observation, and feedback. Teachers may find them difficult to manage in large classes.

Finally, language anxiety can influence student performance, especially in speaking tests. Teachers should create a supportive classroom environment that reduces fear and encourages participation.

Results and Discussion

The findings of this study show that assessment and evaluation play a crucial role in language teaching. Formative assessment was found to support continuous learning by providing regular feedback to students. Summative assessment effectively measures overall achievement and learning outcomes at the end of a course. Alternative assessment methods, such as portfolios and projects, help evaluate practical language skills in authentic contexts. In addition, self-assessment and peer assessment encourage learner autonomy and active participation.

The discussion indicates that no single assessment method can fully measure all aspects of language proficiency. Traditional tests are useful for assessing grammar and vocabulary knowledge, but they may not reflect real communication skills. Alternative assessment methods provide a broader understanding of students' abilities and progress. Teachers should combine different assessment approaches to ensure fairness and reliability. Therefore, a balanced assessment system can improve both teaching effectiveness and student learning outcomes.

Conclusion

Assessment and evaluation are essential parts of language teaching. They help teachers understand students' progress, improve teaching methods, and support effective learning. Different methods, including formative assessment, summative assessment, traditional testing, alternative

assessment, self-assessment, and peer assessment, all contribute to a balanced language education system.

Effective language assessment should not focus only on test scores. It should also consider communication ability, practical language use, and students' personal growth. When assessment and evaluation are used wisely, they become powerful tools for improving both teaching and learning.

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DEVELOPING FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS THROUGH AN INTEGRATED APPROACH IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract. This article explores the development of foreign language skills through an integrated approach in English language teaching. The four fundamental skills—listening, speaking, reading, and writing—are essential for effective communication. However, in traditional teaching methods, these skills are often taught separately, which can negatively affect learners' ability to use the language in real-life contexts. The integrated approach emphasizes teaching these skills together through meaningful and interactive activities. This article analyzes modern teaching strategies such as communicative language teaching, task-based learning, and project-based learning. It also presents practical classroom examples to demonstrate how these methods can be applied effectively. The findings show that students who learn through integrated skill instruction demonstrate higher motivation, better engagement, and improved language proficiency. They are more confident in using the language and can communicate more effectively. In conclusion, integrating language skills is a powerful and effective way to improve foreign language teaching and learning outcomes.

Keywords: language skills, integrated approach, speaking, listening, reading, writing, English teaching

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ İNTEQRATİV YANAŞMA ƏSASINDA XARİCİ DİL BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAFI

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Xülasə. Bu məqalədə ingilis dilinin tədrisində xarici dil bacarıqlarının – dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı – integrativ yanaşma əsasında inkişaf etdirilməsi məsələsi araşdırılır. Qloballaşan dünyada xarici dillərin, xüsusilə ingilis dilinin əhəmiyyəti getdikcə artır və bu da tədris prosesində daha effektiv və müasir metodların tətbiqini zəruri edir. Ənənəvi tədris üsullarında bu bacarıqların çox vaxt ayrı-ayrılıqda öyrədilməsi şagirdlərin dili real ünsiyyət mühitində sərbəst istifadə etmələrinə mane olur. Məqalədə integrativ yanaşmanın mahiyyəti izah olunur və bu yanaşmanın şagirdlərin kommunikativ bacarıqlarının inkişafına müsbət təsiri əsaslandırılır. Eyni zamanda kommunikativ dil tədrisi, tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə və layihə əsaslı fəaliyyətlər kimi müasir metodların tətbiqi imkanları təhlil edilir. Bu metodlar şagirdlərin dərş prosesində aktiv iştirakını təmin edir, onların motivasiyasını artırır və öyrənmə prosesini daha maraqlı və effektiv edir. Tədqiqat nəticələri göstərir ki, integrativ yanaşma əsasında təşkil olunan dərslər şagirdlərin dil bacarıqlarını daha kompleks şəkildə inkişaf etdirir, onların tənqidi düşünmə qabiliyyətini gücləndirir və real həyatda dili tətbiq etmə imkanlarını genişləndirir. Nəticə olaraq qeyd olunur ki, müasir tədris mühitində integrativ yanaşmanın tətbiqi ingilis dilinin öyrədilməsində yüksək nəticələrin əldə olunmasına şərait yaradır.

Açar sözlər: dil bacarıqları, integrativ yanaşma, danışma, dinləmə, oxu, yazı, ingilis dili tədrisi

Introduction

The growing prominence of English language in the field of international trade and commerce, its essentiality for learners to capture right opportunities in the Market necessitates continuous research and improvement in the field of ELT. Poor linguistic competencies of students may be due to ineffective method of teaching. This is the driving force behind incessant exploration and reformation in the existing system. There is an outcry by the Private Sector in India that students who are graduating schools, colleges and universities are finding it difficult to dive into Job Market and bag suitable opportunities. Utilizing the features of technology emerging during the instruction process will serve as a Catalyst in the process of imparting quality inputs. English Language and integration of ICT tools in curriculum strengthen's linguistic foundation of Students for better and quick gains in Language. The present paper aims at throwing light into the area of conceptual framework of ICT integration into methodology of teaching English and highlights the need and advantages, features and instructional sequence of integrated approach in language teaching. (Díaz-Rico, L. T. & Weed, K. Z. (1995)

In the contemporary globalized world, foreign language proficiency has become an essential component of personal, academic, and professional success. Among foreign languages, English occupies a dominant position as a lingua franca in international communication, science, technology, and education. As a result, the effectiveness of English language teaching methodologies has become a central concern for educators worldwide. Traditionally, language teaching focused primarily on grammar rules, vocabulary memorization, and translation exercises. Although these methods provided learners with theoretical knowledge, they often failed to develop the ability to use language in authentic communicative situations. Students frequently demonstrated strong receptive knowledge but lacked productive competence, especially in speaking and writing. Language competence is generally defined through four core skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. These skills are not independent; rather, they are interrelated and mutually supportive. For example, effective speaking relies on listening input, while writing is often influenced by reading exposure. Therefore, separating these skills in the teaching process contradicts the natural

way languages are acquired. Modern pedagogical approaches emphasize communicative competence, learner autonomy, and real-life application of knowledge. Within this framework, the integrated approach has emerged as a highly effective method that combines all four skills in a coherent and meaningful way. This approach reflects authentic language use, where individuals simultaneously employ multiple skills to communicate. The aim of this study is to analyze the role of the integrated approach in developing foreign language skills and to explore its practical implementation in English language classrooms. The study also highlights the benefits, challenges, and pedagogical implications of this approach. (Brown, H. D, 2004)

Materials and methodology

This research is based on a qualitative analysis of contemporary teaching methodologies, pedagogical theories, and classroom practices related to English language teaching. The study synthesizes theoretical perspectives with practical classroom applications. A variety of methods and approaches were examined to evaluate their effectiveness in integrating language skills. First, Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) was analyzed as one of the most influential approaches in modern language education. CLT emphasizes interaction as both the means and the goal of learning. It prioritizes fluency over accuracy and encourages learners to use language for meaningful communication rather than mechanical repetition. Second, Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) was considered due to its focus on real-world tasks. In this approach, learners engage in activities such as problem-solving, decision-making, and information exchange. These tasks require the simultaneous use of multiple language skills, thereby naturally promoting integration. Third, Project-Based Learning (PBL) was examined as an approach that fosters long-term engagement and deeper learning. Students work collaboratively on projects that involve research, discussion, presentation, and written output. This method supports not only language development but also critical thinking and creativity. In addition, the role of digital technologies was explored. Modern tools such as multimedia resources, online platforms, and interactive applications provide opportunities for integrated skill development in dynamic and engaging environments. This study is based on the analysis of modern teaching approaches and classroom practices. It focuses on methods that promote the integration of language skills.

2.1 Communicative Language Teaching

This method focuses on communication as the main goal of language learning. Students are encouraged to interact, express their ideas, and use language in real-life situations.

2.2 Task-Based Learning

Task-based learning involves completing meaningful tasks such as solving problems, discussing topics, or working on projects. These tasks require students to use multiple skills at the same time.

2.3 Project-Based Learning

Students work on projects that require research, collaboration, and presentation. This method integrates all four skills naturally.

2.4 Use of Technology

Digital tools such as videos, online platforms, and interactive applications support integrated learning and increase student engagement. (Ellis, R, 2003)

Discussion

The findings of the study indicate that the integrated approach significantly enhances the development of foreign language skills. Students exposed to integrated instruction demonstrate higher levels of engagement, motivation, and communicative competence. One of the key

advantages of the integrated approach is its alignment with authentic language use. In real-life situations, individuals rarely use a single skill in isolation. For instance, participating in a conversation involves listening, responding, and often recalling previously read or learned information. Therefore, integrated instruction better prepares students for real-world communication. Another important finding is the positive impact on student motivation. When learners participate in interactive and meaningful activities, they are more likely to be actively involved in the learning process. Activities such as role-plays, debates, group discussions, and collaborative projects create a learner-centered environment where students feel more confident and engaged. Furthermore, the integration of skills contributes to the development of higher-order thinking skills. Students are required to analyze information, express opinions, solve problems, and synthesize ideas. This goes beyond simple language learning and promotes cognitive development. However, the implementation of the integrated approach is not without challenges. Teachers need to carefully design lessons that effectively combine different skills. This requires time, creativity, and professional training. Additionally, classroom management can become more complex when students are engaged in interactive activities. Despite these challenges, the benefits of the integrated approach outweigh its limitations. It provides a holistic learning experience and fosters both linguistic and cognitive development.

Integration of the four skills is concerned with realistic communication. This means that we are teaching at the discourse level, not just at the level of sentences or individual words and phrases. Discourse is a whole unit of communicative text, either spoken or written. However, integrating the four language skills can be demanding of the teacher. (Nation, I. S. P., 2008)

- We need to have a good understanding of discourse, and to be able to use textbooks flexibly. Choose instructional materials, textbooks, and technologies that promote the integration of listening, reading, speaking, and writing, as well as the associated skills of syntax, vocabulary, and so on.
- This can also be time-consuming, requiring a lot of preparation.
- Another limitation is the problem of designing suitable materials that take account of students' different skill levels. The four skills tend to develop at a different pace: receptive skills are stronger than productive skills, for example. Reflect on their current approach and evaluate the extent to which the skills are integrated.
- This means that teachers have to be skilful in selecting or designing integrated activities for their students. Learn more about the various ways to integrate language skills in the classroom (e.g., content-based, task-based, or a combination).
- Even if a given course is labeled according to just one skill, remember that it is possible to integrate the other language skills through appropriate tasks.
- Teach language learning strategies and emphasize that a given strategy can often enhance performance in multiple skills

Practical Classroom Implementation

To effectively apply the integrated approach, teachers should design lessons that combine multiple skills within a single activity. For example, a lesson may begin with a listening task, such as watching a short video. This is followed by a discussion activity where students express their opinions. Next, students read a related text to deepen their understanding of the topic. Finally, they complete a writing task, such as summarizing the information or writing an essay.

Another effective strategy is the use of project-based activities. Students can work in groups to prepare presentations on specific topics. This process includes researching information (reading), discussing ideas (speaking), listening to peers, and preparing written materials.

Technology can also play a significant role. Online discussions, interactive quizzes, and multimedia content allow students to practice multiple skills simultaneously. For instance, students can watch a video, respond to questions, and participate in online discussions. (Scrivener, J., 2011)

The integrated approach has several advantages in language learning.

3.1 Skill Integration in Practice

Teachers can design lessons that combine skills. For example:

- Listening to a dialogue → discussing it → writing a summary
- Reading a text → answering questions → presenting ideas

3.2 Classroom Activities

- Role plays
- Group discussions
- Debates
- Storytelling
- Project presentations

3.3 Benefits

- Improves fluency
- Increases confidence
- Encourages active participation
- Develops critical thinking

3.4 Challenges

- Requires planning
- Time management issues
- Need for teacher training

The necessity for integrating different teaching methods arises from the fact that no single method can adequately address the diverse learning styles, cognitive abilities, and emotional needs of young learners. The goal of ACADEMIC RESEARCH IN MODERN SCIENCE International scientific-online conference 172 integrating methods is to create a holistic learning experience that combines the strengths of different approaches, such as communicative language teaching (CLT), total physical response (TPR), task-based learning (TBL), and storytelling. By integrating methods, teachers can offer children a more varied and engaging learning environment that caters to multiple learning styles—visual, auditory, and kinesthetic (Harmer, 2007). This diversity is essential for maintaining engagement and ensuring that all students, regardless of their preferred learning mode, can access and understand the language being taught.

In addition to traditional classroom techniques, modern technology plays a significant role in integrating language skills. Online platforms, educational applications, and multimedia resources provide opportunities for students to practice listening, speaking, reading, and writing simultaneously. For example, students can watch a video (listening), comment on it (writing), discuss it (speaking), and read related materials (reading). Such activities create a dynamic and engaging learning environment. Another important factor is student motivation. When students are actively involved in meaningful tasks, they become more interested in learning. Integrated activities make lessons more enjoyable and interactive. (Nation, I. S. P., 2008)

Integrating language skills enables students to improve their communication abilities by practicing all aspects of language simultaneously. By engaging in activities that require the use of multiple skills, such as role-plays, group discussions, and multimedia projects, learners can enhance their fluency, accuracy, and confidence in using the English language. Integrating language skills enables students to improve their communication abilities by practicing all aspects of language simultaneously. By engaging in activities that require the use of multiple skills, such as role-plays, group discussions, and multimedia projects, learners can enhance their fluency, accuracy, and confidence in using the English language. Integrating language skills enhances student motivation and confidence by offering meaningful and engaging language learning experiences. By providing opportunities for success, feedback, and collaboration, students can build their self-esteem, motivation, and willingness to take risks in using the English language. Integrating language skills enhances student motivation and confidence by offering meaningful and engaging language learning experiences. By providing opportunities for success, feedback, and collaboration, students can build their self-esteem, motivation, and willingness to take risks in using the English language. It also enhances student motivation and confidence by offering meaningful and engaging language learning experiences. By providing opportunities for success, feedback, and collaboration, students can build their self-esteem, motivation, and willingness to take risks in using the English language. Integrating language skills enhances student motivation and confidence by offering meaningful and engaging language learning experiences. By providing opportunities for success, feedback, and collaboration, students can build their self-esteem, motivation, and willingness to take risks in using the English language.

The integrated-skill approach, as contrasted with the purely segregated approach, exposes English language learners to authentic language and challenges them to interact naturally in the language. Learners rapidly gain a true picture of the richness and complexity of the English language as employed for communication. Moreover, this approach stresses that English is not just an object of academic interest nor merely a key to passing an examination; instead, English becomes a real means of interaction and sharing among people. This approach allows teachers to track students' progress in multiple skills at the same time. Integrating the language skills also promotes the learning of real content, not just the dissection of language forms. Finally, the integrated-skill approach, whether found in content-based or task-based language instruction or some hybrid form, can be highly motivating to students of all ages and backgrounds. (Richards, J. C., & Rodgers, T. S., 2001)

With careful reflection and planning, any teacher can integrate the language skills and strengthen the tapestry of language teaching and learning. When the tapestry is woven well, learners can use English effectively for communication.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the integrated approach represents a modern and effective strategy in English language teaching. By combining listening, speaking, reading, and writing, it reflects the natural use of language and enhances communicative competence. This approach not only improves language proficiency but also increases student motivation, engagement, and confidence. It encourages active participation and supports the development of critical thinking skills. Although the implementation of this approach requires careful planning and professional competence, its advantages make it a valuable method in contemporary education. Therefore, educators are encouraged to adopt integrated teaching strategies to achieve more effective and meaningful learning outcomes. In today's globalized world, the ability to communicate in a foreign language, especially English, has

become increasingly important. English is widely used in international communication, education, business, and technology. Therefore, effective methods of teaching English are essential for preparing students for real-life situations. Language learning involves the development of four key skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. These skills are interconnected and should support each other. However, traditional teaching methods often focus on grammar and vocabulary, treating language skills separately. As a result, students may know the rules of the language but struggle to communicate effectively. (Harmer, J, 2007)

Modern approaches emphasize communicative competence and real-life usage. One of the most effective approaches is the integrated approach, which combines all four skills in a meaningful way. This article aims to explore the importance of this approach and provide practical examples for classroom application. The integrated approach is an effective and modern method for developing foreign language skills. It allows students to use language in a natural and meaningful way. By combining listening, speaking, reading, and writing, learners become more confident and competent. Teachers should adopt student-centered methods and create interactive classroom environments. Despite some challenges, the benefits of this approach are significant and long-lasting.

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DATA-DRIVEN APPROACHES TO TEACHING ECONOMICS: ENHANCING STUDENT ANALYTICAL SKILLS

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Abstract: The article examines data-driven approaches to teaching economics and their role in enhancing students' analytical skills. In contemporary higher education, economics can no longer be taught only through abstract theory, verbal explanation, and traditional problem-solving exercises. The increasing availability of macroeconomic databases, labour market indicators, business statistics, digital dashboards, artificial intelligence tools, and real-time economic information requires learners to develop the ability to collect, interpret, visualize, and critically evaluate data. The purpose of the study is to conceptualize a pedagogical framework for integrating data analytics into economics teaching. The research is based on secondary source analysis, pedagogical synthesis, and comparative interpretation of international approaches to digital education, data literacy, and competency-based learning. The findings show that data-driven teaching strengthens economic reasoning by connecting theoretical concepts with empirical evidence, improves students' ability to identify trends and causal relationships, and supports more active classroom engagement. At the same time, the article emphasizes that data-driven instruction requires methodological preparation, digital competence, ethical use of data, and careful selection of learning tasks. The study concludes that economics education should move from passive knowledge transmission toward evidence-based, problem-oriented, and analytics-supported learning models.

Keywords: data-driven teaching; economics education; analytical skills; digital tools; data literacy; evidence-based learning

İQTİSADİYYATIN TƏDRİSİNDƏ DATA ƏSASLI YANAŞMALAR: TƏLƏBƏLƏRİN ANALİTİK BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAF ETDİRİLMƏSİ

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Xülasə: Məqalədə iqtisadiyyatın tədrisində verilənlərə əsaslanan yanaşmalar və onların tələbələrin analitik bacarıqlarının inkişaf etdirilməsində rolu araşdırılır. Müasir ali təhsil şəraitində iqtisadiyyat fənni artıq yalnız abstrakt nəzəriyyə, şifahi izah və əənəvi məsələ həlli tapşırıqları vasitəsilə tədris oluna bilməz. Makroiqtisadi məlumat bazalarının, əmək bazarı göstəricilərinin, biznes statistikalarının, rəqəmsal idarəetmə panellərinin, süni intellekt alətlərinin və real vaxt rejimində iqtisadi informasiyanın əlçatanlığının artması tələbələrdən məlumatları toplamaq, şərh etmək, vizuallaşdırmaq və tənqidi qiymətləndirmək bacarığı tələb edir. Tədqiqatın məqsədi verilənlər analitikasının iqtisadiyyat tədrisinə inteqrasiyası üçün pedaqoji çərçivəni konseptuallaşdırmaqdır. Tədqiqat ikincidərəcəli mənbələrin təhlili, pedaqoji sintez və rəqəmsal təhsil, məlumat savadlılığı və kompetensiyaya əsaslanan öyrənmə üzrə beynəlxalq yanaşmaların müqayisəli şərhə əsasında aparılmışdır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, verilənlərə əsaslanan tədris nəzəri anlayışları empirik sübutlarla əlaqələndirməklə iqtisadi düşüncəni gücləndirir, tələbələrin trendləri və səbəb-nəticə əlaqələrini müəyyənləşdirmək bacarığını inkişaf etdirir və auditoriyada daha fəal iştirakçılığı dəstəkləyir. Eyni zamanda, məqalədə vurğulanır ki, verilənlərə əsaslanan təlim metodoloji hazırlıq, rəqəmsal kompetensiya, məlumatlardan etik istifadə və təlim tapşırıqlarının diqqətlə seçilməsini tələb edir. Tədqiqat belə nəticəyə gəlir ki, iqtisadiyyat təhsili passiv bilik ötürülməsi modelindən sübuta əsaslanan, problem yönümlü və analitika ilə dəstəklənən öyrənmə modellərinə keçməlidir.

Açar sözlər: data əsaslı tədris; iqtisadiyyat təhsili; analitik bacarıqlar; rəqəmsal alətlər; data savadlılığı; sübuta əsaslanan öyrənmə

Introduction

The digital transformation of education has changed not only the technologies used in classrooms but also the nature of knowledge, competence, and assessment. In economics education,

this transformation is particularly important because economic phenomena are increasingly explained through data: inflation rates, unemployment dynamics, household consumption, investment flows, public expenditures, exchange rates, market concentration, and productivity indicators. Therefore, students who study economics should not only memorize definitions and theoretical models; they should also be able to interpret numerical evidence and use data to support economic reasoning.

Traditional economics teaching has often been based on lectures, textbook explanations, mathematical formulas, and written examinations. Although these methods remain important, they may be insufficient for developing the analytical skills required in a data-intensive economy. Contemporary labour markets increasingly value graduates who can work with spreadsheets, statistical indicators, dashboards, visualization tools, and evidence-based reports. In this context, data-driven teaching becomes a methodological necessity rather than a supplementary innovation.

International organizations increasingly emphasize the importance of digital competence, data literacy, critical thinking, and responsible use of educational technologies. The OECD Digital Education Outlook underlines the need for effective digital education ecosystems, while UNESCO highlights human agency, critical thinking, ethics, and teacher competence in digital and AI-supported education. These priorities are directly relevant to economics teaching because economic decision-making depends on the quality of data interpretation and the ability to distinguish evidence from assumption.

The main research problem addressed in this article is the gap between theoretical economics teaching and the practical analytical skills required from students. Many students can reproduce definitions of demand, supply, inflation, unemployment, GDP, and fiscal policy, but they may experience difficulties when asked to interpret real datasets, compare indicators across countries, create a chart, identify a trend, or make an evidence-based conclusion. This gap shows that economics education should be redesigned through data-driven pedagogical strategies.

The purpose of the article is to analyze how data-driven approaches can be integrated into economics teaching in order to enhance students' analytical skills. The article seeks to answer three main research questions: first, what does data-driven teaching mean in the context of economics education; second, how can data analytics improve students' conceptual understanding and analytical reasoning; and third, what pedagogical conditions are necessary for effective implementation of data-driven economics instruction?

Materials and Methods

This study is based on a conceptual-analytical research design. It does not conduct a classroom experiment or a primary survey; instead, it develops a theoretically grounded and pedagogically applicable framework for using data-driven approaches in economics teaching. The selected design is appropriate because the article aims to clarify the methodological role of data analytics in economics education and to identify the instructional mechanisms through which analytical skills can be developed.

The information base of the study includes international policy documents, academic literature on digital education, data literacy, economics pedagogy, and evidence-based teaching, as well as examples of publicly available economic data sources that may be used in the classroom. The key sources include publications of the OECD, UNESCO, the World Bank, and research literature on educational technology and economics instruction. These materials were selected because they provide reliable conceptual foundations for understanding digital skills, teacher competence, data use, and student-centred learning (OECD, 2026).

The first methodological component is secondary source analysis. Through this method, the study examines existing approaches to digital learning, data literacy, and analytics-supported education. Special attention is given to the relationship between data use and higher-order thinking skills. In economics education, higher-order thinking includes interpretation, comparison, explanation, evaluation, forecasting, and decision-making based on evidence. Therefore, the literature is analyzed not only from the perspective of educational technology, but also from the perspective of economic reasoning and applied analytical competence.

The second methodological component is pedagogical synthesis. This method is used to combine different teaching strategies into a coherent instructional model. Data-driven economics teaching may include problem-based learning, case analysis, statistical interpretation, visualization exercises, spreadsheet modelling, classroom discussion, and reflective writing. Pedagogical synthesis makes it possible to connect these activities into a logical teaching sequence: introduction of an economic concept, presentation of relevant data, guided interpretation, group analysis, visualization, evidence-based conclusion, and teacher feedback.

The third methodological component is comparative interpretation. The study compares traditional content-centred economics teaching with data-driven and competency-based teaching. Traditional teaching generally prioritizes explanation of theory and reproduction of knowledge, whereas data-driven teaching prioritizes the application of theory to real indicators. This comparison helps to identify the added value of data analytics in developing analytical skills. It also shows that the purpose of data use in teaching is not to replace theory, but to make theory empirically meaningful and practically applicable.

The fourth methodological component is instructional modelling. On the basis of the analyzed literature, the article proposes a data-driven teaching cycle for economics education. This model consists of six stages: selection of an economic problem, identification of relevant data sources, data cleaning and organization, visualization and interpretation, discussion of theoretical implications, and assessment of analytical conclusions. Each stage is linked to specific student skills, such as information search, numerical interpretation, graph reading, critical thinking, argumentation, and written communication.

The study also applies a competency-based perspective. Analytical skills are treated as a complex competence that includes data literacy, statistical reasoning, economic interpretation, digital tool use, and evidence-based communication. From this perspective, the teacher's role is not limited to transmitting economic knowledge. The teacher becomes a facilitator of inquiry, a designer of data-based tasks, and a guide who helps students transform raw information into meaningful economic conclusions.

In terms of research limitations, the article is theoretical and methodological rather than empirical. It does not measure student performance before and after the application of data-driven teaching. However, the proposed framework may serve as a foundation for future empirical studies, including classroom experiments, student surveys, learning analytics, and assessment of analytical skill development. The limitation is therefore not a weakness of the article, but a boundary of its research scope.

Results and Discussion

The analysis indicates that data-driven teaching can significantly strengthen economics education by transforming the learning process from passive reception of information into active interpretation of evidence. In traditional teaching, students often learn economic concepts in an abstract form. For example, inflation may be defined as a general increase in prices, unemployment

may be explained as the absence of paid work for those seeking employment, and GDP may be described as the total value of goods and services produced in an economy. These definitions are necessary, but they remain incomplete if students cannot interpret real inflation data, compare unemployment rates, or analyze GDP growth across different periods.

Data-driven teaching changes the logic of classroom activity. Instead of asking students only to define a concept, the teacher asks them to investigate an economic problem through evidence. For instance, students may be given a dataset on consumer prices and asked to identify which product groups contributed most to inflation. They may compare unemployment rates by age group and discuss why youth unemployment differs from general unemployment. They may examine GDP growth together with investment, exports, and household consumption in order to understand the structure of economic expansion. Such tasks make economics more concrete and intellectually demanding.

Table 1. Comparison of traditional and data-driven economics teaching

Criterion	Traditional approach	Data-driven approach	Expected student outcome
Main focus	Explanation of concepts and theories	Application of concepts to real economic data	Stronger conceptual understanding
Student role	Listener and note-taker	Analyst, interpreter, and presenter	Active learning and inquiry
Learning material	Textbook examples and formulas	Datasets, dashboards, charts, and cases	Evidence-based reasoning
Assessment	Reproduction of definitions and calculations	Interpretation, visualization, argumentation, and reporting	Analytical and digital competence
Teacher role	Knowledge transmitter	Designer of data-based learning tasks	Guided independent analysis

The table demonstrates that the difference between traditional and data-driven teaching is not merely technological. It is pedagogical. Data-driven teaching changes the function of knowledge. Economic theory becomes a tool for interpreting reality, while data become a means of testing, illustrating, and problematizing theory. This creates a more authentic learning environment because students work with information that resembles the data used by economists, public institutions, businesses, and policy analysts.

One of the most important results of data-driven economics teaching is the development of analytical skills. Analytical skills include the ability to identify relevant indicators, understand relationships between variables, detect patterns, compare data across time and space, recognize limitations, and produce reasoned conclusions. These skills are essential for economic literacy because economic decisions are often made under uncertainty and with incomplete information. A student who learns to question data sources, check measurement units, compare indicators, and interpret trends is better prepared for academic research and professional practice (Brookings Institution, 2021).

Another important result concerns student motivation. Economics may appear abstract to students when it is presented only through theoretical schemes. However, when students analyze real data on prices, wages, exchange rates, employment, public debt, or household income, they can connect classroom learning with everyday economic life. This connection increases engagement

and makes the subject more meaningful. Data-based assignments also encourage students to ask questions, defend their interpretations, and participate in discussion.

Digital tools play a central role in the implementation of data-driven teaching. Spreadsheet software, online statistical databases, visualization platforms, learning management systems, and AI-supported tools may be used to organize and interpret data. However, the effective use of these tools depends on pedagogical purpose. Technology should not be used only for visual attractiveness or formal innovation. It should help students understand economic relationships more deeply. For example, a simple line chart showing inflation over several years may be more pedagogically useful than a complex dashboard if it supports clear interpretation and discussion.

The teacher's competence is therefore decisive. A data-driven approach requires the teacher to select appropriate datasets, simplify complex information without distorting meaning, design guiding questions, and evaluate students' analytical conclusions. The teacher must also explain the limitations of data. Economic indicators may be affected by methodology, sampling, institutional definitions, time lag, seasonal adjustment, and political or administrative context. If these limitations are ignored, students may develop superficial or misleading interpretations. Thus, data-driven teaching should include critical data literacy, not only technical data use.

Ethical considerations are also important. Data use in education should respect accuracy, transparency, academic integrity, and responsible interpretation. Students should learn that data can support arguments, but it can also be misused through selective presentation, inappropriate comparison, or misleading visualization. In economics teaching, this is particularly important because economic data often influence social debates, business decisions, and public policy. Therefore, analytical skills must be combined with ethical judgement (Wuttipong & Rattana, 2024).

A practical data-driven economics lesson may be organized around a specific problem. For example, the teacher may ask: "What factors explain changes in household consumption during a selected period?" Students first review the theoretical relationship between income, prices, expectations, and consumption. Then they examine statistical data, create charts, identify changes, compare possible explanations, and present conclusions. In this process, they do not merely repeat economic theory; they use theory to interpret empirical evidence. This is the central pedagogical value of data-driven teaching.

The proposed cycle shows that data-driven economics teaching is a structured process. It begins with a problem rather than with isolated data. This is methodologically important because students should not collect information mechanically. They should first understand the economic question and then search for relevant evidence. The cycle ends with feedback and reflection, because analytical competence develops through repeated correction, comparison, and improvement.

The integration of data analytics into economics education may also support differentiated learning. Students with stronger technical skills can work on more advanced visualization or statistical tasks, while students at an introductory level can focus on interpreting ready-made charts and tables. Group work may combine different roles: data collector, chart designer, theory interpreter, and presenter. This structure allows students to learn from each other and develop both individual and collaborative skills.

At the institutional level, the implementation of data-driven economics teaching requires access to digital infrastructure, teacher training, curriculum flexibility, and assessment reform. If examinations continue to measure only memorization, teachers and students may not take data-based learning seriously. Therefore, assessment should include analytical reports, chart

interpretation, short policy briefs, classroom presentations, and project-based tasks. These formats better reflect the skills that students need in contemporary economic and professional environments.

The discussion also shows that data-driven teaching is closely connected with the broader goal of improving economic literacy. Economic literacy means the ability to understand economic information, evaluate policy debates, make informed decisions, and participate responsibly in social and professional life. In a digital economy, such literacy cannot be separated from data literacy. A person who cannot interpret basic indicators, read a graph, or question a statistical claim is vulnerable to misinformation and weak economic judgement (UNESCO, 2024b).

Theoretical analysis further reveals that data-driven instruction is especially suitable for economics because the discipline itself is built on the interaction between models and evidence. A demand curve, for example, is not only a diagram in a textbook; it is a simplified representation of observable market behaviour. When students compare theoretical demand with real price and consumption data, they begin to understand that economic models are analytical instruments rather than memorized drawings. The same applies to the Phillips curve, Okun's law, income elasticity, market equilibrium, and fiscal multipliers. These topics become clearer when students test them against real or simplified datasets.

A second pedagogical advantage is that data-driven learning supports interdisciplinary competence. Modern economic analysis increasingly overlaps with statistics, information technology, business analytics, public policy, and communication. When students learn to prepare a short evidence-based report, they simultaneously practise economic interpretation, digital organization of information, written academic expression, and presentation skills. Such integration is valuable because graduates are rarely asked in professional life to reproduce a definition only. They are more often expected to analyze a situation, justify a recommendation, and communicate the results clearly.

Data-driven teaching also creates conditions for formative assessment. In a traditional written test, the teacher often sees only the final answer. In data-based tasks, the teacher can observe the whole analytical process: how students choose indicators, how they clean or organize data, how they construct a chart, how they interpret the pattern, and how they formulate a conclusion. This enables more precise feedback. A student may have a correct theoretical idea but a weak chart; another may produce a visually correct graph but make a wrong economic interpretation. Data-based assessment allows the teacher to identify such differences and support targeted improvement.

Another important discussion point is the role of artificial intelligence. AI tools can support economics teaching by helping students summarize datasets, generate preliminary visualizations, compare indicators, and explore alternative explanations. However, AI should be used as a learning assistant, not as a substitute for reasoning. Students must be required to explain how they obtained results, what data they used, why a certain chart type was selected, and what limitations exist in their conclusion. Otherwise, AI may produce a false sense of competence. Data-driven economics education should therefore combine AI support with transparent reasoning, source verification, and teacher-guided reflection (World Bank, 2025).

The implementation of data-driven teaching may begin with simple classroom activities. At the introductory level, students can interpret a ready-made chart showing inflation, exchange rate changes, or unemployment. At the intermediate level, they can download data from official statistical portals, create tables, and compare annual trends. At an advanced level, they can conduct small research projects, prepare policy briefs, or use basic statistical methods to examine

relationships between variables. This gradual progression is important because students differ in their digital and mathematical readiness.

The following table presents examples of possible data-driven tasks in economics education. These tasks can be adapted to different education levels and can be implemented with simple tools such as Excel, Google Sheets, national statistical databases, or publicly available international datasets.

Table 2. Examples of data-driven economics learning tasks

Economic topic	Possible dataset	Student task	Analytical skill developed
Inflation	Consumer price index by year or month	Create a line chart and explain the trend	Trend analysis and interpretation
Labour market	Unemployment rate by age or gender	Compare groups and discuss possible causes	Comparative reasoning
GDP growth	GDP by sector or expenditure component	Identify the main source of growth	Structural economic analysis
International trade	Exports and imports by product group	Calculate trade balance and interpret changes	Evidence-based conclusion
Public finance	Budget revenue and expenditure data	Assess fiscal priorities through percentages	Numerical and policy reasoning

These examples show that data-driven teaching does not necessarily require complex econometric software. The main requirement is a well-designed learning question. A simple dataset can produce meaningful learning if students are asked to explain, compare, justify, and reflect. Conversely, even advanced technology may have little educational value if the task is not connected with a clear economic concept.

In the context of economics teacher development, data-driven teaching also requires continuous professional learning. Teachers need support in selecting reliable data sources, preparing classroom-friendly datasets, designing assessment rubrics, and managing different levels of student readiness. Teacher training should therefore include not only technical skills, but also didactic strategies for transforming data into learning activities. This is consistent with international discussions on digital education, where teacher agency and pedagogical purpose are emphasized as key conditions for meaningful technology integration.

The proposed approach may be particularly useful for developing countries and transition economies, where students need stronger links between academic economics and real socio-economic challenges. Topics such as inflation, employment, regional development, entrepreneurship, digital economy, public finance, and sustainable development can be taught through local and international data. This strengthens students' ability to understand their own economic environment and compare it with broader global trends (Wuttipong & Rattana, 2024).

Nevertheless, several challenges should be considered. First, students may lack sufficient statistical background. Second, some teachers may have limited experience with digital tools. Third, data sources may differ in format, terminology, and update frequency. Fourth, excessive focus on data may lead to mechanical interpretation if theoretical foundations are weak. Therefore, data-driven economics teaching should be balanced: theory explains the logic of economic relationships, while data help students examine how these relationships appear in reality.

Conclusion

The article concludes that data-driven approaches to teaching economics are essential for enhancing students' analytical skills in contemporary education. Economics is a discipline that

explains real processes, but these processes are increasingly represented through data. Therefore, students must learn not only economic concepts, but also how to use data to interpret, evaluate, and communicate economic phenomena.

The proposed framework shows that data-driven teaching connects theory with empirical evidence and transforms students from passive recipients of information into active analysts. It develops data literacy, critical thinking, visualization competence, economic reasoning, and evidence-based communication. These skills are necessary for academic success, labour market readiness, and responsible participation in economic life.

At the same time, the article emphasizes that data-driven teaching should not be reduced to the mechanical use of digital tools. Its success depends on pedagogical design, teacher competence, ethical data use, and appropriate assessment. Teachers should select relevant data, formulate meaningful problems, guide interpretation, and help students understand the limitations of indicators. Educational institutions should support this process through curriculum modernization, teacher training, and digital infrastructure.

The main recommendation is that economics curricula should systematically include data-based assignments, visualization tasks, case studies, and analytical projects. Such integration would make economics education more practical, evidence-based, and aligned with the demands of the digital economy. Future research may empirically test the impact of data-driven teaching on student performance, motivation, and long-term analytical competence.

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THE BARRIERS OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING

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Abstract: The acquisition of a second language is a multifaceted process influenced by an intricate web of cognitive, psychological, and external factors. While the globalization of the 21st century has increased the demand for multilingualism, many learners encounter significant "plateaus" or total stalls in their progress due to various systemic and personal barriers. This essay explores the taxonomy of these obstacles, categorized primarily into psychological inhibitors, linguistic distance, and socio-environmental constraints. Psychological barriers, such as language anxiety and the fear of social ridicule, often create a "silent period" that prevents the essential output necessary for fluency. Linguistically, the concept of "language transfer" and the cognitive load required to master disparate syntax or phonology can discourage learners, particularly those attempting to bridge significant gaps between their native and target languages. Furthermore, the essay examines the environmental lack of immersion and the socio-economic disparities that limit access to high-quality pedagogical resources. By analyzing these barriers, we can better understand why adult language acquisition often falls short of native-like proficiency and how educators might refine their methodologies to address the emotional and structural needs of the modern learner. Ultimately, identifying these hurdles is not an argument for the impossibility of the task, but a roadmap for developing the resilience and strategic approaches required to achieve cross-cultural communicative competence.

Key words: Psychological barriers, affective barriers, linguistic distance, cognitive distance, language anxiety, the affective filter, the socio - environmental domain

XARİCİ DİL ÖYRƏNİLMƏSİNDƏ MANEƏLƏR

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Xülasə: İkinci dilin mənimsənilməsi idrak, psixoloji və xarici amillərin mürəkkəb şəbəkəsinin təsiri altında olan çox şaxəli prosesdir. 21-ci əsrdə qloballaşma prosesi çox dilliliyə tələbi artırsa da, bir çox öyrənənlər müxtəlif sistemli və şəxsi maneələr səbəbindən irəliləyişlərində əhəmiyyətli maneələr və ya ümumi əngəllərlə qarşılaşırlar. Bu məqalə bu maneələrin taksonomiyasını araşdırır, əsasən psixoloji inhibitorlara, linqvistik məsafəyə və sosial-ekoloji məhdudiyyətlərə bölünür. Dil narahatlığı və sosial istehza qorxusu kimi psixoloji maneələr tez-tez səlis danışmaq üçün lazım olan əsas çıxışın qarşısını alan "səssiz dövr" yaradır. Linqvistik baxımdan, "dil köçürməsi" anlayışı və fərqli sintaksis və ya fonologiyaya yiyələnmək üçün tələb olunan idrak yükü öyrənənləri, xüsusən də doğma və hədəf dilləri arasında əhəmiyyətli boşluqları aradan qaldırmağa çalışanları ruhdan sala bilər. Bundan əlavə, məqalə yüksək keyfiyyətli pedaqoji resurslara çıxışı məhdudlaşdıran ekoloji çatışmazlıqları və sosial-iqtisadi bərabərsizlikləri araşdırır. Bu maneələri təhlil etməklə biz dil mənimsənilməsinin niyə tez-tez yerli dil biliklərindən geri qaldığını və müasir öyrənənin emosional və struktur ehtiyaclarını qarşılamaq üçün pedaqoqların öz metodologiyalarını necə təkmilləşdirə biləcəyini daha yaxşı başa düşə bilərik. Nəhayət, bu maneələri müəyyən etmək tapşırığın qeyri-mümkünlüyünün arqumenti deyil, mədəniyyətlər arasındakı kommunikativ səriştəyə nail olmaq üçün tələb olunan möhkəmlik və strateji yanaşmaların inkişafı üçün yol xəritəsidir.

Açar sözlər: Psixoloji maneələr, affektiv maneələr, linqvistik məsafə, idrak məsafəsi, dil narahatlığı, affektiv filtr, sosial-ekoloji sahə

Introduction

Breaking the silence in a new language is rarely just a matter of memorizing vocabulary or mastering syntax; it is an act of navigating a complex labyrinth of psychological, cognitive, and environmental hurdles. While the digital age has made language resources more accessible than ever, the journey from "hello" to true fluency remains fraught with invisible obstacles that can stall even the most resolute learners.

Understanding these barriers is the first step toward dismantling them. From the "affective filter" of performance anxiety to the structural differences between native and target tongues, language acquisition is as much a test of emotional resilience as it is of mental acuity. This article explores the primary factors that impede foreign language learning and offers insight into how learners can bridge the gap between frustration and communication.

1. The Architecture of obstruction: a comprehensive analysis of foreign language learning barriers

The acquisition of a second language is a transformative cognitive and social endeavor. However, for many learners, the journey is characterized by significant plateaus and systemic challenges. To understand why some achieve fluency while others stall, one must examine the three primary pillars of obstruction: Psychological and Affective Factors, Linguistic and Cognitive Distance, and Socio-Environmental Constraints.

I. The Psychological and Affective Domain: The Internal Gatekeeper

The most immediate barriers to language acquisition are often internal. Even with perfect pedagogical materials, a learner's emotional state can act as a total filter against progress.

1. Language Anxiety and the Affective Filter

One of the most cited theories in Second Language Acquisition (SLA) is Stephen Krashen's Affective Filter Hypothesis. Krashen (1982) posits the emotional variables such as anxiety, low self-esteem, and lack of motivation function as an invisible screen that prevents linguistic input from reaching the brain's language acquisition device.

Research by Horwitz, Horwitz, and Cope (1986) further defined "Foreign Language Classroom Anxiety" as a distinct complex of self-perceptions and feelings related to the act of communication. When a learner is anxious, their working memory is occupied by intrusive thoughts of failure, making it physically difficult to retrieve vocabulary or apply grammatical rules in real-time. This often leads to a "silent period" where the learner understands input but is psychologically paralyzed when asked to produce output (Krashen, 1982).

2. Ego Permeability and the Fear of Social Ridicule

For adult learners, "ego permeability" presents a unique challenge. In their native language, adults are sophisticated, witty, and competent. In a foreign language, they are reduced to a level of perceived "childishness." Guiora (1972) suggested that the "language ego" is a protective barrier that resists the new identity required by a second language. The fear of appearing unintelligent leads to hyper-correction and perfectionism, which are terminal barriers to the "productive struggle" required for fluency.

II. The Linguistic and Cognitive Domain: The Structural Gap

Even with elevated levels of motivation, the inherent structural differences between a learner's native language (L1) and the target language (L2) create mechanical hurdles.

1. Linguistic Distance and L1 Interference

The concept of Linguistic Distance suggests that the more structural commonalities two languages share (e.g., Spanish and Italian), the faster the acquisition. Conversely, languages with vast structural gaps (e.g., English and Mandarin) require significantly more cognitive energy. Chiswick and Miller (2005) demonstrated that linguistic distance is a quantitative predictor of how long it takes a learner to achieve professional proficiency.

Furthermore, L1 Interference or "Language Transfer" occurs when a learner subconsciously applies the rules of their native tongue to the new language. For instance, a native English speaker may struggle with the Subject-Object-Verb (SOV) word order of Japanese or the complex case systems of Slavic languages. These deeply ingrained neural pathways from the L1 must be bypassed or rewritten, a process that demands immense stamina (Chiswick & Miller, 2005).

2. The Phonological Ceiling and the Critical Period

The Critical Period Hypothesis (CPH) suggests that after puberty, the brain's plasticity for language acquisition decreases (PMC, 2013). While adults are capable of learning grammar, achieving native-like pronunciation becomes significantly harder because the brain becomes "tuned" only to the phonemes of the native language. For instance, if a learner's native language lacks the distinction between 'R' and 'L', their brain may eventually stop prioritizing the auditory difference between them, creating a permanent phonological barrier.

III. The Socio-Environmental Domain: The Reality of Access

The context in which a person learns can either accelerate or utterly stifle their progress. Language does not exist in a vacuum; it is a social tool that requires a fertile environment.

1. The Immersion Deficit and Artificial Environments

Most language learning takes place in classrooms – artificial environments that rarely replicate the chaotic, fast-paced nature of real-world interaction. Without comprehensible input – language just above the learner's current level – in a natural setting, the language remains a static set of rules (Krashen, 1982). Research suggests that immersive environments are superior because they force "survival-based" learning, which creates stronger emotional and neural connections to vocabulary (Rustic Pathways, n.d.).

2. Socio-Economic Constraints and the Quality of Instruction

Socio-economic status (SES) remains a major predictor of success. High-SES learners often have access to private tutors, study-abroad programs, and advanced technologies like Virtual Reality (VR) platforms that simulate immersion (Frontiers, 2025). Learners from low-SES backgrounds may lack the time or resources for these "accelerants," relying instead on free but fragmented tools that lack personalized feedback.

3. Cultural Insulation and the "Expat Bubble"

In a globalized world, the dominance of English as a *lingua franca* creates a barrier for English speakers trying to learn other tongues. In many major cities, locals will switch to English the moment they detect a learner's struggle. This deprives the learner of the "productive struggle" required for growth. Additionally, many learners fall into the "expat bubble," surrounding themselves with speakers of their own native tongue, which effectively kills any chance of linguistic integration.

IV. Overcoming the Barriers: A Synthesis of Solutions

Breaking these barriers requires a holistic approach that targets the mind, the method, and the environment simultaneously.

Mindset Shift: Learners must intentionally lower their "ego permeability" by embracing a Growth Mindset. Treating mistakes as data points rather than failures helps lower the Affective Filter and encourages output.

Targeted Cognitive Training: To combat L1 interference, techniques like Shadowing (immediate vocal imitation of native speakers) and Spaced Repetition Systems (SRS) can help "hard wire" new phonetic and grammatical patterns into long-term memory.

Engineering Immersion: In the absence of travel, learners should use Technological Flipping – changing device languages to the target language – and seek out Output-First platforms like iTalki or HelloTalk to simulate a high-stakes environment.

Materials and Methods

This study employed a qualitative, descriptive research approach to examine the main barriers affecting foreign language learning. The analysis focused on three interconnected domains: psychological and affective barriers, linguistic and cognitive barriers, and socio-environmental barriers.

Relevant academic literature on second language acquisition, language anxiety, linguistic distance, language transfer, critical period effects, immersion, and socio-economic factors was reviewed and analysed. Particular attention was given to the theoretical perspectives of Krashen (1982), Horwitz, Horwitz and Cope (1986), Guiora (1972), and Chiswick and Miller (2005), as well as recent research addressing technological and environmental factors in language learning.

The collected information was analysed thematically and organised according to the major categories of barriers identified in the literature. Psychological factors included language anxiety, low self-esteem, fear of making mistakes, and fear of social ridicule. Linguistic and cognitive factors included linguistic distance, first-language interference, phonological difficulties, and differences in grammatical structures. Socio-environmental factors included limited immersion opportunities, socio-economic inequalities, access to educational resources, and cultural isolation.

The study also examined strategies for overcoming these barriers, including reducing language anxiety, developing a growth mindset, using targeted cognitive training, increasing exposure to authentic language input, and incorporating digital technologies into language learning. The findings from the reviewed literature were compared and synthesised to provide a comprehensive understanding of the factors that may hinder foreign language acquisition and the approaches that can support learners in achieving effective cross-cultural communicative competence.

Discussions and conclusions about barriers of foreign language learning

The barriers to foreign language acquisition are rarely isolated; they often function as an interconnected web. For instance, a cognitive barrier – such as struggling with a complex grammatical case system – can quickly trigger a psychological barrier, leading to "language anxiety" and a subsequent refusal to practice speaking. This feedback loop suggests that addressing language learning purely through rote memorization is insufficient. Instead, a holistic approach that integrates emotional support and cultural context is vital.

Furthermore, the "Critical Period Hypothesis" continues to be a point of contention. While neuroplasticity in younger learners provides a clear advantage in phonology (accent), adult learners often possess superior meta-cognitive strategies that allow them to navigate structural barriers more analytically. The primary differentiator often ends up being environmental: adults frequently lack the high-volume, low-stakes immersion time that children naturally experience.

Overcoming the hurdles of foreign language learning is not a linear process of elimination, but a continuous exercise in adaptation. As we have explored, the path is obstructed by a variety of factors:

Internal Hurdles: The "Affective Filter," where stress and self-consciousness act as a mental block.

External Hurdles: Lack of access to native speakers or authentic cultural materials.

Systemic Hurdles: Educational frameworks that prioritize test scores over functional communication.

Ultimately, the most significant barrier may be the misconception that fluency is a destination rather than a spectrum. By reframing errors as essential data points rather than failures, and by leveraging modern tools to simulate immersion, learners can bypass traditional obstacles. Language is, at its core, a tool for human connection; when the desire to connect outweighs the fear of imperfection, the most daunting barriers begin to dissolve.

Final Thoughts for Learners

Objective	Strategy
Lower Anxiety	Practice in "low stakes" environments (apps, journals).
Increase Immersion	Switch device languages and consume target-language media.
Combat Plateaus	Introduce new domains of vocabulary (e.g., professional vs. casual).

Conclusion

The barriers to learning a foreign language are diverse, ranging from the internal architecture of the mind to the external realities of one's environment. Overcoming these obstacles requires more than just memorization; it demands resilience, cultural curiosity, and consistent exposure. While the "language wall" can feel insurmountable, understanding these barriers is the first step toward dismantling them and achieving true cross-cultural communication.

To dismantle the formidable barriers of foreign language learning, one must adopt a holistic strategy that addresses the mind, the method, and the environment. Since these obstacles are interconnected, the solutions must be equally integrated, moving beyond simple rote memorization toward a lifestyle of linguistic engagement.

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THE ROLE OF ECOLOGICAL EDUCATION IN AZERBAIJAN LANGUAGE LESSONS IN GRADES V–XI

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Abstract: The article provides a comprehensive and systematic analysis of the possibilities of forming ecological education through Azerbaijani language lessons in grades V–XI, examining both the pedagogical essence and methodological foundations of this process within the framework of modern scientific approaches. In accordance with contemporary educational paradigms, it is emphasized that Azerbaijani language lessons should not be limited to the teaching of grammatical rules, syntactic structures, and stylistic features. Instead, they should function as an integrative subject that contributes to the development of students' personality, social and moral values, and overall worldview. From this perspective, the integration of ecological education into language teaching is considered an important pedagogical necessity for strengthening students' sense of responsibility toward nature, fostering sensitivity to environmental issues, and promoting a culture of sustainable development. The study highlights that in the language learning process, students should not only develop linguistic competencies but also engage with various texts to understand real-life problems, analyze them critically, and express informed opinions. In particular, reading, analyzing, and discussing ecologically oriented texts, as well as writing essays and compositions, significantly contribute to the development of students' thinking and expressive skills, thereby directly influencing the formation of ecological awareness. In this process, interactive teaching methods such as group work, brainstorming, role-playing, and project-based activities play a particularly important role.

Keywords: ecological education, Azerbaijani language, student personality, communicative skills, ecological thinking, teaching methods.

V–XI SİNIFLƏRDƏ AZƏRBAYCAN DİLİ DƏRSLƏRİNDƏ EKOLOJİ TƏRBIYƏNİN ROLU

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Xülasə: Məqalədə V–XI siniflərdə Azərbaycan dili dərsləri vasitəsilə ekoloji tərbiyənin formalaşdırılması imkanları geniş və sistemli şəkildə təhlil edilir, bu prosesin həm pedaqoji mahiyyəti, həm də metodoloji əsasları müasir elmi yanaşmalar çərçivəsində araşdırılır. Müasir təhsil paradimalarına uyğun olaraq vurğulanır ki, Azərbaycan dili dərsləri yalnız qrammatik qaydaların, sintaktik strukturların və üslubi xüsusiyyətlərin tədrisi ilə məhdudlaşmamalıdır. Əksinə, onlar şagirdlərin şəxsiyyətinin, sosial-mənəvi

dəyərlərinin və ümumi dünyagörüşünün inkişafına töhfə verən integrativ bir fənn kimi fəaliyyət göstərməlidir. Bu baxımdan, ekoloji tərbiyənin dil tədrisinə integrasiyası şagirdlərin təbiətə cavabdehlik hissini gücləndirmək, ətraf mühit problemlərinə həssaslığı artırmaq və davamlı inkişaf mədəniyyətini təşviq etmək üçün mühüm pedaqoji zərurət kimi qiymətləndirilir. Tədqiqatda göstərilir ki, dilöyrənmə prosesində şagirdlər yalnız dil kompetensiyalarını inkişaf etdirməməli, həm də müxtəlif mətnlərlə işləyərək real həyat problemlərini anlamalı, onları tənqidi təhlil etməli və əsaslandırılmış fikir bildirməlidirlər. Xüsusilə ekoloji yönümlü mətnlərin oxunması, təhlili və müzakirəsi, eləcə də inşa və esse yazılması şagirdlərin təfəkkür və ifadə bacarıqlarının inkişafına əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə töhfə verir, bununla da ekoloji şüurun formalaşmasına birbaşa təsir göstərir. Bu prosesdə qrup işi, əqli hücum, rollu oyunlar və layihəyönümlü fəaliyyətlər kimi interaktiv təlim üsulları xüsusilə mühüm rol oynayır.

Açar sözlər: ekoloji tərbiyə, Azərbaycan dili, şagird şəxsiyyəti, kommunikativ bacarıqlar, ekoloji təfəkkür, tədris metodları.

Introduction

In the modern era, the growing global environmental problems have made the approach to ecological education in the education system increasingly relevant and necessary. Issues such as climate change, rapid depletion of natural resources, and pollution of air and water bodies have become the focus not only of environmental sciences but also of social and humanitarian disciplines. In this regard, one of the key responsibilities of educational institutions is to develop ecological awareness among students, foster a responsible attitude toward nature, and promote the principles of sustainable development.

Ecological education is not limited to the content of biology and geography subjects; rather, it functions as an integrative responsibility of all disciplines. In particular, humanitarian subjects, including Azerbaijani language lessons, play a significant role in this process. Language education not only develops students' grammatical and communicative skills but also shapes their worldview, value system, and sense of social responsibility. Therefore, the integration of ecological education into Azerbaijani language instruction is of particular relevance from the perspective of modern pedagogical approaches.

The Azerbaijani language subject provides students with the opportunity to think about, discuss, and form personal opinions on nature, the environment, and human relations through various texts. This serves as an important didactic tool in the development of ecological awareness. At the same time, essay writing, discussions, debates, and interactive teaching methods develop both linguistic abilities and ecological thinking in parallel.

The application of ecological education in Azerbaijani language lessons in grades V–XI is particularly significant, as this stage is crucial for the formation of students' worldview and the consolidation of their social and moral values. Integrating ecological topics into teaching at this age fosters sensitivity, responsibility, and a protective attitude toward nature. Thus, the application of ecological education in Azerbaijani language lessons not only enriches the subject content but also becomes an important pedagogical tool for the holistic development of the personality.

Materials and Methods

The essence of environmental education in Azerbaijani language lessons holds a special place as one of the most relevant and strategic directions of modern pedagogical thinking. Environmental education is the process of forming students' love for nature, developing a responsible attitude toward the environment, and instilling a culture of ecological behavior. This process is not limited to the transmission of theoretical knowledge; it also influences students' emotional sphere, shapes their value system, develops practical behavioral skills, and ensures a sensitive approach to real-life

environmental problems. J. Dewey explained education as a “social process formed on the basis of experience,” emphasizing that teaching is not only about providing information but also about connecting a person with real-life problems (Dewey, 1938). This approach creates a methodological foundation for the application of environmental education in Azerbaijani language lessons, as language instruction enables students both to express their thoughts and to understand the surrounding world. In this regard, Azerbaijani language lessons serve as one of the most suitable humanitarian subjects for the formation of ecological awareness and play an important role in expanding students’ worldview.

The application of environmental education in Azerbaijani language lessons is a complex pedagogical process that develops both students’ language skills and their socio-cultural worldview. The main goal of this process is to form a conscious, responsible, and active attitude toward nature, and to educate students as citizens who understand environmental problems, analyze them, and propose solutions. As emphasized in modern educational concepts, education is not only a means of individual development but also a key factor in ensuring sustainable societal development. UNESCO documents state that “education is a key tool in ensuring sustainable development and forming ecological awareness” (UNESCO, 2017). This idea further confirms the importance of systematically integrating environmental topics into Azerbaijani language lessons. Thus, students learn to express their thoughts through language and to think about pressing environmental issues of society. This process contributes to both their intellectual and moral development and fosters a sense of environmental responsibility.

Environmental education in Azerbaijani language lessons is implemented through various interconnected directions. First of all, reading and analyzing environmentally themed texts not only develops students’ reading skills but also strengthens their analytical and critical thinking abilities. Through such texts, students gain a deeper understanding of the importance of nature protection, identify cause-and-effect relationships, and learn to analyze the author’s viewpoint. For example, when working on a text titled “Nature is the Home of Man,” students are guided to understand not only the content but also its idea, main message, and ecological meaning. At this stage, the teacher activates students’ thinking through questions such as: “Why does the author describe nature as the home of man?” and “What consequences may arise if nature is not protected?” These questions stimulate students’ cognitive activity and help them become not only readers but also analysts.

V. Sukhomlinsky stated that “a child’s interaction with nature is the main source of the formation of his moral world” (Sukhomlinsky, 1978). This idea highlights the moral and psychological significance of integrating ecological content into Azerbaijani language lessons. Nature-themed texts influence students’ emotional world, strengthen empathy, and form a sensitive attitude toward nature. Thus, environmental education in Azerbaijani language lessons is implemented both at the cognitive and emotional levels and contributes to the holistic development of the student’s personality.

One of the important directions of environmental education is essay and composition writing. In Azerbaijani language lessons, this activity serves as one of the key tools for developing students’ creative thinking and written speech skills. When students work on topics such as “Green World,” “Let’s Protect Nature,” “My Environmental Responsibility,” and “Harmony Between Nature and Human,” they learn not only to express ideas but also to justify them and present them in a logical sequence. This process contributes to the formation of their personal position and conscious attitude toward environmental issues. For example, a student’s statement such as “If we do not protect nature, future generations will be deprived of a green world” demonstrates an emerging sense of

ecological responsibility. Such writings integrate emotional and cognitive aspects, deepening ecological thinking. At this stage, the teacher plays a guiding role, helping students express their ideas in a more systematic and scientific way.

Debates and discussions are among the most important methods of implementing environmental education in Azerbaijani language lessons. These activities develop not only knowledge but also social communication, argumentation, and critical thinking skills. Students exchange ideas on topics such as "Should plastic waste be banned?", "What are the social and environmental consequences of deforestation?", and "Is it necessary to increase green areas in cities?", learning to compare different perspectives. This process strengthens their ability to think alternatively, support claims with evidence, and justify opinions. L. Vygotsky noted that "human thinking is formed in a social environment through dialogue and interaction" (Vygotsky, 1978). This idea further confirms the importance of the debate method in environmental education, as students deepen their understanding of ecological issues through dialogue.

Lexical-semantic work plays an important role in forming the scientific basis of environmental education in Azerbaijani language lessons. At this stage, students become familiar with terms such as "ecosystem," "biodiversity," "pollution," "climate change," and "sustainable development," learning their meanings in context. This not only expands vocabulary but also contributes to the formation of scientific worldview. When teachers explain these terms using real-life examples, students better understand them and begin to use them in everyday communication. As a result, ecological vocabulary becomes part of their active lexicon and enriches their speech culture.

Creative tasks and project-based activities further strengthen the practical dimension of environmental education. Projects such as "Clean Schoolyard," "Paper Saving Week," "Water Conservation Campaign," and "Let's Plant a Tree" help students develop not only theoretical knowledge but also real behavioral change. Through these activities, students realize their personal responsibility in solving environmental problems. According to constructivist learning theory, knowledge is not passively received but actively constructed and applied by learners. Therefore, project-based learning is considered one of the most effective methods of environmental education. In this process, students cooperate, make decisions, and evaluate outcomes.

For effective environmental education, students' age and cognitive characteristics must be considered. In grades V–VII, students are in a concrete and emotional stage of thinking; therefore, environmental topics are presented in simple, figurative, and life-related forms. Topics such as "My Nature," "Green World," "Clean Air," and "My Beautiful Garden" are widely used. Students observe nature, construct texts based on pictures, and develop basic descriptive skills. This approach creates an initial emotional connection with nature and lays the foundation for ecological awareness.

In grades VIII–IX, as students' analytical thinking develops, environmental problems are examined more deeply in terms of causes and consequences. Topics such as "Causes of Air Pollution in Baku," "Consequences of Water Resource Depletion," and "Problems of Waste Management" are discussed through written and oral tasks. Students not only describe but also analyze, identify causes, and propose solutions. This strengthens critical thinking and ensures a more systematic approach to environmental issues.

In grades X–XI, environmental education becomes more critical, scientific, and socio-political. Students prepare essays and participate in debates on global warming, climate change, depletion of energy resources, and environmental policy. They use various sources, support

arguments with data, and from social positions. The main goal at this stage is not only knowledge acquisition but also the formation of civic responsibility and awareness of global environmental issues.

The materials used in Azerbaijani language lessons enhance the effectiveness of environmental education. Literary texts, journalistic writings, poems, and stories on environmental topics influence students' emotional world. For example, when analyzing poems about nature, students understand the ecological meaning of poetic expressions. The Brundtland Commission report states that "sustainable development is development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs" (WCED, 1987).

In conclusion, the implementation of environmental education in Azerbaijani language lessons plays a crucial role in the development of both language skills and ecological awareness of students. Interactive methods, age-appropriate approaches, and rich textual materials increase the effectiveness of this process. As a result, students become environmentally responsible, critically thinking, and socially active citizens.

Conclusions and Discussion

The integration of environmental education into Azerbaijani language lessons in grades V-XI shows that language teaching can be an effective platform for developing students' environmental awareness alongside linguistic competence. The analysis shows that when environmental content is systematically incorporated into reading texts, writing assignments, discussions and interactive activities, students not only develop language skills, but also gain a deeper understanding of environmental issues and develop a stronger sense of responsibility towards nature. In this context, Azerbaijani language lessons become an interdisciplinary space where cognition, communication and value-based learning intersect.

From a pedagogical perspective, the findings confirm that environmental education should not be perceived as an isolated component of natural science subjects, but as an interdisciplinary approach that encompasses all subjects, especially the humanities. This study supports this idea by showing that language-based activities such as text analysis, essay writing and discussion can effectively shape students' environmental thinking and ethical awareness.

The discussion also highlights the importance of interactive teaching methods in achieving these outcomes. Group work, brainstorming, role-playing, and project-based learning encourage active participation and collaboration among students, making environmental topics more engaging and meaningful. These methods create a learner-centered environment where students are encouraged to express their ideas, solve problems, and reflect on real-life environmental issues. As a result, both communication skills and critical thinking skills are developed simultaneously.

Furthermore, research shows that age-appropriate differentiation plays an important role in the effectiveness of environmental education. While younger students benefit more from visual materials and simple texts that develop initial environmental awareness, older students can engage in more complex analytical and argumentative tasks, such as debates and essay writing. This progression ensures the continuous and developmental formation of environmental awareness throughout the school years.

Overall, the findings show that Azerbaijani language education, when enriched with environmental content and supported by interactive methodologies, significantly contributes to the formation of environmentally responsible and socially aware individuals. This approach not only increases academic achievement, but also fosters long-term environmental values that are essential for sustainable social development.

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PROBLEMS TERMINOLOGICAL STYLE OF SPEECH IN TEACHING BIOLOGY SUBJECTS

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Abstract: Current challenges in biological terminology stem from the rapid integration of bioinformatics, neurobiology, biotechnology, bioethics, and other related disciplines into the educational process. These include the lack of uniform definitions and terminology in these fields, the emergence of new terms in bioethics (cloning, embryology) and biomedical engineering, as well as difficulties with translation and international standardization that hinder the exchange of information. The main difficulties exist in bioethics and medicine, where there is an urgent need for precise definitions of terminology concerning the status of the embryo, surrogacy, cloning, and genetic testing. In environmental terminology, standardized terms in fields related to the description of biodiversity loss, the greenhouse effect, and global warming are virtually nonexistent. As is well known, there is an urgent need to standardize the terms discussed at international scientific conferences on biological and medical sciences in the Azerbaijani language. Due to the ambiguity of biological and medical terms in the Azerbaijani language, difficulties in processing this data remain a pressing issue today. Modern technologies have become an integral part of medical and biological practice. In clinical practice, accurate data is essential for developing new artificial intelligence algorithms and image processing programs capable of making diagnosis and treatment more effective and precise. For this, precise and clear terminology is of the utmost importance.

Keywords: biological and medical sciences, precise and clear terminology, standardization of biomedical terminology in the Azerbaijani language, artificial intelligence algorithms.

BİOLOGİYA VƏ TİBB RLMLƏRİNDƏ MƏLUMATLARIN SÜNİ İNTELLEKT İLƏ İŞLƏNMƏSİNİN TERMINOLOJİ PROBLEMLƏRİ

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Xülasə: Bioloji terminologiyanın aktual problemləri bioinformatikanın, neyrobiologiyanın, biotexnologiyanın, bioetikanın və digər əlaqəli fənlərin tədrisə sürətli inteqrasiyası ilə əlaqədardır. Bu sahələrdə vahid təriflərin və terminologiyayın olmaması, bioetikada (klonlama, embriologiya) və biotibbi mühəndislikdə yeni terminlərin meydana çıxması, eləcə də məlumat mübadiləsinə mane olan tərcümə və beynəlxalq standartlaşdırma ilə bağlı çətinliklər daxildir. Çətinliklərin mövcud olduğu əsas sahələr bioetika və tibbdə, embrionun statusunun, surroqat analıq, klonlama və genetik test terminologiyasının dəqiq tərifinə ciddi ehtiyac vardır. Ekoloji terminologiyada biomüxtəlifliyin itirilməsi, istixana effekti və global istiləşmənin təsviri ilə bağlı sahələrdə standartlaşdırılmış terminlər yox dərəcəsindədir. Məlum olduğu kimi, bioloji və tibbi elmlərinə aid beynəlxalq elmi konfranslarda müzakirə olunan terminlərin azərbaycan dilində standartlaşdırılmasına ciddi ehtiyac vardır. Bioloji və tibbi terminlərin azərbaycan dilində qeyri-müəyyənliyinə görə məşin məlumatlarının emalı ilə bağlı çətinliklər dövrün aktual məsələsi olaraq qalmaqdadır. Müasir texnologiyalar tibbi və bioloji təcrübənin ayrılmaz hissəsinə çevrilmişdir. Kliniki təcrübədə diaqnoz və müalicəni daha effektiv və dəqiq edə biləcək yeni süni intellekt alqoritmləri, görüntülərin emalı proqramlarının işlənilib hazırlanması üçün dəqiq verilənlər olmalıdır. Bunun üçün mütləq dəqiq və tanınan terminlərin mövcudluğuna ciddi ehtiyac vardır.

Açar sözlər: biologiya və tibb elmləri, dəqiq və tanınan terminlər, bio-tibbi terminlərin azərbaycan dilində standartlaşdırılması, süni intellekt alqoritmləri

Introduction

An analysis of databases in the biological and medical fields shows that biology and medicine constitute an interdisciplinary field that increasingly relies on intelligent technologies: artificial intelligence, data analysis, modeling, and automation. In lectures conducted within modern virtual laboratories, we see how these technologies help solve real-world problems in biology, medicine, and veterinary medicine. AI is most commonly used in the diagnosis of skin diseases, heart diseases, the diagnosis and treatment of diabetes, as well as in the interpretation of X-ray images (Shtun, 2016). In order for artificial intelligence (AI) computer systems to perform tasks that typically require human intelligence, it is necessary to compile a dictionary of Latin terms in the Azerbaijani language. AI algorithms enable a higher level of decision-making, accuracy, and problem-solving in laboratory and practical sessions (Patel, and others, 2024)

Metodology and materials

Mastering the methods of searching for special biological information while teaching at the Azerbaijan Department of Biological and Medical disciplines, including civil medicine; specialized biological terminology; biological theories, analysis of biological information to solve specific fundamental and applied problems; ability to analyze and synthesize biological knowledge; modern problems of general biology; basic understanding of biological processes; safe work in visual laboratories; modeling of biotechnological production. Biological terminology is under pressure from rapidly developing branches of science and requires an accurate description of new concepts, which creates a gap between new discoveries and their terminological codification. To perform the tasks of computer artificial intelligence (AI) systems, which usually require human intelligence, a dictionary of Latin terms in the Azerbaijani language should be compiled. Si algorithms provide a higher level of decision making, accuracy, and problem solving in laboratory and practical classes. Biology is scientifically remembered, must be preserved and in various concepts, the study required complex terminology is rich. Serious discipline requires the use of these terms in teaching. There are a large number of terms of foreign origin in all areas of biological science, so students should understand the meaning of the terms and pronounce them correctly. Biological concepts, their

translation into Azerbaijani, such concepts, the essence of realizing what is doing, the definition of the concept from the point of view of purposefully, in parallel. Therefore, in order to facilitate memorization and understanding of complex and voluminous factual material on biology, the teacher needs to learn methodological techniques. In addition, Biology students should know the peculiarities of the scientific style of speech, the peculiarities of the formation of scientific thinking with their help. The scientific style is understood as a functional style reflecting the communicativeness, the function of language, corresponding to the goals and objectives of certain spheres of communication. The scientific style includes varieties that create specificity in the biological literature (Sharma, and others, 2024).

Discussion

One of the most pressing needs of the modern education system is the use of artificial intelligence in the processing of biomedical data. Even if explaining the terms of metagenomics – the field that studies the DNA of all microorganisms inhabiting the human body – in the Azerbaijani section were a waste of time, students would still be unable to grasp this information.

Projects such as MetaHIT (human gut metagenomics) are already available online, demonstrating how modern technologies allow us to glimpse the invisible microbial world within us. In this context, projects that have become a turning point in understanding the structure and functions of the gut microbiota are utilized. These projects are important because the gut microbiota is directly linked to digestion, immunity, metabolism, and, more importantly, mental health. It is necessary to explain that diseases are caused not only by the function of individual genes but also by disturbances in the composition or activity of microbes. Scientific information plays a key role here. The analysis of metagenomic data requires working with datasets containing millions of DNA fragments, hundreds of thousands of genes, and thousands of species of microorganisms. Identifying patterns, separating signal from noise, and building reliable models of the relationship between the composition of the microbiome and health require statistical modeling, machine learning, and visualization. Without accurate scientific data, it is impossible to unravel the complex ecosystem that exists within the human body. Large-scale studies generate petabytes of data that must be efficiently processed, stored, and analyzed. Generative AI tools have already been developed that can predict the structure and function of proteins encoded in DNA across all areas of life, identify molecules that may be useful for bioengineering and medicine, and enable laboratories to conduct dozens of other standard experiments in a matter of minutes through virtual research. However, in Azerbaijani universities, students spend all their class time searching for and translating these terms, which does not yield the expected results. It is necessary to create a terminology dictionary in Latin, English, and Azerbaijani that explains these terms so that classes can be conducted at the required level. To input text into natural language processing software, such as ChatGPT, it is also necessary to know the terms correctly; otherwise, the results obtained will be incorrect (Shen, and others, 2024).

In genetics, one of the most promising fields, artificial intelligence is advancing medicine and enabling personalized treatments through cutting-edge data analytics. Currently, artificial intelligence models are used to identify hard-to-detect genetic variants and assess their impact on health. These tools combine genomic data with clinical data to facilitate early diagnosis and lead to more accurate prognoses and personalized therapy. If students have access to a terminology dictionary that reflects this information when studying genetics, they can successfully navigate the global education system. For example, AI-based platforms are improving gene-editing methods, such as CRISPR, by optimizing target identification and enhancing the efficacy and safety of these

tools. These innovations demonstrate how artificial intelligence is transforming genomic medicine by solving complex problems related to genetic diseases and paving the way for more effective personalized treatment strategies (Zhou, Yu., and others, 2024).

In the teaching of medicinal plants, machine learning uses AI tools to assess the safety of medicinal products. As noted, students should have access to terminology dictionaries to study and memorize this information.

Conclusion

If students lack language skills, particularly in English and Latin, they face significant challenges when analyzing and clustering data. The relevance of artificial intelligence (AI) in biological and medical disciplines further underscores the importance of future applications in healthcare. Artificial intelligence is becoming an integral part of modern medicine and opens up new possibilities for the diagnosis, treatment, and prevention of diseases. The main areas in which artificial intelligence has a significant impact on biology and medical science include accurate diagnosis, personalized medicine, patient monitoring, and facilitating drug development. AI is capable of analyzing large volumes of data and identifying hidden patterns, which aids in early detection, disease prediction, and the development of individualized treatment plans. The use of artificial intelligence in medical imaging, genetic research, and robotic surgery can significantly improve the accuracy and effectiveness of treatment. It is also important to address issues of ethics, data security, and human-to-human interaction, which play a crucial role in the future development of these technologies. Thus, despite the aforementioned limitations, the future of artificial intelligence in medical science is well-positioned to revolutionize healthcare. Artificial intelligence systems help reduce doctors' time spent moving reminders, entering and organizing patient information on portals (such as Epic), and diagnosing patients, which serves as a means of providing doctors with a second opinion. Artificial intelligence systems can also help patients receive additional medical care and alternative prescription drugs. Artificial intelligence also has the ability to remotely diagnose patients, making medical services available not only in major urban centers of the world, but also in remote areas. Artificial intelligence, systems for using language knowledge for modernization and opens up great opportunities. Students can independently learn a foreign language for various programs and websites.

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THE USE OF COMMUNICATIVE AND INTERACTIVE TEACHING METHODS IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE CLASSES

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Abstract: In modern times, foreign language teaching in secondary schools requires the application of new methods and methodologies. Political, economic, and cultural relations with countries around the world, relations between states, nations, and languages open up new stages in the communication process. This requires the setting of new theoretical and practical problems in foreign language teaching and the finding of solutions. It is necessary to teach and learn a foreign language as a fully real means of communication. Creating real communication conditions by establishing natural situations and conducting discussions in a foreign language in the teaching process is one of the most important elements. Language learning does not depend solely on verbal factors, because communicative competence, etiquette rules, and other non-verbal factors also play an important role in creating effectiveness in communication.

Communication in the learning process is understood as the interaction of learners, that is, students, with each other and with the teacher in such a way that, as a result, not only knowledge, skills and habits in subjects, but also the ability to take into account the desires and behavior of one's counterpart, to understand the emotional state and condition of other students in joint activities, to be able to choose the right thing in the search for information, and to solve problems and contradictions that arise are formed. Thus, organizing foreign language lessons in accordance with the requirements of the era we live in is one of the tasks of an experienced teacher. Also, creating mutual feedback with language learners in the right direction is one of the important tasks facing the teacher today.

This article explores the role of communicative and interactive teaching methods in English language instruction. These approaches promote student-centered learning, active engagement, and the development of real-life communication skills. The paper analyzes theoretical foundations, practical classroom applications, and the effectiveness of these methods. The findings indicate that integrating communicative and interactive strategies significantly improves learners' motivation and language proficiency.

Key words: communicative and interactive teaching methods, student-centered, skills, collaboration, visual aids, to encourage

İNGİLİS DİLİ DƏRSLƏRİNDƏ KOMMUNİKATİV VƏ İNTERAKTİV TƏDRİS METODLARINDAN İSTİFADƏ

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Xülasə: Müasir dövrdə ümumtəhsil məktəblərində keçirilən xarici dil tədrisi yeni metod və metodologiyaların tətbiqini tələb edir. Dünya ölkələri ilə siyasi, iqtisadi, mədəni sahədə qarşılıqlı əlaqələr, dövlətlər, millətlər və dillər arasında olan münasibətlər ünsiyyət prosesində yeni mərhələlər açır. Bu da xarici dilin tədrisində qarşıya yeni nəzəri və praktik problemlərin qoyulmasını və həll yollarının tapılmasını tələb edir. Xarici dili tam real ünsiyyət vasitəsi kimi tədris edib öyrətmək lazımdır. Tədris prosesində təbii situasiyalar quraraq, xarici dildə diskussiyalar apararaq real ünsiyyət şəraiti yaratmaq ən önəmli ünsürlərdən biridir. Dil öyrənmək tək verbal yəni şifahi faktorlardan asılı deyil, çünki ünsiyyətdə effektivlik yaratmaqda kommunikativ səriştə, etiket qaydaları və digər qeyri-verbal faktorlar da mühüm rol oynayır.

Təlim prosesində kommunikativlik dedikdə öyrənənlərin yəni şagirdlərin bir-biri ilə və müəllimlə elə qarşılıqlı əlaqəsi başa düşülür ki, nəticə olaraq, nəinki fənlər üzrə bilik, bacarıq və vərdişlərin, həm də öz tərəf müqabilinin arzu və fəaliyyətinin davranışını nəzərə alma, birgə fəaliyyətdə olan digər şagirdlərin emosional hal və vəziyyətini anlama, məlumat axtarışında doğru olanı seçməyə qadir ola bilmə, yaranan problem və ziddiyyətləri həll etmə bacarıqları formalaşmış olsun. Belə ki, xarici dil dərslərini yaşadığımız dövrün tələblərinə uyğun təşkil etmək təcrübəli müəllimin vəzifələrindəndir. Həmçinin dilöyrənənlərlə qarşılıqlı əks-əlaqəni düzgün istiqamətdə yaratmaq da bu gün müəllimin qarşısında duran vacib məsələlərdən biridir.

Bu məqalədə ingilis dili tədrisində kommunikativ və interaktiv tədris metodlarının rolu araşdırılır. Bu yanaşmalar tələbəyə yönəlmiş öyrənməni, aktiv iştirakı və real həyatda ünsiyyət bacarıqlarının inkişafını təşviq edir. Məqalədə nəzəri əsaslar, praktik sinif tətbiqləri və bu metodların effektivliyi təhlil edilir. Nəticələr göstərir ki, kommunikativ və interaktiv strategiyaların inteqrasiyası tələbələrin motivasiyasını və dil biliklərini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə yaxşılaşdırır.

Açar sözlər: kommunikativ və interaktiv metodlar, tələbə yönümlü, bacarıqlar, əməkdaşlıq, vizual vasitələr, həvəsləndirmək

Introduction

In recent decades, English language teaching has undergone significant transformation. Traditional methods such as grammar-translation have gradually been replaced by more learner-centered approaches that emphasize communication and interaction. According to Richards and Rodgers (2001), modern language teaching prioritizes the ability to use language meaningfully rather than merely understanding its structure.

The importance of communicative competence was highlighted by Hymes, who argued that knowing a language involves more than grammatical knowledge – it requires the ability to use language appropriately in social contexts (as cited in Brown, 2007). Therefore, communicative and interactive teaching methods have become essential in modern classrooms.

The aim of this article is to examine these methods, describe their implementation, and evaluate their effectiveness in English language teaching.

Communicative Teaching Method

The communicative approach focuses on meaningful interaction and the practical use of language. It encourages learners to communicate in real-life situations and develop fluency.

Key principles include:

- Language as a tool for communication
- Emphasis on fluency over accuracy
- Integration of language skills

According to Harmer (2007), communicative activities such as role-plays, simulations, and discussions help learners use language in authentic contexts. For example, students may practice ordering food in a restaurant or asking for directions.

Research shows that communicative language teaching improves students' speaking confidence and overall fluency (Nunan, 1991). It also allows learners to take responsibility for their own learning.

Interactive Teaching Method

Interactive teaching methods focus on collaboration and active participation. These methods require students to engage with each other and the learning material.

Key characteristics include:

- Pair and group work
- Problem-solving tasks
- Use of multimedia resources

Willis (1996) emphasizes that task-based learning, a form of interactive teaching, allows students to use language to complete meaningful tasks. Examples include group discussions, debates, and project-based activities.

Interactive teaching enhances not only language skills but also critical thinking and social interaction. Students become active participants rather than passive learners.

Combination of Communicative and Interactive Methods

Combining communicative and interactive methods creates a more effective learning environment. These approaches complement each other by promoting both meaningful communication and active engagement.

Advantages include:

- Increased motivation
- Improved collaboration skills
- Development of communicative competence

For instance, in a lesson about travel, students may first learn vocabulary and then work in groups to role-play situations such as booking a hotel. This integrates communication with interaction, making learning more practical and engaging.

Materials and Teaching Techniques

Effective implementation of these methods requires diverse teaching materials and strategies:

- Authentic materials (e.g., newspapers, videos)
- Digital tools and applications
- Role-plays and simulations
- Task-based activities

According to Harmer (2007), authentic materials expose learners to real language use and increase motivation. Digital tools also enhance engagement and provide interactive learning opportunities.

Results and Discussion

Studies indicate that communicative and interactive methods significantly improve language learning outcomes. Students become more confident, motivated, and capable of using English in real-life situations (Brown, 2007).

However, challenges such as large class sizes and limited resources may affect implementation. Teachers must adapt methods to their specific classroom contexts.

Despite these challenges, the benefits of these approaches are considerable. They create a dynamic and supportive learning environment that encourages active participation.

Conclusion

Communicative and interactive teaching methods are essential components of modern English language education. They shift the focus from teacher-centered instruction to learner-centered engagement.

By integrating these methods, teachers can enhance students' communicative competence and prepare them for real-world communication. Future research should explore innovative ways to apply these approaches more effectively.

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DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS (LISTENING, SPEAKING, READING, WRITING)

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Abstract. The development of foreign language skills is a fundamental objective of modern education systems, particularly in the context of globalization and intercultural communication. This research focuses on four essential language skills – listening, speaking, reading, and writing – and examines effective strategies for their development. The study emphasizes the importance of an integrated approach, where these skills are taught in combination rather than isolation. Various methodologies, including communicative language teaching, task-based learning, and technology-enhanced instruction, are analyzed in terms of their effectiveness in improving learners' proficiency.

The research also explores psychological factors such as motivation, anxiety, and learner autonomy, which significantly influence language acquisition. Special attention is given to the role of authentic materials and real-life communication tasks in enhancing practical language use. The findings indicate that

balanced skill development leads to improved communicative competence, greater learner confidence, and better long-term retention of language knowledge.

Furthermore, the study highlights the growing importance of digital tools and online resources in facilitating language learning. It concludes that educators should adopt flexible, learner-centered approaches and create interactive learning environments to ensure effective development of all four language skills.

Keywords: Foreign language learning; communicative competence; listening skills; speaking skills; reading skills; writing skills; language acquisition

XARİCİ DİL BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAFI (DİNLƏMƏ, DANIŞMA, OXUMA, YAZMA)

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Xülasə: Xarici dil bacarıqlarının inkişafı müasir təhsil sistemlərinin əsas məqsədlərindən biridir, xüsusilə qloballaşma və mədəniyyətlərarası ünsiyyət şəraitində. Bu tədqiqat dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı kimi dörd əsas dil bacarığını araşdırır və onların inkişaf etdirilməsi üçün effektiv strategiyaları təhlil edir. Tədqiqat bu bacarıqların ayrı-ayrılıqda deyil, inteqrasiya olunmuş şəkildə öyrədilməsinin vacibliyini vurğulayır.

Kommunikativ dil tədrisi, tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə və texnologiyaya əsaslanan metodların effektivliyi geniş şəkildə araşdırılır. Bundan əlavə, motivasiya, narahatlıq və öyrənmənin müstəqilliyi kimi psixoloji amillərin dil öyrənilməsinə təsiri nəzərdən keçirilir. Real həyat materiallarının və praktik ünsiyyət tapşırıqlarının istifadəsinin dil bacarıqlarının inkişafında mühüm rol oynadığı müəyyən edilmişdir.

Nəticələr göstərir ki, balanslı şəkildə inkişaf etdirilən dörd bacarıq daha yüksək kommunikativ bacarıq, özünə inam və uzunmüddətli yadda qalma ilə nəticələnir. Eyni zamanda, rəqəmsal alətlərin və onlayn resursların dil öyrənməsində rolu getdikcə artır. Tədqiqatın nəticəsi olaraq müəllimlərə öyrənmə mərkəzli və interaktiv yanaşmalar tətbiq etmələri tövsiyə olunur.

Açar sözlər: Xarici dil öyrənilməsi; kommunikativ bacarıq; dinləmə bacarığı; danışma bacarığı; oxu bacarığı; yazı bacarığı; dil mənimsəmə

Introduction

Foreign language education has undergone significant transformations over the past decades. With the rapid development of globalization, communication across linguistic and cultural boundaries has become a necessity rather than a choice. As a result, the ability to use a foreign language effectively is now considered a key competence in both academic and professional contexts.

Language proficiency is generally defined through four fundamental skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. These skills are interdependent and collectively contribute to communicative competence. However, in many traditional educational systems, emphasis has often been placed on grammar and reading, while listening and speaking have been relatively neglected. This imbalance has led to a situation where learners may understand written texts but struggle to communicate effectively in real-life situations.

The purpose of this study is to examine the development of these four language skills and to identify effective teaching strategies that promote balanced language acquisition. The study also aims to explore the role of modern methodologies, technological tools, and psychological factors in enhancing language learning outcomes.

Materials and Methods

This research is based on a qualitative approach, involving the analysis of existing literature, teaching methodologies, and classroom practices. A variety of sources, including academic books, journal articles, and educational reports, were reviewed to provide a comprehensive understanding of language skill development.

The study focuses on several widely recognized teaching methodologies:

- **Communicative Language Teaching (CLT):** emphasizes interaction and real communication
- **Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT):** focuses on completing meaningful tasks
- **Audio-lingual Method:** based on repetition and habit formation
- **Content-Based Instruction:** integrates language learning with subject content

In addition, classroom practices were analyzed to understand how these methods are implemented in real educational settings. Particular attention was given to:

- Types of classroom activities
- Teacher-student interaction
- Use of authentic materials
- Integration of technology

Data was also gathered from observations of language learners, focusing on their performance in different skill areas. This helped identify common difficulties and effective strategies for improvement.

Results and Discussion

Listening Skills Development

Listening is a fundamental receptive skill that serves as the foundation for language acquisition. It is often the first skill developed in both first and foreign language learning, as learners are initially exposed to language through auditory input. Despite its importance, listening is frequently considered one of the most challenging skills due to the complexity of real-time processing.

One of the main difficulties in listening comprehension is the transient nature of spoken language. Unlike written texts, spoken language cannot be easily revisited unless recordings are used. (Brown, 2007) Learners must process information instantly, which requires not only linguistic knowledge but also cognitive skills such as attention, memory, and prediction. Additionally, factors such as speech rate, accent variation, intonation, and background noise can significantly affect comprehension.

Effective listening instruction should adopt a structured approach that includes three main stages: pre-listening, while-listening, and post-listening. During the pre-listening stage, learners are prepared for the task through activities such as discussing the topic, predicting content, and introducing key vocabulary. This stage activates prior knowledge and reduces comprehension difficulties.

The while-listening stage focuses on understanding the audio material. Tasks may include identifying the main idea, listening for specific details, or completing information gaps. It is important to provide learners with clear objectives to guide their listening process. Repeated listening can also be beneficial, as it allows learners to focus on different aspects of the text each time.

In the post-listening stage, learners reflect on and extend their understanding. Activities such as summarizing, discussing, or responding to the content help reinforce comprehension and integrate listening with speaking and writing skills.

The use of authentic materials is particularly important in developing listening skills. Real-life audio resources, such as podcasts, interviews, films, and conversations, expose learners to natural language use, including informal expressions and varied accents. This exposure prepares learners for real-world communication.

Moreover, the integration of technology has enhanced listening practice. Online platforms and mobile applications provide access to a wide range of audio materials, allowing learners to practice independently. Features such as subtitles, playback control, and interactive exercises further support comprehension.

In conclusion, listening skills development requires systematic practice, exposure to authentic input, and the use of effective teaching strategies. By addressing both linguistic and cognitive aspects, educators can help learners become more confident and competent listeners.

Speaking Skills Development

Speaking is a productive language skill that plays a central role in communication. It involves the ability to express thoughts, ideas, and emotions clearly and effectively in real-time interaction. Unlike receptive skills, speaking requires immediate language processing, making it one of the most demanding skills for foreign language learners.

One of the primary challenges in developing speaking skills is the presence of psychological barriers. Many learners experience anxiety, fear of making mistakes, and lack of confidence when speaking a foreign language. This phenomenon, often referred to as “foreign language anxiety,” can significantly hinder performance and participation. Therefore, creating a supportive and non-threatening learning environment is essential for encouraging learners to speak more freely.

From a linguistic perspective, speaking requires the integration of several components, including pronunciation, grammar, vocabulary, and fluency. Pronunciation is particularly important, as it affects intelligibility. Learners need to be exposed to correct pronunciation models and given opportunities to practice stress, rhythm, and intonation patterns. However, the goal should not be native-like pronunciation but rather clear and understandable speech.

Fluency and accuracy are two key dimensions of speaking. Fluency refers to the ability to speak smoothly and continuously, while accuracy involves correct use of grammar and vocabulary. In language teaching, it is important to balance these two aspects. Overemphasis on accuracy may discourage learners from speaking, while focusing only on fluency may lead to fossilized errors. Effective instruction should include activities that target both fluency (e.g., free discussions) and accuracy (e.g., controlled practice).

A variety of classroom activities can be used to develop speaking skills. Pair work and group discussions are particularly effective, as they increase student talking time and promote interaction. Role-plays and simulations allow learners to practice real-life situations, such as ordering food, participating in meetings, or solving problems. These activities not only improve speaking skills but also develop pragmatic competence – the ability to use language appropriately in different social contexts.

Another effective technique is the use of information gap activities, where learners must communicate with each other to complete a task. This type of activity creates a genuine need for communication and encourages learners to use language meaningfully. Similarly, debates and

presentations help develop more advanced speaking skills, such as argumentation and public speaking.

Feedback is an essential component of speaking development. Teachers should provide constructive feedback that focuses on both strengths and areas for improvement. Immediate correction may be useful in accuracy-focused activities, while delayed feedback is often more appropriate during fluency-based tasks to avoid interrupting communication.

The role of interaction in speaking development cannot be overstated. According to communicative language teaching principles, language is best learned through meaningful interaction. When learners engage in conversations, they negotiate meaning, clarify misunderstandings, and adapt their language use, which leads to deeper learning.

Technology has also expanded opportunities for speaking practice. Online communication tools, language exchange platforms, and virtual classrooms enable learners to interact with native speakers and other learners worldwide. Recording tools allow learners to monitor their own speech and track their progress over time.

In addition, speaking should be integrated with other language skills. For example, learners can discuss a text they have read, respond to a listening activity, or present written work orally. This integration reinforces language learning and reflects real-world communication.

In conclusion, speaking skills development requires a combination of linguistic knowledge, psychological support, and communicative practice. By providing a variety of interactive activities, encouraging participation, and offering constructive feedback, educators can help learners become confident and effective speakers in a foreign language.

Reading Skills Development

Reading is a crucial receptive skill that plays a significant role in language learning. It not only enhances vocabulary and grammar knowledge but also develops critical thinking and comprehension abilities. Through reading, learners are exposed to a wide range of linguistic structures, discourse patterns, and cultural information. (Nation, 2001)

One of the key aspects of reading is the ability to process texts at different levels. This includes understanding the general meaning (global comprehension), identifying specific information, and interpreting implicit ideas. To achieve this, learners need to develop a variety of reading strategies.

Skimming and scanning are essential techniques that help learners read efficiently. Skimming involves quickly reading a text to grasp the main idea, while scanning focuses on locating specific information. These strategies are particularly useful in academic and professional contexts where time management is important. (Ur, 2012).

Another important aspect of reading is vocabulary development. Learners often encounter unfamiliar words while reading, and the ability to infer meaning from context is a valuable skill. Teachers should encourage learners to avoid relying excessively on dictionaries and instead use contextual clues to understand new vocabulary.

Reading instruction should also include both intensive and extensive reading. Intensive reading focuses on detailed analysis of short texts, often in a classroom setting, while extensive reading involves reading longer texts for pleasure and general understanding. Extensive reading is particularly effective in improving fluency and fostering a positive attitude toward reading.

The selection of appropriate materials is essential for effective reading instruction. Texts should be relevant, engaging, and suitable for the learners' proficiency level. Authentic materials,

such as newspapers, magazines, and online articles, provide exposure to real-world language and help learners develop practical reading skills.

In addition, reading activities should be interactive and purposeful. Pre-reading tasks, such as predicting content or discussing the topic, help activate background knowledge. While-reading tasks guide comprehension, and post-reading activities, such as summarizing or critical discussion, deepen understanding.

Furthermore, reading contributes to the development of other language skills. For example, exposure to well-structured texts improves writing ability, while reading aloud can support pronunciation and speaking skills.

Overall, reading skills development requires a combination of strategy training, appropriate materials, and regular practice. By fostering both comprehension and critical thinking, educators can help learners become effective and independent readers.

Writing Skills Development

Writing is a productive skill that requires the ability to express ideas clearly, accurately, and coherently. It is often considered the most complex language skill because it involves multiple components, including grammar, vocabulary, organization, and critical thinking.

One of the main challenges in writing is the need for accuracy. Unlike speaking, where errors can be corrected in real time, writing requires careful planning and revision. Learners must pay attention to sentence structure, punctuation, and coherence, which can be difficult, especially at lower proficiency levels. (Harmer, 2015).

An effective approach to teaching writing is the process writing method, which emphasizes multiple stages of writing: planning, drafting, revising, and editing. In the planning stage, learners generate ideas and organize them into a logical structure. Drafting involves writing the initial version of the text, focusing on content rather than accuracy. During revision, learners improve the organization and clarity of their ideas, while editing focuses on correcting grammatical and lexical errors. (Brown, 2007)

Feedback plays a crucial role in writing development. Teachers should provide constructive and specific feedback that helps learners understand their mistakes and improve their performance. Peer feedback can also be valuable, as it encourages collaboration and critical thinking.

Different types of writing tasks should be included in instruction, such as descriptive, narrative, argumentative, and academic writing. Each type requires different skills and helps learners develop versatility in writing.

Another important aspect of writing is coherence and cohesion. Learners need to use linking words and logical connectors to organize their ideas effectively. Teaching these elements explicitly can significantly improve writing quality.

Technology has also contributed to writing development. Word processing tools, online writing platforms, and grammar-checking software provide immediate feedback and support the writing process. However, learners should be encouraged to develop their own writing skills rather than relying entirely on technological tools.

In addition, writing should be integrated with other skills. For example, learners can write summaries of texts they have read or reflections on listening activities. This integration reinforces language learning and provides meaningful contexts for writing.

In conclusion, writing skills development requires systematic instruction, regular practice, and constructive feedback. By focusing on both the process and the product of writing, educators can help learners become effective and confident writers.

Integration of Language Skills

The integration of language skills is a key principle in modern language teaching. In real-life communication, listening, speaking, reading, and writing are rarely used in isolation. Instead, they are interconnected and often occur simultaneously. Therefore, teaching these skills in an integrated manner is essential for developing communicative competence.

One of the main advantages of skill integration is that it reflects authentic language use. For example, in a typical conversation, a person listens to others, responds by speaking, reads messages, and writes replies. Similarly, academic tasks often require students to read texts, listen to lectures, discuss ideas, and produce written assignments. (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).

Integrated skill instruction also enhances learning efficiency. When skills are taught together, learners can reinforce their knowledge and transfer skills from one area to another. For instance, reading exposes learners to vocabulary and grammatical structures that can be used in writing and speaking.

There are several effective ways to integrate language skills in the classroom. Task-based learning is one approach that encourages learners to complete meaningful tasks using multiple skills. For example, learners may listen to a recording, discuss its content, and write a summary. Such tasks promote active engagement and meaningful communication.

Project-based learning is another effective method. In this approach, learners work on projects that require the use of all four skills. For instance, they may research a topic (reading), present their findings (speaking), listen to feedback (listening), and write a report (writing).

The integration of skills also supports learner motivation. Activities that combine different skills are often more engaging and dynamic than isolated exercises. They provide learners with a sense of purpose and help them see the practical value of language learning.

However, integrating skills requires careful planning. Teachers must design activities that are appropriate for the learners' level and ensure that all skills are practiced effectively. It is also important to provide clear instructions and support throughout the task. (Harmer, 2015).

Technology plays a significant role in facilitating skill integration. Online platforms, multimedia resources, and interactive tools allow learners to engage with language in diverse ways. For example, watching videos (listening), participating in online discussions (speaking and writing), and reading digital content can all be combined in a single learning activity.

In conclusion, the integration of language skills is essential for developing comprehensive language competence. By creating meaningful and interactive learning experiences, educators can help learners use language effectively in real-life situations.

Role of Motivation and Psychology

Motivation is a critical factor in language learning. Learners who are motivated are more likely to engage in practice and persist despite difficulties. Factors influencing motivation include:

- Personal goals
- Interest in the language and culture
- Classroom environment

Anxiety is another important factor that can negatively affect language performance, particularly in speaking. Teachers should aim to reduce anxiety by creating a supportive atmosphere.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the development of foreign language skills requires a comprehensive and balanced approach. Listening, speaking, reading, and writing should be taught in an integrated manner to reflect real-life communication.

Effective language learning depends on:

- Modern teaching methodologies
- Active learner participation
- Use of authentic materials
- Integration of technology

Teachers play a vital role in guiding learners and creating effective learning environments. By adopting learner-centered approaches and encouraging meaningful communication, educators can significantly improve language learning outcomes.

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INTERACTIVE TEACHING STRATEGIES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE LEARNING: ENHANCING STUDENT ENGAGEMENT AND COMMUNICATION SKILLS

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Abstract: This study explores the role of interactive teaching strategies in enhancing student engagement and communication skills in English language learning. Traditional teacher-centered approaches often limit students' opportunities to actively participate and practice real-life communication. In contrast, interactive methods—such as group discussions, role-plays, problem-based learning, and digital collaborative tools—create a learner-centered environment that fosters active involvement and meaningful language use.

The research examines how these strategies influence learners' motivation, confidence, and communicative competence. By integrating interactive techniques into classroom practice, students are encouraged to engage in authentic communication, negotiate meaning, and develop both linguistic and social skills.

Findings indicate that interactive teaching significantly improves students' willingness to participate, enhances their speaking and listening skills, and promotes critical thinking. Moreover, students exposed to interactive environments demonstrate higher levels of motivation and reduced language anxiety compared to those in traditional settings. Technology further enhances these advantages by offering a wide range of adaptable platforms that support communication and collaborative interaction.

The study concludes that adopting interactive teaching strategies is essential for modern English language education. It suggests that educators integrate diverse, learner-centered activities and make effective use of digital tools to foster engaging and dynamic learning environments. Such approaches not only improve language proficiency but also equip learners with essential communication skills required in academic and professional contexts.

Keywords: interaction, teaching strategies, engagement, communication, confidence

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN ÖYRƏNİLMƏSİNDƏ İNTERAKTİV TƏDRİS STRATEGİYALARI: TƏLƏBƏ FƏALLIĞININ VƏ KOMMUNİKASIYA BACARIQLARININ ARTIRILMASI

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Xülasə: Bu tədqiqat ingilis dili öyrənməsində tələbə iştirakını və ünsiyyət bacarıqlarını artırmaqda interaktiv tədris strategiyalarının rolunu araşdırır. Ənənəvi müəllim mərkəzli yanaşmalar çox vaxt tələbələrin fəal iştirakını və real həyatda ünsiyyət bacarıqlarını tətbiq etməsini məhdudlaşdırır. Bunun əksinə olaraq, qrup müzakirələri, rol oyunları, problem əsaslı öyrənmə və rəqəmsal əməkdaşlıq vasitələri kimi interaktiv metodlar tələbə mərkəzli mühit yaradaraq aktiv iştirak və mənalı dil istifadəsini təşviq edir.

Tədqiqat bu strategiyaların öyrənmələrin motivasiyası, özünəinamı və kommunikativ səriştəsinə necə təsir etdiyini araşdırır. İnteraktiv texnikaların sinif təcrübəsinə inteqrasiyası nəticəsində tələbələr autentik ünsiyyətə cəlb olunur, mənanı birlikdə formalaşdırır və həm dil, həm də sosial bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirirlər.

Nəticələr göstərir ki, interaktiv tədris tələbələrin iştirak etməyə meyilliliyini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır, onların danışmaq və dinləmə bacarıqlarını gücləndirir və tənqidi düşüncəni inkişaf etdirir. Bundan əlavə, interaktiv mühitlərdə təhsil alan tələbələr ənənəvi tədris mühitləri ilə müqayisədə daha yüksək motivasiya və daha aşağı dil narahatlığı nümayiş etdirirlər. Texnologiya isə müxtəlif uyğunlaşdırıla bilən platformalar təqdim edərək ünsiyyət və əməkdaşlıq imkanlarını genişləndirir.

Tədqiqat belə nəticəyə gəlir ki, interaktiv tədris strategiyalarının tətbiqi müasir ingilis dili təhsilində zəruridir. O, müəllimlərin müxtəlif, tələbə mərkəzli fəaliyyətləri inteqrasiya etməsini və cəlbəedici, dinamik öyrənmə mühitləri yaratmaq üçün rəqəmsal vasitələrdən səmərəli istifadə etməsini tövsiyə edir. Bu yanaşmalar təkcə dil bacarıqlarını deyil, həm də akademik və peşəkar mühitlərdə tələb olunan vacib ünsiyyət bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirir.

Açar sözlər: interaktiv ünsiyyət, tədris strategiyaları, fəallıq, kommunikasiya, özünə güvən

Introduction

Interactive learning has become a key element of contemporary educational methods, especially within the field of English Language Teaching (ELT). With the shift from traditional, teacher-centred approaches such as the 'grammar translation method' to student-centred methodologies such as the 'communicative approach', a very definite emphasis on interactive learning and communication is at the forefront of ELT. As teachers we know that fostering interaction is crucial for language acquisition and proficiency development. We know that the best way to help our students learn the target language and use it confidently and fluently, not to mention

accurately, is encouraging them to speak. Whether your teaching context is adults or juniors, General English or CLIL, every classroom can benefit from maximising interactive learning in the classroom. This article explores various techniques and approaches to enhance interactive learning in the ELT classroom, empowering both teachers and students to actively engage in the language learning process in a fun yet effective way.

Language is a means of communication; People use language in transmitting information or messages and expressing their thoughts and emotions. Language is also used to state everyone's hopes, ambitions, and thoughts. Moreover, language can serve the human requests in their communication in all sectors, such as manufacturing, military, business, tourism, transport, sports, international relations, and especially in education (Jondeya, 2011).

The speaking skill could be considered the most important one among the four language skills. People who know a language are referred to as 'speakers of this language', as if speaking integrated all other types of skills, and many, if not most foreign language learners are mainly interested in learning to speak (Ur, 2006). Speaking needs that learners not only recognize how to produce specific points of language for example grammar, vocabulary or pronunciation (linguistic competence), but also they recognize when, why and in what ways to produce language (sociolinguistic competence) (Cunningham, 1999).

The speaking skill is as vital as any other language skill: whether reading, writing, speaking and listening, obviously appear together in every English class, even in the EFL context. To teach the speaking skill is to teach the learners to produce English sounds correctly using vocabulary in grammatically correct sentences coherently and fluently.

EFL learners are expected to develop their speaking skills through interaction with others. However, producing appropriate English in the classroom can be challenging due to limited opportunities to use the language in everyday life. Various factors need to be considered, including pronunciation, vocabulary, fluency, grammar, intonation, tone, stress, word choice, and overall communicative effectiveness.

Instructors should select activities that enhance students' learning and avoid ones that are a waste of instructors' and students' time. Although the importance of the speaking skills as a crucial means for communication, students face many difficulties when they speak in EFL classes, So the use of some interactive teaching strategies as brainstorming, role playing, classroom discussion could be a viable means to enhance students' speaking skills. Successful English teaching relies not only on the content and methodologies, but also on the guidance and timely feedback from teachers. Teachers should observe students' performance during the learning process and provide both positive and constructive feedback. Such interactions not only enhance students' motivation to learn, but also help them identify and correct mistakes, further improving their learning outcomes.

By combining interactive teaching methods such as storytelling and group discussions, English teachers can significantly increase student engagement and speaking proficiency, turning the classroom into a vibrant and effective learning environment. Through these strategies, students not only make progress in language learning, but also build confidence in communication and expression.

Stories are a powerful and universal way of communication that bring people together across cultures and backgrounds, making complex ideas more accessible. In English language teaching, using stories to introduce new vocabulary or grammar can significantly enhance student engagement while also improving comprehension and memory. This is because stories present language in meaningful, real-life contexts. For example, when teaching the past tense, a teacher

might share a story about a trip, allowing students to practice various verb forms within a natural narrative setting.

Group discussions are a valuable method for improving students' English speaking abilities. They provide a supportive setting in which learners feel more comfortable sharing their ideas, while also encouraging active thinking and communication in the target language. When teachers consistently incorporate activities like role-plays and debates, students have the chance to use English in real-life situations, which enhances both their fluency and self-confidence.

Interactive teaching emphasizes the active participation of learners, transforming them from passive recipients into engaged contributors in the learning process. It represents a modern trend in education where the teacher adapts their methods to meet students' needs by applying a variety of interactive strategies. An effective interactive teacher understands learners' individual differences and preferred learning styles. Through meaningful personal interaction, instructors also support the positive development of students' personalities, as noted by Alegaonkar (2007).

Methodology and Materials

There are different types of Interactive Teaching Strategies:

1) Classroom discussion

Classroom discussion is widely regarded as one of the most effective instructional strategies for enhancing students' communicative competence, particularly in the context of teaching English as a Foreign Language (EFL). It involves organizing learners into pairs or small groups so they can actively participate in exchanging ideas, rather than relying on teacher-centered instruction. Through such structured interaction, students are encouraged to use the target language in meaningful ways, which strengthens both their fluency and confidence. According to Murdibjono (2001), classroom discussion is especially beneficial because it gives learners more opportunities to practice speaking. When students interact with peers, they are already familiar with, they tend to feel more comfortable and less inhibited by anxiety or fear of making mistakes. This supportive atmosphere helps reduce psychological barriers that often prevent learners from participating actively in language use.

In this context, classroom discussion can be understood as the open and dynamic exchange of ideas among three or more participants, which may include the teacher as a facilitator. Rather than dominating the conversation, the instructor guides and supports the interaction, ensuring that all students have the opportunity to contribute. This approach promotes peer-to-peer learning, where students not only practice language skills but also learn from one another's perspectives, vocabulary usage, and communicative strategies. Furthermore, classroom discussion encourages critical thinking, active listening, and collaboration. Activities such as problem-solving tasks, debates, and role-plays can be incorporated to make discussions more engaging and purposeful. By participating in these interactive settings, students develop not only their linguistic abilities but also essential social and cognitive skills, making classroom discussion a powerful and comprehensive tool in modern language teaching.

2) Brainstorming

Brainstorming stimulates creative and divergent thinking, enabling learners to generate vocabulary, develop story ideas, and explore topics more deeply, thereby going beyond routine exercises and promoting higher-order cognitive skills. As a learner-centered strategy, brainstorming creates an open environment in which participants feel encouraged to share ideas freely without immediate judgment, thereby increasing both confidence and engagement. It means the use of brain to the active problem solving and the brainstorming session aims to develop creative

solutions to problems (Jarwan, 2005). The brainstorming process is essentially collaborative and iterative. It typically begins with the rapid generation of ideas at the individual level, followed by the exchange and discussion of these ideas within a group. Through this process, participants evaluate, improve, and build upon their original ideas. According to Homan et al. (2007), this cycle of individual idea generation, group discussion, and collective evaluation enables the integration of diverse perspectives, ultimately resulting in more comprehensive and creative solutions.

In educational settings, brainstorming not only enhances language development and critical thinking but also supports social interaction and cooperative learning. Therefore, brainstorming continues to be an essential teaching strategy for fostering creativity and effective problem-solving across different fields.

2) Role playing

In role playing, a language is not studied but used (Larsen-Freeman, 2001). The researcher defined role playing as it is a kind of communicative activity in which the student plays the part of somebody else in a specific situation. It is a good strategy to improve cultural knowledge because they give a relatively safe and protected situation in which students can make cultural and language errors without feeling too threatened.

Role playing is particularly effective in ELL classrooms because it creates authentic, purposeful communication. Learners engage in simulated real-life scenarios—such as ordering food, participating in interviews, or resolving conflicts – which require them to think critically and respond spontaneously. This helps develop fluency, pragmatic competence, and conversational skills, as students must negotiate meaning, interpret social cues, and adapt their language according to context.

Another significant advantage of role playing is its contribution to cultural competence. By stepping into the roles of individuals from different cultural or social backgrounds, students gain insight into cultural norms, values and communication styles. This experiential learning approach promotes intercultural awareness and sensitivity, which are essential components of effective language use in global contexts.

Importantly, role playing provides a supportive and low-risk learning environment. Since students are “acting” as someone else, they often feel less anxious about making mistakes. This reduced affective filter encourages greater participation, experimentation with language, and willingness to take risks. As a result, learners can make linguistic and cultural errors without feeling overly self-conscious or threatened, which enhances confidence and accelerates language development.

Furthermore, role playing fosters collaborative learning and social interaction. Students work together to create dialogues, negotiate roles, and perform scenarios, thereby strengthening teamwork and communication skills. Collaborative learning involves students actively contributing their individual strengths through the sharing of knowledge, ideas, and strategies. This process takes place in a supportive and cooperative environment, which not only facilitates the acquisition of new knowledge but also promotes higher levels of cognitive engagement, gradually evolving into more advanced forms of teamwork and partnership. It also allows teachers to observe learners’ language use in dynamic contexts and provide targeted feedback.

Overall, role playing is a highly effective instructional strategy in ELL, as it integrates linguistic practice with social, cultural, and cognitive development, ultimately leading to more meaningful and sustained language learning.

Discussion

Interactive activities during lessons focus on fostering dialogue communication, cultivating mutual understanding, interaction, and the joint resolution of shared, yet personally significant tasks. Through such approaches, students develop critical thinking abilities, address complex problems by examining contexts and relevant information, consider multiple perspectives, make well-informed decisions, and participate in meaningful discussions while communicating effectively. These outcomes are supported through a variety of methods, including individual, group, and cooperative work, participation in research-based tasks, role-playing activities, analysis of documents and diverse information sources, as well as involvement in creative practices. Within the teaching–learning process, several key dimensions can be distinguished: the content dimension (what is taught), the procedural dimension (how it is taught), the motivational dimension (how learners are actively engaged), and the organizational dimension (how both teacher and student activities are structured). Each of these dimensions incorporates a range of concepts and strategies, such as the integration and meaningful synthesis of learning materials, the use of problem-based and interactive methodologies, the stimulation of learners' cognitive interest and motivation, and the application of organizational approaches grounded in humanistic and collaborative pedagogy.

The rapid development of modern society requires students to quickly absorb and understand information, especially in the context of foreign language learning. Today, proficiency in at least one foreign language is an essential competence for professionals across various fields. Therefore, increasing the effectiveness and quality of language education has become a key priority. Interactive methods are widely regarded as some of the most effective approaches to language acquisition. The concept of “interactive” refers to cooperation and reciprocal influence among participants, involving dialogue and communication between teachers and students, as well as among students themselves. The success of such methods largely depends on active student participation. Interactive learning aims to establish a learning environment in which all students are engaged, able to understand and influence one another, and contribute meaningfully to the educational process within a positive and supportive atmosphere.

It is clear that students engaged in interactive classes tend to be both attentive and diligent. Overall, the discussion of these techniques suggests that interactive teaching methods play a crucial role in improving the process of learning English. Such approaches are designed to strengthen motivation and increase the overall effectiveness of language education.

Integrating interactive methods into the learning experience offers numerous advantages. These include creating conditions that closely resemble real-life professional contexts, promoting learner independence, encouraging decision-making within a dynamic and creative environment, improving spontaneous speaking abilities, enhancing organizational skills, and narrowing the gap between theoretical language study and its practical use.

Furthermore, the integration of interactive techniques contributes to increased learner motivation, greater self-confidence, and reduced language anxiety – key factors for successful language acquisition. The use of digital tools amplifies these outcomes by providing flexible and inclusive platforms for communication and cooperation.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the adoption of interactive, technology-supported teaching practices is essential for modern English language education. Interactive approaches – supported by digital tools, collaborative platforms, and real-time communication – create opportunities for students to actively engage with the language rather than passively absorb it. This active involvement enables learners to develop a deeper understanding of linguistic structures while simultaneously building confidence

in using the language in authentic contexts. Such approaches not only enhance linguistic proficiency but also equip learners with the communication and interpersonal skills necessary for academic success and professional development in a globalized world.

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A SKILL-ORIENTED APPROACH TO FOREIGN LANGUAGE ACQUISITION

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Abstract: The development of foreign language skills is a crucial component of modern education in an increasingly globalized and interconnected world. Proficiency in a foreign language not only enhances communication across cultures but also provides academic and professional advantages. This article examines the four core language skills—listening, speaking, reading, and writing—and emphasizes their interdependent nature in achieving communicative competence. It further explores effective strategies and methodologies for improving each skill, including exposure to authentic materials, interactive practice, and learner-centered approaches. Additionally, the study highlights the importance of integrating these skills in real-life contexts rather than teaching them in isolation. The role of technology, such as digital platforms and artificial intelligence tools, is also discussed as a means of facilitating language acquisition and providing personalized learning opportunities. Overall, the article argues that a balanced and integrated approach to language learning leads to more effective and sustainable outcomes for learners.

Keywords: foreign language learning, listening skills, speaking skills, reading comprehension, writing skills, language acquisition, communicative competence

XARİCİ DİLİN MƏNİMSƏNİLMƏSİNDƏ BACARIQ ƏSASLI YANAŞMA

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Xülasə: Qloballaşan və qarşılıqlı əlaqələrin artdığı müasir dünyada xarici dil bacarıqlarının inkişaf etdirilməsi təhsilin mühüm tərkib hissəsinə çevrilmişdir. Xarici dil bilikləri yalnız mədəniyyətlərarası ünsiyyəti gücləndirmir, eyni zamanda akademik və peşəkar sahədə əhəmiyyətli üstünlüklər yaradır. Bu məqalədə dilin dörd əsas bacarığı – dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı – təhlil olunur və onların kommunikativ kompetensiyanın formalaşmasında qarşılıqlı asılılığı vurğulanır. Eyni zamanda, hər bir bacarığın inkişaf etdirilməsi üçün effektiv strategiyalar və metodlar araşdırılır; bunlara autentik materiallarla işləmək, interaktiv məşğələlər və öyrənən yönümlü yanaşmalar daxildir. Bundan əlavə, bu bacarıqların ayrı-ayrılıqda deyil, real həyat kontekstində integrasiya olunmuş şəkildə öyrədilməsinin vacibliyi xüsusi olaraq qeyd edilir. Məqalədə həmçinin rəqəmsal platformalar və süni intellekt alətləri kimi texnologiyaların dil öyrənməni asanlaşdırmaq və fərdiləşdirilmiş təlim imkanları yaratmaq baxımından rolu da müzakirə olunur. Ümumilikdə, məqalə göstərir ki, balanslaşdırılmış və integrativ yanaşma dil öyrənənlər üçün daha effektiv və davamlı nəticələrə gətirib çıxarır.

Açar sözlər: Xarici dil öyrənilməsi, dinləmə bacarıqları, danışma bacarıqları, oxuyub-anlama, yazı bacarıqları, dil mənimsənilməsi, kommunikativ kompetensiya

Introduction

Foreign language learning has become essential in the 21st century due to globalization, international communication, and academic mobility. Mastery of a foreign language requires the development of four fundamental skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. These skills are interrelated and collectively contribute to communicative competence. Traditional language teaching methods often focused heavily on grammar and translation. However, modern approaches emphasize practical communication and the integration all four skills. Developing these skills effectively requires both structured instruction and continuous practice in real-life contexts (Chapelle, 2003 p. 15–20).

Listening is often considered the most challenging skill for language learners, as it involves understanding spoken language in real time. It requires the ability to recognize sounds, interpret meaning, and respond appropriately. Listening plays a crucial role in language acquisition because it provides input necessary for developing other skills. According to Krashen's Input Hypothesis, comprehensible input is essential for language learning (Day, 1998, p. 20–25). Listening is widely regarded as one of the most fundamental yet challenging skills in foreign language learning. Unlike reading, where learners can control the pace, listening requires immediate processing of spoken language, often without the opportunity to revisit unclear parts. This makes it a cognitively demanding activity that involves not only hearing sounds but also interpreting meaning, recognizing intonation patterns, and understanding context.

From a pedagogical perspective, listening serves as the primary source of language input. According to Krashen's Input Hypothesis, learners acquire language most effectively when they are exposed to comprehensible input that is slightly above their current level of proficiency (Day, 1998, p. 20–25). This highlights the importance of selecting appropriate listening materials that are both challenging and accessible.

There are two main types of listening: **intensive listening** and **extensive listening**. Intensive listening focuses on detailed understanding, such as identifying specific words, grammatical structures, or pronunciation features. It is often practiced in classroom settings through exercises

like gap-filling or dictation. In contrast, extensive listening involves exposure to longer texts for general understanding, such as podcasts, films, or lectures. This type of listening helps learners develop fluency and overall comprehension.

Speaking is a productive skill that allows learners to express their thoughts, ideas, and emotions. One of the main challenges in speaking is overcoming anxiety. Many learners fear making mistakes, which can hinder their progress (Ellis, 2003, p. 123). Developing speaking skills involves several sub-competencies, including pronunciation, fluency, accuracy, and discourse management. Pronunciation ensures intelligibility, while fluency reflects the learner's ability to speak smoothly without excessive hesitation. Accuracy, on the other hand, focuses on the correct use of grammar and vocabulary. Discourse management refers to the ability to organize ideas logically and maintain coherence during communication.

In modern language teaching approaches, communicative activities such as role-plays, discussions, debates, and presentations are widely used to enhance speaking ability. These tasks encourage learners to use language meaningfully rather than memorizing isolated structures. Moreover, interaction with native speakers or AI-based conversation partners can significantly improve confidence and spontaneity. Another important factor in speaking development is reducing anxiety. Many learners experience fear of making mistakes, which limits their willingness to speak. Creating a supportive learning environment where errors are seen as part of the learning process is therefore crucial.

Reading is a receptive skill that helps learners acquire vocabulary, grammar structures, and cultural knowledge. Extensive reading has been shown to significantly improve language proficiency (Hymes, 1972, p. 6–10). Effective reading comprehension depends on several sub-skills, including skimming, scanning, detailed reading, and inferencing. Skimming allows learners to grasp the general idea of a text quickly, while scanning helps locate specific information. Detailed reading focuses on understanding the text more deeply, and inferencing enables learners to interpret implied meanings that are not explicitly stated. Reading also contributes significantly to vocabulary development. When learners encounter new words in context, they are more likely to understand and retain them compared to isolated memorization. Additionally, exposure to authentic texts such as articles, essays, and stories helps learners become familiar with natural language usage and cultural contexts. In modern language teaching, extensive reading programs and graded readers are commonly used to improve reading fluency. Extensive reading encourages learners to read large amounts of material for general understanding and enjoyment, while intensive reading focuses on close analysis of shorter texts to develop accuracy and comprehension skills.

Writing is a complex skill that requires organization, grammar accuracy, and clarity. Process writing is considered one of the most effective approaches (Harmer, 2007, p. 335–340). The development of writing skills involves several key components, including content generation, organization, coherence, cohesion, grammar accuracy, and vocabulary use. Content generation refers to the ability to develop relevant and meaningful ideas. Organization ensures that these ideas are arranged in a logical structure, typically with an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion. Coherence and cohesion help connect ideas smoothly using linking words and logical transitions, making the text easier to understand. In foreign language learning, writing is often developed through guided practice, such as paragraph writing, essay tasks, summarization, and creative writing activities. Process writing is especially effective, as it emphasizes planning, drafting, revising, and editing. This approach helps learners improve both accuracy and clarity over time rather than focusing only on the final product.

Methodology and materials

This study uses a qualitative descriptive approach based on the analysis of existing literature in applied linguistics and language teaching. No primary data was collected. The materials include academic books, journal articles, and research on second language acquisition and communicative language teaching. The study mainly focuses on theories such as Krashen's Input Hypothesis and process-oriented learning. Listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills are analyzed through previous studies. Listening is examined through audio materials and classroom tasks; speaking through communicative activities; reading through authentic and graded texts; and writing through process-based approaches such as drafting and revising. The study is based on secondary data and aims to identify effective strategies for developing language skills.

Discussion

The analysis shows that the four language skills are closely connected and should be developed together. Listening provides essential input for language learning, while speaking improves through practice and confidence-building activities. Reading helps expand vocabulary and supports writing development, especially through exposure to authentic texts. Writing is the most complex skill and improves effectively through a step-by-step process approach.

Overall, an integrated teaching approach that combines all four skills is more effective than teaching them separately. Interactive methods and authentic materials further support learner development and communication skills.

Conclusion

The development of listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills is essential for achieving proficiency. A balanced and integrated approach leads to effective outcomes. Each skill contributes differently, yet none can be fully developed in isolation. A balanced approach that integrates all four skills leads to more effective and meaningful language learning. Modern teaching methods, including communicative activities, authentic materials, and technology-based tools, further enhance the development of these skills.

Therefore, mastering a foreign language requires continuous practice, exposure, and interaction. When learners actively engage with all four skills, they become more confident and competent communicators, capable of using the language effectively in academic, professional, and real-life contexts.

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THE EFFECTS OF SKIMMING AND SCANNING TECHNIQUES ON 5TH GRADE STUDENTS' READING SPEED AND COMPREHENSION

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Abstract: Reading skills have been a necessity for a very long time, and even today, they remain an integral part of the development of modern society. For this reason, the ability to pragmatically analyze written language and make decisions accordingly is a highly valuable asset for today's societies. In this regard, this paper aims to demonstrate the effectiveness of Skimming and Scanning in improving 5th-grade students' reading speed and comprehension. To conduct this research, 10 5th-grade students from a middle school in Izmir, Türkiye, are selected and given a text approximately 300 words in length and appropriate to their current levels, followed by 7 questions to test their performance prior to instruction. The procedure proceeds by providing instruction related to skimming and scanning strategies in reading, which takes 2 lessons, then they will be given another text that is similar to the pre-test, including around 300 words and 7 follow-up questions to determine whether these techniques, skimming and scanning, are useful and the findings are in line with the consequences. Findings show that using scanning and skimming techniques actually affects reading ability. These techniques improve students' reading speed and comprehension accuracy. Although there are some drawbacks, such as a lack of participants, a limited setting, and limited time, the study shows that these techniques for improving reading skills are effective in English language teaching.

Keywords: Reading, Skimming, Scanning, Comprehension.

GÖZ GEZDİRME VE TARAMA TEKNİKLERİNİN 5. SINIF ÖĞRENCİLERİNİN OKUMA HIZI VE KAVRAMALARINA ETKİLERİ

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Özet: Okuma becerisi antik çağlardan beri bulunduğu zamanın gerektirdiği ihtiyaçlardan birisidir ve günümüzde de okuma becerisi modern toplumun gelişmesi için ayrılmaz bir parçasıdır. Bu nedenle insanların yazılı dili pragmatik bir şekilde çözümlemesi ve bu doğrultuda kararlar verebilmesi günümüz toplumları için çok değerli bir unsurdur. Bu nedenle, bu araştırma okuma tekniklerinin, özellikle Göz Gezdirmeye ve Tarama, 5. Sınıf öğrencilerinin okuma hızı kapasitesi ve kavraması üzerindeki etkisini göstermeyi amaçlamaktadır. Bu araştırmayı yürütmek adına, İzmir, Türkiye'deki bir ortaokuldan 10 öğrenci seçilmiştir ve mevcut seviyelerine uygun yaklaşık 300 kelimelik bir metin verilip, devamında anlatım öncesi performanslarını ölçmek için 7 soru verilmiştir. Süreç göz gezdirmeye ve tarama teknikleri hakkında 2 ders saati sürecek bir öğretimle devam eder. Öncesinde verilen metne benzer yaklaşık 300 kelimelik bir metin ve bu tekniklerin,

göz gezdirme ve tarama, kullanışlı olup olmadığını ve verilerin sonuçlarla uyumlu olup olmadığını belirlemek için 7 soru içerir. Bu teknikler öğrencilerin okuma hızlarını ve verilen metinler bağlamında doğruluklarını geliştirmiştir. Katılımcıların sayıca eksikliği, ortam ve süre bakımından bazı dezavantajlar olmasına rağmen, bu tekniklerin İngilizce dili öğretiminde okuma becerilerini geliştirdiğini ortaya koymuştur.

Anahtar Kelimeler: Okuma, Göz Gezdirme, Tarama, Kavrama

1. Introduction

Reading is an indispensable skill taught in schools alongside listening, speaking, and writing. It is not only concerned with reading per se, but also with understanding what to read is rather significant. In other words, students need to be able to interpret, reason, and use pragmatically what they read. Afferbach et al. (2008) indicate that reading skills are automatic processes that support decoding and comprehension with speed, efficiency, and fluency. This definition aligns with the idea that reading skill demands rapid reading, interpretation, understanding, and the search for specific information to be comprehended. Another definition of reading skill emphasizes how difficult it is to acquire, as McKee (2012) notes that reading comprehension is a complex activity that involves multiple processes. Teachers can ease this skill burden on students by applying these strategies, helping them acquire reading skills. Furthermore, reading comprehension is crucial in every stage of life, and so being able to interpret words, sentences, chunks (symbols, briefly) is what the instructors want from their students to cope with social-cultural requirements. To do so, there are two main techniques that make reading easier and faster to understand: scanning and skimming.

Secondly, as a reading strategy, scanning allows readers to find specific information, such as dates, locations, names, and statistics, in any given written format. It requires quick eye movements and focused attention on specific data, and the key point is that the reader does not have to read every single word to understand it. Shinta (2024) describes scanning as a reading skill that enables readers to locate specific information quickly. This technique streamlines answering questions and quickly extracts specific data from the given text. Additionally, Fauzi (2018) draws a clear distinction between scanning and skimming by saying ‘scanning is more of a limited activity, only retrieving information relevant to a purpose.’ This definition draws a line; however, it does not devalue the effectiveness of scanning compared to skimming.

As the third issue, skimming is another reading technique that is used when readers need to understand the topic, main idea, and the structure of the text. Skimming is another subject that researchers have been working on. According to Banditvilai (2020), the purpose of skimming is to get an overview of the organization of a text and its main idea from a passage in a book, and to describe it as a useful technique for developing a schema of the given text. Additionally, Hong (2013) indicates that Skimming has been deemed either a rapid reading skill leading to superficial understanding or a demanding cognitive or metacognitive skill.’ This description emphasizes the requirements for some cognitive abilities, rather than treating it as just a reading technique. Similarly, in scanning, the reader does not have to focus on every word; they can focus on the first sentences of each paragraph. With skimming, students can easily infer some ideas by just looking over a text. To determine how effectively these techniques are applied to reading skills, this paper aims to answer this question by conducting a 2-phase process and evaluating the outcomes.

In light of all the above, this study aims to reveal the effectiveness of Skimming and Scanning in improving 5th-grade students' reading speed and comprehension. To fulfill this, the research questions are proposed as follows:

1. In order to analyze and interpret the findings and results, two questions are chosen to define whether this process has given a proper consequence or not:
2. How do skimming and scanning affect reading skills?
3. If so, to what extent do they affect the development of reading skills?

3. Methodology

This paper is based on an experimental method design divided into two sections: pre-test reading and post-test reading. 10 Turkish students in the 5th grade who had similar levels in English were chosen. The procedure was conducted anonymously; information on students' ages, genders, and names was not used or shared for any purpose. In accordance with this process, students were given a text of approximately 300 words with 7 follow-up questions to gather data before using skimming and scanning techniques. Then, skimming and scanning techniques were taught in two 45-minute sessions, including their definitions, uses, and examples. Afterward, they were given another text that had the same level as before and measured how their reading comprehension and speed were influenced by using the two reading techniques. The data gathered during the process include students' WPM (words per minute) scores and their success rates on each test, and are used to compare and demonstrate the effects of skimming and scanning techniques. The further examinations are included in the 'Findings and Results' section with Table 1 and Table 2.

4. Findings and Results

Due to the small number of participants (below 30), the Wilcoxon signed-rank test is used, a nonparametric test for comparing two related samples to assess WPM and test accuracy. The data has shown that reading strategies, such as skimming and scanning, are highly effective in English language teaching among 5th-grade students. The difference between Pre-Test and Post-Test in terms of word per second (WPM) and accuracy is shown in Table 1: Paired Samples T-Test with the names of WPM_Pre, WPM_Post, and Accuracy Pre, Accuracy Post titles.

Table 1. Paired Samples T-Test

Measure 1		Measure 2	<i>W</i>	<i>z</i>	<i>df</i>	<i>p</i>
WPM_Pre	-	WPM_Post	0.000	-2.80		.002
Accuracy_Pre	-	Accuracy_Post	3.500	-2.25		.028

Note. Wilcoxon signed-rank test.

The table shows that all 5th-grade participants demonstrate an increase in their English reading speed, as indicated by the *W* value (0.00), which indicates that all participants improved their reading skills in the post-test phase. In addition, the *p*-value indicates that the process is statistically significant and affects their reading speed. For accuracy, some students showed no or little increase in their development on 7 post-test questions, indicating that the scores are highly practical, and the *p*-value (.028) also supports the idea that all participants participated properly and effectively.

Table 2. Descriptive statistics

	N	Mean	SD	Coefficient of variation
WPM_Pre	10	109.7	27.50	0.251
WPM_Post	10	213.2	53.00	0.249
Accuracy_Pre	10	3.400	2.119	0.623
Accuracy_Post	10	5.050	1.657	0.328

Table 2 provides more detailed information about the process. In the WPM_Pre and WPM_Post sections, it can be seen that students' reading speed increased from 109.7 (SD = 27.50) to 213.2 (SD = 53.00), indicating a wider distribution of reading speed. When it comes to the Accuracy Pré and Accuracy Post sections, which includes 7 questions for each tests, students has demonstrated development as well as WPM section, since the mean scores rising from 3.4 to 5.05 indicate the improvement in the success rate of 7 questions, while SD scores (2.1 in Accuracy Pré and 1.6 in Accuracy Post) explain that the students are distributed homogenously in Post-Test after the instruction of skimming and scanning strategies.

5. Discussion and Conclusion

As a result, reading strategies such as skimming and scanning can improve reading skills. Based on the research, reading speed increased significantly, and students found what they were looking for in the text. Additionally, the group's accuracy has improved, though some participants showed little or no improvement in that section. However, it can be clearly stated that this research has some drawbacks and lacks. First, these findings would have differed if there had been more participants, yielding more accurate results. Secondly, the tests were designed with the help of artificial intelligence, with attention to difficulty levels, so this research may be conducted using official resources and advanced settings suitable for this process. Notwithstanding the drawbacks, further research will probably show similar results in improving reading skills among younger ages.

Reading is a fundamental skill that cannot be separated from the other language skills, and there have been several practices and research in this field to enhance reading skills to a desired, optimal level for everyone. The study showed that applying reading strategies, especially skimming and scanning, can improve reading skills at a younger age to cope with understanding of the given test and accuracy. Although there are some drawbacks related to both the design and the facilities, the study has shown that reading strategies should be taught by teachers. Especially in countries like Turkiye, exams administered by officials are highly dependent on reading comprehension, underscoring the importance of developing reading skills.

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THE USE OF INNOVATIVE TEACHING METHODS IN TEACHING ENGLISH AT SPECIALIZED MILITARY EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

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Abstract: In the rapidly evolving field of education, exploring innovative teaching methods for effective foreign language acquisition in specialized military institutions holds significant importance. These methods aim to enhance the professional preparedness of military personnel by improving their language proficiency in a shorter time and ensuring long-term retention of learned material. Traditional approaches to language teaching, while valuable, often fail to meet the specific demands of military environments, such as rapid learning, practical communication, and the ability to perform under high stress. Innovative methods address these gaps by focusing on learner-centered approaches that are interactive, practical, and tailored to individual needs. Techniques such as project-based learning, game-based learning, communicative methods, and technology-driven tools play a key role in fostering creativity, critical thinking, and active participation among military learners. These approaches also integrate military-specific requirements, such as clear and concise communication and the use of abbreviations, into language programs. The application of such methods is crucial for preparing personnel for multilingual environments, enabling effective communication during foreign missions, intelligence operations, and conflict resolution. By adopting innovative strategies, military institutions can better equip their personnel to succeed in global security operations, ensuring their language skills contribute directly to mission success.

Key words: Innovative methods, foreign language teaching, new technologies, military environment.

HƏRBİ TƏHSİL MÜƏSSISƏLƏRİNDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ İNNOVATİV TƏLİM METODLARINDAN İSTİFADƏ

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Xülasə: Hərbi təhsil müəssisələrində ingilis dilinin səmərəli öyrənilməsi üçün innovativ təlim metodlarının tətbiqi mühüm əhəmiyyət kəsb edir. İnnovativ təlim metodları hərbi qulluqçuların peşəkar hazırlığını artırmaq məqsədilə onların dil biliklərini qısa müddətdə inkişaf etdirmək və öyrənilən materialların uzun müddət yadda qalmasını təmin etməyə yönəlmişdir. Xüsusi təyinatlı hərbi müəssisələrdə xarici dillərin öyrədilməsində innovativ təlim metodlarının tətbiqi müasir təhsil tələblərinə cavab verərək tədris prosesinin keyfiyyətini artırır. Bu metodlar ənənəvi yanaşmalardan fərqli olaraq, hərbi mühitin spesifik ehtiyaclarını nəzərə alır və öyrənən mərkəzli yanaşma ilə tədrisi daha səmərəli edir. Layihə əsaslı, oyun əsaslı, kommunikativ, konstruktiv və texnologiya əsaslı metodlar hərbi qulluqçuların dil öyrənmə prosesini sürətləndirir, praktiki ünsiyyət bacarıqlarını təkmilləşdirir, onların dil öyrənməkdə fərdi tələbat və ehtiyaclarını təmin etmiş olur.

Hərbi mühitin xüsusi tələblərinə cavab verən innovativ metodlar şəxsi heyətin çoxdillli mühitdə uğurla fəaliyyət göstərməsinə əlverişli imkanlar yaradır və beynəlxalq təhlükəsizlik əməliyyatlarında səmərəli ünsiyyət bacarıqlarını təmin edir. Beləliklə, innovativ təlim metodlarının tətbiqi xarici dillərin öyrədilməsi sahəsində yeni imkanlar açaraq hərbi qulluqçuların peşəkar hazırlıq səviyyəsini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə yüksəldir və onların uğurla fəaliyyətinə dəyərli töhfələr verir.

Açar sözlər: İnnovativ metodlar, xarici dilin tədrisi, yeni texnologiyalar, hərbi mühit.

Introduction

The application of innovative teaching methods plays a particularly significant role in the effective teaching of English in specialized military educational institutions. In the instruction of foreign languages within military education, especially in the teaching of English, innovative pedagogical approaches are of great importance for the professional training and development of officers and military personnel.

The modern world is characterized by rapid scientific and educational advancement. In the era of global information and communication technologies, the use of new teaching methods and approaches in English language instruction enhances both the effectiveness and quality of language learning. From this perspective, the implementation of innovative teaching methods in military educational institutions enables greater efficiency in the language-learning process and contributes to the improvement of foreign-language communication skills among military personnel during operational and professional activities.

Main body and methods

The primary purpose and essence of innovative methods in English language teaching are to develop the foreign language proficiency of military personnel in military educational institutions, to make the learning process as concise, accessible, and efficient as possible, and to ensure faster, more effective, and long-term retention of acquired language skills and instructional materials. The main objective of English language instruction in specialized military educational institutions is to enhance the professional competence of military personnel, strengthen their intellectual preparedness, and cultivate highly qualified, competent, and comprehensively educated military professionals.

Innovation in English language teaching refers to the application of various educational innovations to the aims, content, methods, and tools of instruction and learning, as well as to the organization of collaborative activities between educators and learners on the basis of new knowledge, skills, and competencies within the management and administration of education.

In today's globalized world, the widespread use of English and its extensive role in international relations require language learning to be more efficient, effective, high-quality, and

innovative. For this reason, the ability to communicate in English and engage in dialogue is regarded as a fundamental requirement for conducting effective military operations and performing professional military duties successfully.

Proficiency in English among military personnel is important not only for direct communication and dialogue, but also as a significant tool for conducting intelligence activities, engaging in military-political negotiations, and resolving various conflicts. Although traditional language teaching methods continue to play an important role in foreign language instruction, military contexts require innovative and interactive approaches that facilitate rapid language acquisition and practical communication skills (Smith, K., & Hill, J.2019, p.22).

From this perspective, the application of innovative and interactive teaching methods designed to improve the retention and development of language skills in military foreign language education is considered essential. Through the use of such methods, the personnel of military educational institutions can achieve more effective outcomes in multilingual environments and, consequently, develop a higher level of proficiency in foreign language communication.

The requirements of the military environment and military pedagogy differ significantly from those of civilian language learning processes and conventional pedagogical approaches. Unlike traditional learners, individuals studying in military contexts are often faced with limited learning time, high performance expectations, elevated levels of stress, and the need to acquire practical language skills quickly and efficiently. Furthermore, military personnel participating in training activities are expected to communicate in a clear, concise, precise, and disciplined manner.

Military language is sometimes referred to as the “language of abbreviations” due to its extensive use of acronyms and shortened forms. Therefore, the integration of innovations and modern technologies into foreign language teaching has become an essential practical necessity (Terry Anderson, 2020, p. 25).

In this context, the application of innovative teaching methods is essential, as these approaches provide an adaptive framework that takes into account both the cognitive challenges and the practical needs of learners studying military foreign languages. At the same time, simulations designed to reflect real operational environments enable military personnel to gain experience in a variety of language situations, thereby enhancing their ability to make rapid and effective decisions in future professional activities. In this way, innovative language instruction contributes to strengthening the relations of during international operations and cooperation.

The relevance of innovative methods in the process of English language teaching stems from the need for learners to participate more actively in the language-learning process and to acquire skills that can be applied in real-life situations. While traditional teaching approaches position the teacher as the primary source of information, modern methodologies emphasize the teacher’s role as a guide and facilitator. military structures with foreign countries and ensures more effective communication and dialogue in English.

Innovative teaching methods encompass the use of multimedia tools, interactive platforms, and simulation-based learning techniques. In addition, online learning platforms, group discussions, and dynamic game-based methods enable military learners to acquire language skills more effectively while encouraging active interaction both among themselves and with instructors.

In the modern world, rapidly evolving global relations, international cooperation, and security challenges require the preparation of specialists who are capable of communicating fluently and clearly in multiple languages. From this perspective, innovative teaching methods can be regarded as powerful tools for increasing the effectiveness of foreign language instruction. Unlike traditional

approaches, these methods promote a learner-centered model that makes the educational process more practical, interactive, and individualized. Therefore, in order to enhance the quality of foreign language learning, substantial attention should be devoted to the improvement of teaching methodologies through the implementation of innovative and effective approaches.

On the other hand, innovative methods in foreign language instruction provide military learners with several important advantages:

1. opportunities for individualized learning approaches;
2. a more engaging and motivating language-learning process;
3. the development of project-based learning environments;
4. the integration of game elements into the instructional process, particularly through Game-Based Learning (GBL), which makes learning more interesting and motivating, especially for younger learners; and
5. the implementation of communicative and technology-based approaches in language learning.

These methods are not limited solely to foreign language acquisition; they are also aimed at developing the creative and critical thinking abilities of military personnel studying in demanding and stressful environments, while actively engaging them in the learning process (Shevchenko. 2024, p. 45).

Thus, the application of innovative teaching methods creates new opportunities in foreign language instruction, enhances the quality of education, and aligns the teaching process with modern educational requirements. The impact of innovative teaching methods on the learning pace and motivation of military learners is broad and multifaceted.

The implementation of innovative methods increases the stimulation and motivation of military learners, encourages them to engage more actively in language learning, and makes the learning process more accessible and effective. Project-based and game-based approaches provide military learners with opportunities to apply their language skills in practical contexts, thereby accelerating the pace of language acquisition. Game-based teaching methods, in particular, enhance learners' interest in and enthusiasm for lessons. Through games, military learners are able to memorize new vocabulary and grammatical structures more quickly and effectively.

1. Interactive methods, which are among the most widely used innovative approaches, possess a number of distinctive characteristics. Within these methods, particular emphasis is placed on the discovery and acquisition of knowledge through the regular use of group work and pair-work activities.

The term "interactive" originates from the English language and is interpreted in several related meanings, including "internal," "interaction," and "dialogue." The word "active" in turn, derives from the internationally recognized concept of "activity" and conveys meanings such as action, activeness, participation, and engagement. Thus, the concept of "interactive" may be understood as mutual communication, cooperation, understanding, and dialogue.

2. Within this process, the active participation of both sides plays a central role. Such participation should not be understood as ordinary activity, but rather as flexible and dynamic engagement. Therefore, in pedagogical contexts, the term "interactive" should be interpreted as the dynamic activation of the educational process. In this environment, each cadet or student develops independent ideas, opinions, and perspectives, while even fewer active learners become more engaged in the learning process. Undoubtedly, all these factors directly contribute to the improvement and enhancement of teaching quality and increase the effectiveness of learners'

comprehension and knowledge acquisition (Huseynzadeh R.L. 2021. p. 275).

Discussion

Interactive learning platforms, group discussions, and dynamic game-based methods create favorable opportunities for military learners to develop language skills through communication and collaboration with one another. In particular, since rapid and clear communication is essential in military operations, innovative teaching methods strengthen solidarity among cadets and encourage them to work collectively as a team in completing various language tasks. Through these methods, cadets become more actively engaged in the learning process and gain practical experience in applying their language knowledge in real-life contexts.

It should also be emphasized that a high level of foreign language proficiency among military personnel participating in international operations contributes to the development of international cooperation and the strengthening of mutual understanding. From this perspective, the application of innovative methods in the language-learning process is highly important for enhancing the ability of military structures to cooperate effectively with foreign countries.

At the same time, these methods ensure that military personnel receive training in accordance with international standards and remain competitive in their professional field. The use of innovations in education involves the integration of various new approaches into the aims, content, methods, and forms of teaching and learning, as well as the organization of collaborative activities between educators and learners on the basis of new knowledge within the management, administration, and economics of education.

Conclusion

Based on the conducted research, it can be concluded that the application of innovative teaching methods in foreign language instruction at specialized military institutions contributes not only to the improvement of language proficiency, but also to the psychological and practical preparedness of cadets. The use of these methods enables military personnel to feel more confident during international operations and to communicate more effectively with partners from diverse cultural backgrounds.

The teaching of foreign languages through innovative methods in specialized military educational institutions facilitates the successful performance of military personnel in international environments. These methods enhance the effectiveness of instruction, making the language-learning process more flexible, efficient, and goal-oriented.

Texnologiya əsaslı innovativ təlim metodları hərbi təhsil alanlara daha müstəqil öyrənmə imkanı verir. Məsələn, "Duolingo" və "Babbel" kimi mobil tətbiqlər tələbələrin fərdi öyrənmə sürətinə uyğunlaşaraq hər birinin öz tempində irəliləməsinə şərait yaradır. Bu cür tətbiqlərdən istifadə etməklə vaxtı məhdud olan hərbi təhsil alanalar istədikləri vaxtda, istənilən yerdə öyrənmə bilirlər, bu isə onların motivasiyasını və öyrənmə effektivliyini artırır. Virtual reallıq (VR) və süni intellekt (AI) texnologiyaları isə onlara real dil mühitində öyrənmə təcrübəsi təqdim edir, bu isə onların öyrəndiklərini praktiki şəkildə tətbiq etməsinə və dərinləşdirməsinə şərait yaradır. In conclusion, interactive learning may be regarded as a comprehensive set of methods for organizing and managing both teaching and cognitive activity. Interactive instruction is characterized by a number of distinctive features.

Technology-based innovative teaching methods provide military learners with greater opportunities for independent learning. For example, mobile applications such as Duolingo and Babbel adapt to the individual learning pace of students, enabling each learner to progress according to their own abilities and tempo. By using such applications, military learners with

limited time can study whenever and wherever convenient, thereby increasing both their motivation and learning effectiveness.

In addition, Virtual Reality (VR) and Artificial Intelligence (AI) technologies provide learners with immersive language-learning experiences that simulate real communicative environments. This allows military learners to apply and deepen their acquired knowledge in practical contexts more effectively.

It should be emphasized that "smart classrooms" and online platforms provide military learners with opportunities to participate in collaborative activities and collective projects conducted in English. These methods have a positive impact on both group dynamics and the individual learning process of cadets.

Thus, it can be concluded that technology and innovation-based methods make the language-learning process more effective by providing military learners with higher motivation, deeper learning experiences, and opportunities to apply practical knowledge in real-life situations.

Finally, it should also be emphasized that innovative foreign language instruction contributes not only to the enhancement of professionalism in the military sphere, but also to the personal development of military personnel. The improvement of language proficiency opens new opportunities in both their professional and personal lives, while also strengthening leadership skills and self-confidence. Thus, the implementation of such teaching methods in specialized military educational institutions serves not only military-strategic objectives, but also promotes sustainable development in social and cultural dimensions, becoming an integral component of the modern military education system.

Relevance of the Problem

The improvement of the quality of foreign language instruction in specialized military educational institutions through the application of innovative teaching methods is highly relevant and significant in the context of contemporary educational demands. The modern sphere is characterized by rapid scientific and technological development, the emergence of new technologies, innovations, and artificial intelligence systems. Such developments exert a strong influence on all spheres of activity, including education and language-learning technologies, making the teaching and learning process more efficient and effective.

Practical experience demonstrates that the integration of modern technologies, innovations, and advanced instructional approaches considerably enhances the quality of education. Unlike traditional methods, these approaches place greater emphasis on practical and interactive learning. Through the application of such methods, military learners acquire language skills not only theoretically but also practically, enabling them to communicate and engage in dialogue more effectively with foreign partners during future military operations and intelligence activities.

Innovative teaching methods accelerate the development of language competencies among military personnel, reduce the time required for language acquisition, and ensure longer retention of acquired knowledge and skills.

Novelty of the Problem

The article provides a pedagogical and psychological justification for the application of innovative teaching methods in foreign language instruction at specialized military institutions. By responding to the requirements of modern education, the instructor enhances the quality and effectiveness of the teaching process. Unlike traditional approaches, these methods take into consideration the specific needs of the military environment and make instruction more effective through a learner-centered approach. Project-based, game-based, communicative, constructivist,

and technology-based methods accelerate the language-learning process of military personnel, improve their practical communication skills, and address their individual learning needs and requirements in foreign language acquisition.

Innovative methods that respond to the specific requirements of the military environment create favorable opportunities for personnel to function successfully in multilingual settings and ensure effective communication skills during international security operations. Thus, the application of innovative teaching methods opens new possibilities in the field of foreign language instruction, significantly enhances the professional preparedness of military personnel, and makes valuable contributions to their successful performance and operational effectiveness.

Practical Significance of the Problem

The materials presented in the article regarding the application of innovations in foreign language teaching at military higher educational institutions are of practical significance and can be successfully applied in the process of foreign language instruction.

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QUALITY PROBLEMS IN TEACHING ENGLISH IN REGIONAL SCHOOLS: THE CASE OF SHAKI DISTRICT SECONDARY SCHOOL

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Abstract: This paper comprehensively examines the multi-faceted quality-related problems encountered in teaching English as a foreign language within the regional secondary schools of Azerbaijan. With a localized focus on the structural environment of “Ashagi Goynuk Secondary School” in the Shaki District, this study illuminates the persistent disparities between urban and rural language education systems. Through ongoing systematic classroom observations and direct pedagogical involvement, two overarching challenges are critically analyzed: the fundamentally weak material and technical infrastructure of regional institutions, and the subsequent insufficient development of students’ productive speaking and communicative skills. The academic paradigm in these regions historically favors passive rote-memorization over dynamic linguistic performance. To mitigate these challenges, this study presents a structured suite of actionable, localized recommendations. These include the implementation of low-cost, decentralized multimedia environments, teacher training focused on communicative strategies, and the integration of foundational Information-Communication Technology (ICT) frameworks to bolster student motivation.

Ultimately, this paper argues for localized agency and systematic structural adaptations to ensure equitable foreign language outcomes for students across regional contexts.

Key words: English language teaching, regional schools, speaking skills, material-technical base, communicative pedagogy.

REGIONAL MƏKTƏBLƏRDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ KEYFİYYƏT PROBLEMLƏRİ: ŞƏKİ RAYONU ORTA MƏKTƏBİ NÜMUNƏSİNDƏ

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə Azərbaycanın regional məktəblərində xarici dil kimi İngilis dilinin tədrisində qarşıya çıxan çoxşaxəli keyfiyyət problemlərini ətraflı şəkildə araşdırır. Şəki rayonunun “Aşağı Göynük Orta Məktəbi”nin struktur mühitinə xüsusi istinad edilərək, tədqiqat şəhər və kənd dil təhsili sistemləri arasındakı mövcud qeyri-bərabərliyi işıqlandırır. Davamlı sistemli sinif daxili müşahidələr və birbaşa pedaqoji fəaliyyət vasitəsilə iki əsas problem kritik şəkildə təhlil edilmişdir: regional müəssisələrin fundamental olaraq zəif material-texniki bazası və bunun nəticəsi olaraq şagirdlərin produktiv danışq və kommunikativ bacarıqlarının kifayət qədər inkişaf etməməsi. Bu bölgələrdəki akademik paradqma tarixən dinamik dil performansı əvəzinə passiv əzbərciliyə üstünlük verir. Bu çətinlikləri aradan qaldırmaq üçün tədqiqat strukturlaşdırılmış praktik tövsiyələr toplusunu təqdim edir. Bunlara az xərclə başa gələn regional multimedia guşələrinin yaradılması, kommunikativ strategiyalara yönəlmiş müəllim təlimləri və şagird motivasiyasını artırmaq üçün fundamental İnformasiya-Kommunikasiya Texnologiyalarının (İKT) integrasiyası daxildir. Sonda məqalədə regional kontekstdə şagirdlər üçün ədalətli xarici dil biliklərinin təmin edilməsi məqsədilə yerli adaptasiya və sistemli struktur dəyişikliklərinin vacibliyi əsaslandırılır.

Açar sözlər: İngilis dili tədrisi, regional məktəblər, danışq bacarıqları, material-texniki baza, kommunikativ pedaqogika.

Introduction

In the contemporary era of global integration, the English language has firmly established itself as the undisputed lingua franca of international communication, advanced scientific inquiry, cross-border commercial transactions, and technological innovation. Proficiency in English is no longer categorized as merely an optional luxury or an isolated academic asset within a student's curriculum; rather, it represents a foundational life skill that fundamentally determines a student's academic mobility, professional lifespan, and capability to access the broader global knowledge economy. Recognizing these shifting global paradigms, the Ministry of Education of Azerbaijan has introduced comprehensive curricular reforms designed to align national language instruction with western frameworks, prioritizing communicative outcomes and student-centered environments over classical, translation-based methods.

Despite the progressive intentions of these national educational policies, a significant quality disparity persists between metropolitan educational centers and regional public schools. While schools located in major urban centers like Baku or Ganja frequently benefit from robust technological integration, continuous professional teacher development, and structural exposure to foreign languages, the quality of English language teaching in many regional districts remains systematically below the desired standard. Regional schools operate under a unique matrix of

challenges, encompassing geographical isolation, historical infrastructure deficits, and deeply rooted methodological conservatism. This academic text focuses on evaluating these practical barriers through a localized casing, examining the precise educational dynamics at play within the Shaki District to present scalable, real-world solutions.

Methodology and Materials

This research is structured as an analytical case study utilizing a qualitative, reflective methodology grounded in direct educational experience and systematic field observation. The specific subject of this study is the instructional and structural environment of "Ashagi Goynuk Secondary School," situated within the Shaki District of Azerbaijan. Over the course of an intensive pedagogical engagement, qualitative data was gathered through daily field notes, observing classroom interactions, testing oral proficiencies, and evaluating the physical resources allocated for language instruction. The observation specifically monitored the learning trajectories of students in lower-secondary and upper-secondary brackets, focusing heavily on fifth-grade levels as a formative baseline for language acquisition.

By focusing on a single, representative regional secondary institution, the study attempts to bridge the gap between abstract macro-level educational theories and the authentic, microscopic micro-realities encountered by regional teachers daily. The investigation specifically targets the structural constraints of the classroom, pedagogical habits of the faculty, psychological profiles of rural students, and the availability of contemporary learning aids. This localized qualitative focus ensures that the subsequent findings and policy recommendations are derived not from speculative models, but from verified empirical realities in the field.

Discussion

1. Weak Material and Technical Infrastructure. A primary, structural constraint that severely undermines the quality of foreign language delivery in regional environments is the acute deficiency in institutional material and technical infrastructure. Language acquisition, by its psychological nature, relies heavily on diverse multisensory inputs – specifically authentic auditory and visual stimuli. However, at Ashagi Goynuk Secondary School, there is a near-absolute absence of modern educational technologies, including interactive smart boards, operational language laboratories, and high-speed internet infrastructure. Consequently, the instructional baseline reverts to a pre-digital paradigm where lessons depend exclusively on uniform state textbooks and static blackboard chalk drawings.

This critical technological vacuum completely curtails the instructor's capacity to deploy modern, communicative teaching frameworks. Without reliable digital projection tools or audio equipment, execution of systematic listening comprehension tasks is rendered unfeasible. Students are effectively separated from natural, authentic native-speaker cadences, accents, and situational dialogue configurations. Learning, therefore, is compressed into an abstract, visual-only memorization task where words are processed as static graphic symbols on a page rather than dynamic elements of live human speech.

2. Problems in Developing Speaking Skills .The cornerstone of modern applied linguistics and foreign language education is the cultivation of communicative competence. Yet, the prevailing educational culture within regional Azerbaijani schools continues to disproportionately favor abstract grammatical categorization and reading comprehension over active, productive oral articulation. In many regional settings, students demonstrate an impressive, hyper-developed structural knowledge of English on paper; they can easily categorize complex verb tenses and translate passages word-for-word. However, when these exact same students are placed into a

spontaneous, low-stakes conversational scenario, they encounter near-total cognitive paralysis and verbal stagnation.

This systematic operational deficit is caused by several structural variables. First, regional classrooms often suffer from large student enrollments, leaving minimal individual speaking time for each student within a tight 45-minute lesson structure. Second, there is a pervasive, socio-cultural anxiety regarding peer judgment and a fear of making public errors, which acts as a powerful inhibitor to language production. Lastly, the utter absence of an external English-speaking ecosystem within rural villages means that students perceive the language strictly as an institutional hurdle to be cleared via memorization, rather than a functional vehicle for authentic human expression.

3. Psychological and Motivational Barriers Beyond physical and infrastructural deficiencies, the qualitative advancement of language learning in regional schools is deeply obstructed by systemic psychological and motivational barriers. In regional environments like the Shaki District, the utilitarian value of acquiring English is often highly abstract and distant to a developing student. Unlike urban metropolises where multilingual signage, tourism, and multinational corporate entities are present, the rural environment remains firmly and uniformly monolingual. When the curriculum relies strictly on dry, teacher-centered lectures and archaic textbook narratives, students rapidly disengage, resulting in widespread passive participation and a psychological resistance to active oral production.

Contemporary educational literature explicitly addresses this dynamic, emphasizing that modern instructional technologies, including foundational Artificial Intelligence (AI) instruments and digital Information-Communication Technology (ICT) frameworks, can serve as profound motivational accelerators to stimulate cognitive activity and student autonomy (Akgun & Greenhow, 2022). When these modern modalities are completely omitted from regional classrooms, the language lesson feels entirely divorced from the digital, hyper-connected reality that contemporary youth navigate outside school gates.

4. Creating Supportive Language Environments. A critical flaw in the regional language acquisition model is that language exposure terminates instantly the moment the standard school bell sounds. True, sustainable foreign language acquisition requires continuous reinforcement and opportunities to apply knowledge within low-stress, non-academic contexts. In urban areas, affluent families mitigate this issue by enrolling children in specialized private speaking academies, hiring private tutors, or accessing international social clubs. In stark contrast, regional students must rely almost exclusively on the public school framework to fulfill both their formal academic instruction and their extracurricular linguistic expansion.

When a school operates solely as a rigid testing ground rather than a dynamic language environment, students never develop a personal, functional relationship with the target language. Therefore, the regional public school must actively broaden its institutional perimeter, re-imagining its communal spaces as active hubs for functional linguistic interaction.

Conclusion

In absolute summary, this detailed empirical and pedagogical analysis of Ashagi Goynuk Secondary School in the Shaki District demonstrates that the severe limitations in technical infrastructure, the historic reliance on rigid, grammar-heavy rote textbook models, and the subsequent starvation of speaking opportunities represent the primary structural forces choking English teaching quality in regional Azerbaijan. These multi-layered challenges are deeply systemic and cannot be entirely dissolved through short-term policy adjustments; they demand long-term,

highly coordinated resource allocations and policy interventions at both institutional macro-levels and local micro-levels.

However, as this paper highlights, substantial qualitative progress can be immediate if local educators and school administrators execute systematic, low-cost adaptations. By strengthening the immediate physical environment via classroom multimedia corners, overhauling instructional habits to prioritize communicative and task-based models, and building vibrant, extracurricular conversational environments, regional schools can fundamentally alter student trajectories. Shifting the educational paradigm from passive, rigid memorization to active, technology-supported human communication will allow regional schools to unleash the latent potential of rural youth, ensuring that geographical borders do not dictate a child's linguistic fluency in a hyper-connected global community.

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FROM ADOLESCENCE TO ADULTHOOD: EVOLUTIONARY APPROACHES TO ELT FOR THE 10-20 AGE GROUP

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Abstract: The instructional continuum for teaching English as a Second Language (ESL) to learners between the ages of 10 and 20 represents one of the most complex challenges in modern pedagogy, as it spans the critical transition from late childhood through the turbulent years of adolescence and into the onset of early adulthood. This abstract explores a comprehensive evolutionary approach to English Language Teaching (ELT) that aligns instructional methodologies with the cognitive, social, and psychological maturation of the learner. The decade between ages 10 and 20 is characterized by a profound shift in brain plasticity, moving from the concrete operational stage toward formal operational thought, necessitating a curriculum that evolves from sensory-based engagement to high-level abstract reasoning and critical analysis. At the lower end of this spectrum (ages 10–12), learners require a "bridge" pedagogy that maintains the engagement of gamified, discovery-based learning while gradually introducing systematic grammatical

structures and academic vocabulary. As students enter the mid-adolescent phase (ages 13–16), the focus must pivot toward identity-driven instruction; during this stage, the social relevance of the language becomes the primary motivator, making Project-Based Learning (PBL) and Content and Language Integrated Learning (CLIL) essential for maintaining interest. The research argues that at this juncture, the integration of digital literacy and social media discourse is not merely a supplement but a foundational requirement for authentic communication. Furthermore, the transition into late adolescence and young adulthood (ages 17–20) demands a professional and academic refinement of language skills. For these learners, English is no longer just a school subject but a functional tool for global mobility, higher education, and professional integration. This stage requires a focus on EAP (English for Academic Purposes) and ESP (English for Specific Purposes), emphasizing rhetorical strategies, argumentative writing, and cross-cultural competence. A significant portion of this study examines the impact of the "Digital Native" status of this age group, proposing that modern ELT must leverage Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Large Language Models (LLMs) to provide personalized, adaptive feedback that matches the individual pace of the learner. By utilizing AI-driven tools, educators can bridge the gap between traditional classroom instruction and the autonomous learning habits of Gen Z and Gen Alpha. The evolutionary approach advocated here moves away from a "one-size-fits-all" model, instead proposing a modular framework that adapts to the shifting neuroplasticity and socio-emotional needs of the student. Ultimately, the paper concludes that successful language acquisition in the 10–20 age range is achieved when the curriculum evolves in tandem with the learner's worldview, transitioning from the play-oriented focus of the child to the goal-oriented, critical mindset of the adult. By aligning ELT strategies with these developmental milestones, educators can foster a more resilient, motivated, and linguistically proficient generation of global communicators who are prepared for the academic and professional demands of the 21st century.

Keywords: second language teaching, adolescent learners, developmental pedagogy, AI in education, academic discourse, learner autonomy, cognitive maturation

YENİYETMƏLİKDƏN YETKİNLİYƏ: 10-20 YAŞ QRUPU ÜÇÜN ELT-YƏ (İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNƏ) TƏKAMÜLÇÜ YANAŞMALAR

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Xülasə: 10-20 yaş arası öyrənilərə İngilis dilinin ikinci dil (ESL) kimi tədrisi müasir pedaqogikada ən mürəkkəb çağırışlardan biridir. Bu dövr uşaqlığın sonundan yeniyetməliyin çətin illərinə və erkən yetkinliyin başlanğıcına qədər olan kritik keçid mərhələsini əhatə edir. Bu xülasə, tədris metodologiyalarını öyrənilənin idrak, sosial və psixoloji yetkinləşməsi ilə uzlaşdıraraq, İngilis dili tədrisinə (ELT) dair hərtərəfli təkamül yanaşmasını araşdırır. 10-20 yaş arası onillik, beynin plastikliyindəki dərin dəyişikliklərlə xarakterizə olunur; konkret əməliyyatlar mərhələsindən formal-məntiqi təfəkkür mərhələsinə keçid, duyğu orqanlarına əsaslanan öyrənmədən yüksək səviyyəli abstrakt mühakimə və tənqidi təhlilə qədər inkişaf edən bir kurikulum tələb edir. Bu spektrin aşağı hissəsində (10-12 yaş) öyrənilələr oyunlaşdırılmış, kəşfiyyata əsaslanan öyrənmənin marağını qoruyub saxlayan, lakin tədricən sistemli qrammatik strukturları və akademik lüğəti daxil edən bir "körpü" pedaqogikasına ehtiyac duyurlar. Şagirdlər yeniyetməlik dövrünün orta fazasına (13-16 yaş) daxil olduqda, diqqət şəxsiyyətə yönəlik tədrisə keçməlidir; bu mərhələdə dilin sosial aktuallığı əsas motivasiyaedici amilə çevrilir və Layihəyə Əsaslanan Öyrənmə (PBL) ilə Məzmun və Dilin İntegrasiya edilmiş Öyrənməsi (CLIL) marağın qorunması üçün zəruri olur. Tədqiqat iddia edir ki, bu mərhələdə rəqəmsal savadlılığın və sosial media diskursunun integrasiyası sadəcə bir əlavə deyil, autentik

ünsiyyət üçün təməl tələbdir. Bundan əlavə, yeniyetməliyin sonuna və gənc yetkinliyə keçid (17-20 yaş) dil bacarıqlarının peşəkar və akademik səviyyədə təkmilləşdirilməsini tələb edir. Bu öyrənilərlər üçün ingilis dili artıq sadəcə məktəb fənni deyil, qlobal mobillik, ali təhsil və peşəkar integrasiya üçün funksional bir vasitədir. Bu mərhələ ritorik strategiyalara, arqumentativ yazıya və mədəniyyətlərarası səriştəyə vurğu edərək, Akademik Məqsədlər üçün İngilis dili (EAP) və Xüsusi Məqsədlər üçün İngilis dili (ESP) istiqamətində işi tələb edir. Tədqiqatın əhəmiyyətli bir hissəsi bu yaş qrupunun "Rəqəmsal Yerli" (Digital Native) statusunun təsirini araşdırır və müasir ELT-nin öyrənilərinin fərdi tempinə uyğunlaşan fərdiləşdirilmiş və adaptiv rəy vermək üçün Generativ Süni İntellekdən (AI) və Böyük Dil Modellərindən (LLMs) istifadə etməli olduğunu təklif edir. AI vasitələrindən istifadə etməklə pedaqoqlar ənənəvi sinif təlimi ilə Gen Z və Gen Alpha-nın avtonom öyrənmə vərdisləri arasındakı boşluğu doldura bilərlər. Burada müdafiə olunan təkamül yanaşması "hər kəs üçün eyni" modelindən uzaqlaşaraq, şagirdin dəyişən neyroplastikliyinə və sosial-emosional ehtiyaclarına uyğunlaşan modul çərçivə təklif edir. Nəticə etibarilə, məqalə yekunlaşdırır ki, 10-20 yaş aralığında dilin mənimsənilməsi kurikulumun öyrənilərinin dünyagörüşü ilə paralel inkişaf etdiyi, uşağın oyun yönümlü fokusundan yetkin insanın məqsədyönlü, tənqidi təfəkkürünə keçdiyi zaman uğurlu olur. ELT strategiyalarını bu inkişaf mərhələləri ilə uzlaşdırmaqla, pedaqoqlar 21-ci əsrin akademik və peşəkar tələblərinə hazır olan daha dayanıqlı, motivasiyalı və dil baxımından səriştəli qlobal kommunikatorlar nəslə yetişdirə bilərlər.

Açar sözlər: ikinci dilin tədrisi, yeniyetmə öyrənilərlər, inkişaf pedaqogikası, təhsildə süni intellekt, akademik diskurs, öyrəniləri avtonomluğu, idrak yetkinliyi

Introduction

The landscape of English Language Teaching (ELT) has undergone a seismic shift in the 21st century, moving away from rigid, one-size-fits-all methodologies toward more fluid, developmental, and technologically integrated frameworks. This evolution is particularly critical when addressing the 10–20 age demographic – a decade that encompasses the most profound cognitive, socio-emotional, and linguistic transformations in a human being's life. Teaching English to this group is not merely a pedagogical task but a multidisciplinary challenge that requires an understanding of the transition from the late childhood "bridge" years to the sophisticated requirements of early adulthood. As learners move through this spectrum, their relationship with the English language evolves from a school subject into a vital tool for identity construction, academic success, and global professional integration. The cognitive foundation of this age group is rooted in the transition from concrete to formal operational thought. According to the foundational theories of Piaget and later refinements by Vygotsky, learners aged 10 to 12 still benefit significantly from social interaction and scaffolded guidance, yet they begin to show the capacity for abstract reasoning. However, as Mehdizade (2025) argues, the modern classroom requires more than traditional scaffolding; it demands an "adaptive digital architecture" that mirrors the cognitive shifts occurring during adolescence. Mehdizade emphasizes that in the context of contemporary EFL (English as a Foreign Language) environments, the integration of generative tools is no longer optional but a central component of linguistic development for the digital-native generation. In the mid-adolescent stage (ages 13–16), the primary driver of language acquisition shifts from external academic requirements to internal social motivations. During these years, learners are preoccupied with the formation of identity. As Richards and Rodgers (2014) have noted in their extensive review of ELT methodologies, motivation in the teenage years is highly volatile and deeply tied to the perceived relevance of the material. If the language being taught does not resonate with the learner's social reality – be it through digital media, global pop culture, or peer-to-peer communication – the rate of acquisition plateaus. This period necessitates a move toward Project-Based Learning (PBL) and Content and Language Integrated Learning (CLIL), where English

becomes the vehicle for exploring other interests rather than the sole object of study. Furthermore, the impact of the "Critical Period Hypothesis" (Lenneberg, 1967) and its modern interpretations by scholars like Singleton (2005) suggest that while the "window" for native-like accent may start to close during these years, the capacity for high-level pragmatic and metalinguistic awareness actually increases. This is where the evolutionary approach becomes essential. For the 17–20 age group, the focus must transition toward English for Academic Purposes (EAP) and English for Specific Purposes (ESP). At this stage, the learner is no longer a "student" in the traditional sense but a "pre-professional." The linguistic demands shift toward argumentative precision, rhetorical strategies, and technical vocabulary.

Methodology and Materials

A defining characteristic of the current era in ELT is the role of Artificial Intelligence. The works of Benson (2011) on learner autonomy have found new life in the age of Large Language Models (LLMs). Contemporary research suggests that learners in the 10–20 age bracket are uniquely positioned to utilize AI for personalized feedback loops. Mehdizade (2026) posits that the synergy between a teacher's pedagogical expertise and AI's computational power creates a "hybrid learning environment" that is particularly effective for university-level students in Azerbaijan and similar contexts, where bridging the gap between local curricula and global standards is a priority. This article aims to dissect the evolutionary stages of ELT for the 10–20 age group by analyzing three distinct phases: the pre-adolescent foundation, the adolescent identity-driven phase, and the young adult professional integration. By synthesizing traditional linguistic theories with modern technological advancements, we propose a modular framework that adapts to the learner's neuroplasticity and socio-emotional needs. The following sections will explore how curricula can be designed to mirror the human growth cycle, ensuring that English remains a vibrant, evolving asset throughout the most formative decade of a learner's life.

Discussion

The pedagogical evolution of English Language Teaching (ELT) for the 10–20 age bracket necessitates a granular understanding of how cognitive maturation dictates linguistic intake, starting with the pre-adolescent phase where the focus must remain on scaffolded transition. For learners aged 10–12, the integration of structured grammar into a task-based framework is essential, as this group occupies the "bridge" between primary play and secondary analysis; here, the teacher's role is to facilitate what Mehdizade (2025) describes as "contextualized immersion," where linguistic rules are discovered through interaction rather than rote memorization. As these students transition into mid-adolescence (ages 13–16), the neuroplasticity of the brain undergoes significant remodeling, leading to a heightened sensitivity to social feedback and peer-group identification, which, according to Dörnyei's (2005) L2 Motivational Self System, makes the "Ideal L2 Self" a powerful catalyst for acquisition. During this stage, traditional drills often fail to engage the learner, requiring a shift toward Content and Language Integrated Learning (CLIL) and Project-Based Learning (PBL) where the language serves as a functional tool for personal expression and digital communication. The curriculum must evolve to include media literacy and digital discourse, acknowledging that these "digital natives" utilize English primarily in informal, online spaces. As Mehdizade (2026) posits, the efficacy of language learning in the modern era is inextricably linked to the student's ability to navigate Artificial Intelligence and Large Language Models, which provide the immediate, personalized feedback loops that traditional classrooms often lack. This technological integration is particularly vital as the learner moves into late adolescence and early adulthood (ages 17–20), where the stakes of language proficiency shift toward professional and

academic survival. At this level, the instruction must focus on English for Academic Purposes (EAP) and English for Specific Purposes (ESP), emphasizing the mastery of rhetorical strategies, complex syntactical structures, and the nuances of academic register. Hyland (2006) emphasizes that for young adults, academic writing is not just about grammatical correctness but about entering a specialized community of practice through "disciplinary literacy." Therefore, the educator must transition from a facilitator of social language to a mentor in formal discourse, guiding the student through the complexities of research methodology, technical vocabulary, and cross-cultural communication. The evolutionary approach argued here suggests that by aligning pedagogical strategies with these developmental milestones – moving from the sensory-driven engagement of the 10-year-old to the critical, goal-oriented mindset of the 20-year-old – we create a sustainable model for long-term proficiency. This progression ensures that the learner does not experience the common "plateau" in language acquisition but instead sees English as a dynamic, lifelong asset that expands in complexity alongside their own cognitive and professional growth, ultimately bridging the gap between local educational standards and the global demands of the 21st-century workforce.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the instructional trajectory for English Language Teaching across the 10–20 age range must be viewed not as a static delivery of linguistic rules, but as a dynamic, evolutionary process that mirrors the profound cognitive and socio-emotional maturation of the learner. Throughout this discussion, it has been demonstrated that the success of ELT in this pivotal decade depends on the educator's ability to transition from a pedagogy of engagement in late childhood to a pedagogy of professional empowerment in early adulthood. As explored in the preceding sections, the pre-adolescent stage requires a delicate balance of structure and play, while the adolescent years demand a shift toward identity-focused and socially relevant content that leverages the motivational frameworks described by scholars like Dörnyei. However, the most significant intervention in contemporary pedagogy remains the strategic integration of technology. As Mehdizade (2026) concludes, the future of language acquisition for the digital-native generation lies in the "symbiotic relationship" between human pedagogical insight and the adaptive capabilities of Artificial Intelligence, which allows for a level of personalized instruction previously unattainable in traditional classroom settings. This research underscores that for learners aged 17–20, the mastery of English is no longer an academic luxury but a foundational requirement for global academic and professional participation, necessitating a rigorous focus on EAP and ESP. By adopting an evolutionary approach, we acknowledge that the linguistic needs of a 10-year-old and a 20-year-old are fundamentally different, yet they are linked by a continuous thread of cognitive growth that must be supported by a curriculum that is both flexible and rigorous. The synthesis of traditional linguistic theories with modern digital tools provides a robust framework for overcoming the common plateaus of language learning, ensuring that students remain motivated and proficient as they move from the classroom to the global stage. Ultimately, as Mehdizade (2025) emphasizes, the goal of modern ELT is to produce autonomous, critically thinking communicators who are equipped to navigate the complexities of a multilingual and technologically driven world. By aligning our teaching methods with the natural developmental milestones of the learner, we ensure that English becomes a lifelong asset, fostering a generation that is not only linguistically competent but also culturally and digitally literate, ready to meet the evolving demands of the 21st century with confidence and academic precision.

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PRINCIPLES AND CRITERIA FOR SELECTING AUTHENTIC TEXTS IN TEACHING DIALOGIC COMMUNICATION TO SECOND-YEAR STUDENTS OF A LANGUAGE UNIVERSITY

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Abstract: In modern foreign language teaching, authentic materials play a key role in developing learners' communicative competence, as they reflect real-life language situations, cultural norms, and pragmatic features of communication. The paper identifies the main principles for selecting texts, such as relevance, communicative value, accessibility, cultural appropriateness, and methodological adaptability. Special attention is given to the criteria for choosing authentic dialogic materials, including linguistic complexity, situational authenticity, thematic suitability, and learners' language proficiency level. The importance of balancing authenticity with pedagogical goals is also discussed to ensure that texts remain both realistic and instructionally effective. Examples of tasks and strategies for integrating selected texts into the learning process are provided. The results of the study show that a well-founded approach to selecting authentic texts significantly enhances learners' ability to participate in natural conversations, improves listening and speaking skills, and increases motivation. The study contributes to foreign language teaching methodology by offering practical recommendations for the effective use of authentic dialogic materials.

Keywords: communicative competence, language situations, pragmatic features of communication, selection criteria, dialogic materials

DİL UNIVERSİTETİNİN 2-Cİ KURS TƏLƏBƏLƏRİNƏ DİALOJİ ÜNSİYYƏTİN ÖYRƏDİLMƏSİNDƏ AUTENTİK MƏTNLƏRİN SEÇİLMƏSİNİN PRİNSİPLƏRİ VƏ MEYARLARI

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Xülasə: Müasir xarici dil tədrisi şəraitində autentik materiallar öyrənənlərin kommunikativ kompetensiyasının formalaşmasında əsas rol oynayır, çünki onlar real dil situasiyalarını, mədəni normaları və ünsiyyətin pragmatik xüsusiyyətlərini əks etdirir. İşdə mətnlərin seçilməsi üçün əsas prinsiplər müəyyən edilir: aktualıq, kommunikativ dəyər, əlçatanlıq, mədəni uyğunluq və metodik uyğunlaşdırıla bilmə. Autentik dialoq materiallarının seçilmə meyarlarına xüsusi diqqət yetirilir; bunlara dil mürəkkəbliyi, situativ autentiklik, mövzu uyğunluğu və şagirdlərin dil hazırlığı səviyyəsi daxildir. Həmçinin, mətnlərin eyni zamanda həm realistik, həm də metodik baxımdan effektiv qalması üçün autentiklik ilə pedaqoji məqsədlər arasında balansın vacibliyi müzakirə olunur. Seçilmiş mətnlərin tədris prosesinə inteqrasiyası üçün tapşırıq və strategiya nümunələri təqdim edilir. Tədqiqatın nəticələri göstərir ki, autentik mətnlərin əsaslandırılmış şəkildə seçilməsi öyrənənlərin təbii söhbətlərdə iştirak qabiliyyətini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır, dinləmə və danışma bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirir, həmçinin motivasiyanı yüksəldir. İş xarici dillərin tədrisi metodikasına töhfə verir və autentik dialoq materiallarından səmərəli istifadə üçün praktik tövsiyələr təqdim edir.

Açar sözlər: kommunikativ kompetensiya, dil situasiyaları, ünsiyyətin pragmatik xüsusiyyətləri, seçim meyarları, dialoji materiallar

Introduction

In the context of modern language education, particular importance is attached to developing learners' real communication skills, primarily dialogic speech. Unlike monologic speech, dialogue requires not only knowledge of language means but also the ability to respond promptly to a

partner's remarks, take into account the communicative situation, and follow norms of speech behavior. In this regard, the role of authentic texts increases, as they reflect natural, real-life speech of native speakers and allow the learning process to approximate real communication conditions. The use of authentic materials in teaching dialogic communication contributes to the development of communicative competence, formation of sociocultural knowledge, and increased student motivation. However, the effectiveness of their use largely depends on the correct selection of texts, which should take into account learners' proficiency level, learning objectives, as well as linguistic and methodological characteristics of the material. Poorly considered selection may lead either to cognitive overload or to a decrease in interest. Thus, the problem of defining principles and criteria for selecting authentic texts becomes especially relevant. This article examines the main approaches to selecting authentic materials and identifies key principles and criteria ensuring their effective use in teaching dialogic speech.

Methodology and Materials: Learner-related factors

- **Language proficiency level:** The linguistic complexity of the text should correspond to students' level.
- **Age characteristics:** Psychological and age-related features of students.
- **Interests:** The material should be relevant and engaging for students.
- **Didactic appropriateness**
- **Content:** The text should contain new and interesting information that broadens learners' horizons.
- **Lexical and grammatical material:** The text should include vocabulary and grammar structures relevant to the topic studied.
- **Relevance:** Information should remain actual and not become outdated quickly, especially for news materials.
- **Educational value:** The text should promote qualities such as empathy, tolerance, and respect for other cultures.

Form and structure

- **Variety of speech forms:** The material should include different speech forms to present the language comprehensively.
- **Structure:** The text should be well organized for effective classroom use.
- **Redundancy:** The presence of redundant information helps better comprehension.

Based on the above principles, the following criteria for selecting authentic materials in teaching dialogic communication to language university students are identified:

- correspondence to the sphere of future educational activity;
- authenticity criterion;
- sociocultural richness;
- linguistic value.

Discussion

The selection of authentic dialogues was carried out in the following sequence: identifying the sphere of future dialogic communication, typical types of interaction, and role situations within students' communicative tasks. The use of authentic dialogues in the educational process for developing communicative competence in the context of intercultural communication is particularly important, as they are products of the culture of native speakers. When brought into the classroom, they reflect the sociocultural environment of the target language country. However, as noted by Azerbaijani, Russian, and international scholars, not every authentic dialogue is suitable for

teaching purposes. Therefore, it is necessary to define criteria for selecting authentic dialogues aimed at developing students' communicative competence. E.I. Passov emphasizes the importance of considering learners' background knowledge and the intercultural nature of texts. The relevance to the sphere of educational activity is determined by how well texts correspond to students' communicative needs. Authentic texts were selected from authentic sources such as *Follow Me*, *Conversations and Dialogues in Action*, *English Conversation for English Students*, *Regent Language School*, etc. The criterion of sociocultural richness предполагает selecting typical authentic texts that reflect cultural features of the target language country and highlight similarities and differences with learners' native culture.

Example:

- How much is that?
- Two pounds eighty, please.
- Keep the change.
- Thank you very much.

In the context of globalization and expanding intercultural contacts, the ability to conduct dialogue in natural communication situations becomes especially important. This is impossible without exposure to authentic language material. Traditional educational texts are often artificial and limited, reducing their effectiveness in preparing students for real communication. Authentic texts reflect modern spoken language, including clichés, spontaneity, variability, and culturally determined norms. Their use increases student motivation, making learning more practical and closer to real life. However, their integration requires a scientifically grounded selection approach, which determines the relevance of this study.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the use of authentic texts in teaching dialogic communication is an important and effective means of developing students' communicative competence. They bring the learning process closer to real communication conditions, develop spontaneous speech skills, and form an understanding of sociocultural features of communication. At the same time, the effectiveness of authentic materials depends on their purposeful and methodologically justified selection. Observing principles such as communicative orientation, accessibility, situational relevance, and cultural significance, as well as considering learners' linguistic and psychological characteristics, ensures effective integration into the educational process. Thus, carefully selected authentic texts enrich learning content and serve as an important tool for developing dialogic speech skills, facilitating the transition from classroom communication to real intercultural interaction. Future research prospects are related to developing methods for adapting authentic materials and creating effective systems of exercises based on them.

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FACTORS AFFECTING ELT FRESHMEN'S WILLINGNESS TO SPEAK ENGLISH AS A FOREIGN LANGUAGE

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Abstract: Speaking skills worldwide are considered the most common indicators of competence in a target language, not only for all people but also specifically for English language teacher candidates, given that speaking the language they teach is assumed to be a professional skill. Therefore, this study aims to gauge factors that affect students' eagerness to speak English as a foreign language in the classroom. A quantitative research design was used, and data were collected from ELT freshmen at a state university in İzmir. Fifty participants took part in this study and completed a 32-item online questionnaire. The study found that motivation was the strongest factor affecting students' eagerness to speak the target language, whereas anxiety about speaking was moderate. Though participants were highly motivated to speak in class, their concerns made them nervous and held them back. Moreover, their self-perceived competence did not match their willingness to communicate. The study shows the importance of a supportive classroom setting and an anxiety-free environment for students to speak English confidently.

Keywords: Willingness to speak, speaking anxiety, motivation, self-perceived competence, professional skill.

ÜNİVERSİTE 1. SINIF İNGİLİZCE ÖĞRETMENİ ADAYLARININ YABANCI DİL KONUŞMA İSTEĞİNİ ETKİLEYEN FAKTÖRLER

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Özet: Dünya çapında konuşma becerileri, hedef dildeki yeterliliğin en yaygın göstergeleri olarak kabul edilmektedir; bu durum sadece genel olarak herkes için değil, özellikle İngilizce öğretmen adayları için de geçerlidir; zira öğrettikleri dili konuşabilmek mesleki bir beceri olarak kabul edilmektedir. Bu nedenle bu çalışma, öğrencilerin sınıf ortamında yabancı dil olarak İngilizce konuşma istekliliğini etkileyen faktörleri belirlemeyi amaçlamaktadır. Nicel bir araştırma tasarımı kullanılmıştır ve veriler İzmir'deki bir devlet üniversitesinde İngilizce Öğretmenliği birinci sınıf öğrencilerinden toplanmıştır. Bu çalışmada elli katılımcı yer almıştır ve 32 maddelik bir çevrimiçi anketi doldurmuştur. Çalışma, motivasyonun öğrencilerin hedef dili konuşma istekliliğini etkileyen en güçlü faktör olduğunu, konuşma kaygısının ise orta düzeyde olduğunu ortaya koymuştur. Katılımcılar sınıfta konuşmaya oldukça istekli olsalar da, endişeleri onları tedirgin etti ve çekingen davranmalarına neden oldu. Ayrıca, kendilerini yetkin bulma düzeyleri, iletişim kurma istekleriyle uyuşmuyordu. Çalışma, öğrencilerin kendinden emin bir şekilde İngilizce konuşabilmeleri için destekleyici bir sınıf ortamının ve kaygıdan uzak bir ortamın önemini ortaya koymaktadır.

Anahtar kelimeler: Konuşma isteği, konuşma kaygısı, motivasyon, kendini yetkin bulma, mesleki beceri.

1. Introduction

Speaking, as one of the most significant productive skills of language learning, holds a pivotal position in the process of acquiring a language, particularly in the field of English Language Teaching. Therefore, English functions as a primary tool not only for their careers but also for their everyday life. For this reason, to accomplish speaking action successfully, they need to train themselves to be professionally competent (Brown, 2001; Richards, 2008). In particular, during their professional development, most teacher candidates may find it intriguing to speak in public or present a lesson in English, despite having strong motivation. Being familiar with the structure of English may not overcome this anxiety, given that speaking a language requires more than knowing its structure and having strong motivation and initiative. Hence, unless necessary skills and training are taken, the desire to speak in class may become insufficient. Additionally, many students may find it rather challenging to speak the target language in the classroom (Horwitz, 1986; Maclyntre, 1998).

As the second issue, many students might fear being humiliated by their peers when they are struggling to speak the target language in public. At this point, their motivation to use the foreign language in public might be negatively affected, as motivation is considered a powerful driver of success (Dörnyei, 2001; Gardner, 1985). Learners who have lost their motivation, alongside the fear of being judged by their peers, are hindered from using the target language effectively in the classroom. When a student is treated judgmentally by their peers, which hinders effective use of the target language, this negative atmosphere will soon affect the other students. Therefore, a student's success is associated with the potential success of others, as classroom inclusion and collaboration have reciprocal effects on learners (Vygotsky, 1978).

Considering the issues cited above, this study aims to examine factors affecting students' eagerness to speak English in classroom settings. In order to fulfill this, the current study seeks to answer the questions below:

1. What factors affect students' willingness to speak English as a foreign language in a classroom setting?
2. Are there any differences affecting willingness to speak English as a foreign language in terms of gender?

2. Materials and Methods

This study adopted a quantitative research design to reveal the factors influencing students' eagerness to speak in class. An experimental design was used to address the study's research questions. The study was conducted at the state university in Izmir, Türkiye. Participants in the study are 50 first-year university students recruited on a voluntary basis (Creswell, 2012; Cohen, 2018). To collect the data, a five-point Likert scale adopted from Dörnyei (2005) was used. The questionnaire's validity was calculated, and Cronbach's Alpha was .75. The questionnaire contains five rating scales from 1 (strongly agree) to 5 (strongly disagree). The questionnaire also consisted of four main sections as follows:

- a) Willingness to speak
- b) Speaking anxiety
- c) Self-perceived competence
- d) Motivation

Additionally, the questionnaire comprised 32 questions and took students 10 to 15 minutes to complete. Descriptive statistics were used to analyze the collected data quantitatively. The study was conducted in accordance with ethical principles. All participants were informed of the study's aim and its use of data for academic purposes. Additionally, the questionnaire was anonymous to maintain confidentiality and encourage honest responses. No personal information was included in the analysis, and all responses were used solely for the research.

3. Results and Discussion

The study involved 50 freshmen from the English Language Teaching department. Most participants are female (68%), while male participants account for 30%, and one participant chose not to state their gender. By age, the most common is 19 at 40%, followed by 18-year-olds at 26%. Moreover, nearly half of the students graduated from Anatolian High Schools (46%). Furthermore, their language backgrounds are also clear. 54% of the students feel they are at an Upper-Intermediate level. This confidence is also evident in their classroom participation. About 92% of participants reported speaking English 'often' or 'sometimes'. They actually want to participate in English class communication. The statistics were given in Table 1 below.

Table 1. *Demographic Information and Language Background*

Variable	Category	Percentage (%)
Gender	Female	68%
	Male	30%
	Other / Not stated	2%
Age	18	26%
	19	40%

Variable	Category	Percentage (%)
Language Level	20+	34%
	Upper-Intermediate	54%
	Other	46%

Basic descriptive statistics such as means (M) and standard deviations (SD) were used to analyze the survey. Specifically, the mean (M) and standard deviation (SD) were calculated for the four main parts of our questionnaire. These parts were motivation, willingness to speak, self-perceived competence, and speaking anxiety. Table 2 describes all details below.

Table 2. *Descriptive Statistics of the Main Constructs*

Category	Mean (M)	Standard Deviation (SD)
Motivation	4.46	0.61
Willingness to Speak	3.77	0.73
Self-Perceived Competence	3.63	0.52
Speaking Anxiety	3.03	0.70

Motivation emerged as the strongest factor in the group. It reached a high mean score of 4.46 with a standard deviation of 0.61. The answers were very consistent. Almost everyone selected Agree or Strongly Agree on the survey. The motivation to speak in class actually shows an important issue to address. The participants do not evaluate English as a hobby; they see it as a prerequisite. So, they also have to communicate efficiently. It seems that this will enhance their motivation. The participants also wanted to improve their language skills so they could teach well when they become teachers.

According to the statistics, the second section, the willingness to speak category, had a mean score of 3.77 and a standard deviation of 0.73. It indicates that the participants are highly motivated and are interested in joining the speaking activities. Besides, they usually feel ready to communicate when they are given the chance. It was also observed that high motivation naturally increases their enthusiasm for using the target language.

In the self-perceived competence section, the mean score was 3.63 with a standard deviation of 0.52. It is revealed that the participants have a realistic view of their own skills. Also, they seemed eager to speak, but sometimes they hesitated. This might result from their awareness of their language capacity, indicating they need continuous improvement.

In the final section, speaking anxiety ranks last, with a mean score of 2.02 and a standard deviation of 0.70. The results indicated that students still have anxiety with a moderate level of nervousness. According to these statistics, students are interested in speaking, but they have some concerns during classroom activities. Their concerns mostly center on making mistakes and being judged by their peers.

4. Conclusion

The study aimed to measure students' willingness to speak English as a foreign language in a classroom setting. In light of the findings, it is concluded that pre-service English teachers are highly motivated to use the target language in the classroom atmosphere. Nevertheless, their self-perceived competence does not align with their willingness to speak. These might stem from the fact that they are in the process of language learning, which may hinder their readiness to speak and trust themselves. On the other hand, students still worry about being assessed and criticized by their peers, which hinders learning a foreign language by causing anxiety (Horwitz, 1986).

As the second issue, it seemed apparent that motivation can contribute to a certain level of student participation in communication. Teachers shoulder a great responsibility to create a more motivating and proficiency-enhancing classroom atmosphere in which students feel free from stress, peer judgment, and harassment. As long as students feel secure, without the fear of immediate correction from their teachers and peers, they will feel prepared and mature to use the target language efficiently.

In terms of implications, the fear of using the target language in public speaking can be eradicated with the strong initiatives of the class teachers who are designing their classes in such a warm climate in which every single student feels themselves in safe hands and any mistake will be welcomingly accepted and constructively corrected both by the instructors and their peers.

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ACADEMIC STRATEGIES FOR DEVELOPING ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS IN HIGHER EDUCATION

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Abstract: The development of English language skills in higher education has become one of the necessary and fundamental requirements in connection with globalization, increased academic mobility and the expansion of international scientific cooperation. In modern times, English acts not only as a means of communication, but also as a key tool for accessing scientific information, publishing research and participating in international academic discourse. In this regard, universities should provide students with language skills at a level that allows them to function effectively in a multilingual and multicultural environment. This article examines effective and scientifically based strategies for developing students' English language competencies, with particular attention to the integrative development of listening, speaking, reading and writing skills. Modern pedagogical approaches recommend that these skills be taught not in isolation, but in interaction and in real academic contexts. In this regard, while communicative language teaching (Brown, 2001) focuses on developing students' real communication skills, task-based learning (Ellis, 2003) allows them to master the language through practical and purposeful activities. At the same time, the integration of technology into the teaching process has become an integral part of modern language teaching. E-learning platforms, virtual classrooms, interactive applications and artificial intelligence-based tools create personalized and flexible learning opportunities for students. These tools not only increase students' motivation, but also create conditions for them to develop language skills in an out-of-class environment. As a result, the effective development of English language skills in higher education requires a complex and innovative approach. The integration of modern learning strategies, technology and continuous assessment mechanisms is the basis of this process. Universities can expand both the language skills of students and their opportunities for successful activity in an international academic environment by implementing flexible and adaptive learning models that meet the needs of students in a globalized world.

Keywords: academic English, language skills, higher education, communicative approach, teaching strategies

ALİ TƏHSİL SƏVİYYƏSİNDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİ BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAF EDİLMƏSİ ÜÇÜN AKADEMİK STRATEGİYALAR

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Xülasə: Ali təhsil mühitində ingilis dili bacarıqlarının inkişafı qloballaşma, akademik mobilliyin artması və beynəlxalq elmi əməkdaşlığın genişlənməsi ilə əlaqədar olaraq zəruri və fundamental tələblərdən birinə çevrilmişdir. Müasir dövrdə ingilis dili yalnız ünsiyyət vasitəsi kimi deyil, həm də elmi məlumatlara çıxış, tədqiqatların nəşri və beynəlxalq akademik diskursda iştirak üçün əsas alət kimi çıxış edir. Bu baxımdan universitetlər tələbələrə çoxdilli və multikultural mühitdə effektiv fəaliyyət göstərə biləcək səviyyədə dil bacarıqları ilə təmin etməlidirlər.

Bu məqalədə tələbələrin ingilis dili kompetensiyalarının inkişaf etdirilməsi üçün effektiv və elmi əsaslandırılmış strategiyalar araşdırılır, xüsusilə dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı bacarıqlarının integrativ şəkildə inkişafına diqqət yetirilir. Müasir pedaqoji yanaşmalar bu bacarıqların ayrı-ayrılıqda deyil, qarşılıqlı əlaqədə və real akademik kontekstlərdə öyrədilməsini tövsiyə edir. Bu baxımdan kommunikativ dil tədrisi (Brown, 2001) tələbələrin real ünsiyyət bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirməyə yönəltdiyi halda, tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə (Ellis, 2003) onların dili praktik və məqsədyönlü fəaliyyətlər vasitəsilə mənimsəməsinə şərait yaradır. Eyni zamanda, texnologiyanın tədris prosesinə integrasiyası müasir dil təliminin ayrılmaz tərkib hissəsinə çevrilmişdir. Elektron tədris platformaları, virtual siniflər, interaktiv tətbiqlər və süni intellekt əsaslı alətlər tələbələrə fərdiləşdirilmiş və çevik öyrənmə imkanları yaradır. Bu vasitələr tələbələrin motivasiyasını artırmaqla yanaşı, onların sinifdən-kənar mühitdə də dil bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirməsinə şərait yaradır. Nəticə etibarilə, ali təhsildə ingilis dili bacarıqlarının effektiv inkişafı kompleks və innovativ yanaşma tələb edir. Müasir təlim strategiyalarının, texnologiyanın və davamlı qiymətləndirmə mexanizmlərinin integrasiyası bu prosesin əsasını təşkil edir. Universitetlər qloballaşan dünyada tələbələrin ehtiyaclarına uyğun çevik və adaptiv təlim modellərini tətbiq etməklə onların həm dil bacarıqlarını, həm də beynəlxalq akademik mühitdə uğurlu fəaliyyət imkanlarını genişləndirə bilərlər.

Açar sözlər: akademik ingilis dili, dil bacarıqları, ali təhsil, kommunikativ yanaşma, təlim strategiyaları

Introduction

In modern higher education, English has become the primary language of academic communication, scientific research, and international collaboration (Crystal, 2012). The dominance of English in scholarly publications, conferences, and global academic networks has made it an essential tool for students and researchers worldwide. As a result, university students are increasingly expected to demonstrate a high level of proficiency in English in order to access academic resources, participate in discussions, present research findings, and produce written work that meets international standards.

The growing importance of English in academia is closely linked to globalization and the internationalization of higher education (Hyland, 2006). Many universities offer programs in English, attract international students, and encourage academic mobility through exchange programs. In this context, English is not merely a subject of study but a medium through which knowledge is constructed, shared, and evaluated. Therefore, insufficient language proficiency can become a significant barrier to academic success, limiting students' ability to fully engage in learning processes and academic communities.

Moreover, the development of academic English skills goes beyond general language competence. It requires mastery of discipline-specific vocabulary, critical reading and analytical writing skills, as well as the ability to engage in formal and structured communication. Students must learn how to interpret complex texts, construct coherent arguments, synthesize information from multiple sources, and present their ideas clearly and persuasively. These skills are essential not only for academic achievement but also for future professional development in an increasingly globalized labor market.

Despite the recognized importance of English language proficiency, many students face challenges in acquiring the necessary skills. These challenges may include limited exposure to

authentic language use, lack of confidence in speaking, insufficient practice opportunities, and traditional teaching methods that focus heavily on grammar rather than communication. Consequently, there is a growing need for innovative and student-centered teaching approaches that address these issues and support effective language learning.

Therefore, developing effective strategies for teaching English in higher education is essential. Such strategies should integrate modern pedagogical approaches, including communicative language teaching, task-based learning, and the use of digital technologies. They should also promote active learning, collaboration, and learner autonomy, enabling students to take responsibility for their own language development.

This study aims to identify and analyze key approaches that enhance students' academic language competencies and improve overall learning outcomes. By examining contemporary teaching practices and theoretical perspectives, the research seeks to provide insights into how English language instruction can be optimized in higher education contexts. Ultimately, the study contributes to the ongoing discussion on improving the quality of language education and preparing students for successful participation in the global academic community.

Materials and Methods

This study employs a qualitative research approach aimed at exploring and analyzing effective strategies for developing English language skills in higher education. The research is primarily based on an extensive review and synthesis of scientific literature, contemporary pedagogical models, and international teaching practices. By focusing on theoretical and empirical sources, the study seeks to identify best practices and evaluate their applicability within university-level language education (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).

A systematic literature review method was utilized to collect relevant academic sources, including peer-reviewed journal articles, books, conference proceedings, and reports published by international educational organizations. The selected materials mainly focus on communicative language teaching (CLT), task-based learning (TBL), student-centered approaches, and the integration of digital technologies in language education. Priority was given to recent and widely cited studies to ensure the reliability and relevance of the findings.

In addition, comparative and descriptive research methods were applied to examine similarities and differences among various teaching strategies. The comparative method enabled the evaluation of different instructional approaches in terms of their effectiveness, adaptability, and relevance to academic contexts. The descriptive method was used to present and interpret key characteristics of each approach, highlighting their strengths and limitations in practice.

The study also incorporates elements of content analysis, allowing for the identification of recurring themes, patterns, and trends in the literature. This analytical process made it possible to categorize teaching strategies according to their pedagogical focus, such as communicative competence, learner autonomy, collaborative learning, and technology-enhanced instruction. Furthermore, examples of best practices from international higher education institutions were reviewed to provide a broader perspective on the implementation of these strategies.

Overall, the methodological framework of this study provides a comprehensive and systematic analysis of current approaches to English language teaching in higher education, offering valuable insights for educators, researchers, and policymakers.

Discussion

The findings of this study reveal that the development of English language skills in academic settings requires a holistic, integrated, and student-centered approach. In contemporary higher

education, language learning is most effective when it moves beyond traditional grammar-focused instruction and emphasizes meaningful communication, active participation, and authentic language use. The analysis shows that combining multiple pedagogical strategies leads to more sustainable improvements in students' academic language competencies.

One of the key findings is that communicative language teaching (CLT) plays a significant role in enhancing students' speaking and listening skills. By encouraging real-life interaction (Brown, 2001), classroom discussions, role-plays, and collaborative tasks, CLT creates opportunities for learners to use English in meaningful contexts. This approach reduces language anxiety, increases learner confidence, and promotes spontaneous communication, which is essential for academic and professional environments. As a result, students become more capable of expressing ideas clearly and engaging in academic discourse.

Similarly, task-based learning (TBL) has been identified as an effective strategy for developing practical language use. The study indicates that when students are engaged in meaningful tasks such as problem-solving activities, project work, and case studies, they are more likely to apply language structures naturally and purposefully. TBL not only improves linguistic accuracy but also enhances critical thinking, collaboration, and decision-making skills, which are essential in higher education contexts (Ellis, 2003).

Another important finding is the significant contribution of digital tools to language learning. Online platforms, mobile applications, virtual classrooms, and interactive learning environments provide students with flexible and personalized learning opportunities. These tools enable learners to access authentic materials, practice language skills independently, and receive immediate feedback. Moreover, multimedia resources such as videos, podcasts, and interactive exercises enhance engagement and support different learning styles. The integration of technology into language instruction also extends learning beyond the classroom, making it more continuous and accessible (Hyland, 2006).

The study further emphasizes the importance of academic reading and writing skills, which are critical for students' success in higher education. Academic reading skills allow students to understand complex texts, analyze information critically, and extract relevant data from scholarly sources. Writing skills, on the other hand, enable students to produce structured essays, research papers, and reports that meet academic standards. The development of these skills is essential for participation in scientific communication and research activities.

Overall, the discussion highlights that the most effective approach to English language teaching in higher education is one that integrates communicative, task-based, technological, and assessment-driven strategies. The combination of these approaches creates a dynamic and supportive learning environment that fosters both linguistic competence and academic success.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the development of English language skills in higher education requires a comprehensive, systematic, and multidimensional approach that integrates modern pedagogical strategies, digital technologies, and effective assessment methods. In the context of globalization and the increasing internationalization of academic environments, English has become not only a medium of instruction but also a key competence for academic success, research productivity, and professional development.

The findings of this study emphasize that traditional teacher-centered approaches are no longer sufficient to meet the complex language needs of university students. Instead, student-centered and interactive learning environments play a crucial role in enhancing language

acquisition. Such environments encourage active participation, collaboration, critical thinking, and learner autonomy, which are essential components of successful language learning. When students are actively engaged in the learning process, they are more likely to develop confidence and fluency in using English for academic purposes.

Furthermore, the integration of modern teaching strategies such as communicative language teaching, task-based learning, and blended learning models significantly contributes to improving students' linguistic competence. These approaches provide learners with opportunities to use language in meaningful and authentic contexts, thereby bridging the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application. In addition, the use of digital technologies, including online platforms, multimedia resources, and artificial intelligence-based tools, expands learning opportunities beyond the classroom and supports individualized learning pathways.

Overall, the implementation of innovative pedagogical approaches in higher education is essential for improving the quality of English language teaching. A balanced integration of modern methodologies, technological support, and continuous assessment ensures a more effective and sustainable language learning process. In the future, further research and practical application of these strategies will continue to enhance academic English proficiency and better prepare students for participation in the global academic and professional community.

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THE ROLE OF INTERACTIVE TEACHING METHODS IN IMPROVING THE QUALITY OF EDUCATION

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Abstract: The improvement of teaching quality in general education has become one of the most important priorities in modern pedagogical practice, as education systems worldwide strive to meet the demands of rapidly changing social, technological, and economic environments. In this context, interactive teaching methods have emerged as one of the most effective and innovative approaches to enhancing the quality of the teaching and learning process. Unlike traditional teacher-centered instruction, which positions students as passive recipients of knowledge, interactive methods place learners at the center of the educational process, encouraging active participation, collaboration, and critical engagement with learning content. This article explores the role of interactive teaching methods in improving the quality of education in general education settings. It analyzes how various interactive techniques (such as group work, discussions, problem-solving activities, project-based learning, brainstorming, and digital tools) contribute to more effective learning outcomes. These methods facilitate deeper understanding of subject content and promote the development of essential 21st-century skills, including communication, teamwork, creativity, and critical thinking. The study is based on a qualitative analysis of contemporary pedagogical literature, educational theories, and classroom practices. By synthesizing findings from different academic sources, the research identifies key factors influencing the effectiveness of interactive teaching approaches. The results indicate that the implementation of interactive teaching methods significantly enhances student motivation, engagement, and academic achievement. Furthermore, these methods create a more dynamic and supportive learning environment, where students feel more confident and responsible for their own learning process.

In conclusion, the article emphasizes that the successful application of interactive teaching methods depends on well-prepared and professionally trained teachers, adequate teaching resources, and continuous professional development. Therefore, educational institutions should prioritize teacher training programs and provide appropriate infrastructure to ensure the effective integration of interactive approaches into everyday teaching practice.

Key words: interactive teaching methods, teaching quality, pedagogical approaches, classroom interaction, teaching strategies, student-centered learning, optimization of teaching process

TƏHSİLİN KEYFİYYƏTİNİN YÜKSƏLDİLMƏSİNDƏ İNTERAKTİV TƏDRİS METODLARININ ROLU

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Xülasə: Ümumi təhsildə tədrisin keyfiyyətinin yüksəldilməsi müasir pedaqoji təcrübənin ən mühüm prioritetlərindən biridir, çünki təhsil sistemləri sürətlə dəyişən sosial, texnoloji və iqtisadi tələblərə uyğunlaşmağa çalışır. Bu kontekstdə interaktiv təlim metodları tədris və öyrənmə prosesinin keyfiyyətini artıran ən effektiv və innovativ yanaşmalardan biri kimi çıxış edir. Ənənəvi müəllimlərlə tələmədən fərqli olaraq, interaktiv metodlar şagirdləri təlim prosesinin mərkəzinə yerləşdirir, onların fəal iştirakını, əməkdaşlığını və tənqidi düşünməsini təşviq edir.

Məqalədə interaktiv təlim metodlarının ümumi təhsildə tədrisin keyfiyyətinin yüksəldilməsində rolu araşdırılır. Qrup işi, müzakirələr, problem həlli tapşırıqları, layihə əsaslı öyrənmə, beyin həmləsi və rəqəmsal vasitələrin istifadəsi kimi interaktiv texnikaların daha effektiv öyrənmə nəticələrinə necə təsir etdiyi təhlil

olunur. Bu metodlar fənn məzmununun daha dərinlən mənimsənilməsinə şərait yaradır və eyni zamanda ünsiyyət, əməkdaşlıq, yaradıcılıq və tənqidi düşünmə kimi XXI əsr bacarıqlarının inkişafını dəstəkləyir.

Tədqiqat müasir pedaqoji ədəbiyyatın, təhsil nəzəriyyələrinin və sinif təcrübələrinin keyfiyyət təhlili əsasında aparılmışdır. Müxtəlif elmi mənbələrin sintezi nəticəsində interaktiv təlim yanaşmalarının effektivliyinə təsir edən əsas amillər müəyyən edilmişdir. Nəticələr göstərir ki, interaktiv təlim metodlarının tətbiqi şagirdlərin motivasiyasını, fəallığını və akademik nailiyyətlərini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır. Eyni zamanda, bu yanaşmalar daha dinamik və dəstəkləyici öyrənmə mühiti yaradır, şagirdlərdə özünəinam və öyrənməyə görə məsuliyyət hissini gücləndirir.

Nəticə etibarilə, interaktiv təlim metodlarının səmərəli tətbiqi üçün müəllimlərin peşəkar hazırlığı, adekvat tədris resursları və davamlı peşəkar inkişaf mühüm şərt kimi çıxış edir. Buna görə də təhsil müəssisələri interaktiv yanaşmaların effektiv tətbiqi üçün müəllim hazırlığı proqramlarını və infrastruktur təminatını prioritet kimi inkişaf etdirməlidirlər.

Açar sözlər: interaktiv təlim metodları, tədrisin keyfiyyəti, pedaqoji yanaşmalar, sinifdaxili qarşılıqlı əlaqə, təlim strategiyaları, şagirdyönlü öyrənmə, tədris prosesinin optimallaşdırılması

Introduction

Modern education systems aim to continuously improve teaching quality through innovative pedagogical approaches that respond to the changing needs of society and learners. In the context of globalization, digital transformation, and the rapid development of information technologies, traditional teaching methods are no longer sufficient to ensure high-quality learning outcomes. As a result, educators and researchers increasingly focus on learner-centered approaches that enhance students' active involvement in the educational process. One of the most effective approaches in this regard is the use of interactive teaching methods, which promote active student participation and meaningful learning experiences. These methods are based on the principle that learning becomes more effective when students are directly involved in the process of knowledge construction rather than passively receiving information (Brown, 2014). Interactive teaching encourages students to think critically, express their ideas, and engage in collaborative learning activities. Unlike traditional methods, which are mainly teacher-centered and focus on memorization of information, interactive approaches create opportunities for communication, cooperation, and problem-solving among learners. Techniques such as group discussions, pair work, role-playing, brainstorming, case studies, and project-based learning allow students to apply theoretical knowledge in practical situations. This not only strengthens their understanding of the subject matter but also develops essential skills such as creativity, teamwork, decision-making, and independent thinking.

In addition, the integration of digital technologies into interactive teaching further enhances the learning process. Online platforms, multimedia resources, and interactive applications provide students with flexible and engaging learning environments, making education more accessible and effective. These tools also support individualized learning, allowing students to progress at their own pace and according to their own needs (Johnson & Johnson, 2017).

Therefore, interactive teaching methods play a crucial role in transforming traditional education systems into dynamic, student-centered learning environments that support both academic achievement and personal development.

Materials and Methods

This study is based on qualitative research methodology aimed at examining the effectiveness of interactive teaching methods in improving the quality of education. The qualitative approach was selected because it allows for an in-depth understanding of pedagogical processes, classroom

interactions, and the practical application of teaching strategies in real educational settings (Creswell, 2018). Unlike quantitative methods, qualitative research provides a more detailed analysis of behaviors, experiences, and educational practices.

The research process involved a systematic review of scientific literature, including peer-reviewed journal articles, books, and international research studies related to interactive teaching methods, student-centered learning, and modern pedagogical approaches. In addition, relevant pedagogical theories were analyzed to identify the conceptual foundations of interactive instruction and its role in enhancing teaching quality. In this context, the work of Sugata Mitra is particularly relevant. His research on Self-Organized Learning Environments (SOLE) demonstrates that students can effectively develop knowledge and problem-solving skills through collaboration, inquiry-based learning, and minimal teacher intervention. Mitra's findings strongly support the idea that interactive and technology-enhanced learning environments foster autonomy, engagement, and deeper understanding among learners (Mitra, 2010).

Furthermore, classroom practices reported in previous empirical studies were examined to understand how interactive methods are implemented in real educational environments (Hattie, 2018). This included an analysis of teacher-student interactions, instructional strategies, and learning activities used in general education settings. The study focused on identifying patterns that contribute to effective learning outcomes.

Comparative and descriptive research methods were also applied. The comparative method was used to evaluate different interactive teaching strategies, such as group work, classroom discussions, role-playing, brainstorming activities, and problem-based learning. These methods were compared in terms of their effectiveness, student engagement levels, and contribution to skill development. The descriptive method was used to systematically present and interpret the characteristics of each instructional approach, highlighting their pedagogical advantages and potential limitations.

In addition, content analysis was applied to categorize and synthesize key themes emerging from the reviewed literature (Vygotsky, 1978). These themes included student engagement, communication skills, critical thinking development, collaboration, and the integration of technology in teaching. Through this analytical framework, the study aimed to provide a comprehensive understanding of how interactive teaching methods contribute to improving the overall quality of the educational process.

Overall, the methodological framework ensures a reliable and structured analysis of interactive teaching practices, offering evidence-based insights for educators and researchers.

Discussion

The analysis of the reviewed pedagogical literature and classroom-based studies indicates that interactive teaching methods have a significantly positive impact on the overall quality of education. The findings consistently demonstrate that when interactive strategies are systematically applied in the learning process, student engagement, motivation, and comprehension of learning material increase considerably (Freeman et al., 2014). This suggests that interactive approaches create a more dynamic and learner-centered educational environment compared to traditional teacher-centered instruction.

In particular, group activities and structured classroom discussions play a crucial role in developing students' communication skills and teamwork abilities (Prince, 2017). When learners are actively involved in collaborative tasks, they are encouraged to express their ideas, listen to others, and negotiate meaning within a group setting. This process not only improves language and

communication competence but also fosters social interaction skills that are essential for both academic and professional life. Furthermore, such activities contribute to the development of responsibility and cooperation among students.

Problem-solving tasks and inquiry-based learning activities are also identified as highly effective components of interactive teaching. These approaches enhance students' analytical thinking, creativity, and decision-making skills by requiring them to apply theoretical knowledge to practical situations. As a result, learners become more capable of independently analyzing problems, generating solutions, and evaluating different perspectives. This contributes to deeper cognitive processing and long-term retention of knowledge.

In addition, the integration of digital technologies into interactive teaching environments further strengthens the learning process (Laurillard, 2019). The use of multimedia resources, online learning platforms, educational applications, and interactive tools increases student interest and facilitates more flexible and engaging instruction. These technologies also support individualized learning, allowing students to learn at their own pace and revisit materials when necessary, which improves overall learning effectiveness.

However, the findings also highlight that the success of interactive teaching methods is highly dependent on teachers' professional competencies, methodological preparedness, and classroom management skills. Teachers play a key role in designing meaningful learning activities, guiding student interaction, and maintaining an effective learning environment. Without adequate training and pedagogical competence, the potential benefits of interactive methods may not be fully realized.

Overall, the results confirm that interactive teaching methods significantly enhance the quality of education when properly implemented and supported by qualified teaching staff and appropriate learning resources.

Conclusion

In conclusion, interactive teaching methods play a significant and increasingly important role in improving the quality of education in general schools. These approaches transform the learning process from passive knowledge transmission into an active, student-centered environment where learners are directly involved in constructing their own understanding. As a result, students not only acquire subject knowledge more effectively, but also develop essential 21st-century skills such as critical thinking, communication, collaboration, and creativity.

The application of interactive methods also contributes to a more motivating and engaging classroom atmosphere. When students participate in discussions, group work, problem-solving tasks, and other collaborative activities, they become more responsible for their own learning process. This increases their interest in the subject and improves long-term retention of knowledge. Furthermore, interactive strategies help teachers identify students' individual needs and adapt instruction accordingly, which enhances overall learning outcomes. At the same time, the effectiveness of these methods largely depends on the professional competence of teachers and their ability to manage an interactive classroom environment. Therefore, continuous professional development, methodological training, and access to modern teaching resources are essential for the successful implementation of interactive pedagogy. Schools should also ensure the availability of digital tools and supportive learning materials to strengthen the impact of these approaches.

Overall, the integration of interactive teaching methods into general education systems represents a necessary step toward improving educational quality and aligning teaching practices with modern pedagogical standards.

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INNOVATIVE ASSESSMENT STRATEGIES IN TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH

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Abstract: Improving the quality of the educational process and increasing the efficiency of management are among the main priorities in the modern education system. In this regard, the proper organization of the monitoring and evaluation mechanism in secondary schools is of particular importance. Monitoring and evaluation allow you to track the progress of the educational process, objectively analyze the results achieved, and determine the dynamics of education development. The implementation of this system in educational institutions creates conditions for more efficient organization of the activities of all participants in the pedagogical process - teachers, students, parents

and management. At the same time, increasing the cognitive activity of students, objective assessment of their knowledge and skills, and the application of modern approaches in the learning process play an important role in improving the quality of education.

Keywords: Monitoring, evaluation, education system, comprehensive schools, educational process, management, cognitive activity of students, pedagogical process, quality of education, teacher activity.

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİ VƏ ÖYRƏNİLMƏSİNDƏ İNNOVATİV QİYMƏTLƏNDİRMƏ STRATEGİYALARI

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Xülasə: Təhsil prosesinin keyfiyyətinin yaxşılaşdırılması və idarəetmənin səmərəliliyinin artırılması müasir təhsil sisteminin əsas prioritetləri sırasındadır. Bu baxımdan, ümumtəhsil məktəblərində monitoring və qiymətləndirmə mexanizminin düzgün təşkili xüsusi əhəmiyyət kəsb edir. Monitoring və qiymətləndirmə təlim prosesinin gedişatını izləməyə, əldə olunmuş nəticələri obyektiv təhlil etməyə və təhsilin inkişaf dinamikasını müəyyənləşdirməyə imkan verir. Bu sistemin təhsil müəssisələrində tətbiqi pedaqoji prosesin bütün iştirakçılarının – müəllimlərin, şagirdlərin, valideynlərin və rəhbərliyin fəaliyyətini daha səmərəli təşkil etməyə şərait yaradır. Aynı zamanda, şagirdlərin idrak fəallığının artırılması, onların bilik və bacarıqlarının obyektiv qiymətləndirilməsi, təlim prosesində müasir yanaşmaların tətbiqi təhsilin keyfiyyətinin yüksəldilməsində mühüm rol oynayır.

Açar sözlər: Monitoring, qiymətləndirmə, təhsil sistemi, ümumtəhsil məktəbləri, təlim prosesi, idarəetmə, şagirdlərin idrak fəallığı, pedaqoji proses, təhsilin keyfiyyəti, müəllim fəaliyyəti.

Introduction

One of the priority directions of our education system is the continuation of the transition to lifelong learning. In modern times, lifelong learning is understood as a system of acquiring professional education, raising the general cultural level, moral and civic responsibility. In this regard, lifelong learning faces three main tasks that are closely related to each other:

- raising the general cultural level;
- creating human resources;
- modernization of personnel potential

What and at what level does the development of society affect education. The development of education is the result of the development of society. Let us also note that there is also a feedback loop here. In this case, education can affect the development of society, reduce or increase its development. Therefore, the changes taking place in education and made to education in accordance with modern requirements are an important condition for

the future development of society. In order for there to be socio-political, socio-economic and cultural progress in society, there must be highly professional, educated and capable personnel who train and educate the younger generation in the education system. In the current globalized modern world, education is a national issue for all states. The role of the human factor in the development of education has been considered important.

Today, numerous innovations of various natures are being implemented in the educational sphere of developed and developing countries of the world, depending on their direction and importance. Progressive trends are noticeable in the direction of small or large-scale state reforms, renewal and enrichment of the content of education, forms of its organization, methods and technologies. These changes are aimed at the following main areas of the education system:

- improving the financing and social status of the system;
- the structure of the education system;
- updating the content of education (curriculum, programs and textbooks);
- organizing the internal activities of the school;
- teacher-student relations;
- teaching methods;
- equipping educational institutions and using information technologies in education;

This is, first of all, the process of collecting information for the purpose of the activities of the main participants in the pedagogical process. In this case, the assessment by experts based on the following principles will create the conditions for obtaining a complete, detailed picture of the quality of the school's educational process:

- collection of accurate and reliable information about the object to be evaluated (pedagogical process or any of its elements);
- accurate use of quantitative measurements when assessing the quality of education after analyzing the materials obtained as a result of monitoring;
- preparation of special regulatory and legal documents for this purpose in advance;
- regular informing the public and official bodies about the results, as well as the implementation of the assessment, in order to ensure transparency during the assessment with monitoring observations;
- conducting the assessment of the quality of education in accordance with international standards.

Since the results of the student's learning appear as the results of all activities taking place in the field, it is possible to evaluate the activities of educational institutions, structures of educational departments and the education system of the country as a whole, as well as the results and conclusions obtained from the results of the study. At the same time, it is possible to determine the actual state of quality. Such a management system is being created in the general education system of the Republic of Azerbaijan.

Materials and Methods

First, let's focus on the concept of evaluation: "Evaluation is the determination of the value of a measured parameter, the state of an object or system in relation to an accepted standard. This procedure requires the presence of an evaluation scale that allows the degree of proximity of the measurement result to the standard to be converted into a quantitative

indicator. Monitoring allows you to determine the characteristics of changes in the value of a parameter, the state of an object or system (quality indicator), the causes of these changes, and ways to influence them.

Thus, monitoring is a process of continuous and systematic collection and analysis of information about the situation in order to study the characteristics of the changes taking place and make appropriate decisions. In modern times, monitoring is considered a technology that is successfully applied in various fields of activity, including education.

After looking at the meanings of both of these concepts and what systems they implement, we can say that evaluation and monitoring are related concepts. More precisely, evaluation is a concept that serves monitoring.

The word monitoring is derived from the Latin verb “monere”, which means “to notify”. Monitoring is the systematic and purposeful observation of a certain type of activity and its development and recording the results. Monitoring allows you to systematically collect information about all aspects of the observed activity and analyze this information, increase the effectiveness and efficiency of that activity, and timely transmit information about inconsistencies in the activity to managers and decision-makers. Implementing monitoring in planning is like controlling the path you are taking while riding a bicycle: you can adjust it without getting off the bike and be sure that you are going on the right path.

With the help of data obtained from monitoring student success, the actual state of school performance can be systematically and objectively predicted. Although monitoring and evaluation are interrelated systems, there are a number of differences between them.

The biggest difference between monitoring and evaluation in education is that the results of monitoring can be used to improve the efficiency of the process and make certain adjustments while the process is ongoing. Thus, monitoring determines the current status of the activity. Since evaluation determines the impact of the activity, its results can only be used for monitoring purposes in the next school years or during the implementation of the next assessment program. For example, as a result of internal school assessment, students' performance can be compared in terms of compliance with state standards. However, teachers who are in the most contact with students do not always have such static indicators during the school year to help students who are lagging behind, but rely only on their own observations using various assessment methods and tools. For this reason, in many countries with advanced education systems, monitoring of student achievements is carried out by school teachers. Thus, to obtain information about students who are lagging behind in education, teachers use a special type of internal school assessment - formative assessment. Thus, no student is left out.

In short, monitoring is an internal management process that continuously monitors the quality of education.

Monitoring can identify the strengths and weaknesses of educational activities and provide practical suggestions for achieving the expected results. Monitoring means not only making suggestions, but also taking concrete steps to solve problems. Monitoring has three main components:

- Data collection;
- Data analysis;
- Actions taken.

Monitoring should be carried out by collecting reliable data. Only then will the quality of education be good. The main thing in monitoring is to collect information that can be the object of

analysis.

Data analysis should be conducted in such a way that it helps to implement the necessary measures to eliminate the problems. This involves identifying reliable indicators for education managers to identify problems. These indicators are empirical results and reflect reality. Actions taken as a result of monitoring include precautionary measures, corrective measures and strengthening measures. Collecting data without taking action or only analyzing the collected data may be important from a research perspective, but this is nothing more than a fruitless experiment from a management perspective. Measures can take the following forms:

- Structural: reform measures aimed at developing or fundamentally changing the education system.
- Individual: this includes sanctions and recommendations. Sanctions can be positive - stimulating (for example, promotion, updating school equipment, etc.) or negative - punitive (for example, reprimand or dismissal)

Discussion

The new assessment system implemented in the field of general education is conceived as a mechanism that evaluates all activities in general education and ensures their development in line with the established relevant standards. Here, all activities mean the activities of the student, teacher, educational institution, education management structures and, finally, the general education system of the country. The leading link in this hierarchy is the results of the student's learning activities, all other activities serve to obtain these results and are reflected in these results. Therefore, the basis of the new assessment system is the consistent and systematic assessment of student learning activities. Its essence, main features and types, as well as the essence, content and rules for conducting each type are reflected in the "Concept of Assessment in the Field of General Education of the Republic of Azerbaijan" and the instructions prepared on its basis.

In the new assessment system implemented in education, student assessment is divided into three systems: internal school assessment, national assessment, and international assessment. The most comprehensive and important of these assessment systems is internal school assessment. The student progress monitoring system, which forms the basis of internal school assessment, is conceived as a technology that directs the student's learning and the teacher's teaching activities to achieve the specified learning outcomes in the subject during the school year and allows for the assessment of the activities of both parties at the end of the school year. National assessment allows for the examination of the compliance of existing educational programs (curricula) with real needs, for determining their quality, and the results of international assessment allow for the comparison of the quality of education in the country with other countries.

Thus, the results of national and international assessments serve as the main database for improving the country's education system. Thus, the new assessment, being a very broad and comprehensive process, serves to improve all activities in the field of education in accordance with the requirements set out in the document "State standards and programs (curricula) of the general education level of the Republic of Azerbaijan" and thus to manage the quality of education as a whole.

Each assessment involves objective diagnostics (quality indicators) of the student. The quality of training, the effective functioning of the institution, the solution of many didactic and educational tasks largely depend on the objectivity of this information. Since monitoring and evaluation of knowledge and the learning process in pedagogical practice is mainly subjective in nature, it highlights the relevance of monitoring and evaluating the learning process with new approaches and

methods, and increases the importance of creating new assessment mechanisms in the process of assessing knowledge and activity. The main task of assessment is to determine the readiness of teachers for lessons, the quality of lessons, the level of implementation of the teaching of subjects provided for at each level of general education in terms of current requirements, the level of knowledge and skills of students, and to clarify in what aspects it is necessary to provide methodological assistance to each member of the pedagogical team.

Conclusion

The following conclusions were reached in the research:

1. Monitoring and evaluation play an important role in democratic management of the education system and in improving the quality dynamics of teaching and learning in schools. In order for secondary schools to produce effective results, their management form must be further improved. The main participants in the pedagogical process, teachers, parents, students, and educational management staff, should be involved in the evaluation.
2. Assessment helps improve the teaching and learning process, increases the efficiency of education, and creates objective conditions to determine what learners have mastered, what information they have learned, what skills they have acquired, and what changes have occurred in them.
3. With the help of properly conducted monitoring and evaluation, the heads of educational institutions collect the necessary information about the level of educational work in the institution, the activities of teachers and students, summarize the results, take appropriate preventive measures and prepare proposals to eliminate the identified shortcomings and ensure that the work is at an excellent level. Timely elimination of existing shortcomings in education is one of the important conditions.
4. The activities of educational institutions will be even more effective if the monitoring and assessment of students' cognitive activity are carried out on the principles of equality and fairness. There should be no discrimination between educational institutions. The work should not be of a personal interest nature.
5. Regular monitoring of students' cognitive activity, modernization of the form and content of education, implementation of new educational standards, normalization of the course load, protection and further strengthening of students' health, and other issues are processes of particular importance.
6. In many schools, monitoring and evaluation leads to increased responsibility of teaching staff members, a more professional approach to their work, and motivates the staff to do new things that are beneficial to students.
7. Without fully understanding the essence of the concepts of monitoring and evaluation, it is impossible to ensure their objectivity. Knowing the form and content of these concepts well, understanding their tasks in depth, and mastering advanced practices are important conditions. One of the main conditions is the purposeful organization of work. If these conditions are followed in a planned manner, the quality of education and the dynamics of development will increase. In particular, the principle of purposefulness must be strictly observed. Experts should know in advance what is to be monitored and evaluated in the field of school education.
8. Cognitive activity of students is a systematic process and an integral part of educational

activity. Cognitive activity exists primarily on the basis of stimulation of thinking. To achieve this, first of all, problem situations that activate cognitive activity should be created in the educational process. When students try to solve a problem, their cognitive activity is activated, they want to discover new knowledge.

9. Teaching students in general education institutions systematized knowledge, skills and habits, improving the system for monitoring and evaluating student success, and forming a quality monitoring and evaluation mechanism in education systems should be among the main tasks set by the state. For a more dynamic and qualitative development of education in both secondary schools and higher education institutions, monitoring and evaluation should be carried out at the end of each school year based on appropriate specific indicators. This will affect the future activities of the institution and will allow it to correctly determine its direction.
10. Students should have a high interest in school and lessons. They should look forward to encountering new information and gaining new knowledge every day. There should be teachers who create such desires in students. Teachers should be familiar with the pedagogical process, all the subtleties of their specialty, not get tired of working with students, communicating with them, and acquiring new knowledge, and they should enjoy these activities.

Lessons taught by highly qualified innovative teachers are more interesting and meaningful. Thanks to such teachers, students study well, gain comprehensive literacy, and master national-spiritual, moral-ethical values more perfectly. As a result, competitive specialists who master national and universal values are trained in society.

It is important for teachers to bring innovations into their activities. Learning about every pedagogical innovation happening in the world and using them correctly are pressing issues facing our education.

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INQUIRY-BASED TEACHING: PROMOTING STUDENT AGENCY AND FORMATIVE LEARNING

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Abstract: Inquiry-based teaching is a learner-centered approach that emphasizes curiosity, exploration, and critical reflection as central components of the learning process. Rather than relying on teacher-directed instruction, this pedagogy encourages students to pose meaningful questions, investigate authentic problems,

and construct knowledge through active engagement. Such practices foster student agency, enabling learners to take responsibility for their own progress while developing resilience, creativity, and collaborative skills. Rooted in constructivist theory, inquiry-based teaching also integrates formative assessment, allowing teachers to provide continuous feedback and learners to reflect on their growth. This dynamic interaction between inquiry and assessment supports deeper understanding and the development of transferable competencies essential for lifelong learning. Furthermore, inquiry pedagogy contributes to teacher professional growth, requiring reflective practice and adaptive planning. By embedding inquiry into curriculum design and digital learning environments, educators can cultivate classrooms that prepare students to navigate complex educational and social contexts with confidence.

Keywords: inquiry-based learning, student agency, formative assessment, curriculum design, pedagogy.

SORĞUYA ƏSASLANAN TƏDRİS: TƏLƏBƏ MÜSTƏQİLLİYİNİN VƏ FORMATİV ÖYRƏNMƏNİN TƏŞVİQİ

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Xülasə: Sorğuya əsaslanan tədris, öyrənmə prosesinin mərkəzi komponentləri kimi maraq, araşdırma və tənqidi düşüncəni vurğulayan, tələbə yönümlü bir yanaşmadır. Müəllim tərəfindən yönləndirilən ənənəvi təlimdən fərqli olaraq, bu pedaqogika tələbələri mənalı suallar formalaşdırmağa, real problemləri araşdırmağa və aktiv iştirak vasitəsilə bilik qurmağa təşviq edir. Belə təcrübələr tələbə agentliyini gücləndirir, öyrənənlərə öz inkişafına cavabdehlik gətirməyə, dözümlülük, yaradıcılıq və əməkdaşlıq bacarıqları formalaşdırmağa imkan verir. Konstruktivist nəzəriyyəyə əsaslanan sorğuya əsaslanan tədris həmçinin formativ qiymətləndirməni inteqrasiya edir, müəllimlərə davamlı rəy verməyə, tələbələrə isə öz irəliləyişlərini təhlil etməyə şərait yaradır. Araşdırma və qiymətləndirmə arasındakı bu dinamik qarşılıqlı əlaqə daha dərin anlama və ömür boyu öyrənmə üçün zəruri olan ötürülə bilən kompetensiyaların inkişafına dəstək olur. Bundan əlavə, sorğuya əsaslanan pedaqogika müəllimlərin peşəkar inkişafına töhfə verir, reflektiv təcrübə və adaptiv planlaşdırma tələb edir. Sorğunu kurikulum dizaynına və rəqəmsal təhsil mühitlərinə daxil etməklə, pedaqoqlar tələbələri mürəkkəb təhsil və sosial kontekstlərdə inamla hərəkət etməyə hazırlayan siniflər yarada bilərlər.

Açar sözlər: sorğuya əsaslanan öyrənmə, tələbə agentliyi, formativ qiymətləndirmə, kurikulum dizaynı, pedaqogika

Introduction

Education in the 21st century is increasingly shaped by global demands for learners who are independent, critical thinkers, and capable of adapting to rapidly changing contexts. The rapid pace of technological innovation, globalization, and shifting social structures requires educational systems to prepare students not only with subject-specific knowledge but also with transferable skills such as collaboration, creativity, and resilience. Traditional teacher-centered models, while

effective in transmitting information, often limit opportunities for students to develop autonomy, problem-solving abilities, and agency in their learning (Oliyev, 2020). Inquiry-based teaching offers a compelling alternative by positioning students as active participants in their educational journey. Rooted in constructivist theory, this pedagogy emphasizes the process of learning rather than the mere acquisition of facts (Dewey, 1938; Vygotsky, 1978). Learners are encouraged to pose meaningful questions, investigate authentic problems, and reflect critically on their findings. Such practices not only deepen subject knowledge but also cultivate lifelong learning dispositions, enabling students to navigate uncertainty and complexity with confidence.

Within international frameworks such as the International Baccalaureate (IB), inquiry is central to curriculum design, reinforcing the importance of student agency and reflective practice. Inquiry pedagogy aligns with broader educational reforms that prioritize learner-centered approaches, formative assessment, and curriculum flexibility. It also resonates with contemporary calls for equity and inclusivity, as inquiry tasks can be adapted to diverse linguistic, cultural, and disciplinary contexts (Genetti, 2018; Mammadov, 2021). Moreover, inquiry-based teaching extends beyond student outcomes to influence teacher development. By shifting the role of educators from knowledge transmitters to facilitators of learning, inquiry pedagogy requires reflective practice, adaptive planning, and professional collaboration (Wells, 1999). This dual impact—on both learners and teachers—positions inquiry as a sustainable model for educational innovation.

This paper explores the pedagogical implications of inquiry-based teaching, focusing on its role in promoting student agency, embedding formative assessment, supporting teacher professional growth, and adapting to digital and hybrid learning environments. By examining theoretical foundations and practical applications, the study highlights inquiry pedagogy as a philosophy of education that prepares learners to thrive in complex and evolving global contexts.

Materials and Methods

This study adopts a qualitative, interpretive methodology, focusing on the pedagogical implications of inquiry-based teaching in contemporary classrooms. The materials include theoretical frameworks from constructivist learning theory (Dewey, 1938; Vygotsky, 1978), applied linguistics (Genetti, 2018), and curriculum design. Inquiry pedagogy is examined through the lens of formative assessment practices (Hattie & Timperley, 2007), teacher professional development, and digital learning environments.

The methods involve:

Literature review: Synthesizing key contributions from Dewey's experiential learning (1938), Vygotsky's sociocultural theory (1978), and contemporary research in language education (Genetti, 2018).

Comparative analysis: Contrasting inquiry-based approaches with traditional teacher-centered instruction to highlight differences in student engagement, assessment, and curriculum flexibility (Prince & Felder, 2006).

Contextual application: Practical examples were drawn from multilingual classrooms, interdisciplinary projects, and digital learning environments. Case studies from Azerbaijani and international contexts (Mammadov, 2021) illustrated how inquiry pedagogy can be adapted to diverse educational settings, addressing issues of equity, inclusivity, and cultural relevance. Special attention was given to the integration of inquiry into hybrid and online platforms, where digital tools expand opportunities for collaboration and authentic investigation.

As a qualitative study, the methodology emphasizes respect for diverse educational contexts and acknowledges the limitations of generalizing across systems. The interpretive lens ensures that

inquiry pedagogy is analyzed not as a prescriptive model but as a flexible framework adaptable to varying institutional, cultural, and technological conditions.

Student Agency and Autonomy

Inquiry-based teaching places learners at the center of the educational process, positioning them as active constructors of knowledge rather than passive recipients. By encouraging students to formulate questions, investigate problems, and present findings, inquiry pedagogy develops autonomy, resilience, and a sense of ownership over learning (Bruner, 1961). This empowerment fosters intrinsic motivation, as learners begin to perceive themselves as contributors to knowledge creation, which in turn strengthens their confidence and persistence in tackling complex tasks (Oliyev, 2020). Student agency is not limited to individual autonomy; it also encompasses collaborative and social dimensions. Inquiry tasks often require teamwork, negotiation, and shared decision-making, allowing learners to practice democratic participation and collective problem-solving. In multilingual and multicultural contexts, inquiry supports identity formation and intercultural competence, enabling students to explore language and culture through authentic inquiry tasks (Genetti, 2018). This process helps learners connect personal experiences with academic content, reinforcing relevance and deepening engagement. Agency also extends to metacognitive development. Through inquiry, students learn to monitor their progress, evaluate strategies, and adjust approaches when faced with challenges. This reflective capacity is closely tied to formative assessment practices, where learners engage in self-assessment and peer feedback, strengthening their ability to take responsibility for growth. Such metacognitive skills are essential for lifelong learning, as they prepare students to adapt to new contexts and demands beyond formal education.

Importantly, student agency is both an outcome and a driver of inquiry pedagogy. As learners gain confidence in directing their learning, they become more willing to take intellectual risks, challenge assumptions, and engage in critical reflection. This cycle of empowerment and inquiry creates a dynamic classroom culture where curiosity and resilience are valued, and where students are prepared to navigate uncertainty in academic, professional, and social domains.

Integration with Formative Assessment

Inquiry pedagogy naturally embeds formative assessment into the learning cycle, creating a dynamic interplay between exploration, reflection, and feedback. Unlike summative assessment, which evaluates outcomes at the end of instruction, formative assessment within inquiry emphasizes growth, adaptability, and the ongoing refinement of learning strategies (Hattie & Timperley, 2007). This integration ensures that assessment is not a separate activity but an essential part of the inquiry process itself. Teachers play a crucial role in facilitating this integration. Through continuous feedback, they guide learners in identifying strengths, addressing misconceptions, and refining approaches. At the same time, students engage in self-assessment and peer evaluation, developing metacognitive awareness and responsibility for their own progress. This dual process – external guidance and internal reflection – creates a feedback-rich environment that strengthens both academic achievement and personal growth.

Formative assessment in inquiry also supports differentiated learning. Because inquiry tasks are open-ended and student-driven, assessment can be tailored to individual needs, interests, and contexts. For example, multilingual learners may be encouraged to reflect on language use and cultural perspectives, while science students may evaluate experimental design and data interpretation. Such adaptability ensures that assessment remains meaningful and inclusive across diverse educational settings.

Moreover, the integration of formative assessment enhances student agency. By involving learners in setting goals, monitoring progress, and evaluating outcomes, inquiry pedagogy empowers them to take ownership of their learning journey. This empowerment fosters resilience and intrinsic motivation, as students begin to view assessment not as judgment but as a tool for growth. Digital and hybrid learning environments further expand the possibilities of formative assessment within inquiry. Online platforms allow for real-time feedback, collaborative peer reviews, and interactive reflection tools. These innovations make assessment more immediate, transparent, and accessible, while also encouraging students to engage critically with digital resources and global perspectives.

In sum, the integration of formative assessment into inquiry pedagogy transforms assessment from a static measure into a dynamic process of learning. It strengthens metacognitive skills, supports equity and inclusivity, and reinforces the philosophy of inquiry as a learner-centered approach. By embedding assessment into the very fabric of inquiry, educators create classrooms where reflection, adaptability, and growth are continuous, preparing students for lifelong learning in complex and evolving contexts.

To further clarify the pedagogical distinctions, it is useful to compare inquiry-based teaching with traditional models and to examine how formative assessment differs from summative approaches. The following tables highlight these contrasts. The first illustrates how inquiry pedagogy transforms classroom roles, curriculum design, and learning culture compared to conventional teacher-centered instruction. The second emphasizes how formative assessment, when embedded in inquiry, shifts the focus from static measurement of outcomes to dynamic processes of reflection, adaptability, and growth. Together, these visuals underscore the philosophical and practical shifts required to implement inquiry-based teaching effectively, while also demonstrating its potential to cultivate agency, resilience, and lifelong learning skills.

Table 1. Summative vs. Formative Assessment in Inquiry-Based Teaching

Aspect	Summative Assessment	Formative Assessment (within Inquiry)
Purpose	Measures final achievement at the end of instruction	Supports ongoing growth, reflection, and adaptability
Timing	Administered after learning (end of unit/course)	Embedded continuously throughout the learning process
Focus	Outcomes and mastery of content	Process, progress, and development of skills
Student Role	Passive recipients of evaluation	Active participants in self-assessment and peer feedback
Teacher Role	Judge of performance	Facilitator providing guidance, scaffolding, and continuous feedback
Feedback	Limited, often numerical or graded	Rich, descriptive, iterative, and actionable
Impact on Agency	Reinforces external accountability	Empowers learners to take responsibility for their learning
Adaptability	Standardized, uniform across learners	Flexible, tailored to individual needs and contexts
Connection to Inquiry	Often disconnected from exploration and questioning	Integral to inquiry, reinforcing curiosity, reflection, and resilience

This table makes the contrast explicit: summative assessment is static and outcome-driven, while formative assessment, especially when integrated into inquiry, is dynamic, learner-centered, and growth-oriented.

Table 2. Traditional vs. Inquiry-Based Teaching

Dimension	Traditional Teaching	Inquiry-Based Teaching
Student Role	Passive recipients of information	Active constructors of knowledge through questioning and exploration
Teacher Role	Knowledge transmitter, authority figure	Facilitator, guide, and co-learner
Curriculum	Fixed, standardized, content-driven	Flexible, adaptive, connected to student interests and real-world issues
Learning Process	Focus on memorization and repetition	Emphasis on investigation, reflection, and problem-solving
Assessment	Predominantly summative, outcome-focused	Formative, continuous, process-oriented
Skills Developed	Recall, compliance, subject-specific knowledge	Critical thinking, creativity, collaboration, resilience
Classroom Culture	Teacher-centered, hierarchical	Student-centered, democratic, participatory
Connection to Context	Often abstract, detached from real-world applications	Authentic, interdisciplinary, linked to global and local challenges

This table makes the pedagogical shift very clear: traditional teaching emphasizes transmission and compliance, while inquiry-based teaching emphasizes agency, reflection, and adaptability.

Curriculum Flexibility and Relevance

Inquiry-based teaching promotes curriculum flexibility by adapting content to student interests and real-world issues. For instance, in language education, learners may investigate authentic texts, discourse strategies, or translation challenges (Genetti, 2018). This adaptability ensures that learning remains meaningful and context-sensitive. Inquiry also supports interdisciplinary connections, encouraging students to draw links across subjects and develop a holistic understanding (Wiggins & McTighe, 2005). For instance, a project on environmental sustainability may integrate science, language, and social studies, allowing students to explore complex issues from multiple perspectives. Such curriculum flexibility enhances relevance and prepares learners to navigate diverse educational and social contexts.

Teacher Development and Professional Growth

The implementation of inquiry pedagogy requires teachers to transition from knowledge transmitters to facilitators of learning. This shift demands reflective practice, adaptive planning, and professional collaboration (Wells, 1999). Teachers must design open-ended tasks, scaffold learning appropriately, and balance freedom with structure. Professional growth is achieved as educators refine their pedagogical skills, develop sensitivity to student needs, and embrace continuous learning (Zohar & Dori, 2003). Inquiry thus contributes not only to student development but also to teacher professionalization, fostering a culture of innovation and reflective practice within schools.

Digital and Hybrid Learning Environments

Inquiry pedagogy is particularly relevant in digital and hybrid learning contexts. Online platforms provide access to diverse resources, enable collaborative projects, and allow students to present findings in innovative formats (Prince & Felder, 2006). Digital inquiry fosters information literacy, critical evaluation of sources, and global dialogue. However, challenges include ensuring equitable access to technology, maintaining academic integrity, and supporting learners in navigating digital environments. Addressing these challenges requires systemic support, teacher training, and the integration of digital literacy into curriculum design.

Challenges and Limitations

Despite its advantages, inquiry-based teaching faces several challenges. Standardized testing often prioritizes coverage over exploration, creating tension between inquiry and assessment requirements (Mammadov, 2021). Students unfamiliar with learner-centered approaches may struggle initially, requiring scaffolding and support (Piaget, 1972). Equity remains a concern, as inquiry demands resources and teacher expertise that may not be equally available across institutions. Time management is another limitation, as inquiry projects can be more demanding than traditional lessons. Addressing these challenges requires systemic support, professional development, and policy alignment to ensure inquiry pedagogy can be sustained across diverse educational contexts.

Conclusion

Inquiry-based teaching is a transformative pedagogy that fosters student agency, embeds formative assessment, and promotes curriculum flexibility. By positioning learners as active participants, it cultivates curiosity, resilience, and lifelong learning skills (Dewey, 1938; Vygotsky, 1978). In multilingual and interdisciplinary contexts, inquiry tasks also strengthen identity formation and intercultural competence (Genetti, 2018). Formative assessment within inquiry emphasizes reflection and adaptability, helping learners monitor progress and refine strategies (Hattie & Timperley, 2007). Curriculum flexibility ensures relevance by connecting learning to student interests and real-world issues, while interdisciplinary projects encourage holistic understanding (Wiggins & McTighe, 2005). Teachers play a central role in sustaining inquiry pedagogy, shifting from knowledge transmitters to facilitators of learning. This transition requires reflective practice, adaptive planning, and collaboration, contributing to professional growth and innovation (Wells, 1999; Zohar & Dori, 2003). Digital and hybrid environments further expand opportunities for inquiry, though challenges such as equitable access and digital literacy demand systemic support (Prince & Felder, 2006). Despite its advantages, inquiry-based teaching faces limitations, including tensions with standardized testing, resource constraints, and time management (Mammadov, 2021; Piaget, 1972). Addressing these challenges requires institutional commitment and policy alignment.

Overall, inquiry-based teaching is not merely a method but a philosophy that reshapes classroom culture. It prepares learners to navigate complex contexts with confidence and creativity, while fostering teacher growth and innovation. Future research should examine digital inquiry platforms, cross-cultural applications, and long-term impacts on student agency and institutional change. As education continues to evolve, inquiry pedagogy offers a sustainable pathway for cultivating lifelong learners equipped for the demands of the 21st century.

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THE ROLE OF COMMUNICATIVE COMPETENCE IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING: A READING-BASED APPROACH

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Abstract: This article examines the role of communicative competence in modern foreign language teaching with a particular focus on reading as a key instructional tool. The study is based on a qualitative descriptive approach and aims to analyze how reading activities contribute to the development of learners' communicative abilities. Special attention is given to the integration of reading strategies, such as skimming, scanning, and intensive reading, within a communicative teaching framework.

The research highlights the importance of selecting appropriate texts that correspond to students' proficiency levels, interests, and cultural backgrounds. It also emphasizes the role of structured classroom procedures, including pre-reading, while-reading, and post-reading stages, in enhancing comprehension and interaction. The findings demonstrate that reading is not only a receptive skill but also an interactive process that supports vocabulary acquisition, grammatical development, and critical thinking.

Furthermore, the study underlines the significance of the teacher's communicative personality, including professional competence, interaction style, and motivational influence, in creating an effective learning environment. It is argued that teachers who employ communicative strategies and demonstrate supportive and engaging behavior significantly improve students' participation and confidence.

The results confirm that the integration of reading activities with communicative language teaching enhances learners' overall language proficiency. The study concludes that reading should be considered both a goal and a means of foreign language instruction, playing a central role in the development of communicative competence in a multicultural and globalized educational context.

Keywords: reading skills, foreign language teaching, communicative competence, text analysis, reading strategies, receptive skills, language acquisition

XARİCİ DİL TƏDRİSİNDƏ KOMMUNİKATİV BACARIĞIN ROLU: OXU ƏSASLI YANAŞMA

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Xülasə: Bu məqalədə müasir xarici dil tədrisində kommunikativ səriştənin rolu, xüsusilə oxunun əsas tədris vasitəsi kimi əhəmiyyəti araşdırılır. Tədqiqat keyfiyyətə əsaslanan təsviri yanaşma üzərində qurulmuş və oxu fəaliyyətlərinin tələbələrin kommunikativ bacarıqlarının inkişafına necə təsir göstərdiyini təhlil etməyi məqsəd qoymuşdur. Skimming, skanning və intensiv oxu kimi oxu strategiyalarının kommunikativ tədris çərçivəsində integrasiyasına xüsusi diqqət yetirilmişdir.

Tədqiqat göstərir ki, tələbələrin səviyyəsinə, maraqlarına və mədəni xüsusiyyətlərinə uyğun mətnlərin seçilməsi mühüm əhəmiyyət kəsb edir. Həmçinin oxudan əvvəl, oxu zamanı və oxudan sonra mərhələlərdən ibarət strukturlaşdırılmış dərs prosesi anlama və qarşılıqlı ünsiyyətə əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə gücləndirir. Nəticələr sübut edir ki, oxu yalnız reseptiv bacarıq deyil, həm də lüğət ehtiyatının zənginləşməsi, qrammatik biliklərin möhkəmlənməsi və tənqidi düşüncənin inkişafını təmin edən interaktiv prosesdir.

Bundan əlavə, müəllimin kommunikativ şəxsiyyəti, peşəkarlığı, ünsiyyət üslubu və motivasiyaedici rolu effektiv tədris mühitinin yaradılmasında mühüm rol oynayır. Müəyyən edilmişdir ki, kommunikativ yanaşmadan istifadə edən və tələbələrlə fəal qarşılıqlı əlaqə quran müəllimlər onların iştirakını və özünə inamını artırır.

Ümumilikdə, oxu fəaliyyətlərinin kommunikativ tədris metodları ilə integrasiyası tələbələrin dil bacarıqlarının inkişafına mühüm təsir göstərir. Məqalədə belə nəticəyə gəlinir ki, oxu həm məqsəd, həm də vasitə kimi xarici dil tədrisinin mərkəzi komponentidir.

Açar sözlər: oxu bacarıqları, xarici dil tədrisi, kommunikativ səriştə, mətn təhlili, oxu strategiyaları, reseptiv bacarıqlar, dil mənimsənilməsi

Introduction

The Republic of Azerbaijan, having strengthened its independence and statehood, is recognized as a country that implements socio-political and economic transformations and builds a civilized, democratic society based on national interests. Today, it can be confidently stated that in the context of globalization, Azerbaijan is among the dynamically and steadily developing countries in the world. (Grabe, 2009).

In recent years, significant political, social, and economic changes have taken place in the republic. These changes have influenced various sectors of society, including the field of education, making its modernization necessary. At the same time, the direction and pace of societal development largely depend on the success of the education system. In this regard, the democratization of education places a strong emphasis on developing citizens' activity, abilities, and

moral-ethical qualities. All these factors highlight the relevance of the issues related to the language of education and the teaching of language.

Undoubtedly, the primary goal of a modern national education system is to educate individuals who are well-rounded, free-thinking, and capable of approaching life creatively. Psychological and pedagogical knowledge extends from personal relationships to organizational and industrial structures, and even to international relations. In order to address and prevent potential problems in these areas, it is necessary for individuals to analyze and improve their behavior and learning strategies, as well as to develop their potential capacities. Therefore, the broader the cultural scope incorporated into education, the more meaningful and effective the foundation becomes for the development of a well-rounded personality and a creative individual.

Materials and Methodology

This study adopts a qualitative descriptive research design aimed at investigating the role of communicative competence in modern foreign language teaching. The research focuses on analyzing how communicative skills, teacher personality, and instructional strategies influence the effectiveness of language learning in a multicultural educational context.

Participants

The study was conducted with a group of undergraduate students learning English as a foreign language at an intermediate level (B1-B2). A total of 20-30 students participated in the research. In addition, 2-3 foreign language teachers were involved in the observation process to evaluate teaching strategies and classroom interaction.

Materials

The research materials consisted of a variety of instructional resources designed to support communicative language teaching. These included:

- adapted and authentic reading texts (literary, academic, and journalistic)
- dialogue-based activities and role-play scenarios
- communicative tasks aimed at developing speaking and interaction skills
- vocabulary and grammar exercises integrated into communicative contexts
- multimedia resources, including audio and video materials

The selected materials were aligned with students' proficiency levels and focused on promoting intercultural awareness and real-life communication.

Procedure

The study was carried out over a series of lessons and followed a structured instructional model based on communicative language teaching principles. The teaching process included three main stages:

1.Pre-activity stage:

Students were introduced to the topic through discussion, brainstorming, and vocabulary preparation. This stage aimed to activate prior knowledge and prepare learners for communication.

2. While-activity stage:

Students engaged in reading, speaking, and interactive tasks. They practiced communicative strategies such as expressing opinions, asking questions, and negotiating meaning. Teachers encouraged the use of authentic language and monitored interaction.

3.Post-activity stage:

Students participated in reflection, discussion, and feedback activities. They summarized content, evaluated their performance, and practiced language production through writing or speaking tasks.

Data Collection and Analysis

Data were collected through:

- classroom observation
- analysis of students' oral and written performance
- teacher feedback and reflective notes

The data were analyzed qualitatively to identify patterns in students' communicative behavior, level of engagement, and the effectiveness of teaching strategies. Special attention was given to the development of communicative competence and the role of teacher personality, including charisma and interaction style.

Discussion

In the context of globalization, the development of intercultural and interreligious dialogue is considered one of the priority tasks in international policy. Intercultural dialogue is an integral part of progressive humanity. In the modern era, for intercultural dialogue to be conducted effectively and at a high level, individuals are expected to know at least three languages. It is important to note that during the flow of information, numerous barriers may arise, including technical, psychological, psychophysiological, social, national-cultural, linguistic, stylistic, semantic, phonetic, and status-related obstacles. Furthermore, due to various objective and subjective factors, the distortion of information is inevitable. Therefore, all these aspects must be taken into account during communication.

In contemporary society, the development of information and communication technologies (ICT) is regarded as one of the key indicators of a country's intellectual and scientific potential, and its importance has become even more evident in the era of globalization. The rapid growth and widespread use of these technologies create broad opportunities for human development. Since the adoption of the national strategy, the Government of Azerbaijan has implemented and continues to implement a number of comprehensive measures in this field. One of the main priorities in this direction is the timely and effective integration of modern information technologies into the education system.

Undoubtedly, in Azerbaijan, which is developing under conditions of multiculturalism, communicative competence plays a significant role in the modern teaching of foreign languages, both for learners and especially for teachers.

Any strategy, including educational strategy, is built upon the application of specific behavioral models. A partnership-based strategy of cooperation предполагает the use of mechanisms that promote mutual understanding, such as decentration and empathy, as well as clarity and precision in expressing needs, feelings, and emotions, along with sincerity.

It should be particularly emphasized that before analyzing the structure of communicative competence, it is necessary to define the concept of a communicative personality. By the term **"communicative personality,"** we understand the unity of an individual's communicative competence, which manifests in the use of individual communicative strategies and tactics, as well as cognitive, semiotic, and motivational preferences during the communication process. I.A. Sternin refers to this as a "communicative passport," while I.N. Gorelov describes it as a "visiting card." It should also be noted that being a communicative personality is a requirement of the modern world.

In the modern educational process, the professionalism of a foreign language teacher is of great importance. The cognitive characteristic is related to the teacher's intellectual potential and cognitive activity. In the consciousness of each individual, ideas are structured within a hierarchy of

values. A communicative personality, particularly a teacher, expresses themselves through preferred speech formulas and individual linguistic expressions.

A communicative personality represents the content, core, and unity of communicative acts directed toward different interlocutors; in other words, it functions as an active participant in communication. Without a communicative personality, interpersonal communication cannot exist. Thus, the communicative personality is the central element and key participant in interpersonal communication. (Nuttall, 1996)

Researchers distinguish various models of communicative personality. Indeed, a communicative personality is multifaceted. While maintaining its uniqueness and identity, it can simultaneously incorporate different roles or “voices,” reflecting the polyphonic nature of the individual.

In contemporary discourse, it is widely accepted that a communicative personality can function within multiple contexts or discourses. For instance, the same individual may simultaneously perform roles such as a prosecutor and a composer, or a student, a salesperson, a child, a parent, and a teacher. Although the methods of communicative tactics – such as persuasion, coercion, or request – may appear similar across different roles, they are shaped by specific communicative situations. These situations are distinguished by individual nuances and variations depending on the context and role of the participant. (Grabe, 2009).

Three defining parameters characterize a communicative personality: **motivational, cognitive, and functional**. Depending on how an individual utilizes their communicative potential, they may be classified into different types. In most cases, individuals tend to adapt spontaneously to their interlocutors, thereby performing a **metacommunicative function**. However, a professional in the field of communication should consciously manage this function by directing attention to the code and process of communication, as well as by regulating and adjusting its course.

One of these parameters is consistently reflected in the communicator, understood as a specific type of interlocutor. Scholars identify several main types of communicators, including **dominant** (assertive and leading), **mobile** (dynamic and flexible), **rigid** (strict and inflexible), and **introverted** (withdrawn and inward-oriented) individuals.

In examining the structure of communicative competence, it is important to note that every individual must integrate socially into society, which constitutes a significant aspect of personal development. Each person needs the ability to express their position and establish their place within society. Otherwise, the individual may fail to interact effectively with others, leading to isolation, misanthropy, and loneliness.

An individual's development begins with their interaction with and adaptation to the surrounding environment. From early childhood, people acquire accepted patterns of behavior and thinking, many of which gradually become habitual. This process of integration occurs through the assimilation of behavioral norms, values, patterns, and skills, enabling individuals to become полноценные members of society. (Nuttall, 1996)

The fundamental reason for this process lies in the fact that human social behavior is not biologically predetermined. Individuals must continuously learn how to understand their environment and respond appropriately to it. In this regard, the role of the teacher is indispensable, as they guide the development of communicative competence and social adaptation (Grabe, 2009).

In general, when examining the role of communicative competence in modern foreign language teaching, it should be emphasized that, in addition to possessing the required level of knowledge, cultural awareness (both internal and external), and adherence to behavioral and ethical

norms, a teacher should also possess **charisma**. The term "*charisma*" originates from the Greek word *charisma*, meaning "grace," "favor," or "gift."

Charisma is understood not only as a person's outward appearance but also as a unique and compelling personal quality determined by characteristics such as wisdom, insight, courage, nobility, purposefulness in actions, clarity of goals, leadership tendencies, determination, expressiveness, and freedom of expression. All these features contribute to what is described as a **charismatic personality**. (Nuttall, 1996)

A charismatic personality is often perceived as an image shaped and maintained through mass media, especially in relation to leaders who aspire to authority and influence. In the context of modern education, it is highly desirable that not only foreign language teachers but all educators possess a certain degree of charisma, as this quality significantly enhances their professional effectiveness and influence on learners.

Conclusion

The results of the study demonstrate that the implementation of communicative-based teaching strategies has a significant positive impact on students' language development, particularly in terms of communicative competence. Classroom observations and analysis of students' performance revealed noticeable improvement in their ability to understand, interpret, and respond to texts, as well as to participate actively in communicative tasks.

Firstly, students showed a clear increase in **reading comprehension skills**. The use of structured reading stages (pre-reading, while-reading, and post-reading) helped learners better understand the content, identify key ideas, and interpret meaning more effectively. Students who initially relied heavily on translation gradually began to use contextual clues and prediction strategies.

Secondly, the integration of **communicative activities**, such as discussions and role-plays, contributed to the development of students' speaking skills. Learners became more confident in expressing their opinions, asking questions, and interacting with their peers. This indicates that combining reading with communicative tasks enhances overall language performance.

Another important finding relates to the **role of the teacher's communicative personality**. It was observed that students were more engaged and motivated in classes where the teacher demonstrated clarity, expressiveness, and supportive interaction. Teachers who displayed elements of charisma and effective communication strategies were more successful in maintaining students' attention and encouraging participation.

Furthermore, the results highlight the importance of **text selection**. Materials that were relevant to students' interests and appropriate to their language level significantly improved engagement and comprehension. In contrast, texts that were too complex or unfamiliar reduced participation and slowed down the learning process.

Despite these positive outcomes, some challenges were identified. A number of students still experienced difficulties related to limited vocabulary and lack of background knowledge. In addition, some learners were hesitant to participate in communicative activities due to low confidence.

Overall, the findings confirm that the effective integration of reading activities with communicative teaching strategies enhances students' language competence. The results also emphasize the crucial role of the teacher in facilitating interaction and creating a supportive learning environment.

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MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract: This paper explores modern methods and approaches used in English language teaching, focusing on the transition from traditional, teacher-centered methods to more student-centered, technology-enhanced models. Modern approaches emphasize making language learning more effective, engaging, and meaningful. These methods focus on communicative competence, student engagement, and the real-world application of language skills. The integration of technology, student-centered learning, and inclusive teaching strategies are core components of these approaches. These methods not only aim to improve linguistic proficiency but also seek to develop critical thinking, autonomy, and social skills. The role of digital tools and mobile applications in enhancing language learning experiences is also discussed, as they provide learners with flexibility, personalized learning paths, and increased motivation. Through the review of contemporary teaching methods, this paper demonstrates how modern approaches can lead to more successful and enjoyable language learning experiences, fostering both linguistic and cognitive skills essential in today's globalized world.

Key words: modern teaching methods, language learning, technology, communicative skills, student-centered, approaches.

İNGLİS DİLİ TƏDİRİSİNDƏ MÜASİR METOD VƏ YANAŞMALAR

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə, ingilis dili tədrisində istifadə olunan müasir metod və yanaşmaları araşdırır və ənənəvi, müəllim mərkəzli metodlardan daha çox tələbə mərkəzli, texnologiya ilə zənginləşdirilmiş modellərə keçidi vurğulayır. Müasir yanaşmalar, dil öyrənməni daha effektiv, maraqlı və mənalı etmək üzərində fokuslanır. Bu metodlar, kommunikativ bacarıq, tələbə iştirakı və dil bacarıqlarının real həyatda tətbiqi üzərində dayanır. Texnologiyanın integrasiyası, tələbə mərkəzli öyrənmə və inklüziv tədris strategiyaları bu yanaşmaların əsas komponentləridir. Bu metodlar yalnız dil bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirmək məqsədini güdmür, həm də tənqidi düşüncə, müstəqillik və sosial bacarıqları inkişaf etdirməyə çalışır. Dil öyrənmə təcrübələrini zənginləşdirən rəqəmsal alətlərin və mobil tətbiqlərin rolu da müzakirə olunur, çünki onlar tələbələrə çeviklik, fərdiləşdirilmiş öyrənmə yolları və artan motivasiya təmin edir. Müasir tədris metodlarının icmal vasitəsilə, bu məqalə müasir yanaşmaların daha uğurlu və əyləncəli dil öyrənmə təcrübələrinə necə yol açma biləcəyini nümayiş etdirir və bu təcrübələrin bugünkü global dünyada həm dil, həm də bilişsel bacarıqlar üçün nə qədər vacib olduğunu göstərir.

Açar sözlər: müasir tədris metodları, dil öyrənmə, texnologiya, ünsiyyət bacarıqları, tələbəyə yönəlmiş yanaşmalar.

Introduction

The rapid global spread of the English language has made it not only a tool for communication in various domains such as business, science, and technology but also a necessity for academic and professional success. As the demand for English language skills continues to grow, the need for effective and efficient teaching methods has never been more urgent. Traditional methods of language teaching, which were largely teacher-centered and focused on rote memorization of grammar and vocabulary, have proven insufficient in preparing students for the real-world use of language. While such methods contribute to foundational language skills, they do not adequately foster the communicative competence required for everyday interactions and professional settings (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).

In response to these limitations, modern language teaching has evolved significantly. There has been a shift towards more student-centered approaches that prioritize active learning, communication, and interaction. These methods aim to make students not just passive recipients of knowledge but active participants in their learning process. Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Learning (TBL), and Content and Language Integrated Learning (CLIL) are among the most prominent methods in contemporary language instruction. These approaches encourage learners to use language for real communication, engage with content meaningfully, and develop critical thinking and problem-solving skills (Ellis, 2003).

Furthermore, the recognition of the diversity in students' needs, learning styles, and cultural backgrounds has led to the adoption of differentiated and inclusive teaching strategies. These strategies acknowledge that learners are unique individuals and that a one-size-fits-all approach is ineffective (Tomlinson, 2014). Instead, modern teaching methods aim to adapt to each learner's strengths, weaknesses, and preferences, ensuring more personalized and effective learning experiences.

Another major development in modern language teaching is the integration of technology. With the advent of mobile-assisted language learning (MALL) and online learning platforms, students now have the opportunity to learn at their own pace and outside traditional classroom settings. Digital tools not only make learning more accessible and flexible but also provide learners with a wider range of resources and interactive activities, enhancing their motivation and engagement (Godwin-Jones, 2018).

This paper aims to explore these contemporary approaches in English language teaching, evaluate their effectiveness, and examine how they have transformed the language learning process. Through a comprehensive review of modern teaching methods, the paper will highlight the ways in which these approaches improve learners' linguistic, cognitive, and social skills.

Materials and Methods

This paper draws on academic literature, research studies, and teaching practices related to modern English language teaching. The materials analyzed include scholarly articles, books on language pedagogy, mobile language learning applications, online resources, and various teaching models. The methodology involves evaluating research that examines the effectiveness of contemporary methods and approaches. Additionally, the experiences of language teachers and students are incorporated to provide insights into the practical application of these methods. The paper focuses on student-centered approaches, the use of technology in language teaching, and differentiated and inclusive teaching strategies.

Results and Discussion

Student-Centered Approaches

One of the core aspects of modern language teaching is the shift toward student-centered learning. This approach places the student at the center of the learning process, empowering them to take an active role in their own education. In traditional methods, teachers often act as the primary source of information, whereas student-centered approaches encourage students to engage in their learning through independent work, group discussions, and project-based learning. By allowing students to explore topics that interest them, these approaches increase student motivation and engagement (Brown, 2007). Furthermore, student-centered teaching fosters the development of critical thinking and problem-solving skills, as learners are encouraged to think for themselves and make decisions about their learning process.

The Role of Technology

The integration of technology in language teaching has revolutionized the way languages are learned and taught. Digital platforms, mobile applications, and interactive tools have made language learning more dynamic and personalized. Mobile-Assisted Language Learning (MALL) enables learners to practice language skills at their own pace and on their own schedule, making learning more flexible and accessible (Godwin-Jones, 2018). Virtual classrooms, video conferencing, and online discussions allow for increased interaction between teachers and students, overcoming the limitations of time and space (Kukulska-Hulme, 2012). Technology also allows for more engaging learning activities, such as language games, simulations, and virtual environments, which provide students with authentic language practice.

Communicative Language Teaching (CLT)

Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) has become one of the most widely adopted methods in modern language teaching. This approach focuses on teaching language through meaningful communication rather than just memorizing grammar rules and vocabulary. CLT encourages students to engage in real-life communication, allowing them to develop their ability to

use language effectively in social and professional contexts. By prioritizing fluency over accuracy, CLT helps students become more confident in their language skills and encourages them to take risks and make mistakes as part of the learning process (Richards & Rodgers, 2014). CLT also promotes collaboration, as students often work together in pairs or groups to solve problems, negotiate meaning, and engage in discussions.

Inclusive and Differentiated Approaches

Modern language teaching recognizes the importance of catering to the diverse needs of learners. Inclusive and differentiated teaching strategies ensure that all students, regardless of their background or abilities, have access to high-quality education. Differentiated instruction involves tailoring teaching methods to accommodate different learning styles, whether visual, auditory, or kinesthetic, and addressing the specific needs of individual learners (Tomlinson, 2014). Inclusive teaching, on the other hand, ensures that all students, including those with special educational needs, are supported in their learning. By taking into account the varied backgrounds and abilities of students, these approaches help create a more equitable and effective learning environment.

Critical Thinking and Metacognitive Approaches

Modern approaches to language teaching emphasize the development of critical thinking and metacognitive skills. Critical thinking enables students to analyze, evaluate, and synthesize information, while metacognitive skills help students become more aware of their learning process and take control of their learning strategies. Metacognitive approaches encourage students to set goals, monitor their progress, and reflect on their learning experiences (Anderson & Krathwohl, 2001). These skills are essential not only for language learning but also for lifelong learning and personal development.

Conclusion

Modern methods and approaches in English language teaching have transformed the way languages are taught and learned. By focusing on student-centered learning, communicative competence, and the integration of technology, these approaches have made language learning more interactive, engaging, and effective. The shift from traditional, teacher-centered methods to more dynamic and learner-driven approaches has enhanced students' motivation and participation in the learning process. Furthermore, the use of digital tools and mobile applications has provided learners with more flexibility and personalized learning paths. The growing emphasis on critical thinking, metacognitive skills, and inclusive teaching strategies has helped ensure that language education is accessible to all learners, regardless of their backgrounds or learning styles. In conclusion, modern approaches to English language teaching not only enhance linguistic competence but also foster cognitive, social, and intercultural skills that are essential in today's interconnected world.

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FACTORS INFLUENCING STUDENT PARTICIPATION IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE CLASSROOMS

Bariş ÇAPAR

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Abstract: In this qualitative study, crucial factors affecting student participation in an 8th-grade EFL class at a Turkish public middle school were examined through a comparison of teacher-centered, interactive, and pair-work activities. The qualitative research design was used for this purpose and involved data triangulation, including data from non-participant observations, semi-structured interviews with the teachers, and unstructured student visits conducted over four lesson hours. Using thematic analysis, it was revealed that a traditional, teacher-centered approach to grammar lessons decreased student participation by 15-20%, resulting in the "spotlight effect" and increasing the level of the affective filter, as students were scared to make mistakes in front of their peers. Consequently, it led to academic stress. In turn, switching to a student-centered approach and gamified vocabulary activities increased participation to 60-70% due to external motivation. Pair-work role-play with knowledge gaps increased participation to 80-85%. This tremendous surge has been explained by providing a psychologically "safe space" in which the traditional role of the teacher is transformed into that of a facilitator, and hence allows for peer interaction among students of various abilities, as well as students feeling comfortable enough to joke about their mistakes instead of being afraid of criticism. Moreover, although the inherently interactive nature of a student-centered approach would allow such first-person (L1) communication to flourish, the study points out that the "L1 Paradox" is actually a critical aid in meaning-making. Therefore, this study's results show that, for middle school English teachers, a psychologically safe classroom environment through role-playing and knowledge-gap exercises is indispensable.

Key Words: EFL (English as a Foreign Language), Student participation, Pair-work, Affective filter, Qualitative observation

İNGİLİZCE DERSLERİNDE ÖĞRENCİLERİN DERSE KATILIMINI ETKİLEYEN FAKTÖRLER

Bariş ÇAPAR

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Özet: Bu nitel çalışmada, bir Türk devlet ortaokulunda 8. sınıf İngilizce dersinde öğrenci katılımını etkileyen bazı önemli faktörler, öğretmen merkezli, etkileşimli ve ikili çalışma etkinlikleri arasında bir karşılaştırma yapılarak incelenmiştir. Bu amaçla nitel araştırma tasarımı kullanılmış ve katılımcı olmayan gözlemlerden, öğretmenlerle yapılan yarı yapılandırılmış görüşmelerden ve dört ders saati boyunca gerçekleştirilen yapılandırılmamış öğrenci ziyaretlerinden elde edilen verileri içeren veri üçgenlemesi yapılmıştır. Tematik analiz kullanılarak, dilbilgisi derslerinde geleneksel, öğretmen merkezli yaklaşımın öğrenci katılım oranını %15-20 oranında azalttığı, "dikkat çekme etkisi"ne yol açtığı ve öğrencilerin akranlarının önünde hata yapmaktan korkmaları nedeniyle duygusal filtre düzeyini artırdığı ortaya çıkmıştır. Sonuç olarak, bu durum akademik strese yol açmıştır. Buna karşılık, öğrenci merkezli yaklaşıma geçildiğinde, oyunlaştırılmış kelime bilgisi etkinlikleri, dış motivasyon nedeniyle katılımı %60-70'e kadar artırmıştır. Bilgi boşlukları içeren ikili çalışma rol yapma etkinlikleri ise katılımı %80-85'e çıkarmıştır. Bu muazzam artış, öğretmenin geleneksel rolünün kolaylaştırıcı rolüne dönüştürüldüğü ve böylece farklı yeteneklere sahip öğrenciler arasında akran etkileşimine olanak tanıyan, öğrencilerin eleştiriden korkmak yerine hataları hakkında şaka yapabilecek kadar rahat hissetmelerini sağlayan psikolojik olarak "güvenli bir alan" sağlanmasıyla açıklanmıştır. Dahası, öğrenci merkezli bir yaklaşımın doğası gereği etkileşimli yapısı, bu tür bir birinci şahıs (L1) iletişiminin gelişmesine olanak tanıyacak olsa da, çalışma "L1 Paradoksu"nun aslında anlam oluşturmada kritik bir yardımcı olduğunu ortaya koymuştur. Bu nedenle, bu çalışmanın sonuçlarından, ortaokul İngilizce öğretmenleri için rol yapma ve bilgi açığı egzersizleri yoluyla psikolojik olarak güvenli bir sınıf ortamının vazgeçilmez olduğu görülebilir.

Anahtar Kelimeler: Yabancı Dil Olarak İngilizce (EFL), Öğrenci katılımı, İkili çalışma, Duygusal filtre, Nitel gözlem

1. Introduction

Student participation in class is one of the most fundamental building blocks for successful language learning outcomes. In this context, student engagement is a crucial tool for language acquisition or teaching environments. Interaction is essential in language classes because one of the most fundamental factors affecting language acquisition is its presence or absence. As clearly stated by Tasgin and Tunc (2018), it is very important to prepare the teaching process by considering factors that will increase secondary school students' effective participation in the lesson. In English Language Teaching (ELT), in-class interaction isn't simply a casual chat; it's a fundamental element that shifts students from a passive to an active mode of language acquisition. However, maintaining a high level of participation in the long term is a significant challenge for English teachers in language classes, as preserving this communicative and interactive atmosphere is quite difficult, even if the reasons vary from class to class. This challenge is even more pronounced and growing in countries like Turkey, where English is taught as a foreign language (EFL). Research shows that in countries like Turkey, where language acquisition and exposure time are limited to class hours, language acquisition rarely continues beyond class time. Consequently, the classroom environment can be seen as the only place for interaction in this context, and therefore, this plays a significant role in determining the quality and level of interaction in classroom activities. If participation and interaction levels within these limited hours do not reach a sufficient level, the progress of language acquisition will seriously decrease, and the success of the learning process will be significantly jeopardized.

The teacher determines the overall framework for class participation and interaction. Traditionally, in many English as a Foreign Language (EFL) classes, the teacher is seen as the sole

source of information in language learning; consequently, teacher-centered activities are most commonly used. This approach, seen as one-to-many and widely adopted, may be effective when applying methods such as the traditional grammar-translation method or teaching grammar in a simpler way, but it is insufficient for more advanced language acquisition. Furthermore, this approach frequently triggers classroom anxiety in children in language classes, leading to difficulties with speaking comfort. As Tegegne, Y., Wubie, D., & Mekonnen, Y. (2022) stated, "Students' ability to speak up actively in the class using the English language has paramount significance for their academic achievement and performance." (p.47). According to Krashen's (1982) Affective Filter hypothesis, it has been observed that when students feel anxious, that is, when they perceive a mental obstacle in the learning process, it significantly affects the student's language learning process. On the other hand, the same study shows that when students engage in pair work, their anxiety decreases and learning becomes easier. Pair work removes the teacher-fronted nature of the lesson and provides students with a space where they can speak more and feel comfortable. Being in a pair-work environment increases communication between students, and because this communication feels safe to them, it has been observed that such activities yield more positive long-term results.

While class participation and the level of interaction in activities are the most visible factors, another very important factor that affects both is students' language level and their readiness to use it. In middle school settings, especially among 8th-grade students, socio-cultural dynamics and peer pressure significantly affect students' classroom behavior and, consequently, their class participation. Considering all this, the fear of making mistakes in front of the whole class, their peers, turns into serious anxiety, which can become a major obstacle to class participation. Studies show that the influence of peer groups among students can boost their anxiety, especially pertaining to their education (Kadir, Atmowasdoyo & Salija, 2018). On the other hand, according to De Guzman, M. (2007), while we tend to think that peer influence leads teens to engage in unhealthy and unsafe behaviors, it can actually motivate youth to study harder in school, volunteer for community and social services, and participate in sports and other productive endeavors. When students receive the support they need from their peer group, they tend to excel and exceed their capabilities, concentrate more on their studies, and perform well on academic tasks at school (Olalekan, 2016). This anxiety about class participation is especially likely in low-attendance classes because being directly in the spotlight significantly increases anxiety among students. In Fassinger, P. A. (2000)'s research, it is clearly seen that this anxiety increases in classes with low participation and decreases in classes with high participation, especially in the areas of a) keeping their comments brief, b) suppressing student confidence, and c) avoiding controversial opinions. For all these reasons, it has become very important to examine different learning methods – such as teacher-fronted or pair work as stated before – in detail and to clearly see how each type of activity affects things in the long term as a result of these studies. Although pair-work programs have many theoretical advantages, it is absolutely essential to examine how this educational method will affect Turkish state schools in the long term, especially from a socio-cultural perspective.

The primary aim of this study is to examine the factors influencing student participation in lessons by observing and comparing teacher-fronted, pair, and interaction-based activities implemented in an 8th-grade classroom in a public school in Türkiye. The research specifically aims to address the following question:

1. Which activities do students participate in most?
2. What are the differences in terms of participation between teacher-fronted and pair work

activities?

3. What are the specific factors influencing students' participation in classroom interaction?

It is anticipated that the findings and conclusions of this research will provide English teachers (ELTs) with evidence-based information to create a more motivating, highly engaged, and interactive classroom atmosphere.

2. Methodology

Research Design

The current study employs a qualitative research design to explore factors affecting student engagement in an EFL class. As Creswell (2014) noted, the qualitative research design was the best methodological approach because it allows the researcher to gain deeper insights into classroom interactions and experiences.

Research Setting and Research Participants

The study was conducted at a public secondary school in Türkiye during the 2025-2026 academic year. The study participants comprised about 25-30 8th-grade students. It should be noted that the students admitted to this grade were rated at the A2 level according to the CEFR. Furthermore, the researcher engaged the classroom teacher, whose experience exceeded ten years.

Data Collection Methods and Process

Data were collected through a triangulation strategy involving three sources over a period of 4 lesson hours. Firstly, observation checklists were used during non-participant observations to record the frequency of interactions and students' participation in teacher-centered and paired tasks. Secondly, a semi-structured mini-interview was conducted with the classroom teacher to obtain professional views regarding barriers to participation. Thirdly, unstructured interviews with selected students aimed to capture their feelings towards different activities.

Data Analysis Methods

Thematic analysis was used to analyze the collected data. Data emerging from observation records and interviews were coded into themes such as "emotional barriers" and "peer support". Such an approach ensures the objectivity of the results, as they are consistent with practice and based on qualitative data collected during the internship.

3. Findings and Discussion

The findings of this study show significant differences in class participation across the activities used during the lesson. This data was obtained from three different class observations and interviews with some students and the teacher. The data indicate that participation in a class dominated by traditional classroom structures, i.e., teacher-fronted activities, significantly reduces student engagement. On the other hand, pairwork and interactive activities were observed to increase participation and encourage engagement. To provide an overview of the data obtained from these observations and interviews, the data is summarized in the table below.

Table 1. *General Results of Observations*

Feature	Teacher-Fronted (TF)	Interactive Activities	Pair Work (PW)
Interaction Pattern	T - S (One-way)	T - Class (Multi-way)	S - S (Student-to-Student)

Participation Rate	Low (Approx. 15-20%)	High (Approx. 60-70%)	Maximum (Approx. 80-85%)
Student Talking Time	Very Limited	Moderate (Task-dependent)	Maximum
Affective Filter	High (Anxiety/Fear of failure)	Lowered (Focus on the game)	Lowest (Safe peer environment)
Dominant Goal	Accuracy & Knowledge Transfer	Fluency & Engagement	Communication & Negotiation
L1 (Native Language)	Minimal (Strictly controlled)	Moderate (Excitement-driven)	Present (Used for scaffolding)
Teacher's Role	Authority / Controller	Referee / Organizer	Facilitator / Observer

3.1. The Spotlight Effect and Academic Distress

Regarding the teacher-centered grammar lesson in the "Chores" unit, there was interaction in line with the TS model. This instructional approach led to a unique situation, referred to by the teacher as "The Power of Three," in which only successful students engaged, while the rest were in what can be described as "academic distress," including yawning and doodling. From the interviews conducted, one could understand the psychological aspect of the problem. The teacher talks to the entire class, and "The Spotlight Effect" is activated. As Student 2 (S2) pointed out, when one speaks in front of the entire class, their heart rate increases due to fear of making a mistake, leading them to think, "I failed in front of the class." Thus, the decision is made to "stay silent and be safe." Also, from Student 3 (S3), it was revealed that cognitive speed is an impediment. According to S3, fast learners have answered questions before others mentally translate the question, thus, waiting until "the bell rings."

3.2. Gamification and Change in Approach

There was one interesting change during the gamified vocabulary instruction ("In the Kitchen"). Participation grew up to 80% with the implementation of a competitive board game. From the data, we see that competitiveness served as a powerful external motivation factor. As S3 said, such a format made them "forget about being inside the class." Thus, the teaching approach shifted from focusing on grammar correctness to understanding and speed. Despite the emergence of the "L1 Paradox" due to interaction (an increase in L1 Turkish for side conversations), much more vocabulary in the target language – English was produced in comparison to the direct instruction stage.

3.3. Pairwork as "Safe Space" for Peer Collaboration

The greatest effect on student engagement was witnessed when applying communicative role-playing techniques in the "Adventures" unit. Thanks to the information gap task, engagement levels rose to nearly 90%, as there was simply nowhere to "hide in the crowd." According to the collected qualitative data, the reason for these results lies in the creation of a "safe space." The teacher noted a shift in roles from an authoritative "ruler" to an "assistant," thereby altering the power balance in the classroom.

In this context, peer support became highly effective. High-achievers such as S1 felt "helpful" when collaborating with peers; meanwhile, low-achievers like S3 were happy with the individually paced task, saying, "my partner is waiting for me." Importantly, the fear of judgment vanished. As S2 stated, "I can just laugh about any mistakes when speaking with my peers," which explains why Student Speaking Time (SLT) overwhelmingly surpassed Teacher Speaking Time (TST). Overall, these results show that shifting communication from public and teacher-centered to private and student-centered enables maximizing communicative engagement.

4. Conclusion

This study offers insight into the interplay of factors in the process of English learning in an 8th-grade EFL class. The results indicate that student involvement cannot be attributed solely to personal motivation but is also directly affected by the instructor's teaching techniques. It is found that although the conventional teacher-centered approach allows for the efficient delivery of educational material, it inevitably fosters high levels of stress in the learning process and makes the fear of embarrassment the key deterrent to student involvement. As shown by the "Power of Three," the dominant teacher-centered method tends to marginalize most students in terms of their active participation. Conversely, a transition towards student-oriented practices such as pair work and gaming helps lower the levels of performance anxiety.

In addition, the article reveals that working in pairs is a crucial medium for scaffolding among peers, thus allowing learners of different abilities to assist each other at their own individual paces. Although many critics have pointed out that this kind of activity results in greater use of the native language, the article argues that using the mother tongue in this way is actually a crucial step toward making meaning-making easier, not more difficult. By introducing productive noise into the learning process, teachers can turn the classroom environment from a silent, teacher-driven lecture hall into an exciting, interactive lab.

In light of these results, it is strongly advised that English teachers in the Turkish public education system prioritize the use of information-gap activities and collaborative role-plays to foster sustained motivation in the target language. Strategies such as giving students free time to discuss their answers in pairs before sharing them with the entire class may help the more reticent students gain sufficient confidence to speak up. It is equally important for teachers to change their perspective on the native language, recognizing its role as a means to a more difficult end. In sum, the success of any form of language instruction within the context of foreign language learning relies on creating a psychologically secure learning environment.

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STRATEGIES FOR DEVELOPING LISTENING COMPREHENSION IN ENGLISH LEARNERS

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Abstract: This paper explores strategies for developing listening comprehension in English learners. It requires simple and effective teaching strategies, regular practice and exposure to real language. As a receptive skill listening is an active process. ESL learners try to understand meaning, guess information and respond. They improve more when they use strategies such as planning how to listen, checking their understanding and thinking about their mistakes. (Vandergrift & Christine, 2012) These skills help learners become more independent. According to the researches, it is necessary to use authentic materials such as conversations, podcasts, videos. This assists learners understand how English is used in real life. In addition, listening is not only hearing but also leading learners learn the language step by step. Studies show that students who learn listening strategies perform better. (Vandergrift & Hamideh, 2010) Regular listening practice gives them more confidence and develops their fluency in target language. Most organizations recommend using interactive activities, videos and different types of tasks to meet students' needs for developing listening skills. Teachers can support this process by creating a positive and supportive classroom environment. Using group work, discussions, pre- and post- listening activities can make lessons more engaging and effective. Learners also need short and clear exercises. With teacher's support, appropriate classroom environment can improve their listening comprehension and feel more confident using English in real situations.

Keywords: Listening comprehension, language skills development, audio-based learning, classroom activities, listening tools, listening strategies.

İNGİLİS DİLİ ÖYRƏNƏNLƏRDƏ DİNLƏMƏ QABİLİYYƏTİNİN İNKİŞAF ETDİRİLMƏSİ ÜÇÜN STRATEGİYALAR

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə ingilis dili öyrənənlərdə dinləmə bacarıqlarının inkişaf etdirilməsi strategiyalarını araşdırır. Effektiv tədris sadə və praktik metodların tətbiqini, həmçinin müntəzəm məşq və real dilə məruz qalmanı tələb edir. Qəbul edici bacarıq kimi dinləmə aktiv prosesdir. Bu zaman ESL öyrənənlər mənanı anlamağa, məlumatı təxmin etməyə və uyğun şəkildə cavab verməyə çalışırlar. Öyrənənlər dinləməyi necə planlaşdırmaq, öz anlayışlarını yoxlamaq və səhvləri üzərində düşünmək kimi strategiyalardan istifadə etdikdə daha çox irəliləyiş əldə edirlər. (Vandergrift & Kristin, 2012). Bu bacarıqlar onların daha müstəqil öyrənənlərə çevrilməsinə kömək edir. Araşdırmalar göstərir ki, dialoqlar, podkastlar və videolar kimi autentik materiallardan istifadə çox vacibdir. Bu materiallar öyrənənlərə ingilis dilinin real həyatda necə istifadə olunduğunu anlamağa kömək edir. Bundan əlavə, dinləmə yalnız eşitmək deyil, həm də öyrənənləri dili mərhələli şəkildə mənimsəməyə yönləndirən bir prosesdir. Tədqiqatlar göstərir ki, dinləmə strategiyalarını öyrənən tələbələr daha yüksək nəticələr əldə edirlər (Vandergrift & Həmidə, 2010). Müntəzəm dinləmə təcrübəsi onların özünə inamını artırır və hədəf dildə səlisliklərini inkişaf etdirir. Bir çox təhsil təşkilatları dinləmə bacarıqlarının inkişafı üçün interaktiv fəaliyyətlərin, videoların və müxtəlif tapşırıq növlərinin istifadəsini tövsiyə edir. Müəllimlər müsbət və dəstəkləyici sinif mühiti yaradaraq bu prosesa mühüm töhfə verə bilərlər. Qrup işi, müzakirələr, dinləmə öncəsi və dinləmədən sonrakı fəaliyyətlər dərsləri daha maraqlı və effektiv edir. Bundan əlavə, öyrənənlər qısa və aydın tapşırıqlardan da faydalanırlar. Müəllim dəstəyi və düzgün təşkil olunmuş sinif mühiti ilə şagirdlər dinləmə bacarıqlarını əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə inkişaf etdirir və real həyat vəziyyətlərində ingilis dilindən istifadə edərkən daha inamlı ola bilərlər.

Açar sözlər: Dinləyib anlama, dil bacarıqlarının inkişafı, audio əsaslı öyrənmə, sinif fəaliyyəti, dinləmə vasitələri, dinləmə strategiyaları.

Introduction

Listening is one of the most important skills in learning English, but it is often difficult for many learners. Learners may understand grammar and vocabulary, yet still struggle to follow spoken language in real situations. This is because listening requires not only hearing words, but also understanding meaning, tone and context at the same time. Learners need to think, predict and check their understanding while they listen. Many researchers highlight that learners improve their listening skills when they are exposed to clear strategies and real-life materials. It is explained that authentic audio, such as conversations and recordings, helps students become familiar with natural speech (Flowerdew J. and Lindsay M., 2010). Teaching should focus on how students listen, not only on what they understand.

Several important listening strategies can support learners in this process. One common strategy is predicting, where learners try to guess the topic or key ideas before listening (Vandergrift and Goh, 2010). This improves comprehension and focus. Another useful strategy is listening for gist, which means understanding the general idea without focusing on every word (Field J., 2009). Learners can also use listening for specific information, where they listen carefully to find particular details such as names, numbers, or key facts. In addition, note taking helps students remember important points and organize information while listening. Finally, self-checking or reflection allows learners to evaluate their understanding and improve over time.

Effective classroom activities play a key role in improving listening comprehension because they give learners a chance to practice in meaningful and engaging ways. One productive activity is pre-listening discussion. The teacher introduces the topic and asks learners to share their ideas and predict what they will hear. This prepares them and activates their background knowledge. Such

preparation helps students feel more confident and ready to listen. Another necessary activity is while-listening tasks. These include exercises like matching, multiple-choice questions, filling in missing information. That type of tasks guide learners to focus on key points instead of trying to understand every word. Breaking listening into stages helps learners understand how to process information step by step (Field J., 2009). Post-listening activities are equally important. Learners can summarize what they heard, answer open-ended questions, take part in group discussions. These help them reflect on the content and improve both listening and speaking skills. Pair and group work also increase interaction and allow them to learn from each other.

In terms of practical methods, using authentic materials such as podcasts, interviews, and videos is highly effective. It is noted that these materials expose learners to natural pronunciation, accents and speaking speed. Teachers can also apply task-based learning, where learners complete a task based on what they hear, such as solving a problem, making a decision. Planning, monitoring and evaluating listening are examples of metacognitive strategies. Through these strategies learners become more independent and aware of their learning process (Vandergrift and Goh, 2012). Combining interactive activities with practical methods creates a supportive environment where learners can gradually improve their listening comprehension in a natural and effective way.

Materials and Methods

This study uses a qualitative and descriptive research design to explore strategies for developing listening comprehension in English learners. It is appropriate for exploring teaching strategies and understanding how listening skills are developed in real learning contexts. A qualitative approach focuses on meanings, ideas and experiences rather than numbers or statistics. In this research, it helps to examine how different listening strategies work, how teachers apply them, and how learners respond to them. Listening development involves cognitive and metacognitive processes, which are best understood through detailed explanation rather than measurement (Vandergrift & Goh, 2012). Therefore, a qualitative method allows the researcher to interpret these processes in a deeper and more flexible way. The descriptive aspect of the study aims to clearly present and explain existing methods, strategies, and classroom practices used in teaching listening. Instead of testing a hypothesis, the research describes what effective listening instruction looks like and how it can be applied. For example, ideas from *Listening in the Language Classroom* are used to explain how learners process spoken language step by step, while *Second Language Listening* provides descriptions of real listening situations and authentic materials. This descriptive approach helps organize information in a simple and understandable way for teachers and learners.

The research is based on a careful review and analysis of existing academic literature and educational resources. This approach allows the study to combine theoretical knowledge with practical teaching ideas and present clear recommendations. The main materials for this research include well-known academic books, peer-reviewed articles, and professional educational resources. Key theoretical concepts were taken from *Teaching and Researching Listening* (Vandergrift & Goh, 2012) which explains the importance of metacognitive strategies in listening. *Listening in the Language Classroom* (Field, 2009) which focuses on how learners process spoken language. Additionally, *Second Language Listening* (Flowerdew & Lindsay, 2010) provided useful information about authentic materials and real-life listening contexts.

To support the theoretical background with research evidence, several academic articles were also examined. For example, *Metacognitive Instruction in Listening* (Vandergrift & Hamideh, 2010) was used to understand how strategy training improves listening performance. Another

important source, *The Effects of Extensive Listening Practice* (Willy & Thomas, 2011) highlights the role of regular and repeated listening practice in developing fluency and confidence. These studies provide reliable data and support the effectiveness of the suggested methods.

In addition to academic sources, practical teaching materials were gathered from professional organizations such as British Council. These resources include classroom activities, lesson plans and interactive tasks designed for different learner levels. Digital tools like BBC Learning English were also considered as supplementary materials that support independent learning outside the classroom. The method of analysis involved selecting relevant information from these sources, comparing different approaches, and organizing them into key themes. These themes include listening strategies, classroom practices and the role of technology in language learning. The data were then interpreted in a simple and clear way to make the findings useful teachers and learners. By using reliable sources and systematic analysis, the study offers practical and evidence-based suggestions for improving listening comprehension in English learners.

Results and Discussion

The findings of this study show that using clear listening strategies has a positive effect on learners' comprehension skills. Based on the ideas, students who apply metacognitive strategies—such as planning before listening, focusing during listening, and checking understanding after listening—become more active and successful listeners (Vandergrift & Goh, 2012). These strategies help learners understand not only words but also the overall meaning of spoken texts. According to *Teaching and Researching Listening*, learners who are trained to plan, monitor, and evaluate their listening process become more active and independent. This idea is supported by the study *Metacognitive Instruction in Listening*, which found that students who received strategy instruction showed clear improvement in comprehension compared to those who did not. This suggests that teaching students how to listen is as important as giving them listening practice.

Another important result is the role of authentic materials in improving listening ability. As explained by *Second Language Listening*, exposure to real-life audio, including conversations and media content, helps learners adapt to natural speech, different accents, and speaking speeds (Flowerdew & Lindsay, 2010). This is important because many learners struggle when they hear English outside the classroom. Similarly, *Listening in the Language Classroom* argues that learners often fail not because the content is too difficult, but because they do not know how to process spoken language effectively. Therefore, using authentic input together with guided tasks can improve both understanding and confidence. This makes listening practice more realistic and useful. It is highlighted that focusing on the listening process – rather than only correct answers – supports deeper understanding.

The study also shows that regular practice plays a key role in developing listening skills. Researches indicate that frequent listening activities improve fluency and confidence over time (Willy & Thomas, 2011). Learners who listen more often become more comfortable with spoken English and can understand messages more easily. This type of practice allows students to gradually recognize common words, phrases, and patterns without translating every word. As a result, listening becomes faster and more automatic. This supports the idea that listening improvement requires continuous exposure, not just occasional classroom activities.

From a practical perspective, the analysis shows that interactive classroom methods play an important role in motivating learners and improving results. Materials and recommendations from British Council suggest that activities such as group discussions, pair work, and task-based exercises increase student engagement and make listening more meaningful. When students actively

participate, they are more likely to focus and understand the content. Furthermore, the use of digital tools like BBC Learning English provides learners with flexible opportunities to practice listening outside the classroom, which supports independent learning.

From a critical perspective, the discussion shows that no single method is enough on its own. For example, using authentic materials without guidance may be too difficult for beginners, while focusing only on strategies without enough practice may limit progress. Therefore, a balanced approach is necessary. Teachers should combine strategy instruction, graded and authentic materials, and regular practice to meet learners' needs at different levels.

In general, the results confirm that effective listening instruction is a combination of strategy training, meaningful input, and continuous practice. These elements work together to create a supportive learning environment where learners can gradually improve their listening comprehension and use English more confidently in real-life situations.

Conclusion

In conclusion, developing listening comprehension in English learners requires a combination of effective strategies, meaningful materials, and regular practice. It is a complex but achievable goal when the right methods and strategies are used. Listening demands active thinking, attention, and practice. As explained in *Teaching and Researching Listening*, learners improve more effectively when they are taught how to manage their listening process through planning, monitoring, and evaluation (Vandergrift & Goh, 2012). This mentions the necessity of teaching not only content, but also learning strategies. Learners need guidance to improve their skills. Using metacognitive strategies helps students become more aware of how they listen and improves their overall understanding.

The use of authentic materials is also essential. Exposure to natural speech helps listeners become familiar with different accents, pronunciation, and speaking speeds. At the same time, the learners are guided to process this input successfully. This means that facilitators should carefully select materials and design tasks that match students' levels. It allows students to develop deeper comprehension skills.

Regular practice and continuous exposure to English play a key role as well. Studies like *The Effects of Extensive Listening Practice* show that frequent listening improves both confidence and fluency. Support from teachers and the use of interactive methods, recommended by British Council, further enhance learning outcomes. It creates a positive learning environment where students feel motivated to participate.

Furthermore, the integration of technology has become increasingly important in modern language learning. Digital platforms and tools allow learners to practice anytime and anywhere, making learning more flexible and continuous. This supports independent learning and helps students take responsibility for their own progress.

Overall, the paper mentions that there is no single solution for enhancing listening skills. A balanced approach that combines strategy instruction, authentic input, interactive activities, and consistent practice is the most successful. Teachers should adapt these methods to the interests and levels of learners, while they stay active and engaged in the process. Efforts by listeners can significantly strengthen listening comprehension and communicate more productively in real-life conditions.

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DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS

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Abstract: It is important for people to learn foreign languages since today the world is becoming increasingly globalized. The article focuses on the four key language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing, which play an important role in mastering language skills. The author examines each of these skills in relation to its significance for learners, problems that occur when trying to master it, and approaches to solving them. Two of the mentioned skills are receptive (listening and reading), whereas others are productive (speaking and writing). It should be noted that the article emphasizes that these four language skills cannot be viewed independently of each other because they are tightly interconnected. Also, it analyzes how modern technologies, motivational factors, and regular practice can contribute to language learning. Overall, one can conclude that the balanced development of all language skills combined with relevant learning techniques is very significant.

Keywords: foreign language learning, language skills, receptive skills, productive skills, interconnection, learning challenges, learning strategies

XARİCİ DİL BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAFI

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Xülasə: Xarici dil bacarıqlarının inkişafı müasir qloballaşan dünyada mühüm əhəmiyyət kəsb edir, çünki müxtəlif mədəniyyətlər arasında effektiv ünsiyyət getdikcə daha vacib olur. Bu məqalədə dörd əsas dil bacarığı – dinləmə, danışma, oxuma və yazma – və onların ümumi dil biliyinin formalaşmasındakı rolu araşdırılır. Hər bir bacarıq onun əhəmiyyəti, öyrənmələrin qarşılaşdığı çətinliklər və inkişaf üçün praktik strategiyalar baxımından təhlil olunur. Dinləmə və oxuma qəbul edici (reseptiv) bacarıqlar kimi, danışma və yazma isə məhsuldar (produktiv) bacarıqlar kimi təqdim edilir. Tədqiqat bu bacarıqların bir-biri ilə sıx əlaqəli olduğunu vurğulayır və dil öyrənmədə integrativ yanaşmanın vacibliyini ön plana çıxarır. Bundan əlavə, müasir texnologiyanın, motivasiyanın və davamlı məşqin dil öyrənməsinə təsiri də müzakirə olunur.

Nəticələr göstərir ki, bütün dörd bacarığın balanslı şəkildə inkişaf etdirilməsi, effektiv öyrənmə strategiyaları və uyğun mühitlə birlikdə, dil bacarıqlarının əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə yüksəlməsinə səbəb olur. Bu məqalə həm öyrənənlər, həm də müəllimlər üçün faydalı tövsiyələr təqdim edir.

Açar sözlər: xarici dilin mənimsənilməsi, dil bacarıqları, reseptiv dil bacarıqları, produktiv dil bacarıqları, bacarıqların qarşılıqlı əlaqəsi, dil öyrənmə çətinlikləri, dil öyrənmə strategiyaları

Introduction

In the present-day world, which is highly globalized, speaking several languages has turned into an important quality. Learning foreign languages not only promotes successful interaction but also allows for various opportunities in terms of education, career building, and culture. Language acquisition is a complicated process requiring the mastering of such basic skills as listening, speaking, reading, and writing. All these skills are related to one another and contribute to fluency acquisition.

The present article will analyze the development of four basic language skills, difficulties encountered while learning them, ways of improving skills, and the contribution of modern technologies to language acquisition.

Methodology and Materials

In order to investigate the topic of foreign language skills development, the present study follows the qualitative research methodology which will allow analyzing how listening, speaking, reading, and writing – four main skills essential for the development of communication competence in a foreign language – may be enhanced by means of diverse techniques, strategies, and educational environments. Using the descriptive and analytical approach, the research is focused on examining theoretical foundations of foreign language learning as well as practical ways of mastering the mentioned skills.

The research relies mainly on an extensive literature review. A variety of academic sources, namely books, peer-reviewed articles, educational reports, and credible online publications, were analyzed. Information about the theory of communicative language teaching, task-based language learning, and other models of foreign language education was gathered and reviewed. Different empirical studies that addressed the problem under discussion were examined as well.

Apart from the literature review method, a comparative analysis approach was also used in this research. Each of the four foreign language skills was analyzed separately, and then the skills were compared to each other in terms of their distinctive features, importance, and ways of mastering them. Moreover, listening and speaking are also highly correlated because being exposed to language spoken will affect pronunciation and fluency. Reading, on the other hand, helps writing because vocabulary is learned from reading, along with the structure and grammar of sentences.

Furthermore, the research includes insights from observation based on learning experiences that are common to all language learners. Observations are made with regard to the problems learners encounter when learning languages. For instance, in listening, learners often find it difficult to understand fast speech, whereas in speaking, learners may not have enough confidence. In reading, learners are often hampered by their lack of vocabulary. Lastly, in writing, learners make grammatical mistakes. The study provides ways to address these issues.

Lastly, this study considers various types of materials to assist in language acquisition. Traditional materials consist of textbooks, grammar books, reading texts, and writing exercises. On the other hand, modern materials include language learning applications, websites, podcasts, videos, and interactive exercises. There is much to say about the use of audio-visual materials with regard to

listening and speaking skills. This implies that viewing films, listening to podcasts, and communicating with native speakers contribute to the process of acquiring certain pronunciation, accents, and expressions. Furthermore, there are many written texts, articles, and stories read by the learner. Moreover, the use of information on the Internet also helps in expanding one's vocabulary and improving reading skills.

Another important source to be mentioned here is various written works and communication on the Internet. First of all, using this kind of material contributes to the process of organizing thoughts and using grammar. Moreover, comments from teachers or other learners are perceived as the most vital aspect of language acquisition.

As far as this approach is concerned, technology plays the most important role here. It provides more opportunities and flexibility for the learner to learn independently. Thus, using technology becomes more interesting and effective in the process of acquiring new knowledge. Communicating with native speakers through the Internet is another helpful method.

Discussion

From the results of the current research, it can be noted that language acquisition, including the four skills of listening, speaking, reading, and writing, is a complex process that should be approached from different angles. In particular, it is crucial to realize the value of each skill in language acquisition; however, each of the skills cannot exist without others as all of them are intertwined.

First of all, it is important to note that listening and reading can be considered skills of intake of information in language acquisition. Speaking and writing can be viewed as skills of output of information. The necessity of these skills lies in their integration; that is, the learner should not only receive information but also produce it to learn the language successfully. Another finding of the research is that the learner faces certain problems when he tries to improve his skills. For instance, it can be difficult to listen to someone speak, as it is hard to control the flow of the information received. Speaking skills may be problematic for many due to the fear of making mistakes and lack of vocabulary. As far as reading comprehension is concerned, students struggle with texts that have unknown words and complex structures. Finally, the learner can face issues when he tries to write due to poor grammar skills. In other words, language learning is not just about acquiring new linguistic knowledge; it is also about emotions and motivation.

The next topic of the paper under discussion concerns different approaches used in language learning. Traditional approaches based on studying grammar rules and memorizing things are not as efficient as modern methodologies aimed at improving communicative competence. In particular, task-based learning plays an important role in achieving this goal.

Technologies have also proven themselves as an indispensable part of language acquisition. Access to various online sources, apps on the smartphone, and multimedia content gives the possibility of continuous practicing of the new language at any convenient moment. Authentic materials and interaction with native speakers provide effective listening and speaking training. At the same time, according to the discussed information, technologies can be considered a tool that supplements learning rather than replaces it.

Two important aspects, which are motivation and regularity of training, were highlighted as necessary for efficient language development. As a rule, students who practice continuously and regularly achieve better results. It is better to make a few but frequent exercises than spend much time on intensive classes. Also, it is vital to create a comfortable environment for studying; this will allow a learner to feel less embarrassed when making mistakes.

As the last issue mentioned in the course of discussion, it is crucial to integrate all four language skills in one exercise. For example, listening to an article, then discussing it with a partner, reading additional information, and writing a paper.

Conclusion

To conclude, it is important to note that mastering foreign language skills, including listening, speaking, reading, and writing, is crucial to communicate effectively in the contemporary context. These four skills are related to each other and should be developed simultaneously in order to achieve language proficiency. Learning only one skill is unlikely to bring good results, thus a balanced approach is needed.

As mentioned above, each language skill has its particular challenges associated with it, including difficulty comprehending audio information, reluctance in communicating, poor vocabulary in terms of reading, and grammar errors in case of writing. Nevertheless, through applying proper techniques and methods, along with practicing and using different sources of information, these problems can be easily resolved.

It is also worth paying attention to the contribution made by modern technologies, learners' motivation, and favorable conditions to achieve success in foreign languages. Modern technologies can become useful for training language skills within certain situations, which will positively influence learning. In addition, one must remain persistent and motivated throughout this period.

Thus, language learning is a complex process that requires a considerable amount of effort and time.

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A COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS OF LOCAL AND GLOBAL REPRESENTATIONS IN THE 5TH GRADE ENGLISH TEXTBOOK

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Abstract: This study examines the cultural and intercultural dimensions of the newly published Turkish Ministry of National Education (MoNE) 5th-grade English textbook, *English Year 5* (2025). The study adopted a qualitative content analysis approach, analyzing all eight units of the coursebook using three theoretical frameworks: Cortazzi and Jin's cultural categories, Hall's Iceberg Model, and Byram's Intercultural Communicative Competence (ICC) model. The findings indicate that the textbook maintains a relatively balanced distribution between Source Culture and International Culture, while Target Culture is underrepresented. However, most cultural representations are restricted to surface-level elements such as food, landmarks, and clothing, with insufficient emphasis on deep cultural values, norms, and perspectives. Furthermore, the activities mostly focus on knowledge transmission rather than on developing intercultural skills and critical cultural awareness. The study's findings conclude that although the textbook reflects a modern local-to-global orientation, it still lacks deeper intercultural engagement. Several pedagogical recommendations are offered to strengthen critical literacy, intercultural competence, and deeper cultural understanding in Turkish EFL contexts.

Keywords: Intercultural Communicative Competence, Textbook Evaluation, Cultural Iceberg, English as a Lingua Franca, 5th-grade ELT.

5. SINIF İNGİLİZCE DERS KİTABINDA YEREL VE KÜRESEL KÜLTÜREL TEMSİLLERİN KARŞILAŞTIRMALI ANALİZİ

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Özet: Bu çalışma, Türkiye Millî Eğitim Bakanlığı (MEB) tarafından yeni yayınlanan 5. Sınıf İngilizce ders kitabı *English Year 5* (2025)'in kültürel ve kültürlerarası boyutlarını incelemektedir. Çalışmada nitel içerik analizi yaklaşımı benimsenmiş ve ders kitabının sekiz ünitesinin tamamı üç teorik çerçeve kullanılarak analiz edilmiştir: Cortazzi ve Jin'in kültürel kategorileri, Hall'un Buzdağı Modeli ve Byram'ın Kültürlerarası İletişimsel Yeterlilik (ICC) modeli. Bulgular, ders kitabının Kaynak Kültür ile Uluslararası Kültür arasında nispeten dengeli bir dağılım sağladığını, ancak Hedef Kültürün yeterince temsil edilmediğini göstermektedir. Bununla birlikte, kültürel temsillerin çoğu yemek, simgesel yapılar ve giyim gibi yüzeysel unsurlarla sınırlı kalmakta, derin kültürel değerler, normlar ve bakış açılarına yeterince vurgu yapılmamaktadır. Ayrıca, etkinlikler çoğunlukla kültürlerarası becerilerin ve eleştirel kültürel farkındalığın geliştirilmesinden ziyade bilgi aktarımına odaklanmaktadır. Çalışmanın bulguları, ders kitabının modern bir yerel-küresel yönelimi yansıtmaya rağmen, daha derin bir kültürlerarası etkileşimden yoksun olduğu sonucuna varmaktadır. Türk EFL bağlamlarında eleştirel okuryazarlığı, kültürlerarası yeterliliği ve daha derin kültürel anlayışı güçlendirmek için çeşitli pedagojik öneriler sunulmaktadır.

Anahtar Kelimeler: Kültürlerarası İletişim Yetkinliği, Ders Kitabı Değerlendirmesi, Kültürel Buzdağı, Ortak Dil Olarak İngilizce, 5. Sınıf İngilizce Öğretimi.

1. Introduction

In today's globally interconnected world, where language and society are inseparable, culture plays a cardinal role in language education, making it almost impossible to learn a new language without cultural elements. As a result, in the process of learning a new language, the influence of

the native language (L1) and its culture is almost unavoidable. (Ho, 2009; Lange & Paige, 2003, as cited in Baleghizadeh & Amiri Shayesteh, 2020). Most theoreticians agree that it comprises a set of symbolic systems, including knowledge, norms, values, beliefs, language, art, customs, as well as habits and skills learned by members of a given society (Shirayev and Levy, 1995, as cited in Young, Sachdev, et al., 2009)

From the learner's perspective, living in a monolingual or monocultural environment may expose them to less cultural diversity. In this case, cultural models can be used as a reference for enculturation. Although there is no direct exposure to the culture being taught, cultural models can be very useful, given that they organize a wide array of cultural knowledge (Rahayu & Aljouhani, 2023). In this context, the students are seen as *tabula rasa* (blank slate), and it is the duty of the teachers to guide them in forming their perspectives, which are acquired through various channels: family, teachers themselves, friends, the media, and, most importantly, the hidden curriculum of textbooks.

On the other hand, as it is assumed in the 21st century, English has become a *lingua franca* (ELF), a language used for communication among individuals with different native languages (Seidlhofer, 2005). Consequently, textbooks have become more globalized, with content that aligns with Byram's Intercultural Communicative Competence (ICC) model, which emphasizes that learners must become 'intercultural speakers.' Because the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR) explicitly includes developing intercultural awareness as a core goal, teaching linguistic features solely is no longer the concern of the instructors. In this regard, the CEFR presents the learner as a "social agent", implying a paradigm shift in course planning by promoting engagement and autonomy in an intercultural context. (Council of Europe, 2001).

In analyzing the coursebooks for intercultural items, three major models emerge. Firstly, in Cortazzi and Jin's Culture Aspects, Cortazzi and Jin (1999) identify three main types: Source culture (native culture), Target culture (native English-speaking countries, namely *lingua franca* (Al-Sofi, 2018), and international target culture (global settings). To prepare learners for global interactions, balancing them is significant. Secondly, for the Cultural Depth and Hall's Iceberg Model, both visible and invisible layers were explained (Paron, 2021). Recognizable items like flags, food, and landmarks constitute the Surface Culture, while Deep Culture includes invisible elements that cannot be recognized at first sight, such as values and social norms. These unconscious values and attitudes may be challenging for students to recognize. (Frank, 2013). Thirdly, Byram's ICC model outlines the skills required to interact respectfully across cultures. The key dimensions include *Savoir*: knowledge of self and others; of interaction; and of the individual and the society. *Savoir-être*: attitudes; relativizing the self, valuing others. *Savoir comprendre*: skills of interpreting and relating. *Savoir apprendre/faire*: skills of discovering and/or interacting. *Savoir s'engager*: political education, critical cultural awareness (Byram, 1997, as cited in Hoff, 2020).

The relevant framework generally indicates that studies tend to focus on understanding how textbooks function as cultural artifacts and influence learners' views. For instance, Halil (2019) underscored that the 6th-grade MoNE textbook emphasized Source and international elements, while Alan (2020) found that 8th-grade international representations outnumbered Target and Source cultures. More recently, Bacanak & Eşkan (2022) revealed that International Culture in various textbooks outperformed Source Culture elements. To address the gap in the literature, this study emphasizes the cultural and intercultural issues in the most recent 2025 5th-grade textbook. To fulfill this, the study aims to answer the following research questions:

1. To what extent are source, target, and global cultural elements distributed within the “English 5” textbook?
2. According to Hall’s (1976) Iceberg Model, what is the balance between surface-level and deep-level cultural representations?
3. Which dimensions of Byram’s (1997) Intercultural Communicative Competence (ICC) model (Knowledge, Attitudes, or Skills) are most prominently integrated into the textbook’s activities?
4. How do the cultural representations in the 5th-grade textbook compare to previous findings in the Turkish EFL context?

2. Materials and Methods

2.1. Research Design

This study adopted a qualitative content analysis approach. As qualitative content analysis, as defined by Merriam and Tisdell (2015), is a reflective and interactive process of interpreting meanings, intentions, and objectives reflected within the text. The newly published textbook of English Language, “English Year 5,” by the Turkish Ministry of National Education (MoNE) in 2025, was evaluated for its balanced cultural content in teaching a foreign language.

2.2. Data Source

The data were collected by the Ministry of National Education (MoNE, 2025) in Türkiye for “English Year 5,” used in Turkish public schools. To provide a holistic and detailed overview, all eight units of the relevant coursebook were thoroughly examined.

2.3. Data Analysis

For data analysis, the coursebook was first analyzed using three models. Additionally, the cultural items were classified under Contextual Focus (Cortazzi & Jin, 1999), Cultural Depth (Hall, 1976), and ICC (Byram, 1997). The last two dimensions (Skills of discovery/interaction and Critical cultural awareness) were excluded to maintain the validity of the analysis, as the learners in the relevant coursebook were not at a developmental stage to develop critical cultural awareness, which requires complex skills. (Huang & Byram, 2024; Schat et al., 2022). In the second phase, some pages of the coursebook were examined using these three models as case studies to enrich the data source and analysis.

3. Results and Discussions

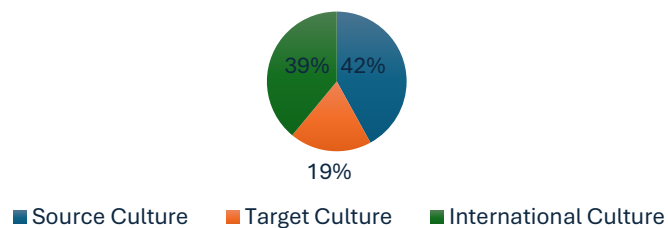
3.1. Analysis of Cultural Representations (Source, Global, and Target Culture)

Analysis of Cultural Representations (Source, Global, and Target Culture). 206 cultural items were identified through qualitative analysis by examining all eight units in the textbooks.

As shown in Figure 1, the frequency of the Source Culture (%42) aligns with Halil's (2019) findings. In Halil’s findings, the 6th-grade English textbook provided by MoNE (2018) prioritized the source Culture and Target Culture. But, in Alan’s findings (2020), the 8th-grade “Upswing” textbook illustrated that the International Culture was the most frequent, outnumbering the Source Culture. So, the newly designed “English Year 5” (MoNe, 2025) maintains a “local-to-global” balance.

Figure 1 *Contextual Focus (Source, Target, and International Culture)*

Contextual Focus



3.2. Analysis of Cultural Depth (Hall's Iceberg Theory)

The findings show that the Surface Culture items (n=159) outnumbered the Deep Culture items (n=34). The textbook mirrors the tip of the iceberg, leaving the bottom untouched.

This creates a "Tourist-Learner" rather than a Learner. These findings align with the previous studies by Halil (2019), Alan (2020), and Bacanak & Eşkan (2022).

Table 1. *Level of Cultural Representation (Hall's Iceberg Theory)*

Category	Frequency (n)	Examples
Surface Culture	159	Flags, clothing, famous landmarks, food names, postage stamps, etc.
Deep Culture	34	Family values, social norms, eating habits, environmental awareness, etc.
TOTAL	193	

3.3. Distribution of Byram's ICC Dimensions

149 items were identified in the integrated activities. The findings show that the dominance of Knowledge follows the patterns seen in MoNE textbooks, which prioritize information delivery over active skills.

Table 2. *Distribution of Byram's ICC Dimensions in the Textbook*

ICC Dimension	Frequency (n)	Percentage (%)	Key Examples from the Book
Knowledge (Savoirs)	95	%64	School systems across different countries, traditional clothes, and habitats.
Attitudes (Savoir-être)	30	%20	Showing respect for study places, openness to different styles, and valuing family time.

ICC Dimension	Frequency (n)	Percentage (%)	Key Examples from the Book
Skills (savoir-faire/apprendre)	24	%16	Comparing school subjects, making a survey, or writing a postcard from a foreign country.
TOTAL	149	%100	

3.4. Case Studies from Textbook Units:

- Page 38 (CLIL & Culture Part): This part lists some countries' rules along with Türkiye, which fosters the Attitudes (Savoir-être), but the activities lack making a comparison to develop the critical cultural awareness.
- Page 52 (CLIL & Culture Part): This presented the perceptions of schools from different countries, which moved beyond the Knowledge. However, the activities again remained at the surface level, asking students to complete some true/false comprehension questions.
- Page 136 (CLIL & Culture Part): Landmarks like the Grand Canyon and Great Barrier Reef were presented in the reading passage. Activities were comprehension-based, which prioritized Knowledge over Skill. Unlike Alan's (2020) findings, this new curriculum is more Source-Global hybrid.

However, cultural depth remains narrow. The new curriculum is modern in its approach to geography but traditional in its depth. Based on the analysis of the 5th-grade coursebook using three models and relevant case studies, three recommendations emerged and are listed below.

Critical Literacy

Teachers should critically analyze and evaluate the textbook and other materials, and focus on the "Surface Culture" areas that require more attention. Additionally, they need to practice using textbook reading passages on different cultures to create opportunities for comparative intercultural discussions, using materials and strategies already available. Furthermore, teachers are supposed to make a concerted effort to pose "Why" and "How" questions that address Byram's "Skills" dimension, rather than merely reciting the standard comprehension questions which are already included in most textbooks.

Bridging the Waterline in the Iceberg

Regarding cultural debate initiatives, teachers are expected to endeavor to hold more "Deep Culture" discussions throughout the year. For instance, when studying a landmark from around the world on page 136 of the relevant textbook to share the country's societal values or environmental norms, the issue should be discussed with the students.

Engaging the Family Factor

Regarding the family factor, the young learners' attitudes toward integrating parents and family into the school environment are significant, given that Language learning is influenced more by their parents, who are also their first language users, than by teachers and the school environment. In doing so, homework activities could easily be modified and designed to involve the family unit. For example, students could interview their parents about Turkish social norms and customs, and compare these with similar practices from around the world to validate the Source Culture, reduce prejudice toward the "others," and adopt the Target Culture.

4. Conclusion

In light of all that has been discussed above, the study concludes that the newly designed textbook (English Year 5) by the Ministry of National Education (MoNE, 2025) balanced Source Culture and International Culture, and outnumbered Target Culture. However, these cultural representations remained at the surface level, with items of the iceberg, and did not move into the deep culture, with material remains almost entirely above Hall's Iceberg "waterline. These indicate that the relevant coursebook was unable to function richly enough to reflect cultural issues.

There is one more issue that can be drawn from the study: the cultural database was insufficient to integrate Byram's dimensions for interpreting or relating to invisible social norms. It manages to update the source of culture, but not too deeply. On the other hand, to nurture intercultural speakers, this should not be merely the transfer of factual data, but rather the development of analytical skills to navigate the complexities of a globalized world.

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RETHINKING ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING IN HIGHER EDUCATION: COMMUNICATIVE SKILLS AND DIGITAL LEARNING INTEGRATION

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Abstract. The research critically examines the structural imperatives demanding a fundamental reconceptualization of English language teaching (ELT) in higher education, synthesizing theoretical and empirical developments across four interconnected domains. First, it interrogates the continuing dominance of the native-speaker model in university ELT, arguing that postcolonial, World Englishes, and English as a Lingua Franca frameworks necessitate an epistemological reorientation toward plurilingual and decolonizing pedagogies. Second, it reconceptualizes communicative competence beyond its classical linguistic foundations, demonstrating that digitally mediated, multimodal, and intercultural forms of meaning-making are now constitutive of both academic and professional communication. Third, it evaluates the integration of task-based language teaching with digital platforms, arguing that pedagogical coherence and communicative authenticity must drive tool selection rather than technological availability alone. Fourth, it critically assesses the role of generative artificial intelligence in language education, distinguishing between instrumentalist deployments that risk deskilling learners and principled integrations that function as cognitive scaffolds. Finally, the article foregrounds structural inequalities in digital access and institutional readiness as foundational constraints on any progressive pedagogical agenda, concluding that equity-oriented institutional investment is a prerequisite for meaningful reform rather than an optional supplement to it.

Keywords: English language teaching, communicative competence, digital learning integration, multimodal literacy, critical pedagogy.

ALİ TƏHSİLDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİ TƏDRİSİNİN YENİDƏN DÜŞÜNÜLMƏSİ: KOMMUNİKATİV BACARIQLAR VƏ RƏQƏMSAL ÖYRƏNMƏNİN İNTEQRASIYASI

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Xülasə: Tədqiqat ali təhsildə ingilis dili tədrisinin köklü şəkildə yenidən konseptuallaşdırılmasını tələb edən struktur imperativləri tənqidi şəkildə araşdırır və dörd bir-biri ilə əlaqəli sahə üzrə nəzəri və empirik inkişafı sintez edir. Birincisi, məqalə universitetdə ingilis dili tədrisində ana dili daşıyıcısı modelinin hökm sürmə tendensiyasını sorğulayır və postkolonial, “Dünya İngiliscəsi” və “Lingua Franca” kimi ingilis dili çərçivələrinin çoxdillilik və dekoloniallaşdırıcı pedaqogikaya doğru epistemoloji yenidən istiqamətlənməni zəruri etdirdiyini əsaslandırır. İkincisi, kommunikativ kompetentliyi onun klassik linqvistik əsaslarının çərçivəsindən kənara çıxaraq yenidən konseptuallaşdırır; rəqəmsal vasitələrlə həyata keçirilən, çoxmodlu və mədəniyyətlərarası mənə yaratma formalarının artıq həm akademik, həm də peşəkar kommunikasiyanın tərkib hissəsinə çevrildiyini göstərir. Üçüncüsü, tapşırıq əsaslı dil tədrisinin rəqəmsal platformalarla inteqrasiyasını qiymətləndirir; pedaqoji ardıcılıq və kommunikativ autentikliyin texnoloji əlçatımlılıqdan deyil, alət seçimindən irəli gəlməli olduğunu iddia edir. Dördüncüsü, generativ süni intellektin dil təhsilindəki rolunu tənqidi şəkildə təhlil edir; öyrənmələri peşəsizləşdirmə riski daşıyan instrumentalist təbiiqləri ilə idrak istinadı funksiyasını yerinə yetirən prinsipial inteqrasiyaları bir-birindən fərqləndirir. Nəhayət, məqalə rəqəmsal çatıma və institusional hazırlıqdakı struktur bərabərsizlikləri hər hansı bir müntəzəm pedaqoji proqramın əsas məhdudiyyəti kimi ön plana çıxarır və nəticə etibarilə bərabər hüquqluluğa yönəlmiş institusional investisiyanın əsl islahatın əvəzsiz ön şərti olduğunu vurğulayır.

Açar sözlər: ingilis dili tədrisi, kommunikativ kompetentlik, rəqəmsal öyrənmənin inteqrasiyası, çoxmodlu savadlılıq, tənqidi pedaqogika.

Introduction

The questions addressed in the paper carry direct institutional and policy relevance at a moment when higher education systems globally are under simultaneous pressure to internationalize their curricula, adopt digital learning technologies, and respond to postcolonial critiques of Anglo-centric pedagogical norms. English language teaching in universities occupies a structurally pivotal position within these overlapping demands: it is at once a site of cultural reproduction, a mechanism of academic socialization, and an increasingly digitally mediated practice whose outcomes shape students' capacity to participate in global knowledge production. Yet the field has been slow to translate its theoretical advances in ELF scholarship, critical pedagogy, multiliteracies theory, and educational technology research into coherent institutional practice, with the result that most university ELT programs continue to operate under frameworks that are misaligned with both the communicative realities their graduates will face and the equity obligations that publicly funded higher education systems are expected to fulfill. This research is therefore relevant not only as a contribution to applied linguistics and language education theory but as an intervention in the broader institutional conversation about what it means to prepare students for communicative participation in a digitally transformed, linguistically diverse, and structurally unequal world.

In this regard, the purpose of the research is to critically synthesize current theoretical and empirical developments across postcolonial ELT scholarship, critical pedagogy, multimodal communication theory, and digital learning research in order to identify the structural imperatives that must guide the reconceptualization of English language teaching in higher education.

Thus, the paper advances the existing literature by offering an integrative theoretical framework that connects four hitherto largely separate lines of inquiry (the decolonization of ELT, the critical pedagogy turn, multimodal digital composition, and digital equity) thereby providing a more comprehensive and institutionally actionable account of what rethinking English language teaching in higher education requires than any single-strand analysis has previously produced.

Methodology and Materials

The study employs a critical integrative review methodology, synthesizing theoretical and empirical literature across four intersecting domains: postcolonial and World Englishes scholarship, critical pedagogy, multimodal communication theory, and educational technology research. Rather than generating primary data, the study pursues conceptual coherence across these bodies of literature, drawing on peer-reviewed journal articles, systematic reviews, and theoretically grounded empirical studies published predominantly between 2021 and 2026 and retrieved from Scopus-indexed sources. Source selection was guided by thematic relevance to the reconceptualization of English language teaching in higher education and to the pedagogical integration of digital learning environments, with particular attention to studies addressing communicative competence, task-based instruction, generative artificial intelligence in EFL contexts, and structural inequalities in digital access. The analytical procedure involved identifying convergent arguments and structural tensions across the selected literature, mapping them onto four thematic axes, and deriving from their intersection a set of institutional and pedagogical imperatives that no single-strand analysis has previously synthesized in an integrated framework.

Discussion

The institutional frameworks that have historically governed English language teaching (ELT) in higher education are increasingly recognized as inadequate for the communicative realities of a multipolar, globalized world. For much of the twentieth century, university-level ELT operated under what scholars have termed a native-speaker model, privileging Anglo-American linguistic norms as the unmarked standard of competence, competency, and prestige. This orientation has come under sustained theoretical critique from researchers working within the frameworks of World Englishes, English as a Lingua Franca (ELF), and Global Englishes (GE). These approaches advocate for acknowledging the multilingual and multicultural resources involved in ELF communication, valuing local teaching practices and materials, and rejecting methodologies and content imposed exonymously from Anglophone contexts. Crucially, such reconceptualizations carry institutional implications: curricula, teacher training programs, and assessment instruments constructed around a monolithic native-speaker norm systematically disadvantage multilingual learners whose communicative repertoires are both different from and, in many respects, more flexible than those of monolingual native speakers. A decolonizing framework for ELT teacher education argues that instructors should confront the linguistic imperialism embedded in the field, promote plurilingual pedagogical approaches, and develop students' critical awareness of the power relations that structure language hierarchies. The practical consequence of this critique is that rethinking ELT in universities requires not merely methodological updating but a more fundamental epistemological reorientation; one that repositions local knowledge, non-Western pedagogical traditions, and translingual practices as legitimate rather than deficient (Baker, et al., 2025; Qin, 2021).

A second axis of transformation concerns the pedagogical relationship between language instruction and critical thinking. Traditional ELT in higher education has tended toward a functional or instrumentalist conception of language competence, treating proficiency primarily as a set of skills to be acquired for professional and academic mobility. Critical pedagogy, drawing on Freirean principles and transformative learning theory, challenges this orientation by insisting that language education is inherently political and that classrooms are sites where ideological assumptions are either reproduced or contested. Research on university-level EFL courses of intercultural communication demonstrates that when students are trained to critically evaluate textbook content, they acquire intercultural literacy and learn to challenge the cultural

presuppositions embedded in pedagogical materials, with the conclusion that ELT must be conducted from a genuinely multilingual and multicultural perspective. Studies conducted across diverse higher education contexts, including Indonesia, Egypt, and Japan, indicate that critical pedagogy is gaining momentum globally, though its uptake is shaped primarily by assessment regimes, available materials, and teacher preparation rather than by ideological resistance alone. This points to a structural problem: even where instructors are philosophically committed to critical approaches, institutional pressures around standardized testing and curriculum compliance constrain their pedagogical agency (Wang, et al., 2021; Zaimoğlu & Dağtaş, 2025a). Rethinking ELT in higher education therefore demands not only different classroom practices but also reformed institutional architectures, revised assessment policies, flexible curricula, and faculty development programs designed to support critical, reflective, and intercultural forms of language instruction.

The third major pressure demanding a reconceptualization of university-level ELT comes from the rapid integration of generative artificial intelligence into educational environments. As generative AI tools become increasingly embedded in higher education, EFL teachers are challenged to rethink their pedagogical identities and practices, particularly given that policy discourses tend to promote such tools primarily for their potential to enhance instructional efficiency rather than for the fostering of meaningful student engagement. The distinction is consequential: efficiency-oriented deployment of AI, automated feedback generation, content creation, grammar checking, risks further deskilling students and consolidating a passive relationship to language, while pedagogically sophisticated integration can function as what researchers describe as a cognitive scaffold. Cognitively engaged language learners using GenAI tools in goal-directed ways are more likely to approach tasks with a curious mindset, question grammatical rules, and employ self-regulatory strategies to deepen their understanding. At the same time, the ethical and epistemological challenges are substantial. The adoption of generative AI in EFL teaching preparation presents significant challenges around aligning AI outputs with educational standards and maintaining meaningful teacher-student interaction. Additionally, concerns about academic integrity, the homogenization of student writing, and differential access across institutional and national contexts underscore the need for theoretically grounded, equity-sensitive AI policies (Zaimoğlu, & Dağtaş, 2025b; Zaim, et al., 2024). In general, these pressures (postcolonial critiques of the native-speaker norm, the demands of critical pedagogy, and the disruptive yet generative potential of AI) converge to make the rethinking of English language teaching in higher education not an optional pedagogical update but a structural imperative for institutions committed to both intellectual rigor and social justice.

The conceptual relationship between communicative competence and digital learning environments has undergone substantial theoretical reformulation over the past two decades, driven by the recognition that communication in contemporary society is no longer primarily a linguistic or even a verbal phenomenon. Classical models of communicative competence, anchored in the work of Hymes, Canale and Swain, and later Bachman, defined competence largely in terms of grammatical, discourse, sociolinguistic, and strategic knowledge, all implicitly assuming that the communicative act occurs through language-as-text. This conception, however adequate for an earlier media ecology, has been progressively challenged by the proliferating modes of meaning-making available in digitally mediated environments. Digital literacy has evolved from a narrow set of technical skills into a multidimensional competency that now encompasses critical, ethical, creative, and communicative proficiencies, reflecting the recognition that navigating digital environments requires far more than instrumental tool use. Contemporary communication, in both

academic and professional contexts, routinely involves the simultaneous deployment of linguistic, visual, auditory, gestural, and spatial resources across multiple platforms, a phenomenon theorized in semiotics as multimodality. Multimodality, described as a defining feature of human communication, addresses its complex nature through the dynamic interaction of various modes of expression, including textual, visual, audio, gestural, and spatial elements, and with the advancement of digital technologies, it has become the norm in contemporary communication rather than an exception. This shift demands that higher education institutions reconceptualize what counts as communicative skill, moving toward frameworks that integrate classical competence models with emerging literacies in digital composition, intercultural navigation, and multimodal meaning-making (Gong, et.al, 2025; Yu, et.al, 2026).

The most pedagogically influential response to this reconceptualization has been the alignment of task-based language teaching (TBLT) with digital learning platforms, producing what researchers have increasingly termed blended or digitally enhanced communicative instruction. Task-based approaches, which organize language instruction around meaningful communicative activities rather than formal structural sequences, have proven particularly amenable to digital integration because digital tools substantially expand the range of tasks available to learners, the audiences to whom they can communicate, and the feedback mechanisms that support their development. Systematic reviews of blended TBLT in EFL contexts indicate that this integration can enhance speaking, writing, and vocabulary outcomes while fostering learner autonomy, confidence, and motivation, though successful implementation depends critically on alignment between digital tools and instructional objectives, the authenticity of communicative tasks, and the quality of teacher facilitation. Digital task-based instruction distinguishes itself from conventional TBLT by immersing learners in tasks that require active language use for communication, decision-making, and problem-solving, rather than relying on rote memorization or decontextualized grammar exercises. This immersion helps learners perceive the practical value of language learning and fosters a deeper connection to the language itself, while structured online activities of this kind have been shown to significantly improve communication and collaboration skills. At the same time, researchers caution against an uncritical enthusiasm for digital tools: most mobile language-learning applications are designed for individual use and focus on linguistic form rather than communicative function, which restricts their ability to foster interactive speaking skills such as negotiation of meaning, turn-taking, and real-time response, the very dimensions most central to genuine communicative competence (Ramdana, et.al, 2026; Al-Rashidi, 2025). The implication is that effective digital integration must be pedagogically driven rather than tool-driven, with decisions about platform selection grounded in principled models of communicative development.

The question of multimodal digital composition occupies a particularly important position within current debates about communicative skill development, as it marks the site where traditional academic literacy practices, centered on the written essay as the privileged form of knowledge display, encounter the demands of a digitally mediated knowledge economy. Educators working within the multiliteracies framework, originally articulated by the New London Group, have argued for decades that print-based literacy curricula systematically underequip students for the communicative demands of professional and civic participation in digital environments. Research on collaborative digital multimodal writing in undergraduate courses indicates that students perceive such work as offering opportunities for greater creativity and autonomy while simultaneously challenging their inherited conceptions of academic writing forms, conventions, and practices, with students voicing a desire for increased exposure to and experience with digital

technologies that connect different aspects of their present lives and benefit their futures. In English for Academic Purposes (EAP) contexts specifically, the integration of digital multimodal composition has been theorized as essential preparation for academic communication in a digital era. Research examining student-generated knowledge dissemination videos, a form of digital multimodal composition targeting non-specialist audiences, finds that students excel at creating interpersonal meaning through embodied and filmic modes, but their ability to convey ideational and textual meaning requires structured pedagogical support, with many students relying on technical language with unclear visuals or deploying a limited semiotic repertoire, pointing to specific areas where EAP course development must intervene. Broader studies of multimodal literacy in higher education reveal significant discrepancies between assumed digital proficiency and actual multimodal competence among university students, suggesting that structural pedagogical interventions are necessary rather than optional (Highland & Fedtke, 2023; Huang & Xia, 2024). This points to a productive tension that curriculum designers must navigate: students enter universities already deeply embedded in digital communication cultures, yet their informal digital practices do not automatically translate into the critical, academically sophisticated multimodal competence that higher education contexts demand.

A fourth dimension of the communicative skills and digital learning integration debate concerns structural conditions of access, equity, and institutional readiness – factors that condition whether the pedagogical aspirations outlined above can be realized for all students or only for those already advantaged by socioeconomic position and geographic location. The digital divide refers to unequal access to digital multimodal technology, including smartphones, tablets, laptops, and high-speed internet, and this unequal access creates a gap between those who can afford to access web-based information and resources for academic and professional needs and those who cannot, with the inequity extending beyond mere access to encompass understanding of how to select and use tools to enhance learning. This structural problem acquired heightened visibility during and after the COVID-19 pandemic, which accelerated the shift to online and blended learning while simultaneously exposing the depth of existing disparities. Research on digital inequity in education identifies an urgent need to address barriers that prevent equal access to educational resources, including the establishment of digital infrastructure such as high-speed internet connections in remote or less developed areas, and the integration of digital devices into teaching and learning as a systematic institutional responsibility rather than an individual student obligation. The equity dimensions of digital learning integration are not limited to hardware and connectivity, however. Evidence from sub-Saharan African higher education institutions reveals that twenty-first century skills are insufficiently developed among students due to inadequate digital infrastructure, underprepared faculty, and outdated or nonexistent ICT policies that hinder effective technology adoption in teaching, a configuration of institutional failure that simultaneously disadvantages communicative development and entrenches structural inequalities (Meng, et.al, 2024; Ndibalema, 2025). These findings caution against techno-optimistic narratives that frame digital integration as self-evidently democratizing: without deliberate institutional investment in infrastructure, faculty development, and inclusive curriculum design, the integration of digital tools into communicative skills instruction risks reproducing and amplifying existing inequalities rather than overcoming them.

Conclusion

The article has examined the intersecting pressures that compel a fundamental rethinking of English language teaching in higher education, with particular attention to the integration of digital

environments into communicative skills development. Drawing on theoretical frameworks from postcolonial linguistics, critical pedagogy, multimodal semiotics, and educational technology research, the discussion has demonstrated that the challenges facing university-level ELT are neither isolated nor technical in nature but are structurally interconnected. The principal findings of the analysis may be summarized as follows:

First, the native-speaker model that has historically anchored ELT curricula, assessment instruments, and teacher training programs is theoretically untenable in a world where English functions primarily as a lingua franca among non-native speakers, necessitating an epistemological reorientation toward plurilingual, decolonizing, and World Englishes-informed pedagogies.

Second, communicative competence in contemporary contexts cannot be adequately conceptualized through classical linguistic frameworks alone; it must be expanded to incorporate multimodal, intercultural, and digitally mediated forms of meaning-making that are now constitutive of both academic and professional communication.

Third, task-based language teaching, when aligned with carefully selected digital platforms and anchored in authentic communicative purposes, offers a pedagogically coherent framework for developing genuine communicative competence, though its effectiveness depends critically on teacher facilitation quality and the communicative authenticity of designed tasks rather than on digital tool adoption per se.

Fourth, the integration of generative AI into language education presents a dual pedagogical reality: when deployed instrumentally for efficiency, it risks deskilling learners and homogenizing output, whereas pedagogically principled integration can function as a cognitive scaffold that deepens reflective engagement with language.

Fifth, structural inequalities in digital access, institutional readiness, and faculty capacity constitute a foundational constraint on the realization of any progressive pedagogical agenda, meaning that equity-oriented institutional investment is a prerequisite rather than a supplement to pedagogical reform.

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RETHINKING COMMUNICATIVE LANGUAGE TEACHING: MICRO-INTERACTION TASKS AS A SUSTAINABLE MODEL FOR CONTEMPORARY EFL CLASSROOMS

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Abstract: Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) has long been recognized as one of the most influential approaches in English language education due to its emphasis on meaningful communication, interaction, and learner-centered instruction (Richards, 2006). It shifts language learning from memorizing grammatical rules to using language in real-life contexts, helping learners develop communicative competence (Brown, 2007). However, in practice, CLT often faces challenges such as mixed-ability classrooms and varying levels of learner motivation (Harmer, 2015). These factors can reduce student

participation and make it difficult to ensure equal interaction opportunities, highlighting the need for more flexible and adaptable teaching strategies.

Micro-interactions are short, structured, and regularly repeated communicative exchanges integrated into lessons. Unlike traditional communicative activities, which may be time-consuming and uneven in participation, these tasks are brief and designed to involve all learners consistently (Ellis, 2003). Their main purpose is to maintain continuous engagement by giving every student frequent opportunities to speak and interact, regardless of proficiency level.

The study uses a qualitative methodology based on classroom observation, learner reflection journals, and informal interviews (Harmer, 2015). This approach provides a detailed understanding of both behavioral changes and learner perceptions. The findings show that micro-interaction tasks improve student engagement, reduce speaking anxiety, and increase overall participation. They also support formative assessment by allowing teachers to monitor progress continuously and adjust instruction when needed (Brown, 2007). Overall, the results indicate that frequent and structured interaction plays a key role in language learning, and micro-interactions offer an effective and practical model for modern EFL classrooms.

Key words: micro-interaction, communicative pedagogy, learner engagement, task-based instruction, formative assessment, EFL, classroom dynamics

KOMMUNIKATİV DİL TƏDRİSİNƏ YENİ BAXIŞ: MÜASİR EFL SINIFLARI ÜÇÜN MİKRO-İTERAKSIYA TAPŞIRIQLARI DAYANIQLI MODEL KİMİ

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Xülasə: Kommunikativ dil tədrisi ingilis dili öyrədilməsində ən geniş istifadə olunan yanaşmalardan biridir və onun əsas məqsədi dilin real ünsiyyət situasiyalarında tətbiqini təmin etməkdir. Bu metod tələbələrin dil bacarıqlarını yalnız nəzəri deyil, həm də praktik şəkildə inkişaf etdirməyə yönəlmişdir. Lakin bu yanaşmanın sinif mühitində tətbiqi hər zaman asan olmur və müəyyən çətinliklərlə müşayiət olunur. Xüsusilə müxtəlif dil səviyyələrinə malik tələbələrin birgə təhsil aldığı siniflərdə, eləcə də dərs vaxtının məhdud olduğu şəraitdə bütün tələbələrin eyni dərəcədə aktiv iştirakını təmin etmək müəllimlər üçün ciddi problem yaradır. Bundan əlavə, bəzi tələbələrin motivasiya səviyyəsinin aşağı olması da kommunikativ fəaliyyətlərin effektivliyini azalda bilər.

Bu tədqiqat kommunikativ yanaşmanın daha səmərəli tətbiqi üçün mikro-interaksiya tapşırıqlarının istifadəsini araşdırır. Mikro-interaksiyalar dərs prosesinə sistemli şəkildə daxil edilən, qısa, məqsədyönlü və strukturlaşdırılmış ünsiyyət fəaliyyətləridir. Bu tapşırıqların əsas məqsədi tələbələrin dərs boyu tez-tez danışq prosesinə cəlb olunmasını təmin etmək və onların passiv qalmasının qarşısını almaqdır. Beləliklə, hər bir tələbə üçün bərabər iştirak imkanları yaradılır və kommunikativ bacarıqların inkişafı daha ardıcıl şəkildə dəstəklənir.

Tədqiqatın nəticələri göstərir ki, mikro-interaksiya tapşırıqlarının tətbiqi tələbələrin dərslə fəallığını əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır, danışq zamanı yaranan psixoloji gərginliyi azaldır və daha rahat və dəstəkləyici ünsiyyət mühiti formalaşdırır. Eyni zamanda, bu yanaşma müəllimlərə davamlı və formativ qiymətləndirmə aparmaq imkanı verir, tələbələrin inkişafını daha sistemli şəkildə izləməyə şərait yaradır.

Açar sözlər: mikro-interaksiya, kommunikativ pedaqogika, tələbə fəallığı, tapşırıq əsaslı tədris, formativ qiymətləndirmə, sinif dinamikası, ingilis dili

Introduction

The role of English as a global lingua franca has significantly increased the importance of effective language teaching methodologies (Richards, 2006). In modern education, the primary objective is no longer limited to grammatical competence but extends to communicative competence (Brown, 2007). This shift has led to the adoption of Communicative Language Teaching as a dominant instructional approach.

CLT emphasizes interaction, real-life communication, and student-centered learning (Harmer, 2015). However, despite its theoretical strengths, its practical application often falls short. In many classrooms, communicative activities are treated as isolated events rather than an integral part of the lesson.

Another challenge relates to classroom diversity. Differences in proficiency levels, learning styles, and motivation can create imbalances in participation. More confident students tend to dominate communicative tasks, while others remain silent (Willis, 1996).

To address these challenges, this study introduces micro-interaction tasks. These tasks are designed to create frequent opportunities for communication, ensuring that all students are actively involved throughout the lesson.

Furthermore, this approach aligns with contemporary educational theories that emphasize active learning, learner autonomy, and continuous engagement. By restructuring the lesson into smaller interactive segments, micro-interactions aim to transform passive learning environments into dynamic and participatory spaces.

Methodology and Materials

This study adopts a qualitative research design to explore the effectiveness of micro-interaction tasks in an EFL classroom (Ellis, 2003). The research was conducted over a six-week period with 24 students representing different proficiency levels. The lesson structure was redesigned to include micro-interaction tasks at regular intervals. Each task lasted between one and three minutes and was integrated into different stages of the lesson, including warm-up, practice, and consolidation phases.

The micro-interaction tasks implemented in this study were designed based on task-based learning principles (Ellis, 2003). These tasks included quick opinion-sharing activities, which encouraged learners to express their immediate views on a given topic; short pair discussions, which promoted collaborative thinking and peer interaction; mini role-play situations that simulated real-life communicative contexts; collaborative problem-solving tasks that required learners to work together to find solutions; and question–response exchanges aimed at developing spontaneous speaking skills.

To ensure reliability, multiple data collection methods were used. These included classroom observation notes, student reflection journals, and informal interviews (Harmer, 2015). These included structured classroom observation notes, which allowed the researcher to systematically record student behavior and participation patterns during lessons; student reflection journals, where learners documented their own experiences and perceptions of the learning process; and informal interviews, which provided additional qualitative insights into student attitudes and challenges.

The evaluation of student performance was based on several key criteria. The primary focus was placed on the level of participation in communicative activities, as well as improvements in speaking fluency. In addition, students' confidence in communication and their ability to interact effectively with peers were carefully observed and assessed. In line with communicative approaches, grammatical accuracy was considered less important than meaning-focused communication (Brown, 2007).

Discussion

The findings demonstrate that micro-interaction tasks positively influence learner engagement and classroom behavior (Richards, 2006). The data collected through observation, student reflections, and informal interviews indicate noticeable improvements in engagement, confidence, and communicative performance.

One of the most prominent outcomes of the intervention was a significant rise in student participation rates. Unlike traditional communicative tasks, micro-interactions reduce cognitive load and align with task-based learning principles (Ellis, 2003). This reduced cognitive and emotional load encouraged more students to take part actively in classroom interaction.

Furthermore, participation became more evenly distributed across the class. Students also reported reduced speaking anxiety, which aligns with affective filter theory discussed in language acquisition research (Brown, 2007). This shift created a more equitable learning environment where even quieter or less confident students were able to engage meaningfully.

Another key finding relates to the affective dimension of language learning. Students reported a noticeable reduction in speaking anxiety when engaging in micro-interaction tasks compared to longer, more formal speaking activities. The short duration of these tasks minimized performance pressure and allowed learners to focus on meaning rather than accuracy.

Over time, repeated exposure to such low-stakes communicative situations appeared to build learner confidence. This aligns with the idea that language anxiety can be reduced through incremental and frequent practice rather than isolated high-pressure performance. As students became more familiar with regular interaction patterns, their willingness to speak increased naturally.

Micro-interaction tasks also improved classroom dynamics, making lessons more interactive and learner-centered (Harmer, 2015). Students became more responsive and engaged throughout the lesson. This constant shift between listening and speaking activities improved attention levels and reduced classroom fatigue. Students were more alert, responsive, and involved in the learning process. In addition, peer-to-peer interaction increased significantly, strengthening collaborative learning and improving social communication within the classroom.

From an assessment perspective, micro-interactions functioned as continuous formative evaluation tools. Teachers could observe learner performance in real time and adjust instruction accordingly (Richards, 2006). This continuous monitoring allowed for immediate feedback and more accurate identification of learner difficulties. Teachers were able to adjust explanations, modify tasks, and provide targeted support based on ongoing classroom evidence. As a result, instruction became more adaptive and responsive to student needs.

Moreover, assessment shifted from being a separate classroom event to an integrated part of the learning process. This integration supports modern assessment theories that emphasize learning as a continuous cycle rather than a final product. Despite the positive outcomes, the study also identified several challenges associated with the implementation of micro-interaction tasks. One of the main issues is the need for careful instructional planning. Tasks must be clearly designed with specific learning objectives in mind; otherwise, they risk becoming repetitive or lacking educational depth.

In addition, effective implementation requires teacher competence in managing rapid interaction cycles. Educators must be able to balance spontaneity with structure, ensuring that short tasks remain meaningful and pedagogically relevant. Without adequate training, there is a risk that micro-interactions may lose their effectiveness.

Another limitation concerns classroom time management. Although tasks are short individually, integrating them frequently requires careful pacing of the lesson. Teachers must ensure that micro-interactions complement rather than disrupt the overall lesson structure.

Conclusion

This study highlights the importance of interaction frequency in communicative language teaching (Richards, 2006). The findings suggest that micro-interaction tasks significantly enhance engagement and communicative competence.

Rather than focusing only on task design, effective language teaching also depends on how often learners interact (Willis, 1996). Regular short interactions improve fluency and confidence more effectively than occasional long speaking tasks.

Micro-interactions contribute to inclusive and dynamic classroom environments by ensuring equal participation opportunities (Harmer, 2015). They also support continuous formative assessment (Brown, 2007). By distributing participation more evenly and reducing affective barriers, they ensure that a greater number of students are actively involved in the learning process. Additionally, their integration into classroom practice provides continuous formative assessment opportunities, allowing teachers to respond more effectively to learner needs.

Overall, micro-interactions represent a practical, flexible, and sustainable model for modern EFL instruction. They are particularly valuable in educational contexts where traditional communicative approaches may be limited by time constraints, large class sizes, or mixed proficiency levels.

Future research may explore technology-enhanced micro-interactions, building on task-based learning principles (Ellis, 2003). Additionally, comparative studies across different educational settings could provide deeper insights into the scalability and long-term effectiveness of this approach.

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THE ROLE OF READING IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING: STRATEGIES, TEXT ANALYSIS, AND COMMUNICATIVE DEVELOPMENT

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Abstract: This article explores the role of reading in foreign language teaching as a fundamental component of language acquisition and communicative competence. It examines reading as a receptive yet

interactive skill and analyzes different types of reading strategies, including skimming, scanning, intensive, and extensive reading. The study also focuses on methodological approaches to working with texts, emphasizing the importance of text selection, pre-reading and post-reading activities, and learner-centered instruction. Special attention is given to the impact of reading on vocabulary development, grammar acquisition, and cognitive skills. The findings suggest that effective integration of reading activities significantly enhances learners' comprehension abilities and overall language proficiency.

Key words: reading skills, foreign language teaching, communicative competence, text analysis, reading strategies, receptive skills, language acquisition

XARICI DİLİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ OXUNUN ROLU: STRATEGİYALAR, MƏTN TƏHLİLİ VƏ KOMMUNİKATİV İNKİŞAF

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Xülasə: Bu məqalədə oxunun xarici dil tədrisində dil mənimsənilməsinin və kommunikativ kompetensiyanın əsas komponenti kimi rolu araşdırılır. Oxu reseptiv, eyni zamanda interaktiv bacarıq kimi təhlil olunur və skimming, skanning, intensiv və ekstensiv oxu kimi müxtəlif oxu strategiyaları izah edilir. Tədqiqatda mətn üzərində işin metodik yanaşmaları, mətn seçiminin əhəmiyyəti, oxudan əvvəl və sonra mərhələlərin təşkili, eləcə də tələbəyönümlü tədris prinsipləri ön plana çəkilir. Həmçinin oxunun lüğət ehtiyatının zənginləşdirilməsinə, qrammatik biliklərin möhkəmləndirilməsinə və idrak bacarıqlarının inkişafına təsiri xüsusi vurğulanır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, oxu fəaliyyətinin düzgün təşkili tələbələrin anlama qabiliyyətini və ümumi dil bacarıqlarını əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə inkişaf etdirir.

Açar sözlər: oxu bacarıqları, xarici dil tədrisi, kommunikativ kompetensiya, mətn təhlili, oxu strategiyaları, reseptiv bacarıqlar, dil mənimsənilməsi

Introduction

In contemporary foreign language pedagogy, the role of reading has gained increasing importance as both a fundamental skill and an effective instructional tool. The ability to comprehend written texts in a foreign language is essential not only for academic success but also for meaningful communication in a globalized world. As a result, the organization of text-based instruction has become a central concern in modern language teaching methodology.

Reading is traditionally classified as a **receptive type of speech activity**, as it involves the perception and interpretation of written language rather than its production. However, recent methodological approaches emphasize that reading is far from a passive process. Instead, it is an active and interactive activity that requires learners to engage cognitively with the text, apply background knowledge, and use various strategies to construct meaning. In this sense, reading contributes significantly to the development of overall communicative competence.

The analysis of methodological literature demonstrates that effective work with texts requires a combination of theoretical knowledge and practical teaching experience. Teachers must be able to select appropriate texts, identify their structural and typological features, and design tasks that facilitate comprehension. Moreover, the effectiveness of reading instruction depends on the learner's level, motivation, and familiarity with the subject matter (Harmer, 2007).

Another important aspect is the dual role of reading in foreign language teaching. On the one hand, it serves as a goal of instruction, as learners aim to develop the ability to understand written texts independently. On the other hand, it functions as a means of language acquisition, supporting the development of vocabulary, grammar, and discourse skills. Through reading, learners are exposed to authentic language input, which helps them internalize linguistic patterns and improve their language performance.

Furthermore, the selection and organization of reading materials play a crucial role in the learning process. Texts used in teaching must correspond to learners' needs, interests, and proficiency levels. Properly chosen materials not only enhance comprehension but also increase motivation and engagement. In addition, the use of different types of reading strategies, such as skimming, scanning, and intensive reading, allows learners to approach texts more effectively. (Grabe, 2009).

Given these considerations, the present article aims to examine the role of reading in foreign language teaching, analyze different types of reading activities, and explore methodological principles for working with texts. Special attention is given to the importance of reading as a communicative skill and its contribution to the development of learners' linguistic and cognitive abilities.

Materials and Methods

This study is based on a qualitative descriptive approach aimed at examining the role of reading in foreign language teaching. The research was conducted with a group of intermediate-level university students learning English as a foreign language. A variety of materials were used, including literary texts, scientific articles, and journalistic texts selected according to students' proficiency level and interests. The instructional process followed three main stages: pre-reading, while-reading, and post-reading activities. During the pre-reading stage, students were introduced to the topic and key vocabulary; during the while-reading stage, they applied strategies such as skimming and scanning to understand the text; and in the post-reading stage, they participated in discussions and summarizing tasks. Data were collected through classroom observation and analysis of students' responses, allowing for evaluation of their comprehension skills and engagement in reading activities.

Results and Discussion

The organization of working with texts in foreign language teaching remains a relevant issue in modern methodology. The analysis of the structural and typological features of texts shows that working with texts requires significant theoretical knowledge and practical experience from teachers. Experienced teachers understand that theoretical knowledge alone cannot always be effective if it is not properly applied in practice.

In textbooks, sufficient space is usually devoted to reading. In foreign language teaching, reading is considered one of the types of speech activity. Its main goal is to teach learners to read and understand texts constructed on the basis of lexical and grammatical material. Reading plays an important role in the successful teaching of foreign languages (Harmer, 2007).

When reading becomes a habit, it significantly improves students' reading skills. Students who regularly read additional materials develop a strong interest in reading and even feel a lack of engagement when they do not read. Therefore, university teachers should carefully consider whether the materials selected for independent or home reading correspond to students' needs and interests.

One of the primary objectives of language teaching is to develop students' oral communication skills, including their ability to understand speech and express their thoughts clearly. In methodological literature, reading has been widely studied both as a goal and as a means in foreign language teaching.

First of all, it should be noted that the reading process involves the perception of ready-made speech models rather than their production. For this reason, reading is defined as a receptive type of speech activity. The effectiveness of reading largely depends on the nature of the texts used. (Grabe, 2009).

Textbooks include a variety of texts, which allow teachers to select appropriate methods depending on the type of text. For example, when working with literary texts (extensive reading), the main attention is paid to their form, including characters, actions, setting, and the grammatical, lexical, and compositional features used in the description.

Depending on the objective, several types of reading are distinguished:

- Skimming reading – general overview of the text
- General reading – reading for overall understanding
- Close reading – detailed study of the text
- Scanning reading – careful reading to find specific information
- Search reading – reading to obtain particular information

Each of these types has a communicative character and collectively serves the purpose of obtaining information. As a type of speech activity, reading contributes to solving communicative tasks, namely understanding the material being read.

During reading, learners inevitably memorize words, phrases, and grammatical patterns, which are later used in speech production. In this sense, reading acts as a means, while the main goal is the comprehension of information (Harmer, 2007).

The title of a text is also an important factor. It serves as a guide to understanding the content and attracts the reader's attention. Previewing a text and attempting to understand it through prediction should be considered a positive outcome.

For example, students should be encouraged to:

- identify the most important information
- determine the main idea
- use their personal experience to understand the text

In recent years, several scientific studies have focused on text adaptation, allowing for the identification of specific characteristics of different types of texts.

It is also important to note that reading can be divided into two groups depending on the conditions of the reading process:

1. Reading for obtaining information (silent reading)
2. Reading for conveying information to others (loud reading)

Thus, the first type is silent reading, while the second is reading aloud. Both types should be mastered by students, but silent reading should be prioritized at all stages of instruction, as it focuses attention on meaning.

Reading should be used effectively as a type of speech activity. Even when literary texts are simplified, they retain their content, characters, relationships, and the author's attitude toward events.

Descriptions of events, characters' actions, and their speech preserve various syntactic and stylistic features, such as parallel structures, repetition, ellipsis, and asyndetic connections. The expressiveness of literary language is achieved through metaphors, comparisons, and irony.

Journalistic and scientific texts have their own specific linguistic and compositional features. Short texts usually convey meaning through a few key ideas, while longer texts are structured into several thematic units. The title and the first paragraph typically introduce the topic and create a thematic background.

When working with texts, several methodological principles should be followed:

1. The text should be presented as a complete unit, regardless of its type.
2. Silent reading should be the main form of work.
3. Attention should be focused on both content and form.
4. Translation should be used only when necessary to demonstrate equivalent expressions.
5. Maximum use should be made of the text's features to achieve teaching objectives.
6. Individual differences among students should be considered.
7. Lexical and grammatical difficulties should be addressed before reading.

Work with texts becomes effective only when teachers clearly understand the objectives of the tasks and guide students accordingly. The main goal of tasks performed during the teaching process is to increase efficiency and achieve better learning outcomes.

Conclusion

In conclusion, reading plays a crucial and multifaceted role in foreign language teaching, functioning both as a primary objective and as an effective means of language acquisition. As a receptive yet highly interactive skill, reading enables learners to access information, develop vocabulary, and internalize grammatical structures while simultaneously enhancing their overall communicative competence.

The analysis presented in this article demonstrates that successful reading instruction depends on several key factors, including the careful selection of texts, the application of appropriate reading strategies, and the consideration of learners' individual needs and abilities. Different types of reading, such as skimming, scanning, intensive, and extensive reading, contribute to the development of diverse comprehension skills and should be systematically integrated into the teaching process.

Moreover, the study highlights the importance of organizing work with texts in a structured manner. The use of pre-reading, while-reading, and post-reading activities ensures a more effective and meaningful engagement with the text. At the same time, teachers must create a supportive learning environment that encourages students to read independently and develop a sustained interest in reading.

It is also evident that reading should not be taught in isolation. Its integration with other language skills—such as speaking, writing, and listening—significantly enhances the overall effectiveness of language learning. Through such integration, reading becomes a powerful tool for developing not only linguistic competence but also critical thinking and cognitive skills.

Ultimately, the effectiveness of reading in foreign language teaching lies in its ability to bridge theoretical knowledge and practical application. When properly implemented, reading fosters learner autonomy, improves comprehension abilities, and contributes to long-term language development. Therefore, it should remain a central component of foreign language instruction and be utilized to its full pedagogical potential.

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FROM THEORY TO TALK: BRIDGING THE GAP BETWEEN CLT AND CLASSROOM INTERACTION

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Abstract: Higher education is undergoing a fundamental pedagogical change from teacher-centered teaching to Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and Interactive Learning in an era characterized by increasing digitalization and the emergence of artificial intelligence. In contrast to language as a static subject of study, this article explores how CLT redefines language as a dynamic tool for social mediation. The study presents a comprehensive framework for contemporary language learning by combining the fundamental theories of Stephen Krashen's Affective Filter and Dell Hymes' communicative competency. The analysis focuses on the methodological change toward optimizing Student Talk Time (STT) through the 20/80 instructional paradigm, the strategic integration of authentic materials (realia), and the reconfiguration in integration with CLT principles produces a strong, flexible approach that is crucial for educating students for the practical and sociocultural requirements of international communication in a tech-driven society.

Key words: communicative, interactive, affective filter, discourse, think-pair-share

NƏZƏRİYYƏDƏN MÜZAKİRƏYƏ: KDT (KOMMUNİKATİV TƏDRİS YANAŞMASI) VƏ SİNİFDAXİLİ QARŞILIQLI ƏLAQƏ ARASINDAKI BOŞLUĞU ARADAN QALDIRMAQ

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Xülasə: Rəqəmsallaşmanın və süni intellektin ortaya çıxmasının artdığı bir dövrdə ali təhsil müəllim mərkəzli təlimdən kommunikativ dil tədrisinə (KDT) və interaktiv təlimə qədər fundamental pedaqoji dəyişikliklərə məruz qalır. Bu məqalə dili statik tədqiqat mövzusu kimi görmək əvəzinə, Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisini dilin sosial qarşılıqlı əlaqə üçün dinamik bir vasitə kimi necə yenidən təsəvvür edildiyini araşdırır. Tədqiqat, S. Kraşenin affektiv filtrinin fundamental nəzəriyyələrini və D.Haymsın kommunikativ səriştəsinin fundamental nəzəriyyələrini birləşdirərək müasir dil öyrənməsi üçün hərtərəfli bir çərçivə təqdim edir. Təhlil, 20/80 öyrənmə paradigması, orijinal materialların strateji inteqrasiyası (realia) və müəllimin fasilitator kimi rolunun yenidən düşünülməsi vasitəsilə tələbələrin danışmağa sərf etdiyi vaxtı optimallaşdırmağa yönəlmiş metodoloji dəyişikliklərə yönəlmişdir. Nəticədə, tədqiqat rəqəmsal inteqrasiyanın KDT-nin prinsipləri ilə birləşməsi texnoloji cəhətdən inkişaf etmiş bir cəmiyyətdə tələbələri beynəlxalq ünsiyyətin praktik və sosiomədəni tələblərinə hazırlamaq üçün vacib olan güclü və çevik bir yanaşma yaratdığı qənaətinə gəlir.

Açar sözlər: kommunikativ, interaktiv, affektive filtr, müzakirə, düşün-uyğunlaşdır-paylaş

Introduction

In an age of rapid digitalization and the dawn of Artificial Intelligence, the landscape of higher education is undergoing a fundamental pedagogical transformation. The present trend is shifting from the traditional teacher-oriented instruction towards Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and Interactive Learning. This framework posits that language is much more than a static object of study, it is a dynamic resource for social mediation and collaborative problem solving. "So, the vast majority of English as a Second Language (ESL) and English as a Foreign Language (EFL) practitioners today refer to 'communicative' as the basic methodology of their lesson planning."

Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) is a radical change in pedagogical theory where interaction and authentic communication are the major means, and the end, of language learning. At the heart of this approach is the notion of communicative competence which is a complex concept encompassing not only grammatical correctness but also the pragmatic capacity to use language appropriately in various social contexts. This technique stems from the social-constructivist perspective that students learn language most effectively when they are actively involved in purposeful, meaningful exchanges rather than passive observation.

One of the key features of CLT is that it intentionally utilizes authentic materials and real-life simulations. The transition from conventional, sterile textbook exercises to modern tools like newspapers, digital media and situational assignments provides educators with a means to bridge the gap between academic theory and practical application. Exposure to realia like this helps learners appreciate the immediate relevance of what they are studying, and develops the skills they will need to cope with the complexities of life beyond the classroom. The motivation to learn, then, is driven by a real internal desire to talk about meaningful things in ways that produce tangible social results.

The implementation of CLT calls for a change in the traditional classroom hierarchy, where teaching is learner-centered. In such conditions, students are actively involved in collaborative structures such as role-plays, pair work, and impromptu discussions in which meaning has to be negotiated on the spot. The instructor is then no longer the principal lecturer, but a facilitator who

provides the scaffolding and support that is necessary to guide students without limiting their communicative autonomy.

In a CLT exercise, the direction is shaped by the participants' unique responses. This keeps students engaged in a lively process that reflects the fluid nature of daily communication. Expert Margie S. Berns emphasizes that language is fundamentally a social activity closely tied to the society in which it operates. (Margie, 2013) Therefore, studying language must go beyond isolated linguistic forms. It should focus on the practical use of discourse within its broader context. This means looking at both the linguistic context, which includes the surrounding flow of conversation, and the socio-situational context, which considers the social roles of the participants and their underlying intent. Ultimately, CLT sees language not as a static subject, but as a living, social tool shaped by the interaction between the speaker, the listener, and their shared world.

In CLT, communicative competence is a multi-faceted construct as a framework, and it extends to a far greater extent than proficiency in syntax or lexicon. This means that the learner has to achieve a functional control of the language, i.e. to be able to use different linguistic forms for different purposes and communicative functions. This competence, besides being useful, needs a very high sociolinguistic sensitivity: the speaker must be able to adjust his discourse according to the context and the social roles of the interlocutors. This includes the subtle discrimination between formal and informal registers as well as the ability to distinguish between the conventions of written and oral communication.

Additionally, communicative competency requires a deep comprehension of discourse patterns, which enables students to create and comprehend a variety of text kinds, from technical reports and narrative structures to impromptu interviews and fluid conversations.

The founder of CLT theoretical framework the sociolinguist Dell Hymes, questioned the dominant emphasis on solely language structures. Hymes presented the seminal idea of communicative competence, arguing that the capacity to use a language code effectively in a social setting is more important than mastering it. (Hymes et al, 2012)

According to his work, true language competency is a societal accomplishment rather than just grammatical accuracy. This paradigm has given rise to a number of significant trends within the philosophy of communicative instruction, such as proficiency-based instruction and notional-functional syllabi, all of which are based on the fundamental idea that language acquisition is a social activity. Accordingly, there are four fundamental aspects of communicative competence that need to be incorporated into the educational process:

- Grammatical Competence that is included phonology, syntax, and lexicon.
- Sociolinguistic Competence which covers social norms and the capacity to discriminate between registers, such as when to use formal vs casual address or politeness cues.
- Discourse Competence in order to arrange disparate statements into a cohesive and coherent whole, whether in a digital email, academic report, or extended conversation.
- Strategic Competence which includes compensatory methods, such as paraphrasing, gesturing, or asking for explanation when language expertise is inadequate, to handle communication breakdowns. (Nunan, 2001) By combining these components, CLT turns the classroom into a miniature version of the actual world, where interaction effectiveness – rather than form perfection – is the key to success.

Materials and Methods

In this setting, methods go beyond typical lectures to become structured, guided experiences, and materials are no longer seen as static "texts" but rather as dynamic tools for interaction. The

"communicative value" of CLT materials, which are expressly created to elicit a response or fulfil a sincere demand for knowledge, is the foundation of their effectiveness. This is accomplished by carefully utilizing realia, or legitimate elements, such as menus, podcasts, and social media feeds, which guarantee that the language's utility and meaning are based on social reality. (William, 2010)

Additionally, information-gap materials are used to generate a functional necessity for communication by giving different pupils various parts of a cognitive jigsaw. These are frequently complemented in the modern classroom by AI driven platforms and scaffolded digital tools that manage "pre communicative" input, saving the actual classroom for high-level production. As a result, task-based rubrics that emphasize successful meaning negotiation over isolated grammatical accuracy are becoming more prevalent in evaluation materials.

The "engine" of this interaction is a system that maximizes Student Talk Time (STT) while keeping the Affective Filter low. The 20/80 Instructional Model operationalizes this, with the teacher serving as both an architect and a facilitator and using only 20% of the class time for modelling and instruction. In order to prioritize fluency over accuracy, the remaining 80% is devoted to student-led collaborative projects.

Before students participate in independent practice, the MUD framework (Meaning, Use, Demonstration) makes sure that every linguistic notion is contextually established and modelled. (Lee, 2000)

Collaborative learning frameworks like Think-Pair-Share and the Jigsaw method, which foster a structural demand for peer interaction and boost individual confidence, further add methodological depth. Delayed correction, in which the instructor keeps track of and documents mistakes made during the interaction phase but saves feedback for a post-task session to prevent interfering with the communicative flow, is a crucial methodological decision in this framework. Lastly, the methodological integration of digitization is progressively defining the modern CLT scene. While synchronous digital tools like breakout rooms and collaborative documents provide real-time problem resolution, strategies like the flipped classroom allow students to interact asynchronously with the "Meaning" and "Use" of language.

Results and Discussion

Stephen Krashen's Monitor Model, especially the distinction between acquisition and learning, has a significant impact on the practical implementation of CLT. According to Krashen, learning entails the deliberate study of formal rules, while acquisition is a subconscious process of internalizing language through meaningful experience. (Dr. Manvender Kaur Singh, 2020). The Affective Filter Hypothesis, which identifies a set of psychological factors – specifically, drive, self-confidence, and anxiety – that either facilitate or obstruct linguistic information, is fundamental to this differentiation.

According to Krashen, the affective filter is a metaphorical psychological wall that "rises" when a learner is experiencing elevated levels of stress, fear, or humiliation. This effectively blocks the cognitive processing of input and prevents acquisition. On the other hand, the learner becomes more open to input when the filter is "lowered" through a feeling of psychological safety and strong motivation, which promotes a more organic and effective acquisition process. This theory gives CLT practitioners a crucial mandate for instructional design and classroom management. The main goal of implementation is to reduce learner anxiety by establishing a "low-stress" atmosphere. Teachers can keep the affective filter low by emphasizing fluency over quick error correction and promoting risk-taking through group projects. The classroom becomes a place where pupils are

emotionally accessible to process language in such a setting, facilitating the shift from formal study to genuine, subconscious acquisition.

The Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) paradigm's steadfast dedication to genuine, everyday communication is one of its defining characteristics. Within this framework, classroom activities are carefully crafted to replicate the variety of interactions that students are likely to have in both their personal and professional life. Through role-plays, simulations, and cooperative problem-solving exercises, students transcend memorization of phrases and employ the target language as a useful tool to accomplish particular, goal-oriented objectives. The open-ended nature of these communicative tasks is a crucial aspect. These kinds of exercises are essential for developing strategic adaptability, which enables students to handle unforeseen social twists and sustain real-time communication. The methodical incorporation of realia, or authentic materials, complements these interactive tactics. The classroom setting is grounded in the sociolinguistic reality of the target language through the use of social media conversation, multimedia movies, and current news articles. These resources expose students to a variety of registers, colloquial idioms, and cultural subtleties, giving them an unvarnished perspective on how language works in context. Students develop a sophisticated pragmatic awareness through the interpretation and response to these real-world inputs, ensuring that their language abilities are not just theoretical but are well-prepared for the demands of the globalized world.

Perhaps the most important practical change in the Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) paradigm is the restructuring of the educator's identity. In a CLT framework, the instructor serves as a learning architect, facilitator, and communication guide rather than the conventional role of a "sage on the stage" or a key source of knowledge transmission. (Larsen-Freeman, 2000). This transformation implies a shift away from teacher-centred lecturing and toward a model in which the educator's main duty is to create and administer an environment that demands meaningful interaction. The teacher maintains the pupils' fluency and safeguards the integrity of the "Affective Filter" by giving delayed feedback instead of prompt correction. Additionally, rather than just modeling isolated right forms, the educator frequently takes on the role of a communicator by engaging in activities that mirror natural language use, social cues, and pragmatic tactics. In this situation, assessment takes on a parallel change: the teacher assesses the student's broader communicative competence – their capacity to use language successfully to accomplish a functional purpose within a particular social context – in addition to grammatical accuracy. In the end, a CLT practitioner's success is determined by the quantity and caliber of Student Talk Time (STT) generated rather than the lucidity of their grammatical explanations. The degree to which students effectively negotiated meaning and completed the task's functional requirements determines how effective the class was, signifying the teacher's shift from an authoritative lecturer to a strategic facilitator of practical skills.

Conclusion

The incorporation of authentic materials is a crucial link between pedagogical theory and linguistic reality in the Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) framework. These tools, which include unedited newspaper articles, impromptu podcast segments, and authentic social media discourse, are essential because they show students how language naturally functions in its natural setting. Authentic materials capture the intricacies of natural language, in contrast to scripted textbook dialogues, which are frequently artificially created to emphasize particular grammatical points. They have a variety of discourse indicators, broken sentences, colloquial registers, and cultural subtleties that controlled exercises just cannot match.

Developing sociolinguistic and discourse competency is the main goal of using these resources. By interacting with "realia," students get the capacity to decipher the functional language patterns they will come across outside of the classroom and negotiate the unpredictability of human contact. In this paradigm, communicative relevance – rather than just linguistic complexity – determines the choice of elements. For example, a learner in a professional setting might interact with real email exchanges or meetings that have been recorded, but a general learner might examine current news clips or recordings of regular conversations. Communicative authenticity is ultimately the requirement for inclusion in a CLT syllabus. Teachers make sure that language learning is not only a theoretical exercise but a strong preparation for the practical challenges of international communication by basing lessons on materials that have cultural depth and real-world implications. This exposure permits learners to advance beyond the "sanitized" versions of language offered in traditional courses, promoting a more flexible and sophisticated command of their target language.

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ACQUISITION-BASED ELT: METHODS, SKILLS, AND EVALUATION

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Abstract: The main purpose of this article is to investigate modern methods and approaches in teaching English. Not only analyze the role of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), but also explain ways to improve foreign language skills, and use methods. Special attention is given to the theoretical contributions of prominent scholars in the field, including Stephen Krashen's Input Hypothesis (i+1) and

other influential models of cognitive and social linguistic development. The research explores the practical application of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and interactive strategies designed to foster student engagement. Moreover, it details systematic approaches to enhancing the four fundamental language skills - listening, speaking, reading, and writing - within a balanced instructional context. The final section of the paper addresses contemporary measurement and assessment techniques, evaluating their role in monitoring linguistic progress and ensuring pedagogical effectiveness. By bridging classical acquisition theories with modern classroom practices, this article offers a multifaceted perspective on optimizing English language education in the 21st century.

Keywords: ELT, Second Language Acquisition, Communicative Competence, Pedagogical Theories, Four Language Skills, Assessment and Evaluation, Interactive Learning.

MƏNİMSƏMƏYƏ ƏSASLANAN İNGİLİS DİLİ TƏHSİLİ: METODLAR, BACARIQLAR VƏ QIYMƏTLƏNDİRMƏ

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Xülasə: Bu məqalənin əsas məqsədi ingilis dilinin tədrisində müasir metod və yanaşmaları araşdırmaqdır. Yalnız Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisinin (KDT) rolunu təhlil etməklə yanaşı, həm də xarici dil bacarıqlarının inkişaf etdirməyin yollarını və metodlardan istifadəni izah edir. Xüsusi diqqət Stiven Kraşenin Giriş Hipotezası (i+1) və koqnitiv və sosial linqvistik inkişafın digər təsirli modelləri də daxil olmaqla, bu sahədəki görkəmli alimlərin nəzəri töhfələrinə verilir. Tədqiqatda Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisinin (KDT) və şagirdlərin fəallığını artırmaq üçün hazırlanmış interaktiv strategiyaların praktik tətbiqi araşdırılır. Bundan əlavə, balanslaşdırılmış tədris kontekstində dörd əsas dil bacarığını - dinləmə, danışma, oxuma və yazma bacarıqlarının inkişaf etdirmək üçün sistemli yanaşmalar ətraflı şəkildə izah olunur. Məqalənin son hissəsində müasir ölçmə və qiymətləndirmə texnikaları, onların linqvistik irəliləyişin monitorinqində və pedaqoji effektivliyin təmin edilməsindəki rolunun qiymətləndirilməsi nəzərdən keçirilir. Klassik öyrənmə nəzəriyyələrini müasir sinif təcrübələri ilə əlaqələndirərək, bu məqalə 21-ci əsrdə ingilis dili təhsilinin optimallaşdırılmasına dair çoxşaxəli bir perspektiv təklif edir.

Açar sözlər: İngilis dili tədrisi (ELT), ikinci dilin qazanılması, kommunikativ bacarıq, pedaqoji nəzəriyyələr, dörd dil bacarığı, qiymətləndirmə və dəyərləndirmə, interaktiv təlim.

Introduction

In today's globalized world, English has gone beyond being simply a foreign language and has become a fundamental lingua franca for international communication, as well as for science and technology. As the demand for English proficiency continues to rise, teaching approaches are shifting from traditional, teacher-centered methods to more dynamic and student-centered practices.

The primary objective of modern English Language Teaching (ELT) is no longer just the rote memorization of grammatical rules, but the development of communicative competence. This requires a comprehensive combination of the four main language skills: *listening, speaking, reading, and writing*. In addition, the realization of interactive strategies and innovative assessment methods is necessary in creating an engaging learning environment that satisfy to diverse learner needs.

Materials and Methods

This study employs an analytical and practice-oriented methodology, focusing on the synthesis of linguistic theories and their application in the classroom. The research framework is built upon the following components:

- **Theoretical Framework:** The study draws on the principles of Second Language Acquisition (SLA), primarily focusing on **Stephen Krashen's Input Hypothesis** and the concept of "comprehensible input." Additionally, it integrates socio-constructivist views from various prominent authors to support the importance of interactive learning.
- **Instructional Materials and Activities:** The core of the practical analysis consists of specific communicative tasks. The article examines and provides examples of **Role-play** and **Information Gap activities**, analyzing how these techniques reduce the "affective filter" and encourage natural speech production.
- **Methodological Approach:** A qualitative analysis of **Communicative Language Teaching (CLT)** is presented. The study demonstrates how integrating these interactive strategies facilitates the development of the four macro skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

Results and Discussion

One of widespread approach is traditional teacher-centered method. It mainly focuses on grammar translation and memorization. However, this method is not effective. Because the students are not acquiring language. Turning to modern pedagogy is not based mechanical memorization of grammar rules and long vocabulary. Instead, it emphasizes **Communicative Competence**. As **H. Douglas Brown** suggests, *"effective teaching is not a set of "tricks," but a grounded transition from theoretical understanding to classroom practice"*.

According to Brown, teacher should bases her lessons on scientific proof, not her feeling or mood. It should be a systematic process, not a blind one. Old knowledge should connected new informations. When information is not associated with old knowledge, the brain sees is as a "foreign object" and forgets it a short time. This process is fundamentally based on by **Stephen Krashen's (1985) Input Hypothesis**, specifically the formula **i + 1**. In this model, 'i+1' represents the learner's current level of competence, while **i+1** signifies the linguistic input that is just one step beyond that level. Modern methods ensure that by providing this 'comprehensible input,' teachers facilitate a natural and seamless evolution in the student's **interlanguage**. This strategic exposure allows learners to bridge the gap between their existing knowledge and the target language. Thus, learning becomes both challenging and achievable.

One of H. Douglas Brown's most important contributions is his emphasis on the concept of the **Language Ego**. He argues that learning a second language requires the development of a "second identity", and this identity, especially in the early stages of language acquisition, is often vulnerable and defenseless. This feeling of vulnerability can cause learners to feel anxious, afraid of making mistakes, or hesitant to actively participate in communication.

To address this problem, teachers are advised to use **scaffolding techniques**. This method allows students temporary support. If the students acquire the lesson, the teacher reduce this support. These are some types:

- Guided practice,
- Modeling,
- Visual aids,

- Structured activities,
- Constructive feedback.

In short, scaffolding is the principle of “help me until I can do it myself”. Furthermore, effective scaffolding plays a crucial role in building learners’ self-confidence. When students feel supported and experience small successes, they become more willing to take risks, experiment with language, and engage in meaningful communication. This process not only strengthens their linguistic abilities but also reduces anxiety and fosters a positive learning environment.

Another effective method is the **Direct Method**. It emerged as a response to the limitations of the Grammar-Translation Method. Its main idea was that a second language should be acquired in a natural way, similar to how a first language is learned, without relying on translation. In this approach, the target language was used absolutely in the classroom, encouraging learners to think directly in the new language. Grammar was not explained explicitly; instead, students were expected to discover rules on their own through exposure and practice. A strong emphasis was also placed on speaking skills and accurate pronunciation. From the perspective of H. Douglas Brown, although the Direct Method has more advantages, but it has not been scientifically proven.

In Additionally, there is **Audio-Lingual Method (ALM)**, which became popular in the mid-20th century, was based on behaviorist psychology and the idea that language learning is essentially habit formation. According to this approach, learning occurs through a process of stimulus, response, and reinforcement. In practice, this meant that students engaged in repetitive drills, memorized dialogues, and used techniques such as mimicry and memorization (“mim-mem”). The main goal was to achieve high levels of accuracy and to avoid errors, particularly those caused by interference from the learner’s native language.

Overall, Brown points out that ALM placed too much emphasis on the structural aspects of language and not enough on meaning. Because learners were often repeating sentences without fully understanding them, they found it difficult to use the language in real-life situations where communication is unpredictable and requires flexibility. As a result, although students could produce correct forms, they often lacked true communicative competence.

Compared to the modern method, ALM is done by repeating the same thing over and over again like a parrot. However, this method is not useful. In contrast, in the modern method, you master the language more through real tasks such as role-plays.

Another important shift is the shift from accuracy to fluency. Whereas previous methods expected learners to use language correctly immediately, modern pedagogy accepts errors as a natural part of the learning process. Mistakes are beginning a perfect result. In this context, making mistakes is not seen as a failure, but rather as a crucial step for effective communication and long-term language development. This approach is found in the Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) method. Communicative Language Teaching: Saying "How", not "What"

Error tolerance: One of the most important points in this method is the approach to errors. Instead of immediately correcting every small grammatical error, the teacher prefers to convey the idea to the other party. This eliminates the "fear of speaking" in the student.

Functionality: Language is learned in a real-life setting – functional skills such as ordering in a restaurant, making a complaint or giving advice come to the fore.

These are the primary strategies for acquiring the language in CLT method:

1. **Role-playing:** Students act out real-life scenarios by taking on different roles. For example, one student becomes a seller and the other a buyer. This also develops the emotional side of the language and body language.

2. Discussion and Debate: Discussions about a actual topic exposes the student to language and forces them to speak.

3. Information Gap: Students learn information which they don't know by asking each other questions. This method based on real communication. Also improves speaking skills.

These approaches are more effective

Increased motivation: When a student sees that he can use the language, his self-confidence increases.

Permanent learning: Although memorized words are quickly forgotten, expressions used with laughter or excitement during a dialogue are permanently etched in the memory.

Social adaptation: Students learn to work in a team and understand different accents.

To sum up, language is not a set of rules that remain between walls, but a living mechanism that builds bridges between people. Also to build this bridge, it is not enough to just "read", you need to "speak" and "live".

Expanding this topic, let's look at developing Foreign Language Skills: Listening, Speaking, Reading, and Writing. Effective communication in a second language requires the balanced development of four fundamental skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. According to William Littlewood in *Communicative Language Teaching: An Introduction*, language learning should focus not only on grammatical competence but also on communicative competence – the ability to use language meaningfully and appropriately in real-life situations.

Listening Competence: Listening is fundamental skills of language development. It is a receptive skills that enables individuals to understand spoken language in a variety of contexts. Listening is a active cognitive process. Based on the ideas of William Littlewood, students are exposed to real dialogues and receive input in this process. Teacher assist learners in connecting their exist knowledge with new informaton during the pre-listening and post-listening activites. This makes the learning process more effective.

Speaking skills: Speaking is tool for communication and learners demonstrates thoughts with easily. Little wood categorizes these activities into two main groups: **functional communicative tasks** (aimed at specific outcomes like problem-solving) and **social interaction activities** (such as improvisational role-plays). During the speaking, teacher should focus on fluent, not grammar mistakes.

Reading Skills: Reading serves as a vital receptive channel for expanding vocabulary and deepening contextual understanding. So, the learners was focused on things like "what does this word mean?" As discussed in the previous section, CLT prefers reading for meaning. The main idea in CLT is not understand every word, but to understand the general meaning.

Writing Abilities: Writing is more difficult than other skills. Writing is not just about arranging sentences one after another, it is about logically and consistetly. According CLT method, writing is not ust about grammar activities, it is a means of communication.

The Integration of Skills

The language is a unit. In real life, we don't separate language into just speaking or just listening. For instance: You are sitting in a cafe, reading the menu and hearing the waiter's question and answering it. As you can see, you have combined three different skills: reading, listening and speaking.

To conclude, learning language is like a puzzle. Reading, writing, speaking, listening are all part of that puzzle. When you put them together, you get a complete picture in real situation. Littlewood outlined this system and Krashen proved that when we use these parts together,

language stops being a “burden” and becomes a “skill”. The integration of these skills absolutely leads to the question of how they are measured and evaluated in an academic setting. Measurement is the numerical representation of a student’s knowledge, such as score on a test. Evaluation is the interpretation of these results. That is the teacher uses these scores to determine students’ level.

Contemporary ELT classrooms often utilize:

- **Portfolios:** Long-term collections of student work that demonstrate progress over time.
- **Self and Peer-Assessment:** Encouraging learners to develop metacognitive skills by assessing their own linguistic output.
- **Task-Based Assessment:** Evaluating language use through real-world scenarios, such as solving a problem.

Conclusion

This research highlights that contemporary English language teaching has gradually moved away from a strict focus on grammar rules toward more flexible, communication based approach. As evidenced by Stephen Krashen’s Input Hypothesis and H. Douglas Brown’s emphasis on the “Language Ego”, creating a supportive environment that provides “comprehensible input” is crucial for reducing learner anxiety and fostering natural acquisition. Moreover, the findings reveal that successful communication depends on the harmonious development of the four core skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. When these skills are taught together through engaging techniques such as role-plays and information-gap tasks, language learning transforms from a theoretical obligation into a meaningful and practical ability. In summary, language is not merely a set of rules confined within classroom walls; it is a living mechanism that builds bridges between people. To successfully build these bridges, it is not enough for learners to simply "read" or memorize; they must "speak" and "live" the language in real-world contexts. Future pedagogical practices should continue to prioritize communicative competence to ensure that students are not just linguistically correct, but socially and functionally proficient in a globalized world.

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STUDENT-CENTERED APPROACHES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING: INSIGHTS FROM TKT AND TESOL

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Abstract: In recent years, English language teaching has gradually shifted from teacher-centered practices to approaches that emphasize the active role of learners. This change is based on the understanding that language learning becomes more effective when students participate actively in the learning process rather than passively receiving information. Within this context, student-centered approaches have gained increasing importance in modern educational environments.

This study explores how student-centered principles are reflected in widely used frameworks such as TKT and TESOL. These frameworks highlight the need to create a learning environment where students are encouraged to communicate, interact, and take responsibility for their own learning. Classroom activities such as pair work, group discussions, and role-play are frequently used to support this approach, as they allow learners to practice language in meaningful and realistic contexts.

In addition, particular attention is given to the development of the four core language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. These skills are most effectively developed when integrated through interactive and task-based activities, which make the learning process more engaging and purposeful.

Another important aspect is the changing role of the teacher. In student-centered classrooms, the teacher acts as a facilitator who guides and supports learners rather than simply delivering information. This shift helps increase student motivation, reduce anxiety, and build confidence.

Overall, the findings suggest that student-centered approaches, supported by TKT and TESOL principles, contribute to more effective and engaging English language teaching practices.

Keywords: student-centered learning, English language teaching, TKT, TESOL, communicative competence, interactive activities, learner autonomy

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ TƏLƏBƏYÖNÜMLÜ YANAŞMALAR: TKT VƏ TESOL-DAN BAXIŞLAR

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Xülasə: Son illərdə ingilis dili tədrisində müəllim mərkəzli yanaşmalardan tədrisən tələbə mərkəzli yanaşmalara keçid müşahidə olunur. Bu dəyişiklik ondan irəli gəlir ki, dil öyrənmə prosesi yalnız məlumatın təqdim olunması ilə deyil, eyni zamanda tələbələrin həmin prosesdə fəal iştirak etməsi ilə daha səmərəli olur. Bu baxımdan tələbə mərkəzli yanaşmalar müasir təhsil mühitində getdikcə daha böyük əhəmiyyət qazanır.

Bu məqalədə tələbə mərkəzli yanaşmaların TKT və TESOL kimi geniş yayılmış tədris çərçivələrində necə əks olunduğu araşdırılır. Bu yanaşmalar tələbələrin dərş prosesində aktiv iştirakını, qarşılıqlı ünsiyyətini və öz öyrənmə proseslərinə məsuliyyətlə yanaşmasını təşviq edir. Cütlərlə iş, qrup müzakirələri və rol oyunları kimi fəaliyyətlər tələbələrə dili daha real və mənalı situasiyalarda istifadə etməyə imkan yaradır.

Bununla yanaşı, dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı bacarıqlarının birlikdə inkişaf etdirilməsi xüsusi əhəmiyyət kəsb edir. Bu bacarıqların interaktiv və tapşırıq əsaslı fəaliyyətlər vasitəsilə inkişaf etdirilməsi öyrənmə prosesini daha maraqlı və effektiv edir.

Eyni zamanda müəllimin rolu da dəyişir; o artıq yalnız məlumat verən deyil, həm də istiqamət verən və dəstək göstərən şəxs kimi çıxış edir. Belə mühitdə tələbələrin motivasiyası artır, həyəcan azalır və özünə inam güclənir.

Ümumilikdə, TKT və TESOL prinsiplərinə əsaslanan tələbə mərkəzli yanaşmalar ingilis dili tədrisini daha səmərəli və interaktiv edir.

Açar sözlər: tələbə mərkəzli təlim, ingilis dili tədrisi, TKT, TESOL, kommunikativ kompetensiya, interaktiv fəaliyyətlər, öyrənmə muxtariyyəti

Introduction

Over the past decades, English language teaching has undergone substantial pedagogical and methodological changes, particularly in the shift from traditional teacher-centered instruction toward more learner-centered approaches. This transformation reflects a growing recognition in applied linguistics that language acquisition is most effective when learners are actively engaged in meaningful communication and interaction rather than passively receiving knowledge. As Richards and Rodgers (2014) emphasize, modern language teaching approaches place strong emphasis on interaction, communicative competence, and learner participation as essential components of successful language learning.

Within this framework, student-centered approaches have become a central focus in contemporary language education. According to Nunan (2004), learner-centered instruction prioritizes learners' needs, interests, and autonomy, encouraging them to take responsibility for their own learning process. The teacher's role gradually shifts from being the primary source of knowledge to acting as a facilitator who supports and guides learning.

The theoretical foundation of this approach is supported by Vygotsky's (1978) sociocultural theory, which highlights that learning develops through social interaction and collaborative processes. From this perspective, language learning is not an individual act but a socially constructed process.

Research

Research in English language teaching has increasingly shifted toward learner-centered pedagogical paradigms that emphasize active participation, collaboration, and meaningful communication. This transition is largely driven by the recognition that language learning is not a passive process of information reception, but rather an active process of meaning construction through interaction. As Nunan (2004) explains, learner autonomy is a central factor in successful language acquisition, as it enables students to take responsibility for planning, monitoring, and evaluating their own learning progress.

From a methodological perspective, TKT principles provide practical guidance for implementing student-centered instruction in real classroom contexts. Cambridge English (2013) emphasizes the importance of maximizing student talk time (STT) and minimizing teacher talk time (TTT), which ensures that learners are actively engaged in using the language. Classroom techniques such as pair work, group discussions, information-gap tasks, and role-play activities are widely recommended as effective tools for promoting interaction. These techniques not only enhance linguistic performance but also encourage cooperation, negotiation of meaning, and peer learning.

In a similar way, TESOL standards stress the importance of creating inclusive, supportive, and interactive learning environments where learners feel confident to participate (TESOL International Association, 2020). Within this framework, teachers are expected to design learner-centered lessons that accommodate diverse learning styles, proficiency levels, and cultural backgrounds. Scrivener (2011) further highlights that effective teaching involves balancing structure with flexibility, ensuring that learners are guided while still being given space for exploration and discovery.

The theoretical foundation of student-centered approaches can be traced back to Vygotsky's (1978) sociocultural theory, which argues that cognitive development occurs through social interaction within the Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD). From this perspective, learning is enhanced when students collaborate with peers and receive scaffolding from teachers. Similarly, Larsen-Freeman and Anderson (2011) emphasize that task-based language teaching allows learners to acquire language through meaningful tasks that reflect real-life communication.

Communicative language teaching (CLT), as described by Richards (2006), further supports this view by focusing on language use in authentic contexts rather than mechanical grammar practice. Thornbury (2005) adds that speaking activities such as role-play, debates, and problem-solving tasks significantly reduce learner anxiety while increasing fluency and confidence.

In addition, the teacher's role in student-centered classrooms has undergone a fundamental transformation. Instead of being the primary source of knowledge, the teacher acts as a facilitator, organizer, and guide who supports learners throughout the learning process (Harmer, 2015). This shift contributes to a more democratic classroom environment where learners feel valued and motivated to participate.

Furthermore, student-centered approaches also contribute to the development of higher-order thinking skills. When learners are encouraged to analyze, evaluate, and create meaning through language use, they develop not only linguistic competence but also critical thinking and problem-solving abilities. This holistic development is considered one of the key advantages of modern language teaching methodologies.

Another important aspect is the integration of technology and multimedia tools in student-centered classrooms. Digital resources, interactive platforms, and online communication tools provide learners with additional opportunities for practice and exposure to authentic language input. These tools further enhance engagement and support individualized learning paths.

Overall, the combination of TKT and TESOL principles provides a strong pedagogical framework for effective English language teaching. By promoting interaction, autonomy, and communicative competence, student-centered approaches create dynamic learning environments that support both linguistic and cognitive development.

Conclusion

In conclusion, student-centered approaches in English language teaching represent a significant shift in modern pedagogy. Supported by TKT and TESOL principles, these approaches encourage learner participation, interaction, and autonomy. The findings suggest that such methods improve motivation, reduce anxiety, and enhance language learning outcomes. Therefore, student-centered teaching is essential for effective and modern English language education.

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ENHANCING YOUNG LEARNERS' ENGAGEMENT IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE CLASSES: CONTEMPORARY PEDAGOGICAL APPROACHES AND CLASSROOM PRACTICES

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Abstract: This study examines contemporary challenges in enhancing young learners' engagement in English as a Foreign Language (EFL) classrooms. It focuses on the role of interactive teaching approaches such as game-based learning, pair and group work, and communicative activities in increasing student participation and motivation. A qualitative research design was employed, including classroom observations, experimental teaching sessions, and reflective analysis. The findings demonstrate that student-centered methods significantly improve learners' engagement, communication skills, and confidence. Game-based activities reduce anxiety and foster a supportive learning environment, while collaborative tasks enhance peer interaction and active involvement. The study also identifies key factors affecting engagement, including teacher competence, classroom management, and resource availability. The results suggest that integrating communicative and interactive strategies leads to more effective and dynamic language learning environments. This research offers practical implications for educators seeking to promote active learning and improve teaching outcomes. Additionally, the study highlights the importance of adapting teaching strategies to learners' individual needs and learning styles.

Keywords: young learners, engagement, communicative approach, game-based learning, motivation, collaborative learning

İNGİLİS DİLİ DƏRSLƏRİNDƏ KİÇİKYAŞLI ŞAĞİRDŁƏRİN FƏALLIĞININ ARTIRILMASI: MÜASİR PEDAQOJİ YANAŞMALAR VƏ SİNİFDAXİLİ TƏCRÜBƏLƏR

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Xülasə: Bu tədqiqat ingilis dili dərslərində kiçikyaşlı şagirdlərin fəallığının artırılması ilə bağlı müasir problemləri araşdırır. Araşdırmada oyun əsaslı öyrənmə, cüt və qrup işi, kommunikativ fəaliyyətlər kimi interaktiv metodların şagirdlərin motivasiyasına və dərstdə iştirakına təsiri təhlil edilmişdir. Tədqiqat əsasən keyfiyyət metodlarına söykənmiş, dərs müşahidələri, müəllim-şagird qarşılıqlı əlaqələrinin təhlili və eksperimental tətbiqlər həyata keçirilmişdir. Əldə olunan nəticələr göstərir ki, şagirdyönümlü yanaşmalar onların fəallığını, ünsiyyət bacarıqlarını, tənqidi düşünmə qabiliyyətlərini və özünəinamını əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır. Oyunlar şagirdlərdə maraq və motivasiya yaradır, qrup işi isə əməkdaşlığı, sosial bacarıqları və məsuliyyət hissini gücləndirir. Bununla yanaşı, müəllimin peşəkarlığı, dərsin planlaşdırılması, istifadə olunan resurslar və müsbət psixoloji mühit də şagirdlərin fəallığına birbaşa təsir göstərir. Nəticə etibarilə, interaktiv və kommunikativ metodların sistemli tətbiqi daha effektiv, maraqlı və dinamik öyrənmə mühitinin formalaşmasına şərait yaradır.

Bundan əlavə, fərqli öyrənmə üslublarının nəzərə alınması dərsin daha inklüziv olmasına kömək edir. Müasir texnologiyalardan istifadə şagirdlərin diqqətini cəlb etməyi asanlaşdırır və öyrənmə prosesini daha maraqlı edir. Müəllimlərin davamlı peşəkar inkişafı bu metodların effektiv tətbiqi üçün vacibdir.

Açar sözlər: şagird fəallığı, kommunikativ yanaşma, oyun əsaslı öyrənmə, motivasiya, qrup işi

Introduction

Student engagement is considered a crucial factor in successful language learning, especially in English as a Foreign Language (EFL) contexts. Traditional teacher-centered instruction often limits students' participation and reduces their motivation to learn. In contrast, contemporary educational approaches emphasize learner-centered environments where interaction, collaboration, and communication play a central role.

Young learners, in particular, require dynamic and engaging instructional strategies to sustain attention and actively participate in classroom activities. This study explores how modern teaching methods—such as game-based learning, pair and group work, and communicative tasks – can enhance student engagement and improve learning outcomes.

Materials and Methods

This study employs a qualitative research design aimed at examining how contemporary pedagogical approaches influence young learners' engagement in English as a Foreign Language (EFL) classrooms. A qualitative approach was selected due to its effectiveness in analyzing classroom interaction, learner behavior, and engagement patterns in natural educational contexts (Creswell, 2014).

The research was conducted in primary and lower secondary school settings, involving learners aged between 8 and 12 with mixed proficiency levels. This diversity allowed for a broader understanding of how different instructional strategies affect learners with varying linguistic abilities (Pinter, 2017).

The study followed an action research framework, which enabled the researcher to implement teaching interventions, observe their effects, and reflect on instructional practices (Burns, 2010). This approach ensured continuous improvement and deeper insight into classroom processes.

Data Collection Procedures

Multiple data collection tools were used to ensure validity and reliability:

- **Classroom observations:** Observations were conducted during both traditional and interactive lessons to compare student engagement levels. Special attention was given to participation, interaction, and behavioral responses (Harmer, 2007).
- **Teacher reflective journals:** The researcher documented each lesson, focusing on teaching methods, student reactions, and challenges encountered (Farrell, 2015).
- **Student participation tracking:** Engagement was assessed based on students' willingness to participate, frequency of responses, and involvement in tasks (Fredricks et al., 2004).
- **Informal feedback:** Students' attitudes toward activities were also considered through informal observation and discussion.

Experimental Procedure. The research was conducted in two phases:

1. Baseline Phase (Traditional Instruction): During the baseline phase, instruction was conducted using predominantly teacher-centered methods, which are commonly observed in traditional EFL classrooms. The teaching process relied heavily on textbook-based activities, grammar explanations, and controlled practice exercises. The teacher assumed the primary role as a knowledge provider, while students were mainly passive recipients of information (Scrivener, 2011).

Classroom interaction during this phase was limited. Most communication followed a teacher–student pattern, with minimal opportunities for peer interaction. Students were typically asked to respond to direct questions or complete individual tasks, often focusing on accuracy rather than meaningful communication. As a result, the use of the target language was restricted and lacked authentic context (Harmer, 2007).

Observation data indicated that student participation levels were relatively low. Only a small number of learners actively contributed to classroom discussions, while the majority remained silent or disengaged. This suggests that traditional instructional approaches may not sufficiently address the diverse learning needs and motivational factors of young learners (Pinter, 2017).

From an emotional perspective, students appeared less enthusiastic and less motivated during lessons. Some learners showed signs of anxiety when required to speak, likely due to fear of making mistakes in a teacher-dominated environment (Dörnyei, 2001).

Cognitively, the activities in this phase primarily focused on lower-order thinking skills, such as memorization and repetition. Opportunities for critical thinking, problem-solving, and creative language use were limited. Consequently, students' engagement remained superficial and did not fully support deeper language acquisition processes (Piaget, 2001).

Overall, the baseline phase provided a reference point for evaluating the effectiveness of interactive teaching methods introduced in the subsequent intervention phase. The findings from this stage highlight the limitations of traditional instruction in fostering active engagement and meaningful language use.

2. Intervention Phase (Interactive Instruction): During the intervention phase, the instructional approach shifted from teacher-centered to student-centered practices, with a strong emphasis on interaction, collaboration, and meaningful language use. A variety of contemporary

pedagogical strategies were systematically integrated into the teaching process to enhance student engagement and participation.

The lessons incorporated game-based learning activities, which were designed to reinforce vocabulary, grammar, and speaking skills in an enjoyable and low-anxiety environment. These activities encouraged students to participate actively, as they were motivated by both the competitive and entertaining nature of games (Wright et al., 2006). As a result, even less confident learners became more involved in classroom tasks.

In addition, pair and group work were widely implemented to promote collaboration and peer interaction. Students were assigned tasks that required communication, idea exchange, and joint problem-solving. This approach not only increased participation but also allowed learners to practice the target language in a more natural and supportive context (Richards & Rodgers, 2014). The classroom atmosphere became more dynamic, with learners actively engaging with each other rather than relying solely on the teacher.

Another key component of this phase was the use of communicative activities, including role-plays, dialogues, and real-life situation tasks. These activities provided students with opportunities to use language meaningfully and develop their speaking and listening skills. Learners demonstrated increased fluency and confidence as they engaged in authentic communication (Nation & Newton, 2009).

Furthermore, the teacher's role evolved into that of a facilitator, guiding students through activities, providing feedback, and creating a supportive learning environment. This shift allowed students to take greater responsibility for their learning and encouraged independent thinking (Harmer, 2007).

Observations indicated a significant improvement in all dimensions of engagement. Behaviorally, students participated more actively in tasks and discussions. Emotionally, they showed greater enthusiasm and interest in learning activities. Cognitively, they demonstrated deeper understanding and problem-solving abilities. Socially, collaboration among students increased, leading to more effective communication and peer support (Fredricks et al., 2004). Despite these positive outcomes, certain challenges remained, such as managing large groups, addressing different proficiency levels, and ensuring equal participation among students. However, overall, the intervention phase proved that interactive and communicative teaching methods significantly enhance student engagement and contribute to more effective language learning outcomes.

Evaluation Criteria

Student engagement was evaluated based on the following indicators:

- Active participation in tasks
- Frequency and quality of interaction
- Motivation and emotional involvement
- Use of target language in meaningful contexts

These criteria reflect the nature of engagement, including behavioral, emotional, and cognitive aspects (Fredricks et al., 2004).

Results and Discussion

The findings indicate a significant increase in student engagement following the implementation of interactive teaching methods. The results highlight the effectiveness of student-centered approaches in fostering active learning environments.

Behavioral Engagement. Behavioral engagement refers to the observable actions of students in the learning process, including participation in classroom activities, attentiveness, effort, and

persistence. In the context of this study, behavioral engagement was assessed through students' involvement in tasks, frequency of responses, and willingness to participate in both individual and collaborative activities (Fredricks et al., 2004). During the intervention phase, a noticeable increase in behavioral engagement was observed. Students actively participated in classroom discussions, volunteered to answer questions, and showed greater readiness to engage in learning tasks. Unlike the baseline phase, where participation was limited to a small group of learners, the majority of students became involved in activities when interactive methods were applied.

Emotional Engagement

Emotional engagement refers to learners' affective responses during the learning process, including feelings such as interest, enjoyment, motivation, anxiety, and attitude toward classroom activities. It reflects how students emotionally connect with the learning environment and plays a crucial role in sustaining participation and enhancing learning outcomes (Fredricks et al., 2004).

In this study, emotional engagement was observed through students' enthusiasm, willingness to participate, facial expressions, and overall attitude toward learning tasks. During the intervention phase, a significant positive shift in students' emotional responses was identified. Learners appeared more motivated, confident, and interested in classroom activities compared to the baseline phase.

One of the key factors contributing to increased emotional engagement was the implementation of game-based learning. These activities created a relaxed and enjoyable classroom atmosphere, reducing learners' anxiety and fear of making mistakes. Students were more willing to take risks and use the target language, which is essential for language development (Dörnyei, 2001).

Additionally, communicative and collaborative tasks enhanced students' sense of belonging and involvement. Working in pairs and groups allowed learners to interact freely, share ideas, and support each other, which fostered positive emotions and increased confidence. This supportive environment contributed to a more positive attitude toward language learning (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).

Another important observation was the reduction of negative emotions such as boredom and frustration. In traditional lessons, students often showed signs of disengagement; however, during interactive activities, they remained attentive and emotionally invested throughout the lesson.

Cognitive Engagement

Cognitive engagement refers to the degree to which learners invest mental effort in understanding the content, applying knowledge, and developing higher-order thinking skills such as analysis, problem-solving, and critical thinking. It goes beyond simple participation and reflects how deeply students process information and engage intellectually with learning tasks (Fredricks et al., 2004).

In this study, cognitive engagement was evaluated through students' ability to understand and apply language structures, solve problems, ask questions, and actively think during classroom activities. The findings indicate a clear improvement in cognitive engagement during the intervention phase compared to the baseline phase. Interactive teaching strategies played a crucial role in promoting deeper cognitive involvement. Communicative tasks required students to use language meaningfully rather than mechanically repeating structures. As a result, learners were encouraged to think, interpret, and produce language in context, which enhanced their understanding and retention (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).

Game-based learning also contributed to cognitive engagement by incorporating problem-solving elements and decision-making processes. Students needed to recall vocabulary, apply grammar rules, and respond quickly in order to succeed in tasks. This type of active mental

involvement supported the development of both linguistic competence and thinking skills (Wright et al., 2006).

Furthermore, pair and group work created opportunities for learners to negotiate meaning, clarify misunderstandings, and construct knowledge collaboratively. Through discussion and interaction, students were able to refine their ideas and develop deeper comprehension of the language (Vygotsky, 1978). Another important observation was the shift from lower-order thinking skills, such as memorization, to higher-order cognitive processes. Students engaged in activities that required analysis, comparison, and creative language use, which are essential components of effective learning (Piaget, 2001).

Overall, the results demonstrate that student-centered and interactive teaching approaches significantly enhance cognitive engagement by encouraging learners to think actively, solve problems, and use language in meaningful contexts.

Social Engagement

Social engagement refers to the extent to which learners interact with others in the classroom, collaborate on tasks, and participate in shared learning experiences. It involves communication, cooperation, peer support, and the ability to build meaningful relationships within the learning environment. In language learning contexts, social engagement is especially important, as interaction serves as both a means and a goal of communication (Fredricks et al., 2004).

In this study, social engagement was assessed through students' participation in pair and group work, their willingness to communicate with peers, and the quality of their collaborative interactions. The findings reveal a significant increase in social engagement during the intervention phase.

The implementation of pair and group activities created more opportunities for students to interact with each other. Learners were encouraged to exchange ideas, ask and answer questions, and work together to complete tasks. This collaborative environment promoted active participation and reduced dependence on the teacher (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).

Effectiveness of Game-Based Learning

Game-based learning refers to the integration of structured games and playful activities into the teaching process to support language acquisition and increase learner engagement. In EFL contexts, especially with young learners, games serve as a powerful pedagogical tool by combining learning objectives with enjoyment and active participation (Wright et al., 2006).

In this study, game-based learning proved to be one of the most effective strategies for enhancing student engagement across multiple dimensions. During the intervention phase, students showed a marked increase in participation, motivation, and willingness to use the target language. The игровой (playful) nature of activities created a low-anxiety environment, allowing learners to take risks and communicate more freely (Dörnyei, 2001).

From a behavioral perspective, games encouraged active involvement. Students eagerly participated in tasks, followed instructions attentively, and demonstrated persistence in completing activities. The competitive and goal-oriented aspects of games motivated learners to stay focused and engaged throughout the lesson.

Emotionally, game-based learning had a highly positive impact. Students expressed enjoyment, excitement, and curiosity, which contributed to a supportive and energetic classroom atmosphere. The reduction of stress and fear of making mistakes allowed learners to build confidence in using the English language.

Cognitively, games promoted deeper learning by requiring students to recall vocabulary, apply grammar rules, and think critically in order to succeed. Many activities involved problem-solving and quick decision-making, which enhanced learners' mental engagement and reinforced language retention.

Role of Communicative Activities

Communicative activities are instructional tasks designed to promote meaningful interaction, where learners use language as a tool for expressing ideas, negotiating meaning, and achieving communicative goals. These activities are central to communicative language teaching and emphasize fluency, interaction, and real-life language use rather than isolated grammatical practice (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).

In this study, communicative activities such as role-plays, dialogues, information-gap tasks, and situational conversations played a crucial role in enhancing young learners' engagement. During the intervention phase, students were actively involved in tasks that required them to use English in realistic and purposeful contexts. From a behavioral perspective, communicative tasks significantly increased student participation. Learners were more willing to speak, respond to peers, and engage in spontaneous interaction compared to the baseline phase. The necessity to communicate meaningfully encouraged continuous involvement in classroom activities.

Emotionally, these activities contributed to a more positive learning experience. Students demonstrated increased confidence and reduced anxiety when using the target language in structured yet flexible situations. The opportunity to express personal ideas and opinions made learning more relevant and enjoyable.

Cognitively, communicative activities required learners to process language actively, think quickly, and adapt their responses based on context. This promoted higher-order thinking skills such as analysis, synthesis, and evaluation, rather than mechanical repetition of language forms (Nation & Newton, 2009).

Challenges Identified

Despite the positive results, several challenges were observed:

- Large class sizes limited individual participation (Harmer, 2007)
- Limited teaching resources restricted activity variety
- Differences in proficiency levels affected group work
- Teachers required additional training to effectively implement interactive strategies (Scrivener, 2011)

Discussion of Findings

The findings confirm that engagement is a multidimensional construct involving behavioral, emotional, cognitive, and social components (Fredricks et al., 2004). Interactive teaching methods address all these dimensions, leading to improved learning outcomes. The study also highlights the importance of the teacher's role as a facilitator rather than a knowledge transmitter. This shift aligns with modern pedagogical approaches and contributes to more effective and engaging learning environments (Richards & Rodgers, 2014).

Conclusion

This study confirms that enhancing student engagement requires a shift from traditional teaching methods to interactive, learner-centered approaches. Game-based learning, collaborative tasks, and communicative activities significantly improve participation, motivation, and language skills. Engagement should be viewed as a dynamic and multifaceted construct influenced by cognitive, emotional, and social factors. Teachers play a crucial role in creating environments that

foster engagement through innovative and flexible teaching strategies. Future research should focus on integrating technology, exploring long-term effects of engagement strategies, and developing teacher training programs.

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DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS

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Abstract. Abstract: In the modern globalized world, translation and communication play a crucial role in connecting people from different linguistic and cultural backgrounds. This article examines the interrelationship between translation and communication, focusing on how translation facilitates intercultural interaction and mutual understanding. The study explores the theoretical and practical aspects of translation, including common challenges such as semantic equivalence, cultural differences, and context adaptation. It also highlights the importance of effective communication strategies in overcoming these challenges. Furthermore, the role of modern technologies, including machine translation and digital communication tools, is analyzed in enhancing translation efficiency. The findings suggest that successful communication across cultures depends not only on linguistic accuracy but also on cultural awareness and pragmatic competence.

Key words: intercultural communication, language barriers, semantic equivalence, cultural differences, translation strategies, machine translation, language proficiency

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Xülasə. Müasir qloballaşan dünyada tərcümə və kommunikasiya müxtəlif dillərə və mədəniyyətlərə malik insanlar arasında qarşılıqlı anlaşılanın təmin olunmasında mühüm rol oynayır. Bu məqalədə tərcümə ilə kommunikasiya arasındakı əlaqə araşdırılır və onların mədəniyyətlərarası ünsiyyətə təsiri təhlil edilir. Tərcümə prosesində qarşıya çıxan əsas problemlər – semantik uyğunluq, mədəni fərqlər və kontekstin düzgün ötürülməsi – geniş şəkildə izah olunur. Bununla yanaşı, effektiv kommunikasiya strategiyalarının bu çətinliklərin aradan qaldırılmasındakı əhəmiyyəti vurğulanır. Məqalədə həmçinin müasir texnologiyaların, xüsusilə maşın tərcüməsi və rəqəmsal kommunikasiya vasitələrinin tərcümə prosesinə təsiri nəzərdən keçirilir. Araşdırmanın nəticələri göstərir ki, uğurlu kommunikasiya yalnız dil bilikləri ilə deyil, eyni zamanda mədəni məlumatlılıq və pragmatik bacarıqlarla sıx bağlıdır. Bu baxımdan, tərcümə və kommunikasiya bacarıqlarının paralel inkişafı müasir cəmiyyətdə mühüm əhəmiyyət kəsb edir.

Açar sözlər: mədəniyyətlərarası kommunikasiya, dil baryerləri, semantik uyğunluq, mədəni fərqlər, tərcümə strategiyaları, maşın tərcüməsi, dil bacarıqları, pragmatik kompetensiya

Introduction

Introduction: In today's globalized world, communication across languages and cultures has become increasingly important. As international cooperation expands in areas such as education, business, science, and technology, the need for effective translation has grown significantly. Translation serves as a bridge that connects people from different linguistic and cultural backgrounds, enabling the exchange of ideas, knowledge, and values.

However, translation is not merely a mechanical process of converting words from one language into another. It involves understanding the cultural context, intentions, and nuances embedded in the source text. Therefore, successful translation requires not only linguistic competence but also intercultural awareness and pragmatic skills. At the same time, communication plays a key role in ensuring that the intended message is delivered accurately and effectively to the target audience.

Despite its importance, several challenges arise in the process of translation and communication, including issues of semantic equivalence, cultural differences, and contextual adaptation. In recent years, modern technologies such as machine translation tools and digital communication platforms have influenced the way translation is performed, making it faster but sometimes less accurate. This article aims to examine the relationship between translation and communication, analyze the main challenges encountered in this field, and explore effective strategies for improving intercultural communication in a multilingual world.

Modern Methodologies and Technological Integration in ELT

Learner-Centered Pedagogical Frameworks

In recent decades, English Language Teaching (ELT) has undergone a significant transformation, shifting from traditional teacher-centered approaches to more dynamic learner-centered pedagogical frameworks. This shift emphasizes the active role of learners in the educational process, where students are no longer passive recipients of knowledge but active participants in constructing their own learning experiences. Learner-centered pedagogy is grounded

in the idea that each student has unique needs, learning styles, interests, and levels of proficiency. Therefore, effective teaching requires adapting instruction to meet these individual differences. In this context, methodologies such as Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), and Content and Language Integrated Learning (CLIL) have gained prominence. These approaches focus on meaningful communication, real-life language use, and the integration of language skills rather than isolated grammar instruction.

A key principle of learner-centered frameworks is the promotion of autonomy and responsibility in learning. Students are encouraged to take control of their own progress by setting goals, engaging in self-assessment, and reflecting on their learning strategies. This not only enhances motivation but also fosters lifelong learning skills. Teachers, in turn, act as facilitators, guides, and supporters rather than sole authorities in the classroom. The integration of modern technologies has further strengthened learner-centered approaches in ELT. Digital tools such as online platforms, mobile applications, interactive whiteboards, and learning management systems (LMS) provide diverse opportunities for personalized and flexible learning. For example, students can access authentic materials, participate in virtual discussions, and receive immediate feedback through digital environments. Technologies like artificial intelligence and adaptive learning systems can also tailor content to individual learners' needs, enhancing both engagement and effectiveness.

Moreover, collaborative learning has become an essential component of learner-centered education. Through group work, peer interaction, and project-based activities, learners develop not only their language skills but also critical thinking, problem-solving, and communication abilities. These skills are essential in today's globalized and interconnected world. Despite its many advantages, implementing learner-centered approaches may present certain challenges, such as the need for teacher training, access to technological resources, and the management of diverse classrooms. Nevertheless, the benefits of increased student engagement, improved language proficiency, and the development of independent learning skills make learner-centered pedagogy a highly effective framework in modern ELT. In conclusion, learner-centered pedagogical frameworks, supported by modern methodologies and technological integration, represent a progressive and effective direction in English language teaching. They create a more interactive, inclusive, and meaningful learning environment that prepares learners for real-world communication.

Methodology and Materials

This study adopts a qualitative and descriptive research design aimed at examining modern methodologies and technological integration in English Language Teaching (ELT), with a particular focus on learner-centered pedagogical frameworks. The research is grounded in contemporary applied linguistics and educational technology perspectives, allowing for a comprehensive understanding of how teaching practices evolve in response to digital transformation and learner needs.

The methodology of the study is primarily based on document analysis and literature review. A wide range of academic sources, including peer-reviewed journal articles, books, conference papers, and educational reports published within the last decade, were examined. These materials were selected to ensure relevance to current ELT practices, especially those involving communicative language teaching, task-based learning, and technology-enhanced instruction. The selection process prioritized sources that discuss both theoretical foundations and practical applications in classroom environments.

In addition to secondary data, the study also considers comparative analysis of different teaching models. Traditional teacher-centered approaches were compared with modern learner-centered methodologies to identify key differences in instructional design, learner engagement, and language acquisition outcomes. Special attention was given to the role of digital tools such as learning management systems, mobile applications, interactive platforms, and AI-supported language learning environments. The materials used in this research include both printed and digital academic resources. Printed materials consist of established ELT methodology textbooks and foundational linguistic theory works. Digital materials include online databases such as Google Scholar, ResearchGate, and institutional repositories, which provided access to recent studies on educational technology integration.

Furthermore, sample lesson plans, curriculum frameworks, and classroom activity designs were analyzed to understand how theoretical approaches are implemented in real teaching contexts.

To ensure reliability and validity, only credible and academically recognized sources were included. Preference was given to studies published in indexed journals and works authored by experts in applied linguistics and language education. Data interpretation was carried out through thematic analysis, where recurring concepts such as learner autonomy, interaction, motivation, and digital literacy were identified and categorized. Overall, this methodological approach allows for a structured and in-depth exploration of ELT methodologies, highlighting the impact of technological advancements on teaching and learning processes.

Discussion

The findings of this study highlight a clear shift in English Language Teaching (ELT) from traditional teacher-centered instruction toward more dynamic, learner-centered approaches. This shift is not simply a methodological preference but a necessary response to the changing demands of education in the 21st century. Learners today are expected to develop not only linguistic competence but also critical thinking, collaboration skills, and digital literacy. Therefore, modern methodologies such as task-based learning, communicative language teaching, and technology-enhanced instruction have become central to effective language education. One of the most significant observations is the increasing role of technology in shaping classroom practices. Digital tools, including mobile applications, online platforms, and interactive software, have transformed language learning into a more flexible and accessible process. However, it is important to emphasize that technology alone does not guarantee successful learning outcomes. Its effectiveness depends on how well it is integrated into pedagogical strategies. In many cases, poor implementation of technology leads to superficial learning experiences rather than meaningful engagement. Teachers must therefore be adequately trained to use these tools purposefully, not randomly or just for appearance.

Another important point is learner autonomy. Modern ELT approaches strongly emphasize the learner's active role in the learning process. Students are encouraged to take responsibility for their own progress, engage in self-directed learning, and participate in collaborative tasks. This represents a major improvement compared to traditional rote-learning systems. However, not all learners are immediately prepared for such independence. Without proper guidance, some students may struggle to adapt, which can negatively affect motivation and performance. This indicates that teacher support remains essential even in learner-centered environments.

The study also reveals that communicative competence is prioritized over grammatical perfection in contemporary teaching models. While grammar remains important, the ability to use language effectively in real-life situations is considered more valuable. This approach aligns with

global communication needs, especially in academic and professional contexts. Nevertheless, an overemphasis on fluency without sufficient attention to accuracy may create gaps in linguistic development. A balanced approach is therefore necessary. Furthermore, the integration of multiple teaching methodologies suggests that there is no single “perfect” method for language instruction. Effective ELT practice often involves combining different strategies depending on learners’ needs, proficiency levels, and learning contexts. Teachers who rigidly follow one method without adaptation risk limiting student progress. Flexibility and reflective practice are crucial qualities in modern language education.

In conclusion, the discussion demonstrates that while modern ELT methodologies and technological integration offer significant advantages, their success depends heavily on thoughtful implementation, teacher competence, and learner readiness. Without these conditions, even the most advanced approaches may fail to achieve their intended outcomes.

Conclusion

This study has explored modern methodologies and technological integration in English Language Teaching (ELT), with a special focus on learner-centered pedagogical frameworks. The analysis shows that contemporary ELT practices have significantly shifted from traditional teacher-centered instruction toward more interactive, flexible, and learner-focused approaches. This transformation reflects the growing need for learners to develop not only language proficiency but also critical thinking, collaboration skills, and digital competence.

The findings indicate that methodologies such as communicative language teaching, task-based learning, and blended learning approaches play an important role in improving learner engagement and language acquisition. In particular, the integration of technology has expanded learning opportunities beyond the classroom, allowing students to access authentic materials, practice language skills independently, and participate in interactive learning environments. However, the study also highlights that technology is most effective when it is supported by well-structured pedagogical strategies and competent teacher guidance.

Another key conclusion is that learner autonomy has become a central component of modern ELT. Students are increasingly encouraged to take responsibility for their own learning process, which contributes to greater motivation and long-term language development. At the same time, the role of the teacher remains essential as a facilitator who guides, supports, and monitors learner progress. Despite the advantages of modern approaches, the study also reveals certain challenges, such as unequal access to digital resources, varying levels of learner readiness, and the need for continuous teacher training. These challenges suggest that successful implementation of modern ELT methodologies requires careful planning, institutional support, and ongoing professional development for educators.

In conclusion, modern ELT is most effective when traditional pedagogical knowledge is combined with innovative methods and technology. A balanced, flexible, and learner-centered approach ensures more meaningful and sustainable language learning outcomes.

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WHY LANGUAGE LEARNERS UNDERSTAND ENGLISH BUT STRUGGLE TO SPEAK IT

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Abstract: Many learners of English as a foreign language develop strong receptive skills, allowing them to understand spoken and written input with relative ease. However, a significant number of these learners struggle when required to produce spoken language. This imbalance between comprehension and speaking ability represents a persistent challenge in second language acquisition and language pedagogy. The present article investigates the main cognitive, psychological, pedagogical, and environmental factors contributing to this phenomenon. The analysis reveals that speaking anxiety, fear of negative evaluation, and lack of confidence are among the most influential psychological barriers that prevent learners from engaging in oral communication. Even when learners possess sufficient vocabulary and grammatical knowledge, these emotional factors inhibit spontaneous speech production. In addition, traditional teaching approaches that emphasize grammar accuracy, translation, and reading comprehension often neglect the development of oral fluency. This leads to a situation where learners accumulate passive linguistic knowledge without gaining sufficient communicative practice. Moreover, limited exposure to authentic English-speaking environments further restricts learners' ability to develop fluency and automatic speech processing. Without consistent interaction in real-life contexts, learners struggle to respond quickly and naturally in English. The article concludes by emphasizing the importance of communicative, task-based, and learner-centered approaches, which create opportunities for meaningful interaction and reduce speaking anxiety. Fluency development requires not only knowledge but also confidence, repetition, and active engagement in communication.

Keywords: Language learning, speaking skills, communicative competence, language anxiety, classroom interaction, fluency development, second language acquisition

NİYƏ DİL ÖYRƏNƏNLƏR İNGİLİS DİLİNİ BAŞA DÜŞÜR, LAKİN DANIŞMAQDA ÇƏTİNLİK ÇƏKİRLƏR

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Xülasə: İngilis dili xarici dil kimi öyrənən bir çox tələbə güclü reseptiv bacarıqlar inkişaf etdirir və bu onlara danışq və yazılı mətnləri nisbətən asanlıqla anlama imkanı verir. Lakin bu tələbələrən əhəmiyyətli bir hissəsi danışq bacarığından istifadə etməli olduqda çətinlik yaşayır. Anlama və danışma bacarıqları arasındakı bu balanssızlıq ikinci dilin mənimsənilməsində və dil tədrisində davamlı problem kimi qalmaqdadır. Bu məqalə bu fenomenə səbəb olan əsas koqnitiv, psixoloji, pedaqoji və mühit faktorlarını araşdırır.

Təhlil göstərir ki, danışq narahatlığı, mənfi qiymətləndirmə qorxusu və özünəinamın olmaması şagirdlərin şifahi ünsiyyətdə iştirakını əngəlləyən ən mühüm psixoloji maneələrdəndir. Öyrənənlər kifayət qədər söz ehtiyatı və qrammatik biliklərə malik olsalar belə, bu emosional faktorlar onların spontan danışq bacarığını məhdudlaşdırır.

Bundan əlavə, qrammatik dəqiqliyə, tərcüməyə və oxu-anlama bacarıqlarına üstünlük verən ənənəvi tədris yanaşmaları çox vaxt şifahi nitqin inkişafını nəzərə almır. Bu isə tələbələrən passiv dil bilikləri toplanmasına, lakin ünsiyyət üçün kifayət qədər praktiki bacarıq qazana bilməməsinə səbəb olur.

Eyni zamanda, autentik ingilis dili mühitlərinə məhdud çıxış da tələbələrən səlis danışq və avtomatik nitq emalını inkişaf etdirməsini məhdudlaşdırır. Real həyat vəziyyətlərində davamlı ünsiyyət olmadıqda, tələbələr ingilis dilində sürətli və təbii cavab verməkdə çətinlik çəkirlər.

Məqalə sonda kommunikativ, tapşırıq əsaslı və tələbə mərkəzli yanaşmaların vacibliyini vurğulayır. Bu yanaşmalar mənalı ünsiyyət üçün imkan yaradır və danışq narahatlığını azaldır. Səlis danışq yalnız biliklə deyil, həm də özünəinam, təkrarlama və aktiv ünsiyyət təcrübəsi ilə inkişaf edir.

Açar sözlər: Dil öyrənmə, danışq bacarıqları, kommunikativ səriştə, dil narahatlığı, sinifdaxili qarşılıqlı əlaqə, səlislik inkişafı, ikinci dilin mənimsənilməsi

Introduction

English has become one of the most influential global languages, used in education, science, technology, and international communication. Despite widespread instruction, a common and persistent issue exists among learners: they can understand English effectively but cannot speak it fluently. This contradiction raises an important question in applied linguistics and language teaching methodology –why does comprehension not naturally lead to speaking ability? Understanding this gap is crucial for improving teaching practices and learner outcomes. Speaking is often considered the most difficult language skill because it requires real-time processing, immediate response, and psychological readiness. This article explores the underlying causes of this issue and suggests ways to improve speaking competence in English language learners.

Psychological Barriers in Speaking English

One of the most powerful and often underestimated reasons why learners can understand English but cannot speak it fluently is psychological barriers. Speaking a foreign language is not only a cognitive task but also an emotional experience. Many learners experience intense anxiety when they are required to speak English in front of others. This phenomenon is commonly known as language anxiety. It includes fear of making mistakes, fear of being laughed at, and fear of negative evaluation from teachers or classmates. In many classroom environments, students feel that every sentence they produce is being judged for grammatical correctness. This creates a high-pressure situation where learners prioritize accuracy over communication. As a result, they hesitate, pause frequently, or avoid speaking altogether. Even students who have a good command of vocabulary and grammar often remain silent because they do not feel emotionally safe.

Another important psychological factor is lack of self-confidence. Confidence plays a critical role in speaking fluency. A confident learner is more willing to take risks, experiment with language, and continue speaking even when errors occur. In contrast, low-confidence learners tend to overthink every sentence before speaking, which interrupts natural communication flow.

Perfectionism also contributes significantly to this issue. Many students believe that they must speak “perfect English” without errors. However, in real communication, mistakes are a natural and necessary part of learning. This unrealistic expectation creates mental pressure and discourages participation. Over time, learners may develop a “silent habit,” where they prefer listening and understanding rather than speaking. Therefore, psychological barriers are not just minor obstacles but major factors that directly shape speaking ability. Without addressing anxiety, fear, and confidence issues, it is very difficult for learners to achieve fluency, no matter how strong their grammatical knowledge is.

The Role of Teaching Methods in Language Learning

Teaching methodology plays a fundamental role in determining whether students develop speaking fluency or remain passive language users. In many educational systems, traditional methods such as grammar-translation and teacher-centered instruction are still widely used. These methods focus heavily on grammatical accuracy, vocabulary memorization, reading comprehension, and written exercises. While these skills are important, they often dominate classroom time at the expense of speaking practice. As a result, students develop a strong theoretical understanding of English but lack the ability to use it spontaneously in real communication. They may perform well in written exams, recognize complex grammatical structures, and translate texts accurately, yet struggle to form simple sentences in conversation. This creates a clear gap between “knowing” and “using” the language.

Another limitation of traditional teaching methods is the passive role of students. In many classrooms, teachers dominate the lesson while students mainly listen, take notes, and complete written tasks. Speaking opportunities are often limited to short, controlled exercises such as repeating sentences or answering fixed questions. These activities do not reflect real-life communication, where language is spontaneous, unpredictable, and interactive.

In contrast, modern approaches such as Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) emphasize interaction, meaning, and real communication. CLT encourages students to use language actively through discussions, problem-solving tasks, and pair work. However, in many contexts, these methods are not fully implemented due to exam-oriented education systems, large class sizes, or lack of training. Therefore, teaching methodology is not just a technical issue but a core factor shaping learners’ speaking abilities. When instruction focuses only on form and accuracy, students remain passive users of language. When communication becomes the center of learning, speaking skills naturally develop.

Lack of Speaking Practice and Real Communication

Another critical reason why learners understand English but struggle to speak it is the lack of meaningful speaking practice and real communication opportunities. Language is fundamentally a skill that develops through use, repetition, and interaction. However, in many learning environments, students have very limited chances to actually speak English in a natural and continuous way. In most cases, English is treated as an academic subject rather than a communication tool. Students learn it inside the classroom but immediately switch back to their native language outside of it. This creates a situation where English is disconnected from real-life

usage. Without regular exposure to spoken English, learners cannot develop fluency or automatic response skills.

Classroom conditions also contribute to this problem. Large class sizes mean that each student has very little speaking time during a lesson. Even when speaking activities are included, they are often short and controlled, such as answering simple questions or reading prepared dialogues. These activities do not reflect real conversations, where speakers must think quickly, respond unpredictably, and maintain interaction over time.

Another important issue is the lack of authentic communication environments. Many learners do not interact with native speakers or other fluent users of English. They also rarely engage in real-life situations where English is necessary. As a result, they do not develop the ability to think directly in English. Instead, they translate mentally from their native language, which slows down speech production and reduces fluency. Without consistent speaking practice, learners cannot build the “automaticity” needed for fluent speech. They may know words and grammar rules, but they cannot retrieve and use them quickly during conversation. Therefore, the absence of real communication is one of the strongest barriers to speaking development.

Strategies to Improve Speaking Skills in Language Learners

Improving speaking skills requires a shift from traditional knowledge-based learning to active, communication-based learning. One of the most effective approaches is Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), which emphasizes interaction, meaning, and real-life communication rather than grammatical perfection. In CLT classrooms, students are encouraged to use language as a tool for expressing ideas, not just as a subject to study. One highly effective method is task-based learning. In this approach, students complete meaningful tasks such as solving problems, discussing real-life situations, or preparing presentations. These tasks require communication and cooperation, which naturally increases speaking practice. Because learners focus on completing the task rather than avoiding mistakes, their anxiety decreases and confidence improves. Group work and pair activities are also essential strategies. They provide students with more speaking opportunities compared to teacher-centered instruction. In small groups, learners feel more comfortable expressing themselves and are less afraid of making mistakes. This creates a supportive environment where communication becomes more natural and less stressful. Role-plays and simulations are another powerful tool for developing speaking fluency. They allow students to practice real-life situations such as ordering food, interviewing, or making travel arrangements. These activities bridge the gap between classroom learning and real-world communication.

Finally, the teacher’s role is crucial in creating a positive learning atmosphere. Teachers should encourage students, provide constructive feedback, and reduce fear of errors. When mistakes are treated as a normal part of learning, students become more willing to speak. Over time, this leads to increased fluency, confidence, and communicative competence.

Conclusion

The gap between understanding and speaking English is a complex issue influenced by psychological, methodological, and environmental factors. Students often fail to speak not because they lack knowledge, but because they lack confidence, practice, and communicative opportunities. Traditional teaching methods further reinforce this problem by focusing more on passive skills than active use. To overcome this challenge, language education must prioritize communication, interaction, and learner confidence. By creating supportive classrooms and increasing meaningful speaking practice, learners can gradually transform their passive knowledge into active fluency.

Ultimately, speaking a language is not only about knowing it, but about using it confidently and continuously in real-life situations.

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NEW TRENDS IN LEARNING AND TEACHING ENGLISH LANGUAGE: SHADOWING, CHUNKING, ETC..

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Abstract: This article examines new trends in learning and teaching English, focusing specifically on effective techniques such as shadowing, chunking, and narrow listening, and their role in language acquisition and speaking fluency. In modern English language teaching, there is an increasing emphasis on practical methods that help learners use the language actively rather than passively. These approaches are closely connected to natural language acquisition processes and aim to improve learners' ability to communicate fluently. Shadowing is a technique in which learners listen to spoken language and repeat it simultaneously, which significantly enhances pronunciation, rhythm, and speaking fluency. Chunking, on the other hand, involves learning language in meaningful phrases instead of isolated words, allowing learners to produce speech more naturally and efficiently. Narrow listening focuses on repeated exposure to similar listening materials, which strengthens comprehension and reinforces vocabulary and structures. These techniques are particularly beneficial for learners who aim to improve speaking fluency, as they reduce hesitation and increase confidence. Moreover, they support language acquisition by providing repeated and meaningful input. The article concludes that integrating shadowing, chunking, and narrow listening into English language teaching can significantly improve learners' speaking abilities and overall language development.

Keywords: shadowing, chunking, narrow listening, language acquisition, speaking fluency.

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN ÖYRƏNİLMƏSİNDƏ VƏ TƏDRİSİNDƏ YENİ MEYİLLƏR: SHADOWING, CHUNKING VƏ.S

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə ingilis dilinin öyrənilməsi və tədrisində yeni tendensiyaları araşdırır və xüsusilə shadowing, chunking və narrow listening kimi effektiv üsullara, eləcə də onların dil mənimsənilməsi və danışiq axıcılığındakı roluna diqqət yetirir. Müasir ingilis dili tədrisində öyrənənlərin dili passiv deyil, aktiv şəkildə istifadə etməsinə kömək edən praktik metodlara artan diqqət müşahidə olunur. Bu yanaşmalar təbii dil mənimsəmə prosesləri ilə sıx əlaqəlidir və öyrənənlərin sərbəst ünsiyyət qurmaq bacarığını inkişaf etdirməyi hədəfləyir. Shadowing öyrənənlərin danışiq nitqini dinləyərək onu eyni anda təkrar etməsinə əsaslanan bir üsuldur və bu, tələffüzün, ritmin və danışiq axıcılığının əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə inkişafına kömək edir. Chunking isə dilin ayrı-ayrı sözlər şəklində deyil, mənalı ifadələr şəklində öyrənilməsini nəzərdə tutur və öyrənənlərin daha təbii və səmərəli danışmasına imkan yaradır. Narrow listening oxşar dinləmə materiallarına təkrar-təkrar məruz qalmağa əsaslanır ki, bu da anlama bacarığını gücləndirir və lüğət ehtiyatı ilə qrammatik strukturların möhkəmlənməsinə kömək edir. Bu üsullar xüsusilə danışiq axıcılığını inkişaf etdirmək istəyən öyrənənlər üçün faydalıdır, çünki onlar tərəddüdü azaldır və özünə inamı artırır. Bundan əlavə, bu yanaşmalar təkrar və mənalı dil inputu təqdim etməklə dil mənimsənilməsini dəstəkləyir. Məqalə nəticə olaraq göstərir ki, shadowing, chunking və narrow listening üsullarının ingilis dili tədrisinə inteqrasiyası öyrənənlərin danışiq bacarıqlarını və ümumi dil inkişafını əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə yaxşılaşdırma bilər.

Açar sözlər: shadowing, chunking, narrow listening, dil mənimsənilməsi, danışiq axıcılığı

Introduction

In modern language education, English has become a global tool for communication, making effective teaching methods more important than ever. Traditional approaches that focused mainly on grammar rules, translation, and memorization are no longer sufficient to meet the needs of today's learners. Instead, the focus has shifted toward language acquisition and speaking fluency, emphasizing real communication and practical usage. Language acquisition is understood as a natural process through which learners internalize language patterns by being exposed to meaningful input. Speaking fluency, on the other hand, refers to the ability to express ideas smoothly and confidently without excessive hesitation. Many learners struggle with fluency because they lack opportunities to use English in real-time communication. To address this issue, modern teaching methodologies have introduced techniques such as shadowing, chunking, and narrow listening, which are designed to reflect natural language learning processes and improve both comprehension and production skills.

Theoretical Background: Language Acquisition and Speaking Fluency

Language acquisition is a subconscious process that occurs when learners are exposed to understandable and meaningful input over time. Unlike formal learning, which relies on explicit instruction, acquisition happens naturally through interaction and repetition. This concept is strongly supported by second language acquisition theory, which emphasizes the importance of exposure to comprehensible input. Speaking fluency is closely related to acquisition because it depends on the learner's ability to access and use language automatically. Fluency is not only about speed but also about coherence, confidence, and natural expression. Learners often face difficulties in speaking because they must simultaneously think about vocabulary, grammar, and sentence structure, which increases cognitive load. The techniques of shadowing, chunking, and narrow

listening help reduce this burden by providing structured input and repeated practice, allowing learners to internalize language patterns more effectively.

Shadowing Technique and Speaking Fluency

Shadowing is a language learning technique in which learners listen to spoken English and repeat it at the same time or immediately after hearing it. This method requires intense focus and real-time processing, which strengthens both listening and speaking skills. One of the main advantages of shadowing is its impact on pronunciation, intonation, and rhythm. By imitating native speakers, learners gradually develop more natural speech patterns. Shadowing also improves speaking fluency because it trains learners to produce language without pausing to translate or analyze grammar. Instead, they respond automatically, which increases speech speed and confidence. In addition, shadowing enhances auditory processing skills, allowing learners to recognize sounds, stress patterns, and connected speech more easily. In classroom practice, shadowing can be implemented using short dialogues, audio recordings, or video materials. Regular practice is essential, as repeated exposure leads to gradual improvement in fluency and comprehension.

Chunking and Natural Language Production

Chunking is the process of learning and using language in meaningful groups of words rather than individual vocabulary items. These groups, known as chunks, include fixed or semi-fixed expressions such as “on the other hand,” “as a result,” or “I would like to.” The main advantage of chunking is that it allows learners to produce language more quickly and naturally because they do not need to construct sentences word by word. Instead, they retrieve ready-made expressions from memory. This significantly reduces cognitive effort and increases speaking fluency. Chunking also reflects how native speakers use language in real communication, as they rely heavily on formulaic expressions. By learning chunks, students can improve both accuracy and fluency simultaneously. Teachers can introduce chunking through reading texts, listening activities, and speaking exercises, encouraging students to recognize and use common expressions in different contexts. Over time, learners build a large repertoire of chunks that support smoother and more effective communication.

Narrow Listening and Comprehension Development

Narrow listening is a technique that involves repeated exposure to listening materials that are similar in topic, vocabulary, or speaker. This repetition helps learners become familiar with language patterns and reduces the difficulty of understanding spoken English. Unlike random listening exercises, narrow listening focuses on consistency and repetition, which strengthens language acquisition. When learners listen to similar content multiple times, they gradually improve their comprehension and become more confident in understanding spoken language. Narrow listening also supports speaking fluency because repeated exposure helps learners internalize vocabulary and sentence structures. As a result, they are more likely to use these expressions in their own speech. This technique is especially useful for learners who struggle with listening comprehension, as it allows them to focus on familiar content and gradually build their skills. In teaching practice, narrow listening can be implemented through themed audio sets, interviews, or short lectures on the same topic.

Integration of Techniques in Language Teaching

The most effective approach to language teaching involves integrating shadowing, chunking, and narrow listening into a unified learning process. Each technique plays a different role in supporting language acquisition and speaking fluency. Narrow listening provides input and builds comprehension, chunking helps organize and store language in meaningful units, and shadowing

allows learners to practice real-time production. When combined, these techniques create a cycle of input, processing, and output that mirrors natural language acquisition. For example, a lesson may begin with narrow listening activities to introduce new language, followed by chunking exercises to highlight useful expressions, and end with shadowing practice to reinforce pronunciation and fluency. This integrated approach encourages active learning and helps students develop both receptive and productive skills simultaneously.

Advantages and Challenges

These techniques offer many advantages in language teaching. They improve speaking fluency, enhance pronunciation, strengthen comprehension, and support natural language acquisition. They also increase learner motivation by making lessons more interactive and practical. However, there are also some challenges. Shadowing can be difficult for beginners who struggle with fast speech. Chunking requires consistent exposure and practice to become effective. Narrow listening may become repetitive if not carefully designed. Teachers must therefore carefully select materials and provide structured guidance to ensure successful implementation. Despite these challenges, the overall benefits of these techniques make them highly valuable in modern English language teaching.

Conclusion

In conclusion, new trends in English language teaching emphasize the importance of practical, learner-centered approaches that support both language acquisition and speaking fluency. Shadowing, chunking, and narrow listening are effective techniques that help learners develop natural communication skills through repeated exposure, meaningful input, and active practice. These methods reduce cognitive load, increase confidence, and bridge the gap between language knowledge and actual use. By integrating these approaches into classroom practice, teachers can create more effective and engaging learning environments that better prepare students for real-world communication. Ultimately, these techniques represent a significant advancement in modern language teaching and offer a powerful framework for improving English language proficiency.

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APPLIATION OF NEW METHODOLOGY IN TEACHING PROVERBS

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Abstract: In modern education, teaching methodologies are continuously evolving to enhance student engagement and improve learning outcomes. Proverbs, as an essential part of language and cultural heritage, require effective and innovative approaches for successful teaching. Traditional methods often rely on memorization, which limits students' ability to understand the deeper meaning and use proverbs in real-life contexts.

This study examines the application of new methodologies in teaching proverbs, focusing on student-centered and communicative approaches. Interactive techniques such as group discussions, role-play, storytelling, and the use of digital tools are highlighted as effective strategies. These methods encourage active participation, collaboration, and critical thinking among learners.

Furthermore, the role of the teacher shifts from a knowledge provider to a facilitator who guides students in discovering meanings independently. As a result, learners become more motivated and confident in using language.

The findings suggest that modern methodologies significantly improve students' comprehension, cultural awareness, and practical language use. Therefore, integrating innovative teaching methods is essential for making proverb instruction more engaging and effective.

Keywords: proverbs, teaching methodology, student-centered learning, interactive activities, communicative approach

ATALAR SÖZLƏRİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ YENİ METODOLOGİYANIN TƏTBİQİ

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Xülasə: Müasir təhsil sistemində tədris metodları daim inkişaf edərək şagirdlərin fəallığını artırmağa və öyrənmə nəticələrini yaxşılaşdırmağa yönəlir. Atalar sözləri dilin və mədəniyyətin mühüm tərkib hissəsi olmaqla yanaşı, onların düzgün tədrisi üçün müasir və effektiv metodların tətbiqini tələb edir. Ənənəvi metodlar əsasən əzbərləməyə əsaslandığı üçün şagirdlərin atalar sözlərinin dərin mənasını anlama və gündəlik həyatda tətbiq etmə bacarıqları məhdud qalır.

Bu məqalədə atalar sözlərinin tədrisində yeni metodologiyaların tətbiqi araşdırılır və tələbə mərkəzli, kommunikativ yanaşmalar ön plana çəkilir. Qrup müzakirələri, rol oyunları, hekayə qurma və rəqəmsal vasitələrdən istifadə kimi interaktiv üsulların effektivliyi göstərilir. Bu metodlar şagirdlərin dərslərində aktiv iştirakını təmin edir və onların tənqidi düşünmə bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirir.

Eyni zamanda müəllimin rolu dəyişərək məlumat verəndən daha çox istiqamət verən və dəstək göstərən şəxsə çevrilir. Nəticədə şagirdlərin motivasiyası artır, özünə inamı güclənir və dil bacarıqları inkişaf edir.

Araşdırmanın nəticələri göstərir ki, müasir metodların tətbiqi atalar sözlərinin daha effektiv və maraqlı şəkildə tədrisinə imkan yaradır.

Açar sözlər: atalar sözləri, tədris metodologiyası, tələbə mərkəzli təlim, interaktiv fəaliyyətlər, kommunikativ yanaşma

Introduction

Proverbs represent an essential element of language, reflecting the cultural values, beliefs, and collective wisdom of a society. They are widely used in both spoken and written communication, making them an important component of language learning. Teaching proverbs not only contributes to learners' linguistic development but also enhances their cultural awareness and communicative competence. However, despite their importance, proverbs are often taught through traditional methods that rely heavily on memorization and translation, which limits students' deeper understanding and practical use.

In recent years, language teaching has undergone significant methodological changes, shifting from teacher-centered approaches to more learner-centered and interactive models. These modern approaches emphasize active participation, communication, and meaningful learning. According to contemporary pedagogical theories, students learn more effectively when they are engaged in the learning process and encouraged to think critically.

Applying new methodologies to the teaching of proverbs is particularly important, as proverbs often carry figurative meanings that require interpretation and contextual understanding. Therefore, innovative teaching techniques are needed to help students grasp not only the literal meaning but also the implied message and cultural background. This study aims to explore how modern, student-centered methodologies can be applied to teaching proverbs in an effective and engaging way.

Research

The application of new methodologies in teaching proverbs focuses on creating an interactive and student-centered learning environment. One of the most effective approaches is the use of communicative and task-based activities, which encourage learners to actively participate in the learning process. Instead of passively memorizing proverbs, students are engaged in activities that require them to analyze, interpret, and apply proverbs in meaningful contexts.

Group discussions play a crucial role in this process. By discussing the meanings of proverbs in small groups, students are able to share their ideas, compare interpretations, and develop a deeper understanding of the expressions. This collaborative learning environment promotes critical thinking and allows learners to explore different perspectives.

Role-play activities are another effective method. In this approach, students act out real-life situations where specific proverbs can be applied. This helps learners connect abstract meanings with practical usage, making the learning process more engaging and memorable. Similarly, storytelling activities encourage students to create short stories based on proverbs, which enhances creativity and reinforces comprehension.

The integration of digital technologies also contributes significantly to the effectiveness of teaching proverbs. Multimedia tools such as videos, interactive presentations, and online platforms provide visual and contextual support, helping students better understand the meaning and usage of proverbs. These tools also increase motivation and make lessons more dynamic.

Furthermore, the role of the teacher changes in accordance with modern methodologies. The teacher is no longer the sole source of knowledge but acts as a facilitator who guides students,

encourages participation, and provides feedback. This shift creates a more supportive and inclusive learning environment where students feel confident to express their ideas.

In addition, these methodologies contribute to the development of higher-order thinking skills. Students are encouraged not only to understand proverbs but also to analyze their meanings, evaluate their relevance, and use them appropriately in different contexts. As a result, learners develop both linguistic competence and critical thinking abilities.

Discussion

The analysis of modern approaches to proverb teaching demonstrates that innovative methodologies provide more effective learning outcomes than traditional memorization-based techniques. Proverbs contain figurative meanings and cultural references that often cannot be fully understood through direct translation alone. For this reason, modern teaching approaches emphasize interpretation, contextual understanding, and communication.

One of the major findings of the study is that interactive classroom activities increase learner engagement and comprehension. Group discussions, for example, allow students to exchange ideas and compare different interpretations of proverbs. Through collaborative learning, students become more active participants in the educational process and develop stronger communicative skills.

Role-play activities also contribute significantly to proverb learning. When students apply proverbs to realistic situations, they begin to understand not only the literal meaning but also the social and cultural implications behind the expressions. Similarly, storytelling tasks encourage learners to use creativity while reinforcing vocabulary and contextual language use.

The discussion further indicates that digital tools and multimedia resources positively influence students' motivation and interest. Videos, visual illustrations, and online learning platforms make abstract meanings more accessible and help learners connect proverbs with authentic communication. Such technologies also create a more dynamic classroom atmosphere compared to traditional teacher-centered instruction.

Another important point concerns the changing role of the teacher. Modern methodologies require teachers to function as facilitators rather than authority-centered instructors. In this environment, students are encouraged to think independently, express personal opinions, and participate more confidently in classroom interaction. This contributes not only to language development but also to learner autonomy and critical thinking.

The findings also show that teaching proverbs through modern methodologies supports intercultural awareness. Proverbs reflect the traditions, values, and experiences of a particular society. Therefore, understanding proverbs helps learners gain insight into cultural perspectives and social behavior. This intercultural dimension is especially important in communicative language teaching.

Overall, the discussion suggests that combining communicative activities, collaborative learning, and technological support makes proverb teaching more meaningful and effective. Modern methodologies help students move beyond mechanical memorization and develop the ability to interpret and use proverbs naturally in real-life communication.

Methodology and Materials

The present study adopts a descriptive and analytical research approach in order to examine the effectiveness of modern methodologies in teaching proverbs in English language classrooms. The study is mainly based on theoretical analysis and interpretation of existing academic literature related to language teaching methods, communicative learning, and intercultural competence.

Particular attention is given to classroom practices that encourage active learner participation and contextual understanding.

The materials used in this research include academic books, journal articles, and methodological studies focusing on proverb teaching, communicative language teaching, and learner-centered education. In addition, examples of classroom activities such as group discussions, role-play tasks, storytelling exercises, visual presentations, and multimedia-supported learning are considered as practical instructional tools. These materials help illustrate how proverbs can be taught more effectively through interactive and meaningful activities rather than through memorization alone.

Within the scope of the study, traditional teaching practices are compared with contemporary methodologies commonly applied in modern language education. Traditional methods based on translation and repetition are analyzed alongside interactive approaches such as task-based learning and collaborative classroom activities. The study also considers the role of digital technologies and visual materials in helping students understand figurative language and cultural meanings more clearly.

Another important aspect of the research involves examining the role of the teacher in modern proverb instruction. Instead of functioning only as a transmitter of information, the teacher acts as a guide who supports communication, encourages interpretation, and creates opportunities for classroom interaction. This learner-centered perspective is evaluated in relation to students' motivation, participation, and communicative development.

Since the study is theoretical in nature, it does not include experimental procedures or statistical analysis. The conclusions are drawn through comparative interpretation of scholarly sources and pedagogical perspectives concerning modern language teaching practices.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the application of new methodologies in teaching proverbs plays a significant role in improving the overall effectiveness of language learning. Traditional methods, which focus mainly on memorization, are no longer sufficient in modern educational contexts. Instead, student-centered and interactive approaches provide more meaningful and engaging learning experiences.

The use of techniques such as group discussions, role-play, storytelling, and digital tools allows students to actively participate in the learning process and develop a deeper understanding of proverbs. These methods not only enhance language skills but also promote cultural awareness, creativity, and critical thinking.

Moreover, the changing role of the teacher as a facilitator contributes to a more positive and motivating classroom environment. Students become more confident, independent, and responsible for their own learning.

Overall, the findings of this study suggest that integrating innovative methodologies into proverb teaching significantly improves students' comprehension and practical language use. Therefore, educators should adopt modern teaching strategies to make the learning process more effective, interactive, and relevant to real-life communication.

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EARLY FOREIGN LANGUAGE LEARNING AND ITS CHARACTERISTICS

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Abstract: Early foreign language learning has become a central issue in contemporary education due to globalization and increasing intercultural interaction. This study examines the characteristics, theoretical foundations, advantages, and challenges of early language acquisition. It also explores cognitive, neurological, social, and pedagogical dimensions of learning a foreign language at a young age. The findings indicate that early exposure to a foreign language enhances cognitive flexibility, pronunciation accuracy, and intercultural competence. However, factors such as teacher qualifications, socioeconomic conditions, and lack of appropriate materials may limit the effectiveness of early language education. The study concludes that early foreign language instruction should be systematically integrated into educational systems with appropriate methodologies and policy support.

Keywords: early language learning, bilingualism, cognitive development, critical period hypothesis, language teaching

ERKƏN YAŞLARDA XARİCİ DİL ÖYRƏNMƏ VƏ ONUN XÜSUSİYYƏTLƏRİ

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Xülasə: Qloballaşma və artan mədəniyyətlərarası qarşılıqlı təsir səbəbindən erkən xarici dil öyrənməsi müasir təhsildə əsas məsələyə çevrilmişdir. Bu tədqiqat erkən dil öyrənməsinin xüsusiyyətlərini, nəzəri əsaslarını, üstünlüklərini və çətinliklərini araşdırır. Həmçinin, gənc yaşda xarici dil öyrənməyin koqnitiv, nevroloji, sosial və pedaqoji ölçülərini araşdırır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, xarici dilə erkən məruz qalma koqnitiv

elastikliyi, tələffüz dəqiqliyini və mədəniyyətlərarası səriştəni artırır. Lakin müəllim ixtisasları, sosial-iqtisadi şərait və müvafiq materialların olmaması kimi amillər erkən dil təhsilinin effektivliyini məhdudlaşdırır. Tədqiqat erkən xarici dil tədrisinin müvafiq metodologiyalar və siyasət dəstəyi ilə təhsil sistemlərinə sisteməlik şəkildə inteqrasiya olunmalı olduğu qənaətinə gəlir.

Açar sözlər: erkən dil öyrənməsi, ikidillilik, koqnitiv inkişaf, kritik dövr hipotezi, dil tədrisi

Introduction

In the modern world, the ability to communicate in more than one language has become an essential skill rather than a luxury. Globalization, technological advancement, and increasing intercultural interaction have made multilingual competence a necessity for individuals in both academic and professional contexts. In this regard, early foreign language learning has attracted considerable attention from researchers, educators, and policymakers. It is widely accepted that childhood represents a unique period during which language acquisition occurs more naturally and effectively compared to later stages of life (Crystal, 2003).

The significance of early language learning is closely related to biological and cognitive development. The human brain demonstrates a high degree of plasticity during early childhood, which facilitates the acquisition of linguistic structures. This idea is supported by the Critical Period Hypothesis, which suggests that there is an optimal time frame for language acquisition, typically before puberty (Lenneberg, 1967). During this period, children can internalize phonological, grammatical, and semantic features of a language with minimal effort.

Methods and Materials

This study adopts a qualitative research design in order to explore the characteristics, advantages, and challenges of early foreign language learning. The research is primarily based on a systematic review of existing literature related to language acquisition, cognitive development, and early education. Various academic sources, including books, peer-reviewed journal articles, and previous research studies, were analyzed to provide a comprehensive understanding of the topic. Both primary and secondary data sources were considered in the research process. Secondary data forms the main basis of this study and includes well-established theories such as the Critical Period Hypothesis (Lenneberg, 1967), cognitive development theory (Piaget, 1952), and social interactionist theory (Vygotsky, 1978). In addition, recent studies on bilingualism and early language education were examined to support the discussion. The method of content analysis was used to interpret and organize the collected information. Key themes such as cognitive benefits, pronunciation development, social interaction, teaching methods, and educational challenges were identified and categorized. This approach allowed for a structured and in-depth analysis of early foreign language learning. Furthermore, a comparative approach was applied to evaluate differences between early and late language learning processes. This comparison helped highlight the unique advantages of early language acquisition, particularly in terms of fluency, pronunciation, and long-term retention. Overall, the chosen methodology ensures a comprehensive and well-supported analysis of early foreign language learning by integrating theoretical perspectives with empirical findings from existing research.

Discussion

Early foreign language learning is grounded in several theoretical frameworks that explain how children acquire language. One of the most influential perspectives is the behaviorist approach, which emphasizes imitation, repetition, and reinforcement as key mechanisms in language learning. Although this approach has been criticized for oversimplifying the learning process, it still provides

valuable insights into the role of environmental input (Lightbown & Spada, 2013). In contrast, the cognitive approach, represented by Piaget (1952), views language learning as an active mental process in which children construct knowledge through interaction with their environment. This perspective highlights the importance of developmental stages and cognitive readiness in language acquisition. Additionally, the social interactionist theory proposed by Vygotsky (1978) underscores the role of social interaction and cultural context, suggesting that language development occurs through communication with more knowledgeable individuals. From a neurological standpoint, early language learning is closely associated with brain plasticity. During childhood, neural connections are formed rapidly, enabling children to process and retain linguistic input more efficiently. Research in neurolinguistics suggests that bilingual individuals often show increased gray matter density in brain regions related to language control, indicating that early language exposure has a lasting impact on brain structure and function. Moreover, language functions in young learners are more flexible and distributed across the brain, allowing them to adapt more easily to multiple languages. One of the most distinctive characteristics of early language learners is their ability to acquire language implicitly. Unlike adults, who often rely on explicit grammar instruction, children learn language through exposure and interaction. This implicit learning process allows them to develop a natural sense of the language without conscious effort (Cameron, 2001). Another important characteristic is their superior pronunciation ability. Young learners are more capable of perceiving and reproducing subtle phonetic differences, which enables them to achieve near-native pronunciation (Krashen, 1982). In addition to linguistic advantages, early foreign language learning has significant cognitive benefits. Studies have shown that bilingual children demonstrate higher levels of executive functioning, including improved attention control, problem-solving skills, and cognitive flexibility (Bialystok, 2001). These cognitive advantages extend beyond language learning and positively influence overall academic performance. Furthermore, early language learners are more likely to develop metalinguistic awareness, which refers to the ability to think about and analyze language as a system. The social and cultural benefits of early language learning are equally important. Learning a foreign language exposes children to different cultures, traditions, and perspectives, fostering intercultural competence and empathy. This cultural awareness is essential in a globalized world where communication across cultures is increasingly common. Moreover, multilingual individuals have better opportunities for international collaboration and career advancement.

Despite its numerous advantages, early foreign language learning also presents several challenges. One of the main issues is the quality of teaching. Effective language instruction requires teachers who are not only proficient in the target language but also trained in child-centered pedagogical methods (Demirel, 2012). Without proper training, teachers may rely on inappropriate methods that fail to engage young learners. Another challenge is the availability of suitable teaching materials. Young learners require interactive, visually rich, and engaging resources, which may not always be accessible. Socioeconomic factors also play a significant role in early language learning. Children from higher-income families often have greater access to quality education, private language courses, and technological resources. In contrast, those from disadvantaged backgrounds may have limited exposure to foreign languages, which creates educational inequality. Therefore, it is essential to develop inclusive policies that ensure equal access to language education for all children. The role of input and environment is another critical factor in language acquisition. According to Krashen (1982), comprehensible input is essential for effective learning. This means that learners should be exposed to language that is slightly above their current level but still

understandable. In early language education, input should be meaningful, contextualized, and supported by visual and auditory elements. Immersive environments, where the target language is used frequently, can significantly enhance learning outcomes. Teaching methods and classroom practices also influence the success of early language learning. Communicative Language Teaching emphasizes interaction and real-life communication, making it particularly suitable for young learners (Richards & Rodgers, 2014). Activities such as storytelling, songs, games, and role-playing create a dynamic learning environment that motivates children. In such environments, error correction should be handled carefully to avoid discouraging learners. Assessment in early language learning requires alternative approaches that go beyond traditional testing. Observation, portfolios, and performance-based tasks provide a more comprehensive evaluation of children's language abilities. These methods allow teachers to assess not only linguistic knowledge but also communicative competence and participation. Another important aspect is the comparison between early and late language learning. While adults may learn faster in the initial stages due to their developed cognitive skills, children tend to achieve better long-term outcomes, particularly in pronunciation and fluency (Lightbown & Spada, 2013). This distinction highlights the importance of starting language education at an early age while maintaining consistent exposure over time. Parental involvement is also a key factor in successful language learning. Children who receive support from their families are more likely to practice the language outside the classroom. Activities such as reading books, watching educational programs, and engaging in simple conversations can reinforce learning and increase motivation.

Finally, curriculum design plays a crucial role in early language education. An effective curriculum should be flexible, age-appropriate, and focused on communication rather than memorization. It should also incorporate cultural elements and interactive activities to make learning meaningful and enjoyable.

Conclusion

In conclusion, early foreign language learning represents a highly significant and multidimensional area within contemporary educational research, encompassing cognitive, neurological, social, cultural, and pedagogical dimensions. The findings discussed throughout this study clearly demonstrate that childhood is a uniquely advantageous period for language acquisition due to heightened brain plasticity, increased sensitivity to phonological input, and a natural tendency toward implicit learning. These characteristics enable young learners to acquire foreign languages more efficiently and to achieve higher levels of long-term proficiency, particularly in pronunciation and communicative competence. Beyond linguistic outcomes, early foreign language learning contributes substantially to broader cognitive development. As highlighted in the literature, bilingual and multilingual children tend to exhibit enhanced executive functioning, including improved attention control, task-switching abilities, and problem-solving skills (Bialystok, 2001). These cognitive benefits extend into other academic domains, suggesting that early language education not only supports linguistic development but also fosters overall intellectual growth. In this sense, foreign language learning should not be viewed as an isolated subject but rather as an integral component of holistic education. Moreover, the social and cultural implications of early language learning are equally profound. Exposure to different languages inherently involves exposure to different cultures, perspectives, and worldviews. This process promotes intercultural competence, empathy, and tolerance—qualities that are increasingly essential in a globalized and multicultural world. Individuals who develop these competencies at an early age are more likely to become effective communicators and responsible global citizens. Therefore, early foreign language

education plays a crucial role in shaping not only academically successful individuals but also socially aware and culturally sensitive members of society. However, despite these well-documented benefits, the implementation of early foreign language education remains inconsistent and often inadequate. One of the most critical challenges lies in teacher preparation. Effective early language teaching requires educators who possess both strong linguistic competence and specialized pedagogical skills tailored to young learners. Without proper training, teachers may rely on traditional, grammar-focused methods that are not suitable for children and may hinder motivation and engagement. Consequently, investing in teacher education and continuous professional development is essential for improving the quality of early language instruction. In addition to teacher-related issues, disparities in access to educational resources present another significant challenge. Socioeconomic inequalities can limit children's exposure to foreign languages, particularly in underprivileged communities where access to quality materials, technology, and extracurricular opportunities is restricted. Addressing these disparities requires comprehensive educational policies that promote equity and inclusion. Governments and educational institutions must ensure that all children, regardless of their background, have access to high-quality language learning opportunities. Another important consideration is the role of the learning environment. As emphasized in this study, meaningful and comprehensible input is fundamental to successful language acquisition (Krashen, 1982). Therefore, creating immersive and interactive learning environments should be a priority. Classrooms should encourage communication, creativity, and active participation rather than passive memorization. Furthermore, parental involvement should be actively promoted, as support at home significantly enhances the effectiveness of language learning. From a policy perspective, the findings of this study highlight the need for a systematic and long-term approach to early foreign language education. Rather than treating it as an optional or supplementary subject, educational systems should integrate foreign language learning into the core curriculum from the earliest stages of schooling. Curriculum design should be flexible, developmentally appropriate, and focused on communication and interaction. Additionally, the integration of technology should be carefully managed to support, rather than replace, meaningful human interaction in the learning process.

Finally, it is important to recognize that early foreign language learning is not a one-time intervention but a continuous process that requires sustained support over time. Early exposure alone is not sufficient; it must be followed by consistent and progressively advanced instruction to ensure long-term success. Future research should therefore focus on longitudinal studies that examine the lasting effects of early language learning across different contexts and populations. Such research would provide valuable insights into how early educational experiences shape language proficiency and cognitive development in later life. In summary, early foreign language learning offers a wide range of benefits that extend far beyond language acquisition itself. It enhances cognitive abilities, fosters cultural awareness, supports academic achievement, and prepares individuals for active participation in a globalized world. However, realizing these benefits requires careful planning, adequate resources, and a commitment to educational equity. By addressing existing challenges and implementing evidence-based strategies, educational systems can maximize the potential of early language learning and contribute to the development of more competent, adaptable, and globally minded individuals.

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EXPLORING THE GAPS BETWEEN EXPECTATIONS AND REALITY: A STUDY OF FIRST-YEAR ELT STUDENTS

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Abstract: Many students often hold specific expectations about language development, teaching practices, academic workload, course content, and social experiences. This study aims to examine mismatches between expectations and realities and how they affect students' motivation, satisfaction, and academic willingness. In this study, a mixed-methods approach will be used. Quantitative data will be collected through a questionnaire comprising Likert-scale items that measure students' pre-entry expectations and post-entry perceptions. In addition, student interviews were conducted to collect more detailed data to capture students' personal reflections and suggestions. The study is expected to identify both areas of alignment and potential gaps between expectations and reality in the ELT program. These insights may help understand first-year student adjustment and improve program design to better support students' transition into higher education.

Keywords: ELT students, first-year experience, expectations vs. reality, mixed-methods research, student perceptions, academic adjustment

BEKLENTİLER VE GERÇEKLİK ARASINDAKİ UÇURUMUN ARAŞTIRILMASI: İNGİLİZCE ÖĞRETMENLİĞİ (ELT) BİRİNCİ SINIF ÖĞRENCİLERİ ÜZERİNE BİR ÇALIŞMA

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Özet: Birçok öğrenci, dil gelişimi, öğretim uygulamaları, akademik iş yükü, ders içeriği ve sosyal deneyimler hakkında belirli beklentilere sahiptir. Bu çalışma, bu beklentiler ile gerçeklik arasındaki uyumsuzlukları ve bunların öğrencilerin motivasyon düzeyleri, memnuniyetleri ve akademik isteklilikleri üzerindeki etkilerini incelemeyi amaçlamaktadır. Bu çalışmada karma yöntem (mixed-methods) yaklaşımı kullanılacaktır. Nicel veriler, öğrencilerin üniversiteye giriş öncesi beklentilerini ve üniversiteye başladıktan sonraki algılarını ölçen Likert tipi maddelerden oluşan bir anket aracılığıyla toplanacaktır. Buna ek olarak, öğrencilerin kişisel yansımalarını ve önerilerini daha ayrıntılı bir şekilde ortaya koyabilmek amacıyla öğrenci görüşmeleri yapılmıştır. Çalışmanın, ELT programında beklenti ile gerçeklik arasında hem uyumlu alanları hem de olası boşlukları belirlemesi beklenmektedir. Bu bulgular, birinci sınıf öğrencilerinin uyum sürecini anlamaya ve öğrencilerin yükseköğretime geçişlerini daha iyi desteklemek için program tasarımını geliştirmeye katkı sağlayabilir.

Anahtar Kelimeler: ELT öğrencileri, birinci sınıf deneyimi, beklenti ve gerçeklik, karma yöntem araştırması, öğrenci algıları, akademik uyum

1. Introduction

For many students, the transition from high school to university marks a significant change in academic, social, and psychological aspects. While this transition occurs upon entering university, students often unconsciously develop expectations about the social environment, academic life, teaching methods, course content, and personal development opportunities. These expectations are usually shaped by personal aspirations, media representations, prior educational experiences, social expectations, and the university's image (Nadelson et al., 2013). However, the realities students

face at university may not always meet their standards. When expectations and reality mismatch, many students experience disappointment, decreased motivation, difficulty adapting to university life, dissatisfaction with lectures, and a loss of excitement.

Student expectations have become a highly researched topic in higher education contexts due to their influence on academic adjustment, class participation and engagement, and overall educational satisfaction. Some scholars reported that students who enter university with unrealistic or unmet expectations are more prone to low academic motivation, poor emotional well-being, and lower grades. (Smith & Wertlieb, 2005). The first year of university is critical for meeting student expectations because it shapes students' future approaches to their department, academic willingness, and sense of belonging within the institution. (Van Rooij et al., 2018). Therefore, understanding students' insights and expectations and how they compare with reality can provide valuable information for improving educational and social experiences and facilitating student adjustment.

Students often begin university with certain ideas about what their academic and social experiences will be like. When these expectations are not fully met, it can affect how motivated, engaged, or satisfied they feel with their education. Previous research has explored this connection in different educational settings. For example, Vincent Tinto (1993) explains that students are more likely to adapt successfully to university life when they feel academically and socially connected to their institution. In a similar way, Robert W. Baker and Bohdan Siryk (1984) suggest that adjusting to university is not only related to academics, but also to students' social, emotional, and personal experiences. These areas are often determined by students' expectations before starting university. When it comes to shaping students' experiences and motivation, researchers have identified several effective factors, such as teaching quality, classroom communication, and opportunities to improve language skills, that play important roles.

In the field of English Language Teaching (ELT), first graders may have specific aspirations regarding rapid language development, communicative competence, teaching styles, and the level of interactive classroom activities. So many ELT students enter the program expecting intensive speaking practice and quick improvement in their English level. At the same time, they might also expect and hope for a socially engaging university life. On the other hand, the realities of ELT programs may differ from these expectations because of factors such as theoretical course content, academic workload, assessment styles, institutional limitations, and differences in instructional approaches. And as Lee (2016) states, unrealistic expectations may negatively affect adaptation processes and professional perceptions.

Despite the growing attention to and research on student expectations and university adjustment, this attention was limited to first-year ELT students and teacher education programs. While many studies focus on university students in general, fewer examine how ELT students perceive, live, and experience differences between their expectations and the realities they face when they actually begin their lives as active college students. Furthermore, there is still a limited window for research into how these expectations and reality gaps may influence students' motivation, satisfaction, academic willingness, and overall adjustment processes in ELT contexts. Therefore, this study aims to uncover further details and fill additional gaps in the field by analyzing first-year ELT students. In more detail, this study seeks to answer questions about what happens to first-year ELT students during the transition from high school to higher education. This period of transition contains both students' expectations and what happens to those expectations

after a period of lived truth in the faculty. Some examples of those expectations are the duration of lectures, university life, student-centered education, interactive courses, and so on.

This study aims to analyze all aspects of this period: the before (expectations), the during (experiences), and the after (outcomes), and tries to answer the questions below:

1. Before entering university, did first-year ELT students have any expectations regarding their academic and social life? And if they had, what kind of expectations were they?
2. Did they encounter any visible differences between their expected life and their real life?
3. Did these visible differences, in other words, gaps between their expectations and experiences, affect their motivation levels, satisfaction levels, or academic engagement?
4. Do they have any suggestions on improving this transition era and making it easier and more effective for themselves? What changes would have a positive impact on their experiences?

2. Materials and Methods

This study utilized a mixed-methods approach to analyze the gap between first-year English Language Teaching (ELT) students' aspirations before entering the department and their actual experiences while studying their first year at university. The study mainly used a qualitative and descriptive quantitative approach to explore students' perceptions, insights, experiences, and their levels of satisfaction with various aspects of the ELT program. Using both Likert-scale items and open-ended questions helped us, as researchers, identify measurable trends and gain personal insights into students' adjustment to university life.

This study was conducted in the English Language Teaching department of Dokuz Eylul University in Türkiye during the 2025/2026 academic year. The research focused specifically on first-year ELT students, as the transition from high school to university involves a significant academic, social, and psychological adjustment. The study aimed to examine how students' expectations regarding language development, teaching methods, academic environment, and social experiences compared with the realities they encountered during their first year in the department.

22 first-year ELT students participated in the study. For convenience, a questionnaire was used due to accessibility. Every student who participated completed the questionnaire anonymously and voluntarily. The participants' expectations, backgrounds, cultures, experiences, and perspectives varied widely. The collected data provided insights into the early adaptation process within the department, as the study focused on first-year students.

In this study, an adjusted and adapted survey was utilized. The questionnaire was built on existing literature on students' expectations, insights, perceptions, and the transitional era in higher education, especially the work of Khaleel and Ali (2023) on ELT students. Several points were adjusted linguistically to better suit first-year ELT students. The questionnaire includes 20 five-point Likert-type questions. These 20 questions were divided into 2 complementary areas. The first 10 questions covered pre-entry expectations, while the last 10 examined post-entry perceptions. This design helped the researchers analyze the results more efficiently, leading to clearer identification of the gaps.

The questions were based on the research objectives, aims, and relevant literature on student expectations, adaptation to college life, and English Language Teaching, to ensure the questionnaire is valid and yields solid findings. After these steps, the questionnaire was carefully analyzed and reviewed to ensure it posed clear questions, was relevant to the field, and was appropriate for first-year ELT students in terms of their language proficiency and linguistic competence. Since the focus

of this study is students' experiences, the findings were analyzed by identifying common ideas, themes, and patterns in their responses.

By using descriptive analysis techniques, the collected data were examined. Answers claimed from the Likert-scale items were analyzed to highlight general habits, similarities, and differences between students' expectations and actual experiences. The findings were evaluated by examining responses and identifying common and distinct themes. The qualitative open-ended questions were analyzed by focusing on repeated ideas and related experiences. Expectations, university life, struggles, disappointments, decline in motivation, classroom interaction, and practical experiences were among the themes that emerged from students' answers and were used to support the quantitative results.

In this study, ethical issues were carefully considered. The students were informed beforehand and kept up to date on any changes throughout the study. All the participants' identities were kept anonymous. Also, confidentiality was protected. The collected data was only used for academic purposes. Students who participated in the study were informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any time and could decline to answer any questions they didn't feel comfortable answering.

3. Results and Discussions

As expected at the beginning of the study, the findings showed that there was a significant gap between expectations and experiences among first-year ELT students. A big part of the students is expected to improve their speaking skills while also improving their overall language skills. The majority of them believed that there would be more interactive classes where they could practice and be able to speak more comfortably in the classroom. However, some of these expectations were not fully met as they had hoped. Some participants also stated that some courses were mostly theoretical rather than practical. Some of them also mentioned that this mismatch between hopes and reality affected their motivation and willingness to learn.

Table 1. General Comparison of Expectations and Experiences

Area	Expectations	Actual Experiences
Speaking Skill Development	High	Moderate
Interactive Classes	High	Moderate
Practical Teaching Opportunities	High	Low
Motivation	High	Moderate
Social Environment	Positive	Positive

As shown in Table 1, the largest gap was seen in practical teaching opportunities and classroom interaction. While students expected more active, sociable, and practical lessons, many described their experiences as more theoretical and sometimes repetitive.

Table 2. Common Themes in Open-Ended Responses

Theme	Student Responses
Expectations	Improving speaking skills, active participation, supportive environment
Disappointments	More theoretical courses, crowded classes, and less interaction
Suggestions	More practical activities, interactive lessons, and speaking opportunities

The responses to the open-ended questions supported the quantitative findings. Even though the majority of participants chose not to answer the open-ended questions, the few responses showed similar ideas about classroom interaction, participation, motivation, and, again, practical

learning experiences. Taken as a whole, the findings suggest that first-year ELT students undergo an adjustment as they adapt to the realities of university education and life.

4. Conclusion

The study's findings reveal that ELT students' expectations for their first year of education do not fully align with their experiences, and, in most cases, this leads to disappointment. Students enter university with positive expectations, such as interactive courses, a student-centered approach, more speaking opportunities, greater socialization, more classroom participation, and less reliance on a theoretical framework. The findings above showed that they faced a more theoretical environment than an interactional one. The problem of theoretical courses might be related to the ELT department's course design, as in the first year, mainly theoretical classes are offered. And as students mature, more practical classes are added. But this structure can be discouraging for students who enter the department hoping for actual teaching opportunities. These findings are also supported by previous studies related to student expectations and university adaptation. James (2002) states that "students may develop unrealistically high expectations" (p. 71), especially during the transition from high school to higher education. This leads to a decline in motivation in students' academic life.

So, these findings suggest that ELT programs may benefit from creating a more interactive learning environment for students. Giving them more opportunities to speak and teach might benefit students' motivation and development in the years ahead. Moreover, reducing the theoretical workload and increasing classroom participation and group work may help students feel like actual members of the language-teaching community and give them a sense of belonging within their department. As a result, students may adapt to university life more easily.

Although this study helped better understand freshman ELT students, it has several limitations. First, the sample size is very small, with only 22 participants from the same class and department, which may bias the study. It also prohibits the study from being generalized for all ELT departments. Another limitation was that most students didn't answer the open-ended questions, which prevented us from analyzing and interpreting a substantial amount of qualitative data. In other words, the study needed more qualitative answers.

Current studies in the field lack diversity in terms of backgrounds, cultures, and universities. When analyzing first-year ELT students' expectations, most recent studies are limited. Future research can focus on closing this gap; they might aim for larger, more diverse, unbiased samples. And lastly, future research can also focus on how first-year expectations and experiences shape second, third, and fourth years of university. It can focus on the long-term effects.

In conclusion, this research highlighted mismatches and gaps between expectations and experiences among first-year ELT students at Dokuz Eylul University. The majority of the students stated that what they had hoped did not match their reality. Although many students reported positive experiences, several also noted that the department could improve how classes are conducted and taught. They stated the need for interactive courses, more speaking opportunities, and fewer theoretical classes. Overall, the findings show that the first year of university is not just an academic shift from high school to higher education, but also a critical process of adjustment and adaptation for many students.

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DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS: EFFECTIVE STRATEGIES FOR SPEAKING, READING, LISTENING, AND WRITING

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Abstract: The development of foreign language skills remains one of the central aims of modern language education. Effective communication depends on the balanced improvement of four key skills: speaking, listening, reading, and writing. However, many learners experience uneven progress, as they often perform better in some areas than in others. This article examines the common difficulties learners face in developing these skills and discusses practical strategies to support improvement. The study is based on the analysis of relevant literature in the field of language teaching and second language acquisition, together with observations commonly reported in classroom practice. The discussion shows that speaking is often limited by anxiety, lack of confidence, and insufficient practice, while listening difficulties are frequently connected with vocabulary limitations, speech rate, and reduced exposure to authentic input. Reading comprehension may be influenced by decoding difficulties, limited background knowledge, and limited vocabulary, whereas writing is commonly affected by grammatical inaccuracies, organizational challenges, and dependence on the first language. The findings suggest that regular practice, meaningful exposure to language, learner

motivation, constructive feedback, and the integration of all four skills can significantly improve overall proficiency. It is concluded that successful language learning requires a consistent, learner-centered, and skill-balanced approach.

Keywords: foreign language learning, language skills development, speaking proficiency, reading comprehension, listening comprehension, writing skills, language teaching strategies.

XARİCİ DİL BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAFI: DANIŞIQ, OXU, DİNLƏMƏ VƏ YAZI ÜZRƏ SƏMƏRƏLİ STRATEGİYALAR

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Xülasə: Xarici dil bacarıqlarının inkişafı müasir dil təhsilinin əsas məqsədlərindən biri olaraq qalır. Səmərəli ünsiyyət danışiq, dinləmə, oxu və yazı olmaqla dörd əsas dil bacarığının balanslı şəkildə inkişaf etdirilməsindən asılıdır. Bununla belə, bir çox öyrənənlər bu bacarıqların inkişafında qeyri-bərabər irəliləyiş göstərir, çünki onlar adətən bəzi sahələrdə digərlərinə nisbətən daha yüksək nəticələr əldə edirlər. Bu məqalədə öyrənənlərin həmin bacarıqları inkişaf etdirərkən qarşılaşdıqları ümumi çətinliklər araşdırılır və onların aradan qaldırılmasına kömək edən praktik strategiyalar müzakirə olunur. Tədqiqat dil tədrisi və ikinci dilin mənimsənilməsi sahəsində mövcud elmi ədəbiyyatın təhlilində, eləcə də sinif təcrübəsində geniş müşahidə olunan nəticələrə əsaslanır. Müzakirələr göstərir ki, danışiq bacarığı çox vaxt həyəcan, özünəinamın aşağı olması və kifayət qədər praktikanın olmaması səbəbindən məhdudlaşır. Dinləyib-anlama bacarığında yaranan çətinliklər isə əsasən məhdud söz ehtiyatı, nitqin sürəti və autentik dil materiallarına kifayət qədər məruz qalmamaqla əlaqədardır. Oxuyub-anlama bacarığı sözlərin düzgün qavranılması, məhdud əvvəlki biliklər və zəif lüğət ehtiyatından təsirlənə bilər. Yazı bacarığında isə qrammatik səhvlər, mətnin təşkili ilə bağlı çətinliklər və ana dilinin təsiri daha çox müşahidə olunur. Tədqiqatın nəticələri göstərir ki, müntəzəm məşq, dilə davamlı və məqsədyönlü şəkildə məruz qalma, öyrənənlərin motivasiyasının artırılması, konstruktiv geribildirim və dörd dil bacarığının inteqrasiyalı şəkildə inkişaf etdirilməsi ümumi dil səriştəsinin əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə yüksəlməsinə kömək edir. Nəticə etibarilə, uğurlu xarici dil öyrənilməsi ardıcıl, öyrənməyönlü və bütün dil bacarıqlarının tarazlı inkişafına əsaslanan yanaşma tələb edir.

Açar sözlər: xarici dilin öyrənilməsi, dil bacarıqlarının inkişafı, danışiq bacarığı, oxuyub-anlama, dinləyib-anlama, yazı bacarığı, dil tədrisi strategiyaları.

Introduction

In today's world, learning a foreign language has become more important than ever. People need language skills for education, employment, travel, access to information, and communication with others from different cultural backgrounds. As international contact continues to grow, the ability to use a foreign language effectively is no longer seen as an extra advantage but as a practical necessity. For this reason, the development of language skills has become one of the main goals of modern education systems. Humanity built the internet, and now everyone needs English to reset a password.

Successful language learning is usually measured through four basic skills: speaking, listening, reading, and writing. These skills are closely connected and often support one another during the learning process. For example, regular listening can improve pronunciation and speaking

confidence, while reading can strengthen vocabulary and grammar that later appear in writing. However, learners do not always progress equally in all four areas. Some students may read well but hesitate to speak, while others communicate orally but struggle with writing accurately.

Many factors can slow down progress in foreign language learning. Limited exposure to the target language, fear of making mistakes, low motivation, limited vocabulary, and lack of regular practice are among the most common challenges learners face. In classroom settings, teachers often observe that students understand more than they can actively produce. This gap between passive knowledge and active use can lead to frustration and undermine confidence if not addressed properly.

Because of these difficulties, it is important to examine practical ways to support balanced skill development. The purpose of this article is to discuss common obstacles learners face in speaking, listening, reading, and writing, and to present effective strategies that can help improve overall language proficiency.

Materials and Methods

This article is based on a qualitative review of literature related to foreign language teaching, second language acquisition, and skill development. Academic books, journal articles, and well-known studies on speaking, listening, reading, and writing were examined to identify the main difficulties learners commonly face and the strategies most frequently recommended by researchers and teachers. Since apparently the world prefers endless articles before doing simple things, there was no shortage of material.

The study also draws on practical observations from classroom contexts, where learners often show different strengths and weaknesses across the four language skills. Attention was given to recurring issues such as speaking anxiety, limited vocabulary, listening comprehension problems, weak reading strategies, and difficulties in organizing written work. These challenges were compared with methods suggested in previous research and common teaching practice.

The collected information was analyzed descriptively. Similar findings from different sources were grouped into categories connected with each language skill. As a result, the article presents a structured discussion of common barriers to language development together with practical strategies that may help learners improve their overall proficiency. No experimental procedure was carried out, and no numerical data were used, as the main purpose of the study is analytical and pedagogical rather than statistical.

Results and Discussion

Development of speaking skills

Speaking is widely considered a core component of language proficiency and is often identified by learners as one of the most challenging skills to develop. Learners frequently experience difficulty speaking a foreign language due to anxiety, limited opportunities for practice, and fear of making errors, despite possessing sufficient grammatical and lexical knowledge. Identifying factors that hinder performance is often considered essential for the effective development of any skill.

One of the main reasons for the struggle is the lack of exposure to the target language. Limited exposure to meaningful input reduces opportunities for natural language acquisition (Ellis, 2008). Therefore, most students struggle to express their thoughts, opinions, or feelings in a foreign language when needed. Additionally, making mistakes can be discouraging, so creating a supportive environment that builds self-confidence is essential. Students often find it unpleasant to make mistakes or pause frequently, so they choose not to speak at all, which leads to

underdeveloped speaking skills. According to Krashen's Affective Filter Hypothesis, emotional barriers, such as anxiety, can significantly impede language acquisition (Krashen, 1982).

Another core obstacle to talking might be a lack of foundational language skills in the target language, such as basic grammar and vocabulary. According to Ellis (2008), learners need a developing knowledge of grammar and vocabulary to successfully produce spoken language.

To address these obstacles, some methods can be discussed and learned. One way to enhance speaking skills in a non-native language is to expose oneself to the target language in as many ways as possible, such as having foreign friends, listening to podcasts and music, watching movies, and reading books in that language. Extensive exposure to authentic materials, such as films, music, and interaction, contributes to more natural language acquisition (Nation, 2001).

In classroom practice, when teachers welcome mistakes, students can gain the most benefit from role-plays, debates, pair work, interviews, and short presentations. As Harmer states, communicative activities such as role-plays, debates, and pair work are widely recognized as effective techniques for developing speaking proficiency (Harmer, 2007; Ur, 1996).

Fluency development, though gradual, often results from systematic repetition and sustained practice rather than sudden improvement.

Development of listening skills

Listening is considered a foundational skill in second language acquisition, as comprehension of input is essential for language production (Krashen, 1982; Rost, 2011). Learners cannot produce a language by speaking alone if they lack sufficient listening ability. Limited listening comprehension can negatively affect learners' speaking performance, as communication depends on successful understanding of input (Field, 2008; Vandergrift, 2007). Provided that we do not understand what is being said, we are unable to respond effectively. Therefore, listening is a skill that requires continuous practice.

Turning to barriers to listening skills, research has shown that limited vocabulary knowledge is one of the most frequently reported causes of breakdowns in listening comprehension (Buck, 2001; Azmi Bingol et al., 2014). To address this issue, it is recommended to listen to authentic recordings, such as news, songs, and educational videos, to expand vocabulary.

Secondly, it is believed that when students listen to various authentic recordings aligned with their interests, they can benefit greatly. Learners' interest and motivation have been shown to facilitate better comprehension by lowering the affective filter and increasing engagement (Dörnyei, 2001; Krashen, 1982).

Thirdly, many students struggle with the recording's speed since native speakers speak faster, use connected speech, and use informal pronunciation. John Field (2008) explains that spoken language processing requires rapid recognition of sounds and meaning. To overcome these challenges, learners are encouraged to engage in extensive listening, shadowing techniques, and scaffolded exposure strategies such as initial use of subtitles followed by gradual removal as proficiency increases (Rost, 2011; Vandergrift & Goh, 2012).

Overall, listening development is therefore a continuous and essential process that underpins overall language proficiency and requires consistent exposure, practice, and learner engagement to achieve effective communication.

Development of reading skills

Reading is a skill that young learners try to develop as they begin learning their mother tongue or a second language. This article argues that reading should not be approached in isolation

when learning. As noted by multiple researchers, children who have problems with reading comprehension also have difficulties with listening, as these two skills are linked. (Smiley 1977).

However, many students struggle to develop this skill due to a variety of linguistic, cognitive, and motivational factors. Civilization invented books and then acted surprised when students struggled with them. In this article, we will discuss the problems the students face and the ways to help them overcome them.

A restricted vocabulary is one of the most common barriers to reading comprehension. When learners encounter too many unfamiliar words, they may lose the overall meaning of the text and become discouraged (Nation, 2001). To overcome this problem, teachers should provide explicit vocabulary instruction, pre-teach key words before reading, and encourage extensive reading to expand lexical knowledge.

Another problem can be a lack of background knowledge. Comprehension is strongly influenced by prior knowledge. Students may struggle to understand texts related to unfamiliar topics, cultures, or experiences (Anderson & Pearson, 1984). Activating students' background knowledge through pre-reading discussions, visuals, and brainstorming activities can improve understanding.

Difficulty identifying main ideas is frequently seen among students. Some learners focus excessively on details and fail to recognize the central theme or purpose of a passage (Grabe, 2009). To address this issue, teachers can train students to identify topic sentences, headings, and supporting details through guided practice.

Last but not least, some students do not know how to use strategies such as skimming, scanning, summarizing, or monitoring comprehension while reading (Oxford, 1990). To cope with this challenge, teachers should explicitly teach reading strategies and provide regular opportunities for practice.

Learners who are eager to develop their reading skills should focus on extensive reading, which involves reading large volumes of relatively easy, interesting texts. This builds fluency, vocabulary recognition, and reading speed over time, as supported by Day & Bamford (1998).

Development of writing skills

Writing is a productive skill that requires greater accuracy, vocabulary, and grammatical knowledge (Harmer, 2007; Hyland, 2019). Writing is a tool of communication that students need both in academic and professional life. Learners can achieve their goals through strong writing skills in their education and professional development. Harmer lays stress on the essentiality of the writing skill, saying "The reasons for teaching writing to students of English as a foreign language include reinforcement, language development, learning style, and most importantly, writing as a skill in its own right."

Writing in a second language is needed in different areas:

- To make presentations
- In searching or applying for a job
- Communication at work by emailing
- Writing academic reports and doing research
- Getting reliable information from different resources, etc.

Despite its benefits, many students may want to avoid writing for various reasons.

Firstly, when learners have limited vocabulary and knowledge of grammar, they can make frequent mistakes. A limited vocabulary and insufficient grammatical knowledge often lead to

frequent errors in second language writing, which can further decrease learners' confidence (Nation, 2001; Ellis, 2006).

Secondly, students often rely on their first language when producing second-language writing, which may lead to incorrect structures and literal translations that do not fit target-language rules (Selinker, 1972; Cook, 2016). Learners may translate ideas, patterns, or expressions directly from their mother tongue, resulting in incorrect use of the target language. To address this problem, students must consistently work on their writing, get plenty of practice, and develop their skills through constructive teacher feedback. Without proper practice, it is hard to reach a desirable level in writing.

Thirdly, students may struggle with organization when writing in a second language. Some students have ideas but cannot structure them logically. Cognitive writing models suggest that effective writing requires planning, organizing, and revising, which are often underdeveloped in L2 learners (Flower & Hayes, 1981). As a result, their writing may lack clear introductions, supporting paragraphs, or conclusions. To overcome this problem, planning before writing, using outlining, mind mapping, or brainstorming techniques can boost one's writing skills.

In conclusion, writing is an essential skill in a modern world where communication is largely through writing across every aspect of life. Although students face challenges in organizing their thoughts, translating from their L1, or struggling with limited grammar and vocabulary, they can develop with enough practice and structure.

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THE ROLE OF MOTIVATION IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract: This article investigates the role of motivation in foreign language teaching. Motivation is considered one of the most important psychological factors affecting language learning success. The study examines internal and external motivation, their influence on students' learning activities, and the methods teachers use to increase learners' interest in foreign languages. (Gardner, 1985)

The article also analyzes the relationship between motivation and academic achievement in language learning. Different teaching strategies, classroom atmosphere, communication skills, and technological tools are discussed as important motivational factors. The theoretical ideas of several linguists and educators related to motivation in education are also examined.

Furthermore, the article emphasizes that motivated students participate more actively in lessons, develop language skills more effectively, and achieve better results in communication. The study mainly relies on descriptive and comparative analysis methods.

Key words: motivation, foreign language, teaching, learning process, internal motivation, external motivation

XARİCİ DİL TƏDRİSİNDƏ MOTİVASİYANIN ROLU

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Xülasə: Məqalədə xarici dilin tədrisində motivasiyanın rolu araşdırılır. Motivasiya dil öyrənməsinin uğuruna təsir edən ən vacib psixoloji amillərdən biri hesab olunur. Tədqiqatda daxili və xarici motivasiya, onların tələbələrin öyrənmə fəaliyyətinə təsiri və müəllimlərin şagirdlərdə xarici dilə maraq yaratmaq üsulları təhlil edilir.

Məqalədə həmçinin motivasiya ilə akademik nailiyyət arasındakı əlaqə araşdırılır. Müxtəlif tədris strategiyaları, sinif mühiti, ünsiyyət bacarıqları və texnoloji vasitələr motivasiyaya təsir edən əsas amillər kimi təqdim olunur. Təhsil və motivasiya ilə bağlı müxtəlif alimlərin nəzəri fikirlərinə də yer verilir.

Bundan əlavə, motivasiyalı tələbələrin dərslərdə daha fəal iştirak etdiyi, dil bacarıqlarını daha sürətlə inkişaf etdirdiyi və ünsiyyət zamanı daha uğurlu nəticələr əldə etdiyi vurğulanır. Tədqiqat əsasən təsviri və müqayisəli təhlil metodlarına əsaslanır.

Açar sözlər: motivasiya, xarici dil, tədris, təlim prosesi, daxili motivasiya, xarici motivasiya

Introduction

Foreign language teaching is one of the most important areas of modern education. In today's globalized world, learning foreign languages has become necessary for communication, education, professional development, and cultural exchange. (Harmer, 2007) However, successful language learning depends not only on teaching methods but also on students' motivation.

Motivation plays a central role in the learning process. It encourages learners to participate actively in classroom activities, complete tasks successfully, and improve their language skills continuously. Without motivation, even effective teaching methods may fail to produce positive learning outcomes. Therefore, teachers should pay special attention to increasing students' interest and enthusiasm for language learning (Harmer, 2007)

There are two main types of motivation in foreign language teaching: internal and external motivation. Internal motivation appears when learners study a language because of personal interest, enjoyment, or self-development. (Deci & Ryan, 1985) External motivation is related to outside factors such as grades, exams, rewards, career opportunities, or social expectations. Both forms of motivation influence the success of language acquisition.

Modern teaching approaches focus on creating a learner-centered environment where students feel confident, active, and interested in communication. Teachers use interactive activities, games, discussions, group work, and digital technologies to increase learners' motivation and participation in lessons.

Methodology and materials

The selection of a mixed -methods approach for this research is driven by the complexity of artificial intelligence in academic environments. Since academic writing is both a cognitive and a technical process, relying on a single data source would provide an incomplete perspective. The motivation for choosing the specific methods in this study is outlined below:

These methods were selected based on their suitability to the research goals. This also enhances the reliability of the data and allows for a more precise analysis of the result.

Discussion

The findings of this study demonstrate that motivation plays a decisive role in the process of foreign language teaching and learning. (Ellis, 1997) Both intrinsic and extrinsic motivation significantly influence learners' academic performance, participation in classroom activities, willingness to communicate, and overall language achievement. The discussion of the results reveals that motivated learners tend to show greater persistence, confidence, and enthusiasm during the language learning process compared to learners with low motivation levels.

One of the major points observed in the study is the importance of intrinsic motivation in successful foreign language acquisition. (Deci & Ryan, 1985) Learners who study a foreign language because of personal interest, curiosity, enjoyment, or self-development usually achieve more sustainable and long-term success. Intrinsically motivated students participate more actively

in classroom discussions, complete tasks with greater responsibility, and willingly practice language skills outside the classroom environment. Such learners are generally more independent and capable of overcoming difficulties encountered during the learning process. This confirms the idea that internal desire and personal interest are among the strongest driving forces in education.

At the same time, the research also highlights the considerable impact of extrinsic motivation. External factors such as grades, examinations, certificates, scholarships, parental expectations, career opportunities, and social recognition can encourage students to learn a foreign language more seriously. In many educational settings, especially in formal academic environments, extrinsic motivation serves as an initial stimulus that attracts learners toward language study. However, the study suggests that relying solely on external rewards may not always ensure long-term learning success. When external rewards disappear, students may lose interest if intrinsic motivation has not been developed simultaneously. Therefore, teachers should aim to transform extrinsic motivation into intrinsic motivation by creating meaningful and engaging learning experiences. (Gardner, 1985)

Another important aspect discussed in the study is the role of teachers in motivating students. The teacher is not only a provider of knowledge but also a key motivational figure in the classroom. Positive teacher attitudes, supportive feedback, effective classroom management, interactive teaching methods, and encouragement can greatly increase students' motivation levels. Students tend to feel more confident and comfortable in classrooms where teachers create a friendly, respectful, and stress-free atmosphere. Conversely, overly strict teaching methods, lack of communication, and monotonous lessons may reduce learners' interest and participation. Thus, the professional competence and emotional support provided by teachers are essential for maintaining learner motivation.

The study also emphasizes the significance of modern teaching methods and technological tools in motivating learners. Interactive activities such as group discussions, role plays, games, multimedia resources, online platforms, and audiovisual materials make language learning more attractive and enjoyable. Technology provides learners with authentic language exposure and allows them to practice listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills in real-life contexts. Especially in the digital age, students are more motivated when educational content is connected with modern communication technologies and real-world applications.

In addition, the findings indicate that classroom environment and peer interaction strongly affect learner motivation. Cooperative learning activities and positive peer relationships increase students' confidence and reduce anxiety during language learning. Learners who feel accepted and supported by classmates are more willing to express themselves in the target language. Anxiety, fear of making mistakes, and lack of self-confidence are common barriers in foreign language learning, and motivation

Conclusion

In conclusion, motivation is one of the most essential factors in the successful teaching and learning of foreign languages. The study has shown that both intrinsic and extrinsic motivation strongly influence learners' attitudes, participation, academic achievement, and overall language development. Students who are highly motivated demonstrate greater interest in learning activities, stronger communication skills, and more persistence in overcoming difficulties during the educational process.

The research also confirms that intrinsic motivation, which comes from personal interest, enjoyment, and self-development, has a long-lasting and more effective impact on language

learning success. At the same time, extrinsic motivation such as grades, rewards, career opportunities, and social recognition can encourage learners and support their educational progress. However, for sustainable success, external motivation should gradually develop into internal motivation. (Deci & Ryan, 1985)

Another important conclusion is the significant role of teachers in motivating learners. Supportive teacher behavior, interactive teaching methods, positive classroom atmosphere, and the use of modern technologies can increase students' willingness to learn a foreign language. Educational institutions should therefore focus on learner-centered approaches and motivational strategies that create active and engaging learning environments.

Furthermore, the study highlights that motivation is not fixed and may change depending on educational experiences, social environment, and personal goals. Continuous encouragement, constructive feedback, and meaningful learning activities are necessary to maintain students' motivation throughout the learning process. (Ushioda, 2011)

Overall, foreign language teaching becomes more effective when motivation is properly supported and developed. Motivation not only improves academic performance but also helps learners become more confident, independent, and successful communicators in the target language. Therefore, teachers, parents, and educational institutions should work together to strengthen learner motivation and create opportunities for successful foreign language acquisition.

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INNOVATIVE APPROACHES TO ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING IN THE POST-PANDEMIC ERA

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Abstract: The COVID-19 pandemic changed people's learning and teaching. Many schools and universities went from traditional classroom lessons to online or hybrid learning. According to change, new methods were founded by teachers. These changes created new trends in teaching and learning English.

This article consists of different approaches that are used in classrooms after the pandemic. It focuses on hybrid learning, task-based language teaching, gamification, mobile-assisted language learning (MALL), and the flipped classroom model. With the help of these methods students practice English in more interactive ways. Also, they increase students' motivation to learn the language.

Another important point is the role of emotional intelligence in language learning. It is crucial that students feel comfortable during the lesson. This increases students' activity in classroom.

This article shows new methods and shows their impact on improvement of students. Besides, modern methods make English learning more effective. It is important to use these methods to develop students' understanding and learning in class.

Keywords: English language teaching, hybrid learning, gamification, MALL, communicative competence

PANDEMİYADAN SONRAKİ DÖVRDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ İNNOVATİV YANAŞMALAR

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Xülasə: COVID-19 pandemiyası insanların öyrənməsini və tədrisini dəyişdirdi. Bir çox məktəb və universitet ənənəvi sinif dərslərindən onlayn və ya hibrid təlimə keçdi. Dəyişikliyə uyğun olaraq, müəllimlər tərəfindən yeni metodlar yaradıldı. Bu dəyişikliklər ingilis dilinin tədrisi və öyrənilməsində yeni trendlər yaratdı.

Bu məqalə pandemiyaadan sonra sinif otaqlarında istifadə olunan müxtəlif yanaşmalardan ibarətdir. Hibrid təlim, tapşırıq əsaslı dil tədrisi, oyunlaşdırma, mobil dəstəklili dil öyrənməsi (MALL) və çevrilmiş sinif modelinə diqqət yetirir. Bu metodların köməyi ilə tələbələr ingilis dilini daha interaktiv şəkildə tətbiq edirlər. Həmçinin, onlar tələbələrin dili öyrənmək motivasiyasını artırır.

Digər vacib məqam isə emosional zəkanın dil öyrənməsində roludur. Tələbələrin dərslər zamanı özlərini rahat hiss etmələri vacibdir. Bu, tələbələrin sinifdə fəallığını artırır.

Bu məqalə yeni metodları göstərir və onların tələbələrin inkişafına təsirini göstərir. Bundan əlavə, müasir metodlar ingilis dilinin öyrənilməsini daha effektiv edir. Bu metodlardan tələbələrin dərslərdə anlayışını və öyrənməsini inkişaf etdirmək üçün istifadə etmək vacibdir.

Açar sözlər: ingilis dili tədrisi, hibrid təlim, oyunlaşdırma, MALL, kommunikativ səriştə

Intorduction

English is one of the most popular languages in the world today. People use English for different reasons. For instance : work, travel, and international communication. Because of this, learning English became very important for students in many countries.

In recent years, the education system has changed a lot. Many schools and universities had to move their traditional class to online . In this time , teachers had to find new ways and methods to keep students interested in learning.

Universities such as Mingəçevir Dövlət Universiteti are also interested in using modern teaching approaches to improve the quality of language education. Teachers today try to create more interactive learning environments.

This article discusses some important trends in English language teaching after the pandemic. It focuses on hybrid learning, task-based learning, gamification, mobile learning, the flipped classroom model, and emotional intelligence in language learning. (P.D. Deep and Y.Chen, 2025)

Hybrid Learning in English Language Education. One of the most noticeable changes is the use of hybrid learning. Hybrid learning combines traditional classroom lessons with online learning activities. This model allows students to study both in class and at home using platforms. For many students this method is very helpful because they can revise the materials several times and learn at their own way. For example, students can watch recorded lectures, read online materials, and complete exercises outside the classroom. At the same time, classroom lessons give them the opportunity to communicate with the teacher and practice speaking with other students. Because of this balance, hybrid learning can support both independent learning and classroom interaction.

Another advantage of hybrid learning is that it supports different learning styles. Some students learn better by listening, while others prefer reading or watching visual materials. Online resources allow teachers to provide different types of materials so that students can choose what works best for them. This can improve students' understanding and make learning more effective.

Task-Based Language Teaching and Communicative Competence

Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) is a method that focuses on using language to complete real-life tasks. Instead of only studying grammar rules, students practice English through activities such as discussions, role-plays, and problem-solving tasks.

In task-based learning, students work together to complete meaningful activities. For example, they may plan a trip, discuss a problem, or present an idea to the class.

This method helps students improve their speaking and communication skills. It also increases confidence because students use English for real communication.

Task-based learning encourages cooperation and teamwork. Students learn from each other and practice language in a natural way.

Gamification in English Language Learning

Gamification also plays an important role in modern language teaching. Many students feel more motivated when learning activities are fun and interactive. By using elements of games such as points, levels, rewards, or competitions, teachers can make lessons more interesting. For example, vocabulary quizzes, language games, and team competitions can encourage students to participate more actively. When students enjoy the learning process, they learn more productive and improve their language skills.

Teachers can use different types of games in language lessons. For example, vocabulary games can help students remember new words, while grammar competitions can help them practice language structures. Interactive quizzes and online games can also be used to review lesson

materials. These activities not only improve students' knowledge but also increase their motivation to learn.

Mobile-Assisted Language Learning (MALL)

Mobile-Assisted Language Learning (MALL) uses mobile devices such as smartphones and tablets to support language learning.

Today, many students use mobile phones every day. These devices can be useful tools for learning English. Students can use language learning applications, watch educational videos, or listen to English podcasts.

Mobile learning allows students to practice English anytime and anywhere. They can study while traveling, waiting, or during free time.

This method also supports independent learning because students can choose their own learning materials and pace.

However, teachers should also pay attention to how students use mobile devices effectively for learning. Sometimes mobile phones can distract students from studying. Therefore, it is important to use them in a balanced and responsible way.

Flipped Classroom Model in English Teaching

The flipped classroom model is another modern teaching method. In this model, students study lesson materials at home before coming to class.

For example, they may watch a video lecture or read learning materials before the lesson. Then, during classroom time, students practice what they learned through discussions, group activities, and exercises.

This approach changes the traditional structure of the classroom. Instead of spending class time explaining theory, teachers can use the time for communication activities and practical exercises.

The flipped classroom model encourages students to take a more active role in their learning. It also allows teachers to give more individual support during classroom activities. However, this model requires students to be responsible and prepared before class. If students do not review the materials, it may be difficult for them to participate fully in classroom activities.

When students come to class already prepared, teachers can focus more on communication activities, discussions, and practice exercises. This makes lessons more interactive and allows students to use English actively. Students also have more opportunities to ask questions and clarify difficult topics.

This method allows teachers to use class time more effectively. Instead of explaining theory, teachers can focus on discussion in the classroom.

The flipped classroom also helps students become more responsible for their learning.

Emotional Intelligence and Language Learning Success

Emotional intelligence is the ability to understand and manage emotions. It is also important in language learning.

Many students feel nervous when they speak a foreign language. They may be afraid of making mistakes or speaking in front of others. Emotional intelligence helps students control these feelings and become more confident.

Teachers can help students overcome these difficulties by creating a supportive and friendly classroom environment. When students feel comfortable, they are more willing to participate in discussions and practice speaking. Encouraging cooperation, giving positive feedback, and respecting students' efforts can also help improve their emotional well-being in the

classroom. Teachers can support students by creating a friendly and supportive classroom atmosphere. When students feel comfortable, they participate more actively and learn more effectively.

Positive feedback and encouragement also help students develop confidence in their language abilities.

In addition, emotional support from teachers can increase students' motivation and interest in learning. When students feel safe and respected, they are more likely to participate actively in discussions and communication activities. This can have a positive effect on their language development and overall learning experience.

Another important point is that modern teaching approaches encourage students to become independent learners. Instead of relying only on the teacher, students learn how to search for information, use digital technology, and practice language skills outside the classroom. This independence is very important for long-term language development.

By combining traditional teaching methods with modern educational technologies, English language learning can become more effective and better adapted to the needs of today's students.

Discussion

The analysis in this article shows that English language teaching has changed in recent years. After the COVID-19 pandemic, teachers started to use more technology and new teaching methods in their lessons. These changes helped teachers continue education during difficult times, and many of these methods are still used today.

One important change is the use of hybrid learning. Combining online and classroom learning gives students more flexibility. Students can review materials online and practice language skills in the classroom. This can help students understand the lesson better and learn at their own place.

Task-based learning is also very useful in English language classes. When students work on tasks such as discussions, presentations, or problem-solving activities, they use English in real communication. This helps them become more confident and improve their speaking skills.

Gamification can also make lessons more interesting for students. When teachers use games, quizzes, or competitions, students often feel more motivated. Learning becomes more enjoyable, and students participate more actively in the lesson.

Mobile-assisted language learning is another helpful tool. Many students use smartphones every day, so language learning applications can help their studies outside the classroom. Students can practice vocabulary, listening, and pronunciation whenever they have free time.

The flipped classroom model also changes the way students learn. When students study lesson materials before class, classroom time can be used for discussions and practice. This can make lessons more interactive and student-centered.

Another important point discussed in this article is emotional intelligence. Students who feel comfortable and confident in the classroom are more likely to participate and communicate in English. Teachers should therefore create a supportive and positive learning environment.

However, it is also important to remember that technology should support learning rather than replace the teacher. Teachers still play a key role in guiding students, organizing learning activities, and creating a positive classroom atmosphere.

Methodology and materials

This article is based on reading and analyzing different sources about modern methods of teaching English. The main goal of the study is to understand how English language teaching has changed, especially after the COVID-19 pandemic. (P.D. Deep and Y.Chen, 2025)

Conclusion

The post-pandemic period has changed many aspects of education, including English language teaching. New technologies and modern teaching methods have become an important part of the learning process.

Hybrid learning, task-based learning, gamification, mobile-assisted learning, and flipped classroom models all help improve student engagement and communication skills. These methods create more interactive and flexible learning environments.

Teachers should continue using innovative approaches and digital tools to support effective language learning. By combining technology with good teaching strategies, English language education can become more interesting and successful for students.

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THE IMPACT OF AN ANALYTICAL AND CRITICAL THINKING COURSE ON EFL STUDENTS' PERCEPTIONS AND ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract: This study investigates how the Analytical and Critical Thinking course affects EFL students and their perceptions of their skills, thus how it relates to English Language Teaching. In today's universities, developing higher-order thinking skills is crucial because students who think analytically tend to be more independent learners. Therefore, this study adopted a comparative design, in which data were collected through an online questionnaire with the participation of 49 EFL students in the English Language Teaching Department of Dokuz Eylül University. The questionnaire had 7 items (a 5-point scale) and some open-ended questions. Students who had taken the course rated their own analytical and critical thinking skills higher than those who had not. This points to a benefit of bringing critical thinking into EFL courses, not just for students' cognitive development but also for keeping them engaged in better language learning.

Keywords: Critical thinking, analytical thinking, EFL, English Language Teaching, higher-order thinking skills

ANALİTİK VE ELEŞTİREL DÜŞÜNME DERSİNİN İNGİLİZCE YABANCI DİL ÖĞRENCİLERİNİN ALGILARINA VE İNGİLİZCE DİL ÖĞRETİMİNE ETKİSİ

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Özet: Bu çalışma, Analitik ve Eleştirel Düşünme dersinin İngilizceyi Yabancı Dil Olarak Öğrenen (EFL) öğrenciler üzerindeki etkisini ve öğrencilerin kendi becerilerine ilişkin algılarını; dolayısıyla bunun İngilizce Öğretmenliği ile nasıl ilişkili olduğunu incelemektedir. Günümüz üniversitelerinde üst düzey düşünme becerilerinin geliştirilmesi büyük önem taşımaktadır; çünkü analitik düşünebilen öğrenciler daha bağımsız öğrenenler olmakta ve daha iyi kavrama becerileri göstermektedir. Bu çalışma karşılaştırmalı bir araştırmadır. Araştırmanın verileri, Dokuz Eylül Üniversitesi İngilizce Öğretmenliği Bölümü'nde öğrenim gören 49 EFL öğrencisinin katılımıyla çevrim içi bir anket aracılığıyla toplanmıştır. Anket, yedi maddeden oluşan beşli Likert ölçeği ile bazı açık uçlu sorular içermektedir. Dersi almış olan öğrenciler, kendi analitik ve eleştirel düşünme becerilerini dersi almamış öğrencilere kıyasla daha yüksek düzeyde değerlendirmiştir. Bu durum, eleştirel düşünmenin EFL derslerine entegre edilmesinin yalnızca öğrencilerin bilişsel gelişimine değil, aynı zamanda onların daha etkili dil öğrenimine katılım göstermelerine de katkı sağladığını ortaya koymaktadır.

Anahtar Kelimeler: Eleştirel düşünme, analitik düşünme, EFL, İngilizce Öğretimi, üst bilişsel beceriler

1. Introduction

The field of education has changed drastically in the 21st century, and in today's world, critical and analytical thinking is needed not only in academic environments but also in daily tasks such as applying for a job and submitting a well-written paper. As a result, schools and universities around the world began taking higher-order thinking skills more seriously than before. Specifically, in the field of English Language Teaching (ELT), this change is clearly noticeable, as learning a foreign language is not just about memorizing grammar rules or vocabulary, but (even more importantly) about understanding complex texts, expressing oneself in arguments, etc. When analytical and critical thinking are part of language instruction, students tend to become more independent learners, communicate more confidently, and understand their studies more deeply. So, it is not surprising that more and more EFL teachers and curriculum designers are seeking ways to incorporate these skills into their courses.

The definition of critical and analytical thinking may alter depending on the focus of interest. Facione (1990) describes analytical thinking as a purposeful, self-monitored process that involves interpretation, analysis, and evaluation. On the other hand, Halpern (1998) emphasizes its role in solving problems and making decisions in different areas of life. Paul and Elder (2006) further argue that critical thinking creates learners who are reflective, self-directed, and intellectually demanding. Willingham (2007) makes an important point: critical thinking does not develop on its own through general education; it needs to be taught explicitly and intentionally.

In language learning, the benefits of critical thinking are observed. Students who engage analytically with texts read more comprehensively, write better arguments, and speak with better clarity. They also develop the habit of questioning what they read and hear and examining evidence

before drawing conclusions, which leads to more complex language use. Kuhn (1999) added another perspective, suggesting that critical thinking tends to deepen over time, especially when students get consistent instructional support. Despite all of this, there is a noticeable gap in the field of research, as most studies discuss critical thinking in broad educational terms rather than focusing on how analytical and critical thinking courses affect EFL students.

Guided by these, the study aims to reveal the impacts of an Analytical and Critical Thinking course on EFL students' perceptions and to determine what these findings mean for the English Language Teaching department. The study addresses the following research questions:

1. What are EFL students' perceptions of an Analytical and Critical Thinking course?
2. Does participation in the course influence students' self-perceived analytical and critical thinking skills?
3. Are there differences in students' perceptions based on gender and grade level?
4. What are the pedagogical implications of the course for English language teaching?

The study aims to contribute to English Language Teaching by showing the kinds of differences this course makes and to be useful to people working on curriculum design, teacher training, and the development of teaching approaches.

2. Materials and Methods

2.1. Research Design

This study adopted a mixed-methods design, comparing two student groups and investigating how exposure to critical thinking instruction relates to EFL students' perceptions of their skills. Rather than manipulating variables, the study observed these groups as they were, making it non-judgmental and providing a structured, meaningful way to compare students within an authentic university EFL context.

2.2. Research Context

The study was done with the students in the English Language Teaching (ELT) Department of Dokuz Eylül University in Turkey during the academic year 2025-2026. One of the courses in the undergraduate ELT program is Analytical and Critical Thinking, which aims to develop students' analytical, evaluative, and interpretative thinking skills. In class, students do analysis, evaluation, reasoning, and interpretation exercises, both academically and linguistically.

2.3. Participants

49 EFL students from the ELT program participated in this study. Participants were selected through convenience sampling, primarily due to accessibility and voluntary participation. They were divided into two groups, the experimental and the control, based on their participation in the course. Group A ($n = 27$) attended the Analytical and Critical Thinking course, while Group B ($n = 22$) did not. Students are from different year groups and backgrounds, bringing diverse views to the study.

2.4. Data Collection Instruments

The required data was derived from the questionnaire. The questionnaire was divided into three sections. The first section collected basic background information: gender, year of study, and whether or not the student had taken the course. The second part was the main perception scale, which consisted of seven items rated on a five-point Likert scale (1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree) covering depth of comprehension, analytical reasoning, how students organize their thoughts, and motivation to learn. The third section consisted of open-ended questions. Here, students could share their experiences and reflect on their problem-solving approach and on the course.

2.5. Validity and Reliability

To ensure the questionnaire measured what it was supposed to, the items were not newly created but were adapted and selected from a previously published study with established reliability. In other words, the questions were already developed and used in research closely related to this topic. Because of this, the scale was considered reliable and appropriate for the current study.

2.6. Data Collection Procedure

The questionnaire was shared online during the spring semester of the 2025–2026 academic year. Before they took the questionnaire, students were informed about the study and told that their responses would remain fully confidential and anonymous. Thus, participation was voluntary, and everyone who responded provided informed consent before taking the questionnaire. Completing the survey took 5 to 10 minutes.

2.6. Data Analysis

The data were analyzed using SPSS. Descriptive statistics were calculated to properly compare the two groups' responses. After that, independent-samples t-tests were used to see if there were any statistical differences. Lastly, additional analyses were conducted to examine differences by gender and year of study, and open-ended responses were analyzed to support the data using thematic analysis by two different instructors.

2.7. Ethical Considerations

All participants were fully informed of the study's purpose, and they were free to change their minds at any time. Participants' confidentiality and anonymity were maintained throughout the whole process. The data were used for research purposes only.

3. Results And Discussions

3.1. Overview of the Findings

This section presents the results of the analysis. Out of the 49 participants, 27 students took the Analytical and Critical Thinking course, and 22 did not. Students who had taken the course averaged higher scores on all seven Likert-scale items ($M = 4.05$) than those who had not ($M = 2.84$), indicating a meaningful relationship between taking the course and how students rate their own analytical and critical thinking skills.

3.2. Descriptive Statistics by Course Participation

Table 1 shows the scores for each item, based on whether students took the course. Course participation improved students' ability to organize their thoughts while reading. The scores are 4.33 for students who took the course and 2.18 for those who did not. Course participation also made a difference in reading for deep understanding, with scores of 4.44 for students who took the course and 2.45 for those who did not. Students who took the course said they enjoyed learning more, with a 4.37 score. Students who did not take the course reported enjoying learning less, with a score of 2.45. Students who took the course are also more willing to read to learn more; the score is 4.41, whereas students who did not take the course are less willing to read to learn more; the score is 2.68. What is interesting is that course participation did not affect how students feel about finding some university courses boring. The scores are 3.48 for students who took the course and 3.55 for those who did not. This shows that the course did not really change how students feel about boredom in university classes.

Table 1. *Comparison of Mean Scores by Course Participation*

Item	Description	Course Completed (M)	Course Not Completed (M)
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Q1	I enjoy reading and learning new things.	4.37	2.45
Q2	I try to understand texts deeply before answering.	4.44	2.45
Q3	I find some university courses boring.	3.48	3.55
Q4	I prefer analytical reading over memorization.	4.19	3.00
Q5	I can organize my thoughts while reading.	4.33	2.18
Q6	There are subjects I avoid reading.	3.15	3.59
Q7	I am willing to read to gain more information.	4.41	2.68

Note. M = Mean score on a five-point Likert scale

3.3. Gender Differences in Perceptions

When we look at how girls and boys did in school, the girls did a little better on average (3.96) than the boys (3.73). We can see the difference when we look at things like how much they like learning, how much they like reading to understand something, and how much they want to find out more information. The difference is not huge. It seems that girls think they are more inclined to use analytical and critical thinking in their English as a foreign language class. We are talking about an English-as-a-foreign-language class, and girls seem to enjoy using analytical and critical thinking in it.

Table 2. Gender Differences in Analytical and Critical Thinking Perceptions

Gender	Mean Score
Female	3.96
Male	3.73

Note. M = Mean score on a five-point Likert scale.

3.4. Grade-Level Differences

Looking at the year of study, fourth-year students rated their analytical and critical thinking skills higher than students in earlier years (M = 4.13 vs. 3.60). This is not surprising — students who have spent more time in a university environment and engaged with demanding academic work tend to feel more capable as thinkers over time.

Table 3. Grade-Level Differences in Perceptions

Grade Level	Mean Score
Fourth-Year Students	4.13

Note. M = Mean score on a five-point Likert scale.

3.4. Inferential Analysis

An independent-samples t-test also revealed a statistically significant difference between the groups ($p < .05$). This indicates that the higher scores of respondents who have completed the course cannot be attributed to chance alone, as they reflect a real difference in students' perceptions of their own analytical skills.

Findings indicate that students who had taken the Analytical and Critical Thinking course rated their own thinking skills positively. They thought highly of their skills in almost every area. The most notable ones were in understanding things, putting ideas together, and wanting to learn. There were also differences between male and female students and between students in different years. Female students and fourth-year students gave higher ratings. Overall, teaching thinking in a structured way can help EFL learners think more clearly and develop their problem-solving skills. This course helped students think positively about their own abilities. The Analytical and Critical Thinking course made a difference in how students think and solve problems.

4. Conclusion

This study was conducted to examine the difference that an Analytical and Critical Thinking course makes in how English as a Foreign Language students think about their skills. The study found that students who took the course thought they were better at critical thinking than those who did not. This shows that teaching students how to think in a way can improve how they learn and how they think about themselves.

The study focused on the differences between the two student groups. It was found that students who took the course were better at organizing their thoughts. Also, reading deeply and completing tasks analytically. They also wanted to read and learn more, which makes sense because being taught how to think analytically gives students tools that they want to use. This indicates similarity with what Willingham (2007) underlined: critical thinking does not just happen; it needs to be taught.

These findings are consistent with those reported by other researchers. Falcioni (1990) indicated that critical thinking is a process that involves analysis, evaluation, and inference. The study revealed that when students are taught these things, they start to feel and behave differently as learners. Halpern (1998) argued that critical thinking supports problem-solving, and Paul and Elder (2006) stated that it makes learners more reflective and self-directed. The students who took the course in this study seemed to be like that. Kuhn said in 1999 that thinking skills improve over time, and the study revealed the same: older students thought they were better at thinking.

According to the results, it can be inferred that, for teachers, the message is: critical thinking should be part of the English as a Foreign Language course. When learners actually practice critical thinking, they improve their critical thinking skills and, thus, their language use. This is not about making classes more fun; it is about giving students what they actually need. Teacher education programs should teach teachers how to design and run thinking activities in language classrooms.

The study also showed some differences between male and female students and between students in different years. Female students performed better than male students, suggesting differences in their approaches to learning. Older students did better than other students, which makes sense because the longer you are in an academic environment, the better your thinking skills get.

There are some constraints to this research study as well. The number of students was low, and the selection process may not have been fully representative of the student population. Furthermore, the data collection method was self-reporting, which may have led to discrepancies in student ratings due to varying interpretations of the questions and differing abilities to remain objective. This study did not involve any experimental manipulation; therefore, one cannot conclude that the observed differences were caused by the course.

There may also be further research that could benefit from this paper by using more varied student groups. The use of experimental research would be beneficial for determining whether the subject indeed increases cognitive ability. The use of mixed methodologies, such as surveys alongside classroom observations and interviews, would shed more light on what really goes on in class.

In conclusion, this research's findings demonstrate the significance of analytical and critical thinking in EFL education. The students who studied Analytical and Critical Thinking showed improved self-confidence, motivation, and English competence. This is vital because language learning cannot develop students' ability to create correct sentences; rather, its goal is to develop critical thinking and communication skills across diverse contexts. Therefore, it is important to integrate higher-order thinking skills into language education.

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Abstract: This article examines and compares the development of traditional and modern methods of English language teaching in higher education institutions, with a particular focus on their effectiveness in developing students' language proficiency. Traditional methods are mainly based on grammar instruction, translation, rote memorization, and repetition. These approaches emphasize accuracy and structure, often relying on a teacher-centred classroom where the instructor is the main source of knowledge and students play a passive role. While such methods can help learners build a strong grammatical foundation, they often limit opportunities for spontaneous communication and real-life language use.

In contrast, modern methods of language teaching prioritize communicative competence, student interaction, and meaningful language use in authentic contexts. The study specifically highlights the importance of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), and blended learning approaches, which integrate both face-to-face instruction and digital tools. These methods encourage learners to actively participate in discussions, solve real-world tasks, and collaborate with peers, making the learning process more dynamic and engaging.

The findings of the study indicate that modern teaching methods significantly improve students' speaking, listening, reading, and writing skills. In addition, they increase learner motivation, confidence, and autonomy. Compared to traditional approaches, modern methods create a more student-centred environment, which supports deeper learning and better retention of language skills. Overall, the research suggests that combining traditional foundations with modern communicative approaches can lead to more effective English language teaching in higher education.

Keywords: English language teaching, higher education, innovative methods, communicative approach, task-based learning, blended learning, language skills, pedagogy

**ALİ TƏHSİL MÜƏSSİSƏLƏRİNDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ İNNOVATİV
METODLAR**

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə ali təhsil müəssisələrində ingilis dilinin tədrisində ənənəvi və müasir metodların müqayisəsini və inkişafını araşdırır. Ənənəvi metodlar əsasən qrammatika, tərcümə və əzbərləmə üzərində qurulmuşdur və müəllim mərkəzli yanaşma ilə xarakterizə olunur. Bu yanaşmada müəllim sinifdə əsas bilik mənbəyi hesab edilir, tələbələr isə daha çox məlumatı qəbul edən və təkrarlayan rolda çıxış edirlər. Bu metodlar qrammatik qaydaların və söz ehtiyatının öyrənilməsi üçün faydalı olsa da, tələbələrin sərbəst ünsiyyət bacarıqlarını kifayət qədər inkişaf etdirmir.

Müasir metodlar isə kommunikativ bacarıqların inkişafına, tələbələrin aktiv iştirakına və real ünsiyyət situasiyalarına əsaslanır. Bu yanaşmalar tələbələrin dili yalnız öyrənməsini deyil, həm də praktik şəkildə istifadə etməsini hədəfləyir. Məqalədə Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisi (CLT), Tapşırıq Əsaslı Öyrənmə (TBLT) və blended learning kimi yanaşmaların əhəmiyyəti vurğulanır. CLT ünsiyyəti əsas məqsəd kimi götürür, TBLT isə real həyatdan götürülmüş tapşırıqların yerinə yetirilməsinə əsaslanır. Blended learning isə ənənəvi dərslərlə rəqəmsal texnologiyaların birləşdirilməsi ilə daha çevik və interaktiv öyrənmə mühiti yaradır.

Araşdırmanın nəticələri göstərir ki, müasir metodlar tələbələrin ingilis dili bacarıqlarını - danışmaq, dinləmə, oxu və yazı - əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə inkişaf etdirir. Eyni zamanda, bu metodlar tələbələrin motivasiyasını, özünəinamını və dərs prosesində fəallığını artırır. Ənənəvi metodlarla müqayisədə müasir yanaşmalar daha dinamik və tələbə mərkəzli mühit yaradır və bu da dil öyrənməsini daha effektiv edir. Ümumilikdə, tədqiqat göstərir ki, ənənəvi və müasir metodların birləşdirilməsi ali təhsil müəssisələrində ingilis dilinin tədrisinin keyfiyyətini xeyli yüksəldə bilər.

Açar sözlər: İngilis dilinin tədrisi, ali təhsil, müasir metodlar, kommunikativ yanaşma, tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə, blended learning, dil bacarıqları, pedaqogika

Introduction

In recent decades, the teaching and learning of English in higher education institutions has undergone significant transformation. Traditional approaches, which were largely based on grammar instruction, translation, and teacher-centred practices, are increasingly being replaced or supplemented by more dynamic and learner-centred methodologies. This shift reflects the growing need for students to develop not only linguistic knowledge but also communicative competence and practical language skills that are essential in academic and professional contexts.

The importance of English as a global language has further intensified the demand for effective teaching strategies in universities. As a result, educators are continuously exploring innovative methods that enhance student engagement, motivation, and autonomy. Approaches such as Communicative Language Teaching, Task-Based Learning, and blended learning environments supported by digital technologies have gained prominence in modern language education.

Despite these advancements, many higher education institutions still face challenges in fully integrating innovative methodologies into their teaching practices. Limited resources, large class sizes, and reliance on traditional assessment systems often hinder the effective implementation of modern approaches.

Therefore, this article aims to explore and analyze innovative methods in English language teaching within higher education institutions, comparing them with traditional approaches and highlighting their pedagogical evolution. The study also seeks to identify how these methods contribute to improving language acquisition and student performance in university settings.

Research

Traditional approaches to English language teaching have played an important role in the development of language education, particularly in higher education institutions. For many years, methods such as the Grammar-Translation Method and the Audio-Lingual Method were widely used. These approaches mainly focused on the formal aspects of language, especially grammar rules, vocabulary memorization, and translation of texts from one language to another. According to Richards and Rodgers (2001), the Grammar-Translation Method prioritizes reading and writing skills over speaking and communication, which limits learners' ability to use the language in real-life situations. Similarly, Harmer (2007) points out that traditional methods often position students as passive recipients of knowledge rather than active participants in the learning process. Despite these limitations, such approaches are still applied in some educational contexts due to their structured nature and ease of evaluation.

Table 1. Comparison of Traditional and Modern Teaching Methods

Aspects	Traditional methods	Modern methods
Teaching focus	Grammar accuracy	Communication skills

Student role	Passive learner	Active participant
Classroom style	Teacher-centered	Learner-centered
Learning outcome	Theoretical knowledge	Practical language use

The table clearly shows that modern approaches prioritize communication and learner participation, while traditional methods focus more on structural knowledge and memorization. In modern classrooms, interaction, group work, and problem-solving activities are increasingly replacing rote memorization techniques. This transition indicates a significant pedagogical shift towards more interactive and student-centred learning environments in higher education institutions.

In contrast, modern approaches to English language teaching emphasize communication, interaction, and learner engagement. One of the most influential approaches in this regard is Communicative Language Teaching (CLT). This method is based on the idea that language learning should focus on meaningful communication rather than the memorization of grammatical rules. Hymes (1972) introduced the concept of communicative competence, which suggests that knowing a language involves not only grammatical accuracy but also the ability to use language appropriately in different social contexts. Later, Canale and Swain (1980) expanded this concept by identifying different components of communicative competence, including grammatical, sociolinguistic, discourse, and strategic abilities. These ideas have significantly influenced modern language teaching practices, especially in university environments where interaction and real-life communication are essential.

Another important modern approach is Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), which builds on communicative principles but places greater emphasis on completing meaningful tasks. Ellis (2003) explains that TBLT encourages learners to use language as a tool to achieve specific outcomes, such as solving problems, planning activities, or conducting surveys. Unlike traditional methods, where language forms are taught in isolation, TBLT allows students to acquire language naturally through engagement in purposeful activities. Willis and Willis (2007) also highlight that task-based learning increases student motivation and promotes learner autonomy, which is particularly valuable in higher education settings.

In the modern era, technological development has also led to the emergence of blended learning as an effective teaching approach. Blended learning combines traditional face-to-face instruction with online learning environments, creating a more flexible and interactive educational experience. Graham (2006) defines blended learning as the integration of classroom teaching with digital tools and online platforms. This approach allows students to access learning materials anytime and anywhere, which supports individualized learning. Bersin (2004) argues that blended learning improves educational effectiveness by combining the strengths of both traditional and modern methods. In English language teaching, digital platforms such as Moodle, Google Classroom, and video-based resources are increasingly used to enhance student engagement and support independent learning. When comparing traditional and modern approaches, a clear shift can be observed from teacher-centered to learner-centered education. Traditional methods emphasize accuracy, memorization, and passive learning, while modern approaches focus on communication, interaction, and active participation. This transformation reflects broader changes in educational philosophy and the growing importance of English as a global language. Modern methods not only improve linguistic competence but also develop critical thinking, collaboration, and problem-solving skills, which are essential in higher education.

In recent years, English language teaching has evolved differently across countries depending on educational policies, technological access, and curriculum design. While many developed educational systems have already integrated modern methodologies, some regions are still in transition from traditional approaches to more communicative and technology-based learning models.

In Azerbaijan, English language teaching in many higher education institutions and schools is still partially influenced by traditional methods such as grammar-focused instruction and translation-based exercises. Although communicative activities are gradually being introduced, the full implementation of student-centred approaches like Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) and blended learning is still limited in some institutions due to large class sizes, limited digital infrastructure, and exam-oriented assessment systems.

On the other hand, in countries such as Turkey, English language teaching in universities has more actively incorporated modern approaches. Many higher education institutions emphasize Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), project-based learning, and digital learning platforms. Turkish universities increasingly use interactive classrooms, online learning systems, and task-oriented assignments to improve students' communicative competence. According to recent educational trends observed in Turkish higher education, blended learning and technology-supported instruction are considered more effective in developing all four language skills (speaking, listening, reading, and writing).

Among modern methodologies, Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) and blended learning are often regarded as the most effective by many educators in higher education contexts. These approaches allow students to engage in real-life tasks, collaborate in groups, and use English in meaningful situations. Compared to traditional methods, they significantly increase student motivation and participation, making language learning more practical and interactive.

However, despite the advantages of modern approaches, their effectiveness largely depends on proper implementation, teacher training, and institutional support. In contexts where resources are limited, a mixed approach combining traditional and modern methods is often considered the most realistic solution.

Table 2. Comparison of English Language Teaching Methods Across Countries

Country	Dominant methods	Trend
Azerbaijan	Grammar-based+ partial CLT	Transition phase
Turkey	CLT+ blended learning	More advanced integration
EU/USA (genral)	TBLT+ digital learning	Fully student-centered

Recent pedagogical trends suggest that technology-enhanced and task-based approaches provide higher student engagement compared to traditional grammar-focused instruction.

In contemporary education, English Language Teaching (ELT) has experienced significant innovation due to technological advancements and changing educational needs. Modern classrooms are no longer limited to traditional teaching materials, as digital tools and interactive platforms have become an integral part of the learning process.

One of the most notable innovations is the integration of digital learning technologies. Online platforms, mobile applications, and virtual learning environments allow students to access educational content beyond the classroom. This flexibility enables learners to study at their own

pace and improves overall engagement. Additionally, tools such as video-based learning and interactive tasks provide more dynamic and personalized learning experiences.

Another important development is the increased use of student-centred approaches. Methods such as Task-Based Language Teaching and project-based learning encourage learners to actively participate in the learning process. These approaches promote collaboration, critical thinking, and real-life language use, making learning more meaningful and effective.

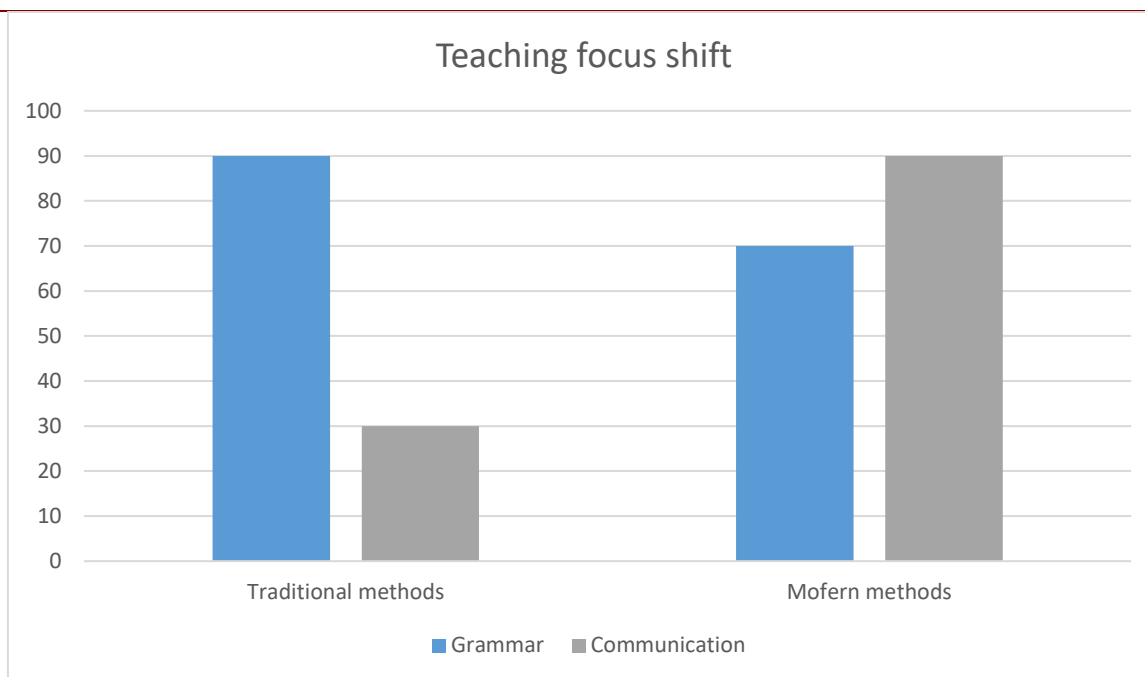
Furthermore, the concept of autonomous learning has gained importance in modern ELT. Students are encouraged to take responsibility for their own learning through self-study, online resources, and independent practice. This shift not only improves language proficiency but also develops lifelong learning skills.

Overall, recent innovations in ELT demonstrate a clear movement towards more flexible, interactive, and learner-oriented teaching practices, which better meet the demands of modern higher education.

Over the past few years, English Language Teaching (ELT) has undergone significant transformation due to the integration of advanced technologies and innovative pedagogical approaches. Among these, Artificial Intelligence (AI), adaptive learning systems, and interactive digital platforms have emerged as powerful tools that enhance both teaching and learning processes. Unlike traditional methods, which often rely on fixed curricula and teacher-centred instruction, modern innovations focus on personalization, flexibility, and student autonomy.

One of the most notable innovations is the use of AI-supported language learning systems. These technologies can analyze students' performance, identify their weaknesses, and provide immediate, personalized feedback. As a result, learners are able to improve their skills more efficiently and independently. For example, AI-based platforms simulate real-life conversations, allowing students to practice speaking without the fear of making mistakes in front of others. This creates a more comfortable and motivating learning environment.

Furthermore, the integration of digital tools has made learning more accessible and interactive. Students can now access educational content anytime and anywhere, which supports self-paced learning. This flexibility is particularly important in higher education, where learners are expected to take responsibility for their own progress. Additionally, modern platforms encourage collaboration through online discussions, group projects, and virtual classrooms, which significantly enhance communication skills.



The focus of English language teaching has shifted from grammar-dominated instruction to communication-oriented learning.

Despite the advantages of modern innovations, their effectiveness depends on several factors such as teacher training, technological infrastructure, and student readiness. In some educational contexts, including developing systems, the transition to fully digital or AI-based learning is still in progress. Therefore, a balanced approach that combines traditional and modern methods is often considered the most practical and effective solution.

Moreover, while AI-based learning provides personalized support, it cannot fully replace human interaction and emotional engagement provided by teachers. Thus, the role of educators remains essential in guiding and motivating students.

Looking ahead, the future of English language teaching is expected to become increasingly technology-driven. The integration of artificial intelligence, virtual reality, and adaptive learning systems may completely transform the traditional classroom environment. These innovations will likely create more immersive and individualized learning experiences, making language acquisition faster and more effective.

Another important aspect to consider is the limitations of modern teaching methods. Despite their many advantages, these approaches are not always easy to implement in every educational context. One of the main challenges is the lack of technological resources in some institutions. Not all students have equal access to digital tools, which may create inequality in learning opportunities. Furthermore, the successful use of innovative methods requires well-trained teachers who are familiar with modern technologies and student-centred approaches. Without proper training, these methods may not be used effectively. In addition, some students may find it difficult to adapt to autonomous learning, as they are more accustomed to traditional teacher-centred instruction.

It is also important to examine the changing role of the teacher in modern English language teaching. In traditional classrooms, teachers were considered the main source of knowledge and controlled most aspects of the learning process. However, in contemporary approaches, the role of the teacher has shifted towards that of a facilitator or guide. Teachers now support students,

encourage participation, and create interactive learning environments. This transformation highlights the importance of flexibility and continuous professional development for educators.

A further point worth discussing is the effectiveness of modern teaching methods in real classroom settings. For instance, observations from university environments show that students who participate in communicative and task-based activities tend to be more engaged and motivated. They are more willing to express their ideas and interact with others in English. In contrast to traditional methods, which often limit speaking opportunities, modern approaches provide students with more chances to use the language actively. This suggests that interactive and practice-oriented methods lead to more successful language learning outcomes.

Finally, it is essential to consider future developments in English language teaching. As technology continues to evolve, teaching methods are expected to become more flexible and personalized. The integration of artificial intelligence, digital platforms, and virtual learning environments may significantly transform the way languages are taught and learned. These innovations are likely to create more engaging and efficient learning experiences for students. Therefore, adapting to these changes will be crucial for both educators and learners in the coming years.

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THE DEVELOPMENT OF ORAL SPEECH SKILLS IN RURAL SECONDARY SCHOOLS WITHOUT ICT

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Abstract: In many rural secondary schools, the lack or limited availability of information and communication technologies (ICT) creates significant challenges for language teaching, particularly in developing students' oral communication skills. Speaking is a fundamental component of language learning, as it allows learners to express ideas, interact with others, and use language in real-life contexts. However, in ICT-poor environments, students often have fewer opportunities to engage with authentic materials or practice communication through digital tools.

This study focuses on the development of oral communication skills in rural secondary schools without ICT support. It explores how traditional and low-resource teaching strategies can be adapted to create interactive and student-centered learning environments. Particular attention is given to communicative classroom activities such as pair work, group discussions, role-play, and storytelling. These activities encourage active participation and help learners use the target language in meaningful and practical situations.

The study also highlights the important role of the teacher in such contexts. Teachers act not only as instructors but also as facilitators who guide learners, provide feedback, and create a supportive atmosphere that reduces anxiety and builds confidence. Additionally, the integration of listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills is considered essential for balanced language development.

Overall, the findings suggest that even in the absence of ICT, oral communication skills can be effectively developed through creative teaching methods and well-organized classroom interaction. This demonstrates that successful language learning depends more on methodology and teacher engagement than on technological resources alone.

Keywords: oral communication, speaking skills, rural schools, ICT absence, language teaching, communicative activities, student participation

THE DEVELOPMENT OF ORAL SPEECH SKILLS IN RURAL SECONDARY SCHOOLS WITHOUT ICT

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Xülasə: Bir çox kənd orta məktəblərində informasiya və kommunikasiya texnologiyalarının (İKT) olmaması və ya məhdud olması dil tədrisində, xüsusilə də şifahi nitq bacarığının inkişaf etdirilməsində ciddi çətinliklər yaradır. Danışqı bacarığı dil öyrənmənin əsas komponentlərindən biridir, çünki bu bacarıq şagirdlərə fikirlərini ifadə etməyə, ünsiyyət qurmağa və dili real həyat şəraitində istifadə etməyə imkan verir. Lakin İKT-nin olmadığı mühitdə şagirdlərin autentik materiallarla işləmək və texnoloji vasitələrlə ünsiyyət qurmaq imkanları məhdud olur.

Bu məqalədə İKT olmayan kənd orta məktəblərində şifahi nitq bacarığının inkişaf etdirilməsi yolları araşdırılır. Aşağı resurslu mühitdə tətbiq oluna bilən ənənəvi və interaktiv tədris üsullarının necə uyğunlaşdırıla biləcəyi təhlil olunur. Xüsusilə cütlərlə iş, qrup müzakirələri, rol oyunları və hekayə danışma kimi kommunikativ fəaliyyətlərin rolu vurğulanır. Bu fəaliyyətlər şagirdlərin dərstdə fəal iştirakını təmin edir və dili praktik və mənalı kontekstlərdə istifadə etməyə şərait yaradır.

Eyni zamanda müəllimin rolu xüsusi əhəmiyyət kəsb edir. Müəllim yalnız məlumat verən deyil, həm də istiqamət verən, dəstək olan və motivasiya yaradan şəxs kimi çıxış edir. O, şagirdlər üçün rahat mühit yaradaraq onların danışqı zamanı həyəcanını azaldır və özünə inamını artırır.

Ümumilikdə nəticə göstərir ki, İKT olmadan da yaradıcı və düzgün metodiki yanaşmalar vasitəsilə şifahi nitq bacarıqları effektiv şəkildə inkişaf etdirilə bilər.

Açar sözlər: şifahi nitq, danışmaq bacarığı, kənd məktəbləri, İKT-nin olmaması, dil tədrisi, kommunikativ fəaliyyətlər, şagird fəallığı

Introduction

In recent years, the development of oral communication skills has become a central objective in English language teaching. Speaking is not only a productive skill but also a key indicator of learners' ability to use language effectively in real-life situations. According to Harmer (2015), the ability to speak fluently and confidently is often seen as the primary goal of language learning. However, achieving this goal can be particularly challenging in rural secondary schools where access to information and communication technologies (ICT) is limited or completely absent.

ICT tools, including multimedia resources, online platforms, and language learning applications, are widely recognized for their role in enhancing language acquisition. They provide learners with authentic input, interactive opportunities, and exposure to real-life language use (Richards & Rodgers, 2014). Despite these advantages, many rural educational settings lack such resources due to economic, infrastructural, or geographical limitations. As a result, teachers must rely on traditional teaching methods, which often prioritize grammar and reading over speaking practice.

This imbalance can negatively affect students' communicative competence. Brown (2007) emphasizes that language learning requires active participation and meaningful use of language, particularly through speaking. Therefore, even in the absence of ICT, it is essential to create classroom environments that encourage oral interaction and student engagement.

In this context, this study aims to explore how oral communication skills can be effectively developed in rural secondary schools without ICT support. It focuses on the role of communicative teaching strategies, teacher creativity, and interactive classroom practices in compensating for the lack of technological resources.

Research

The development of oral communication skills in rural schools without ICT requires a shift from teacher-centered instruction to more interactive and student-centered approaches. In such contexts, the teacher plays a crucial role in designing activities that promote communication and active participation.

One of the most effective approaches is Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), which focuses on the use of language for real communication rather than memorization of rules (Richards, 2006). In rural classrooms, this approach can be implemented through simple yet effective techniques such as pair work and group discussions. These activities increase student talk time and allow learners to practice speaking in a supportive environment. Harmer (2015) notes that maximizing student interaction is essential for developing fluency.

Role-play activities are particularly useful in developing speaking skills. They allow students to simulate real-life situations, such as conversations in shops, schools, or everyday social interactions. According to Nunan (2004), role-play encourages creativity, builds confidence, and helps learners use language in context. Even without ICT, teachers can create realistic scenarios using simple materials or classroom imagination.

Storytelling is another powerful method for enhancing oral communication. It enables students to organize their thoughts, expand vocabulary, and practice fluency. Thornbury (2005) emphasizes that storytelling supports both linguistic and cognitive development, making it an effective tool in low-resource environments.

In addition, repetition and drilling, when used meaningfully, can improve pronunciation and accuracy. Although these techniques are often associated with traditional teaching, they remain valuable when combined with communicative activities. Nation and Newton (2009) highlight that controlled practice can support the development of speaking skills, especially at early stages.

Another important factor is the classroom atmosphere. Students in rural schools may feel shy or anxious about speaking in a foreign language. Therefore, creating a positive and supportive environment is essential. Scrivener (2011) suggests that reducing anxiety and encouraging risk-taking are key to successful language learning. Teachers should provide constructive feedback and avoid over-correction, which may discourage students from speaking.

Moreover, integrating different language skills can enhance speaking development. For example, reading a short text and then discussing it or writing a dialogue and performing it can create meaningful speaking opportunities. Ur (2012) notes that skill integration makes language learning more natural and effective.

Overall, the findings indicate that even without ICT, oral communication skills can be successfully developed through well-planned, interactive, and student-centered teaching strategies. The key factor is not the availability of technology, but the teacher's ability to create engaging and communicative learning experiences.

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MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN TEACHING THE ENGLISH LANGUAGE

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Abstract: Modern English language teaching has shifted from traditional grammar-focused methods to learner-centered approaches influenced by globalization and technology. Today, English is taught as a tool for communication, with emphasis on real-life use, critical thinking, and learner autonomy.

One of the key approaches is Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), which focuses on meaningful interaction rather than memorization. As noted by David Nunan, effective learning occurs through real-life communication. CLT improves fluency and confidence, though it needs balance with grammar instruction. Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) builds on this by organizing learning around practical tasks. According to Jane Willis, it follows structured stages and promotes learning through experience, while also developing problem-solving skills. Technology also plays a vital role, with tools like Duolingo, Quizlet, and Zoom enhancing accessibility and engagement. UNESCO highlights its importance in inclusive education. Modern teaching emphasizes student-centered learning, where learners take an active role and teachers act as guides. This approach is also supported by educational reforms from the Ministry of Education of the Republic of Azerbaijan. Interactive strategies such as discussions and games improve participation and confidence. As Jeremy Harmer suggests, active involvement leads to better learning outcomes. Finally, blended learning combines online and face-to-face teaching, offering flexibility and supporting independent learning. Overall, modern approaches focus on communication, interaction, and preparing learners for real-world use of English.

The rapid development of globalization and digital technologies has significantly reshaped the field of English language teaching (ELT). English is no longer taught merely as a subject focused on grammar and vocabulary; instead, it is viewed as a tool for communication and intercultural interaction. Consequently, modern teaching approaches prioritize learners' communicative competence, critical thinking skills, and ability to function in real-life contexts. Traditional teacher-centered instruction has gradually been replaced by learner-centered methodologies that emphasize interaction, collaboration, and autonomy. This paper explores key modern methods and approaches in ELT, focusing on their theoretical foundations and practical implications.

Keywords: Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), Technology Integration, Student-Centered Learning, Interactive Teaching Strategies

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ MÜASİR METOD VƏ YANAŞMALAR

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Xülasə: Müasir ingilis dili tədrisi ənənəvi qrammatika yönümlü metodlardan uzaqlaşaraq, qloballaşma və texnologiyanın təsiri ilə daha çox şagirdyönümlü yanaşmalara keçmişdir. Bu gün ingilis dili yalnız qayda və söz öyrənmək üçün deyil, ünsiyyət vasitəsi kimi öyrədilir və real həyatda istifadə, tənqidi düşünmə və öyrənən müstəqilliyi ön plana çəkilir.

Əsas yanaşmalardan biri Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisidir (CLT). Bu metod əzbərləmədən daha çox mənalı ünsiyyətə əsaslanır. David Nunan qeyd edir ki, effektiv öyrənmə real həyat ünsiyyəti vasitəsilə baş verir. CLT şagirdlərin sərbəstliyini və özünəinamını artırır, lakin qrammatika ilə balanslı şəkildə tətbiq olunmalıdır. Tapşırıqəsaslı Dil Tədrisi (TBLT) isə bu yanaşmanı daha da inkişaf etdirir və öyrənməni praktik tapşırıqlar üzərində qurur. Jane Willis bu metodun mərhələli quruluşa malik olduğunu və təcrübə yolu ilə öyrənməni təşviq etdiyini vurğulayır. Bu yanaşma həm də problem həll etmə bacarıqlarını inkişaf etdirir. Texnologiya da müasir tədrisdə mühüm rol oynayır. Duolingo, Quizlet və Zoom kimi alətlər öyrənməni daha əlçatan və maraqlı edir. UNESCO isə texnologiyanın inklüziv təhsildə əhəmiyyətini vurğulayır. Müasir tədris şagirdyönümlü yanaşmanı əsas götürür. Bu zaman şagirdlər aktiv rol oynayır,

müəllim isə yönləndirici olur. Bu yanaşma Ministry of Education of the Republic of Azerbaijan tərəfindən də dəstəklənir. Müzakirə və oyun kimi interaktiv strategiyalar şagirdlərin dərstdə iştirakını və özünəinamını artırır. Jeremy Harmer bildirir ki, aktiv iştirak daha effektiv öyrənməyə gətirib çıxarır.

Nəhayət, qarışıq təlim (blended learning) onlayn və ənənəvi tədrisi birləşdirərək çeviklik yaradır və müstəqil öyrənməni dəstəkləyir. Ümumilikdə, müasir yanaşmalar ünsiyyət, interaksiya və real həyatda dil istifadəsinə yönəlmişdir.

Açar sözlər: Kommunikativ yanaşma, tapşırıqəsaslı təlim, texnologiya integrasiyası, şagirdyönümlü təlim, interaktiv strategiyalar

Communicative Language Teaching as a Core Approach

Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) is widely recognized as a fundamental modern approach in language education. It emerged in response to the limitations of earlier methods such as the Grammar-Translation Method and the Audio-Lingual Method. Unlike these traditional approaches, CLT emphasizes meaningful communication and the functional use of language rather than rote memorization of rules. According to David Nunan, language learning becomes effective when learners are actively engaged in communication that reflects real-life situations. In CLT classrooms, activities such as role-plays, discussions, and information-gap tasks are commonly used to promote interaction. The teacher's role shifts from being a knowledge transmitter to a facilitator who creates opportunities for authentic language use. Research indicates that CLT enhances learners' fluency and confidence, although it may sometimes lead to reduced grammatical accuracy if not balanced properly (Richards & Rodgers, 2014). Therefore, effective implementation requires integrating communicative activities with form-focused instruction.

Task-Based Language Teaching and Experiential Learning

Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) represents a further development of communicative principles. It organizes instruction around tasks that mirror real-world activities. A task, in this context, is defined as an activity where meaning is primary and language is used as a tool to achieve a specific outcome. As Jane Willis suggests, TBLT follows a structured framework consisting of pre-task, task cycle, and post-task stages. This structure allows learners to first become familiar with the topic, then perform the task, and finally reflect on language use. TBLT promotes experiential learning by encouraging students to learn through doing. It develops not only linguistic competence but also problem-solving and collaboration skills. However, critics argue that it requires careful planning and may be challenging to implement in large or exam-oriented classrooms.

The Role of Technology in Language Education

The integration of technology has become an essential component of modern ELT. Digital tools provide access to authentic materials and create opportunities for interactive and personalized learning. Online platforms, mobile applications, and virtual classrooms enable learners to practice language skills beyond the traditional classroom setting. For instance, applications like Duolingo and Quizlet support vocabulary acquisition through gamification and spaced repetition. Similarly, video conferencing tools such as Zoom facilitate synchronous communication and remote instruction. According to UNESCO (2021), technology-enhanced learning increases accessibility and promotes inclusive education. However, it also requires digital literacy and adequate infrastructure, which may not be equally available in all contexts.

Student-Centered Learning and Autonomy

A defining feature of modern approaches is the shift toward student-centered learning. This paradigm prioritizes learners' needs, interests, and learning styles. Students are encouraged to take responsibility for their own learning process, which fosters autonomy and intrinsic motivation. In this context, the teacher acts as a guide rather than an authority figure. Activities such as project-based learning, peer teaching, and collaborative tasks are widely used. These strategies not only enhance language skills but also develop transferable competencies such as critical thinking and teamwork. In Azerbaijan, recent educational reforms emphasize competency-based learning and student engagement. According to the Ministry of Education of the Republic of Azerbaijan, modern teaching standards encourage interactive methods and the integration of innovative technologies in classrooms.

Interactive Teaching Strategies in Practice

Interactive teaching strategies play a crucial role in implementing modern methodologies. Techniques such as group discussions, debates, simulations, and educational games create a dynamic learning environment. These strategies promote active participation and help learners practice language in meaningful contexts. Interaction is particularly important for developing speaking and listening skills. As Jeremy Harmer notes, students learn more effectively when they are actively involved in the learning process rather than passively receiving information. Moreover, interactive strategies contribute to a positive classroom atmosphere, increasing learners' motivation and reducing anxiety. This is especially important in language learning, where fear of making mistakes can hinder participation.

Blended Learning and Future Directions

Blended learning, which combines face-to-face and online instruction, has gained significant popularity in recent years. This approach provides flexibility and allows learners to benefit from both traditional and digital methods. The COVID-19 pandemic accelerated the adoption of blended learning worldwide. It demonstrated the importance of adaptability and digital competence in education. In Azerbaijan, many institutions have integrated online platforms into their teaching practices, reflecting global trends. Blended learning supports differentiated instruction by allowing teachers to tailor materials to individual learners' needs. It also encourages independent learning and continuous skill development.

Conclusion

In conclusion, modern methods and approaches in teaching the English language reflect a shift from traditional, teacher-centered instruction to dynamic, learner-centered practices. Approaches such as Communicative Language Teaching, Task-Based Learning, and technology-enhanced instruction have transformed the way English is taught and learned. These methods emphasize communication, interaction, and real-world application, preparing learners for global participation. However, their successful implementation requires careful planning, teacher training, and adequate resources. As education continues to evolve, it is essential for educators to adapt to new methodologies and integrate innovative practices into their teaching.

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TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH LANGUAGE

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Abstract: This article explores the main principles of teaching and learning English as a foreign language, focusing on modern methodologies, learner-centered approaches, and the role of motivation in language acquisition. It examines how different teaching strategies, such as communicative language teaching and task-based learning, contribute to improving students' language skills, including speaking, listening, reading, and writing. The study also highlights the importance of technology integration in English language classrooms, as digital tools and online platforms significantly enhance interaction and engagement. Furthermore, the article discusses the challenges faced by both teachers and learners, such as limited exposure to native language environments and differences in individual learning styles. Overall, it emphasizes that effective English teaching requires a combination of innovative methods, consistent practice, and supportive learning environments to achieve successful outcomes.

In contemporary education, teaching and learning English require the integration of modern methods, interactive strategies, language skill development, and effective assessment techniques. This study explores how these components work together to enhance learning outcomes. The findings suggest that student-centered approaches significantly improve engagement and language proficiency.

Key words: English teaching, modern methods, interactive learning, language skills, assessment

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİ VƏ ÖYRƏNMƏSİ

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə, müasir metodologiyalara, tələbəyə yönəlmiş yanaşmalara və dilin mənimsənilməsində motivasiyanın roluna diqqət yetirərək, ingilis dilinin xarici dil kimi tədrisi və öyrənilməsinin əsas prinsiplərini araşdırır. Burada kommunikativ dil tədrisi və tapşırıq əsaslı təlim kimi müxtəlif tədris strategiyalarının tələbələrin danışmaq, dinləmə, oxu və yazı da daxil olmaqla dil bacarıqlarının inkişafına necə töhfə verdiyi araşdırılır. Tədqiqat həmçinin ingilis dili siniflərində texnologiya inteqrasiyasının vacibliyini vurğulayır, çünki rəqəmsal alətlər və onlayn platformalar qarşılıqlı əlaqəni və iştirakı əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə artırır. Bundan əlavə, məqalədə həm müəllimlərin, həm də tələbələrin üzləşdiyi çətinliklər, məsələn, ana dili mühitinə məhdud məruz qalma və fərdi öyrənmə üsullarındakı fərqlər müzakirə olunur. Ümumilikdə, effektiv ingilis dili tədrisinin uğurlu nəticələr əldə etmək üçün innovativ metodların, ardıcıl təcrübənin və dəstəkləyici öyrənmə mühitlərinin birləşməsinə tələb etdiyi vurğulanır.

Müasir təhsildə ingilis dilinin tədrisi və öyrənilməsi müasir metodların, interaktiv strategiyaların, dil bacarıqlarının inkişafı və effektiv qiymətləndirmə texnikalarının inteqrasiyasını tələb edir. Bu tədqiqat bu

komponentlərin öyrənmə nəticələrini artırmaq üçün necə birlikdə işlədiyini araşdırır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, tələbəyə yönəlmiş yanaşmalar iştirakı və dil səriştəsini əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə yaxşılaşdırır.

Açar sözlər: ingilis dili tədrisi, müasir metodlar, interaktiv öyrənmə, dil bacarıqları, qiymətləndirmə

Introduction

English is widely recognized as a global language used in education, communication, and professional development. In recent decades, teaching approaches have changed significantly. Traditional methods are no longer sufficient for modern learners. Therefore, innovative and flexible approaches are required.

Modern learners need practical communication skills rather than only theoretical knowledge. This has led to the adoption of student-centered methods. These methods emphasize interaction, real-life communication, and continuous practice.

Teachers today play the role of facilitators rather than just information providers. They guide students, encourage participation, and create a supportive learning environment where learners feel confident to express themselves in English. The use of communicative language teaching (CLT) and task-based learning (TBL) has become increasingly common, as these approaches focus on meaningful use of language in real-life situations.

In addition, technology has become an essential part of English language teaching. Digital tools, online platforms, and interactive applications help students practice language skills outside the classroom. These resources increase motivation and allow learners to study at their own pace, making the learning process more effective and personalized.

However, there are still some challenges in English language teaching. Large classroom sizes, limited practice opportunities, and differences in students' learning abilities can affect the effectiveness of instruction. Despite these difficulties, continuous improvement in teaching strategies and the integration of modern tools can significantly enhance the overall quality of English education.

Overall, the shift towards modern, student-centered approaches reflects the need for more practical and communicative language learning, which better prepares learners for real-world use of English.

Methods and Materials

Modern teaching methods such as Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and Task-Based Learning (TBL) focus on active learning. Students are encouraged to participate, express ideas, and solve problems.

These approaches improve critical thinking and collaboration. They also make learning more engaging and meaningful for students.

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In addition, these methods help learners develop real-life communication skills by placing them in practical situations where English is used naturally. Instead of memorizing grammar rules in isolation, students learn how to apply language in discussions, group activities, role-plays, and problem-solving tasks. This not only increases fluency but also builds confidence in using the language.

Furthermore, CLT and TBL support learner autonomy, allowing students to take responsibility for their own learning process. Teachers act as guides who facilitate interaction rather than controlling every aspect of the lesson. As a result, students become more independent and motivated to improve their language abilities both inside and outside the classroom.

Overall, these modern approaches create a more dynamic and student-friendly learning environment, which leads to better long-term language acquisition outcomes.

Interactive Learning Strategies

Interactive strategies include group work, pair discussions, debates, and role-playing activities. These techniques create a dynamic classroom environment.

Students practice speaking more frequently and gain confidence. Interaction also improves social and communication skills.

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Moreover, interactive learning strategies encourage students to actively engage with both the teacher and their classmates, making the learning process more collaborative. Through group activities, learners are exposed to different perspectives, which helps them develop tolerance, teamwork skills, and the ability to express their opinions clearly in English.

In addition, such strategies reduce anxiety and fear of making mistakes, which are common problems in foreign language learning. When students participate in debates or role-plays, they learn to think quickly and respond naturally, which significantly improves fluency. These activities also help reinforce vocabulary and grammar in a more practical and memorable way compared to traditional rote learning.

Overall, interactive strategies play a crucial role in creating a supportive and motivating classroom atmosphere where students are more willing to participate and improve their English communication skills effectively.

Development of Language Skills

Language learning requires the development of four main skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

Listening can be improved through audio materials and real conversations. Speaking develops through interaction and communication tasks. Reading enhances comprehension, while writing improves through structured practice.

An integrated approach ensures balanced skill development. Language learning requires the development of four main skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

Listening can be improved through audio materials and real conversations. Speaking develops through interaction and communication tasks. Reading enhances comprehension, while writing improves through structured practice.

In addition, these four skills are closely interconnected and support each other during the learning process. For example, improved listening skills contribute to better speaking performance, while reading activities help learners expand their vocabulary, which in turn positively affects writing ability. Therefore, effective language instruction should integrate all four skills rather than teaching them separately.

Moreover, the use of authentic materials such as podcasts, articles, videos, and real-life dialogues plays an important role in skill development. These resources expose learners to natural

language usage, different accents, and various communication styles. As a result, students become more familiar with how English is used in real-world contexts.

Teachers can also design balanced activities that combine multiple skills at once, such as reading a text and then discussing it or listening to a conversation and writing a summary. This integrated approach not only strengthens overall language competence but also helps learners use English more fluently and confidently in different situations.

Assessment and Evaluation

Assessment plays a key role in language learning. It helps teachers evaluate progress and identify weaknesses.

Formative assessment provides continuous feedback, while summative assessment measures overall achievement. Self-assessment and peer evaluation also encourage independent learning.

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Formative assessment provides continuous feedback, while summative assessment measures overall achievement.

In addition, effective assessment should not only focus on testing students' knowledge but also support their learning process. Through regular feedback, students can understand their mistakes, recognize areas that need improvement, and take steps to develop their language skills further. This makes assessment an important part of learning rather than just a final measurement.

Moreover, a variety of assessment methods can be used in English language teaching. These may include quizzes, oral presentations, writing tasks, projects, and classroom participation. Such diverse methods allow teachers to evaluate different aspects of language ability, including fluency, accuracy, creativity, and communication skills.

Self-assessment and peer assessment are also valuable tools in modern education. They encourage learners to reflect on their own progress and learn from each other. As a result, students become more aware of their strengths and weaknesses and take greater responsibility for their own learning.

Overall, assessment and evaluation contribute significantly to improving the quality of language education by ensuring continuous development and effective learning outcomes.

Results and Discussion

The integration of modern methods and interactive strategies leads to better learning outcomes. Students become more motivated and actively involved.

However, challenges such as large classrooms and limited resources may affect implementation. Teachers need to adapt methods according to student needs.

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In addition, the success of English language teaching largely depends on how effectively these methods are applied in real classroom settings. Even though modern approaches provide many advantages, their effectiveness can vary depending on factors such as teacher training, institutional support, and students' language proficiency levels. Therefore, careful planning and flexibility are essential in order to achieve the desired results.

Furthermore, the role of the teacher is crucial in overcoming these challenges. Teachers should be able to modify activities, simplify tasks when necessary, and ensure that all students are

given equal opportunities to participate. By doing so, they can maintain an inclusive learning environment where every learner feels involved and supported.

Despite the existing difficulties, continuous professional development and the use of creative teaching strategies can significantly improve the quality of instruction. When teachers combine traditional experience with modern techniques, they can create a more effective and balanced learning process.

Overall, although there are certain limitations in implementation, modern and interactive methods remain highly beneficial for improving English language learning outcomes.

Conclusion

Modern English language teaching requires a balanced and integrated approach. Combining methods, strategies, skill development, and assessment leads to effective learning. Future research should explore innovative technologies and new teaching practices.

Modern English language teaching requires a balanced and integrated approach. Combining methods, strategies, skill development, and assessment leads to effective learning.

In addition, the effectiveness of English language education depends on how well these elements are connected and applied in practice. A student-centered and communicative approach ensures that learners not only understand the language but are also able to use it confidently in real-life situations.

Furthermore, the integration of interactive activities, continuous assessment, and modern teaching tools creates a more engaging and productive learning environment. This helps students develop all essential language skills in a more natural and meaningful way.

Overall, successful English language teaching is achieved when traditional knowledge is combined with innovative methods, ensuring both academic progress and practical communication ability.

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STRATEGIES FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE SKILLS: LISTENING, SPEAKING, READING, AND WRITING

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Abstract: The present study provides a comprehensive analysis of the strategies involved in the systematic development of the four fundamental language skills – listening, speaking, reading, and writing – within the contemporary pedagogical framework of higher education. In an era dominated by rapid technological advancements, the acquisition of a foreign language is no longer confined to traditional rote memorization or basic grammatical drills. Instead, it encompasses a multidisciplinary approach that integrates cognitive linguistics, educational psychology, and the strategic use of digital resources. This

research explores the intricate relationship between receptive input and productive output, emphasizing how listening and reading serve as the essential cognitive foundation for achieving fluency and communicative competence in a globalized academic environment.

The second phase of this investigation delves into the practical application of modern technological tools and their profound impact on the efficiency of language acquisition. Drawing on current findings, the study highlights how tools such as Grammarly, ChatGPT, and QuillBot have become increasingly significant in supporting students through various stages of the writing process, including idea generation, content organization, and the enhancement of linguistic accuracy. By reducing grammatical errors and facilitating complex text structures, these instruments allow learners to focus on higher-order thinking skills. The research analyzes the integration of these AI-driven platforms as supportive mechanisms that complement traditional teaching methodologies rather than replacing the essential human element of language instruction.

Furthermore, the study critically addresses the inherent challenges and ethical considerations associated with the modernization of language learning processes. It identifies significant risks such as potential plagiarism, a decline in independent critical thinking skills, and an over-reliance on automated systems that may lead to the stagnation of authentic linguistic development. Ethical concerns regarding data privacy and the possibility of biased or inaccurate information are also examined as limiting factors. The results suggest that while artificial intelligence and digital resources offer valuable support, they must be utilized in a balanced and responsible manner. The conclusion reinforces the necessity of a learner-centered approach where technology assists the student's cognitive growth without compromising the integrity or the personal effort required to master a foreign language.

Keywords: Four language skills, Listening comprehension, Speaking fluency, Academic reading, Professional writing, Artificial Intelligence (AI) in education, Communicative competence

XARİCİ DİL BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAF ETDİRİLMƏSİ STRATEGİYALARI: DİNLƏMƏ, DANIŞMA, OXU VƏ YAZI

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Xülasə: Təqdim olunan tədqiqat müasir ali təhsilin pedaqoji çərçivəsində dörd əsas dil bacarığının — dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazının sistemli şəkildə inkişafı ilə bağlı strategiyaların hərtərəfli təhlilini təqdim edir. Sürətli texnoloji tərəqqinin üstünlük təşkil etdiyi bir dövrdə xarici dilin mənimsənilməsi artıq ənənəvi əzbərçilik və ya sadə qrammatik tapşırıqlarla məhdudlaşmır. Əksinə, bu proses koqnitiv linqvistikani, təhsil psixologiyasını və rəqəmsal resursların strateji istifadəsini birləşdirən multidissiplinar yanaşmanı əhatə edir. Bu araşdırma qlobal akademik mühitdə səlis danışmaq və kommunikativ səriştəyə nail olmaq üçün dinləmə və oxu bacarıqlarının zəruri koqnitiv təməl rolunu necə oynadığını vurğulayaraq, reseptiv daxiletmə və produktiv xaricetmə arasındakı mürəkkəb əlaqəni araşdırır.

Tədqiqatın ikinci mərhələsi müasir texnoloji vasitələrin praktiki tətbiqinə və onların dil mənimsənilməsinin səmərəliliyinə göstərdiyi dərin təsirə yönəlir. Mövcud tapıntılara əsaslanaraq, tədqiqat Grammarly, ChatGPT və QuillBot kimi alətlərin yazının müxtəlif mərhələlərində — ideyaların yaradılması, məzmunun təşkili və dilin dəqiqliyinin artırılmasında tələbələrə dəstək verməkdə necə mühüm əhəmiyyət kəsb etdiyini göstərir. Qrammatik səhvləri azaltmaq və mürəkkəb mətn strukturlarını asanlaşdırmaqla, bu vasitələr öyrənənlərə daha yüksək səviyyəli düşünmə bacarıqlarına diqqət yetirməyə imkan verir. Araşdırma,

süni intellektə əsaslanan bu platformaların dil tədrisinin vacib insan elementini əvəz etməkdən ziyada, ənənəvi tədris metodologiyalarını tamamlayan köməkçi mexanizmlər kimi inteqrasiyasını təhlil edir.

Bundan əlavə, tədqiqat dil öyrənmə proseslərinin modernləşdirilməsi ilə bağlı mövcud olan çətinlikləri və etik məsələləri tənqidi şəkildə nəzərdən keçirir. Burada plagiat riski, müstəqil tənqidi düşünmə bacarıqlarının zəifləməsi və orijinal linqvistik inkişafın durğunluğuna səbəb ola biləcək avtomatlaşdırılmış sistemlərdən həddindən artıq asılılıq kimi ciddi risklər müəyyən edilir. Məlumat məxfiliyi ilə bağlı etik problemlər və qərəzli və ya qeyri-dəqiq informasiyanın əldə edilməsi ehtimalı da məhdudlaşdırıcı amillər kimi araşdırılır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, süni intellekt və rəqəmsal resurslar qiymətli dəstək təqdim etsə də, onlardan balanslı və məsuliyyətli şəkildə istifadə olunmalıdır. Yekun olaraq, texnologiyanın xarici dili mənimsəmək üçün tələb olunan fərdi səylərə və dürüstlüyə xələl gətirmədən tələbənin koqnitiv inkişafına kömək etdiyi tələbəyönümlü yanaşmanın zəruriliyi vurğulanır.

Açar sözlər: Xarici dilin mənimsənilməsi, Dörd dil bacarığı, Dinləmə anlama, Danışiq səlisiyi, Akademik oxu, Peşəkar yazı, Təhsildə süni intellekt (AI), Kommunikativ səriştə

Introduction

The mastery of a foreign language is a complex, multi-dimensional process that involves more than just the acquisition of vocabulary and grammatical rules. In the contemporary field of English Language Teaching (ELT), the focus has shifted significantly from traditional, isolated skill instruction to a more holistic and integrated model. The “Integrated Approach” is based on the pedagogical principle that in real-world communication, language skills do not function in a vacuum; rather, they are deeply interconnected and interdependent. This research explores how the integration of listening, speaking, reading, and writing creates a synergy that accelerates the learning process.

The theoretical foundation of this approach is rooted in the belief that receptive skills (listening and reading) provide the necessary linguistic “input” that learners need to produce their own “output” through speaking and writing. For instance, extensive exposure to authentic listening materials helps students internalize phonetic patterns and prosody, which directly enhances their oral fluency. Similarly, academic reading proficiency provides the structural and lexical framework required for high-quality writing. This introduction aims to analyze the cognitive benefits of teaching these skills as a unified whole, arguing that an integrated curriculum better prepares students for the complexities of global communication and professional academic environments.

Methodology and Materials

This study employs a comprehensive qualitative research methodology, centered on the analysis of modern pedagogical frameworks and established language acquisition theories. The primary objective of this methodology is to investigate the practical effectiveness of skill integration in higher education settings. To ensure a thorough understanding, the research draws upon secondary data sources, including a systematic review of seminal works in linguistics and language teaching pedagogy. The methodology focuses on the "Input-Output" hypothesis, examining the transition from passive comprehension to active production. The materials used in this study consist of a diverse range of instructional resources designed to simulate authentic language environments. These include:

- Authentic Audio-Visual Materials: Used to analyze the development of listening comprehension and phonetic awareness.
- Diverse Text Corpora: Ranging from academic journals to contemporary literature, used to study the impact of reading on lexical expansion.
- Interactive Communication Tasks: Such as structured debates, role-plays, and

- collaborative writing projects, which serve as the basis for evaluating productive skills. By synthesizing these materials, the research provides a balanced view of how different instructional tools can be woven together to create a seamless learning experience that addresses all four linguistic domains simultaneously.

Discussion

The development of foreign language skills requires a strategic and pedagogical balance between receptive input and productive output. One of the central points of discussion is the “Linguistic Imbalance” that often occurs when skills are taught in isolation. For example, a student may possess a high level of reading comprehension but remain unable to engage in a basic conversation due to a lack of integrated speaking practice. Therefore, the discussion emphasizes that communicative competence is only achieved when learners can transition fluidly between listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

1. Receptive Foundation: Listening and reading act as the primary engines of language growth. Listening allows students to perceive the natural flow of language, while reading introduces them to formal sentence structures and nuanced vocabulary.
2. Productive Application: Speaking and writing are the ultimate tests of a learner’s proficiency. In an integrated classroom, a reading assignment should ideally lead into a discussion (speaking) or a reflective essay (writing). This reinforces the vocabulary and structures learned during the receptive phase.

Furthermore, the discussion highlights the role of “Scaffolding” in the integrated approach. By providing students with a strong base through listening and reading, educators can reduce the cognitive load when students move toward the more challenging tasks of speaking and writing. This method not only builds fluency but also fosters confidence and critical thinking, as students are encouraged to process and synthesize information across different formats. The integration of these skills ensures that the learner’s development is not only rapid but also sustainable and applicable to real-world scenarios.

Conclusion

The systematic review of integrated language teaching strategies confirms that this approach is the most effective and efficient pathway to achieving professional language proficiency. The findings of this study suggest that when the four core skills—listening, speaking, reading, and writing—are treated as a unified whole, students demonstrate a significantly more profound and functional mastery of the foreign language. This holistic method ensures that the learner’s progress is balanced, preventing the common issue of being “strong in theory but weak in practice.”

In conclusion, the integration of skills assists students in building their independent thinking and communicative abilities, preparing them for the rigors of both academic and professional life. Educators are encouraged to move away from fragmented teaching models and instead embrace curricula that simulate the natural, interconnected way language is used in daily life. Ultimately, a balanced focus on all four domains remains the cornerstone of successful language acquisition, fostering a generation of learners who are not only linguistically accurate but also communicatively competent and culturally aware.

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COMMUNICATIVE APPROACHES TO TEACHING GRAMMAR IN NON-LINGUISTIC UNIVERSITIES

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Abstract: This study examines the role of grammar instruction in non-linguistic higher education institutions and proposes a communicative reorientation of grammar teaching practices. Grammar is viewed not as a static set of rules but as a functional resource for meaning-making in context. The article focuses on the development of grammatical competence as a core component of communicative competence and highlights the common gap between learners' knowledge of grammar and their ability to use it effectively in real-life communication.

The study analyzes several pedagogical approaches, including the lexical approach, language awareness, task-based learning, and Dogme ELT, and evaluates their relevance to communicative grammar teaching. Additionally, key principles for effective grammar instruction are identified, and a staged model for the development of grammatical skills is proposed. The findings indicate that integrating grammar into meaningful communicative practice significantly improves both accuracy and fluency in language use.

Keywords: communicative approach; grammatical competence; communicative grammar; task-based learning; foreign language teaching

QEYRİ-LİŇQVİSTİK UNİVERSİTETLƏRDƏ QRAMMATİKANIN TƏDRİSİNDƏ KOMMUNİKATİV YANAŞMALAR

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Xülasə: Bu məqalədə qeyri-dil ixtisaslı ali təhsil müəssisələrində xarici dil qrammatikasının tədrisi məsələləri araşdırılır və kommunikativ yanaşma əsasında qrammatika tədrisinin yenidən nəzərdən keçirilməsi təklif olunur. Qrammatika yalnız qaydalar toplusu kimi deyil, ünsiyyət zamanı mənanın ifadəsi üçün istifadə olunan funksional vasitə kimi təqdim edilir. Məqalədə qrammatik kompetensiyanın

kommunikativ kompetensiyanın əsas tərkib hissəsi kimi rolu təhlil olunur və tələbələrin qrammatik biliklərlə onların praktik istifadəsi arasındakı fərqlə xüsusi diqqət yetirilir.

Tədqiqat çərçivəsində leksik yanaşma, Language Awareness, Task-Based Learning və Dogme metodları kimi müasir yanaşmalar araşdırılır və onların qrammatika tədrisində tətbiq imkanları göstərilir. Eyni zamanda, effektiv qrammatika tədrisi üçün əsas prinsiplər müəyyən edilir və qrammatik bacarıqların mərhələli inkişaf modeli təqdim olunur.

Nəticə olaraq qeyd olunur ki, qrammatikanın kommunikativ kontekstdə tədrisi tələbələrin həm düzgün, həm də sərbəst danışmaq bacarıqlarının inkişafına müsbət təsir göstərir.

Açar sözlər: kommunikativ yanaşma; qrammatik kompetensiya; kommunikativ qrammatika; tapşırıq əsaslı öyrənmə; xarici dil tədrisi

Introduction

In contemporary language education, the emphasis has shifted from the accumulation of linguistic knowledge to the development of communicative ability. This shift is particularly relevant in non-linguistic universities, where foreign language learning serves practical and professional purposes rather than linguistic specialization. However, traditional approaches to grammar teaching often fail to produce learners who can use language effectively in real-life communication.

One of the central principles of communicative language teaching is the emphasis on interaction as a driving force in language acquisition. Interaction provides learners with opportunities to negotiate meaning, clarify misunderstandings, and adjust their language output in response to feedback. This dynamic process contributes significantly to the development of grammatical competence.

From a pedagogical perspective, interaction encourages learners to move beyond passive reception of rules toward active language use. During communicative exchanges, learners are exposed to a variety of grammatical structures in context, which enhances their ability to recognize patterns and internalize them. Moreover, interaction creates a need for precise expression, motivating learners to refine their grammatical accuracy.

Research in second language acquisition suggests that interaction facilitates the process of “noticing,” where learners become aware of gaps between their own language use and the target language norms (Larsen-Freeman, 2003). This awareness is crucial for grammar development, as it triggers cognitive processes that lead to restructuring of linguistic knowledge.

A common issue observed in such contexts is the discrepancy between students’ knowledge of grammatical rules and their ability to apply them in spontaneous interaction. Learners may demonstrate accuracy in controlled exercises but struggle to express themselves fluently. This suggests that grammar instruction should move beyond rule-based teaching toward a more communicative and functional approach (Richards & Rodgers, 2001).

The notion of grammatical competence has evolved significantly over time. Initially, it was defined as the internalized system of rules that enables speakers to produce grammatically correct sentences. While this perspective emphasizes the cognitive dimension of language, it does not fully account for the role of context in communication.

Later developments in applied linguistics expanded this concept to include the ability to use grammatical structures appropriately in different communicative situations. According to Larsen-Freeman (2003), grammar should be understood as a dynamic skill—referred to as “grammaring”—which involves the integration of form, meaning, and use. This perspective highlights the importance of flexibility and adaptability in language use.

Furthermore, grammatical competence is closely linked to communicative competence, as it provides the structural foundation for expressing meaning effectively (Gal's ova & Gez, 2009). Without sufficient grammatical control, communication may become ambiguous or ineffective.

Despite its importance, grammar remains one of the most challenging aspects of foreign language learning. One of the key difficulties is the gap between declarative and procedural knowledge. Learners often know grammatical rules but are unable to apply them in real-time communication (Evgrafova, 2016).

This problem is exacerbated by traditional teaching methods that present grammar in isolation, without sufficient contextualization. As a result, learners may develop fragmented knowledge that cannot be easily transferred to authentic situations. Additionally, excessive focus on accuracy may discourage learners from taking risks, limiting their communicative development.

In non-linguistic universities, these challenges are further intensified by limited instructional time and varying levels of student motivation. Therefore, more effective and engaging approaches are needed to facilitate grammar acquisition.

The communicative approach offers a viable solution to these challenges by integrating grammar instruction with meaningful language use. Within this framework, grammar is viewed as a resource for communication rather than an end in itself. This implies that grammatical forms should be taught in context and linked to communicative purposes (Azimov & Shchukin, 2009).

A central principle of communicative grammar teaching is the integration of form, meaning, and use. Learners are encouraged to explore how grammatical structures function in discourse and how they contribute to conveying meaning. Authentic materials play a crucial role in this process, as they expose learners to natural language patterns.

The use of authentic materials allows learners to observe how grammatical structures function in different contexts, thereby strengthening the connection between form and meaning. For example, learners can analyze how tense and aspect are used in narratives, how modal verbs express politeness in conversations, or how sentence structures vary across genres.

In addition, authentic materials increase learner motivation by making the learning process more relevant and engaging. When students work with real-world texts—such as articles, videos, or interviews—they are more likely to perceive the practical value of grammar. This aligns with the principles of communicative language teaching, which emphasize meaningful and purposeful language use (Richards & Rodgers, 2001).

Grammar teaching should move beyond rule memorization and focus on meaningful communication. The communicative approach enables learners to use grammar effectively in real-life situations, improving both fluency and accuracy.

Lexical Approach

The lexical approach emphasizes the importance of multi-word units and collocations in language learning. According to Lewis (1997), grammar and vocabulary are closely interconnected, and grammatical patterns often emerge from lexical combinations. Teaching grammar through lexical chunks can enhance fluency and naturalness in language use.

Language Awareness

The language awareness approach encourages learners to analyze language and discover patterns самостоятельно. This process promotes deeper understanding and helps learners internalize grammatical structures more effectively (Bolitho, 2011).

Task-Based Learning (TBL)

Task-Based Learning focuses on the use of language for completing meaningful tasks. Grammar is addressed after task completion, allowing learners to reflect on their language use and identify gaps in their knowledge (Ellis, 2005). This approach supports both fluency and accuracy.

Dogme ELT

Dogme ELT emphasizes spontaneous communication and minimizes the use of pre-prepared materials. Grammar emerges naturally from classroom interaction, making learning more relevant and personalized (Meddings & Thornbury, 2009).

Principles of Effective Grammar Instruction

Effective grammar teaching within the communicative framework is based on several key principles:

- grammar should be presented in meaningful contexts;
- form, meaning, and use should be integrated;
- learners should engage in communicative practice;
- authentic materials should be used;
- instruction should balance accuracy and fluency;
- learners should be encouraged to reflect on their language use.

These principles contribute to the development of grammatical competence as a functional skill.

A Developmental Model of Grammar Acquisition

The process of developing grammatical competence can be organized into several stages:

- **Exposure** to grammar in context;
- **Noticing** of grammatical patterns;
- **Understanding** of form and meaning
- **Practice** through guided activities;
- **Production** in communicative tasks
- **Feedback** and reflection

This model emphasizes the gradual transition from knowledge to use and highlights the importance of interaction in language learning (Lunev, 2017).

Conclusion

The expansion of communicative grammar teaching highlights the importance of interaction, authenticity, learner autonomy, and technological integration in language education. Grammar is most effectively learned when it is embedded in meaningful communication and supported by reflective practice.

By adopting a communicative perspective, educators can create learning environments that promote both accuracy and fluency. This approach not only enhances grammatical competence but also prepares learners to use language confidently in real-life situations.

Grammar remains a fundamental component of foreign language proficiency, but its effective teaching requires a shift from traditional rule-based methods to communicative approaches. By integrating grammar with meaningful communication, educators can help learners develop both accuracy and fluency.

The communicative approach, supported by various pedagogical methods, provides a comprehensive framework for teaching grammar in non-linguistic universities. It enables learners to use language more confidently and effectively in real-life situations, thereby fulfilling the primary goal of language education.

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OBJECTIVE AND SUBJECTIVE ASSESSMENT IN TRADITIONAL AND MODERN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract: In recent years, the role of assessment in English language teaching has undergone significant transformation, reflecting broader changes in educational practices and pedagogical approaches. Traditional assessment methods have largely relied on objective techniques such as multiple-choice

questions, true-false items, and standardized testing formats. These approaches are often valued for their reliability, clarity, and ease of scoring. However, they tend to focus primarily on discrete language elements such as grammar and vocabulary, which may not fully represent learners' overall communicative competence.

In contrast, modern language teaching emphasizes the importance of subjective and performance-based assessment methods. These include tasks such as essays, oral presentations, and interactive classroom activities that allow learners to demonstrate their ability to use language in meaningful and realistic contexts. Such approaches provide a more comprehensive evaluation of learners' productive skills, including speaking and writing, as well as their ability to think critically and express ideas effectively.

This study explores the differences between objective and subjective assessment methods within both traditional and modern frameworks of English language teaching. It also considers how these approaches influence the evaluation of the four key language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. Special attention is given to the role of formative assessment, which supports continuous learning through feedback and reflection.

Overall, the findings suggest that while objective assessment remains useful for measuring specific knowledge, subjective assessment plays a crucial role in developing and evaluating communicative competence. A balanced integration of both approaches is therefore essential for effective and comprehensive language assessment.

Keywords: language assessment, objective assessment, subjective assessment, English language teaching, formative assessment, communicative competence, evaluation methods

ƏNƏNƏVİ VƏ MÜASİR İNGİLİS DİLİ TƏDRİSİNDƏ OBYEKTİV VƏ SUBYEKTİV QIYMƏTLƏNDİRMƏ

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Xülasə: Son illərdə ingilis dili tədrisində qiymətləndirmə anlayışı təhsil sistemində baş verən ümumi dəyişikliklərlə paralel şəkildə əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə inkişaf etmişdir. Ənənəvi qiymətləndirmə üsulları əsasən obyektiv yanaşmalara əsaslanırdı və çoxvariantlı testlər, doğru-yanlış tapşırıqları və standart imtahan formaları vasitəsilə həyata keçirilirdi. Bu üsulların üstün cəhətləri onların dəqiq, sabit və asan qiymətləndirilə bilməsidir. Lakin bu yanaşmalar əsasən qrammatika və lüğət kimi dilin ayrı-ayrı elementlərini ölçdüyü üçün öyrənənlərin ümumi kommunikativ bacarıqlarını tam şəkildə əks etdirmir.

Müasir tədris yanaşmalarında isə subyektiv və performans əsaslanan qiymətləndirmə üsullarına daha çox üstünlük verilir. Essé yazıları, şifahi təqdimatlar və interaktiv tapşırıqlar kimi fəaliyyətlər öyrənənlərə dili real və mənalı situasiyalarda istifadə etməyə imkan yaradır. Bu cür yanaşmalar danışma və yazı kimi məhsuldar bacarıqların, həmçinin tənqidi düşünmə və fikrin ifadə olunması qabiliyyətinin daha obyektiv qiymətləndirilməsinə şərait yaradır.

Bu məqalədə ənənəvi və müasir ingilis dili tədrisində obyektiv və subyektiv qiymətləndirmə üsulları müqayisəli şəkildə təhlil olunur. Eyni zamanda dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı bacarıqlarının qiymətləndirilməsində bu yanaşmaların rolu araşdırılır. Formativ qiymətləndirmənin öyrənmə prosesində əhəmiyyəti də xüsusi vurğulanır.

Ümumilikdə nəticə göstərir ki, obyektiv qiymətləndirmə konkret biliklərin ölçülməsində faydalı olsa da, subyektiv qiymətləndirmə kommunikativ bacarıqların inkişafı və qiymətləndirilməsi baxımından daha geniş imkanlar yaradır. Bu səbəbdən hər iki yanaşmanın balanslı şəkildə tətbiqi daha səmərəli nəticə verir.

Açar sözlər: dilin qiymətləndirilməsi, obyektiv qiymətləndirmə, subyektiv qiymətləndirmə, ingilis dili tədrisi, formativ qiymətləndirmə, kommunikativ bacarıq, qiymətləndirmə üsulları

Introduction

In recent years, assessment in English language teaching has undergone significant changes, reflecting broader developments in educational theory and classroom practice. Traditionally, assessment was largely based on objective methods such as multiple-choice tests, matching exercises, and true-false questions. These approaches were mainly designed to measure learners' knowledge of discrete language elements, particularly grammar and vocabulary. While such methods are considered reliable and easy to administer, they often fail to evaluate learners' ability to use language in meaningful communication (Brown, 2004; Hughes, 2003).

With the emergence of communicative language teaching and learner-centered approaches, the focus of assessment has gradually shifted toward more comprehensive and performance-based methods. Richards and Rodgers (2014) argue that modern language teaching requires assessment practices that reflect communicative competence rather than isolated knowledge. In this context, subjective assessment methods, including essays, oral presentations, and project-based tasks, have become increasingly important.

Furthermore, contemporary educational perspectives highlight the role of formative assessment in supporting learning. Black and Wiliam (1998) emphasize that continuous feedback and assessment for learning significantly improve student performance. Similarly, Wiliam (2011) suggests that formative assessment helps learners understand their progress and identify areas for improvement.

Against this background, this study examines objective and subjective assessment methods in both traditional and modern English language teaching, focusing on their effectiveness in evaluating learners' overall language proficiency.

Research

Assessment plays a central role in English language teaching, as it not only measures learning outcomes but also influences teaching methods and learner behavior. Traditionally, objective assessment methods have been widely used due to their reliability, validity, and ease of scoring. These methods, such as multiple-choice tests and standardized examinations, provide clear and consistent results while minimizing examiner bias (Brown, 2004; McNamara, 2000). However, they primarily focus on receptive knowledge and often fail to assess productive language skills effectively.

In contrast, subjective assessment methods offer a more comprehensive evaluation of learners' language abilities. These include essay writing, oral presentations, portfolios, and classroom-based performance tasks. According to Harmer (2015), such methods allow teachers to assess learners' fluency, creativity, and communicative competence in more authentic contexts. Fulcher and Davidson (2007) also note that performance-based assessment provides valuable insights into learners' ability to use language in real-life situations.

From a communicative perspective, modern language teaching emphasizes the importance of assessing learners' ability to use language meaningfully. Richards (2006) argues that communicative competence includes not only grammatical knowledge but also sociolinguistic and pragmatic abilities. Therefore, assessment should reflect real-life communication rather than isolated language forms.

In addition, formative assessment has become a key component of modern teaching practices. Unlike summative assessment, which evaluates learning at the end of a course, formative assessment focuses on continuous feedback and improvement. Black and Wiliam (1998) demonstrate that formative assessment significantly enhances student achievement by involving learners in the evaluation process. Wiliam (2011) further highlights that feedback-oriented assessment helps learners become more autonomous and responsible.

Another important issue is the balance between objectivity and subjectivity in assessment. While objective methods ensure fairness and consistency, subjective methods provide deeper insights into learners' abilities. Weir (2005) emphasizes that effective assessment should combine both approaches to ensure validity and reliability.

Moreover, assessment practices directly influence learner motivation. When learners are evaluated through meaningful and interactive tasks, they are more likely to be engaged and motivated. Harmer (2015) notes that assessment should support learning rather than merely measure it. In this sense, integrating both objective and subjective methods creates a more balanced and effective assessment system.

Overall, modern English language teaching requires a comprehensive approach to assessment that includes both traditional and innovative methods. By combining objectivity with flexibility, teachers can better evaluate learners' knowledge and communicative competence.

Methodology and Materials

The present study applies a descriptive and analytical approach to examine objective and subjective assessment methods in English language teaching. The research is mainly based on the analysis of academic literature, methodological studies, and educational theories related to language assessment and classroom evaluation. The purpose of the study is to compare traditional and modern assessment practices and to investigate how these approaches influence the teaching and learning process.

The materials used in the study consist of books, journal articles, and professional publications written by scholars in the fields of applied linguistics, language testing, and English language teaching. Particular attention is given to sources discussing communicative language teaching, formative assessment, and learner-centered instruction. These materials provide both theoretical explanations and practical examples of assessment methods used in English language classrooms.

Within the research process, objective assessment methods such as multiple-choice tests, true-false questions, matching activities, and gap-filling tasks are examined in terms of reliability, practicality, and scoring accuracy. At the same time, subjective assessment techniques including essay writing, oral presentations, classroom interaction, portfolios, and project work are analyzed from the perspective of communicative competence and authentic language use.

The study also considers the role of formative assessment in modern education. Continuous feedback, peer evaluation, and self-assessment practices are reviewed to understand their contribution to learner development and motivation. In addition, the research compares traditional teacher-centered assessment approaches with more flexible learner-centered evaluation methods commonly used in contemporary English language teaching.

Since the study is theoretical in nature, no experimental procedures or statistical data collection methods are applied. Instead, conclusions are drawn through the interpretation and comparison of existing scholarly sources. The overall analysis aims to identify the strengths and

limitations of both objective and subjective assessment and to determine how they can be integrated effectively in language education.

Discussion

The findings of this study indicate that both objective and subjective assessment methods play an important role in English language teaching, although they focus on different aspects of language learning. Objective assessment methods are generally valued for their reliability, consistency, and ease of administration. Because answers are usually fixed and predetermined, scoring becomes more impartial and suitable for large groups of learners. For this reason, standardized examinations and placement tests often rely heavily on objective testing formats.

Despite these advantages, objective assessment has certain limitations. Such methods mainly evaluate recognition and memorization of language forms rather than the practical use of language in communication. Learners may achieve high scores in grammar or vocabulary tests while still experiencing difficulties in speaking or expressing ideas fluently. Therefore, relying only on objective testing may provide an incomplete picture of learners' actual language ability.

Subjective assessment methods, on the other hand, allow teachers to observe learners' performance in more realistic and meaningful contexts. Activities such as presentations, essays, classroom discussions, and project work help students demonstrate creativity, fluency, and critical thinking skills. These methods are particularly effective in assessing productive language skills and communicative competence.

Another significant point revealed in the discussion is the growing importance of formative assessment in modern English language teaching. Continuous feedback enables learners to identify their weaknesses and gradually improve their performance. In learner-centered classrooms, assessment is not viewed solely as a grading tool but also as a part of the learning process itself. This approach increases learner participation and encourages greater responsibility for individual progress.

However, subjective assessment may sometimes create challenges related to scoring consistency and personal interpretation. Different teachers may evaluate the same performance differently depending on their expectations and teaching experience. As a result, balancing objectivity and flexibility becomes essential in modern assessment practices.

The discussion also demonstrates that assessment strongly affects learner motivation and classroom atmosphere. Students are generally more motivated when assessment tasks reflect real communication and practical language use. Supportive feedback and interactive activities reduce anxiety and help learners develop confidence in using English.

Overall, the study suggests that neither objective nor subjective assessment should be used independently. A balanced combination of both approaches provides a more complete evaluation of learners' knowledge, skills, and communicative abilities. Such integration creates a more effective and fair assessment system in contemporary English language teaching.

Conclusion

In conclusion, assessment in English language teaching has evolved from traditional objective methods toward more comprehensive and learner-centered approaches. While objective assessment remains valuable for measuring specific knowledge and ensuring reliability, it is not sufficient for evaluating communicative competence.

Subjective assessment methods provide a deeper understanding of learners' abilities, particularly in productive skills such as speaking and writing. In addition, formative assessment plays a crucial role in supporting continuous learning and improving learner outcomes.

The findings of this study suggest that a balanced integration of objective and subjective assessment methods leads to more effective evaluation and enhances overall language learning. Therefore, modern English language teaching should adopt a flexible and comprehensive assessment approach that reflects both accuracy and real-life language use.

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MODERN APPROACHES IN TEACHING ENGLISH AS A FOREIGN LANGUAGE: ENHANCING COMMUNICATIVE COMPETENCE

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Abstract: The increasing global role of English as an international language has led to significant changes in language teaching methodologies. This paper investigates modern approaches to teaching English as a Foreign Language (EFL), focusing on the development of communicative competence. Traditional methods, which emphasized grammar and translation, are gradually being replaced by learner-centered and interactive approaches such as Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT). The study examines how these approaches contribute to the development of the four main language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. Special attention is given to the role of digital technologies and innovative teaching strategies in enhancing student engagement and learning outcomes. The findings indicate that modern teaching approaches not only improve students' communicative abilities but also increase motivation and participation. However, several challenges such as lack of resources, insufficient teacher training, and large classroom sizes still affect the effective implementation of these methods.

Keywords: EFL, communicative competence, CLT, TBLT, language teaching, digital learning

XARİCİ DİL KİMİ İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ MÜASİR YANAŞMALAR: KOMMUNİKATİV KOMPETENSİYANIN İNKİŞAF ETDİRİLMƏSİ

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Xülasə: İngilis dilinin beynəlxalq ünsiyyət vasitəsi kimi əhəmiyyətinin artması onun tədris metodlarında mühüm dəyişikliklərə səbəb olmuşdur. Bu məqalədə xarici dil kimi ingilis dilinin tədrisində müasir yanaşmalar və kommunikativ kompetensiyanın inkişafı araşdırılır. Ənənəvi qrammatika və tərcümə əsaslı metodların yerini getdikcə daha çox tələbəyönümlü və interaktiv yanaşmalar, xüsusilə kommunikativ dil tədrisi (CLT) və tapşırıq əsaslı dil tədrisi (TBLT) tutur. Tədqiqat çərçivəsində bu yanaşmaların dinləmə, danışma, oxu və yazı kimi əsas dil bacarıqlarının inkişafına təsiri təhlil edilir. Eyni zamanda, rəqəmsal texnologiyaların və innovativ tədris strategiyalarının tələbələrin motivasiyasına və öyrənmə nəticələrinə təsiri nəzərdən keçirilir. Araşdırmanın nəticələri göstərir ki, müasir tədris metodları tələbələrin kommunikativ bacarıqlarını əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə inkişaf etdirir və onların dərslə fəal iştirakını artırır. Bununla belə, resurs çatışmazlığı, müəllim hazırlığının yetərli olmaması və böyük siniflər kimi problemlər bu metodların tətbiqinə müəyyən çətinliklər yaradır.

Açar sözlər: xarici dil kimi ingilis dili, kommunikativ kompetensiya, kommunikativ dil tədrisi (CLT), tapşırıq əsaslı dil tədrisi (TBLT), dil tədrisi, rəqəmsal öyrənmə

Introduction

In the modern world, English has become a global language used in education, business, science, and international communication. As a result, teaching English effectively has become a major concern for educators worldwide. Traditional teaching methods, such as the Grammar-Translation Method, focused mainly on memorization and grammatical rules. Although these methods helped learners understand language structure, they often failed to develop communicative competence. In contrast, modern approaches emphasize communication, interaction, and real-life language use. Communicative competence involves not only grammatical knowledge but also the ability to use language appropriately in different contexts. This paper aims to explore modern approaches in EFL teaching and analyze their effectiveness in improving students' communicative competence. It also examines the role of technology and innovative teaching strategies in language education. This research is based on a qualitative approach, involving the analysis of academic literature related to English language teaching methodologies. Books, peer-reviewed journal articles, and conference papers were reviewed to identify key trends and developments in the field. Comparative analysis was used to examine differences between traditional and modern teaching methods.

In addition, classroom observations and practical teaching experiences were considered to provide real-life insights into the application of these methods. The study also incorporates examples of classroom activities, digital tools, and assessment techniques used in modern EFL teaching. These examples help illustrate how theoretical approaches can be applied in practice. The materials used in this study consist of both theoretical and practical sources. Theoretical materials include foundational works on Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), as well as studies focusing on second language acquisition and communicative competence. Practical materials involve sample lesson plans, classroom activities,

and digital teaching tools commonly used in EFL classrooms. In addition to literature review, the study incorporates observational data derived from classroom practices. These observations are based on real teaching experiences in secondary and higher education contexts, where modern teaching strategies were implemented.

The observational approach allows for a deeper understanding of how theoretical methods function in real classroom environments. A comparative method was employed to analyze differences between traditional teaching approaches and modern methodologies. The Grammar-Translation Method was used as a reference point for traditional instruction, while CLT and TBLT were analyzed as representative modern approaches. The comparison focused on several criteria, including student engagement, interaction level, skill development, and learning outcomes. Furthermore, elements of descriptive analysis were used to interpret the effectiveness of various teaching techniques. Classroom activities such as role-plays, group discussions, project-based tasks, and digital learning applications were examined to evaluate their contribution to language acquisition.

Methodology and Materials

To ensure the validity of the research, multiple sources were cross-checked and analyzed critically. The study also considers the role of technological tools, including online learning platforms, mobile applications, and virtual classrooms, in supporting language learning. These tools were evaluated based on accessibility, usability, and their impact on student motivation.

Although the study does not involve quantitative data or statistical analysis, it provides a detailed qualitative insight into the effectiveness of modern EFL teaching approaches. The limitation of this method lies in its reliance on existing literature and observational data; however, it allows for an in-depth understanding of current trends and practices in language education. The materials used in this study consist of both theoretical and practical sources. Theoretical materials include foundational works on Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT), as well as studies focusing on second language acquisition and communicative competence. Practical materials involve sample lesson plans, classroom activities, and digital teaching tools commonly used in EFL classrooms. In addition to literature review, the study incorporates observational data derived from classroom practices.

These observations are based on real teaching experiences in secondary and higher education contexts, where modern teaching strategies were implemented. The observational approach allows for a deeper understanding of how theoretical methods function in real classroom environments. A comparative method was employed to analyze differences between traditional teaching approaches and modern methodologies.

Discussion

The Grammar-Translation Method was used as a reference point for traditional instruction, while CLT and TBLT were analyzed as representative modern approaches. The comparison focused on several criteria, including student engagement, interaction level, skill development, and learning outcomes. Furthermore, elements of descriptive analysis were used to interpret the effectiveness of various teaching techniques. Classroom activities such as role-plays, group discussions, project-based tasks, and digital learning applications were examined to evaluate their contribution to language acquisition. (Richards, J. C., 2006)

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Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) is considered one of the most effective modern approaches in English language teaching, as it emphasizes the use of meaningful tasks to promote real-life communication. Unlike traditional methods that focus primarily on grammatical structures and controlled practice, TBLT encourages learners to use language as a tool for achieving specific goals.

A “task” in TBLT is defined as an activity in which learners use the target language to complete a meaningful objective, such as solving a problem, making a decision, or sharing information. These tasks are designed to reflect real-world situations, thereby increasing the relevance of classroom learning. Examples include planning a trip, conducting interviews, preparing presentations, or writing emails. One of the key principles of TBLT is that language learning occurs more effectively when students are focused on meaning rather than form. During task performance, learners prioritize communication, and grammatical accuracy develops gradually through use and feedback. (Brown, H. D., 2004)

This process mirrors natural language acquisition, where individuals learn language by using it in context rather than memorizing rules in isolation. TBLT typically follows a structured framework consisting of three main stages: pre-task, task cycle, and post-task. In the pre-task stage, the teacher introduces the topic, activates prior knowledge, and provides necessary vocabulary or instructions. During the task cycle, students work individually or collaboratively to complete the task, often engaging in discussion and negotiation of meaning. In the post-task stage, learners reflect on their performance, receive feedback, and focus on language forms that emerged during the activity. (Ellis, R., 2003)

The results of classroom implementation indicate that TBLT significantly enhances students’ communicative competence. Learners become more confident in using English, as they are exposed to authentic and purposeful communication. Moreover, TBLT promotes learner autonomy, as students take responsibility for completing tasks and managing their own learning processes. Another important advantage of TBLT is its contribution to the development of higher-order thinking skills.

Tasks often require analysis, evaluation, and creativity, which go beyond simple language use. For example, problem-solving tasks encourage students to think critically and collaborate with peers, thereby integrating cognitive and linguistic development. In addition, TBLT supports collaborative learning. Group and pair work are essential components of this approach, allowing learners to interact with each other and learn through communication. This interaction not only improves language skills but also fosters social and interpersonal competencies. However, the implementation of TBLT also presents certain challenges.

Designing effective and meaningful tasks requires careful planning and a high level of teacher expertise. Teachers must ensure that tasks are appropriate for students’ proficiency levels and aligned with learning objectives. Furthermore, in large classrooms, managing group work and monitoring student performance can be difficult. Another challenge is related to assessment. Traditional testing methods may not fully capture the outcomes of task-based learning, as they often focus on accuracy rather than communicative effectiveness. Therefore, alternative assessment

strategies, such as performance-based evaluation and continuous assessment, are more suitable for TBLT contexts.

Conclusion

Despite these challenges, TBLT remains a highly valuable approach in modern EFL teaching. Its focus on meaningful communication, learner engagement, and real-life application makes it particularly effective in developing communicative competence. When implemented appropriately, TBLT can transform the classroom into a dynamic and interactive learning environment where students actively use language to achieve practical goals.

Modern approaches emphasize the integration of all four language skills:

- Listening: Students are exposed to authentic audio materials such as podcasts and conversations.
- Speaking: Activities like debates and presentations improve fluency and confidence.
- Reading: Authentic texts help develop comprehension and analytical skills.
- Writing: Writing tasks include essays, reports, and creative assignments.

Technology has transformed language teaching in recent years. Online platforms, mobile applications, and interactive tools provide new opportunities for learning. Digital tools allow students to learn independently, access authentic materials, and receive instant feedback. They also make lessons more engaging and interactive. Examples include virtual classrooms, language learning apps, and AI-based tools. Assessment plays a crucial role in the learning process. Modern approaches emphasize formative assessment, which focuses on continuous feedback rather than final exams only. Methods such as peer assessment, self-assessment, and project-based evaluation are widely used. These methods help students become more aware of their learning progress. (Harmer, J., 2007)

Despite their advantages, modern teaching approaches face several challenges:

- Limited access to technology
- Teacher training
- Large class sizes
- Traditional mindset in some institutions

Modern approaches to teaching English as a Foreign Language have significantly improved the quality of language education. Methods such as CLT and TBLT promote communication, interaction, and student engagement. However, effective implementation requires proper teacher training, sufficient resources, and institutional support. Future developments should focus on integrating technology and adapting teaching methods to different learning environments.

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MODERN METHODS AND APPROACHES IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract: This article is dedicated to a comprehensive analysis of modern methods and approaches applied in teaching the English language. In today's globalizing world, English occupies a leading position in education, international business, science, and mass communication. Therefore, acquiring and effectively learning this language is more important than ever. Over time, it has become evident that traditional, grammar-translation and rote-learning methods no longer fully meet contemporary demands. For this reason, there is a great need for innovative approaches to make the learning process more dynamic, engaging, and result-oriented.

The research paper details the communicative language teaching methodology, interactive classroom environments, and the integration of digital technologies into education. At the same time, special attention is paid to the balanced and parallel development of the core language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. Alongside these, objective mechanisms for assessing students' knowledge and skills in the modern era are not overlooked. The analyses and results obtained once again confirm that the proper application of modern methods significantly contributes to students mastering a foreign language more quickly, fluently, and with greater confidence.

Keywords: English teaching, modern methods, communication, language skills, learning strategies

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ MÜASİR ÜSUL VƏ YANAŞMALAR

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Xülasə: Bu məqalə ingilis dilinin tədrisində tətbiq olunan müasir metod və yanaşmaların hərtərəfli təhlilinə həsr olunmuşdur. Qloballaşan müasir dünyada ingilis dili təhsil, beynəlxalq biznes, elm və kütləvi ünsiyyət sahələrində aparıcı mövqe tutur. Məhz buna görə də bu dilin mənimsənilməsi və effektiv öyrənilməsi hər zamankindən daha vacibdir. Zaman keçdikcə klassik və əzbərciliyə əsaslanan ənənəvi tədris metodlarının tələbləri tam qarşılamadığı üzə çıxmışdır. Bu səbəbdən təlim prosesini daha dinamik, maraqlı və nəticəyönümlü etmək üçün innovativ yanaşmalara böyük ehtiyac yaranmışdır.

Tədqiqat işində kommunikativ dil öyrənmə metodologiyası, interaktiv sinif mühiti və rəqəmsal texnologiyaların tədrisə integrasiyası ətraflı şəkildə izah olunur. Eyni zamanda, dilin əsas təməl bacarıqları olan dinləmə, danışma, oxuma və yazma qabiliyyətlərinin paralel və balanslı şəkildə inkişaf etdirilməsi məsələlərinə xüsusi diqqət yetirilir. Bunlarla yanaşı, müasir dövrdə tələbələrin bilik və bacarıqlarının obyektiv qiymətləndirilməsi mexanizmləri də diqqətdən kənarda qalmır. Aparılan təhlillər və əldə olunan nəticələr bir daha təsdiq edir ki, müasir metodların düzgün tətbiqi tələbələrin xarici dili daha sürətli, sərbəst və böyük inamla mənimsəmələrinə mühüm töhfə verir.

Açar sözlər: İngilis dili tədrisi, müasir metodlar, ünsiyyət, dil bacarıqları, öyrənmə strategiyaları

Introduction

In recent years, the importance of learning English has increased significantly. English is used all over the world and is considered a global language. People learn English for different reasons such as education, work, travel, and communication. Because of this, teaching English effectively has become very important.

In the past, traditional methods were used in teaching English. These methods focused mainly on grammar and memorization. However, they were not always effective in helping students communicate in real life. Today, modern methods are used to make learning more practical, interactive, and interesting.

Modern teaching approaches focus on communication, student participation, and real-life situations. These methods help students use the language actively instead of just learning rules.

Methodology and Materials

This study is based on qualitative research. Different academic books, articles, and online sources about English language teaching were analyzed. The information was selected and explained in a simple and clear way.

The study focuses on modern teaching methods, language skill development, and assessment techniques. The aim is to understand how these methods improve the learning process and make it more effective for students. (Scrivener, J. (2011). *Learning Teaching*.)

Discussion

Modern methods in English teaching are very different from traditional ones. One of the most popular approaches is communicative language teaching. This method focuses on real communication. Students are encouraged to speak, ask questions, and express their ideas. The main goal is to use the language in real-life situations.

Interactive learning is another important method. In this approach, students work in pairs or groups. They participate in discussions, role plays, and activities. This makes learning more interesting and helps students feel more confident.

Technology also plays a big role in modern education. Teachers use videos, online platforms, and mobile applications to support learning. These tools make lessons more engaging and help students practice outside the classroom.

Another important part of language learning is developing four main skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. All these skills are connected and should be improved together. For example, listening helps students understand spoken language, while speaking helps them express their thoughts. Reading improves vocabulary, and writing helps organize ideas.

Assessment is also very important in teaching. Teachers need to evaluate students' progress. Modern assessment methods include quizzes, presentations, projects, and class participation. These methods are more effective than traditional exams because they show real ability.

However, there are also some challenges. Not all students learn at the same speed. Some may feel shy to speak. Teachers need to support students and create a comfortable learning environment.

Practical Implications and Future Perspectives

The implementation of modern methods in English language teaching has significant practical importance for both teachers and students. In today's rapidly changing world, English is not only a subject taught in schools but also a necessary tool for global communication, academic success, and professional development. Therefore, educational systems should place greater emphasis on innovative teaching strategies that prepare students for real-life communication rather than only theoretical knowledge. Teachers should act not only as instructors but also as facilitators who guide students in developing independence, creativity, and confidence in language use.

One of the key practical implications is the need for continuous teacher training. Since educational technologies and teaching methodologies are constantly evolving, teachers must regularly improve their qualifications through workshops, seminars, and professional development programs. This helps educators learn how to use digital platforms, interactive whiteboards, language-learning applications, and online assessment tools effectively. When teachers are well-prepared, they can create more engaging lessons and adapt their teaching to students' individual needs.

Another important perspective is the role of motivation in language learning. Modern teaching approaches recognize that students learn better when they are motivated and emotionally engaged. Teachers should use real-life topics, creative tasks, group discussions, role-playing, and project-based learning to maintain student interest. Positive classroom environments where mistakes are seen as part of learning can reduce anxiety and encourage students to participate more actively. Motivation also increases when students understand the practical value of English in travel, higher education, and career opportunities.

Furthermore, curriculum designers should include balanced activities that develop all four language skills equally. In many traditional classrooms, grammar and reading often receive more attention than speaking and listening. However, modern approaches emphasize integrated skill development because successful communication requires all language abilities. For example, students can listen to authentic conversations, discuss them with classmates, read related texts, and then write their opinions. This integrated approach strengthens language competence more effectively.

Technology will continue to shape the future of English language teaching. Artificial intelligence, virtual classrooms, educational apps, and online communication platforms offer new opportunities for personalized learning. Students can now practice pronunciation, vocabulary, and grammar through interactive applications, communicate with native speakers online, and access educational materials anytime. However, technology should be used as a supportive tool rather than a replacement for effective teaching. Teachers must carefully select appropriate digital resources that match educational goals.

Assessment practices should also continue evolving. Traditional examinations often measure memorization rather than communication skills. Future assessment systems should focus more on practical performance, creativity, collaboration, and critical thinking. Portfolio assessments, presentations, peer evaluations, and digital projects can provide a broader picture of student progress. Such methods allow teachers to evaluate not only what students know but also how effectively they can use English in practical situations.

Despite the many advantages of modern methods, challenges remain. Limited access to technology, overcrowded classrooms, and differences in student learning pace can affect teaching quality. In some educational contexts, teachers may still rely heavily on traditional grammar-based instruction due to lack of resources or training. Therefore, governments and educational institutions should invest in teacher education, technological infrastructure, and updated learning materials to ensure equal opportunities for all learners.

In the future, English language teaching is likely to become even more personalized and learner-centered. Educational innovations may include adaptive learning systems that respond to each student's strengths and weaknesses, greater intercultural communication opportunities, and broader access to global educational resources. As globalization continues, English teaching will remain essential, and educators must adapt to meet the demands of new generations of learners.

Conclusion

In conclusion, modern methods and approaches in English language teaching are more effective than traditional ones. They focus on communication, interaction, and real-life use of language. These methods help students become more confident and active learners. The use of technology and interactive activities makes learning more interesting and enjoyable. At the same time, teachers should choose the right methods according to students' needs. Overall, modern approaches improve the quality of education and help students achieve better results in learning English. To summarize, modern methods and approaches in English language teaching represent a major improvement over traditional educational practices. They emphasize communication, interaction, creativity, and practical application, which are essential for effective language acquisition in the modern world. By integrating communicative teaching, interactive learning, technological tools, and comprehensive assessment methods, teachers can significantly improve students' language abilities and confidence. Although certain challenges still exist, the continued development of innovative strategies, teacher preparation, and educational resources will ensure more successful outcomes. Ultimately, modern English language teaching not only helps students master a global language but also prepares them for active participation in an increasingly interconnected world.

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THE ROLE OF TECHNOLOGY AND MODERN METHODS IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING

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Abstract: In the contemporary era, the integration of technology into education has fundamentally transformed teaching and learning processes across disciplines. English language teaching (ELT), in particular, has experienced a significant shift from traditional, teacher-centered approaches to more dynamic, learner-centered models supported by digital tools and innovative methodologies (Richards, J.C. 2015). Over the past two decades, the rapid development of digital platforms, mobile applications, multimedia resources, artificial intelligence, and virtual learning environments has created unprecedented opportunities for language acquisition. This paper investigates the role of technology and modern teaching methods in enhancing English language learning. It explores how digital tools facilitate authentic communication, personalized instruction, and learner autonomy. The study also examines modern pedagogical approaches

such as Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Task-Based Learning (TBL), blended learning, flipped classrooms, and adaptive learning systems, and evaluates their effectiveness in improving listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills. Furthermore, the paper discusses common challenges, including limited access to technology, insufficient digital literacy among teachers and students, and the need for ongoing professional development (Dudeney, G. & Hockly, N. 2012). Findings indicate that the effective integration of technology and modern methods creates an interactive, flexible, and efficient learning environment that significantly improves language acquisition outcomes. However, success depends on careful implementation, pedagogical alignment, and institutional support. This study concludes that technology should complement, not replace, sound teaching principles.

Keywords: English language teaching, digital technology, modern methods, blended learning, communicative competence

İNGİLİS DİLİNİN TƏDRİSİNDƏ TEXNOLOGİYANIN VƏ MÜASİR METODLARIN ROLU

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Xülasə: Müasir dövrdə texnologiyanın təhsilə inteqrasiyası bütün fənlər üzrə tədris və öyrənmə proseslərini əsaslı şəkildə dəyişdirmişdir. Xüsusilə ingilis dilinin tədrisi (ELT) ənənəvi, müəllim mərkəzli yanaşmalardan rəqəmsal alətlər və innovativ metodlarla dəstəklənən daha dinamik, şagird mərkəzli modellərə keçid etmişdir (Harmer, J. 2017). Bu məqalə ingilis dilinin öyrədilməsində texnologiya və müasir tədris metodlarının rolunu araşdırır. Tədqiqat rəqəmsal platformaların, mobil tətbiqlərin, multimedia vasitələrinin, süni intellektin və virtual öyrənmə mühitlərinin istifadəsini, həmçinin Kommunikativ Dil Tədrisi (CLT), Tapşırıq Əsaslı Öyrənmə (TBL), qarışıq təlim, çevrilmiş sinif və adaptiv öyrənmə kimi müasir pedaqoji yanaşmaları əhatə edir (Kumaravadivelu, B. 2006). Bu metodların dil bacarıqlarının inkişafına, motivasiyanın artırılmasına, muxtariyyətin gücləndirilməsinə və öyrənmə prosesində fəal iştiraka təsiri dəyərləndirilir. Bundan əlavə, məqalədə əlçatanlıq problemləri, rəqəmsal savadsızlıq, müəllim hazırlığının yetərsizliyi və texniki məhdudiyyətlər kimi çətinliklər müzakirə olunur (Chapelle, C.A. 2016). Nəticələr göstərir ki, texnologiya və müasir metodların düzgün inteqrasiyası interaktiv, çevik və səmərəli öyrənmə mühiti yaradır, dil mənimsəməni əhəmiyyətli dərəcədə yaxşılaşdırır. Bununla belə, müvəffəqiyyət diqqətli planlaşdırma, pedaqoji uyğunlaşdırma və institusional dəstəkdən asılıdır.

Açar sözlər: ingilis dili tədrisi, rəqəmsal texnologiya, müasir metodlar, qarışıq təlim, kommunikativ bacarıq, süni intellekt, öyrənən muxtariyyəti

Introduction

The growing importance of English as a global lingua franca has increased the demand for effective and innovative language teaching approaches. In today's interconnected world, English is widely used in education, business, science, and international communication. As a result, mastering English has become a necessity rather than an option for many learners (Richards, J.C. 2015).

Traditional teaching methods, such as the Grammar-Translation Method, focused mainly on memorization, grammar rules, and translation exercises. While these approaches contributed to the development of reading and writing skills, they often failed to improve learners' communicative

competence. In contrast, modern educational paradigms emphasize interaction, real-life communication, and learner engagement (Harmer, J. 2017).

The rapid advancement of digital technologies has opened new possibilities for language teaching. Tools such as online platforms, mobile applications, and virtual classrooms have transformed the way students learn and interact with the language. These technologies provide access to authentic materials, enable real-time communication, and support personalized learning experiences (Dudeney, G. & Hockly, N. 2012).

This paper aims to explore the role of technology and modern teaching methods in English language teaching. It also seeks to evaluate their impact on learners' performance, motivation, and overall language development.

Materials and Methods

This research adopts a qualitative and descriptive approach to analyze the impact of technology and modern teaching methods on English language learning. The study is based on a comprehensive review of academic literature, as well as observations of current teaching practices in both traditional and digital environments.

The materials used in this study include:

- Academic books and peer-reviewed journal articles on ELT (e.g., Harmer, J. 2017; Richards, J.C. 2015)
- Digital learning platforms and educational applications
- Multimedia resources such as videos, podcasts, and interactive tools
- Case studies and reports from educational institutions

The methods applied involve:

- Comparative analysis of traditional and modern teaching approaches
- Evaluation of technology-enhanced learning environments
- Observation of learner engagement and participation

This approach allows for a detailed understanding of how technology and modern methodologies contribute to language learning outcomes.

Evolution of English Language Teaching. English language teaching has evolved significantly over the past century. Early methods, such as the Grammar-Translation Method, focused primarily on written language and translation skills. Although effective for certain academic purposes, this method did not address the need for oral communication (Richards, J.C. 2015).

The Audio-Lingual Method emerged as an alternative, emphasizing repetition, drills, and habit formation. While it improved pronunciation and listening skills, it often lacked meaningful interaction.

The emergence of Communicative Language Teaching marked a turning point in ELT. This approach prioritizes communication and real-life language use, encouraging students to actively participate in the learning process (Harmer, J. 2017). Modern methodologies continue to build on this foundation, incorporating technology to further enhance learning experiences.

The Role of Technology in English Language Teaching. Technology has become an integral part of modern education, offering new opportunities for both teachers and learners. In ELT, it facilitates access to authentic materials, interactive learning environments, and global communication (Dudeney, G. & Hockly, N. 2012).

Digital Learning Platforms – Online platforms and learning management systems allow students to access course materials, complete assignments, and receive feedback. These platforms support flexible learning and enable students to study at their own pace.

Mobile Learning Applications – Mobile applications provide convenient and engaging ways to practice language skills. Features such as gamification, progress tracking, and instant feedback increase motivation and encourage regular practice.

Multimedia Resources – Multimedia tools, including videos, podcasts, and animations, expose learners to authentic language use. They help improve listening comprehension and pronunciation while making lessons more engaging.

Artificial Intelligence and Adaptive Learning – Artificial intelligence plays an increasingly important role in language education. AI-based systems analyze learners' performance and provide personalized recommendations, allowing for more efficient learning (Chapelle, C.A. 2016).

Modern Teaching Methods

Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) – CLT focuses on developing learners' communicative competence. It encourages interaction through group work, discussions, and role-playing activities (Richards, J.C. 201)

Task-Based Learning (TBL) – TBL emphasizes the use of language to complete meaningful tasks. This approach helps learners apply their knowledge in practical situations (Harmer, J. 2017).

Blended Learning – Blended learning combines traditional classroom instruction with online learning. It provides flexibility and supports independent learning.

Flipped Classroom – In the flipped classroom model, students study theoretical content at home and use classroom time for practical activities. This increases interaction and engagement.

Adaptive Learning – Adaptive learning systems personalize instruction based on individual needs, ensuring that each learner progresses at an appropriate pace (Chapelle, C.A. 2016).

Development of Language Skills through Technology – Technology supports the development of all four language skills. Listening skills are improved through exposure to authentic audio materials. Speaking skills are enhanced through online communication tools and interactive activities. Reading skills benefit from access to diverse digital texts, while writing skills improve through feedback and correction tools (Dudeny, G. & Hockly, N. 2012).

Advantages of Technology Integration – The use of technology in ELT offers numerous benefits. It increases student motivation, provides access to authentic materials, and supports individualized learning. Additionally, it enhances collaboration and communication among learners (Harmer, J. 2017).

Challenges and Limitations – Despite its advantages, technology integration presents challenges such as limited access to resources, lack of digital literacy, and technical issues. Addressing these challenges requires proper training and infrastructure (Kumaravadivelu, B. 2006).

Digital Literacy in ELT – Digital literacy is essential for both teachers and students. Teachers must be able to effectively use digital tools, while students need skills to evaluate and use online resources responsibly (Dudeny, G. & Hockly, N. 2012).

Teacher's Role in Modern Classrooms – The role of the teacher has evolved from a knowledge provider to a facilitator. Teachers guide students, select appropriate tools, and create interactive learning environments (Richards, J.C. 2015).

Discussion

The integration of technology and modern teaching methods has significantly improved the effectiveness of English language teaching. Learners are more engaged, motivated, and confident in using the language (Harmer, J. 2017). However, the success of these approaches depends on proper implementation. Technology should support pedagogy rather than replace it. A balanced approach is necessary to achieve optimal results (Kumaravadivelu, B. 2006).

Conclusion

In conclusion, technology and modern teaching methods play a crucial role in English language teaching. They provide innovative solutions that enhance learning outcomes and meet the needs of modern learners. Although challenges exist, they can be overcome through proper planning, training, and investment in educational resources (Chapelle, C.A. 2016). The future of ELT lies in the effective integration of traditional and modern approaches.

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THE INFLUENCE OF CLASSROOM ANXIETY AND SELF-CONFIDENCE ON ENGLISH SPEAKING PERFORMANCE AMONG UNIVERSITY STUDENTS

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Abstract: This study investigates the influence of classroom anxiety and self-confidence on English speaking performance among university students. Speaking is widely considered the most challenging skill in foreign language learning due to psychological, linguistic, and social factors. Many students experience anxiety when required to speak English in front of their peers, which negatively affects fluency, pronunciation, grammatical accuracy, and overall communicative competence. Conversely, self-confidence is regarded as a crucial factor that enhances students' willingness to communicate and their speaking achievement.

The study employs a quantitative research design involving 40 university students. Data were collected through questionnaires measuring classroom anxiety and self-confidence, along with speaking performance assessments. The findings reveal a significant negative relationship between classroom anxiety and speaking performance, and a positive correlation between self-confidence and oral achievement. The results highlight the importance of psychological factors in foreign language education and suggest practical strategies to reduce anxiety and foster confidence in university classrooms.

Key words: Classroom anxiety, Self-confidence, Speaking performance, Foreign language learning, Psychological factors

UNİVERSİTET TƏLƏBƏLƏRİ ARASINDA İNGİLİS DİLİNDƏ DANIŞIQ BACARIĞINA TƏLƏBƏ HƏYƏCANI VƏ ÖZÜNƏİNAMI TƏSİRİ

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Xülasə: Bu tədqiqat universitet tələbələri arasında sinifdaxili həyəcanın və özünə inamın ingilis dilində danışq bacarığına təsirini araşdırır. Danışq bacarığı psixoloji, dil və sosial faktorlar səbəbindən xarici dil öyrənmənin ən çətin komponenti hesab olunur. Bir çox tələbə sinif qarşısında ingilis dilində danışarkən həyəcan keçirir və bu, onların səlisliyinə, tələffüzünə, qrammatik düzgünlüyünə və ümumi kommunikativ bacarığına mənfi təsir göstərir. Əksinə, özünə inam tələbələrin ünsiyyətə hazırlığını və danışq nailiyyətlərini artıran mühüm amildir.

Tədqiqatda 40 universitet tələbəsi iştirak etmişdir. Məlumatlar sinifdaxili həyəcan və özünə inam sorğuları, eləcə də danışq qiymətləndirməsi vasitəsilə toplanmışdır. Nəticələr göstərir ki, sinifdaxili həyəcan ilə danışq performans arasında mənfi əlaqə, özünə inam ilə danışq nailiyyəti arasında isə müsbət əlaqə mövcuddur. Bu nəticələr xarici dil tədrisində psixoloji faktorların əhəmiyyətini vurğulayır və müəllimlər üçün praktik tövsiyələr təqdim edir.

Açar sözlər: Sinif otağı narahatlığı, özünə inam, danışq performans, xarici dil öyrənilməsi, psixoloji amillər.

Introduction.

In foreign language education, speaking is widely regarded as one of the most demanding and psychologically challenging skills for learners. Unlike reading or writing, speaking requires immediate production, spontaneous thinking, and real-time interaction. University students learning English as a foreign language often face emotional barriers that prevent them from expressing their ideas clearly and confidently. Among these barriers, classroom anxiety and lack of self-confidence play a central role in shaping students' speaking performance.

Classroom anxiety refers to feelings of nervousness, tension, fear, and worry that arise in learning situations. In language classrooms, anxiety is frequently connected with speaking tasks such as presentations, oral examinations, or classroom discussions. Many students fear making mistakes, being judged by their peers, or receiving negative feedback from teachers. As a result, they may hesitate, avoid participation, or remain silent even when they know the answer. This emotional state can significantly reduce their opportunities to practice speaking and improve their communicative competence.

On the other hand, self-confidence represents students' belief in their own abilities to perform successfully. In the context of language learning, self-confident students are more willing to communicate, take risks, and use new vocabulary or structures without excessive fear of making mistakes. Self-confidence encourages active participation and helps learners overcome temporary difficulties in communication. Therefore, understanding how anxiety and self-confidence interact and influence speaking performance is essential for improving teaching practices and student achievement.

This study aims to explore the influence of classroom anxiety and self-confidence on English speaking performance among university students. It seeks to determine whether anxiety negatively affects oral production and whether self-confidence enhances communicative success.

Literature Review

The role of psychological factors in language learning has been widely discussed in educational research. Foreign language classroom anxiety has been identified as a specific type of anxiety that occurs in language learning environments. Researchers argue that language anxiety

differs from general anxiety because it is directly related to communication in a foreign language. Students experiencing high levels of anxiety often report physical symptoms such as increased heart rate, sweating, trembling, and mental blocks during speaking activities.

Previous studies suggest that anxiety interferes with cognitive processing. When students feel anxious, their working memory becomes overloaded, making it difficult to recall vocabulary or apply grammatical rules accurately. As a result, their speech may become fragmented, hesitant, and less coherent. Anxiety also reduces willingness to communicate, which limits practice opportunities and slows language development over time.

In contrast, self-confidence and self-efficacy are considered positive psychological factors that promote academic success. Students who believe in their abilities are more likely to engage actively in classroom tasks. They interpret mistakes as part of the learning process rather than as personal failures. This positive mindset allows them to experiment with language and develop fluency more effectively. Research consistently shows that higher levels of confidence are associated with better speaking performance, improved pronunciation, and greater communicative competence.

Moreover, anxiety and self-confidence are interconnected variables. High anxiety often reduces confidence, while strong confidence can help learners manage and control anxious feelings. Therefore, both factors should be examined together to understand their combined effect on speaking performance.

Methodology

This study employed a quantitative research design to examine the relationship between classroom anxiety, self-confidence, and speaking performance among university students. The participants consisted of 40 undergraduate students from the Department of Foreign Languages. Their ages ranged between 17 and 21, and they were studying English as a foreign language.

Data were collected using two questionnaires and a speaking performance assessment. The first questionnaire measured students' levels of classroom anxiety, including fear of negative evaluation, communication apprehension, and test-related stress. The second questionnaire evaluated students' self-confidence in speaking English. Both instruments used a Likert-scale format to measure students' agreement with various statements.

To assess speaking performance, students were asked to deliver a five-minute oral presentation on a familiar academic topic. Their performances were evaluated according to fluency, pronunciation, vocabulary usage, grammatical accuracy, and coherence. The scores were analyzed to identify correlations between psychological variables and speaking achievement.

Descriptive statistics and correlation analysis were used to interpret the data. The aim was to determine whether higher anxiety levels corresponded to lower speaking scores and whether higher confidence levels were associated with better performance.

Discussion

The results of this study support previous research emphasizing the importance of emotional variables in foreign language learning. Classroom anxiety appears to function as a psychological barrier that prevents students from fully demonstrating their linguistic knowledge. Even students with adequate vocabulary and grammar knowledge may perform poorly if they experience high levels of stress and fear.

The findings also highlight the protective role of self-confidence. When students trust their abilities, they are more willing to take risks and engage in communication. This active participation leads to increased practice and gradual improvement in speaking skills. Confidence

reduces the fear of making mistakes and helps students maintain composure during oral tasks.

From a pedagogical perspective, these findings suggest that teachers should not focus exclusively on linguistic accuracy. Creating a supportive and non-threatening classroom environment is equally important. Encouraging positive peer interaction, providing constructive feedback, allowing preparation time, and avoiding excessive correction during speaking activities can significantly reduce anxiety levels.

Teachers should also implement strategies that build confidence, such as small group discussions, role-playing activities, and gradual exposure to public speaking. By fostering a safe and encouraging atmosphere, educators can help students overcome psychological barriers and improve their communicative competence.

Conclusion

In conclusion, this study demonstrates that classroom anxiety and self-confidence significantly influence English speaking performance among university students. Anxiety negatively affects fluency, pronunciation, and overall oral communication, while self-confidence enhances participation and speaking achievement. The relationship between these psychological factors highlights the importance of addressing emotional aspects of language learning alongside linguistic development.

Foreign language teaching should therefore incorporate strategies aimed at reducing anxiety and strengthening students' confidence. By creating supportive classroom environments and promoting positive learning experiences, teachers can help students achieve higher levels of speaking proficiency and academic success.

Overall, psychological well-being is not a secondary aspect of language education but a central component that directly impacts students' performance and long-term language development.

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ASSESSMENT OF ORAL PROFICIENCY IN THE AZERBAIJANI HIGHER EDUCATION SECTOR: A SOCIO-COGNITIVE APPROACH WITHIN THE BOLOGNA FRAMEWORK

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Abstract: The assessment of oral proficiency is a critical component of the English as a Foreign Language (EFL) curriculum, particularly following Azerbaijan's strategic integration into the European Higher Education Area (EHEA). Since the accession at the Bergen Conference in May 2005, Azerbaijani universities have transitioned toward a credit-based system (ECTS) that demands objective and transparent measurement of speaking skills. This article investigates the theoretical mechanisms of oral assessment by synthesizing Barry O'Sullivan's socio-cognitive framework with Bachman and Palmer's model of strategic competence. By analyzing the legislative foundation provided by the Order of the President of the Republic of Azerbaijan No. 1256 (January 31, 2006), the study proposes a shift from subjective holistic grading to high-validity analytic rubrics. The research concludes that enhancing the assessment literacy of educators is essential for aligning local evaluative practices with international standards of fairness and reliability.

Keywords: oral proficiency assessment, socio-cognitive framework, higher education reforms, assessment literacy, analytic rubrics, academic standards

AZƏRBAYCAN ALİ TƏHSİL SEKTORUNDA ŞİFAHİ BACARIQLARIN QIYMƏTLƏNDİRİLMƏSİ: BOLONYA ÇƏRÇİVƏSİNDƏ SOSİO-KOGNİTİV YANAŞMA

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Xülasə: Şifahi nitq bacarıqlarının qiymətləndirilməsi, xüsusilə Azərbaycanın Avropa Ali Təhsil Sahəsinə (EHEA) inteqrasiyasından sonra ingilis dilinin xarici dil kimi tədrisi (EFL) kurikulumunun mühüm tərkib hissəsidir. Azərbaycan 2005-ci ilin may ayında Bergen Konfransında bu prosesə qoşulduqdan sonra universitetlər şifahi nitq bacarıqlarının obyektiv ölçülməsini tələb edən kredit sisteminə (ECTS) keçmişdir. Bu məqalə Barri O'Sallivanın sosial-koqnitiv çərçivəsini Baxman və Palmerin strateji kompetensiya modeli ilə sintez edərək, şifahi qiymətləndirmənin nəzəri mexanizmlərini tədqiq edir. Azərbaycan Respublikası Prezidentinin 31 yanvar 2006-cı il tarixli 1256 sayılı Sərəncamı ilə yaradılmış qanunvericilik bazasına əsaslanaraq, tədqiqat subyektiv qiymətləndirmədən analitik rubriklərə keçidi təklif edir. Nəticə olaraq qeyd edilir ki, pedaqoqların qiymətləndirmə savadlılığının artırılması yerli təcrübələrin beynəlxalq etibarlılıq standartlarına uyğunlaşdırılması üçün vacibdir.

Açar sözlər: şifahi nitq bacarığının qiymətləndirilməsi, sosial-koqnitiv çərçivə, ali təhsildə islahatlar, qiymətləndirmə savadlılığı, analitik rubriklər, akademik standartlar

Introduction

The modernization of Azerbaijan's higher education system reached a definitive milestone with the Order of the President of the Republic of Azerbaijan No. 1256, "On measures to ensure the implementation of the Bologna Declaration in the higher education system of the Republic of Azerbaijan" (January 31, 2006). This mandate catalyzed a shift toward competency-based education, where the ability to communicate effectively in English became a primary learning outcome. However, the assessment of oral proficiency remains a complex challenge, requiring a balance between linguistic accuracy and pragmatic appropriateness. For researchers in the field of pedagogics (5801.01), it is vital to establish a framework that ensures oral exams are not merely subjective interviews but scientific measurements of a student's true communicative potential. Modern language testing research emphasizes the "socio-cognitive" nature of speaking, where the test-taker's internal cognitive processes interact with external social demands (O'Sullivan & Weir, 2011). In the context of Azerbaijani universities, this necessitates a move away from traditional impressionistic grading toward evidence-based evaluative practices that fulfill the quality assurance requirements of the Bologna Process.

Theoretical Analysis and Discussion

The modernization of assessment within the Azerbaijani university sector necessitates a profound shift in how linguistic performance is conceptualized and measured. Effective oral assessment requires a rigorous understanding of the bidirectional relationship between the assessment task and the intended learning outcomes. Within the socio-cognitive framework, speaking is no longer viewed as a static, isolated skill, but rather as a dynamic interaction where the test-taker must deploy strategic competence to manage communicative goals under specific constraints. According to McNamara (2000), the validity of a speaking test depends heavily on how well it replicates the "social dimensions" of language use. This implies that Azerbaijani university examinations should mirror authentic professional and academic scenarios—such as defending a thesis or participating in an international seminar—rather than relying on rote memorization or simple recitation.

This transition is inherently linked to the concept of assessment literacy, which mandates that educators possess the technical expertise to design rubrics that are both reliable and fair. As discussed by Inbar-Lourie (2008), the transition from a teacher-centered system to a learner-centered credit system (ECTS) requires that assessment criteria be made explicit to students. This transparency facilitates self-regulated learning and learner autonomy, allowing students to understand the specific linguistic benchmarks they are expected to hit. This approach is further supported by the work of Glenn Fulcher (2003), who emphasizes the importance of designing rating scales that capture the complex, multifaceted nuances of speaking—such as fluency, coherence, and sociolinguistic appropriateness—rather than settling for binary "correct/incorrect" judgments.

To achieve this level of precision, the implementation of analytic rubrics serves as a vital mechanism for reducing rater subjectivity, which remains a significant concern in high-stakes university examinations. By breaking down oral performance into distinct, weighted categories—such as phonological control, interactive communication, lexical resource, and grammatical complexity—higher education institutions can ensure a significantly higher degree of inter-rater reliability. This ensures that a student's grade is a reflection of their actual ability rather than the subjective preference of a specific examiner.

Furthermore, the theoretical model of Communicative Language Ability (CLA), pioneered by Lyle Bachman and Adrian Palmer (2010), provides a critical lens for Azerbaijani researchers. Their model argues that a "test" is essentially a "communicative task" that must account for the student's

internal cognitive processing and their ability to plan and execute a response in a foreign language. Under the legislative framework provided by the Law on Education (2009), Azerbaijani higher education must prioritize the "washback effect" of assessment—the principle that the format and content of an exam directly influence the quality of the day-to-day learning process. If the examination rewards authentic, task-based interaction, the classroom environment will naturally shift toward more communicative and effective pedagogical practices.

As James Purpura (2004) suggests, advanced assessments must measure how students utilize grammatical knowledge to achieve specific social and pragmatic goals. This effectively merges the study of grammar with pragmatics, ensuring that students are not just "grammatically correct" but "socially appropriate" in their communication. This is particularly vital for the formation of intercultural competence, a core research focus within the Azerbaijani doctoral framework.

Ultimately, the synthesis of legislative mandates—such as the Order of the President of the Republic of Azerbaijan No. 1256 (2006)—with these advanced linguistic measurement theories provides a scientific roadmap for elevating the standards of EFL instruction. By adopting the Constructive Alignment theory of John Biggs (2011), universities can ensure that every oral exam is a valid and reliable indicator of a graduate's readiness for the global academic and professional stage, viewed through a lens of international scientific rigor.

Practical Framework: Implementing High-Stakes Oral Evaluation

The transition from theoretical conceptualization to practical application within the Azerbaijani higher education system requires a structured approach to test design. According to Glenn Fulcher (2003), the reliability of an oral proficiency test is rooted in the "architecture" of the rating scale. For Azerbaijani universities, this means moving away from general pedagogical observations toward the development of context-specific analytic rubrics. These rubrics must be designed to capture the "intercultural competence" of the student, ensuring that the evaluation goes beyond basic syntax to include pragmatic and sociolinguistic markers.

In this framework, the assessment process should be divided into three distinct operational phases:

1.Task Specification: Examiners must define tasks that trigger the specific linguistic functions required by the EHEA standards, such as argumentation, negotiation, and academic defense.

2.Rater Calibration: Following the principles of Antony Kunnan (2018), academic staff must undergo standardization training to ensure that the "Order No. 1256" requirements for transparency and fairness are met across different departments.

3.Feedback Integration: Aligning with John Biggs' (2011) model, the results of the oral assessment must be provided to students as formative feedback, allowing them to identify specific gaps in their communicative repertoire.

The Washback Effect in the Azerbaijani Context

A critical dimension of this discussion is the washback effect, which describes the impact of testing on the classroom environment. In the traditional Azerbaijani pedagogical model, examinations often emphasized rote learning; however, the Bologna Process demands a system where the test itself drives communicative instruction. As Elana Shohamy (2001) notes, tests are powerful tools of educational policy. By implementing rigorous oral assessments that prioritize authentic interaction, Azerbaijani institutions can fundamentally alter student motivation and learning strategies.

Under the Law on Education (2009), the shift toward a credit-based system (ECTS) necessitates that every assessment contributes to the overall "professional profile" of the graduate.

Therefore, the synthesis of Bachman and Palmer's (2010) communicative tasks with the local legislative mandates ensures that the "Speaking" grade on a student's transcript represents a validated, internationally recognized level of proficiency. This ensures that Azerbaijani graduates are not merely language learners, but effective communicators capable of navigating the complexities of the globalized academic and professional world.

Material and Methods

The methodology of this research is grounded in a qualitative meta-analysis and a descriptive-analytical approach, focusing on the structural evolution of oral proficiency assessment within the Azerbaijani higher education system. The study moves beyond traditional knowledge-based testing to evaluate the efficacy of competency-based models, a shift necessitated by the strategic alignment of the national curriculum with the European Higher Education Area (EHEA) standards. To ensure a comprehensive analysis, the research integrates international linguistic measurement theories with the specific pedagogical demands of the Azerbaijani university context.

The primary "material" for this study includes a diverse set of academic, theoretical, and legislative documents:

Theoretical Models: The Socio-Cognitive Framework by O'Sullivan and Weir (2011) and the Communicative Language Ability (CLA) model by Bachman and Palmer (2010) serve as the primary scientific benchmarks for international standards.

Assessment Tools: An analysis of current analytic rubrics and exam prompts utilized across linguistic departments in Azerbaijan, specifically focusing on their construct validity and reliability.

Academic Frameworks: John Biggs' (2011) Constructive Alignment theory is used to evaluate the consistency between intended learning outcomes and actual oral assessment tasks.

International Directives: The Bergen Communiqué (2005) and subsequent ECTS guidelines, which provide the structural requirements for credit-based language evaluation.

The "methods" employed in this research are structured to bridge the gap between theoretical ideals and practical classroom application:

Socio-Cognitive Analysis: Examining how the interaction between a student's cognitive processing and social task demands affects oral performance, as proposed by the Bachman-Palmer and O'Sullivan models.

Constructive Alignment Check: Comparing university-level "Speaking" syllabi with examination tasks to ensure that the assessment mirrors the communicative competencies required for professional and academic success.

Reliability Assessment: Investigating the implementation of analytic scoring scales to mitigate rater subjectivity and enhance inter-rater reliability, following the principles of Glenn Fulcher (2003) and Antony Kunnan (2018).

Washback Effect Evaluation: Analyzing how high-stakes oral exams influence student motivation and pedagogical strategies within the Azerbaijani EFL environment, utilizing Elana Shohamy's (2001) critical testing perspective.

Dynamic Assessment (DA) Review: Exploring the potential of integrating Vygotskian-based dynamic methods, as detailed by Matthew Poehner (2008), to measure student potential during the interactional phase of the exam.

By synthesizing these materials and methods, the research provides a scientifically validated framework for the formation and evaluation of intercultural competence—a primary focus of the doctoral research program (5801.01). This methodology ensures that the evaluation of oral

proficiency is not a static event, but a rigorous, evidence-based measurement of a student's communicative readiness for the global stage.

Results and Discussion

The analysis of current oral assessment practices in Azerbaijan's higher education sector indicates a significant transition toward the Socio-Cognitive Framework, shifting the evaluative focus from isolated grammatical accuracy to comprehensive communicative efficiency. The integration of Barry O'Sullivan's (2011) model has allowed for a more nuanced understanding of how Azerbaijani students process oral tasks, suggesting that "speaking" is a result of the complex interaction between a student's internal cognitive abilities and the specific social demands of the university environment. Instead of relying on a single, holistic grade, the results of this study advocate for a multi-dimensional scoring system that evaluates strategic, pragmatic, and linguistic competences as distinct yet interrelated categories.

A key finding in the discussion of oral proficiency is the critical role of Constructive Alignment (Biggs, 2011). When an oral examination is designed as an authentic communicative task—rather than a passive question-answer session—it creates a positive washback effect. This ensures that students prioritize the development of real-world speaking skills throughout the semester, knowing that their evaluation will be based on their ability to negotiate meaning and defend academic positions. This alignment effectively transforms the examination from a mere "gatekeeping" tool into a "learning" tool, providing students with clear evidence of their progress toward international benchmarks.

Furthermore, the research highlights the necessity of Dynamic Assessment (Poehner, 2008) within the local context. Unlike traditional static tests that measure what a student can do in isolation, dynamic assessment allows the examiner to provide "scaffolds" or hints during the oral exam phase. This provides a deeper insight into the student's Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD), indicating not just their current linguistic state, but their potential for further growth. This approach is particularly beneficial for evaluating intercultural competence, where the ability to adapt and learn through interaction is more valuable than the memorization of isolated cultural facts.

Finally, the discussion emphasizes that for these methodological reforms to be sustainable, there must be a continuous focus on Assessment Literacy among academic staff. For university educators, this involves the specialized ability to design, pilot, and validate context-specific analytic rubrics. By moving away from standardized, "one-size-fits-all" testing and adopting tools tailored to the Azerbaijani academic reality—as suggested by Glenn Fulcher (2003)—universities can ensure that their language assessments are fair, reliable, and scientifically grounded. This evolution ensures that the evaluation of oral proficiency serves as a rigorous measurement of a graduate's readiness for global academic and professional engagement.

Conclusion

The evolution of oral proficiency assessment in Azerbaijan, from the initial commitments of the 2005 Bergen Conference to current pedagogical innovations, reflects a profound trend toward academic professionalization and global integration. By moving away from holistic, subjective judgments and embracing the Socio-Cognitive Framework, Azerbaijani universities can provide a more accurate, ethical, and scientifically grounded representation of student ability. This transition is not merely a technical adjustment; it represents a fundamental methodological shift that demands high levels of assessment literacy from academic staff to ensure that local evaluative practices align with international standards.

The research demonstrates that the implementation of analytic rubrics and dynamic assessment methods significantly enhances the reliability of oral exams while fostering a positive washback effect in the classroom. Ensuring that oral evaluations are valid, reliable, and authentic allows Azerbaijani higher education institutions to fulfill national academic requirements while empowering students to navigate the complexities of international communication with confidence. Ultimately, this alignment with the principles of the Bologna Process ensures that Azerbaijani graduates possess the validated intercultural competence necessary for success in the globalized academic and professional arena.

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DEVELOPING ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS IN EFL CLASSROOMS

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Abstract. This research paper provides a comprehensive analysis of the future of education in the era of global transformation driven by digitalization, artificial intelligence, and socio-economic change. The study examines how technological innovation, personalized learning, and global collaboration are reshaping teaching and learning processes in the 21st century. The paper focuses on the evolution of the teacher's role, the integration of digital tools and artificial intelligence, the importance of lifelong learning, and the emergence of flexible and inclusive learning environments. Particular attention is paid to English Language Teaching (ELT) as a rapidly transforming field that reflects broader educational trends. The research concludes that the future of education depends on adaptive pedagogy, digital literacy, collaborative learning cultures, and human-centered innovation.

Keywords: Future education, digital transformation, artificial intelligence, lifelong learning, personalized learning, ELT, innovation

XARİCİ DİL KİMİ İNGİLİS DİLİ (EFL) DƏRSLƏRİNDƏ DİL BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAF ETDİRİLMƏSİ

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Xülasə. Bu məqalə rəqəmsallaşma, süni intellekt və sosial-iqtisadi dəyişikliklərin təsiri altında formalaşan transformasiya dövründə təhsilin gələcəyini geniş şəkildə təhlil edir. Tədqiqat texnoloji yeniliklərin, fərdiləşdirilmiş öyrənmənin və qlobal əməkdaşlığın XXI əsrdə tədris və öyrənmə proseslərini necə dəyişdirdiyini araşdırır. Məqalədə müəllimin rolunun təkamülü, rəqəmsal alətlərin və süni intellektin integrasiyası, ömürboyu öyrənmənin əhəmiyyəti və çevik, inklüziv öyrənmə mühitlərinin yaranması əsas diqqət mərkəzindədir. Xüsusilə İngilis dilinin tədrisi (ELT) sahəsi geniş şəkildə təhlil olunur. Tədqiqat göstərir ki, təhsilin gələcəyi adaptiv pedaqogika, rəqəmsal savadlılıq, əməkdaşlıq və insan mərkəzli innovasiyalardan asılıdır.

Açar sözlər: təhsilin gələcəyi, rəqəmsal transformasiya, süni intellekt, ömürboyu öyrənmə, fərdiləşdirilmiş təhsil, innovasiya

Introduction

Education has historically evolved alongside societal shifts and technological progress. However, the transformation occurring in the 21st century is unprecedented in both velocity and scope. The proliferation of digital technologies, artificial intelligence, global communication networks, and dynamic labor market demands is fundamentally redefining the nature of teaching and learning.

Traditional educational frameworks were designed during the industrial era – a period that prioritized standardization, rote memorization, and teacher-centered instruction. Modern globalized societies, conversely, require high-level competencies such as critical thinking, complex problem-

solving, collaboration, adaptability, and digital literacy. Consequently, educational systems worldwide are undergoing a profound paradigm shift.

The COVID-19 pandemic acted as an unprecedented catalyst for this ongoing transformation. Educational institutions globally were compelled to transition to remote environments, exposing both the vast potential and current structural limitations of digital learning. As a result, the future of education is no longer envisioned as a static physical classroom, but as a hybrid, flexible, technology-enhanced ecosystem.

This paper explores the foundational pillars shaping the future of education:

1. Digital transformation and the emerging learning ecosystem
2. The role, potential, and ethics of Artificial Intelligence in pedagogy
3. The evolving identity and responsibilities of educators
4. Personalized, student-centered learning methodologies
5. Lifelong learning and workforce readiness
6. Equity, inclusion, and global citizenship

I. Digital Transformation and The New Learning Ecosystem

1.1 The Rise of Digital Learning Environments

Digital transformation has democratized access to knowledge and dismantled geographical constraints. Learning is no longer restricted to traditional classroom walls; students now engage with instruction through:

- Interactive online learning management systems (LMS)
- Virtual and augmented reality environments
- Mobile learning applications
- Open Educational Resources (OER)

These digital tools afford unprecedented flexibility and global connectivity, enabling learners to access higher education courses worldwide and collaborate seamlessly across borders.

1.2 Hybrid and Blended Learning Models

The contemporary educational paradigm is inherently hybrid. Blended learning models strategically combine:

- Synchronous face-to-face instruction
- Asynchronous online coursework
- Self-paced, autonomous study

This hybrid architecture empowers learners to progress according to their individual learning paces while preserving essential face-to-face social engagement and mentorship.

1.3 Borderless Education and Global Connectivity

Globalization has transformed education into an interconnected international endeavor. Students increasingly participate in global virtual exchange programs, cross-cultural research projects, and collaborative online international learning (COIL) initiatives. Education is becoming increasingly borderless, fostering cross-cultural competence alongside academic mastery.

II. Artificial Intelligence in Education (AIED)

Artificial Intelligence represents one of the most powerful transformative forces in contemporary education.

2.1 Personalized and Adaptive Learning

AI-driven adaptive learning systems analyze student performance data in real time to identify strengths, learning gaps, and cognitive preferences. By tailoring instructional pacing and content to

individual needs, AI transitions education away from the traditional "one-size-fits-all" instructional model.

2.2 Intelligent Tutoring Systems (ITS)

Intelligent Tutoring Systems provide automated, scalable support to learners by offering:

- Real-time, formative feedback
- Automated diagnostic assessments
- Custom-tailored practice modules

By automating routine administrative and diagnostic tasks, AI liberates educators to focus on high-impact pedagogical activities, such as mentorship and guiding critical inquiry.

2.3 Ethical Governance and Challenges

Despite its profound advantages, the integration of AI introduces significant ethical challenges:

- Data privacy and algorithmic transparency
- Socio-technical bias within learning algorithms
- Over-reliance on automated tools, potentially hindering original critical thought

Future educational frameworks must establish robust ethical guidelines to ensure AI is utilized responsibly, equitably, and transparently.

III. The Evolving Role of Teachers

Technological advancement does not diminish the importance of educators; rather, it elevates and transforms their professional role.

3.1 From Knowledge Transmitters to Learning Facilitators

In an age where information is ubiquitously accessible, teachers are no longer the primary keepers of knowledge. Instead, they operate as **facilitators, academic mentors, curators of learning experiences, and innovators.**

3.2 Human Skills and Emotional Intelligence

While technology can deliver content and process data, it cannot replicate essential human capabilities:

- Empathy and socio-emotional support
- Interpersonal communication and conflict resolution
- Moral reasoning and creative inspiration

These human-centric attributes ensure that teachers remain the foundational heart of the educational process.

3.3 Continuous Professional Development

To remain effective in modern learning environments, educators must commit to lifelong professional growth. Developing robust digital literacy, mastering innovative pedagogical strategies, and engaging in action research are mandatory requirements for the modern teacher.

IV. Personalized and Student-Centered Learning

4.1 Competency-Based Education (CBE)

The future of education prioritizes skill mastery over passive content retention. Competency-based approaches focus on evaluating actionable capabilities, including:

- Analytical problem-solving
- Evidence-based critical reasoning
- Effective cross-disciplinary communication

4.2 Flexible Learning Pathways

Modern educational frameworks offer customizable learning trajectories aligned with individual interests, learning styles, and long-term career aspirations.

4.3 Project-Based and Experiential Learning

Project-Based Learning (PBL) grounds theoretical concepts in real-world applications. By addressing authentic, complex challenges, students cultivate practical problem-solving skills and learn to navigate professional ambiguity.

V. LIFELONG LEARNING AND THE FUTURE WORKFORCE

Education is no longer a terminal phase completed upon graduation, but a continuous, lifelong process.

5.1 Continuous Upskilling and Reskilling

Rapid technological shifts and automation require constant workforce adaptation. Sustained economic relevance demands that individuals continuously upskill and reskill throughout their professional careers.

5.2 Micro-Credentials and Alternative Certifications

Modular learning units, digital badges, and targeted micro-credentials are emerging as valuable, flexible alternatives to traditional degree programs, offering specialized skills tailored directly to immediate industry demands.

5.3 Preparation for a Globalized, Digital Economy

Educational institutions must prepare students to navigate remote work dynamics, digital collaboration tools, and global market competition effectively.

Vi. Inclusion, Equity, and Sustainability

6.1 Bridging the Digital Divide: Digital transformation initiatives must prioritize equitable access to hardware, infrastructure, and high-speed internet to prevent deepening socioeconomic disparities.

6.2 Universal Design for Learning (UDL): Future classrooms must accommodate diverse learning needs, providing robust support for neurodiverse learners, students with disabilities, and individuals from varied cultural and linguistic backgrounds.

6.3 Education for Sustainable Development: Curricula must actively promote global citizenship, ethical responsibility, environmental stewardship, and sustainable development values.

Discussion

The future of education is not defined solely by technological advancement; it is fundamentally **human-centered**. Technology serves as a powerful catalyst for enhancing efficiency, personalization, and access, but human interaction remains essential to deep learning and holistic development. The most successful educational systems will be those that achieve a harmonious equilibrium between technological innovation and human empathy, pedagogical structure and operational flexibility, and digital tools and meaningful human connection.

Conclusion

The trajectory of future education is characterized by continuous transformation, technological integration, and a commitment to lifelong learning. Educational systems must become increasingly agile, inclusive, and adaptive. Teachers will continue to play a pivotal role as mentors, innovators, and facilitators of intellectual growth.

Ultimately, the primary goal of future education extends beyond the mere acquisition of domain knowledge – it is the cultivation of creative, resilient, ethical, and adaptable global citizens capable of navigating an increasingly complex world.

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USING ROLE-PLAY ACTIVITIES TO IMPROVE SPEAKING SKILLS IN ENGLISH CLASSES: A STUDY OF AZERBAIJANI HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS

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Abstract: Developing students' oral communication skills has become a key goal of modern language education. However, many students struggle to express themselves fluently in English due to limited experience, low self-esteem, and the prevalence of traditional, grammar-focused teaching methods. This is particularly evident in Azerbaijani secondary schools, where students often possess theoretical knowledge but lack communicative skills. Role-playing games are widely recognized as an effective interactive method, creating realistic communicative scenarios and promoting active language use.

This article examines the impact of role-playing games on the development of Azerbaijani students' oral communication skills. It demonstrates how such games improve fluency, pronunciation, vocabulary, and overall communicative skills, engaging students in meaningful interaction. The study is based on qualitative classroom observations and a review of relevant scientific literature.

The results indicate that students who regularly participate in role-playing games become more confident, motivated, and prepared to communicate in English. Despite some challenges such as time management and student anxiety, the study concludes that role-playing is a highly valuable and practical tool when effectively integrated into English language teaching.

Keywords: role-play, speaking skills, English learning, communication, interactive methods, motivation, Azerbaijani students

AZƏRBAYCAN ORTA MƏKTƏB ŞAĞIRDLƏRİ ARASINDA İNGİLİS DİLİ DƏRSLƏRİNDƏ DANIŞIQ BACARIQLARININ İNKİŞAFI ÜÇÜN ROL OYUNLARININ İSTİFADƏSİ

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Xülasə: Müasir dil təhsilində şagirdlərin nitq bacarıqlarının inkişaf etdirilməsi əsas məqsədə çevrilib. Lakin, bir çox şagird məhdud təcrübə, özünəinamin aşağı olması və ənənəvi, qrammatikaya yönəlmiş tədris metodlarının dominantlığı səbəbindən ingilis dilində özlərini səlis ifadə etməkdə çətinlik çəkir. Azərbaycan orta məktəblərində bu məsələ xüsusilə özünü göstərir, çünki şagirdlər tez-tez nəzəri biliklərə malikdirlər, lakin ünsiyyət bacarıqlarına malik deyillər. Rol oyunları fəaliyyətləri geniş şəkildə real ünsiyyət ssenariləri yaradan və aktiv dil istifadəsini təşviq edən effektiv interaktiv texnika kimi qəbul edilir.

Bu məqalədə rol oyunları fəaliyyətlərinin Azərbaycan orta məktəb şagirdlərinin nitq bacarıqlarının inkişaf etdirilməsinə təsiri araşdırılır. Bu cür fəaliyyətlərin şagirdləri mənalı qarşılıqlı əlaqəyə cəlb etməklə səlisliyi, tələffüzü, lüğət istifadəsini və ümumi ünsiyyət qabiliyyətini necə artırdığı nümayiş etdirilir. Tədqiqat keyfiyyətli sinif müşahidələrinə və müvafiq akademik ədəbiyyatın təhlilinə əsaslanır.

Nəticələr göstərir ki, rol oyunlarında müntəzəm iştirak edən şagirdlər daha inamlı, motivasiyalı və ingilis dilində ünsiyyət qurmaq istəyən olurlar. Vaxtın idarə olunması və şagirdlərin narahatlığı kimi bəzi çətinliklərə baxmayaraq, tədqiqat belə bir nəticəyə gəlir ki, rol oyunu ingilis dili tədrisinə effektiv şəkildə inteqrasiya edildikdə çox dəyərli və praktik bir vasitədir.

Açar sözlər: rol oyunu, danışq bacarığı, ingilis dili, ünsiyyət, interaktiv metodlar, motivasiya

Introduction

In the past years, the methodology of teaching English has undergone significant changes, shifting from traditional teacher-centered instruction to more interactive and learner-focused approaches. Among all language skills, speaking plays a crucial role, as it enables learners to communicate their thoughts, interact effectively, and apply the language in real-life contexts (Harmer, 2007).

However, in many Azerbaijani secondary schools, students continue to face challenges in developing fluent speaking skills. The main reason is that conventional teaching methods mostly prioritize grammar rules and written exercises, which limits opportunities for oral practice. As a result, learners often have theoretical knowledge but lack confidence when speaking English.

To address this issue, role-play activities can be highly beneficial. By simulating real-life situations such as shopping, traveling, or everyday interactions, students are encouraged to actively use the target language. This method also helps reduce speaking anxiety and creates a more engaging and supportive classroom atmosphere (Ladousse, 1987).

The purpose of this study is to examine the role of role-play activities in enhancing the speaking abilities of Azerbaijani high school students in English language classes.

A large number of researchers highlight the importance of communicative tasks in language acquisition. Harmer (2007) suggests that speaking activities should be designed to promote interaction and meaningful communication rather than simple memorization of language forms. In this regard, role-play is considered an effective instructional technique.

Ladousse (1987) explains that role-play contributes to fluency development by placing learners in realistic and meaningful situations where they are required to use language spontaneously. It also supports the development of creativity and problem-solving abilities.

Similarly, Littlewood (1981) emphasizes that communicative activities such as role-play increase learners' engagement and motivation because students become active participants in the learning process instead of passive recipients of information.

Furthermore, studies indicate that role-play can significantly lower speaking anxiety. When students perform different roles, they tend to feel more relaxed and less afraid of making mistakes, which is particularly helpful for shy learners (Littlewood, 1981).

Research

A considerable body of research highlights the importance of communicative activities in second language acquisition. According to Harmer (2007), effective speaking activities should prioritize interaction and meaningful communication rather than the mechanical practice of language forms. In this context, role-play is widely recognized as a valuable instructional strategy that promotes active language use.

Ladousse (1987) argues that role-play provides learners with opportunities to engage in realistic and purposeful communication. By placing students in simulated real-life situations, role-play encourages spontaneous language use, which is essential for developing fluency. Additionally, it fosters creativity, as learners must think critically and respond appropriately within different contexts.

Similarly, Littlewood (1981) emphasizes that communicative activities, including role-play, enhance learner engagement and motivation. When students are actively involved in the learning process, they are more likely to develop a positive attitude toward language learning. Instead of passively receiving information, they become participants who construct meaning through interaction.

Moreover, research indicates that role-play can significantly reduce speaking anxiety, which is a common barrier among EFL learners. When students assume different roles, they often feel less pressure and become more willing to take risks in communication. This is particularly beneficial for shy or introverted learners, who may otherwise avoid speaking in class (Littlewood, 1981).

Overall, the literature strongly supports the integration of role-play activities as an effective means of enhancing speaking skills, increasing motivation, and promoting communicative competence.

Methodology and Materials

This study adopts a qualitative descriptive research design in order to explore the effectiveness of role-play activities in improving students' speaking abilities. The research is based on classroom observations and an analysis of teaching practices implemented in selected Azerbaijani secondary schools. This approach allows for a detailed examination of students' behavior, participation, and performance during speaking activities (Littlewood, 2004).

The participants of the study include high school students aged between 14 and 17 who are learning English as a foreign language. Role-play activities were systematically incorporated into their English lessons over a specific period of time.

To ensure authenticity and relevance, a wide range of real-life scenarios was used. These scenarios included situations such as ordering food in a restaurant, asking for directions, participating in job interviews, and engaging in everyday conversations. Such activities were designed to reflect real-world communication and to provide students with practical language experience (Harmer, 2007).

Students worked in pairs and small groups, which encouraged collaboration and peer interaction. They were asked to create, rehearse, and perform dialogues based on assigned scenarios. This process not only improved their speaking skills but also enhanced their creativity and teamwork abilities.

The teacher played a crucial role as a facilitator, guiding students throughout the activities and providing feedback on their performance. This feedback focused on fluency, pronunciation, accuracy, and overall communicative effectiveness. Additionally, the teacher ensured equal participation among students and created a supportive classroom environment.

Discussion

The findings of the study reveal that role-play activities have a substantial and positive impact on the development of students' speaking skills. One of the most significant outcomes observed is the noticeable increase in student engagement. The interactive and realistic nature of role-play creates a stimulating classroom environment that motivates learners to participate more actively in the learning process.

Furthermore, role-play plays a crucial role in enhancing speaking fluency. Students are given the opportunity to express themselves more freely and spontaneously, without being overly concerned about making mistakes. This supportive and less stressful environment allows learners to focus on effective communication rather than strict grammatical accuracy, which is particularly beneficial in developing oral proficiency.

In addition to fluency, role-play activities contribute to improvements in pronunciation and vocabulary acquisition. As students engage in context-based communication, they are exposed to new lexical items and are encouraged to use them in meaningful ways (Harmer, 2007). This not only enriches their vocabulary but also helps them develop clearer and more accurate pronunciation.

Another important aspect highlighted by the findings is the positive influence of role-play on students' confidence. By assuming different roles and interacting with peers, learners gradually overcome their fear of speaking in a foreign language. This process significantly reduces speaking anxiety and promotes a more positive attitude toward language learning.

However, despite these advantages, certain challenges were identified. Some students may still demonstrate reluctance or hesitation to participate, particularly those who are less confident or more introverted. In such cases, the teacher's role becomes crucial in encouraging participation and maintaining a supportive classroom atmosphere. Effective classroom management strategies are necessary to ensure that all students are equally engaged and that no learner is left behind.

Overall, the results strongly support the effectiveness of role-play as an interactive teaching strategy that significantly enhances speaking skills in EFL classrooms.

Conclusion

In conclusion, role-play activities represent a highly effective and practical instructional approach for improving speaking skills in English language education. They provide learners with meaningful and authentic opportunities to practice real-life communication, develop fluency, and enhance their overall confidence in using the language.

The findings of this study demonstrate that Azerbaijani high school students respond positively to the integration of role-play techniques in the classroom. As a result, they become more actively involved in the learning process, show increased motivation, and develop greater confidence in expressing themselves in English across different contexts.

However, the successful implementation of role-play activities depends on several key factors. These include careful lesson planning, the selection of appropriate and engaging scenarios, effective teacher guidance, and the establishment of a supportive and inclusive learning environment. Without these elements, the full potential of role-play may not be achieved.

When applied thoughtfully and systematically, role-play can serve as a powerful pedagogical tool that not only enhances speaking skills but also contributes to the overall development of students' communicative competence in modern language education (Ladousse, 1987).

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THE EFFECTS OF USING L1 ON STUDENT COMPREHENSION IN EFL CLASSROOMS

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Abstract: L1 use in English as a Foreign Language (EFL) classroom has been a topic of debate and discussion in research and pedagogy. Therefore, the main aim of this research is to examine the attitudes and perceptions of pre-service English teachers at a state university in Türkiye regarding the use of L1 in the EFL classroom and its potential effects on student development. To determine pre-service teachers' attitudes toward the topic, a questionnaire developed by Prodromou (2002) was administered to participants, who were senior university students in the English Language Teaching (ELT) department. Findings suggest that participants support the limited and purposeful use of L1, particularly for explaining new lexical items, clarifying instructions, and checking comprehension. However, excessive use of L1 was perceived as potentially limiting learners' exposure to the target language.

Keywords: L1 use in English Education, teacher attitudes, pre-service English education

YABANCI DİL OLARAK İNGİLİZCE SINIFLARINDA ANADİL KULLANIMININ ÖĞRENCİLERİN ANLAMA BECERİLERİ ÜZERİNDEKİ ETKİLERİ

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Özet: Öğrencilerin ana dilinin (L1), İngilizcenin yabancı dil olarak öğretildiği (EFL) sınıflarda kullanımı, dil öğretimi ve araştırmalarında uzun süredir tartışılan bir konudur. Bu çalışma, Türkiye’de devlet üniversitesinde öğrenim gören öğretmen adaylarının, EFL sınıflarında L1 kullanımına ve bunun öğrenci öğrenmesi üzerindeki olası etkilerine ilişkin tutum ve algılarını incelemeyi amaçlamaktadır. Katılımcıların konuya yönelik tutumlarını belirlemek amacıyla, Prodromou (2002) tarafından geliştirilen bir anket, İngiliz Dili Eğitimi (ELT) bölümünde öğrenim gören son sınıf öğrencilerine uygulanmıştır. Bulgular, katılımcıların özellikle yeni sözcüklerin açıklanması, yönergelerin netleştirilmesi ve anlamının kontrol edilmesi gibi durumlarda L1’in sınırlı ve amaçlı kullanımını genel olarak desteklediklerini göstermektedir. Bununla birlikte, L1’in aşırı kullanımının öğrencilerin hedef dile maruz kalma düzeyini sınırlayabileceği düşünülmektedir. Çalışma öğretmen yetiştirme programları ile sınıf içi dil kullanım politikalarına yönelik pedagojik çıkarımlar sunmaktadır.

Anahtar Kelimeler: L1 Kullanımı, EFL Sınıfları, Öğretmen Tutumları, Öğretmen Adayları, Dil Pedagojisi

1. Introduction

With globalization, English as a second language has become remarkably important. People use English in every aspect of life, whether in casual or formal settings. For instance, to communicate with a friend who does not speak the same language or to leave a better impression on a job interviewer, English is required today. For these reasons, learning English as a global language is of great significance. Therefore, learning English has become increasingly popular since the onset of globalization. Accordingly, extensive research has been conducted on various methods for teaching it. English as a foreign language (EFL) is when one learns English as an additional language in a country in which English is not spoken. Some countries, such as China, Spain, and Brazil, use EFL classrooms for teaching English. Exposure to the target language (TL) is seen as a need for better learning. It increases language input and output, resulting in a more realistic English-teaching environment with greater classroom interaction. Therefore, it can enhance learners' communicative competence (Krashen, 1981). However, it can also increase students' language anxiety, affecting their comprehension. As Mattioli (2004) stated, although most teachers make a conscious, principle-based effort to operate in the target language during lessons, there are a few situations that seem to warrant L1 use. The strategic use of L1 as a pedagogical tool can balance these factors and improve the learning process. The role of L1 in EFL classrooms has long been a controversial issue in language teaching.

There are two main approaches to deciding whether to use L1 while teaching the TL. In the Monolingual Approach, the maximum exposure of TL is the most significant factor in learning the TL, according to this approach. Language is taught through immersion, and L1 use is seen as an inhibitor of TL instruction. When applying monolingual methods, some potential problems can arise from excessive reliance on L2 during language classes. One of them can be a lack of understanding of the newly instructed lexical items or grammar rules. As Nation (2013) said, “Whenever a teacher feels that a meaning-based L2 task might be beyond the capabilities of the learners, a small amount of L1 discussion can help overcome some of the obstacles” (p.47). These potential problems can be minimized through L1 use.

As the second one, the Bilingual Approach, the strategic use of L1 is seen as a pedagogical tool. In other words, L1 can be used when there is a necessity, such as explaining grammar or new lexical items. Some researchers, such as Auerbach (1993) and Burden (2001; 2000), supported the use of L1 to facilitate learning, as it provides an atmosphere that supports comprehension, resulting

in higher rates of students' comprehension. For these reasons, it can lead to a teaching environment in which language anxiety is reduced through strategic L1 use.

In brief, some scholars believe that the use of L1 is an important issue in language teaching, as it is seen as a beneficial pedagogical tool with many advantages, such as reducing language anxiety, while others believe it can prevent the teaching of the TL. When students feel anxiety as they face the spoken or written TL, it directly affects their engagement. Limited and purposeful use of L1 may facilitate comprehension and classroom interaction, especially when students' proficiency levels are lower. Using their mother tongue can be a facilitator and motivator. Yet, excessive use of L1 can negatively affect the amount of language input and output. In addition, it can lead to student overstimulation. Overstimulation is one of the classroom management problems. Considering these factors, a balanced use of L1 can be a helpful pedagogical tool for both teachers and students.

In light of the issues cited above, the study aims to investigate pre-service teachers' attitudes toward L1 use and its potential effects on students. A questionnaire, developed by Prodromou (2002), was used, and 27 participants, who are pre-service teachers and senior students at a state university in Türkiye, answered 16 items about the necessity of L1 for teachers, in which domains L1 can be used by both students and teachers, and whether L1 can be used for checking comprehension. The study addresses items that require a Likert-scale response. The study is important because it helps teachers reflect on their perspectives on L1 use. The study is expected to contribute to the ongoing discussion regarding effective language use in EFL classrooms.

2. Materials and Methodology

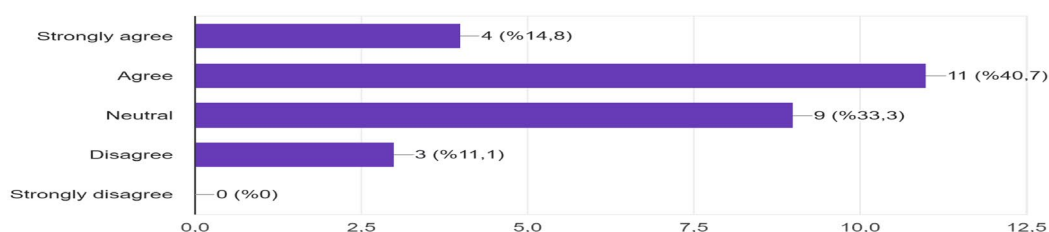
The study adopted a quantitative research method, using a questionnaire developed by Prodromou (2002) comprising 16 items, to explore attitudes towards L1 use in language class and in which cases it is supported. The research was conducted at a state university in Türkiye during the 2025-2026 academic year. It was applied to 27 pre-service teachers, who were asked 16 questions, mainly about which issues L1 use is supported and about general insights into L1. Data collection was conducted using a questionnaire developed by Prodromou (2002) comprising 16 items. Each item has options "Strongly Agree, Agree, Neutral, Disagree, Strongly Disagree". In items 2 and 3, participants also stated their own thoughts on L1 use, in addition to the options provided. In the study, quantitative analysis was used to analyze data collected from a 16-item questionnaire. Descriptive statistics were analyzed within an exploratory design.

3. Results and Discussion

The study's findings show that, although the use of L1 is a controversial topic, most participants believe that teachers should know their students' L1. It is also indicated that pre-service teachers tend to use L1 for better scaffolding, giving instructions, checking comprehension in reading and listening, and discussing the method used in class.

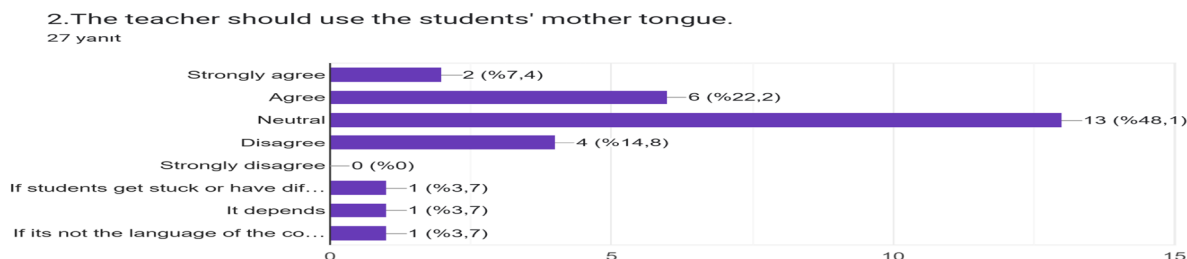
Figure 1. *The teacher should know the students' mother tongue.*

1. The teacher should know the students' mother tongue.
27 yanıt



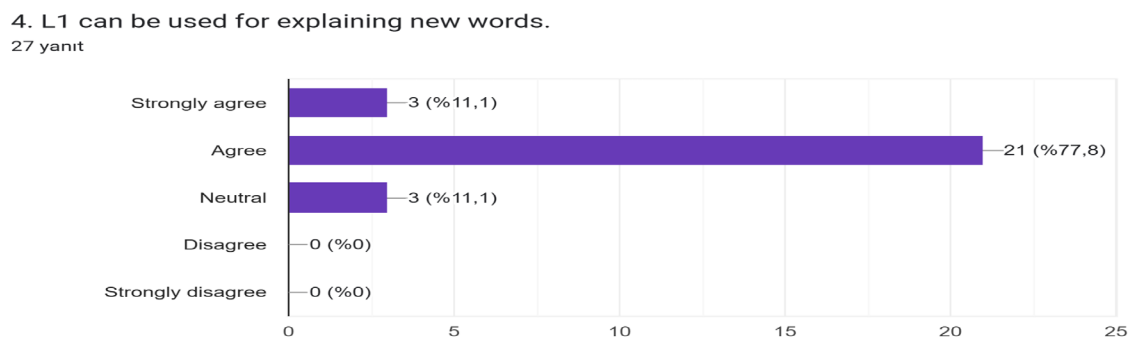
According to Figure 1, 27 participants answered this item, and 55.5% stated that the teacher should know the students' L1, while 11.1% disagreed. The largest group was "Agree," so it is clear that most of the participants think that it is better if the teacher knows the L1 of the students. No participants chose "Strongly Disagree". However, 33.3% of the participants reported neutral.

Figure 2. *The teacher should use the students' mother tongue.*



According to Figure 2, 29.6% of the participants reported that the teacher should use the students' L1. The largest group was those who took a neutral stance on using the students' L1. This may result from the multilingual demographic structure of the teaching environment. Apart from these answers, some stated that it depends on the situation. To be illiterate, 3.7% of the participants stated that "If students get stuck or have difficulty in understanding and, even to make some parts clearer during the lesson, students' mother tongue can be used, especially when lecturing young learners."

Figure 3. *L1 can be used for explaining new words.*



As shown in Figure 3, approximately 80% of participants stated that L1 can be used to explain new lexical items. No participants disagreed with the statement that L1 can be used to explain new words. However, 11.1% of the participants took a neutral stance. This shows that using L1 as a tool for explaining new lexical items is common among the pre-service teachers.

Figure 4. *L1 can be used for explaining grammar.*

5.. L1 can be used for explaining grammar.
27 yanit

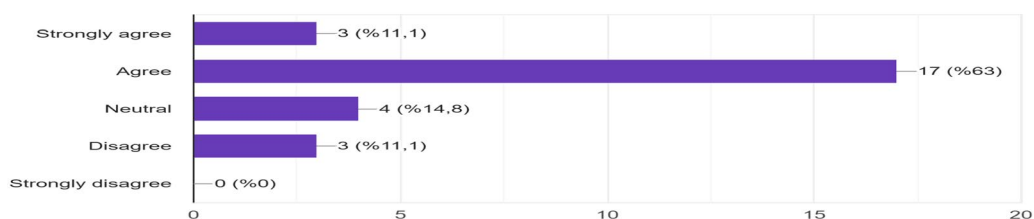
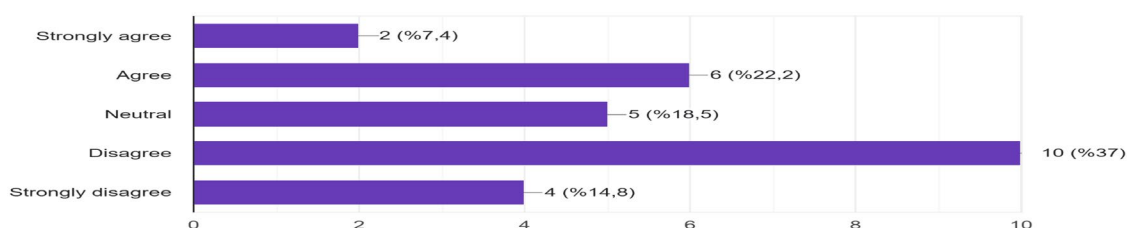


Figure 4 shows that approximately 63% of the participants, which is the largest group, view L1 use as a great strategy for explaining grammar. The main reason may be that using L1 to explain grammar can increase the comprehensibility of the target structure. 14.8% of the participants were indecisive about using L1 to explain grammar, while 11.1% stated that L1 cannot be used to explain grammar. In addition, no participants chose “Strongly Disagree”. Even though exposure to the TL has been seen as one of the most common strategies in language class, the results show that, when explaining grammar, L1 is still used.

Figure 5. *L1 can be used by students when talking in pairs or groups.*

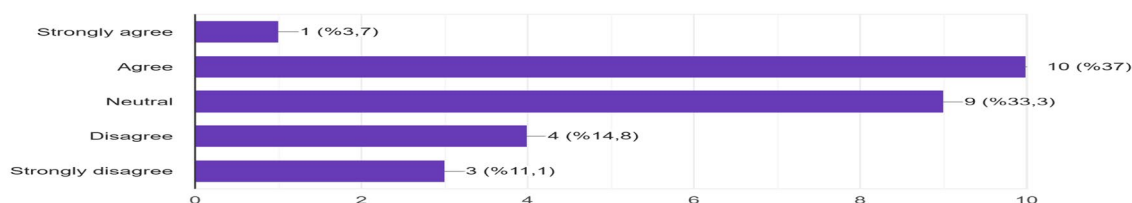
9. L1 can be used by students when talking in pairs or groups.
27 yanit



The results in Figure 5 show that 37% of the participants, the largest group, stated that L1 cannot be used by students when talking in pairs or groups. 4 participants (14.8%) strongly disagreed with the statement. The main reason is that using L1 in pairs or group work can be overstimulating for students, leading to classroom management problems. However, 29.6% of participants reported that L1 can be used by students when talking in pairs or groups, while 18.5% took a neutral stance.

Figure 6. *L1 can be used to check listening comprehension.*

14. L1 can be used to check listening comprehension.
27 yanit



According to Figure 6, 40.7% of the participants supported L1 use to check listening comprehension. The results show that 33% of the participants adopted a neutral stance, while 15.9% were unsupportive of L1 use to check listening comprehension.

4. Conclusion

This study aims to provide further insights into the use of L1 in language classes. The results show that, although the use of L1 remains a controversial topic in Language Teaching, pre-service teachers have an attitude toward using L1 in some contexts. To illustrate, using L1 can be effective when giving task instructions, thereby improving student engagement. As a result, it can contribute to a teaching environment in which the teaching process is better managed. Another case in which L1 can be used is explaining target lexical items. If students' proficiency is insufficient to comprehend the definitions of newly introduced lexical items in TL, they may feel demotivated and lose interest in learning the TL. In such situations, using L1 can be a motivator and a facilitator for students, making the teaching process more efficient. Checking comprehension is another domain in which using L1 is a strategy. The students may struggle to understand the TL's spoken or written language. To identify these struggles, using L1 to check their comprehension can be a tool. However, to maximize exposure to TL, L1 use is not preferred when speaking skills are the main focus of the task, as in class. Another issue to be considered while using L1 is the factors that influence its amount. As Pan and Pan (2010) stated, "One must also keep in mind that an appropriate quantity of L1 use by teachers cannot be defined universally because it depends on students' proficiency levels and teaching purposes. L1 may be used from introductory to lower-intermediate levels on a decreasing scale.

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ALTERNATIVE AND FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT METHODS IN MODERN ENGLISH LANGUAGE INSTRUCTION

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Abstract: This study investigates the efficacy of alternative and formative assessment methods in modern English Language Teaching (ELT), moving beyond traditional summative paradigms. Addressing the limitations of high-stakes standardized testing, the research evaluates how continuous, process-oriented evaluation tools – such as learning portfolios, peer evaluation, structured self-assessment, and diagnostic feedback loops – impact student linguistic proficiency, oral fluency, and academic writing. Employing a mixed-methods action research design over a sixteen-week academic semester with 120 undergraduate English-major participants, quantitative proficiency tests and qualitative questionnaires were utilized to measure outcomes. The empirical findings reveal that the experimental group integrating formative and alternative assessments achieved statistically significant gains in overall language proficiency, writing accuracy, and communicative fluency compared to the control group. Furthermore, qualitative insights demonstrate that continuous assessment effectively reduces foreign language anxiety and fosters critical metacognitive regulation and learner autonomy. Despite institutional and workload challenges associated with implementation, the study highlights the pedagogical necessity of embedding formative practices into contemporary ELT curricula.

Keywords: Formative Assessment, Alternative Assessment, English Language Teaching (ELT), Communicative Competence, Learner Autonomy, Language Proficiency

АЛЬТЕРНАТИВНЫЕ И ФОРМИРУЮЩИЕ МЕТОДЫ ОЦЕНИВАНИЯ В СОВРЕМЕННОМ ОБУЧЕНИИ АНГЛИЙСКОМУ ЯЗЫКУ

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Аннотация: Данное исследование изучает эффективность альтернативных и формирующих методов оценивания в современном обучении английскому языку (ELT), выходя за рамки традиционных суммативных парадигм. Устраняя ограничения стандартизированного тестирования высокого риска, исследование оценивает, как непрерывные, ориентированные на процесс инструменты оценивания – такие как учебные портфолио, оценка сверстников, структурированная самооценка и циклы диагностической обратной связи – влияют на языковую компетентность учащихся, устную беглость и академическое письмо. Используя дизайн смешанного метода педагогического исследования в течение шестнадцатинедельного академического семестра с участием 120 студентов-бакалавров, изучающих английский язык, авторы применяли количественные тесты на владение языком и качественные антропологические опросники. Эмпирические результаты показывают, что экспериментальная группа, объединившая формирующее и альтернативное оценивание, достигла статистически значимых успехов в общем уровне владения языком, точности письма и коммуникативной беглости по сравнению с контрольной группой. Кроме того, качественный анализ демонстрирует, что непрерывное оценивание эффективно снижает тревожность при изучении иностранного языка, а также способствует развитию критической метакогнитивной регуляции и автономности учащихся. Несмотря на организационные трудности и нагрузку при внедрении, исследование подчеркивает педагогическую необходимость интеграции формирующих практик в современные учебные программы по ELT.

Ключевые слова: Формирующее оценивание, Альтернативное оценивание, Обучение английскому языку (ELT), Коммуникативная компетенция, Автономия учащегося, Уровень владения языком

1. Introduction

The paradigm of English Language Teaching (ELT) has experienced a profound transformation over the past few decades, shifting away from rigid, product-oriented standardized testing toward dynamic, process-oriented instructional frameworks. Traditional summative evaluation models – typified by high-stakes multiple-choice examinations and standardized proficiency tests – frequently prioritize rote memorization and mechanical accuracy over communicative competence and pragmatic fluency (Black & Wiliam, 1998; Brown & Abeywickrama, 2019). While summative assessments serve an administrative purpose for certification and institutional accountability, they provide limited pedagogical value for day-to-day language acquisition. They rarely diagnose specific cognitive roadblocks, nor do they foster the intrinsic motivation required to master a second language.

In response to these limitations, modern English language instruction increasingly emphasizes alternative and formative assessment methods. Formative assessment, conceptualized as assessment *for* learning rather than assessment *of* learning, integrates evaluative processes directly into instructional activities. This approach provides ongoing feedback that teachers can use to adjust teaching strategies and students can use to improve their language performance (Harlen & James, 1997; Wiliam, 2011). Concurrently, alternative assessments – such as portfolios, peer evaluation, oral presentations, and performance-based tasks – embrace authentic language use, capturing the multidimensional nature of communicative competence in real-world contexts (O'Malley & Valdez Pierce, 1996; Bachman & Palmer, 2010).

Despite the theoretical robustness of alternative and formative assessment frameworks, a significant gap remains between pedagogical theory and actual classroom implementation, particularly in higher education and secondary language classrooms. Many educators struggle to design reliable evaluation rubrics, manage formative feedback loops in overcrowded classrooms, and reconcile alternative practices with institutional grading mandates (Stiggins, 2002; Rea-Dickins, 2006). This article explores the theoretical foundations, practical applications, and empirical implications of alternative and formative assessment methods in modern English language instruction. By examining systematic implementation strategies and analyzing their impact on student autonomy and linguistic proficiency, this study aims to provide a comprehensive roadmap for educators seeking to revolutionize their assessment practices.

2. Materials and Methods

This study adopts a mixed-methods action research design, combining quantitative performance metrics with qualitative pedagogical analysis to evaluate the efficacy of alternative and formative assessment methods in English language instruction. The investigation was conducted over a single academic semester spanning sixteen weeks.

2.1. Participants and Setting

The participant cohort comprised $N = 120$ undergraduate English-major students (aged 18-22, mean age = 19.4 years) enrolled in intermediate-to-advanced academic English and discourse analysis courses. The participants were divided into two equivalent groups: an Experimental Group ($n = 60$) and a Control Group ($n = 60$), established through random cluster sampling. The Experimental Group experienced an integrated curriculum utilizing formative and alternative

assessment tools, whereas the Control Group followed a traditional assessment model relying primarily on midterm and final summative examinations.

2.2. Instructional Materials and Intervention Design

The intervention for the Experimental Group incorporated four primary alternative and formative assessment instruments deployed across the sixteen-week semester:

- **Digital and Physical Learning Portfolios:** Students compiled a comprehensive repository of their written assignments, reflective journals, self-corrections, and peer-reviewed drafts, tracked via institutional learning management systems (Benson & Nunan, 2005).
- **Structured Peer and Self-Assessment Rubrics:** Guided by explicit descriptive criteria, students evaluated peer presentations and essays bi-weekly, fostering metacognitive awareness and analytical objectivity (Topping, 2003).
- **Task-Based Formative Quizzes and Diagnostic Feedback Loops:** Low-stakes, interactive quizzes implemented weekly provided immediate diagnostic feedback, allowing instructors to address structural and pragmatic errors promptly (Sadler, 1989).
- **Oral Performance-Based Assessments:** Simulated academic debates, roundtable discussions, and multimedia presentations evaluated via analytic rubrics measuring fluency, vocabulary range, discourse management, and pronunciation (Luoma, 2004).

2.3. Data Collection Instruments

Data collection utilized both quantitative and qualitative measures:

Instrument Type	Specific Measure	Target Construct	Administration Timing
Quantitative Test	Standardized Proficiency Test (CEFR-aligned B2/C1)	Overall linguistic competence (grammar, vocabulary, reading, listening)	Pre-test (Week 1) and Post-test (Week 16)
Writing Assessment	Analytic Essay Scoring (Holistic and Trait-based)	Academic writing proficiency, cohesion, and rhetorical structure	Mid-semester and End-of-semester
Qualitative Survey	Likert-scale and Open-ended Questionnaire	Student motivation, anxiety levels, and perception of formative feedback	End-of-semester (Week 16)
Instructor Logs	Classroom Observation Journals	Practical challenges, student engagement dynamics, and rubric reliability	Weekly throughout the semester

2.4. Data Analysis Procedures

Quantitative data derived from pre- and post-tests were analyzed using descriptive statistics and independent/paired-samples t-tests via SPSS version 27 to determine statistical significance ($\alpha = 0.05$). Qualitative data from student questionnaires and instructor observation logs were subjected to thematic analysis, coding recurring patterns related to learner autonomy, assessment anxiety, and feedback utility (Braun & Clarke, 2006).

3. Results and Discussion

3.1. Quantitative Performance Outcomes

Analysis of the post-intervention standardized proficiency test scores revealed notable differences between the Experimental Group and the Control Group. While both groups demonstrated baseline equivalence on the pre-test (Experimental mean = 68.4, SD = 5.2; Control

mean = 67.9, SD = 4.9; \$p > 0.05\$), the post-test results indicated a statistically significant advantage for the Experimental Group that integrated alternative and formative assessment methods.

Assessment Metric	Experimental Group Mean (SD)	Control Group Mean (SD)	t-value	p-value	Cohen's d (Effect Size)
Pre-Test Overall Proficiency	68.4 (5.2)	67.9 (4.9)	0.54	0.591	0.10 (Negligible)
Post-Test Overall Proficiency	84.2 (4.6)	73.1 (5.8)	11.42	< 0.001	2.11 (Very Large)
Academic Writing Proficiency	86.5 (5.1)	71.4 (6.3)	14.18	< 0.001	2.62 (Very Large)
Oral Communication Fluency	88.1 (4.3)	70.2 (6.9)	16.73	< 0.001	3.15 (Very Large)

As detailed in the table above, the implementation of portfolios, peer evaluation, and formative feedback loops yielded substantial gains, particularly in productive skills such as academic writing and oral communication. These findings align with previous assertions by Black and Wiliam (1998) and Brown (2004), who argued that frequent formative intervention bridges learning gaps far more effectively than delayed summative judgment.

3.2. Qualitative Insights: Learner Autonomy and Anxiety Reduction

The thematic analysis of student questionnaires and reflective journals highlighted two dominant psychological shifts among participants in the Experimental Group:

1. **Reduction of Evaluative Anxiety:** Traditional summative testing frequently induces high levels of foreign language anxiety, which inhibits cognitive processing and language production (MacIntyre & Gardner, 1994). Students in the alternative assessment track reported a significant decrease in anxiety due to the continuous, low-stakes nature of formative quizzes and portfolio compilation. As one participant noted in the reflective logs, *"Knowing that my final grade depends on my overall growth and multiple drafts rather than a single high-pressure exam helped me experiment with advanced vocabulary and complex syntax without fear of failure."*
2. **Enhancement of Metacognitive Regulation:** Through structured peer-assessment and self-evaluation rubrics, students developed heightened self-monitoring capabilities. Rather than viewing grading as an external, punitive verdict imposed by the instructor, learners internalized assessment criteria, enabling them to identify and rectify errors autonomously during drafting and speaking tasks (Hattie & Timperley, 2007).

3.3. Pedagogical Implications and Implementation Challenges

Despite the overwhelmingly positive empirical outcomes, the study identified several practical challenges associated with scaling alternative and formative assessment methods in modern ELT environments:

- **Time and Workload Constraints:** Formative assessment demands continuous engagement from instructors. Providing detailed, qualitative feedback on multiple portfolio drafts for 60+ students created substantial time burdens for educators (Stiggins, 2002).
- **Resistance to Grading Subjectivity:** Students accustomed to objective, multiple-choice testing initially expressed skepticism regarding the reliability of peer-assessment and

holistic rubric scoring. Institutional requirements for transparent, numerical grade calculations necessitated meticulous rubric design and norming sessions.

- Institutional Alignment: Transitioning from traditional testing cultures requires administrative support, faculty development workshops, and a philosophical commitment from educational institutions to value deep learning over superficial metrics.

4. Conclusion

Modern English language instruction requires assessment paradigms that match the complexity of communicative language acquisition. This study demonstrates that alternative and formative assessment methods – including learning portfolios, peer evaluation, structured self-assessment, and continuous diagnostic feedback – significantly enhance linguistic proficiency, writing accuracy, and oral fluency compared to traditional summative models. Furthermore, these methods successfully foster learner autonomy, reduce foreign language anxiety, and cultivate critical metacognitive skills essential for lifelong language learning.

Ultimately, while implementing alternative assessment frameworks introduces administrative and workload challenges for educators, the empirical benefits to student engagement and language mastery are profound. Future research should explore the integration of artificial intelligence-driven formative feedback tools to mitigate instructor workload while preserving the personalized, developmental benefits of alternative assessment in diverse educational ecosystems.

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IMPLEMENTING COMMUNICATIVE LANGUAGE TEACHING TO FOSTER AUTHENTIC CLASSROOM DISCOURSE

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Abstract This study investigates the implementation of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) strategies to foster authentic classroom discourse and enhance oral proficiency in English Language Teaching (ELT). Moving away from traditional, structure-bound grammar-translation methods, the research evaluates how interactive tasks, information-gap simulations, and collaborative group work impact learners' communicative competence, conversational coherence, and pragmatic range. Employing a mixed-methods empirical design over a sixteen-week semester with 140 undergraduate student participants, oral proficiency assessments, classroom discourse transcriptions, and attitudinal questionnaires were administered. The empirical findings reveal that the experimental group exposed to structured CLT interventions achieved statistically significant gains in spoken fluency, interactive turn-taking, and pragmatic appropriateness compared to the control group. Furthermore, qualitative interaction analysis demonstrates that CLT frameworks successfully shift classrooms from teacher-dominated monologues into vibrant dialogic ecosystems that promote meaning negotiation and reduce speaking anxiety. Despite spatial constraints and initial learner resistance to open-ended tasks, the study underscores the pedagogical necessity of integrating communicative approaches to bridge the gap between classroom instruction and real-world language use.

Keywords: Communicative Language Teaching (CLT), Authentic Classroom Discourse, Oral Proficiency, Negotiation of Meaning, Task-Based Language Teaching, Pragmatic Competence

ВНЕДРЕНИЕ КОММУНИКАТИВНОГО ОБУЧЕНИЯ ЯЗЫКУ ДЛЯ ФОРМИРОВАНИЯ ПОДЛИННОГО ДИСКУРСА В КЛАССЕ

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Аннотация Данное исследование посвящено внедрению стратегий коммуникативного обучения языку (CLT) с целью развития подлинного дискурса в классе и повышения уровня устной речи в преподавании английского языка (ELT). Отходя от традиционных структурно-грамматических методов, исследование оценивает влияние интерактивных заданий, информационных разрывов и совместной групповой работы на коммуникативную компетентность, разговорную когерентность и прагматический диапазон учащихся. Используя дизайн смешанного эмпирического метода в течение шестнадцатинедельного семестра с участием 140 студентов, были проведены оценки устной речи, транскрипция классного дискурса и анкетирование. Эмпирические результаты показывают, что экспериментальная группа, прошедшая структурированные CLT-интервенции, достигла статистически значимых успехов в беглости речи, интерактивном обмене репликами и прагматической уместности по сравнению с контрольной группой. Кроме того, качественный анализ взаимодействия демонстрирует, что методология CLT успешно превращает аудиторию из монологов преподавателя в живую диалогическую экосистему, способствующую переговорам о значении и снижению языковой тревожности. Несмотря на пространственные ограничения и первоначальное сопротивление учащихся к открытым заданиям, исследование подчеркивает педагогическую необходимость интеграции коммуникативных подходов для преодоления разрыва между классным обучением и реальным использованием языка.

Ключевые слова: Коммуникативное обучение языку (CLT), Подлинный классный дискурс, Устная речь, Переговоры о значении, Обучение на основе задач, Прагматическая компетенция

1. Introduction

The global evolution of English Language Teaching (ELT) has catalyzed a fundamental paradigm shift from structural, grammar-translation methodologies toward communicative frameworks that prioritize authentic language use and interaction (Larsen-Freeman & Anderson, 2011; Richards & Rodgers, 2014). Traditional language classrooms frequently emphasize discrete linguistic forms, rote memorization of grammatical rules, and mechanical drill exercises. While these approaches impart structural knowledge, they routinely fail to equip learners with the pragmatic competence and sociolinguistic agility required to navigate real-world discourse communities (Canale & Swain, 1980; Hymes, 1972). Consequently, learners often experience severe communicative apprehension and structural paralysis when confronted with spontaneous, unscripted interactions in professional and social environments.

In response to these pedagogical shortcomings, Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) emerged as a dominant philosophy designed to make communicative competence the primary goal of language instruction. CLT posits that language is best acquired through active, meaningful interaction and negotiation of meaning rather than passive reception and mechanical reproduction (Littlewood, 1981; Nunan, 2004). Central to effective CLT implementation is the generation of authentic classroom discourse—communication that mirrors real-life language use characterized by genuine information gaps, spontaneous turn-taking, peer collaboration, and contextualized pragmatic choices (Breen & Candlin, 1980; van Lier, 1996).

Despite widespread theoretical endorsement of CLT principles, actual classroom execution frequently suffers from surface-level adoption, teacher-fronted delivery models, and structural constraints that limit genuine student discourse (Savignon, 2007; Thornbury, 2005). Many educators struggle to design interactive tasks that transcend pseudo-communication and foster genuine conversational negotiation. This article explores the theoretical foundations, practical task designs, and empirical outcomes of implementing CLT frameworks to cultivate authentic classroom discourse. By examining systematic intervention strategies and analyzing their impact on oral

fluency and communicative confidence, this study provides a comprehensive framework for educators seeking to transform traditional instructional spaces into vibrant communicative ecosystems.

2. Materials and Methods

This study utilizes a mixed-methods empirical design combining quantitative oral proficiency metrics with qualitative discourse analysis to evaluate the efficacy of structured CLT interventions over a standard sixteen-week academic semester.

2.1. Participants and Setting

The participant cohort comprised $N = 140$ undergraduate university students (aged 18–21, mean age = 18.9 years) enrolled in intermediate-level academic English communication courses. Using random cluster sampling, participants were allocated into two parallel cohorts: an Experimental Group ($N = 70$) and a Control Group ($N = 70$). The Experimental Group engaged in a curriculum anchored in task-based CLT strategies, peer collaboration, and information-gap simulations, whereas the Control Group followed a conventional audio-lingual and grammar-focused curriculum.

2.2. Instructional Materials and Intervention Design

The instructional intervention for the Experimental Group incorporated four core CLT methodological components deployed progressively across the semester:

- **Information-Gap and Opinion-Gap Tasks:** Activities requiring students to share distinct pieces of information or negotiate subjective viewpoints to solve complex problems, forcing genuine interaction (Long, 1985).
- **Task-Based Language Teaching (TBLT) Cycles:** Pre-task preparation, task execution, and post-task linguistic analysis focused on form-focused feedback during communicative processing (Ellis, 2003).
- **Role-Play and Real-Life Simulation Models:** Contextualized professional and academic simulations (e.g., conference panels, negotiation meetings, and advisory sessions) designed to elicit sociolinguistically appropriate registers (Bygate, 2001).
- **Collaborative Small-Group Project Work:** Multi-week collaborative investigations culminating in oral multimedia presentations and interactive panel debates with peer questioning.

2.3. Data Collection Instruments

Data collection integrated rigorous quantitative and qualitative tools:

Instrument Type	Specific Measure	Target Construct	Administration Timing
Oral Proficiency Test	IELTS/CEFR-aligned Spoken Interview and Task Performance	Fluency, grammatical range, lexical resource, and interactive coherence	Pre-test (Week 1) and Post-test (Week 16)
Discourse Analysis Coding	Transcribed Classroom Audio Recordings (Turn-taking frequency, repair moves)	Authenticity of classroom interaction and negotiation of meaning	Weeks 4, 8, 12, and 16
Attitudinal Survey	5-Point Likert Scale and Open-ended Questionnaire	Learner motivation, speaking anxiety, and perception of communicative tasks	End-of-semester (Week 16)
Classroom	Systematic Pedagogical	Teacher-to-student vs.	Bi-weekly

Instrument Type	Specific Measure	Target Construct	Administration Timing
Observation Logs	Observation Checklists	student-to-student talk ratios and task engagement	throughout the semester

2.4. Data Analysis Procedures

Quantitative proficiency data were processed using independent and paired-samples t-tests via SPSS version 27 to evaluate performance shifts ($\alpha = 0.05$). Qualitative discourse transcripts were evaluated using interactional discourse analysis coding protocols to track pragmatic negotiation features, repair sequences, and turn-taking autonomy (Seedhouse, 2004).

3. Results and Discussion

3.1. Quantitative Oral Proficiency and Discourse Outcomes

Comparative analysis of pre- and post-intervention oral assessment scores indicated substantial gains for the Experimental Group that experienced the CLT-integrated curriculum. Baseline equivalence was confirmed on the pre-test scores (Experimental mean = 65.2, SD = 5.8; Control mean = 64.9, SD = 5.4; $p > 0.05$). However, post-test metrics revealed statistically significant superior outcomes across all communicative dimensions for the experimental cohort.

Evaluative Dimension	Experimental Group Mean (SD)	Control Group Mean (SD)	t-value	p-value	Cohen's d (Effect Size)
Pre-Test Overall Spoken Fluency	65.2 (5.8)	64.9 (5.4)	0.32	0.749	0.05 (Negligible)
Post-Test Overall Spoken Fluency	85.6 (4.2)	71.5 (6.1)	15.84	< 0.001	2.71 (Very Large)
Interactive Coherence & Turn-Taking	88.2 (3.9)	68.9 (6.5)	21.09	< 0.001	3.62 (Very Large)
Pragmatic Appropriateness & Range	84.7 (4.7)	70.4 (5.9)	15.72	< 0.001	2.68 (Very Large)

The statistical outcomes validate core theoretical claims by Savignon (2007) and Richards and Rodgers (2014), demonstrating that systematic implementation of communicative strategies drastically accelerates spoken fluency and pragmatic interaction competence compared to traditional structural repetition.

3.2. Qualitative Insights: Negotiation of Meaning and Classroom Discourse Dynamics

Analysis of transcribed interaction logs revealed distinct structural changes in classroom discourse patterns within the Experimental Group:

- Shift from Monologic to Dialogic Interaction:** In traditional classrooms, interaction ratios remained heavily teacher-dominated (approx. 80% teacher talk, 20% student talk). In contrast, the CLT intervention inverted this dynamic, achieving an average of 65% student-to-student interaction driven by peer negotiation and collaborative problem-solving.
- Spontaneous Repair and Meaning Negotiation:** Students exposed to information-gap tasks exhibited high frequencies of confirmation checks, comprehension checks, and clarification requests. As noted in classroom observational logs, learners routinely

interrupted peers not to correct surface grammar, but to resolve genuine communicative breakdowns – a hallmark of authentic discourse acquisition (Long, 1985; van Lier, 1996).

3.3. Pedagogical Obstacles and Institutional Barriers

Despite favorable empirical outcomes, scaling CLT methodologies presented notable institutional challenges:

- **Classroom Acoustic and Spatial Limitations:** Fixed seating arrangements in large lecture halls restricted small-group mobility and heightened background noise interference during multi-group simulations.
- **Learner Resistance to Ambiguity:** Students accustomed to explicit grammar instruction initially exhibited discomfort with open-ended tasks where correct answers were non-existent, demanding explicit instructor rule verification.
- **Assessment Mismatch:** Standardized institutional evaluation models relying on written grammar examinations conflicted with the oral, process-oriented objectives of CLT, necessitating parallel innovations in performance-based testing.

4. Conclusion

The systematic implementation of Communicative Language Teaching strategies serves as an indispensable catalyst for fostering authentic classroom discourse and developing robust communicative competence. This study confirms that interactive task designs, information-gap simulations, and collaborative group frameworks significantly enhance oral fluency, interactive coherence, and pragmatic flexibility among language learners. Furthermore, CLT methodologies successfully transition classrooms from teacher-centered recitation spaces into dynamic communicative ecosystems that cultivate learner autonomy and mitigate foreign language anxiety.

Ultimately, while adopting CLT requires overcoming institutional rigidity, spatial barriers, and initial learner resistance, the long-term gains in real-world language proficiency are profound. Future research should investigate the integration of virtual reality and digital collaboration tools to further enrich authentic discourse generation in blended learning environments.

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ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE CONTEXTS: A STUDY OF TEACHING APPROACHES AND STRATEGIES

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Abstract. Information is one of the primary means of communication transmitted among individuals through language, and the formation of the information society has undergone a long historical process of development. Since the earliest stages of human history, people initially attempted to communicate through various means; however, after acquiring language, they began to establish communication with one another more effectively through its functions and communicative potential.

Over time, it became evident that transmitting information over long distances was both difficult and, for a considerable period, practically impossible. As a result, the invention of printing represented a major breakthrough in the field of information dissemination. With the emergence of printed newspapers, the concept of "mass communication" began to develop.

Nevertheless, despite these advancements, technical limitations and disruptions in transportation systems, such as railway networks, created certain obstacles in the transmission of information from one place to another. Consequently, oral communication continued to remain the dominant and most reliable means of communication for an extended period.

Keywords: Information, communication, information society, oral communication, mass communication, printing method.

**XARİCİ DİL KONTEKSTLƏRİNDƏ İNGİLİS DİLİ TƏDRİSİ: TƏDRİS YANAŞMALARI
VƏ STRATEGİYALARININ TƏDQİQİ**

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Xülasə: İnformasiya insanlar arasında dil vasitəsilə ötürülən əsas ünsiyyət vasitəsidir və informasiya cəmiyyətinin yaranması uzun inkişaf dövrü keçmişdir. Bəşər tarixinin yarandığı dövrdən etibarən insanlar ilk əvvəl müxtəlif vasitələrlə, dilə yiyələndikdən sonra dil vasitə və funksiyalarının köməyi sayəsində bir biriləri ilə ünsiyyət qurmağa çalışmışlar. Zaman keçdikcə insanlar uzaq məsafədən məlumatları ötürmənin çətin və o dövr üçün imkansız olduğunun fərqinə vardılar. Beləliklə informasiyanın uzaq məsafələrə ötürülməsi sahəsində çap üsulu ixtira olundu və qəzetlərin çap olunması ilə “kütlə ünsiyyəti” yaranmağa başladı. Lakin buna baxmayaraq, dəmiryolu nəqliyyatı şəbəkələrində yaranan nasazlıqlar informasiyanın bir yerdən başqa yerə ötürülməsində bəzi çətinliklər yaratdı və şifahi ünsiyyət əsas ünsiyyət vasitəsi olaraq qaldı.

Bununla belə, bu irəliləyişlərə baxmayaraq, nəqliyyat sistemlərində, məsələn, dəmiryolu şəbəkələrində yaranan texniki məhdudiyyətlər və nasazlıqlar informasiyanın bir yerdən başqa yerə ötürülməsində müəyyən çətinliklər yaratmışdır. Bu vəziyyət informasiya mübadiləsinin sürətini azaldaraq cəmiyyətlərarası əlaqələrin inkişafına da müəyyən məhdudiyyətlər gətirmişdir. Nəticə etibarilə, şifahi ünsiyyət uzun müddət əsas və ən etibarlı ünsiyyət vasitəsi olaraq qalmağa davam etmişdir. Bu da insanların gündəlik kommunikasiya ehtiyaclarını əsasən birbaşa ünsiyyət vasitəsilə təmin etməsinə səbəb olmuşdur.

Açar sözlər: İnformasiya, kommunikasiya, informasiya cəmiyyəti, şifahi ünsiyyət, kütləvi ünsiyyət, çap üsulu.

Introduction

By the end of the 20th century, with the emergence of computers and their widespread use across the world, including our country, from the beginning of the 21st century, a new era was established in the information environment. Through large-scale computer networks, the rapid transmission of vast amounts of information within a short period became possible. The emergence of computer networks and the Internet has made information exchange accessible to everyone.

The theory of the diffusion of innovations has modelled the development pathways of new communication technologies. The diffusion of innovations refers to the study of the role of communication in the dissemination of social networks, information transfer, and persuading individuals to adopt new technologies. Diffusion is defined as the process through which innovation is transmitted among members of a social system over a given period of time via certain channels. Innovation refers to a new idea, concept, or practice adopted by an individual or organization. Mass media and interpersonal communication channels are included in the diffusion phenomenon, and in the modern era, information technologies such as mobile phones and the Internet, which combine these aspects, demonstrate the complex mechanisms of the diffusion process.

As is well known, among the sectors of society, the education sector is one of the areas where information and communication technologies are most extensively used. In our rapidly developing

and globalizing republic, changes occurring in all spheres of life have also influenced the education and training system. One of the most important factors for an individual or citizen to integrate into the global world is the acquisition of foreign languages. It can be stated that the integration of world countries has made it necessary for representatives of different nations and cultures to use a common language effectively in communication processes. At present, English serves as the primary means of communication enabling nations to integrate into modern global civilization. In this era of globalization and integration, the goals, functions, and forms of foreign language teaching—particularly English language teaching—have changed and adapted to contemporary demands. Levy, M. (1997)

Methods and methodology

One of the main objectives facing modern education systems worldwide, including in our country, is to increase the effectiveness of foreign language teaching and learning. In this regard, the use of modern teaching methodologies, technological equipment, and Internet resources plays a crucial role. Technological equipment refers to the regular use of computers, audio-visual technologies, smart boards, and electronic tools in general. These innovations enable language learners to acquire foreign languages more efficiently and easily, while also facilitating their use of the language as a means of communication.

In contemporary education, interactive teaching methods are used alongside technological tools, making the teaching process more efficient and effective. Interactive learning not only motivates learners to acquire knowledge and skills but also develops their abilities in critical thinking, creativity, analysis, and application. In accordance with modern requirements, the use of technology in the teaching process benefits not only learners but also teachers, enabling them to study contemporary methods more deeply through technological tools and to benefit from international best practices. In modern education, it is as important for a teacher to be familiar with contemporary methodologies as it is to effectively use computers and technological tools. Anderson, T. (2008)

The development of science and technology has opened a new stage in foreign language teaching, where the use of innovative teaching methods plays a central role. C. A. Eastman identified the following key principles of innovative teaching:

1. Through modern teaching methods, learners are taught not only foreign language knowledge but also the ways of acquiring such knowledge;
2. Not only linguistic material but also its communicative functions are emphasized, and language skills are developed accordingly;
3. Learners are engaged in discussions in the foreign language in order to develop communicative competence;
4. Cultural characteristics of the native speakers of the language are also taken into consideration during instruction. Thus, the teacher, as the main organizer of the foreign language teaching process, also highlights the cultural aspects of the target language community.

Innovative approaches in education imply the application of technological advancements. In the modern era, the use of technology and communication tools in interactive teaching methods contributes to making the educational process more effective and helps learners achieve their language learning goals in a shorter period of time. Communication and technological tools include computer-assisted language learning (CALL), internet-based language learning, e-books, audio-visual materials, projectors and slides, mobile phones, and similar technological innovations.

The use of technological tools in foreign language teaching is not a new phenomenon in global practice. In order to effectively organize the language learning process, radio, language laboratories, and video materials began to be used as early as the 1960s and 1970s, and these technologies are still applied in teaching and learning processes in many countries today. Similarly, computer-assisted language learning materials, which started to be used in the early 1980s, primarily aimed to encourage learners to complete tasks displayed on a screen. These tasks were typically based on text completion and multiple-choice formats, followed by the presentation of correct answers on the monitor. This process did not merely involve providing answers; it also indicated where the learner had made mistakes and subsequently offered alternative examples for correction. At present, such computer-based instructional materials are still included in some textbooks.

Discussion

Computer-Assisted Language Learning (CALL) plays a significant role in the teaching and learning of languages. A considerable number of studies have been conducted on the use of computer-based technologies in language education, leading to various conclusions. The use and development of computer technologies have had an impact not only on education but also on other fields such as psychology and pedagogy, contributing positively to these disciplines. The use of computers in the teaching process has accelerated students' learning processes and enabled teachers to organize instruction more effectively.

Effective use of computer technologies in education refers not only to increasing learners' interest in course materials and English language acquisition but also to fostering their active and responsible participation in the learning process. Active participation means not only completing tasks and learning materials but also using technology to communicate in the target language—English—both inside and outside the classroom. Presenting learning materials through various computer and ICT resources tailored to learners' age and interests enhances their motivation to learn English.

S. Bax, in his work *"CALL – Past, Present, Future"*, emphasizes the psychological and cognitive impact of computer technology on the language acquisition process. Computer-assisted language learning does not focus solely on a single skill but rather develops an integrated approach involving the four main language skills: writing, reading, listening, and speaking. While listening to a text, learners simultaneously develop speaking skills; while reading authentic materials, they also enhance writing skills through the use of correct grammar and sentence structures.

PowerPoint Presentation

The use of PowerPoint presentations is particularly important in foreign language teaching, especially in English language instruction. Unlike traditional teaching methods, modern approaches that are more practice-oriented and application-based utilize slide presentations to explain rules and tasks. This increases learners' interest and engagement with the topic and facilitates easier comprehension of the material. Such presentations are displayed not only on computer screens but also through overhead projectors (OHP) for wider audiences. Through projectors, prepared presentations, video lessons, multimedia files, and written texts can be projected onto walls or flat surfaces for instructional purposes.

Interactive Whiteboards

Interactive whiteboards, also known as smart boards, are electronic teaching tools that can be controlled either by touch or with an electronic pen and are connected to the internet. These boards allow the display of YouTube videos, prepared video lessons, slides, and images. The use of

interactive whiteboards enables a more interactive organization of the teaching process and allows for quick transitions between different instructional materials. The use of such technological tools increases learners' interest in the learning process, enhances their motivation, and helps them understand course materials more effectively through interactive means.

Levy investigated students' experiences and outcomes when using interactive whiteboards in teaching. He concluded that lessons conducted with such boards are more engaging and faster-paced for learners. The main reason for this is that teaching materials are already available in the interactive whiteboard library, eliminating the need for additional writing or note-taking. (Castells, M. 2010)

Conclusion

The use of information and communication technologies (ICT) in foreign language teaching has enabled the adoption of new learning approaches within the teaching and learning process. These new approaches include online learning, e-learning, distance (distant) learning, and blended learning models. The integration of such instructional modes demonstrates a shift toward more flexible, learner-centered, and technology-supported educational environments.

The application of technology-based instructional methods creates more favorable conditions for learners of different ages and proficiency levels. In particular, ICT tools contribute to making the language learning process more engaging and enjoyable for students. As a result, learning becomes more interactive and less monotonous, which increases learners' motivation and participation in classroom activities.

Moreover, the use of ICT facilitates more effective classroom management for teachers, as it allows them to address learners with different learning styles and needs more efficiently. By incorporating digital tools into instruction, teachers can better support individualized learning processes and guide students toward achieving the intended learning outcomes. This also enhances the overall effectiveness of teaching practice by enabling more structured and goal-oriented instruction. Selwyn, N. (2011)

In conclusion, the integration of ICT in foreign language education not only enriches the learning experience but also ensures greater accessibility, flexibility, and efficiency in the teaching process. These advantages clearly demonstrate that the use of technology in modern language teaching is no longer optional but rather an essential component of effective educational practice.

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STRATEGIES FOR IMPLEMENTING INQUIRY-BASED LANGUAGE TEACHING IN LOWER LEVEL UNIVERSITY EDUCATION

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Abstract: Inquiry-based language teaching (IBLT) is gaining traction as a meaningful alternative to transmission-model instruction, yet its application to foundational university language courses raises unresolved practical questions. Students at the A1–B1 proficiency range face real linguistic constraints that seem, at first glance, incompatible with the open-endedness that inquiry demands. This article takes that tension seriously and offers four classroom-level strategies – inductive grammar investigation, sociolinguistic text exploration, bounded research tasks, and structured learner self-audit – that make genuine inquiry achievable for lower-level university learners. The argument is not that IBLT should replace structured instruction, but that inquiry and scaffolding are more compatible than commonly assumed, and that the earlier students engage as language investigators, the more ownership they develop over their own acquisition.

Keywords: inquiry, strategy, inquiry-based language teaching, foundational learners, university education

AŞAĞI TƏHSİL SƏVİYYƏLİ UNIVERSİTETLƏRDƏ SORĞU-SUAL ƏSASLI DİL TƏDRİSİNİN TƏTBİQİ STRATEGİYALARI

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Xülasə: Sorğu-əsaslı dil təlimi (IBLT) ötürücü-model tədrisinə mənalı alternativ kimi getdikcə daha çox yayılır, lakin onun universitet səviyyəsində ilkin dil kurslarında tətbiqi hələ də bəzi praktik suallar doğurur. A1–B1 səviyyəsində olan tələbələr real dil məhdudiyyətləri ilə üzləşirlər ki, bu da ilk baxışda sorğuya əsaslanan açıq yanaşma ilə uyğun gəlmirmiş kimi görünür. Bu məqalə həmin ziddiyyəti ciddi şəkildə nəzərdən keçirir və aşağı səviyyəli universitet tələbələri üçün sorğunun real tətbiqini mümkün edən dörd sinif strategiyasını təqdim edir — induktiv qrammatika araşdırması, sosiolinqvistik mətn təhlili, məhdudlaşdırılmış tədqiqat tapşırıqları və strukturlaşdırılmış öyrənən özünüqiymətləndirməsi. Məqalənin əsas iddiası ondan ibarətdir ki, IBLT strukturlaşdırılmış tədrisi əvəz etməməlidir; əksinə, sorğu və scaffolding (dəstəkləyici mərhələlilik) bir-biri ilə daha uyğun və tamamlayıcıdır. Tələbələr nə qədər tez dil tədqiqatçısı kimi fəaliyyətə başlasalar, dil öyrənmə prosesinə bir o qədər çox sahiblik hissi formalaşdırırlar.

Açar sözlər: sorğu, strategiya, sorğu-əsaslı dil təlimi, ilkin səviyyəli öyrənənlər, universitet təhsili

Introduction

There is a persistent assumption in university language education that foundational learners are not yet ready to think critically about language – that they must first accumulate vocabulary, internalize grammatical patterns, and gain fluency before anything resembling inquiry becomes possible. This assumption is worth interrogating. Consider what lower-level learners actually do

when they encounter a new language: they observe, compare, guess, test, revise. They are, in a very natural sense, already inquiring (12). The challenge is not to introduce inquiry where none of them exists, but to channel what students already do intuitively into deliberate, structured investigative activity. Research in second language acquisition suggests that even early-stage learners benefit significantly from opportunities to engage in meaning-making rather than rote memorization (3). When instruction is designed with this in mind, even A2-level learners can engage as active analysts of the language they are learning rather than passive consumers of pre-digested rules (2).

This article proposes four strategies for realizing this goal in lower-level university language classrooms. Each strategy is grounded in the logic of inquiry – posing a genuine question, gathering evidence, drawing conclusions – while acknowledging the scaffolding requirements that beginner learners legitimately need. The aim is not to produce a prescriptive model, but to offer tested conceptual tools that instructors can adapt to their specific language, curriculum, and student population.

1. Inductive Grammar

The most natural starting point for IBLT at the foundational level is grammar – not grammar as a rulebook to be memorized, but grammar as a system to be discovered. The shift is subtle but consequential: instead of telling students about certain grammatical rule, an instructor might present twenty authentic short sentences grouped by context and ask students to work out what pattern determines case selection.

This approach – sometimes called noticing-based or inductive grammar instruction – asks students to function as pattern detectors. The task is not to produce language immediately, but to observe it carefully. This is a cognitively accessible entry point even for students with limited productive ability. What changes is the stance: the student is an analyst, not a recipient.

Ellis (2002) argues that form-focused instruction is most effective when it arises from communicative need, and inductive tasks create precisely this condition (5). Nassaji and Fotos (2011) similarly demonstrate that learners who discover grammatical rules through structured data analysis retain those rules more durably than those who receive explicit instruction alone (7).

What makes this genuinely inquiry-based rather than merely interactive is the role of the question. Students are not directed toward a pre-determined answer; they are asked to form and test a hypothesis (4). Some groups will identify the target pattern quickly; others will identify a partial rule or a convincing but incorrect one. Both outcomes are valuable, because both require the instructor to respond to the students' thinking rather than simply confirm a pre-packaged answer. The conversation that follows – about why one hypothesis holds and another doesn't – is where much of the deep learning occurs (10).

Practical scaffolding for this strategy includes carefully curated sentence sets where the key variable is visible, observation worksheets that guide students through the noticing process without giving the answer away, and pair or group discussion before whole-class synthesis. The key design principle is that the data must be legible at the students' current proficiency level – obscure vocabulary or complex syntax will redirect cognitive effort away from the grammatical phenomenon being investigated.

2. Sociolinguistic Text Exploration

A second strategy repositions everyday texts as sociolinguistic artifacts rather than comprehension vehicles. In conventional lower-level instruction, a text – an email, a product label, a weather forecast – is typically used to practice reading skills or extract specific information. In

an inquiry-based frame, the same text becomes an object of analysis: Who wrote this, and for whom? What does it assume the reader knows? What is being sold, performed, or concealed?

These questions might seem to belong in advanced cultural studies courses, but they are surprisingly tractable at early proficiency levels when the texts are short, the vocabulary is accessible, and the analytical framework is introduced incrementally. A beginner-level English course, for example, might use two versions of the same advertising slogan – one formal, one colloquial – and ask students to identify which words differ and what those differences suggest about the intended audience. Students do not need to produce a sociolinguistic analysis; they need to notice that language varies with context and begin to ask why.

Students who are asked to interrogate texts – even simple ones – develop an early habit of reading as active meaning-makers rather than passive decoders. Critical reading at foundational levels, when scaffolded appropriately, cultivates transferable analytical dispositions that benefit learners across disciplines. This disposition, cultivated at the foundational stage, is transferable across disciplines and across languages. It also makes explicit something that communicative approaches sometimes leave implicit: that language is always doing social work, and understanding that work is part of becoming a competent user.

3. Small-Scale Research as Language Practice

A third strategy adapts the logic of project-based learning to the constraints of the lower-level language classroom. Rather than open-ended research projects – which presuppose both linguistic and investigative competencies that beginner learners are still developing – this approach uses tightly scoped tasks with a clear investigative question, a defined set of resources, and a structured output format.

Beckett and Slater (2005) demonstrate that project-based tasks, even when tightly scoped, develop both linguistic and investigative competencies simultaneously (1). Thomas (2000), in a comprehensive review of project-based learning, identifies clear investigative questions and structured outputs as the features most strongly associated with positive learning outcomes – precisely the design principles recommended here (11).

A practical example: in a lower-level Mandarin course, students might be asked to investigate how the same concept – punctuality, for instance, is discussed differently in mainland Chinese and Taiwanese online forums, using a curated set of short posts selected by the instructor. The question is narrow enough to be answerable; the linguistic demands are managed through resource selection; the output – a brief comparative summary, perhaps presented orally to a small group, is achievable at the students' proficiency level.

What makes this inquiry rather than simply a structured reading task is that students are gathering and synthesizing evidence to answer a question they cannot look up directly (6). They must make interpretive decisions, however modest, and take responsibility for a conclusion. Others further argue that the oral presentation component of such tasks – even at low proficiency levels – promotes negotiation of meaning and deepens content understanding. This is qualitatively different from answering comprehension questions, even well-designed ones, because it places the student in an epistemic position of not-yet-knowing rather than finding-the-answer-that-is-already there.

4. The Learner as Their Own Research Subject

A fourth strategy turns the inquiry inward: students investigate their own developing competence as a formal object of study. This is more structured than general reflective journaling and more purposeful than standard self-assessment checklists. The idea is to give students a

systematic method for examining their own errors, tracking their progress, and generating hypotheses about their learning patterns.

This approach draws on a robust tradition of research into learner autonomy and self-regulated learning. Most of the instructors identify deliberate practice – practice guided by careful attention to errors and feedback – as the central mechanism of expertise development, a finding that lends empirical support to the structured self-audit proposed here.

A simple implementation might look like this: at regular intervals across a semester, students review a sample of their own written or spoken production, categorize the errors they find using a basic taxonomy provided by the instructor, and write a short analytical note – in the target language, at a level appropriate to their proficiency – explaining what they notice and what they intend to do differently. Researchers observe that learners who engage in systematic error analysis develop greater metalinguistic awareness, which in turn accelerates acquisition. Learners who monitor their own cognitive processes are consistently more effective than those who do not.

This strategy is particularly well suited to the university context, where students are expected to develop as independent learners. Making the investigation of one's own acquisition an explicit course activity communicates that language learning is not something that happens to students but something they can actively shape.

Challenges and Institutional Considerations have impact in implementing this model at universities. Any honest account of IBLT at the foundational university level must acknowledge the structural pressures that work against it. Shohamy (2001) has extensively documented how standardized testing regimes constrain pedagogical innovation, often forcing instructors to prioritize discrete measurable outcomes over process-oriented learning goals (8). Stoller (2006) offers a practical response to this tension, demonstrating that project-based and inquiry-oriented approaches can be designed to produce conventional measurable outcomes while simultaneously developing investigative competencies (9).

One workable approach is to treat IBLT strategies as the vehicle for achieving conventional outcomes rather than a replacement for them: students who investigate the dative case inductively are still learning the dative case, but they are doing so through a process that is likely to produce more durable retention. The inquiry is the method; the grammatical or lexical competence is still the measurable outcome. Student resistance is a related challenge, particularly among learners who have been trained to expect explicit instruction and clear answers. Instructors should begin with shorter, lower-stakes inquiry tasks before moving to more extended project work.

The case for inquiry-based language teaching at the foundational university level rests on a straightforward claim: that students learn more durably when they construct understanding actively than when they receive it passively, and that this principle applies to language learning no less than to other disciplines. The four strategies discussed here – inductive grammatical investigation, sociolinguistic text analysis, bounded research tasks, and structured learner self-audit – are not a comprehensive curriculum framework. They are a set of starting points, each grounded in an inquiry logic that instructors can adapt, combine, and refine.

What connects these strategies is a shared commitment to repositioning the lower-level language learner as a thinker about language, not merely a practitioner of it. That repositioning, this article has argued, is both pedagogically sound and practically achievable – provided that inquiry is understood not as the absence of structure, but as a particular kind of structure, one organized around questions rather than answers.

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